

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה

LESHEM SHVO V'ACHLAMA

*Introductions and Gates · An Annotated English
Translation*

Volume One · Gates One Through Six

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The Hebrew source text of *Leshem Shvo v'Achlama* by Rabbi Shlomo Elyashiv (1841–1926) is a historical work. This edition's English translation, commentary, and annotations are original to this publication.

Volume One of 2 · Gates One Through Six

First edition.

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About This Work

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה

Leshem Shvo v'Achlama

Introductions and Gates · An Annotated English Translation



The Author

Rabbi Shlomo Elyashiv (1841–1926), known as the **Baal haLeshem**, was one of the foremost Kabbalists of the modern era. Born in Lithuania, he devoted his life to the systematic study and exposition of the *Lurianic Kabbalah* — the mystical tradition as taught by Rabbi Isaac Luria (the Arizal, 1534–1572) and transcribed by his chief disciple, Rabbi Chaim Vital.

His magnum opus, *Leshem Shvo v'Achlama* — named after three of the twelve precious stones on the High Priest's breastplate — is widely regarded as the most comprehensive and rigorous presentation of Kabbalistic metaphysics ever written.

The Work

The book is structured as a series of **Shaarim** (Gates), each probing a foundational question in Kabbalistic cosmology: the nature of the Divine Names, the *tzimtzum* (Divine contraction), the structure of the spiritual worlds, and the relationship between the infinite and the finite.

How to read each chapter

- **Hebrew paragraph** — the Baal haLeshem's original text
- **English translation in bold** — a close, faithful rendering
- *Commentary in italic* — explanatory notes for readers new to Kabbalistic terminology
- Footnotes at the bottom of each chapter link to primary sources (Zohar, Etz Chaim, Talmud, etc.)

Contents

Shaar 1 — The Names *Havaye* and *Ad-nai*

- Chapter 1: What the Names *Havaye* and *Ad-nai* Signify
- Chapter 2: The Revelation of the Name *Havaye* in *Atzilut* and in *BiYA*

Further chapters and Gates will be added as the translation progresses.

[Begin Reading →](#)

G A T E

Shaar 1 — The Names Havaye and Ad-nai

Chapter 1: What the Names Havaye and Ad-nai Signify

Leshem Shvo v'Achlamah

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה – הקדמות ושערים

שער א פרק א

Leshem Shevo v'Achlama — Introductions and Gates

Shaar 1 Chapter 1

What the Names *Havaye* and *Ad-nai* Signify

יסוד החכמה ושרש הקבלה.

§ 1:1

The foundation of wisdom and the root of Kabbalah

Rabbi Shlomo Elyashiv (1785–1866) is better known as the Baal haLeshem, after his magnum opus, *Leshem Shvo v'Achlama*, and we will refer to him this way henceforth. He begins his magnum opus explaining Rabbi Isaac Luria's system of Kabbalah with a phrase the initial letters of which spell the Ineffable Divine Name יהוה (often referred to as *Havaye* in English). This is a common practice, especially among Kabbalists.¹

אֲשֶׁר דָּבַר נֵר יְהוָה. אר"י [=אֲדֹנֵינוּ רַבִּי יִצְחָק] לֹוֹרֵא הַקְּדוֹשׁ יָדִיד מְבֹטָן אֶל הַתְּלֻמִּיד
יֵשֶׁר נְאֻמוֹ וְתִיק

§ 1:2

that 'the candle of God' – the holy [Rabbi Isaac] Luria, beloved from the womb, imparted to his upright, faithful and veteran student,

Interestingly, the Baal haLeshem continues the above theme of spelling the Name of G-d by emphasizing the initial letters of the next four words as well, spelling ג-ד-נ-א the Divine Name associated with G-d as Master (*Adon*) of the Worlds Who oversees and orchestrates everything. The Talmud² and the Zohar³ note that the Ineffable Divine Name is spelled יהוה but is pronounced ג-ד-נ-א (*A-d-o-n-a-i*). The Baal haLeshem continues with the same theme with the next five words as well, spelling ג-ד-ה-י-ם — G-d as the Divine Judge and Creator, followed by the words spelling "our G-d" א-ל-ה-י-נו — the G-d of Israel. He completes the theme with the next three words, as we will see below.

Rabbi Isaac Luria, known to many as the Arizal (1534–1572), is regarded as the father of modern Kabbalah. Rabbi Elyashiv reverently refers to him as "the candle of G-d," based on the verse in Proverbs 20:27,⁴ perhaps because Rabbi Luria revealed the inner light of the Torah.⁵ Furthermore, he refers to him as "beloved from the womb" which usually refers to the Patriarch Isaac,⁶ the Arizal's namesake. This may

be because Rabbi Isaac Luria is regarded as one of the founding patriarchs of Kabbalah.

אִישׁ חַיִּים דְּדִינֵנוּ. זָכָר שְׁנִיָּהֶם לְבָרְכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא.

§ 1:3

Our beloved 'man of life' [Rabbi Chaim Vital], may both be blessed with the life of the World to Come

As mentioned above, the Baal haLeshem completes his theme by spelling out the word ט-ח-א — [is] One, thus rendering the first sentence of this work as an acrostic of the foundational principle of Judaism which he intends to expound on in this chapter, and also throughout the entire work — the Oneness of G-d. His entire explanation is based on the teachings of the Arizal which he alludes to by including his name and the name of his chief redactor, Rabbi Chaim Vital, in stating his theme of G-d's unity. The word דְּדִינֵנוּ, besides meaning 'beloved,' may also mean 'our uncle.' Perhaps there was some family connection, although I was not able to find one.

Rabbi Chaim Vital (1543–1620) was among Rabbi Luria's foremost disciples (according to many, his chief disciple) and the one who committed his master's teachings to writing and taught them extensively.

לִידַע וּלְהוֹדִיעַ כִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹרָהֶם אֱלֹהֵי יִצְחָק וְאֱלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל.

§ 1:4

of knowing and informing us that God Almighty, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob, the God of Israel,

Rabbi Chaim was charged with the task of conveying this knowledge to us — that the God of the patriarchs is the singular Divine presence the Baal haLeshem now proceeds to describe.

הִנֵּה הוּא לְבַדּוֹ בְּרָצוֹנוֹ הַטּוֹב. הַמְצִיא כָּל הַנִּמְצָאִים וּבָרָא כָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים

§ 1:5

He alone, out of His good will, brought forth all those in existence and created all the creations

Here Rabbi Elyashiv alludes to the higher 'worlds' — spiritual planes of existence — that he will speak about at length shortly. 'Those in existence' refers to transcendent planes of existence, including the World of *Atzilut* which exists on a plane beyond actual creation; 'created all the creations' refers to the World of *Beriah* — a finite created world called the World of Creation. This is the plane of reality where limited existence comes into being, but it is as yet inchoate, formless, until the World of *Yetzirah*.

(Author's hand-written note: 'Created all the creations' — here I did not write 'creates' in the present tense since the word for creation — בְּרִיאָה — implies ex nihilo as Ramban states,⁷ and that is not applicable in the present.) Creation *ex nihilo* occurred once only, at the beginning of Creation. Now regarding the fact that a number of the blessings use the word בּוֹרָא — creates, in the present tense — our

Sages state (*Berachot* 52b) that בּוֹרָא 'creates', present tense, should be understood as 'created' in the past. But when בּוֹרָא in the present tense occurs after the expression בָּרָא past tense, it is clearly meant to indicate the past. In fact, the present tense is not even relevant since the creation was exclusively *ex nihilo*, and that occurred only on the first day of creation.

וַיֵּצֶר וַיּוֹצֵר כָּל הַיְצוּרִים וַעֲשָׂה וְעוֹשֶׂה כָּל הַמַּעֲשִׂים מִהֵנָּה הַכֹּל בְּכָל עֵת

§ 1:6

He formed and fashions all formed entities, and made and makes all made entities. He brings everything into being at every moment.

"Formed and fashions" refers to the World of *Yetzirah*, the World of Formation, where finite existence now acquires form and dimension. "Made and makes all made entities" refers to the World of *Asiyah* where they become material entities. The meaning of "He brings everything into being all the time" will be explained shortly.

[Meaning to say that all of existence in its entirety — from the time that He brought it forth, and the entire duration of its continued existence — its constant coming into being is only from Him, for He continuously maintains it in existence in all of its fullness].

All being is continuously being kept in existence by the Divine force that created, formed and made it.

וּמַשְׁגִּיחַ בְּכָל בְּלִי הַפֶּסֶק וּמְנַהִיג אֶת הַכֹּל תָּמִיד וְכֵן הוּא לְבִדּוֹ וְאֵין שׁוּם דָּבָר בְּלִעְדּוֹ
מֵאוּמָה בָּלָל.

§ 1:7

And He watches over all beings without pause, and He guides all things constantly; He alone and none other at all.

Here the Baal haLeshem alludes to the doctrine of Divine Providence which he will discuss in a later section.

שְׁמוֹ נִכְתָּב בְּשֵׁם י-ה-ו-ה וְנִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אֲדֹנָי.

§ 1:8

His Ineffable Name is written Yud-Hai-Vav-Hai but is pronounced Adonai.

On the verse (Exodus 3:15) זֶה שְׁמִי לְעֹלָם — "This is My Name forever..." our Sages⁸ note that the word *l'olam* (לְעֹלָם) is written without the letter *vav* and therefore alludes to the word for concealment — *he'elem*. Meaning: the eternal Name *Havaye* should not be read as written, but rather as *Adon-ai*. In order to distinguish the former Name from the latter, Kabbalists often used the term *Havaye* for the former.

וְהִנֵּה הוֹרָאת הָעֲקָרִי דְּהַשֵּׁם הַנִּיחָה הוּא נִמְצָא קִיָּים, וְר"ל שֶׁמִּצִּיאֻתּוֹ הוּא בְּהִנָּה
תָּמִיד וְאֵין בְּמִצִּיאֻתּוֹ עֶבֶר וְעֵתִיד

§ 1:9

The Name *Havaye* signifies primarily 'continuous presence,' meaning that His existence is always in the present, not the past or future

One cannot say that God's existence is in the past, since the past is no longer. Nor is it in the future, since that does not yet exist. His existence is therefore always in the present. Or as the *Zohar* puts it: "Past, present and future all at once" (*Zohar III* p. 257b, *Raya Mehemna*).

וְכֵן יֵשׁ בּוֹ גַם כֵּן הוֹרָאת מַהוּה עַל שֵׁם שְׁכָל הַהִתְהוּוֹת הוּא רַק מִמֶּנּוּ וְתִלּוּי לְעוֹלָם רַק בּוֹ.

§ 1:10

The Name Havaye also signifies 'bringing into being,' since all existence is exclusively from Him, and is always dependent upon Him.

שֶׁהוּא נוֹשֵׂא אוֹתָם בְּכָל מְלוֹאָם כְּנִזְכָּר

§ 1:11

For He maintains [literally, 'carries'] them — all the worlds and everything in them — as mentioned.

וְהִנֵּה עַל שֵׁם הַהִתְהוּוֹת שֶׁהִיא בְּזִמְנוֹ וְנִבְחָן בְּעֵבֶר וְהִנֵּה וְעֵתִיד הִנֵּה נִקְרָא הוּא יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ גַם כֵּן בְּשֵׁם תֹּאֵר הִנֵּה וְהִנֵּה שֶׁהֵם אוֹתִיּוֹת ג' הַיּוֹת.

§ 1:12

Now it is in terms of this 'bringing into being' — which takes place in time and can be differentiated into past, present and future — that He, may His Name Havaye be blessed, can be described as past, present and future, the letters of which are the three states of being — in the past, the present and the future.

The Name יה-וה-י can be explained as an amalgamation of יהִיָּה (was, is, will be — all three states of being throughout time). But this is only when the Name *Havaye* is interpreted as signifying 'bringing into being.'

אֲמָנָם עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ הוּא בְּאֵמֶת תְּמִיד בְּהוּה וְהוּא הוֹרָאת הֶעֱקָרִי דָשֵׁם הַיּוֹה בְּרוּךְ הוּא.

§ 1:13

But His essence (blessed be His Name) is truly always in the present, and this is the primary significance of the Name Havaye, blessed be He.

וְהוֹרָאת דָשֵׁם אֲדָנִי הוּא אֲדוֹן הַכֹּל שֶׁהוּא מְשַׁגִּיחַ בְּכָל וּמִנְהִיג אֶת הַכֹּל

§ 1:14

The import of the Name Adon-ai is that He is Adon [Master] of everything and that He oversees everything and conducts all matters.

וְהוּא בּוֹחֵן וְדוֹן אֶת כָּל הַמַּעֲשִׂים כָּל מֵה שֶׁנֶּצְרָךְ לְהַעֲשׂוֹת בְּכָל הַנִּמְצָאִים כְּלָם בְּקִיּוּמָם וְהַנְהִיגָתָם שְׁבָכָל עֵת.

§ 1:15

And He assesses and judges all deeds and everything that needs to be done with all things in existence, in preserving them and guiding them at all times.

The Name *Adon-ai* thus signifies the Almighty's relationship with the created worlds — as their Master, overseer, preserver and guide.

Footnotes

1. This is not exclusive to Kabbalists, however. See e.g. Rambam's *Mishneh Torah*, *Yesodei HaTorah* 1:1. [↩](#)
2. *Pesachim* 50a, cited below fn. 8. [↩](#)
3. *Zohar III* 230a; *Tikunei Zohar* 101a. [↩](#)
4. משלי כ, כז: נר יהוה נשמת אדם חפש כל חדרי בטן [↩](#)
5. See *Chagiga* 12a; *Zohar I* 47a, 264a; *Zohar II* 148b ff. [↩](#)
6. See *Talmud Shabbat* 137b; *Rashi*. [↩](#)
7. In his commentary to Genesis 1:1. [↩](#)
8. *Talmud Pesachim* 50a, *Rashi*. [↩](#)

Chapter 2: The Revelation of the Name Havaye in Atzilut and in BiYA

שער א פרק ב

Sha'ar 1 Chapter 2

The Revelation of the Name *Havaye* in *Atzilut* and in *BiY*"A

וְהִנֵּה כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם הִלְלוּ אֶשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ בְּכָל זֶה הִנֵּה הוּא רַק עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהִמְצִיא אֶת
כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת

§ 2:1

Now all of these revelations mentioned above that were radiated to us are nevertheless only because He brought forth all of existence.

It is by way of His bringing the worlds into existence that we have any grasp at all of Godliness. Indeed, according to the *Zohar*¹ and the *Arizal*,² this was in fact the purpose of creation.

אָבֵל זֹלַת הַמְּצִיאוֹת הִנֵּה הוּא פְּשׁוּט בְּאַחַדוֹת פְּשׁוּטָה בְּתַכְלִית הַפְּשִׁיטוֹת

§ 2:2

In Himself, other than in terms of this existence that He brought into being, He is 'simple' with the simple unity of absolute simplicity.

The term 'simple' here requires explanation. The closest conceptual equivalents may be 'essential', 'primordial', 'elemental' or perhaps even 'uncompounded' — in the sense of an absolute infinite oneness not comprised of disparate, limited parts.

וְאֵין לוֹ שׁוּם גְּלוּי בְּשׁוּם שֵׁם וְתֹאֵר כָּלֵל וְאֵין בּוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה כָּלֵל בְּשׁוּם דְּבָר וְשֵׁם
וּמְלָא וּבְשׁוּם אוֹת וּנְקֻדָּה

§ 2:3

He in His essence is not revealed in any Divine Name or description and He cannot be described at all in speech or name or word, and not in any letter or vowel point.

כִּי הֵרִי פֹלֶם הֵם בְּהוֹרָאת גְּבוּלֵי עַל כָּל פְּנִים וּבְאַחַדוֹתוֹ הַפְּשׁוּטָה הִנֵּה הוּא מְשַׁלָּל
מִזֶּה בְּתַכְלִית הַשְּׁלִילָה

§ 2:4

For they — words, names, descriptors — are all indicative of limitation in some sense, and in His uncompounded Oneness all descriptors are completely negated in regard to Him.

Any descriptor must have some limitation in order to describe the object of the description. Since He is in Himself infinite, and an indivisible unity, it is not possible to describe Him as He is in Himself. All descriptive terms are thus completely negated.

וְהֵרִי הוּא אִמְתַּת פְּשִׁיטוֹתוֹ נֶעְלַם בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעְלָם וְאֵי אֶפְשָׁר לְדַבֵּר וּלְהִרְהֵר בְּעֵנֵינוּ
אִמְתַּתוֹ וּשְׁלֵמוֹתוֹ אֶשֶׁר זֹלַת הַמְּצִיאוֹת

§ 2:5

Thus His true essential being is completely concealed and it is impossible to speak and think about the truth and completeness of His being which is devoid of existence in the regular sense of 'existence.'

As the Baal haLeshem just explained, our categories of thought and speech are inadequate to the task of positive descriptions of the Being whose existence transcends all limitations. However, as we will see, we can *negate* or repudiate any descriptions which are part of common parlance, and in this way come to a certain level of understanding, albeit negative understanding — i.e. what He isn't (but not what He is).³

אֵלָא רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ שְׁלִילָה לְבַד הֵינּוּ לְשַׁלֵּל מֵאַמְתַּת עֲצֻמּוּתוֹ וּפְשִׁיטוּתוֹ כֹּל עֲנָן גָּבּוּל וְתִמּוּנָה וְדִמְיוֹן

§ 2:6

But we can make use of the method of negation exclusively — that is to say, negate or repudiate any concept of limitation, representation or likeness from His true and simple essence.

וְרוּצָה לֹאמַר כִּי הִנֵּה כֹל גְּלוּיָיו הִנֵּה הֵם בְּעֶרְךָ פְּשִׁיטוּתוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה מֵהֵם בְּבַחֲנֵית כַּח גְּבּוּלֵי וְהִתֵּר לְתֵאֵר בָּהֶם כֹּל תֵּאֲרִי דְשַׁעוּרֵי קוּמָה

§ 2:7

Meaning to say, all revelations that emerge from Him, when compared with the simplicity of His essence that transcends them, are to be regarded as finite powers which it is permissible to describe using any of the descriptive terms that apply to the shiur koma.

The term *shiur koma* refers to those finite spiritual worlds that can in be in some sense described or 'computed,' as explained in Rabbi Yishmael's *Pirkei Heichalot*. Since these are all 'revelations that emerge from Him,' in the words of the Baal haLeshem, and are not His essence, it is permissible to use descriptive terms, and even anthropomorphisms to describe them, as the Baal haLeshem will show. Kabbalah often uses anthropomorphic terms when describing the worlds 'outside of' His essence.⁴

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁנִּמְצָא בַּתּוֹרָה כְּמָה תּוֹאֲרִים בְּזֶה כְּמוֹ וְתַחַת רַגְלָיו, כְּתוּבִים בְּאַצְבַּע אֱלֹהִים וְכַדּוּמָה הִרְבָּה וּבִפְקֻט בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים וּבְדַבְּרֵי חֻכְמֵי הָאֱמֶת

§ 2:8

As we find in the Torah itself a number of such descriptive terms, such as 'Underneath His feet...' [13]; 'Written by the finger of God' [14] and many similar expressions, particularly in The Song of Songs (Shir HaShirim) and in the writings of the 'Sages of Truth' — the Kabbalists.

הַגֵּם שֶׁעֵקֶרָם הֵם בְּאֵמֶת רַק עַל שֵׁם הַמְּצִיאֹת שֶׁיֵּצֵא מֵהֶם עַל כֹּל פָּנִים הִרִי הִתֵּר לְתֵאֵר אוֹתָם גַּם בְּגִלּוּיָיו עֲצֻמָּן גַּם כֵּן מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהֵם הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ לְהַמְצִיאֹת

§ 2:9

Even though primarily these descriptive terms truly only apply to the limited existence that emerges from them, nevertheless it is permissible to use these

descriptions for the revelations themselves as well, since they are (at the very least) the origin of limited existence.

מִשָּׂא כֹן בְּפִשְׁטוּתוֹ הָאֲמִתִּית אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה מִגְּלוּיָיו הֵנָּה שֵׁם אֲסוּר בְּכָל חֹמֶר הָאֲסוּר
הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי לְתַאֵר שֵׁם חֹסֵן וְשָׁלוֹם שׁוֹם בְּחִינַת הַמּוֹרָה עַל אֵיזָה כַּח גְּבוּלֵי וְתִמּוֹנָה
וְדַמְיוֹן

§ 2:10

But this is not the case regarding His true simple — i.e. essential — being that transcends all the revelations

וּמִשְׁלַל שֵׁם מִכָּל זֶה בְּתַכְלִית הַשְּׁלִילָה וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן שֵׁם כָּלֵל אֲלֵא רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ
שְׁלִילָה לְבַד

§ 2:11

— from which all descriptive terms are absolutely and totally negated. It is impossible to even ponder that level other than exclusively by way of negation —

It is possible to contemplate the transcendent Essence only in a negative sense — by repudiating any and all descriptive terms, in the manner that the Baal haLeshem will describe shortly.

לְשַׁלֵּל מִשֵּׁם כָּל עֲנֵן הַמּוֹרָה אֵיזָה חֲסֵרוֹן לְשִׁלְמוֹת הָאֲמִתִּית וְכָל עֲנֵן הַשְּׁגָה וְתַפְסִיחַ
מִזּוּלָּתוֹ

§ 2:12

— by negating there in His essence all concepts that indicate any deficiency in His true completeness, sometimes rendered as the 'Divine plenum.'

כִּי אֵין בְּלַעֲדוֹ יוֹדַע מֵאֲמִתּוֹ מֵאוּמָה וְכָל מָה שְׁאֵנוּ מְדַבְּרִים מִמֶּנּוּ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ הֵנָּה
הוּא רַק עַל יְדֵי מָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ עַל יְדֵי הַמְצִיאוֹת

§ 2:13

For no one besides Him knows anything of His true being; everything we discuss about Him is merely what is revealed to us by way of the limited existence that He brings into being.

Furthermore, this limited existence is all post-*tzimtzum*, where descriptive terms apply, as the Baal haLeshem will explain shortly.

וְכֵן גַּם הַגְּלוּי דְּהַשֵּׁם הַיְּהִי בְּרוּךְ הוּא הֵגֵם שְׁאֵמְרָנוּ שֶׁהוֹרָאָתוֹ הוּא עַל מְצִיאוֹתוֹ
הָאֲמִתִּית שֶׁהוּא בְּהוֹרָה תְּמִיד וּבִלְתִּי זְמַן

§ 2:14

So too, the revelation of the blessed Name Havaye, even though we stated that it is indicative of His true infinite and ineffable existence — in that He is always in the present and beyond time —

הֵנָּה גַּם הַגְּלוּי הַזֶּה נִתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ בּוֹ גַּם כֹּן רַק עַל יְדֵי הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת

§ 2:15

even this revelation is disclosed to us via the existence of the worlds.

כִּי כָל בְּחִינָה נִמְצָא וְהוּא אֲשֶׁר בְּהוֹרָאָת דְּשֵׁם הַיְּהִי בְּרוּךְ הוּא הֵנָּה הוּא גַּם כֹּן רַק
אֲחֵר שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת כּוּלָּם

§ 2:16

Because every aspect indicated by the blessed Name Havaya also is to be found (nimtza) and exists only after it has been revealed within the limited, finite existence of all the worlds.

כִּי כָּל לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא הוּא מוֹרָה עַל גְּלוּי בְּחִדּוּשׁ שֶׁנִּתְחַדֵּשׁ וְנִתְגַּלָּה וְנִמְצָא

§ 2:17

Indeed, every instance of the word nimtza — 'is to be found' — is indicative of a radiance or revelation that is generated anew and becomes revealed and is then 'to be found.'

וְכֵן הוּא מוֹרָה עַל גְּלוּי לְזוּלָתוֹ כִּי כֵן הוּא לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא שֶׁנִּמְצָא לְזוּלָתוֹ

§ 2:18

In addition, the word nimtza also denotes a revelation to something or someone other than Himself; this is actually the semantic definition of 'nimtza' — 'to be found by another' i.e. those who are not Him.

וְעִקָּר לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא הוּא מְגִזֵּרֵת יֵצֵא שֶׁיֵּצֵא מִהֶעֱלָמָתוֹ וְהָרִי הוּא מוֹרָה עַל חִדּוּשׁ עַל כָּל פְּנִימִים

§ 2:19

Indeed, the primary derivation of the word 'nimtza' is from 'yatza' — 'emerged,' 'exited' — it emerged from its prior state of concealment, which anyway indicates that it is generated anew.

וְרוּצָה לוֹמַר שֶׁנִּתְחַדֵּשׁ גְּלוּי מִהֶעֱלָמָתוֹ שֶׁבִּתְחִלָּה כִּי בִּתְחִלָּה הָיָה נֶעְלָם וְעַכְשָׁיו נִתְגַּלָּה וְזֶהוּ לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא

§ 2:20

Meaning to say that this radiance is a new revelation from its prior state of concealment; initially it was concealed and now it is revealed. That is the meaning of 'nimtza.'

וְהָרִי הָיָה גְּלוּי בְּחִדּוּשׁ וְהֵינּוּ מַעַת הַצִּמְצוּם וְלִהְיָאָה שְׂאֵז יֵצֵא מִהֶעֱלָמָתוֹ דְּבִחִינָת אֵין סוֹף וְנִתְּן אֶפְשָׁרִית לְגִלּוּי

§ 2:21

Thus the radiance is a new phenomenon — from the moment of the tzimtzum and on — for this is when it emerged from its state of concealment where it was the aspect of Ein Sof, infinite and therefore ineffable. It was the tzimtzum that gave the possibility for it to emerge as a revelation.

The *tzimtzum* is a major subject that requires some explanation.⁵

As the Baal haLeshem will explain later, this very first radiance or revelation after the *tzimtzum* is called the *kav*⁶ — the ray of light (so to speak) that after a series of further reductions and descents becomes the first plane of existence known in Kabbalah as the meta-world *Adam Kadmon*, the highest and most exalted of the five worlds. *Adam* means "in the likeness of" or "in the image of," from the Hebrew word *domeh*. *Kadmon* means "primordial" or "primary," from the Hebrew root *kadam*. So, *Adam Kadmon* is the primordial, transcendent world which is "in the likeness of" the Infinite Light which preceded it and which became concealed in the process of

creation. This means that even though *Adam Kadmon* is a world that comes into being through the concealment of the Infinite Light, it is such an elevated plane of reality that it remains transcendent — "in the likeness of" the Infinite Light. Thus, the world of *Adam Kadmon* could be called a meta-world, a level so sublime, pure and transcendent that it is almost imperceptible. It cleaves to and mirrors the original Infinite Light.

וכן נתגלה אחר כך בגלוי ממש על ידי האצילות

§ 2:22

And afterwards this radiance becomes revealed in actuality by way of the plane of reality called Atzilut, the world of Emanation.

ומאז נהלצה הוא נתגלה ונמצא שהוא הנה תמיד והוא הוראת דשם הנה ברוך
הוא נמצא קים כנ"ל פרק א'

§ 2:23

And from then on this Divine radiance is in a state of revelation and 'is to be found,' for He always is in the present. This then is what the blessed Name Havaye connotes: 'is to be found' existing, as explained above chap. 1.

אמנם גם הוראת לשון הנה הוא מורה גם כן רק על גלוי לזולתו כי כל שם ומלה
הנה הוא לעולם רק כדי להשתמש על ידיה לזולתו

§ 2:24

However, even the word *hoveh*[¹⁷] — the aspect of the Divine Name that denotes His always being in the present — also only implies 'revelation to another,' i.e. to those who are not Him, since every name and word is always and only so that another can use it.

והוא מה שאמרו במדבר רבה פרשת חקת סימן ג' אני ה' הוא שמי הוא שמי שקרא
לי אדם הראשון הוא שמי שהתניתי ביני לבין עצמי

§ 2:25

This is the significance of the statement in Midrash Bamidbar Rabba (Chukat 19:3) on the verse 'I am Havaye that is My Name' [¹⁸] (Isaiah 42:8): 'This is the Name that Adam called me; this is My Name regarding which I made stipulations with Myself' regarding revelation of Myself therein.

[Meaning to say, this is the Name with which He emerged from concealment to revelation, and His Essence was revealed in this Name. And when it says 'with Myself' this refers to the radiance in Atzilut that was revealed there from the concealed True Being above].

Note that the square brackets are in the original. The meaning of 'stipulations with Myself' will be explained shortly.

The World of *Atzilut* (emanation) is the first of the immanent worlds. The word *Atzilut* in Hebrew derives from the word *etzel*, meaning "close to" or "near."⁷ The world of *Atzilut* is "close to" its source, even though it is not united and identified with it to the same degree as the world of *Adam Kadmon*. Nevertheless it is a lofty and rarefied plane of reality which is merely emanated, not yet created. But the word

Atzilut also means "to set aside," "separated from," as in the verse "And I will set aside from (*v'atzalti*) the spirit that is upon you and place it upon them"⁸ (Numbers 11:17), for the world of *Atzilut* is, so to speak, 'set aside from' God's essence, as the Baal haLeshem goes on to explain.

הוא שמי שהתניתי ביני לבין בריותי ורוצה לומר שנתגלה על ידו לזולתו והוא בעולמות בריאה יצירה ועשיה

§ 2:26

'And this is the Name with which I made stipulations between Myself and My creations,' meaning to say that there was revelation to others — i.e. to those who are not Him — by way of the Name. This alludes to the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

Beriah, the world of Creation, is the second immanent world. It is a tremendous step down from the world of *Atzilut*, as it is the beginning of created being. ברא — the root of the word *Beriah* ('creation'), is always used in Hebrew to signify *yesh mi-ayin* — creation *ex nihilo*.⁹ This implies the coming into being of limited, restricted, finite existence.

Yetzirah is the third of the four immanent spiritual worlds, the realm of spiritual existence in which the limited nature of the created beings takes on form and definition, and *Asiyah*, the fourth and lowest immanent world, is the dimension where Godliness is most concealed. It is the final stage in the creative process and the lowest aspect of it includes the physical universe. The Baal haLeshem will explain all of these in their proper place (in *Shaar 2*).

והרי לנו שכל הגלוי דהשם הויה ברוך הוא הוא רק מעת האצילות ולהלאה ורק מה שנתגלה בו לזולתו

§ 2:27

Thus we have it that all revelations to us of the blessed Name Havaye are exclusively from the moment the world of *Atzilut* was emanated and on, and only that which was revealed therein to those who are not Him.

ומה שנאמר שהתניתי לשון תנאי הוא במה שגזרה רצונו יתברך להתגלות רק בגלוי הזה דוקא ולא באופן אחר בשום פנים וכן לא למטה ממנו ולא למעלה ממנו

§ 2:28

And the phrase 'with which I made stipulations' expresses a condition to be met — signifying that it depends upon what His blessed will decrees — to reveal only in this specific manner of revelation and in no other way at all; and no lower nor loftier than decreed.

והוא במה שנודע שהתחלת הגלוי דהשם הויה ברוך הוא הוא רק בכל הנאצלים אשר מהצמצום ולמטה אבל לא מהצמצום ולמעלה

§ 2:29

Specifically, the decree is, as is known, that the initial revelation of the blessed Name Havaye shall only be in that which is emanated after the *tzimtzum* and below, but not prior to the *tzimtzum*.

וכן גלוי לזולתו הנמשך ממנו להעולמות בריאה יצירה ועשייה הנה הוא בעולם
האצילות ורק בזעיר אנפין ומלכות ולא יצא בעולמות ברי"ע בגלוייו אשר למעלה
מהזעיר אנפין ומלכות

§ 2:30

In addition, the revelation to 'something other' — i.e. to those levels below Atzilut that are regarded as 'other' — that is drawn down from the world of Atzilut to the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah (abbreviated as BiYA), is only drawn from the aspects of zeir anpin and malchut. Thus, the radiance that is drawn into the worlds of BiYA is no higher than zeir anpin and malchut.

Ze'ir anpin is a cluster of *sefirot* that includes *chesed*, *gevurah*, *tiferet*, *netzach*, *hod* and *yesod*. Its composition and function will be discussed later on. *Malchut* is the final *sefirah* and is also referred to as *Shechinah*. These will be explained at length in *shaar 7*.

אלא רק באור דזעיר אנפין ומלכות לבד שהם השמות דהנה אדני.

§ 2:31

This radiance is only from the light of z'a (ze'ir anpin) and malchut, which are the Names Havaye and Ad-nai.

וכנדע שער דהשם הנה ברוך הוא נשלם בזעיר אנפין ומתלבש
בהמלכות ושם נתגלה בהשם אדני

§ 2:32

As is known, the primary revelation of the blessed Name Havaye is manifested completely in z'a, which is then clothed in malchut, where it is revealed as the Name Ad-nai.

ויצא על ידי זה בהעולמות ברי"ע ולא המשיך גלוי דעצמות אור השם הנה ברוך
הוא יותר למטה שהוא בעולם הבריאה

§ 2:33

By way of this process it descends into the worlds of BiYA. However, the radiance of the essence of the blessed Name Havaye is not drawn down to the World of Beriah

וכנדע שער עצמות אלהות נתצמצם להסתים בסוף המלכות דאצילות שהיא
הה"א אחרונה דהשם והיא המתגלה בשם אדני

§ 2:34

As is known, the primary essence of Godliness — i.e. divine revelation — is curtailed and terminates at the lowest level of malchut of Atzilut, corresponding to the final letter hai of the Name Havaye, and is revealed as the Name Ad-nai.

ונתצמצם ומסתים עצמות אלהות בסוף המלכות דאצילות ומשם ולמטה הם
נבראים נוצרים נעשים שאינם אלהות כלל

§ 2:35

As mentioned, the essence of Godliness is curtailed and terminates at the lowest level of malchut of Atzilut. From there on below are the created, formed and made

beings in the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah respectively, that are not Godliness at all.

וְכָל אֹרֹחַ הַנֶּמֶשׁ בָּהֶם הוּא רַק עַל יְדֵי מַסְכִּים

§ 2:36

All the light drawn into them is only via 'screens.' Light on the other side of a screen is called 'ohr shel toldah' — second-generation or derivative light, not original first-generation light.[²²]

וְלֹא נִמְשַׁךְ בָּהֶם אֶלָּא רַק תּוֹלְדוֹת הָאָרֶה לְבַד וּבִזָּה בָּרָא וַיִּצַּר וְעָשָׂה כָּל הַמַּצְיָאוֹת
דְּבִרִּי"ע

§ 2:37

There is not drawn into them — the worlds of BiYA — anything other than a mere radiance, and it was from this that He created, formed and made the worlds of BiYA as they exist.

[All of this is explained in Etz Chaim, in Seder Atzilut in chap. 1 summary; *ibid.* Drushei ABiYA chap 13; Seder ABiYA chap. 1 (end); *ibid* Kisei Hakavod chap. 1 (end). See also Seder ABiYA chap. 6; Kisei Hakavod chap. 5. As is known to those who have tasted from the Etz Chaim — The Tree of Life i.e. the Kabbalah of the Arizal].

The brackets appear in the original. This is a parenthetical statement offering some sources for further study.

וְהוּא שֶׁאִמְרוּ הַתְּנִיטִי לְשׁוֹן תְּנֵאִי לִמְרָשָׁלָה נִתְּגַלָּה אֶלָּא בְּגִלּוֹי הִזָּה דְּיֻקָּא וְלֹא נִתְּן רְשׁוּת לְקִירוֹתָיו וְלַעֲבָדוֹ אֶלָּא רַק בְּאוֹתוֹ הַגִּלּוֹי דְּיֻקָּא.

§ 2:38

To return to our earlier theme: this is why the Sages said that the word הִתְגַּבֵּיתִי (I stipulated) expresses a condition to be met — for He would not be revealed other than in this manner, and permission was not given to call out to Him and serve Him other than via this exact revelation.

Footnotes

1. The term 'revelations/s' – גלויות in Hebrew – refers to Hashem revealing Himself as Himself and not through any individual. It is not meant to convey any sense of revelation as in prophecy etc. ↩
2. Zohar II, 42a: ...נחית תמן. בזה הארץ דיוקנא דמרכבה דאדם עלאה, נחית תמן. בגין דישתמודעון ליה במדות דיליה בכל ואתקרי בההוא דיוקנא יהוה, בגין דישתמודעון ליה במדות דיליה בכל ומדה ומדה. וקרא אל אלהים שדי צבאות אהי"ה, בגין דישתמודעון ליה בכל מדה ומדה ... דאי לא יתפשט נהוריה על כל ברין איך ישתמודעון ליה, ואיך יתקיים (ישעיה ו ג) מלא כל הארץ כבודו ↩
3. See Rambam's Moreh Nevuchin part 1, chap. 58. ↩
4. See Etz Chaim, Shaar 42:2. ↩
5. See Etz Chaim, Shaar 1:2. ↩

6. See *Etz Chaim, Shaar 1:2*. [↩](#)
7. *Pardes, shaar 16:1*. See also *Zohar Chadash, Terumah 29*. [↩](#)
8. *Pardes, shaar 16:1*. [↩](#)
9. Ramban, Genesis 1:1 — "ואין אצלנו בלשון הקדש בהוצאת היש מאין אלא" — [↩](#) "לשון **ברא**

Chapter 3: Derivative Names and Titles

שער א פרק ג

Shaar 1 Chapter 3

Derivative Names and Titles

ונחזור על הדברים כי הנה נתבאר לנו שגם הגלוי דהשם הויה ב"ה אשר הוא עצמו נקרא בו

§ 3:1

Let us recap: It was explained that even the revelation of the blessed Name Havaye by which He Himself is called

ר"ל שאמתת עצמותו הנעלמה נתגלה להקרא בשם זה הנה גלוי אשר נתגלה בזה הוא רק ע"י המציאות

§ 3:2

– meaning to say, when His true hidden essence becomes revealed and can be called by this Name – this revelation in which He is revealed is only by way of finite existence.

והיינו ע"י המציאות דכל הנאצלים אשר מהצמצום ולמטה שעל ידם נתגלה להקרא הוא עצמו בשם הויה ב"ה

§ 3:3

I.e. His Name is revealed via the existence of the emanated worlds post-tzimtzum* and on. It is through them that He becomes revealed so that He Himself can be called Havaye, may He be blessed.

אמנם הגלוי הזה הוא גלוי כללי ומסתער לפרטים רבים שהם כל השמות וכנויים כלם הנמסר לנו בתוה"ק שבכתב ושבע"פ ככל המבאר בדברי חכמי האמת

§ 3:4

However, this revelation is a general revelation that branches out into many details, which are all the holy Names and designations that have been conveyed to us in the holy Torah, both Written and Oral. As all this is explained in the words of the Sages of Truth – a term reserved for the sages of the Kabbalah.

There are seven holy names appearing in the Written Torah (i.e. Scripture), often referred to as 'the seven names which it is forbidden to erase'.¹

וכלם הם מסתעפים מהשם הויה ב"ה כי כלם הם לפי הוראת גלויי הפרטים אשר נתגלה בהמציאות

§ 3:5

But all of them branch out from the blessed Name Havaye, because all of them are according to the specific revelations revealed within finite existence.

הן בפרטי מציאותם גופה והן בפרטי תהלוכות עניני הנהגתם

§ 3:6

This is the case with regard to the details of their existence itself, and with regard to their specific manner of conduct

וְהוּא מִה שְׁנוּדַע מֵאֲמָרִים ז"ל בְּשֵׁמוֹר פ"ג סִימָן ו' לְפִי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי נִקְרָא

§ 3:7

– as is known from the statement of our Sages in **Shemot Rabba** 3:6: 'According to My deeds I am called...'

The Midrash explains that after God gave Moses the mission to liberate the Israelites from Egypt, Moses asked: "When I come to the Israelites to tell them, 'the God of your forefathers sent me to you' they will say to me, 'What is His name?' What should I then answer them?" (Exodus 3:13). The Midrash goes on to give God's response, the latter part of which the Baal HaLeshem quotes here: "My [ineffable] Name you wish to know? *According to My deeds I am called.*"² We will refer to the latter as names and 'titles' or 'designations' – i.e. the names and titles (such as 'the Merciful One, the Almighty etc.) used in reference to God. When 'Name' is capitalized it refers to the ineffable Name (י-ה-ו-ה or *Havaya*).

וְנִמְצָא וְנַעֲשֶׂה כָּל שֵׁם וְשֵׁם לְפִי גִלּוּיוֹ שֶׁבְּכָל פֶּרֶט כִּי הַשֵּׁם וְהַגִּלּוּי אֶחָד הוּא שֶׁהֵשֵׁם
עֲצָמוֹ הוּא הַגִּלּוּי

§ 3:8

So it turns out that each name is fashioned according to its specific revelation in every detail, because the name and the revelation are one and the same. For the name itself **is** the revelation.

The above applies only to the other names, not to the ineffable Name, as will be clarified shortly.

וְכָל אֱלוֹ הַשְּׁמוֹת וְהַגִּלּוּיִם הַפְּרָטִיִּים הֵם כֻּלָּם מִסְתַּעְפִּים וְיוֹצְאִים מִשְּׁמוֹ וְגִלּוּיוֹ הַכִּלְלִי
שֶׁהוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּיָה ב"ה כִּי הֵם רַק פְּרָטִי גִלּוּיָיו עֲצָמוֹ כִּנּוּי

§ 3:9

All of these names and individual revelations – the ones that are according to His deeds – all of them branch out and emerge from His Name and overarching revelation.^[4] the Name *Havaye*. For they are merely the specific revelations of the ineffable Name itself, as mentioned.

וְהִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה בִּכ"ז ע"י הַמַּצִּיאוֹת דְּכָל הַנֶּאֱצָלִים אֲשֶׁר מֵהַצְמָצוֹם וּלְמַטָּה

§ 3:10

Yet nevertheless they are revealed through the limited existence of all the emanated worlds and levels from the **tzimtzum** and on.

See our explanation of the *tzimtzum* according to Rabbi Elyashiv in *shaar* 1, chap. 2.

כִּי ע"ז נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם הוּיָה ב"ה וְכֵן בְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת וְכִנּוּיִם הַמִּסְתַּעְפִּים מִמֶּנּוּ

§ 3:11

For it is by way of this **tzimtzum** that He becomes revealed to be called *Havaye* (may He be blessed) and all the other names and titles that stem from it from the ineffable Name *Havaye*.

וְהֵם כָּל הַתּוֹאֲרִים כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר עָלָיו ית"ש שֶׁהוּא עֲצָמוֹ נִקְרָא וּמִתְאָר בָּהֶם ע"פ גִּלּוּיָיו
שֶׁבְּאֲצִילוֹת

§ 3:12

These are all the descriptive terms or titles for Him, may He be blessed, by which He is called and described – according to what He reveals in the world of Atzilut.

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה כָּל אוֹתָן הַגְּלוּיִם בְּאַצִּילוֹת לְפִי צֶרֶךְ הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע כָּל מָה שֶׁנֶּצֶר לַמְּצִיאוֹתָם וְהַנְּהָגָתָם

§ 3:13

Now all of these revelations of the various names and titles in Atzilut are according to the needs of the existential worlds – i.e. the finite worlds of *BiYA* \Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah\, in contrast with the emanated world of Atzilut and above.

וְהוּא שֶׁאֲמָרוּ בְּרַע"מ פְּנִיחַס רנ"ז ב' קִדְּם דְּבָרָא עַלמָא אֲתִקְרִי הוּא בְּכָל אֱלִין דְּרָגִין עַל שֵׁם בְּרִיין דְּהוּ עֲתִידִין לַהֲבָרָאוֹת

§ 3:14

This is what the *Zohar* III in *Raya Mehemna*^[^5] *Pinchas* 257b states: 'Before He created the world He was called all of those levels in the name of the future creation.'

The *Zohar* here addresses the question as to whether the various names and titles indicate a change in the *Ein Sof* from one state to another – e.g. from judgment to mercy, which would contradict the principles of G-d's immutability and His unity. The *Zohar* answers that even prior to Creation He is called all of these different names and titles etc., not because they actually apply to Him, but because it arose in His will to create the various worlds where these terms would apply in the future. It is only because of the future creation that these terms come into being.³

וְהוּא כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם לְפִי הַסֵּדֶר שֶׁרָאָה רְצוֹנוֹ לִיסֵד בָּהֶם אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּבִי"ע

§ 3:15

These are all the revelations in Atzilut that were revealed there according to the order that He wanted in order to later on establish the existential worlds of *BiYA* – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְאָמַר שֵׁם הָרַע"מ עוֹד דָּאִי לֹא בְּרִיין דְּהוּ דַּעֲלָמָא אֲמַאי אֲתִקְרוּ רְחוּם, דִּין? אֵלָּא עַל שֵׁם בְּרִיין דַּעֲתִידִין

§ 3:16

The *Raya Mehemna* ibid. states further that if not for the creations that would come to be in the world, why would He be called 'the Merciful One, or Judge?' Rather, all of the names and titles are for the sake of future creations.

דְּאִילוּלָא שֶׁהַמְּצִיא אֶת הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע הָיָה כָּל גְּלוּיָיו שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת לְלֹא צֶרֶךְ וּבְגִין דָּא כָּל שְׁמֵהּ אֲנוֹן כְּנוּיִין דְּלִיָּה עַל שֵׁם עוֹבֵדִין דְּלִיָּה שְׁכָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת שֶׁהֵם גְּלוּיָיו הֵם רַק בְּשֵׁבִיל הַבִּי"ע ע"פ מָה שֶׁרָאִוי לָהֶם

§ 3:17

Were it not for the worlds of *BiYA* – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah – that He brought forth, all of the revelations in Atzilut would have been unnecessary. Therefore, all the holy names, His titles so to speak, are given in reference to His

deeds, since all the holy names in Atzilut, which are His revelations, are only for the sake of the worlds of *BiYA*, in the manner that is appropriate for each of them.

אֲמָנָם כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם הֵלְלוּ הוּא רַק מֵעַתָּה הַצְמָצוּם וְלִהְיוֹתָ וְכֵן רַק מִהַצְמָצוּם וְלִמְטָה
שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל הָאֲצִילוֹת כֻּלּוֹ אֲבָל לֹא קֹדֶם הָאֲצִילוֹת וְלֹא לְמַעַלָּה מֵאֲצִילוֹת

§ 3:18

However, all of these revelations are only from the time of the *tzimtzum* and on, and only from the *tzimtzum* and below – which is the entire emanated world of Atzilut, but not prior to the emanation of Atzilut, and not above it, on a higher level than Atzilut.

All of the holy names and titles become manifested only after the *tzimtzum*, and only in the world of Atzilut, not above it. The *Meir HaLeshem*,⁴ one of the commentaries on this work, notes that the Baal HaLeshem seems to be making a distinction here between time ("not prior to...") and space ("not above it"), and he is puzzled as to the reason for the distinction.

However, the concept of time itself in the normal meaning of the word is not relevant in Atzilut, just the concept of space per se is not relevant. Perhaps he means what is called in Midrash *seder zemanim*.⁵

וְנִמְצָא שֶׁכָּל גְּלוּיָיו כָּלָם שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת וְהַכְּנוּיִם כָּלָם הֵם רַק ע"י הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹלָם
הָאֲצִילוֹת וּע"פ מָה שֶׁרָאוי מֵהֶם לְהַמְצִיאוֹת דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 3:19

It transpires therefore that each and every one of His revelations, which are all the names and titles discussed previously, all of them are only revealed by way of the existence of the world of Atzilut. And from them – the revelations in Atzilut – they are drawn down into the existential worlds of *BiYA*, as appropriate for them.

אֲמָנָם כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם הֵלְלוּ שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת וְהַכְּנוּיִם כָּלָם הֵנָּה הֵם מִה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה הוּא
עַצְמוֹ בָּהֶם ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וְנִקְרָא הוּא עַצְמוֹ בָּהֶם כָּלָם ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 3:20

However, all of these revelations – each and every one of the names and titles – are the way in which He Himself is revealed in them via Atzilut. And He Himself is called by all of them via the emanated world of Atzilut.

As the Baal HaLeshem indicated before (from the Midrash) "According to My deeds I am called..." – in other words, it is Me who is acting through these names etc. via their source in Atzilut, as he goes on to explain:

וְהֵנָּה הֵם כָּלָם רַק מֵעַתָּה שֶׁעָלָה בְּרָצוֹנוֹ לְהַמְצִיא בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת דְּהָאֲצִילוֹת וְלִהְיוֹתָ
וְלִהְיוֹתָ עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֵת כָּל הַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 3:21

Now all of these names are only from the time that it arose in His will to be found within^[9] the existence of Atzilut and to be revealed there, and to bring forth all the worlds of *BiYA* thereby.

Footnotes

1. See Talmud *Sh'vuot* 35b; *Shulchan Aruch*, *Yoreh De'ah* 276:9. [↩](#)
2. Note that the previous chapter in our *Midrash* (3:5), and similarly in *Midrash Tanchuma Shemot* (3:25), Moses wanted to know His *great Name* (i.e. Havaye) explicitly. [↩](#)
3. Following *Matok MiDevash*. [↩](#)
4. Footnote 25. [↩](#)
5. See *Bereishit Rabba* 3:7. [↩](#)

Chapter 4: Two Aspects of Revelation in Atzilut

שער א פרק ד

Shaar 1 Chapter 4

Two Aspects of Revelation in Atzilut

וְהָיָה הָיָה סֵדֶר גְּלוּיָיו אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת מִשְׁעָר וּמִכְנֹן בְּכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם בְּמִדָּה וּבְמִשְׁקָל לְפִי
סֵדֶר תּוֹצְאוֹת הַבִּי"ע שֶׁרָצָה לְהוֹצִיא עַל יְדֵיהֶם

§ 4:1

Now, the order of His revelations in the world of Atzilut were measured and precise in all aspects, measured and weighed, so to speak, according to the order of the results that He wished to produce thereby in the worlds of *BiYA*.

כִּי הָיָה כָּל אוֹתוֹ הַגְּלוּיִים אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת הָיָה הֵם עֲצָמָם הַשְּׂרָשִׁים הָעֲקָרִיִּים
דִּהְיוּ לְמוֹת בִּי"ע וְכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם בְּכָללוֹת וּפְרָטוֹת

§ 4:2

Because all of those revelations in Atzilut are themselves the primary roots of the worlds of *BiYA* and all related concepts both generally and specifically.

In Talmudic dialectic when a general rule is followed by an explicit particular, the rule is limited to the specified particular. The Baal HaLeshem invokes this exegetical rule here as well, since the general revelation in Atzilut is limited to the specified particulars He desired in the lower worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, as explained in chapters 2 & 3.

וְנוֹדַע הוּא כִּי בְּכָל שְׂרֵשׁ הָיָה מְסֻדָּר בּוֹ כָּל כְּחוֹתָיו וּתְכוּנוֹתָיו וְכָל לְפִי עֲנִינֵי תוֹלְדוֹת
הָעֵנָף וְהַפְּרִי שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ

§ 4:3

It is known that in every root of a plant all the capacities and qualities are arrayed only according to the products that will emerge later in the branch and fruit that derive and emerge from them – from the roots.

The analogy here to a plant and its roots and fruits comes to illustrate an important principle the Baal HaLeshem outlined earlier – that the products in the lower world (ultimately the 'fruits') are the primary purpose, not the roots. The roots serve merely to nourish and support the plant and fruits that grow from them.

וְהוּא מ"ש בְּזוֹהַר קִפְּדֵי רכ"א ע"א דְּכָל מָה דְּבָרָא קוֹדֵשׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא בְּעֻלְמָא דִּין
בָּרָא לֵיהּ כְּגוֹנָא דְלַעֲלָא

§ 4:4

As is written in the Holy Zohar (*Zohar* II *Pekudei* 221a) that everything the Holy One, blessed be He, created in this world, He created in the likeness of the worlds above.^[10]

וְכָל אֲנוּן גּוֹנִין דְלַעֲלָא אֲתִקִּין לוֹן לְתַתָּא לְמַהוּי עֻלְמָא דָּא בְּדִיוּקָא דְעֻלְמָא דְלַעֲלָא
לְאֲתִדְבָּקָא וּלְאֲתִקְשָׁרָא עֻלְמָא בְּעֻלְמָא

§ 4:5

(The Zohar continues:) All of those 'appearances' [12] – the clusters of *sefirot* or 'spiritual profiles' called *partzufim* [13] – above in the world of Atzilut, He established down below as well, in the worlds of *BiYA* [14] so that this world would be in the likeness of the world above so that one world will cleave to and be bound to the other.

וְכֵן בַּ' תִּצְוֶה קפ"ו ע"ב דְּלִית לָךְ מַלְאָה בְּעֵלְמָא דְּלֵא אִית לָהּ דּוּגְמָא לְעִילָא כְּגוֹנָא
דְּלְעִילָא הִכִּי אִית לְתַתָּא

§ 4:6

Similarly in *parshat Tetzaveh* (186b) the *Zohar* states: There is nothing in the world that does not have its likeness above; as it is above, so is it below.

וְהוּא מְשׁוּם שְׁשׁוּרֶשׁ כָּל מִצִּיאוֹתֵם אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע בְּכָל וּבְפֶרֶט וְכָל סֻדָּרָם
וְתֵהְיוּכֹתִיָּהֶם הֵן מֵה שְׁנוּגָע לְעִצְמוֹתֵם הָעֲקָרִי וְהֵן כָּל מְקָרִיָּהֶם שְׁנַעֲשֶׂה בָּהֶם

§ 4:7

This is because the root of the existence of all entities in all of the worlds of *BiYA*, in general and specifically, and the way they are all arranged in their various groupings and the manner in which they proceed – whether relating directly to their essence or whether to tangential occurrences that involve them –

הִנֵּה שֶׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַדְּבָרִים הוּא הֶכָל בְּאַצִּילוֹת וּמִשָּׁם נִמְשָׁךְ בָּהֶם וְהֵם הֵם גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש
אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת שְׁבָהֶם הוּא מְהוּרָה הֶכָל וּמִנְהִיג אֶת הֶכָל תְּמִיד וְהֵם הֵם שְׁמוֹתָיו ית"ש
§ 4:8

– the root of all of these things is all in Atzilut, from whence it is drawn down to them. These are His very revelations, may His Name be blessed, in the world of Atzilut, with which He brings everything into existence, and by which He directs everything constantly. And these revelations are themselves His names, may His Name be blessed.

The *Meir HaLeshem*¹ notes that the author seems to imply here that the primary emphasis in Kabbalah study should be knowledge of the holy names and the manner in which they are revealed.² However, another authority, Rabbi Yitzchak Isaac Chaver³ (1789-1853), states that the primary goal is to understand Divine Providence (השגחה פרטית) and its workings. Nevertheless, *Meir HaLeshem* opines, there may not be a difference of opinion, since the workings of Divine Providence IS in fact via the revelation of His names.

שֶׁהֵם הַשְּׂרָשִׁים הָרְאוּשׁוֹנִים וְהַכּוֹחוֹת הַפְּנִימִים שֶׁל כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָהּ וְכָל צְאָצְאָהָּ
בְּכָל מֵה שְׁנַעֲשֶׂה בָּהּ בְּכָל עֵת שֶׁהֶכָל הוּא מְמַנּוּ

§ 4:9

These revelations are the first roots and the inner capacities of the entire creation and all of its progeny – everything that is produced thereby at any time – it is all from Him.

The term 'inner capacities' or 'powers' refers to particular, immanent divine revelations that are manifested in specific, limited and definable functions (sometimes called 'vessels' – *kelim*) indicated by the various Divine names. These

are the opposite of 'encompassing' or transcendent revelations (*makifim*) that are not confined to specific, limited functions.

וְהוּא גִלּוּי וְשִׁמוּתוֹ כִּי לִפִּי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי נִקְרָא

§ 4:10

And these are expressed as His revelations and His names, as the Sages declared, 'according to My deeds I am called,' as explained above.

אֲמַנָּם הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה הָגַם שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ שְׁכָל הַגִּילּוּיִם הִלְלוּ הִנֵּה הוּא מָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה
עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה בָּהֶם ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וְאֲמָרְנוּ כִּי הִנֵּה הֵם כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים כָּלָם
אֲשֶׁר נִקְרָא ע"י הָאֲצִי' הוּא עֲצֻמוֹ בָּהֶם לֹא זוּלָתוֹ ח"ו

§ 4:11

However, although we said that all of these revelations are His essence itself, as revealed in them via the world of Atzilut, and we said that these are all the holy names by which He is called via Atzilut, He Himself and no other (God forbid) is in them

וְכַמ"ש (ישעי' מב, ח) אֲנִי ה' הוּא שְׁמִי וְכַבֹּדִי לֹא אֶתָּן

§ 4:12

as it is written, 'I am God (י-ו-ה); that is My Ineffable^[18] Name, and My glory I will not give to any other' (*Isaiah* 42:8) – to idols.^[19]

וְאֲמָרְנוּ ג"כ כִּי כָּל אוֹתָן הַגִּלּוּיִם הֵם הַכּוֹחוֹת הָעֶקְרִיִּים הַנוֹשְׂאִים אֶת כָּל הַהִתְהוּוֹת
כָּלָה וְכָל מִקְרִיָּה בְּכָל מְלוֹאֵיהֶם מְרֹאשִׁית עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה עַד סוֹף תַּחֲתִית הָעֲשִׂיָּה

§ 4:13

We also said that all of those revelations are the primary forces that maintain all of existence and all of the events that take place throughout existence from the highest level of the world of Beriah to the very lowest level of Asiyah.

הִנֵּה עכ"ז אֵין לָנוּ וְלֹא לְשׁוּם נִבְרָא שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה וְהִשָּׁגָה בְּמַהוּת אֵיזָה גִּלּוּי מִכָּל אוֹתָן
הַגִּלּוּיִם כָּלָם

§ 4:14

With all that being said, neither we nor any other created being has any grasp or comprehension of the essence of any of those revelations.

The Baal HaLeshem makes a clear distinction here between knowledge of the *existence* (מציאות) of divine revelations, and comprehending their *essence* (מהות) which is not possible for us. This harkens back to Shaar 1 chap 2 where he explained the difference between positive descriptions and the *negation* or repudiation of any descriptions. See also *Moreh Nevuchin* cited in chapter 2 footnote 12. *Meir HaLeshem* notes that *existence* (מציאות) refers to revelations in the worlds of BiYA.⁴

אֵלָּא רַק בְּצוּרַת הָאוֹתִיּוֹת וְהַנִּקְדּוֹת בְּצִרוּף הַתִּגִּין וְהַטַּעֲמִים אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת
הַקְּדוּשִׁים כִּפִּי מָה שֶׁנִּמְסַר לָנוּ בְּכֶתֶב וּבַע"פ אֲבָל זוּלַת צוּרַת הַשְּׁמוֹת אֵין לָנוּ וְלֹא
לְשׁוּם נִבְרָא שׁוּם הִשָּׁגָה וְתְּפִיסָה בְּמַהוּת אֵיזָה גִּלּוּי מִכָּל גִּלּוּי מְאוּמָה כָּלָל

§ 4:15

We are capable of grasping only the shape of the letters and the vowel points, together with the crowns on top of the letters^[^21] and the cantillation marks of all the holy names,^[^22] as handed down to us in written and oral form. But besides the form of the names neither we, nor any created being, has any comprehension and grasp at all of the essence of any revelation among all of the revelations.

וְהוּא ג"כ מְאוֹתוֹ הַטַּעַם גּוֹפָה שְׁאִמְרָנוּ כִּי כָל אוֹתָן הַגְּלוּיִם כָּלָם הוּא מָה שֶׁהוּא
עֲצָמוֹ ית"ש נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם וְלָכֵן מְשַׁלֵּל הוּא מִכָּל נִבְרָא מִלֵּה שִׁיג בָּהֶם מֵאוֹמָה

§ 4:16

This is for the very same reason already stated: because all of those revelations are such that He Himself is revealed in them. And therefore every created being is denied the possibility of comprehending anything of them.

וְמָה שֶׁאֵנוּ קוֹרְאִים אוֹתָן בְּשֵׁם גְּלוּיִם שֶׁהוֹרָאָתָם הוּא שֶׁמֶשֶׁג וְנִתְפָּס הוּא בְּשֵׁנֵי עֲנִינִים
אֲשֶׁר שָׂרָשָׁם אֶחָד הוּא

§ 4:17

But the fact that we refer to them as 'revelations' – implying that they are comprehended and grasped intellectually – is true in terms of two concepts that have a single origin:

הֵינּוּ א' כִּי הִנֵּה הֵם נִקְרָא גְלוּיִם רַק מִצֵּד מְצִיאוֹתָם וְלֹא מִצֵּד מְהוּתָם כִּי מְהוּתָם
הוּא בְּאֵמָת נֶעְלָם בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעָלָם אֲבָל מְצִיאוֹתָם הִרִי נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בְּוַדַּי מִצֵּד
הַתְּהוּוֹת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת וְהִנֵּהגָתוֹ אוֹתָם תָּמִיד

§ 4:18

1) They are called 'revelations' only in terms of their existence, not their essence – i.e. as revealed in *BiYA*,^[^23] because their essence is indeed profoundly concealed, whereas their existence is certainly revealed to us in terms of His bringing all of existence into being and orchestrating them at all times.

וְהוּא כְּמֵאמַר קְדוֹשׁ ה' בְּשִׁיר הַיְחוד יוֹם ה' לֹא מִצְאָנוּהוּ וְלֹא יִדְעָנוּהוּ אֶךְ מִמַּעֲשָׂיו
הַכְרָנוּהוּ

§ 4:19

This is like the statement of God's sanctity in *Shir HaYichud* for the fifth day of the week: 'God, whom we did not find and did not know, but from Whose deeds we recognize Him...'

Regarding God Himself we have no direct knowledge, but we can know His deeds, as the Baal HaLeshem explained earlier.

וְע"ד שְׁאִמְרָ דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ ע"ה הַשָּׁמַיִם מְסַפְּרִים כְּבוֹד אֵל כו' וְכֵן בְּמִזְמוֹר ק"ד ה' אֱלֹהֵי
גְדֻלַּת מֵאֲד כו' וּבְמִזְמוֹר ק"ז הָמָּה רָאוּ מַעֲשֵׂי ה' כו' וְכִמוּהוּ רַבִּים

§ 4:20

– similar to what King David said, 'the heavens declare the glory of God' (Psalms 19:2). Similarly, in Psalm 104:1 'Havaye my God, You are very great' upon which the Radak comments: 'From Your deeds \[the Creation that this Psalm lauds\] we understand that You are very great.' And in Psalm 107:24 'They have seen the deeds of God...' – His deeds, but not Him. There are numerous other examples.

ובפרט בהנהגתו ית"ש בכל הנסים הנגלים והנסתרים ובכל המאורות כלם אשר
מיום בראוה' אדם על הארץ עד היום הזה ובפרט בישראל עמו ביוחד בכלל ובפרט
§ 4:21

This is all evident particularly in the way He orchestrates matters in terms of all the
miracles, both revealed and concealed, and all the phenomena that testify to His
deeds from the day God created man on earth until this very day. And this is
particularly evident with Israel His people in general and also individually, in a most
singular manner,

עד שכל אחד רואה בעיניו ממש כמאמר הכתוב (דברים ד, לה) אתה □ראת לדעת
כי ה' הוא האלהים אין עוד מלבדו

§ 4:22

to the extent that every person can see it with his very own eyes, as the verse states,
'You have been shown, in order to know, that Havaye is God; there is none beside
Him!' (Deuteronomy 4:35).

והרי לנו שכל מה שצמצם באמתתו הנעלמה המשלל מכל תפיסת מחשבה ודיעה
בו ונתצמצם למקום להעולמות ולהיות מהוה הכל והוה בכל שהוא הן בכל
עצמותם והן בכל מקריהם

§ 4:23

Thus we have it that whatever He constricted (*tzimtzem*) of His concealed true
Being, from which any perch for thought and knowledge is negated, and which was
constricted in order to form a place for the worlds, so that He would bring
everything into being and be within whatever there is, whether in their essential state
or in the events that take place with them, as explained above.

הנה ראוי לקרא אותם היטיב בשם גלויים כי הרי נתגלה ונתודע לנו בכ"ז וכמ"ש
אתה הראת לדעת כו'

§ 4:24

Thus it is wholly proper to refer to them as 'revelations', since they become revealed
and known to us through all these means, as the verse states 'You have been shown,
in order to know...' as mentioned above.

אמנם כל גלויים הוא רק בידיעה ולא בהשגה שהוא רק במציאותם ולא במהותם

§ 4:25

However, all of this revelation is only in one's knowledge of them but not in
comprehension, in their existence but not in their essence, as mentioned above.

אך ענין השני בזה הנה הוא באמת קרוב כמעט לומר שהם גלויים ממש גם בהשגה
ותפיסה חושית

§ 4:26

2) But the second factor truly comes close to stating that they really are revelations,
even in comprehension and in the apprehension of the senses!

In other words, they are revelations not only existentially, as was explained in the
first point above, but can also be considered revelations in a much deeper sense, so

that they are revealed in one's comprehension and can even be apprehended by the senses.

ועכ"ז הנה הם בעמק רק מאותו ענין הראשון עצמו והיינו כי הנה אמרנו לעיל פ"ג שכל גלוייו כלם הנה הם עצמם כל השמות הקדושים הנמסר לנו בכתב ושבע"פ § 4:27

Nevertheless, at their very depth, they are the same concept mentioned in the first point. Meaning to say, that which we stated above in chapter 3 – that all the revelations are themselves all the holy names that have been conveyed to us in writing and orally –

ובאמרנו בע"פ ר"ל כל השמות המבארים בדברי חכמי האמת והם יוצאים כלם מצרופי אותיות שבתורה"ק אם מראשי תבות או מסופי תבות או מחצין

§ 4:28

– now when we say 'orally', we mean those names that are explained in the words of the Sages of Truth the Kabbalists – these all emerge from the permutations of the letters in the Holy Torah, whether from the initial letters of consecutive words or the end letters of consecutive words, or the middle letters.

וכן גם מחלופי האותיות בכל האלפ"י בתי"ן דרל"א שיערים כנודע לבאי בסוד ה'

§ 4:29

They are also produced by letter exchanges using all the alphabets of the 231 gates, as is known to those who are privy to God's secrets.

The *Mishna* in *Avot* 5:1 declares that God created the world with 10 utterances. The *Sefer Yetzirah* (2:4-5) describes this process and mentions that the most basic combinations of letters of the Hebrew Alphabet, i.e. two-letter combinations, form 231 pairs of letters that were used in the construction of the universe. They are called the 231 'gates'.

וכמו שכתב הרמב"ן בפתחת התורה ואמר שם כי כל התורה כלה שמותיו של הקב"ה וכן הוא בזה"ק יתרו צ' ע"ב ומשפטים קכ"ד רע"א

§ 4:30

As the Ramban writes in his Introduction to the Torah in which he states that the entire Torah is names of the Holy One, blessed be He. The same point is made in the Zohar *Yitro* 90b (which will be cited shortly) and *Mishpatim* 124a.

וכבר אמרנו כי כל שמותיו הנה הם הגלויים עצמן אשר הוא עצמו ית"ש נתגלה באותן השמות ע"י האצילות

§ 4:31

As we already said, all of His names are the revelations themselves in which He, may He be blessed, is revealed – in those very names – via Atzilut.

וכמ"ש בזה"ק יתרו פ"ו ע"א על העשר ספירות דאצילות דבהו אתחזי מלכא קדישא ואינון שמה והוא אינון הוא שמה דכתב אני יי' הוא שמי הוא ושמה חד הוא

§ 4:32

As it states in Zohar *Yitro* 86a regarding the ten *sefirot* of Atzilut: 'in which the Holy King appears; they are His name, and He is them. He is His name, as it is written, "I am Havaye; that is My Name" (*Isaiah* 42:8) – He and His Name are one.'

וְכֵן בְּפִרְשֵׁת אֲמֹר צ"ג ע"ב אֵלֶּיךָ מִלְכָּא דְאִיהוּ אֶחָיד בְּהוּ, וְאִינוּן בְּיָהּ. אִינוּן
שְׁמִיָּהּ, וְאִיהוּ וְשְׁמִיָּהּ, מִלָּה חֶדָּא הוּא

§ 4:33

So too in *Zohar* III *parshat Emor* 93b: 'those are the crowns of the King (the ten *sefirot* of Atzilut) with which He is unified, and they with Him. They are His name, and He and His name are one.'

The ten *sefirot* of the world of Atzilut are not distinct entities or intermediaries, which might imply duality or plurality in God. Quite the contrary – as the Baal HaLeshem states here they are nothing other than His names, through which He reveals Himself to man, as explained previously.

וּבפ' יתרו צ' ע"ב דְּהָא אֲוִרִיָּתָא שְׁמָא דְקֹדֶשׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא הוּי כו' וְאֲוִרִיָּתָא כְּלָא שְׁמָא
חַד הוּי שְׁמָא קִדִּישָׁא דְקֹדֶשׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא מִמֶּשׁ כו' מֵאן דְּזָכִי בְּאֲוִרִיָּתָא, זָכִי בְּשְׁמָא
קִדִּישָׁא

§ 4:34

Similarly, in *Zohar* II *parshat Yitro* 90b: 'Indeed, the Torah is the name of the Holy One, blessed is He... and the Torah is all one name, the holy name of the Holy One, blessed is He, literally... One who, by his deep study of Torah and his righteous actions,[^25] merits the Torah, merits the Holy Name.'

ר' יוֹסִי אָמַר בַּקב"ה מִמֶּשׁ זָכִי דְּהָא הוּא וְשְׁמִיָּהּ חַד הוּא

§ 4:35

Rabbi Yose declared: not only is he worthy of the Holy Name, he is worthy of the Holy One, blessed is He Himself, literally, since He and His Name are one.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ מַכ"ז שְׁכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים הֵנָּה הוּא מָה שֶׁעֲצָמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה נִתְגַּלָּה
בְּגִלְוֵיהֶם אַחֵר שְׁנֵתִלְבֹּשׁ בְּאַצִּילוֹת

§ 4:36

Thus, from all of this, we have it that all the holy names are such that His very essence becomes revealed in their being revealed, after being clothed in Atzilut.

וְהוּא מְשֻׁם כִּי אֲמַתָּתוֹ הִנֵּעַלְמָה עֲצָמוֹ נִתְצַמְצַם וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְשׁוֹכֵן בְּאַצִּילוֹת וּמִתְיַחַד
בָּהּ בִּיחוד עָצוֹם עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂית חַד עֲמוֹ

§ 4:37

This is because His concealed true Being itself becomes constricted (*nitzamtzem*) so that He can extend into, and dwell in, Atzilut. And He becomes unified in it with a powerful unity to the extent that it becomes one with Him,

וּכְמ"ש אֵלֶיהוּ זל"ט אֲנִתָּה הוּא דְאַפִּיקַת עֶשֶׂר תְּקוּנֵינוּ, וְקָרִינוּ לוֹן עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹן כו' וּבְגִינוּ
דְּאַנְתָּ מְלָגָנוּ, כָּל מָאן דְּאַפְרִישׁ חַד מִן חֲבֵרִיָּה מֵאֵלֶיךָ עֶשֶׂר, אֲתַחֲשִׁיב לֵיהּ כְּאֵלוֹ אֲפְרִישׁ
בְּךָ

§ 4:38

As Eliyahu the Prophet, who is remembered for the good, stated: 'You are He who brings forth the ten rectifications,[^26] which we call the ten *sefirot*... And because You are within them, anyone who separates one from the other of these ten *sefirot* is regarded as if he caused a separation in You.'

וְהָרִי לָנוּ שְׁעֵצְמוֹתָּ גּוֹפָה שׁוֹכֵן בְּאַצִּילוֹת וְהִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה שָׁם עֲצְמוֹתָּ גּוֹפָה בְּבַחֲיִיתָ אֱלֹ
הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת י-ה-ו-ה וְהוּא אֱלֹהֵינוּ כִּי הָרִי עֲצְמוֹתָּ גּוֹפָה נִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הָאַצִּילוֹת בְּבַחֲי
הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת הֶלְלוּ

§ 4:39

Thus we have it that His very essence rests in Atzilut, and His essence itself is revealed there in the four-letter Name י-ה-ו-ה. And He is our God – as we recite in *Shema* twice daily – since His essence itself is revealed via the world of Atzilut in these four letters.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר בְּרַע"מ פ' בָּא מ"ב ב' דַּע"י הִתְלַבְּשׁוּ בְּאַצִּילוֹת נִתְגַּלָּה הוּא עֲצְמוֹ
בְּהֶשֶׁם הוּיָה ב"ה

§ 4:40

And as is explained in *Zohar* II *Raya Mehemna parshat Bo* p. 42b: via clothing Himself in Atzilut He Himself is revealed in the blessed Name Havaye. Study the text there carefully and you will find this idea.

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה פֶּרֶשֶׁה ב' סִימָן ג' אָמַר ר' חֲנִינְיָא בְּרַאשׁוֹנָה כָּל מִי
שֶׁהֵיָה מְרָאָה אִיקוֹנִין שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ בְּאַצְבַּע הָיָה נִהְרָג וְהִתְיַנּוּקוֹת הוֹלְכִים לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ
וּמְרִאִים אֶת הָאֲזָכְרוֹת בְּאַצְבַּע אָמַר ה' וְדָגְלוּ עָלַי אֶהְבֶּה (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ב, ד) וְגִדְלוּ
עָלַי אֶהְבֶּה

§ 4:41

This is what our Sages stated in *Bamidbar Rabba* 2, 3: Rabbi Chanina declared, 'At first, in earlier generations, anyone who pointed with his finger to the representation[^30] of the king was put to death, but now even young children go to the House of Study and point with a finger to the expressions of the four-letter Name in the Torah! To which God responds, "And their encampments[^31] of the Israelites around the Tabernacle is beloved to Me" (Song of Songs 2:4) – which Rabbi Chanina interprets as meaning: Don't read "and their encampments" but rather "and his thumb[^32] the thumb of a young child pointing to God's Name in the Torah is beloved to Me."

וְהָרִי לָנוּ שְׁקוּרָא הַמִּדְרָשׁ אֶת הֶשֶׁם הוּיָה ב"ה בְּשֵׁם אִיקוֹנִין שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ

§ 4:42

So we have it from here that the Midrash refers to the blessed Name Havaye as the 'representation' of the King!

כִּי אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ דֶּרֶךְ אֶלְפֵי רִיבּוֹאוֹת מִדְּרָגוֹת אֵין חֶקֶר וְנִמְשָׁךְ גְּלוּי
שְׁבַּאצִּילוֹת דֶּרֶךְ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְנִחָתָם בִּכ"א מְחוּתָם לְנִחָתָם עַד שֶׁנִּחָתָמוּ אֵלֵינוּ
לְאֵלוּ הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת דֶּהֶשֶׁם הוּיָה ב"ה כְּפִי מָה שֶׁכְּתוּבִים לְפָנֵינוּ בַּתּוֹרָה

§ 4:43

Because since the Name extends forth and was drawn down tens of thousands of levels to an extent that is impossible to fathom, and the revelation in Atzilut is drawn

down through all the worlds of *BiYA*, and is emblazoned into each of them, from stamp to stamped, until there is emblazoned in us these four letters of the blessed Ineffable Name Havaye, as is written in the teaching before us – this 'stamp' in us is the 'representation' of the King of kings, the blessed Holy One.^[^33]

וְכֵן עַד"ז הִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה עֲצֻמּוֹתָיו עוֹד ע"י הָאֲצִי' בְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת כָּלֵם הַמְּסֻתָּעִים מֵהַשֵּׁם הוּיָה ב"ה וְכֵן בְּכָל הַתּוֹרָה כָּלָה שֶׁהִיא כְּלוֹ שְׁמוֹ שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה כִּנּוּי וְהֵם כָּלֵן אִיקוּנֵי שְׁלוֹ

§ 4:44

In the same manner, His essence is further revealed via Atzilut within all the Divine names that branch out from the blessed Name Havaye, and throughout the entire Torah, which is all the name of the Holy One, blessed be He,^[^34] as mentioned, and they are all His 'representations'

מִבְּחִי גִלּוּיֵי שְׁנִיתְגַּלְתָּה בְּאֲצִילוֹת שְׁנִיתְצַמְצַם שֶׁם לְהִתְגַּלָּה בְּאוֹתָן הַגְּלוּיִם לְהוֹתָם שֶׁרֶשׁ לְכָל פְּעֻלָּתוֹ וְהִנֵּהגָתוֹ שְׁפוּעַל וּמִנְהִיג בְּהַעֲלֹמֹת בִּי"ע

§ 4:45

of the aspect of His revelations as revealed in Atzilut, where He constricted Himself to become revealed in those very revelations, to become the root of all His activities and their orchestration which He brings about and directs in the worlds of *BiYA*.

וּמֵאַחֵר שֶׁהֵם אִיקוּנֵי דְגִילוֹי עֲצֻמּוֹתָיו גּוֹפָה א"כ הֵרִי הֵם נִדְעֵי וְגִלּוּיִם לָנוּ גַם בְּהַשְׁגָּה וּתְפִיסָה חוּשִׁית מִמֶּשׁ וְהוּא עֲנֵן הַשָּׁנִי אֲשֶׁר אִמְרָנוּ לְעִיל בְּטַעַם שֶׁנִּקְרָאוּ בְּשֵׁם גִּלּוּיִם

§ 4:46

And since they are the resemblance of the revelation of Himself, they are known and revealed even in a conceptual sense, and in the perception of our senses. This is the second idea we mentioned above regarding the reason they are called 'revelations.'

כִּי הֵרִי נִרְאָה לְכַאוֹרָה לומר שֶׁהֵם בְּאֵמֶת גִּלּוּיִם מִמֶּשׁ גַּם בְּהַשְׁגָּה וּתְפִיסָה וְהוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּיָה ב"ה וְכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת כָּלֵם וְכֵן כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כָּלָה

§ 4:47

because it seems we can state that they – the holy names – are truly actual revelations, revealed even in thought and intellectual apprehension. This is the blessed Name Havaye and all the derivative names, and also the entire Torah, as mentioned previously.

Footnotes

1. Notes at the back of his commentary on the *Leshem*, p. 415 note 1. [↩](#)
2. He references *Etz Chaim Shaar 1 Anaf 1* as support. [↩](#)
3. Rabbi Yitzchak Isaac was a distinguished kabbalist and one of the foremost disciples of Rabbi Menachem Mendel of Shklov, a close disciple and associate of the Vilna Gaon (1720-1797). [↩](#)
4. Fn. 30, where he refers to the GRA *Sifra diTzniuta* 37. [↩](#)

Chapter 5: The Revelation via the Name Havaye and via other Names

Shaar 1 Chapter 5

The Revelation via the Name *Havaye* and via other Names

אָמַנָם הוּא כַּאֲשֶׁר נִתְּבוּנוֹ בְּזֶה אָנוּ רוֹאִין כִּי עֲנִין הִזָּה הַשְּׁנִי הֵנָּה הוּא בְּהִכְרַח ג"כ רַק מֵעֲנִין הָרִאשׁוֹן עֲצָמוֹ

§ 5:1

However, when we contemplate this matter, we see that the second point mentioned above in the previous chapter – that the revelations discussed really are revelations – is inevitably only the first point itself,[^1] namely, that they are called 'revelations' only in terms of the fact that they actually exist, but not in terms of their essence – in terms of **metziut** but not **mehut**. This will be explained below.

וְכָל גְּלוּיָיו אֲשֶׁר גַּם בְּהַשְׁמוֹת הַקְּדוֹשִׁים וּבְכָל הַתּוֹרָה כּוֹלָה הֵנָּה הֵם מְשׁוּלָל ג"כ מִהַשְׁגָּה וּתְפִיסָה לְשׁוֹם נִבְרָא

§ 5:2

All of His revelations, even those revealed as the holy names throughout the entire Torah, are also inaccessible to the comprehension and intellectual grasp of any created being.

וְהוּא כִּי הָרִי כָּל הַשְׁגָּה וּתְפִיסָה חוּשִׁית אֲשֶׁר יֵשׁ לָנוּ בְּזֶה, הֵנָּה הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ לָנוּ רַק מִצַּד הַחוּמֵּי וְהַגְשְׁמִי שֶׁבָּהֶם שֶׁהָרִי מֵה שְׁאֵנוּ מְשִׁיגִים צוּרַת אוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה וְהַשְׁמוֹת הוּא רַק מִצַּד שֶׁהֵם עֲשׂוּיִם מִקָּלֶף וְדִיו וְשַׁחֲוֹר עַל גְּבִי לָבוֹ

§ 5:3

And this is because any sense-based comprehension and grasp we have of this matter is bestowed upon us only by virtue of their material and physical aspects. The fact that we can grasp the shape of the letters of the Torah and the holy names is only because they are made of parchment and ink, black on white.

וְגַם אִם נִצְיֵר אֵיזָה אוֹת בְּצִיּוֹר הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה לְבַד הֵנָּה נִמְשָׁךְ אֵלֵינוּ כָּל צִיּוֹרֵי צוּרַתָּה וּתְמוֹנָתָה רַק מִכַּח צוּרַת צִיּוֹרֵי מִצִּיאוֹתָם בְּגֶשְׁמִי וְחִמְרִי

§ 5:4

Now even if we depict some letter in thought alone, its entire shape and image is elicited only by virtue of the shape and structure of their physical and material existence.

וּמֵה גַם שְׂכָל כַּח הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה וְהַצִּיּוֹר אֲשֶׁר אֵלֵינוּ הִיא כּוֹלָה מִשְׁתַּף בְּגֶשֶׁם וְחִמְרֵי וְאִי אֲפֹשֶׁר לְרֹאוֹת שְׂכָלֵנוּ לְדַמּוֹת רוּחָנִי בְּלִתִּי גֶשֶׁם בְּשׁוֹם אוֹפֵן אַחֵר שְׂכָל מִצִּיאוֹתֵינוּ בְּנוֹי רַק בְּגֶשֶׁם וְחִמְרֵי

§ 5:5

And particularly so since our power of thought, and the ability to form a mental image, is linked with the physical and material.[^2] It is impossible for our mind's eye to imagine in any other way something spiritual devoid of the physical, because our entire existence is built exclusively upon the physical and material.

ועכ"פ הוא כי כל צורת השמות כלם המשגים אלינו הנה הוא רק ע"י בנין צורתם
שבננוים ועשויים מגשם וחמר שהוא מדיו ע"ג קלף ומצירים מתמונת אותיות ע"י
כתב וסופר

§ 5:6

In any event, the form of all the divine names – all those we can comprehend – is achieved by means of constructing their form on the basis of their physical and material structure as ink on parchment. And they are fashioned in the mind's eye from the image of the letters written by a scribe on parchment.

וכ"ז הרי נודע ופשוט הוא שאור קדשתו ית"ש הוא רחוק ומושלל מלתפס אותו
במצייאות כזה בתכלית השלילה וההרחק

§ 5:7

It is known and even obvious that the light of His blessed holiness is far removed from, and cannot in any way at all be grasped – even remotely – in an empirical manner.

והאות על זה כי הרי גם אחר רוממות מעלת קדושת האותיות דהשם הוי"ה ב"ה
וכן כל השמות כלם הנה אין להם קדושה כלל אלא רק כשנכתבו לשמן דוקא

§ 5:8

The proof of this is that even given the lofty, holy status of the letters of the blessed Name Havaye, and all of the other names as well, they have no holiness at all unless they were written **lishman** – for their own sake.

Torah law requires that Torah scrolls, *tefillin* and *mezuzot* must be written *lishma* – for the intention of fulfilling the *mitzvah* – and not for some ulterior motive, or even without any intention. If that condition is not filled they are invalid.¹

ואמרו בפרוש גיטין נ"ד ע"ב שכל ספר תורה שאין אזכרות שלו כתובות לשמן אינו
שוה כלום

§ 5:9

Our sages said explicitly (**Gittin** 54b) that any Torah scroll whose holy names were not written for their own sake is not worth anything.

Note that the words "not *worth* anything" is the actual expression used in the Talmud since the discussion there is whether a scribe who wrote a *Sefer Torah*, but did not write the names *lishmo* (with the proper intention), can charge his client anything. According to Rav Ami the scroll is worthless and he loses his scribal fee. The *Shulchan Aruch*, *Yoreh De'ah* 274:1 and commentaries describe the scroll as *invalid* (*possul*) if written without proper intention.

וכ"ז הוא משום שכל מציאות צורת האותיות אשר לפנינו הנה הם בנויים ועשויים
מחמר וגשם ולכן אין במציאותם גופה קדושת אלהות כלל מצד עצמן רק ע"י
התפשטות אורו

§ 5:10

This is all because the actual letters in the form they are before us in a Torah scroll, or **tefillin** and **mezuzot**, are made and formed from physical and material things – ink on parchment – and therefore there is no Divine holiness at all in their

existence in and of themselves; only by virtue of the extended radiance of His light to them.

שְׁמֵת־פֶּשֶׁט וְשְׂרִייה בָּהֶם כְּשֶׁהֵם נִכְתָּבִים לְשֹׁמְן וּבִשְׂאֵר כָּל הַתְּנָאִים הַמְּכֻרָשִׁים
בְּהִלְכֹתֵיהֶם וְאִי הֵנָּה יֵשׁ בְּאַמֶּת בָּהֶם עֲצָמָן אֹר קִדְשָׁתוּ ית"ש וְהֵם מְלֵאִים מִקְדוּשַׁת
אֱלֹהוֹת

§ 5:11

For His light extends to them and suffuses them when they are written for their own sake, and when all the other pre-conditions specified in *halacha* (Jewish law) are complied with. And indeed then the blessed light of His holiness is in them in the letters themselves; they are permeated with Divine holiness.

וּבִפְרָט הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה שֶׁנִּקְרָא שֵׁם הָעֵצָם מִשּׁוּם שְׁעֲצָמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה נִתְגַּלָּה בְּהַשֵּׁם
הַזֶּה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וְגִלּוּיָו בּוֹ הוּא בְּלִי שׁוּם לְבוּשׁ כָּלל

§ 5:12

This is particularly so regarding the blessed Name Havaye, which is called 'the Essential Name' since His very Essence is revealed in this Name by way of the world of Atzilut. Moreover, His revelation within it – within the Name Havaye – is with no 'garment' at all,

A 'garment' (*levush*) in this context is something that screens and filters the revelation in order to keep it discreet. The *Zohar*² writes that the Torah itself is a prime example of this in that some of the deepest wisdom of the Torah – the Torah as it is in the world of Atzilut – is clothed in the 'garments' of stories and seemingly mundane events.

אֲמָנָם גִּלּוּיָו בָּהֶם הוּא רַק ע"י מַסְכִּים וּלְבוּשִׁים וְלָכֵן לֹא נִקְרָא שֵׁם הָעֵצָם אֶלָּא רַק
הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה וְהוּא דְיוֹקְנוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמַּלְכִּים הַקְּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא

§ 5:13

However, His revelation within them – within the other holy names – is by way of screens and garments, and therefore only the Name Havaye is called 'the Essential Name'; it is the likeness of the blessed King of kings, as explained previously in chapter 4.

אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה עֲצָמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וּבּוֹ נִתְרָאָה אֱלֵינוּ לֵהִיוֹת כָּל עֲבוֹדָתֵנוּ
אֱלֹו

§ 5:14

In it – in the Name Havaye – His Essence itself is revealed via Atzilut, and with it He appears to us, since all of our service is to Him, as will be explained later in Shaar 7 Chapter 4 and in a number of other places at length in our works.

אֲמָנָם מֵאַחַר שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁכָּל רוּמָמוֹת מַעֲלַת קְדוּשַׁת הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת הִלְלוּ אֲשֶׁר לְפָנֵינוּ
הֵנָּה הוּא רַק ע"י אֹר קִדְשָׁתוּ ית"ש הַשּׁוֹרָה בָּהֶם וּמִמֶּלֶא אוֹתָם בְּכָל מְלֻאָם

§ 5:15

However, we stated that the entire sublime holiness of these four letters before us – the four letters of the Ineffable Name – is due only to the light of His blessed holiness abiding within them and suffusing them completely.

א"כ נמצא שהגם שאותן הד' אותיות עצמן הם משגים וגלויים אלינו גם בהשגה ותפיסה חושית והוא לראות עינינו ממש

§ 5:16

Accordingly, it turns out that although those four letters themselves are comprehensible and are revealed to us even in thought and in sensory perception, and are accessible to our very eyes,

עכ"ז הנה אור קדשתו ית"ש השורה בהם אשר על ידו נתקדשו הד' אותיות הללו להעשות לגלוי עצמותו ולתאר דיוקנו הנה הנה אור קדשתו גופה נעלם עדין אלינו בתכלית ההעלם כמקדם

§ 5:17

nevertheless, the light of His blessed holiness that dwells within these four letters, by virtue of which they became sanctified, and are made into a medium for the revelation of His essence and a portrayal of His likeness, the light of His holiness itself is still concealed from us, absolutely concealed, just as before.

וא"כ נמצא שגם אחר שנתגלה אלינו בהשם הוי"ה ב"ה ובכל השמות כלם ובכל התורה כולה הנמשך ומסתעף מהשם הוי"ה ב"ה

§ 5:18

Therefore it turns out that even after it – the light of His holiness – is revealed to us within the blessed Name Havaye and in all of the names, and throughout the Torah, which is drawn from and branches out from the blessed Name Havaye,[⁵]

עכ"ז הנה מהות אור קדשתו עצמו הוא לעולם רחוק ומשולל מכל השגה ותפיסה[⁶] ולא נגלה אלינו מכל גלוייו אלא רק בידיעה ולא בהשגה[⁷]

§ 5:19

nevertheless, the essence of His holy light itself is always remote from and inaccessible to comprehension and intellectual grasp. And nothing is revealed to us of all His revelations other than awareness about these matters, but without actual comprehension,

כי לא נתגלה אלינו אלא רק במציאותם אבל לא במהותם וכענין הראשון שאמרנו לעיל פרק ד'

§ 5:20

since they were revealed to us only existentially, but not essentially, as in the first concept explained above in chapter 4.

Footnotes

1. See *Mishneh Torah, Tefillin, Metzuzot v'Sefer Torah* 1:15. [↩](#)

2. *Zohar, Behaalotecha* 152a. [↩](#)

Chapter 6: His Revelation within Names and Worlds is Concealed

Shaar 1 Chapter 6

His Revelation within Names and Worlds is Concealed

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאָר שְׂכָל גְּלוּיָיו כָּלָם ר"ל גַּם מֵה שֶׁנִּגְלָה אֵלֵינוּ בְּהִשְׁגָּה חוּשִׁית וְאָמַר לָנוּ
שֶׁהוּא תֹאֵר דְּיוֹקֵנוּ עֲצָמוֹ

§ 6:1

It was explained above that all of His revelations, i.e. including that which is revealed to us through sensory perception, are a portrayal of His likeness, we are told.

This was explained in chapter 4 from the statement of the Sages of the *Midrash Bamidbar Rabbah* chap. 2: In earlier generations, anyone who pointed with his finger to the 'representation' of the king was put to death, but now even young children go to the House of Study and point with their finger to Him, i.e. to the expressions of the four-letter Name in the Torah.

וְהוּא הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת דְּהֵשֵׁם הוּ"ה ב"ה וְכֵן כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים כָּלָם וְכָל הַתּוֹרָה
נִכְלָה שֶׁהִיא כּוֹלָה שְׁמוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ וְהֵם כָּלָם דְּיוֹקֵנוּ גְּלוּיָיו מִמַּשׁ אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם אֲמַתָּתוֹ
הַנֶּעְלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 6:2

This portrayal of His likeness is by way of the four letters of the blessed Name Havaye, and all of the holy names, and the entire Torah – which in its entirety is His blessed name – and they are indeed all representations of His revelations in which His hidden truth becomes revealed via the world of Atzilut.

עכ"ז הִנֵּה אֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ הַשּׁוֹרָה בָּהֶם אֲשֶׁר עַל יְדוֹ נַעֲשִׂים הֵם לְדִיוֹקֵנוּ הִנֵּה
נִשְׁאָר אֵלֵינוּ עַדִּין נַעֲלָם בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעֱלָם כְּמוֹ זֹלַת גְּלוּיָיו

§ 6:3

Nevertheless, the light of His holiness itself abiding within them – within the holy names – which fashions them into His likeness, is still absolutely hidden from us, just as if there had been no revelation.

וְכָל מֵה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם אֵלֵינוּ הוּא לְפִי הַשְּׁגָתָנוּ רַק בְּגִזְרָה שְׂכָךְ אָמַר לָנוּ וְכָךְ צִוָּה לָנוּ

§ 6:4

And all that is revealed within them – within the holy names – to us according to our comprehension is only by Divine decree, for that is what He told us and this is what He commanded,

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר הוּא ית"ש זֶה שְׁמִי זֶה זְכָרִי וְכֵן צִוָּה לָנוּ וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁבַּפ' תְּבֵא לִירְאָה אֶת
הַשֵּׁם הַנִּכְבָּד

§ 6:5

as He stated, 'This is My name... this is My remembrance'[¹⁸] and this is what He commanded us, as it states in *parshat Tavo*[¹⁹] '...to be in awe of this honored

Name.'

ואֵלֵיוּ הוּא כָּל הָעֲבוּדָה כְּמוֹ שְׁנִתְבָּאָר לְקֶמֶן שֶׁעַר ז' פ"ו וְהוּא שֵׁם הָעֶצֶם כִּי אֲמַתָּתוֹ
הַנִּצְעָלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת בְּהֵשֶׁם הַזֶּה

§ 6:6

And to His Name is all of our service, as will be explained further on, in Shaar 7 chapter 6. This is the Essential Name, for His hidden true Being is revealed via Atzilut in this Name.

אָבֵל כ"ז הוּא רַק בִּידִיעָה וְלֹא בְּהִשָּׁגָה כִּי הוּא נִעְלָם בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעָלִם מִלְּהִשֵּׁי אֶת
זֶה בְּהִשָּׁגָתֵנוּ אֵיךְ שֶׁמִּתְיַחֵס אֹר עֲצָמוֹתוֹ לְהִתְגַּלָּה בְּהֵשֶׁם הַזֶּה וְלֹא שֶׁהוּא עֲצָמוֹ
וְהוּא הוּא

§ 6:7

But again all of this is merely in our awareness – we are aware that this is so – but not in our comprehension, because it is absolutely concealed from our intellectual grasp how His essential light becomes revealed in this Name, for us to state that He Himself is it – that He is His name.

אֶךְ עכ"פ הוּא כִּי הָאֲמַתָּה כֵּן הוּא שֶׁהוּא הוּא כִּי כֵּן אָמַר לָנוּ וְכֵן צִוָּה לָנוּ כְּנִז' וְהֵשֶׁם
הַזֶּה הוּא אֲמַתָּת עֲצָמוֹתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ שְׁנִתְגַּלָּה בּוֹ ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וְהוּא אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֵין עוֹד [10^]

§ 6:8

But nevertheless, this is the truth – He is His Name, for this is what He told us and that this is what He commanded us, as mentioned earlier. This Name is His true essential being revealed in this Name via Atzilut, and He is our G-d and there is none other.

אֲלֹא שֶׁכ"ז הוּא רַק בִּידִיעָה וְלֹא בְּהִשָּׁגָה וְכְמוֹ שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ

§ 6:9

But all of this is only in our awareness but not in comprehension, as we said.

Chapter 7: His Essence is Revealed in and until Atzilut; The Primary Revelation is through Torah

Shaar 1 Chapter 7

His Essence is Revealed in and until Atzilut; The Primary Revelation is through Torah

וְהִנֵּה סִבַּת הַדְּבָר מֵה שְׁאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש הוּא נֶעְלָם מִלְּהִשִּׁיג בּוֹ מֵאוֹמָה גַּם אַחֵר
שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בְּכָל גְּלוּיָיו הַנִּזְכָּרִים הִנֵּה הוּא בְּסִבַּת מֵה שְׁאֻמְרָנוּ לַעֲלִיל פ"ב כִּי נִתְצַמֵּצַם
עֲצָמוֹתוֹ ית"ש וּמִסִּתִּים בְּסוֹף הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 7:1

The reason that the light of His holiness is hidden from comprehension and cannot be grasped at all – even after being revealed in all the revelations mentioned above – the reason for this is as we stated above in chapter 2: because He constricted Himself in a way that these revelations come to an end at the lowest rungs of Atzilut.

Since even the lowest levels of Atzilut, where the light is somewhat dimmed, transcend our limited comprehension, how much more so is the light that is revealed in Atzilut beyond our comprehension.

וְכָל מֵה שֶׁמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּאוֹרוֹ וּקִדְשָׁתוֹ לְמִטָּה הוּא רַק ע"י מַסְכִּים וּלְבוּשִׁים וְהוּא רַק
תּוֹלְדוֹת הָאוֹר וְתַמְצִית הָאֶרֶץ לְבַד וּכְנ"ל פ"ב

§ 7:2

Anything that suffuses His light and holiness below is only via screening and cloaking, so that what is revealed is merely a product of the light and only a diminishing or attenuation of the radiance, as explained in chapter 2.

In order for the light to descend to BiYA it must be dimmed and attenuated. This process is akin to covering or cloaking it in garments which obscure the light.

וְאוֹתָהּ הַתַּמְצִית הָאֶרֶץ הוּא עוֹמֵד בְּפְנִימִיּוֹת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע בְּבִחִי נִשְׁמָה
לְנִשְׁמָה וְהוּא אוֹר שְׁכִינָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ הַשּׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹךְ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע ע"י הַתּוֹרָה
וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

§ 7:3

Now this diminishing of the radiance suffuses the inner core of the worlds of BiYA as the aspect of the soul of the soul,^[^1] of those worlds, which is His Shechinah, may He be blessed, within the worlds of BiYA, drawn down there by Torah and the Jewish People.

וְאוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר הוּא מְקוֹמוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם הַמְּהוּה אֶת הַכָּל וְנוֹשֵׂא אֶת כָּל וּמְנַהִיג אֶת הַכָּל
תָּמִיד ע"י קְשׁוּרָה וְאַחֲדוּתָהּ בְּעֶצֶם הָאוֹר הָעֶקְרִי אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה בְּאֲצִילוֹת

§ 7:4

And that light itself is the place^[^2] of the world, and brings everything into being, and sustains and leads everything always, by way of its bond and unification with the essence of the primary light that transcends Atzilut.

That abridged extract from the supernal radiance is itself the life force of the lower worlds.

ולכן אין גלוי בהשגה לכל העולמות בי"ע כלן בעצמותו ית"ש מאומה אחרי שגם
אור שכינתו ית"ש השוכן בהם הוא רק תמצית הארה מאור של מעלה

§ 7:5

And therefore there is no revelation at all of His blessed essence that can be grasped in any of the lower worlds of BiYA, since even the light of His blessed Shechinah that resides within them is only a diminished extract of the Supernal Light.

וגם זה הוא רק בפנימית פנימיותם שהוא בבחי' נשמה לנשמה שהוא למעלה
ממדרגת הנבראים לגמרי כי ממדרגת הנבראים כלם הוא רק מהנשמה ולמטה כמו
שיתבאר בע"ה בשערים הבאים

§ 7:6

And even that diminished extract is only in their innermost being, which is the soul of their souls, transcending the level of created being altogether. This is because the level of all created beings is from the level of soul called neshama^[3] and below, as will be explained in forthcoming chapters, G-d willing.

ולכן גם ההארה הזו הוא נעלם מכלם לגמרי עד שגם משרתיו שרפי מעלה
שואלים זה לזה איה מקום כבודו

§ 7:7

And therefore, even this mere radiance is completely hidden from all, to the extent that even His servants, the supernal seraphim – angels in the world of Beriah – ask, 'Where is His glory?'^[4]

וכלם עונים ואומרים ברוך כבוד ה' ממקומו ממקום שהוא כי מקומו ליכא דידיע
ליה

§ 7:8

And they all answer, 'Blessed is G-d's glory from its place' (Ezekiel 3:12) – from whatever place, for His place is unknown, as the Talmud states in Chagiga 13b^[5] and Zohar I, 103a.^[6]

אמנם מה שיש לנו גלוי ממנו עצמו ג"כ ר"ל זולת פעולותיו גופה הנה הוא ברצונו
המתפשט בהבי"ע

§ 7:9

However, as for revelations to us of Himself – i.e. besides His actions themselves – it is all in the extension of His will into the worlds of BiYA.^[7]

His wanting those worlds to exist is their very existence. Had He not wanted their existence they simply would not be at all.

כי הרי אנו רואין שרוצה בהתהוות כל המציאות ובקיומם תמיד והוא הענין דפרק
שירה

§ 7:10

For we see that He desires the coming into being of all existence and its continuation throughout time, and this is the conceptual basis of Perek Shira.^[8]

אֲשֶׁר הִפְלִיגוּ בְּשִׁבְחָהּ הָאוֹמְרוֹ וְהַמִּתְבּוֹנֵן בּוֹ מְשׁוֹם שֶׁהִרִי כָּל הַתְּהוּוֹתֵם וְקִיּוּמָם הוּא
 רַק רְצוֹנוֹ הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט עַד תַּחֲתִית הָעֲשִׂיָּה וְאַחֲרֵי שֶׁכָּל אוֹתָן הַמִּצִּיאוֹת עֲצָמָם הֵנָּה
 רַבָּם כֻּלָּם הֵם עֲבִים וְחִמְרִים בְּתַכְלִית הַחִמְרִי לָכֵן גְּדוֹל שִׁבְחָהּ הָאוֹמֵר וְהַמִּתְבּוֹנֵן
 בְּכָל פָּרְקֵי הַשִּׁירָה

§ 7:11

The sages effusively praise one who recites it and contemplates the ideas therein, for their entire coming into being and continued existence is by virtue of His will, which extends all the way to the lowest level of the world of Asiyah. And since all those existing things themselves are almost all coarse and materialistic to the greatest extent possible, therefore great is the praise of one who recites and contemplates all the chapters of Shira,

כִּי בִזָּה מְגַלָּה פָּנֵי הַלוֹט וְהַמְסַכָּה הַנְּסוּכָה עַל כָּל הַמִּצִּיאוֹת כָּלָם וּמִתְרָאָה הָאוֹר
 בְּהִיר אֲשֶׁר הֵם נִשְׁוֹאִים עָלָיו שֶׁהוּא רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש

§ 7:12

for in this way one removes the veil and the mask covering the entire existence.^[A9]
 And the bright light – which is His blessed will that they all venerate – will become visible.

וְהִיר מוֹצִיא יָקָר מִזֹּלָל^[10A] שֶׁאִינוֹ קֹץ לְמִתְּן שְׂכָרוֹ וּבִפְרֹט כִּי עִי"ז הֵנָּה נִשְׁלָם רְצוֹנוֹ
 ר"ל גְּלוּיוֹ אֲשֶׁר רָצָה בָּהֶם כִּי לֹא נַעֲשֶׂה גְלוּיוֹ בָּהֶם אֲלָא רַק לְהַמְתִּיבָנָם שֶׁהֵם כָּלָם
 מִרְצוֹנוֹ וְתִלּוּיָם רַק עָלָיו

§ 7:13

This will extract the valuable from the self-indulgent,^[A10] for which there is endless reward, and especially since this fulfills His will, i.e. the revelations that He wanted revealed. For His revelation is not made visible in them other than to one who contemplates that they are all His will and depend only upon Him.

וְהוּא ע"י הַפְּסוּקִים דִּפְרָק שִׁירָה שֶׁהֵם הוֹרָאת כָּל תְּכוּנוֹתֵיהֶם אֲשֶׁר יֵצְאוּ מִרְצוֹנוֹ
 בָּהֶם

§ 7:14

And this is by way of contemplating the verses of Perek Shira, which are instructions regarding all the ethical and moral qualities that emerged from His will. Contemplate this and understand.

וְהִיר לָנוּ כִּי בִמָּה שְׁנִתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ בַּפְּעֻלוֹתָיו הֵנָּה יֵשׁ לָנוּ גְלוּיִ בְּרְצוֹנוֹ עֲצָמוֹ וְהוּא
 בְּאוֹתוֹ הִרְצוֹנוֹ אֲשֶׁר רָצָה בָּהֶם וְהַמְתִּיבָנָם בִּזָּה הִרִי הוּא דְּבִיבֹק בְּרְצוֹנוֹ

§ 7:15

Thus we have it that what is revealed to us via His actions is in fact the revelation of His very Will. And this is the same Will that wanted them – i.e. their existence – so that anyone contemplating this is actually cleaving to His will.

וְהוּא מ"ש הַפְּתוּב (תהלים קד, כד) מְלָאָה הָאָרֶץ קִנְיָנָךְ וְכו' (בראשית יד, יט) קוּנָה
 שְׁמִים וְאָרֶץ לְהַתְּבּוֹנֵן עַל רְצוֹנוֹ אֲשֶׁר בְּכָלָם

§ 7:16

And this is what the verse (Psalms 104:24) states, 'The earth is full of Your possessions,' and (Genesis 14:19) refers to Him as 'Maker of heaven and earth' –

alluding to contemplating His Will as manifested in all of them.

אָמַנְם הִנֵּה עָקֵר גְּלוֹי רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בּוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא כָּל הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה
שֶׁהוּא כָּל הָעֲבוּדָה כֻּלָּה אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה לָנוּ וְרוּצָה מֵאֲתָנוּ

§ 7:17

However the primary revelation of His Will as revealed to us is in Torah and mitzvot, which is the entire service that He commanded us and wants from us.

וְכָל הָעֲבוּדָה כֻּלָּה הִרִי צִוִּיךָ שֶׁתְּהִיָּה לְשִׁמוּ וְלַעֲשׂוֹת נְחִת רוּחַ לְפָנָיו שְׂאֵמֵר וְנַעֲשֶׂה
רְצוֹנוֹ

§ 7:18

This entire service must be fulfilled for His sake, to cause Him delight, for He declared His will and it was done.^[^11]

וְהִרִי נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בְּרְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש וְהוּא גְלוֹי אֱלִינוּ אֲשֶׁר מִמֶּנּוּ עֲצָמוּ ר"ל בְּעֲצֻמּוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה
זוֹלָת גְּלוֹי בְּפַעֲלוֹתָיו אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל הַהִתְהוּוֹת וְהַמְצִיאוֹת דְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁהֵם כֻּלָּם
בְּבַחִי חוּץ מִמֶּנּוּ שֶׁהִרִי הֵם כֻּלָּם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כֻּלָּל

§ 7:19

Thus He is revealed in His Will, and its revelation to us is from Him Himself – meaning to say, from His essence itself – apart from His revelation through His actions of bringing everything into being, including the existence of the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah. For they – all the worlds – are of the aspect of 'outside of Him,' since none of them are G-dliness at all,

Although we stated before that the Almighty is revealed in the act of Creation, this is merely a secondary revelation. The primary revelation is in Torah and mitzvot.

אָבָל גְּלוֹי רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה אֱלִינוּ בּוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא גְלוֹי מֵאֱלֹהוּתוֹ עֲצָמוּ וְעַל זֶה הוּא גִּדָּל
הַחִיּוּב דְּעֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה שְׂאֵנוּ מְחִיבִים בָּהּ

§ 7:20

whereas the revelation of His will as revealed to us in Torah and mitzvot is the revelation of His actual G-dliness. And this is the reason behind the great duty to study Torah in which we are obligated.

כִּי נִדָּע הוּא שֶׁהַשְּׂכָל וְהַמְשָׁכִיל וְהַמְשָׁכֵל אֶחָד הוּא וְכַשְׁמִשְׁכִּיל וְיִדָּע אִיזָה דָּבָר
מֵהַתּוֹרָה הִרִי הוּא דְּבוּק וּמֵתֵאֶחֶד בְּרְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש מִמֶּשׁ כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ הַיְדִיעָה שְׂכָל בּוֹ
שֶׁהוּא חֵלֶק מִכְּחוֹת הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁבּוֹ וְהִרִי מֵתֵאֶחֶד עִם רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש מִמֶּשׁ

§ 7:21

Now as is known, the power of thought, the thinker and the thought are all one.^[^12] so that when a person comprehends and knows some matter in Torah, that person actually cleaves to and is at one with His blessed will. This is because that knowledge becomes part of his intellect, which is an element of his soul-powers. And so he becomes one with His will in actuality.

וְכַשְׁזֹּכָה לִידְעַת כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא רַמ"ח וְשִׁס"ה כְּבָנִין מְצִיָּאת כָּל הָאָדָם וּמִקִּים
וְעוֹשֶׂה אוֹתָם גַּם בְּגוּפוֹ מִמֶּשׁ הִרִי נַעֲשֶׂה כֻּלּוֹ בְּגוּפוֹ וְנִפְשׁוֹ דְּבוּק וּמֵתֵאֶחֶד בְּרְצוֹנוֹ

§ 7:22

Thus, when a person merits knowledge of the entire Torah, which comprises 248 positive commandments and 365 prohibitions,[^13] like the structure of the human body, and when a person keeps the prohibitions and fulfills the commandments with his body as well, he cleaves to and becomes one with His Will completely, body and soul.

וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר וְאַתֶּם הַדְּבָקִים כֹּ' וְכִי הוּא מְשֻׁם שְׂרָצוֹנוֹ ית"ש הִנֵּה הוּא אֹרֹךְ עֲצָמוֹ
הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט לַמָּטָה אַחֵר אֲשֶׁר נִתְצַמָּצַם בְּאַמְתָּתוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה דא"ס וְנִתְגַּלָּה בְכ"ז
בְּאַצִּילוּת

§ 7:23

And for this reason the verse (Deuteronomy 4:4) states, 'And you who cleave to God your Lord are all alive today,'[^14] since His will is His very own light spreading below, after He contracted His hidden true infiniteness – this is the concept of tzimtzum explained above – and is nevertheless revealed in Atzilut.

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא גִלּוּי עֲצָמוֹתוֹ לְכָל אוֹתוֹ הִרְצוֹן אֲשֶׁר גָּלָה לָנוּ בְּכָל הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה וְכֵן
לְהִרְצוֹן אֲשֶׁר בִּפְעֻלַּת כָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים שֶׁנִּבְרָאוּ וְנוֹצְרוּ וְנִעֲשֶׂוּ ג"כ רַק מִהַתּוֹרָה עֲצָמָה

§ 7:24

There in Atzilut His essence is revealed in the entire will He revealed to us throughout Torah and the mitzvot. And similarly regarding the Will that was activated in the process of creating all beings created in the world of Beriah, formed in the world of Yetzirah, and made in the world of Asiyah – from the Torah itself, [^15] since all of the worlds were made from the Torah, as the Zohar declares.

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁאֱמָרוּ בְּסֵפֶר יִצְרָה פ"ב עֲשָׂרִים וּשְׁתַּיִם אוֹתִיּוֹת כֹּ' וְצַר בָּהֶם אֶת כָּל הַיְצוֹר
וְאֶת כָּל הָעֵתִיד לְצַר

§ 7:25

And as the Sefer Yetzirah (2:2) declares: 'Twenty-two letters... with them He designed all that was formed, and all that would be formed.'

וּמְשֻׁם שֶׁכָּל רָצוֹנוֹ אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בּוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת אֹרֹךְ עֲצָמוֹ לָכֵן הַדְּבֹק
בְּרָצוֹנוֹ הוּא דְּבֹק בּוֹ גּוּפָה וְהוּא שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְאַתֶּם הַדְּבָקִים בִּי"א כֹ' וְכִנְזָכָר

§ 7:26

Now since His entire will was revealed to us in it – in the Torah – the Torah is therefore the spreading forth of His very light. Therefore, one who cleaves to His Will, cleaves to Him Himself, and this is what the verse states, 'And you who cleave to God your Lord...' as mentioned.

Chapter 8: Atzilut is Unified with the Emanator; the Future Revelation

Shaar 1 Chapter 8

Atzilut is Unified with the Emanator; the Future Revelation

וְהִנֵּה כ"ז הוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁמִּלְמַדְנוּ קְדוּשׁ עֲלִיוֹן רַבְּנוּ הָרַמְ"ק ז"ל בְּסֵפֶר הַפְּרָדָּס שֶׁעַר
הַצְחָצְחוֹת פ"ג

§ 8:1

All of this — the above explanation — is according to what the Ramak, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero, taught us in *Pardes Rimonim, Shaar haTzachtzachot* chap. 3.

וְאָמַר זֶה לְשׁוֹנוֹ וְהֶעֱנִין כִּי לֹא מַחְשְׁבוֹתָיו מַחְשְׁבוֹתֵינוּ וְלֹא דַרְכָּיו דַּרְכֵּנוּ

§ 8:2

This is what he said, in his own words: "His thoughts are not our thoughts, and His ways are not our ways:[^1]

כִּי בְּאֲשֶׁר יִדְמָה הָאָדָם בְּשִׁכְלוֹ לְהוֹת אִיזוֹ מְצִיאוֹת שִׁיהִיָּה הִנֵּה מַחְשְׁבָתוֹ לֹא תִפְעִיל
וְאִם יִדְמָה וַיִּצִיר בְּשִׁכְלוֹ צוּרַת הַמְצִיאוֹת אֲשֶׁר בְּרָצוֹנוֹ לְהוֹת

§ 8:3

Because when a person thinks about creating some entity, such a thought achieves nothing — even if he imagines it clearly and depicts in his mind the form of what he wishes to bring into being.

עַם כָּל זֹאת וְהִיָּה כָּלֵא הִיָּה עַד יִפְעַל וַיֵּצֵא לַפְעֵל

§ 8:4

Even so, nothing changes — it is as it always was, nothing — until he acts and brings it into reality.

וְנִמְצָא הַפּוֹעֵל שְׁלֵם מֵהַכֹּחַ כִּי הַכֹּחַ חֹסֵר הַמְצִיאוֹת וְאִין לוֹ מְצִיאוֹת וְשְׁלִימוֹת כָּלֵל

§ 8:5

It turns out therefore that, in the human realm, action is more complete than potential, since what is merely in potential lacks existence; it has no actual existence and completeness at all.

וְהַפּוֹעֵל הוּא הָעֹקֵר וְהַמְצִיאוֹת זִוְלָתוֹ אֵין דָּבָר

§ 8:6

Thus the deed is the main thing[^2] and it is what exists, and other than it there is nothing.

וְאִין כּוֹ פְעֻלוֹתָיו וְהוּיּוֹתוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמַּלְכִּים הַקֵּב"ה

§ 8:7

But this is not so with the deeds and creations of the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed is He.

כִּי בְּאֲשֶׁר עָלָה בְּרָצוֹנוֹ לְהוֹת וּלְהַאֲצִיל אֲצִילוֹת הַטְּהוֹר וְהַקְּדוֹשׁ

§ 8:8

For when it arises in His Will to bring something into being and to emanate a pure and holy emanation,[³]

הִנֵּה אֵז נִאֲצֵל וְנִצְטִיר כֻּלּוֹ בְּעֶצְמוֹתוֹ בְּלִי שְׁנוֹי בּוֹ ח"ו

§ 8:9

then it is emanated and formed within Him without any change in Him, G-d forbid.

אֵלָא מְצִיאוֹת מְתִיחַד עִמּוֹ עַד שְׁאִין בֵּין הַמֵּאֲצִיל וְהַמְצִיאוֹת הֵהוּא הַבְּדֵל כָּלֵל

§ 8:10

But that existence is one with Him, to the extent that there is no distinction between the Emanator and that existence at all.[⁴]

אֵלָא הוּא וְהֵם הֶכֶּל דְּבֵר אֶחָד וְעַצֵּם אֶחָד כּו' כּו' ע"ש

§ 8:11

Rather, He and they are all one, and a single essence" etc. etc. This is the end of the quote from the *Pardes Rimmonim*. See there in *Pardes*.

וְכֵן עוֹד בְּדִבְרֵיו בְּזֶה בְּאֵילָמָה בְּעֵין שְׁמֶשׁ תָּמָר א' פ"ב וּבְעֵין הַבְּדֵלָח תָּמָר א' פ' ט"ז ע"ש

§ 8:12

Likewise, again in his own words, in *Eilimah Rabbati, Eyn Shemesh, Tamar* 1, chap. 2, and in *Eyn HaBedolach, Tamar* 1, chap. 16:

וְהִנֵּה כֵן הוּא עַד"ז עֲנִין רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש הִנֵּה הוּא מְצִיאוֹת אֹרֹךְ עֶצְמוֹ

§ 8:13

"It is a similar situation regarding His blessed will — it is His very light of the *Ein Sof* Himself.

וְלָכֵן אָמַרְנוּ כִּי הַדְּבֵק בְּרְצוֹנוֹ הוּא דְּבֹקֵק בּוֹ מִמֶּשׁ

§ 8:14

And therefore we said that one who cleaves to His Will literally cleaves to Him.

אֲמַנִּים כְּבֵר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵגֵם שְׁכָל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה הִנֵּה הִיא אֹרֹךְ רְצוֹנוֹ מִמֶּשׁ וְהִיא אֹרֹךְ קִדְשָׁתוֹ גּוֹפָה

§ 8:15

However, we already noted that even though the entire Torah is actually the light of His Will, and is the light of His holiness itself,

עכ"ז הִנֵּה אֵין גְּלוּי לָנוּ מֵאֹרֶךְ קִדְשָׁתוֹ שְׁבָה אֵלָא רַק בִּידִיעָה וְלֹא בְּהִשָּׁגָה

§ 8:16

nevertheless, the light of His holiness in it — in the Torah — is not revealed to us in a manner that we can comprehend it; only in terms of knowledge do we know that this is so, but not how or why.

וְאֵין אָנוּ מְשִׁיגִים בָּהּ אֵלָא רַק ע"ד הַשְּׁגָתָנוּ בְּכָל בְּחִי' רְצוֹן שֶׁהוּא רְצוֹן וְלֹא מְצִיאוֹת

§ 8:17

And we are able to comprehend of it only in the same manner we comprehend any aspect of will — it is will in a potential state, not actual being, i.e. an entity that exists.

הגם שבאמת הרי הוה רצונו בה אור קדשתו עצמו

§ 8:18

Even though, in truth, His Will in it — in the Torah — is the light of His holiness itself.

וכן אמרנו ג"כ כי הנה היא רק תמצית הארה לבד מאור העקרי אשר למעלה

§ 8:19

Similarly, we also noted that it is only the distillation of the radiance of the main light above.

ולכן אמרו רז"ל ב"ר פ' י"ז ססי' ה' נובלת חכמה של מעלה תורה

§ 8:20

And therefore our Sages state in *Bereishit Rabba* 17:5: 'Torah is merely the runoff from *Chochma* [Wisdom] above.'

Although Torah is G-d's wisdom, the Torah down here in this world is merely the 'runoff' or 'overflow' of G-d's wisdom, according to the sages of the Midrash.

וכן בקהלת רפ"ב ופ' י"א כל התורה שהאדם למד בעולם הזה הכל הוא לפני תורה שבעולם הבא

§ 8:21

A similar statement is found in Midrash *Kohelet* chaps. 2 & 11: 'All the Torah that a person learns in this world is regarded as merely futility^[^5] compared with the Torah of the World to Come.'

כי כאשר יתבטל כל הזהומא ויזדככו כל העביות והמסכים המפסיקים אלינו בין אור קדשתו העקרי אשר למעלה באצילות

§ 8:22

because when all the contamination will be annulled and all the coarseness will be purified, and the 'screens'^[^6] separating us from the main light of His holiness as it is above in Atzilut will be removed —

אז יתפשט אור קדשתו עצמו למטה גם כן ונגלה כבוד ה' אל כל בשר

§ 8:23

then the very light of His holiness will spread forth down below as well, and the glory of G-d will be revealed to all flesh.^[^7]

וכמו שכתוב (ישעיה ל. כ) ולא יכנף עוד מוריך והיו עיניך ראות את מוריך

§ 8:24

as the verse states (*Isaiah* 30:20): "Your Teacher will no longer be hidden behind His garment, and your eyes will behold your Teacher."

כי עכשו על ידי שהיא רק תמצית הארה לבד ועל ידי העביות והזהומא נפסקה חומת ברזל בין ישראל לאביהם שבשמים

§ 8:25

But now, since it is only the distillation of the radiance, and coarseness and contamination obstruct like an iron wall between Israel and their Father in Heaven,

ואין אנו משיגים מאור קדשת רצונו אלא השגת הרצון לבד

§ 8:26

we do not comprehend the light of His holy Will, but only the Will itself — what it is that He wants, though His light is not revealed to us therein.

אֲבָל לְעֵתִיד בְּשִׁיתְבָּטֵל כָּל הַמַּסָּכִים אֲזִי יִתְגַּלֶּה וְיֵרָאֶה כָּל הָרָצוֹן בְּאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ שֶׁבּוֹ
מִמָּשׁ וְהָרִי יִתְגַּלֶּה אֲזִי הָרָצוֹן בְּבַחֲיִנַת הַמְּצִיאוֹת שֶׁבּוֹ גַּם כֵּן וְהוּא אֲמַתַּת רָצוֹנוֹ כְּמוֹ
שֶׁהוּא

§ 8:27

But in the future, when all the 'screens' will be nullified, then His entire Will shall be revealed, with that very light of holiness therein. For the Will shall be revealed then as it is in actuality within Him — this is His true will as it is in itself.

וְנִמְצָא שֶׁכָּל הַגְּלוּי אֲשֶׁר יֵשׁ לָנוּ עֲתֵה בּוֹ הֵנָּה אֵין עֶרֶךְ לוֹ הֵן בְּכַמּוֹת וְהֵן בְּאִיכוֹת נִגְדִּי
הָרָצוֹן הָאֲמִתִּי וְהַעֲקָרִי שִׁיתְגַּלֶּה אֲזִי

§ 8:28

So it turns out that the entire revelation that we have now is incomparable — quantitatively and qualitatively — to the true, primary Will that will be revealed then in the World to Come.

זֶהוּ שֶׁאֲמָרוּ שֶׁכָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהָאָדָם לוֹמֵד בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הֵבֵל הוּא לִפְנֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם
הַבָּא

§ 8:29

And this is the meaning of the statement that the entire Torah that a person learns in this world is merely 'futility' — i.e. inconsequential — compared with the Torah of the World to Come.

Chapter 9: The Importance of the Inner Dimensions of Torah

Shaar 1 Chapter 9

The Importance of the Inner Dimensions of Torah

אָמַנָם הוּא כִּי הָגַם שְׁאִין לָנוּ עֵתָה מִהֲרָצוֹן הָעֶקְרִי אֲלֵא רַק תִּמְצִית הָאָרָה מִמֶּנּוּ
§ 9:1

However, although we do not currently have access to His primary will, but only to the distillation of the radiance thereof — as explained in the previous chapter —

עַם כָּל זֶה הִנֵּה הִיא תִּמְצִית הָאָרָה מְכֻלּוּ בְּלִי חִסּוּר בּוֹ דָּבָר מֵאוּמָה
§ 9:2

nevertheless, it is the distillation of the radiance in its entirety, not missing one iota.

וְלֹא עוֹד אֲלֵא שְׁאוֹתָהּ הַתִּמְצִית הָאָרָה אֲשֶׁר נִתְפָּשְׁטָה אֵלֵינוּ הִנֵּה הוּא הַיְסוֹד
הַמַּעֲמִיד אֶת כָּל גְּלוּיֵי הָעֶקְרִי ית"ש אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה בְּאַצִּילוֹת
§ 9:3

Furthermore, that distilled radiance itself which is disseminated to us is the very foundation that supports His entire primary revelation above in the world of Atzilut.

וְכֻמוֹ שֶׁכְּתוּב בְּשִׁמוּאֵל רַבְתִּי פָּרָשָׁה ה' אֵלֶיךָ נִשְׁאַתִּי אֶת עֵינֵי הַיֹּשֵׁב בְּשָׂמִים (תהלים
קכג, א) שְׁאֵלּוּלָא אֲנִי כְּבִיכּוֹל אֵין הוּא יוֹשֵׁב בְּשָׂמִים וְכֵן בְּסִפְרֵי פ' זֹאת הַבְּרָכָה סִי
שִׁמ"ו

§ 9:4
As is written in Midrash *Shmuel Rabbati* section 5, on the verse (Psalms 123:1)
"To You who resides in the Heavens I lifted my eyes..." — 'If not for me [the Jewish
person learning Torah and doing mitzvot], He would not be sitting in heaven, so to
speak!' A similar sentiment is expressed in *Sifri, Zot HaBracha* section 346.

כִּי אֵלּוּלָא הַתּוֹרָה שְׁבַע עוֹלָם הִזָּה הִיָּה מִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל גְּלוּיֵי אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת גַּם כֵּן וְהִיָּה
חֲזוֹר לְאִין סוּף כְּמִקְדָּם

§ 9:5
Because if not for Torah in this world, all of His revelations in Atzilut as well would
return to their source in the *Ein Sof*, just as before.

וְרַק עַל יְדֵי עֶסֶק הַתּוֹרָה וְקִיּוּם הַמִּצְוָה שְׁבַע עוֹלָם הִזָּה מַעֲמִידִים כָּל גְּלוּיֵי שְׁבַע אִצִּילוֹת
§ 9:6

It is only by virtue of striving in Torah and fulfilling mitzvot in this world that His
revelations are firmly established in Atzilut.

וְהוּא עֲנֵנוּ הָעֲבוּדָה צֶרֶךְ גְּבוּהָ בְּנוֹדַע מִכַּמָּה סִפְרֵי קְדוּשֵׁי עֲלִיוֹן וְכֻמוֹ שֶׁהָאֵרִיכוּ בָּזָה
הָרַב מֵאִיר גַּבַּי בְּסִפְרֵי עֲבוּדַת הַקֹּדֶשׁ וְהַשְׁלָ"ה וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַחַיִּים

§ 9:7
This is called 'service for the sake of the Supreme One,' as is known from a number
of holy works, as explained at length by Rabbi Meir ibn Gabai in *Avodat
HaKodesh*, and by the *Shelah*^[1] and the *Nefesh Hachaim*^[2].

וְהוּא כְּדִי לְהַעֲמִיד אֶת גְּלוּיָיו לְמַעַלָּה וְעֵין זֹהֵר קִדְשׁ פְּרִשְׁת׃ בְּחֻקֵּי קִי״ג סע״א וְשֵׁם
ע״ב

§ 9:8

This service for the sake of the Supreme One is in order to establish His revelations above. See *Zohar* II, *Bechukotai* 113a-b.[³]

וְכָל מֶה שֶׁהָאָדָם מַקְיִים וְעוֹשֶׂה רְצוֹנוֹ ית״ש לְמַטָּה הֵנָּה הוּא מְקַיֵּם וּמַעֲמִיד וּמַתְקֵן
וּבִנְיָה אֶת דְּגֻמָּתוֹ בְּשִׁרְשׁוֹ וְאוּרֹוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה

§ 9:9

Whenever a person fulfills and follows His blessed Will down below, he fulfills and establishes and rectifies and builds something similar in the roots and illuminations above and beyond.

וּמִכָּל שְׁכֵן בְּשֶׁהָאָדָם עוֹסֵק לְמַטָּה בְּפִנְיִית הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא בְּעִנְיָנִי אֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ
אֲשֶׁר בְּאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְמַעַלָּה מֵהַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹתוֹ אֲשֶׁר בְּעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי״ע

§ 9:10

And all the more so when a person occupies himself down here with the inner dimensions of the Torah — i.e. with Kabbalah — in matters pertaining to the light of His holiness itself in Atzilut, that transcends the 'cloaking' that is prevalent in the worlds of *BiYA*.

As mentioned earlier, in order for the light to descend to *BiYA* it must be dimmed and attenuated. This process is akin to covering or cloaking it in garments which obscure the light.

וְהָרִי הוּא עוֹסֵק בְּאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ בְּלִי הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת כָּלֵל וְהָרִי גָדוֹל הָעֶסֶק בְּעִנְיָן הַזֶּה
בְּאֵין עֶרֶךְ וְחֻקֵּר

§ 9:11

In fact, when a person studies Kabbalah he occupies himself with the light of His holiness itself, not cloaked at all. Accordingly, the merit of striving in this matter is immeasurably and unfathomably great.

וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאֵינוֹ רוֹאִין שֵׁיִשׁ חֲלוּק בְּדִין בֵּין הַכּוֹתֵב אֶת הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים לְשֶׁאֵר כָּל
הַתּוֹרָה כִּי הַשְּׁמוֹת צָרִיךְ לְקַדְּשֵׁם בְּקִדְשָׁה כְּפוּלָה נוֹסֵף עַל קִדְשָׁת שֶׁאֵר כָּל הַתּוֹרָה

§ 9:12

This is analogous to the difference we see in Jewish law between writing the holy Names and writing all the other words of the Torah: the holy Names require sanctification with double sanctity over and above the sanctity of the rest of the Torah.[⁴]

For example, before a scribe writes any words of the Torah, he declares, "I am hereby writing this Torah scroll keeping in mind the sanctity of the Torah." Nevertheless, whenever he writes one of the holy Names he must first declare, "I am hereby writing this holy Name for the sanctity of the holy Name."¹ From this we see the Names have a higher level of sanctity. In addition, while the scribe is writing one of the Names, he may not interrupt, even if a Jewish king addresses him. Furthermore, the Names may not be erased, not even a single letter.

והגם שכל התורה כלה הרי הוא שמותיו של הקב"ה וכנ"ל עם כל זה הם חלוקים
בדיו

§ 9:13

And even though the entire Torah comprises G-d's Names,[^6] as mentioned earlier, there is a difference in Jewish law between the holy Names and the rest of the Torah.

וצריך בשמות לקדשם בקדשה יתרה משום ששאר כל התורה היא מלבש באיזה
נושא מהעולם הזה משא כן השמות שהם עליו עצמו ית"ש לכן הם צריכים קדשה
יתרה

§ 9:14

The reason we must treat the Names with a higher level of sanctity is because the rest of Torah is cloaked in some mundane subject or other, whereas the holy Names refer to Him Himself, blessed be He. And therefore they require a greater level of sanctity.

כן הוא נקל להבין על דרך זה תוספת המעלה והקדשה אשר לעוסק באורות
האצילות עצמו אשר למעלה מהעולמות ב"ע

§ 9:15

Similarly, this analogy makes it easy to understand the additional preeminence and holiness of one who occupies himself with the illumination in Atzilut itself, which transcends the worlds of *BiYA*.

והנה מתדבק בזה באור קדשתו עצמו בלתי התלבשות כלל ונעשה הוא גופה מקום
ומעון לשכינת עזו ית"ש

§ 9:16

For he cleaves thereby to the light of His holiness itself, without it being cloaked in any way, and he himself becomes the place and abode for His blessed indwelling power — the *Shechinah*.

וכמו שאמרנו לעיל פ"ז כי השכל והמשכיל והמשכל אחד הוא

§ 9:17

For as we said above in chapter 7 — the power of thought, the thinker and the thought are all one, and this is particularly so in the inner dimensions of Torah — Kabbalah.

וכן בעסקו בזה הנה הוא מקים ומתקן את אותו הגלויים למעלה וכמו שכתוב
בהקדמת זהר בראשית ב' ע"א וד' ע"ב וכן בהקדמת תקונים ג' סע"ב

§ 9:18

Furthermore, when he occupies himself with this — the inner dimensions of Torah — he supports and rectifies those revelations above, as is written in *Zohar, Bereishit* 2a, 4b and in the Introduction to the *Tikunei Zohar* 3b.

ולכן הוא גדל החיוב לעסק בחכמת האמת כל מי שראוי לזה כמו שכתוב בתקונים
תקון ל' פ"א ע"ב

§ 9:19

Thus there is a great obligation for anyone who is suited for this to occupy himself with this True Wisdom, as is stated in *Tikunim, tikun* 30, p. 81b.

וַעֲיֹן שֵׁם בְּהִגְרָא וְכֵן הוּא בְּכִמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת בְּזֹהַר קֹדֶשׁ וַיִּכְמוּ שְׁהָאֲרִיךְ בְּזֶה הַסֵּפֶר
וַיִּקְהַל מֹשֶׁה בְּהַקְדָּמָה

§ 9:20

See the commentary of the GRA — the Gaon of Vilna — to the *Tikunei Zohar*, and in a number of places in the holy Zohar, as the Introduction to *Vayakhel Moshe*^[^7] states at length.

וְכֵן הָרַח"ו ז"ל בְּהַקְדָּמַת עַץ חַיִּים מִדְּפוּס וְאַרְשָׁא תַרנ"א

§ 9:21

And similar statements were made by Rabbi Chaim Vital in the Introduction to *Etz Chaim*, Warsaw 5651 (1891):

וּבְאֲשֶׁר שֶׁהִזְהַר קֹדֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר הוּא כְּלוּ מִיִּסֵּד עַל זֶה הִנֵּה כָּל דְּבָרָיו הֵם סְתוּמִים
וְחֲתוּמִים לְכֹן הָאִיר הַשִּׁית"ב אֶת עֵינֵינוּ וְשָׁלַח לָנוּ אֶת אִישׁ אֱלֹהִים קֹדֶשׁ מִן
הָאֲרִיז"ל

§ 9:22

"And being that the Zohar is founded entirely upon this — the illumination in Atzilut — all of it is closed and sealed to a regular person. And therefore G-d, may He be blessed, illuminated our eyes and sent us the man of G-d, our holy master, the Arizal" — Rabbi Isaac Luria.

וְהוּא פָתַח לְפָנֵינוּ אֶת שַׁעְרֵי אוֹרָה בְּכָל דְּרוֹשָׁיו אֲשֶׁר דָּרַשׁ וְגָלָה לְתַלְמִידוֹ נֶאֱמַר בֵּיתוֹ
נִתְּקָ וְחִסִּיד הָרַח"ו ז"ל

§ 9:23

He opened before us the gates of light through his teachings, and revealed them to his faithful disciple, the venerable and pious Rabbi Chaim Vital.

וְהֵם כָּל סִפְרֵי הָאֲרִיז"ל אֲשֶׁר כְּתִבָּם הָרַח"ו ז"ל וּבִפְרֵט הַסֵּפֶר הַקֹּדֶשׁ וְהַנּוֹרָא עַץ
חַיִּים אֲשֶׁר לְפָנֵינוּ שֶׁהוּא הָרֹאשׁ וְהָרָשׁוֹן וְהַעֲקָרִי לְכָל סִפְרָיו וְהוּא פָתַח וְשַׁעַר לְכָל
דְּבָרֵי הִזְהַר קֹדֶשׁ

§ 9:24

Rabbi Chaim Vital recorded all the works of the Arizal — and particularly the holy, awe-inspiring work *Etz Chaim*^[^8] in its present form before us — which is the first and foremost and the primary of all his works. It is the opening and the gateway to all the words of the holy Zohar.

וְהִנֵּה הוּא מְדַבֵּר בְּרַחֲבָה וְאַרְכָּה בְּכָל כְּלָלוֹת גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר מֵרוֹם חִבּוּן עֲזָו שֶׁהוּא
מְאוּר אֵין סוֹף אֲשֶׁר מֵאַמְתָּתוֹ הִנְעֵלְמָה עַד גְּלוּיֹ הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁבְּכָל הַנְּאֻצִּים כֻּלָּם
שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה שֵׁם בָּאוֹר קֹדֶשְׁתּוֹ עֲצָמוֹ

§ 9:25

It discusses extensively and at length the entirety of His revelations — from the pinnacle of His hidden strength,^[^9] the *Ohr Ein Sof*, His concealed truth — until the final revelation among all the emanations that was revealed there in Atzilut as the light of His holiness itself.

לְהִיּוֹת יִסוֹד וְשֹׁרֶשׁ לְכָל הוֹצָאוֹת הַמְּצִיאוֹת וְהַנְּהָגָה דְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 9:26

This was to become the foundation and root of all the forms of existence that were brought forth, and the foundation and root of how the worlds of *BiYA* are directed.

וְכִמוֹ שִׁיסַד הָאֶרֶץ לִבְתִּפְלֹתוֹ לְיוֹם הַחֲמִישִׁי (בְּשַׁעֲרֵי צִיּוֹן) אֲשֶׁר בְּהִיוֹתָךְ אֶתָּה שָׂרָשׁ
אֶל כָּל נִמְצָא וְיִסּוּד כָּל נִבְרָא

§ 9:27

As we see based on the teachings of the Arizal in the prayer for the fifth day of the week (in *Shaarei Tzion*,^[10] *sha'ar* 3): "In Your being, You are the root of all existence and the foundation^[11] of all creations."

וְהַכְנָנָה הוּא עַל גְּלוּיוֹ שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת שֶׁשָּׁם נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִיּוֹת שָׂרָשׁ לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ

§ 9:28

The objective of this stanza is to refer to His illuminations in Atzilut — revealed there in order to become the root of all existence.

וְהִנֵּה מְדַבֵּר הָעֵץ חַיִּים בְּכָל סֻדְרֵי גְלוּיָיו שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת בְּאִיזָה אִפֹּן שֶׁנִּסְדְּרוּ וּבְאִיזָה פָּנִים
שֶׁמֵּאִירִים שָׁם לְהוֹצִיא פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בָּהֶם וּבִסְדֹר הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת בְּכָל פְּרָטֵי הַנִּצְאָלִים כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר
עַל יְדֵיהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה

§ 9:29

Now the *Etz Chaim* discusses the entire process of His revelations in Atzilut — in what manner they are configured, and which aspects they illuminate — in order to bring forth His activities through them, and it discusses the process by which the light is cloaked in all the specific details of the emanated entities there, by which the light becomes revealed.

וְאִפֹּן יַחֲדוֹ בְּכָל אֶחָד מֵהֶם וּבִסְדֹר עֲמִידָתָם וְקִשּׁוּרָם זֶה בָּזָה וְאִיךְ שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּלְשְׁלוּ
מִמְדֻגָּה לְמִדְרָגָה מִשְׁרָשָׁם הָרִאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר מֵרוֹם חֲבִיּוֹן עָזָה עַד מְצִיאוֹתָם הָאַחֲרוֹן

§ 9:30

In addition, this work explains the manner of His unification with each of them, and their stature and connection with each other. And it reveals how they devolved^[12] from stage to stage from their original root — from the pinnacle of His hidden strength, the *Ohr Ein Sof* — until their final form of existence.

וְכֵן אִפֹּן הַתְּפִשְׁטוּתָם בְּמְצִיאוֹת דְּהֶעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע עֲצָמָן עַד שֶׁכֻּלָּם תְּלוּיִם רַק בְּאַצִּילוֹת
וּבְאוֹר יַחֲדוֹ אֲשֶׁר שָׁם וּמִשָּׁם הֵם נִמְצָאִים וּמִשְׁגָּחִים וּמִתְנַהֲגִים תָּמִיד

§ 9:31

The *Etz Chaim* also delineates the manner in which they spread forth into the objective reality of the worlds of *BiYA* themselves, to the extent that all of them are dependent exclusively upon Atzilut and the light of His Oneness there. And it is from there that they emerge and are overseen and are directed continuously.

וְכָל זֶה הוּא מְבֹאֵר בְּסִפְרֵי הַקְּדוּשָׁה וְהַנּוֹרָא הָעֵץ חַיִּים אֲשֶׁר לְפָנֵינוּ וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר (דְּבָרֵי
הַנְּזִמִּים א' כ"ח) דַּע אֶת אֱלֹהֵי אֲבִיךָ

§ 9:32

All of this is explained in the holy, awe-inspiring work *Etz Chaim* in its present form before us. Regarding this the verse states (I Chronicles 28:9): "Get to know the

G-d of your father."

וְכֹן מֵה שְׁפָתוֹב (דְּבָרִים ד') וַיִּדְעַת הַיּוֹם וְהַשַּׁבָּת אֶל לְבָבָךְ כִּי ה' הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים בְּשָׁמַיִם
מִמַּעַל וְעַל הָאָרֶץ מִתַּחַת אֵין עוֹד

§ 9:33

Similarly, another verse (Deuteronomy 4:39) urges: "Know this day and place upon your heart that G-d is the Lord in the heavens above and upon the earth below; there is no other."

וַיִּדַע כִּי עוֹד כְּמֵה דְבָרִים עֲקָרִיִּים הַנוֹגְעִים לְדְבָרֵינוּ הַנִּי"ל כְּתִבְנוּ בְּאַרְכָּהּ וּבְבֹאוֹר יוֹתֵר
בְּסִפּוֹר הַדְּעָה ח"א דְּרוֹשׁ ה' סִימָן ז'

§ 9:34

Know also that there are a number of fundamental matters pertaining to what we just said above that we have written about at length and with further explanation in our book *De'ah*, part 1 (5:7).

וְכֹן יִתְבָּאֵר עוֹד לְקִמּוֹ בְּשַׁעְרֵים הַבָּאִים בְּעֵזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וַיִּתְעַלֶּה

§ 9:35

These matters will also be explained further in the sections to come, with G-d Almighty's help.

Footnotes

1. *Berachot* 32b; *Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim* chapter 104. [↩](#)

G A T E

*Shaar 2 — Matter, Form, and the Chain of
Worlds*

Chapter 1: From Higher World to Lower World

Shaar 2 Chapter 1

From Higher World to Lower World

והנה אחר שדברנו בשער א' מענין מציאות גלוייו ית"ש אשר נתפשט מאמתתו
הנעלמה ונתגלה באצילות ועל ידי זה המציא את המציאות דעולמות בי"ע

§ 2:1

We spoke in the first *shaar* of this work about His revelations^[^1] — how they spread forth from His hidden true being and are revealed in Atzilut, and in this way the existence of the worlds of *BiYA* is produced.

והנה היה סדר התפשטות גלוייו שבאצילות בדרך השתלשלות המדרגות וירד
ממדרגה למדרגה עד שיירד להתגלות בפעלת מציאות העולמות בי"ע והנהגתם

§ 2:2

Now the orderly manner in which this spreading forth of His revelations in Atzilut proceeds is by way of *hishtalshelut hamadreigot* — a chain of cause and effect, descending from level to level, until it descended to where these Divine revelations became revealed in producing the existence of the worlds of *BiYA* and in the manner in which they are conducted.

וכדי להבין קצת סדר התפשטות המדרגות שבאצילות סדרם וקשורם זה בזה נלמד
מהמאחר אל הקודם היינו מסדר פעלתו ית"ש אשר אנו רואין בעולם הזה

§ 2:3

In order to understand in some small measure the order of this spreading forth of the levels in Atzilut, their sequence, and how they are connected to one another — let us learn in reverse, from later to earlier, that is, from the order of His actions we see in this world and upward.

ומזה נוכל להבין קצת איך שהוא הסדר בשרשם בקדש ובקדש הקדשים אשר
למעלה למעלה

§ 2:4

And from this we will be able to understand a little about the order of things in their root in the holy realms and the holy of holy realms that are above and beyond.

ונתחיל ונאמר כי הנה אנו רואין בכל הנמצאים כלם שבעולם הזה הן בכלל והן
בפרט הנה מיסד כל אחד על שני בחינות שהם חמר וצורה או גוף ונפש

§ 2:5

Let us begin by stating that all the entities we see in this world — in general and in particular, i.e. general categories and individual entities — are all based on two aspects: matter and *tzurah* (form)^[^2] — or body and soul.

וכמו שמבאר כל זה בדרושים האחרונים שבספר עץ חיים ועין בספר הברית
בתחלתו

§ 2:6

as explained in the last teachings in *Etz Chaim*^[^3] — see also *Sefer HaBrit* in the beginning.

והנה אין חמר בלי צורה ולא צורה בלי חמר כנודע

§ 2:7

Now in our world there is no matter without *tzurah*, and no *tzurah* without matter, as is known.

והגם שהם שני מציאויות אשר הם רחוקים במדרגתם זה מזה הרבה מאד עם כל זה הנה הם מתיוחדים זה בזה ביחוד עצום עד שאי אפשר להמצא זה בלא זה

§ 2:8

And even though these are two distinct entities, very distant from one another in terms of their levels, they are united with one another in such a powerful unity that it is impossible to find one without the other.

והענין בזה הוא כי כל מה שאנו רואין שהם שתי מדרגות וגבוה מעלת הצורה על החמר באין ערך הנה כל זה הוא רק בהחמר וצורה שבכל הנמצאים שבועולם הזה גופה

§ 2:9

The concept is this: everything we see as two different levels, where *tzurah* is immeasurably superior to matter, is all exclusively as regards matter and *tzurah* as found in this world itself.

וכן בכל הנמצאים שבכל עולם ועולם עצמו

§ 2:10

Similarly with all the entities in each of the worlds themselves — *tzurah* and matter are inseparably united.

אבל מעולם לעולם הנה נעשה מהחמר של עולם העליון הצורה של עולם התחתון

§ 2:11

But from world to world — from a higher plane of existence to the one below it — the matter of the higher world becomes the *tzurah* of the lower world.

וכלול באותה הצורה כח החמר דהתחתון גם כן אלא שמתחלה היא כלולה שם רק בכח ואחר כך יוצא משם מן הכח אל הפועל למציאות גמור גם כן

§ 2:12

And contained within that *tzurah* is also the potential for matter of the lower plane — albeit that initially it is included there only *in potentia*. This subsequently emerges from potential to actual, as actual existence as well.

והרי הם שניהם משרש אחד ולכך הם מיוחדים זה בזה לעולם כי מתחלה בשרש כלול החמר בצורה ואחר כך כשנשלמו לבחינת מציאות הראוי לתחתון מתלבשת הצורה בהחמר והם אחד לעולם

§ 2:13

Thus both *tzurah* and matter are from a single source, which is why they are always united with one another — since initially, in their root, matter was included in *tzurah*. But afterwards, when it became an entity befitting that lower plane, the *tzurah* becomes vested in the matter and they are one forever.

ובאור הדברים הוא כי הנה כל עולם תחתון הוא משתלשל ונעשה כל מציאותו מהעולם העליון שעליו שהוא קודם אליו בזמן ובמעלה

§ 2:14

The explanation is this: every lower world devolves from — and its entire existence is produced by — the world above it, by the plane of existence that precedes it in time and superiority.

וסדר ההשתלשלות הוא כי מתפשט מתחלה אורו ועצמותו הראוי להיות שרש למדרגת התחתון הנה מתפשט ויורד במקום העתיד לתחתון ועל ידי ירידתו ורחוקו ממקורו הנה נתחשך ונתעבה קצת

§ 2:15

This *hishtalshelut* sequence occurs because initially the light and essence of the higher plane that was fit to become the source of the lower plane spreads out and descends to the future place of the lower plane, and by descending and becoming distant from its source it becomes dimmed and somewhat 'thicker' — i.e. coarser and less permeable to the light.

'Thicker' is not meant literally. It signifies a qualitative reduction and degrading of the light, much like physical light emerging from a semi-opaque filter — it is still light but much dimmer and weaker than it was before.

ואותה העבייות שנעשה בו הוא היסוד שהוא הראשית והתחלה לחמר דהתחתון

§ 2:16

This 'thickening' that takes place is the foundation and initial introduction of matter in the lower plane.

והנה נעשה על ידי התפשטות האור הנזכר שלש תועליות

§ 2:17

Now this spreading forth of the light just mentioned produced three benefits:

אחד כי על ידי רחוקו ממקורו והתפשטותו וירידתו במקום העתיד לתחתון נעשה ראוי להיות שרש אליו

§ 2:18

1) By becoming distant from its origin, and by spreading out and descending to the place of the future lower plane, it becomes suitable as a source for that lower plane.

שנים כי על ידי שנתעבה כמו שאמרנו הרי נעשה בו היסוד לחמר דהתחתון גם כן

§ 2:19

2) By becoming 'thicker', as we said, it also becomes the foundation for the matter of the lower plane.

והשלישי הוא כי הנה באשר שכל אותו האור שנתפשט הנה הוא רק כדי להעשות לבחינת שרש לתחתון הנה מקומו ועקרו הוא רק למעלה בהעלם העליון

§ 2:20

3) The light spreads forth entirely for the purpose of becoming a source for the lower plane — although its proper place and primary nature is only above, in the concealed upper plane.

The spreading forth of the light from the higher plane to the lower is for the sake of the lower plane. Yet in itself the light 'belongs' above, as the Baal HaLeshem goes on to explain.

כי כן הוא מכרח לכל עולם ומציאות להיות לו שרש במקום עליון שממש שואב חיותו תמיד והיה כל התפשטותו אשר נתפשט במקום העתיד לתחתון רק כדי להצטמצם למדרגתו להיות שרש עליון אליו

§ 2:21

In the Divine plan it is necessary that every world and existing entity has its source in the plane above, from whence it draws its life force — so that the entire spreading forth of the higher level to the future place of the lower level is only so that it can become diminished in its descent, and in this way become its supernal source.

ומקומו העקרי הוא רק למעלה בהעלם העליון עצמו ולכן הוא כי אחר שנתפשט ונצטמצם ונעשה ראוי להיות שרש לתחתון הנה הוא אינו עומד שם עוד כלל אלא שחוזר ונסתלק ועולה למעלה ונשאר שם לעולם

§ 2:22

Its primary place is only above in the concealed upper plane itself. Therefore, after it spreads forth and becomes diminished so that it is suitable as a source for the lower, it does not remain there at all. Instead it returns and is withdrawn above, where it always remains.

אמנם בחינת העביות שאמרנו שנעשה בו על ידי ירידתו הנה זה נשאר למטה ואין לו כח לעלות למעלה מאחר שנתעבה והנה נפרד אז העביות מהאור ונשאר היא למטה והאור חוזר ועולה למעלה

§ 2:23

However, the aspect of 'thickening' that we mentioned — which is caused by its descent — remains below. This diminished light has no power to ascend above since it has become thickened, which separates it from the original light. And therefore it remains below while the undiminished light returns and ascends above.

The aspect of light that was diminished and thickened remains below while the undiminished light is retracted and remains above. The light that remains below is called the *reshimu*¹ or *roshem ha-ohr* — the residue of the light, as will be explained.

ידע עוד כי עקר בחינת העביות שאמרנו שנעשה בהאור על ידי ירידתו ורחוקו ממקורו הנה הוא נעשה על ידי כח סוד הצמצום המבאר בדברי האריז"ל שהוא המקום לכל העולמות כלם

§ 2:24

Know further that the primary thickening of the light — that comes about because of its descent and distancing from its source — is the effect of the secret of *tzimtzum* that makes place for all of the worlds, as explained by the Arizal.^[7]

Were it not for the *tzimtzum*, none of the worlds would exist. Even if they could have been created, they would immediately be overwhelmed by the unmitigated *Ohr Ein Sof* and would disappear entirely.

ומכח סוד הצמצום הזה הנה מתעבה כל אור בהתפשטותו ממקום למקום ומעולם לעולם

§ 2:25

The effect of this *tzimtzum*^[^8] is thus to thicken all the light that spreads forth from place to place and from world to world.

The *tzimtzum* has this effect only on the light intended for creation — that which spreads forth to the worlds. The aspect of light that is not intended for the worlds and remains above is unaffected.

וּכְמוֹ שִׁיתְבָּאָר עֲנִינוּ הַצְמָצוּם לְקָמוֹן בְּדַבְרֵינוּ בְּשַׁעְרֵים הַבָּאִים וּבַעֲגָלִים וַיֵּשֶׁר עַנְיָ ב'
§ 2:26

The concept of *tzimtzum* will be explained below in the coming chapters^[^9] and in the section titled *Igulum v'Yosher* chap. 2.^[^10]

וְנִחְזֹר לְעֲנִינוּ כִּי הִנֵּה הָאוֹר חֹזֵר וּמִסְתַּלַּק וְעוֹלָה לְמַעְלָה וְהַעֲבִיּוֹת שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בּוֹ נִפְרָד
אֶז מִמֶּנּוּ וְהוּא נִשְׁאָר לְמַטָּה

§ 2:27

Let us return to the subject. The light returns and withdraws and ascends above, and the thickening that is produced in it becomes thus separated from it and remains below.

אֲמָנָם הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה הַגֵּם שֶׁכָּל הָאוֹר הֶעָקְרִי הִנֵּה הוּא חֹזֵר וְעוֹלָה לְמַעְלָה עִם כָּל זֶה
הִנֵּה מֵאַחֵר שֶׁמִּצִּיאֻת הַעֲבִיּוֹת שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בִּירִידָתוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא מֵהָאוֹר עֲצָמוֹ כִּנֵּ"ל הִנֵּה
נִשְׁאָר תְּמִצִּית הָאֶרֶץ וְרֶשֶׁם אוֹר עִם הַעֲבִיּוֹת גַּם כּוֹ לְעוֹלָם

§ 2:28

It is true, however, that even though all the main aspect of the light returns and ascends above — nevertheless, since the presence of thickening in its descent is an aspect of the light itself, as noted previously — an extract of the radiance and an impression of the light with its thickening also remains forever.

וְאוֹתוֹ הֶרְשָׁם אוֹר הוּא הִכָּנָה וְכֵחַ לְקַבֵּל בְּתוֹכוֹ אֶת אוֹר נִשְׁמָתוֹ הֶעָקְרִי שְׁעֵתִיד
לְהִתְפַּשֵּׁט בּוֹ מִשְׁפַּעַת אוֹר הָעֲלִיוֹן אֲשֶׁר עָלָה וְנִסְתַּלַּק

§ 2:29

And this impression of the light prepares and empowers it to receive within it the primary light of its *neshama*^[^11] — that in the future will spread forth from the outpouring of the supernal light that ascended and was withdrawn.

כִּי אַחֵר שֶׁנִּסְתַּלַּק הָאוֹר וְעָלָה לְמַעְלָה וְנַעֲשָׂה שְׂרָשׁ עָלִיוֹן לְתַחְתּוֹן הִנֵּה הוּא חֹזֵר
וּמִשְׁפִּיעַ בּוֹ שֶׁפַע אוֹר וְנִשְׁמָה הָרְאוּי לְמַדְרַגַּת הַתַּחְתּוֹן עֲצָמוֹ וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ
בְּהַעֲבִיּוֹת שֶׁנִּשְׁאָר לְמַטָּה לְאוֹר וְנִשְׁמָה הֶעָקְרִי שָׁבוּ

§ 2:30

Because after the light was withdrawn and ascended above it became the supernal root of the light remaining below. Then it reverts to projecting a stream of light and *neshama* upon the lower light as appropriate for the level of the lower aspect itself, and it spreads forth and clothes itself in the thickening that remains below as the primary illumination and *neshama* thereof.

וְכָל זֶה הוּא עַל יְדֵי רְשִׁימַת אוֹר שֶׁנִּשְׁאָר בְּהַעֲבִיּוֹת מִתְחַלָּה מֵהָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן עֲצָמוֹ כִּי
עַל יְדֵי זֶה קָשׁוּר הַעֲבִיּוֹת עִם הָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן לְעוֹלָם שֶׁנִּשְׁפִּיעַ בּוֹ אוֹר תָּמִיד

§ 2:31

And this is all due to the residue of the initial light itself that remains in the thickening, because in this way the thickening is always connected to the initial light which enables it to always stream light into the thickening.

וזהו התועלת השלישית שאמרנו לעיל מהתפשטות אור הראשון שבתחלה והוא
הרשם אור שמשאיר אחריו בהעביות שהוא הכנה וכח ושרש לאור נשמתו העקרי
בנזכר

§ 2:32

This is the third benefit of the spreading out of the initial light we noted above — which is that the impression of the light that it leaves behind in the thickening is a preparation for, the empowerment of, and the root of the light of the primary *neshama*, as mentioned.

To recall: the first two benefits were that 1) by becoming 'thicker' the initial light becomes a suitable source for the lower light; 2) by 'thickening' it also becomes the foundation for the matter of the lower plane.

והרי נתבאר בזה מה שאמרנו לעיל בענין החמר וצורה שמתחלה בשרש כלול
החמר בצורה והוא העביות הכלול בהאור הראשון שהוא השרש העליון וכלילותו
שם הוא רק בכח

§ 2:33

This explains what we said above regarding matter and *tzurah* — that initially, in its root, matter is included in *tzurah*; which is the same as saying that the thickening is included in the initial light, which is the supernal root, and its inclusion there is only in a potential state.

כי נעשה עקר העביות בו על ידי סוד הצמצום כנ"ל וכלול בו בכח ואחר כך כשיוצא
מן הכח אל הפועל ונעשה למציאות בפני עצמו והוא כאשר מסתלק האור הראשון
למעלה בנזכר

§ 2:34

Since the primary thickening thereof is via the secret of *zimtum*, as explained above, and it is included only in a potential state — subsequently, when it emerges from potential to actuality and becomes an independent existence,^[12] this occurs when the initial light is withdrawn above, as mentioned.

אז מתלבשת הצורה בהחמר והוא אור נשמתו העקרי אשר נמשך בו אחר כך
משפעת אור הראשון וחוזר ומתלבש בו ונעשו שניהם לאחד כי הם שניהם משרש
אחד כנ"ל

§ 2:35

Then the *tzurah* is clothed in matter — that *tzurah* is the primary light of the *neshama* that is drawn into it afterwards from the outflow of the initial light. The light returns and becomes clothed in matter, and both aspects become a single entity, since they are both from the same root, as explained above.

והוא מה שאמר הרמב"ם ז"ל ביסודי התורה פ"ד סימן ז' וכן הגר"א ז"ל בספר
יצירה פ"א משנה ד'

§ 2:36

This is what the Rambam states in **Yesodei Hatorah** 4:7.^[14] and so does the GR"A of Vilna in his commentary to **Sefer Yetzirah** 1:4.^[15]

אִפֹּן שְׁנֵי שְׁלֹא הָיָה לְעוֹלָם חֲמֵר בְּלֹא צוּרָה וְצוּרָה בְּלֹא חֲמֵר וְכֵן הַחֲמֵר בְּצוּרָה וְכֵן
כֹּחַ הַצּוּרָה בְּחֲמֵר כִּי הִרִי גַם הָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּתְפַּשֵּׁט הֵנָּה הָיָה הַתְּפִשְׁטוּתוֹ מִהַחֲמֵר
דִּהְיָלִיּוֹן שֶׁהוּא הַצּוּרָה לְתַחֲתוֹן כִּכְ"ל

§ 2:37

A second approach to explaining that there was never a situation where matter existed without **tzurah** or **tzurah** without matter, and that the potential for matter is in **tzurah** and the potential for **tzurah** is in matter: The initial light that spread forth emerged from the 'matter' of the upper entity, which is the **tzurah** of the lower, as we explained at the beginning of this chapter.

וְמֵה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁכֹּחַ הַחֲמֵר בְּצוּרָה הוּא הָעֵבִיּוֹת דִּהְתַּחֲתוֹן שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּכֵן דָּאוֹר
הָרִאשׁוֹן וְמֵה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁכֹּחַ הַצּוּרָה בְּחֲמֵר הוּא רְשִׁימַת אוֹר שֶׁנִּשְׁאָר מִיַּחַד לְעוֹלָם
בְּהָעֵבִיּוֹת וְהוּא הִכְנָה וְשֵׁרֵשׁ לָאוֹר נִשְׁמַתוֹ הָעֵקָרִי שֶׁבּו כִּכְ"ל וּמִזֶּה נִמְשָׁךְ לְעוֹלָם שֶׁכֹּחַ
הַחֲמֵר בְּצוּרָה וְכֵן הַצּוּרָה בְּחֲמֵר וְנִמְשָׁךְ וְנִאֲרָג הַתְּהוּוֹת כָּל מְצִיאוֹת מִתְחַלְתּוֹ וְעַד
סוּפוֹ בְּחֲמֵר וְצוּרָה יַחַד

§ 2:38

When we wrote that the potential for matter is contained in **tzurah**, this refers to the thickening of the lower level that is brought about by means of the power of the initial light. When we wrote that the potential for **tzurah** is in matter, this refers to the impression of the light that remains forever united with the thickening, which is the preparation and root of the light of the primary **neshama** therein, as explained above. And from this derives the fact that always the potential of matter is in **tzurah**, and the potential of **tzurah** is in matter — so that matter and **tzurah** are together drawn forth and blended throughout all of existence from beginning to end.

וְדַע כִּי כָּל הַדְּבָרִים הֵלְלוּ הֵנָּה הֵם כּוֹלָלִים כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר מֵאַחֵר אֲמַתָּו
הַנִּעְלָמָת וּלְמַטָּה עַד סוּף עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁכֻּלָּם נִשְׁתַּלְשְׁלוּ כָּל תַּחֲתוֹן מִהָעֵלִיּוֹן בְּסֻדֵּר
זֶה

§ 2:39

And know that all of these matters encompass all of the worlds — from after His inscrutable true Being below, from the very first world until the end of the world of **Asiyah** — because every lower entity devolved from a higher entity according to this arrangement.

אֲמַנָּם אוֹתוֹ הַסֵּדֵר עֲצָמוֹ הוּא בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם לְפִי הָעֲנִינִים וְהַמְצִיאוֹת הַמְתִּיחַס
אֵלָיו וּבִאֲרָנוּ כָּל זֶה בְּעֵמֶק וְאֲרָכָה בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם בְּפָנֵי עֲצָמוֹ בְּסֻדֵּר הַכְּלָלִים אֲשֶׁר
הוּא כָּל מִסְדַּע עַל זֶה

§ 2:40

However, this very arrangement is in each and every world according to the concepts and realities associated with it. We explained all of this in depth and at length for each world individually in **Sefer HaKelalim**, which is based entirely upon this idea.

וְהִרְצָה לְעַמֵּד עַל סוֹד סֵדֶר מִסְדְּרֵי מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית יַעֲיִן שֵׁם וּמִשְׁכִּיל עַל דְּבַר יִמְצָא
טוב

§ 2:41

Anyone who wishes to achieve clarity^[16] regarding the mysteries of the arrangements of Creation should study the matter there. 'One who undertakes a matter intelligently will find good' — i.e. success (*Proverbs* 16:20).

Footnotes

1. See *Etz Chaim* 6:5. [↩](#)

Chapter 2: Tzurah — Form

Shaar 2 Chapter 2

Tzurah — Form

וְהִנֵּה הַגֵּם שֶׁמִּתְבָּאֵר מִדְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁהַחֲמֵר וְהַצּוּרָה הֵם אֶחָד מִשְׁרָשָׁם
וְכֵן הֵם מִיְחָדִים זֶב"ז [זֶה בְּזֶה] תָּמִיד

Now even though we explained that matter and *tzurah* (form¹) are one in their root, and they are also always unified one with the other, so that one cannot find *tzurah* without matter or matter without *tzurah*,

עכ"ז הִנֵּה יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּינֵיהֶם

there is nevertheless a great difference between them,

כִּי הִנֵּה הַחֲמֵר כְּאֶשֶׁר שֶׁנִּשְׁלַם הִיָּתוֹ וּמִצִּיאֹתוֹ בַּמָּקוֹמוֹ

because when the being and existence of matter is complete in its place i.e. in this world

הִנֵּה הוּא נִבְדָּל מִהָעוֹלָם הָעֲלִיוֹן לְגַמְרִי

it becomes completely disconnected from the upper world;

וְלֹא נִרְאָה בּוֹ עוֹד קֶשֶׁר וְשִׁיכוּת עִמּוֹ כָּלֵל

any connection with and relevance to it to the upper world are no longer evident

כִּי עוֹמֵד כָּל מִצִּיאֹתוֹ רַק לְמַטָּה

since its entire existence is only below.

מִשָּׁא"כ [מֵה שָׁאִין כֵּן] הַצּוּרָה הִנֵּה הִיא אֵינָה יוֹרֶדֶת לְמַטָּה
לְהִתְיַחֵד בְּהַחֲמֵר

Whereas the higher aspect of *tzurah* does not descend below to become fused with matter;

אֲלֹא רַק בְּהִקְצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שֶׁלֶּה לְבַד כִּי שֵׁם הִיא שֶׁרֶשׁ לְהַחֲמֵר אֲשֶׁר
מִמֶּנָּה לּוֹקַח

only its lowest extremity descends to become fused with matter for there, in the higher worlds, as explained above, is the root of matter and from there it derives,

וּמִשָּׁם נִמְשָׁךְ לוֹ כָּל חַיּוּתוֹ וְקִיּוּמוֹ וְכָל תְּהֻלוּכּוֹתָיו וְהִנְהָגָתוֹ

and from there all its life force and continued existence is drawn, as well as all of its progress and its conduct.

וְלָכֵן הִיא מִתְיַחֶדֶת בְּזֶה עִם הַחֲמֵר כָּל זְמַן קִיּוּמוֹ

And therefore it the *tzurah* is fused with matter while it exists.

אָבֵל עֲקָרָה דְּהַצּוּרָה הִיא לְעוֹלָם קָשׁוּר וְדָבּוּק בְּשִׁרְשָׁהּ שְׁלִמְעֵלָה
אֲשֶׁר בְּהֶעֱלֵם הָעָלְיוֹן.

Nevertheless, the primary aspect of *tzurah* is always bound up with and cleaves to its root above in the state of supernal hiddenness.

וְהוּא מְסֻבָּת ג' טַעֲמִים אֲשֶׁר כֻּלָּם עוֹלִים לְמִקּוּר אֶחָד.

And this is for three reasons, all of which arise in the same source:

There are three reasons why the *tzurah* of the lower world becomes revealed only at its lowest extremity while pouring forth outflow from above.²

טַעַם א' הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְשׁוּם מְצִיאוֹת לְהִתְקִים אִפִּי רִגַע
אֶחָד בְּהִיוּתָהּ מִפְּרֵד מִשִּׁרְשָׁהּ צוּר מְחַצְבֶּתָהּ

1. The first reason: It is impossible for any existent entity to endure for even a moment if it is severed from the root from whence it was cut out

וְכִמוּ שִׁיתִּבָּאֵר בְּטַעַם הַב' וְהַג'

as will be explained in reasons 2 & 3.

וְלִכֵּן הַצּוּרָה אֲשֶׁר הוּא עֶקֶר חִיּוּתוֹ דְּהַחֲמֵר וְכַח הַתְּהוּוּת וְקִיּוּמוֹ

And therefore the *tzurah*, which is the primary life-force of matter and the power that brings it into existence and maintains it in existence,

הַכֹּרֵחַ לְהַשְׁאֵר לְמַעַלָּה לִשְׁב בְּסִתֵּר עָלְיוֹן תָּמִיד

Must remain above, 'to reside in the supernal hiddenness.'³

וְשׁוֹאֲבֶת מִשָּׁם כָּל שְׁפָעֶת כַּח קִיּוּמוֹ דְּהַחֲמֵר כָּל מָה שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ לוֹ

And it draws from there all the flow of energy that keeps matter in existence as long as needed,

וּמִמְשִׁיךְ בּוֹ דֶּרֶךְ קֶצֶה הַתְּחַתּוֹן שְׁלָה הַמְתִּיחַד עִמּוֹ

and draws down this energy via its lowest extremity – the aspect that fuses with it with matter.

וְעִי"ז מִתְקִים כָּל מְצִיאוֹתוֹ דְּהַחֲמֵר בְּעוֹלָמוֹ כָּל הַזְּמַן הַנִּגָּזֵר עָלָיו

It is through this that the entire existence of matter endures in its world the World of Asiyah for as long as has been decreed from Above.

וְמָה שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ לְמַטָּה רַק הַקֶּצֶה הַתְּחַתּוֹן שְׁלָה

That only its the *tzurah*'s lowest extremity is drawn down below

הוּא מְשׁוּם כִּי רַק זֶה לְבַד הוּא סִבָּת דְּהַחֲמֵר וְצוּרָתוֹ הָרְאוּי אֵלָיו

is because that the lowest level of the spiritual dimension of *tzurah* **alone is the reason for matter and its proper *tzurah*.**

The fact that *tzurah* and matter combine at all is an anomaly, given that they are polar opposites. And the only way they can combine is that only the extreme lower limit of the *tzurah* configures the matter below.

אָבֶל עֲקָרָה דֶּהצֹרֶה הוּא שִׁיךְ רַק לְמַעְלָה וְשֵׁם הוּא מְקוּמָהּ

But the primary aspect of *tzurah* is only relevant above in spiritual dimensions, **for that is its place.**

וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְיַחֵד לַמָּטָה ע"י הַקְצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שֶׁלָּהּ

And from there **it extends forth and unites** with matter **below, via its lowest extremity**

וְשׁוֹאֵבֶת לְמַעְלָה וּמִשְׁפֹּעֶת לַמָּטָה תָּמִיד

that draws off from above and pours its outflow forth continuously below.

טַעַם ב' הוּא כִּי אֵלּוּ שֶׁהִיָּה כָּל נִמְצָא מִפָּרֶד מִמְקוּרֹו הֵן בְּחִמְרוֹ וְהֵן בְּצוּרָתוֹ

1. **The second reason** why the *tzurah* of the lower world becomes revealed only at its lowest extremity while pouring forth outflow from above **is that if any entity was severed completely from its source, whether** this is in terms of **its matter** or in terms of **its *tzurah*,**

וְהֵינּוּ שֶׁהִיָּה מִפָּרֶד כָּל צוּרָה דֶּהתַּחְתּוֹן ג"כ מִמְקוּרֹו

that is to say, the entire *tzurah* of the lower aspect would be severed from its source, so that the *tzurah* would only exist below and would not be connected above,⁴

הֵינָה הִיָּה עוֹמֵד כָּל נִמְצָא עַל מַצָּב אֶחָד לְעוֹלָם בְּלִי שְׁנוּי בּוֹ כָּלֵל

then every entity would remain in the same state forever, with no change at all.

כִּי כָּל שְׁנוּי הַנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּשׁוּם נִמְצָא הֵינָה הוּא לְעוֹלָם רַק ע"י סִבָּה הַמְּסַבֵּב אוֹתָהּ לָזֶה

Because any change in any entity is only due to some cause impinging upon it

וּמִכְרִיחַ אוֹתָהּ עַל שִׁינּוּיָהּ וְכָל מְכַרִּיחַ הֵינָה הוּא לְמַעְלָה מִמֶּנּוּ

'forcing' it to change in those ways. Whatever does the 'forcing' is obviously of a higher status than that which is being forced.

וְאֵלּוּ שֶׁהִיָּה שׁוּם נִמְצָא נִפְרָד לְגִמְרֵי מְלַמְעָלָה לֹא הִיָּה נַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ שׁוּם שְׁנוּי כָּלֵל

And if any entity was completely severed from above, no change would ever transpire in it,

וְהָיָה עוֹמֵד עַל מַצָּב אֶחָד לְעוֹלָם.

and it would remain in the same state forever.

וְלֹא כֵן הָיָה כּוֹנֵנָתוֹ ית"ש בְּכָל הַמְצִיאוֹת כְּלוּ כִּמוֹ שְׂיִתְבָּאֵר

This was not His intention, blessed be His name, throughout all of existence, as will be explained.

וְאִלוֹ שֶׁהָיָה נִפְרָד כָּל מְצִיאוֹת מִלְּמַעְלָה הֵן בְּחִמְרוֹ וְהֵן בְּצוּרָתוֹ

And if any object in existence was severed from what is above, whether its matter or its *tzurah*,

הִנֵּה הָיָה אֵז פְּעֻלָּתוֹ ית"ש ג"כ רַק עַל דֶּרֶךְ פְּעֻלַּת הַתַּחְתּוֹנִים

then His actions would also be like the activities of those below –

שְׁאַחֲרָי גָּמַר הַפְּעֻלָּה אִין לָהּ שְׂיִכּוּת עוֹד עִם הַפּוֹעֵל כָּלֵל

in that after an action is completed it no longer has any relationship to the one performing the act at all,

וְאִינָהּ מְקַבֵּלֶת מִמֶּנּוּ לֹא תוֹסֶפֶת וְלֹא גִרְעוֹן

and the operator can no longer add to or subtract from the action⁵

וְהָיָא מְצֻדוֹ עַל מַצָּב אֶחָד תָּמִיד בְּכָל זְמַן קִיּוּמָהּ

As far as the object is concerned, it would remain in the same status always, as long as it remains in existence.

וּבִאֲשֶׁר שְׂכּוֹנֵנָתוֹ ית"ש בְּכָל מְצִיאוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת בְּכָלֵל וּבִפְרָט

But since His intention in all of the worlds, generally and specifically⁶

לֹא הָיָה הַכּוֹנֵנָה בָּהֶם לְהַשְׁאִירָם עַל מְצִיאוֹתָם שֶׁהֵם עֲתֵה

– the intention in each of them was not that they would remain as they are,

וְשִׁיחָא זֶה לְבֵד תְּכִלִּית מְצִיאוֹתָם ח"ו וְכִמוֹ שְׂיִתְבָּאֵר בְּטַעַם ג'

and that would be the ultimate purpose of their existence, G-d forbid, as will be explained in the third reason below.

לְכַךְ סִדֵּר אֶת בְּנֵיו כָּל מְצִיאוֹתָם הֵן בְּכָלֵל וְהֵן בִּפְרָט

And therefore He arranged the structure of their existence generally and specifically

שִׁיחָא כָּל כַּח קִיּוּמוֹ וְחִיּוּתוֹ שֶׁל כ"א קָשׁוּר וְתִלּוּי לְעוֹלָם רַק לְמַעְלָה

that the ability of each individual entity to endure and its life-force is always bound to and is dependent only upon what is above.

וְכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם הֵם כָּלָם קְשׁוּרִים וְתָלוּיִם זב"ז לְעֵלָא לְעֵלָא עַד
אֱלֹיו עֲצֻמו ית"ש

In addition, all of the worlds are all bound to and depend on one another to the highest levels and beyond – to Him Himself, blessed be His name.

וּמִשְׁגָּחִים כָּלָם תָּמִיד רַק מִמֶּנּוּ וּמִנְהֻגֵּי כָלָם תָּמִיד רַק עַל יָדוֹ

And they are all watched over continuously only by Him, and they are directed always only by Him,

כִּי שׁוֹאֲבִים כָּל חַיּוֹתָם וְכָל כֹּחַ קִיּוּמָם תָּמִיד רַק מִמֶּנּוּ לְבַד

for they always draw down all their life force and the power of their existence only from Him,

וְרַק הוּא לְבַד חַי הָעוֹלָמִים כָּלָם.

and He alone is the life of all the worlds.

וְהִנֵּה הוּא פּוֹעֵל תָּמִיד בָּהֶם וְעִי"ז אֵינוֹ עוֹמֵד הַמְצִיאוֹת בְּמַצָּב אֶחָד
כָּלֵל אֶף רֶגַע אַחַת

Now since He is constantly acting upon them upon the worlds their existence does not remain static for even a moment.

אֲלֹא שְׁמִתְחַלֶּפֶת תָּמִיד בְּשִׁינוּיִם שׁוֹנִים וְאֵינָה עוֹמֶדֶת בְּמִנוּחָה כָּלֵל

On the contrary, it is constantly changing in various ways, and does not remain in a state of inertness at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהִיא בּוֹעֵלָה תָּמִיד וְהוּא מָה שֶׁכָּתוּב אֲשֶׁר בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים
לַעֲשׂוֹת

Instead, it is in a constant state of activity, as the verse (Genesis 2:3) states, "that God created to do." Not "and it was done" but "to do,"² continuously.

(This portion of the verse is often translated as "that God had done.")

כִּי הוּא ית"ש עוֹשֶׂה וּפּוֹעֵל בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת תָּמִיד

For He, blessed be His name, continuously creates and acts upon existence.

שֶׁכָּל הַפְּעֻלוֹת הַנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּכָל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה בְּכָל עֵת הִנֵּה הוּא רַק
מִמֶּנּוּ ית"ש

For all of the actions that take place in all of creation at all times, are only from Him,

ע"ד שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל פְּעֻלוֹת הַגּוּף שֶׁהוּא רַק מִהַנְּשָׁמָה שְׁבוּ

in a manner similar to the activities of a person's body which are exclusively from the soul within him. Without the soul the body would simply be a corpse and

would be incapable of any activity.

והכל הוא מה שהקב"ה עושה בהמציאות תמיד ומנהיג אותה לעולם ע"פ הכוונה התכליתית שבה.

All of them all the events and actions that take place throughout the universe **are all always the actions of the Holy One blessed be He upon existence, which He always directs according to the divine purpose with which it is imbued.**

וע' [ועין] דברים עמקים בזה בדברינו בספר הדע"ה ח"ב דרוש ב' ושם ח"א דרוש א' סימן ג' אות ו'.

See in depth our explanation in *Sefer HaDe'ah* section 2, lecture 2 and section 1 lecture 1 chapter 3, paragraph 6.

והנה נעשה כ"ז ע"י שהנפש והצורה של כל מציאות

Now all of this is brought about by the *nefesh*⁸ and *tzurah* of all existence,

שהיא הכח דכל התהווה ותכונתה

which is the power of its entire coming into being and its properties.

הנה עומד עקרה רק למעלה וקשורה לעלא לעלא עד המאציל עליון ית"ש

Now the primary aspect thereof of the *nefesh-tzurah* is located exclusively above, where it is bound above to the highest levels, until the Supernal Emanator, may His Name be blessed.

ועל ידה מתנהג כל נמצא תמיד בעולה ויורד

And it is by way of this *nefesh-tzurah* that every being is continually guided in its ascent and descent.

כי פעם נתעלה תכונתה בעלוי רב ופעם יורדת ממדרגתה ונגרע מערכה אם מעט ואם הרבה

For at times its nature is greatly elevated and at other times it descends from its level and it loses its value, whether a little or a lot.

ועד"ז מתחלף ועובר על כל נמצא שנוים רבים והיא בפעלה תמיד

And in the same manner everything in existence undergoes many changes and it is always in a state of activity.

והכל הוא מההשגחה והנהגה העליונה

All of this comes from supernal guidance and oversight.

ומקבלת כל מה שנגזר עליה מהפעלות והשנוים ע"י צורתה

And it receives by way of its *tzurah* everything that is decreed upon it in terms of those things that act upon it and the changes it undergoes.

אֲשֶׁר הִיא כֹּחַ כָּל הַתְּהוּוּתָהּ וְאִיכוּתָהּ

That *tzurah* is the power of its coming to be and the nature of that entity

הַנִּשְׁאָר וְעוֹמֵד לְמַעַלָּה דְּבּוּק בְּשִׁרְשָׁהּ הָעֲלִיוֹן

that remains fixed above, cleaving to its supernal root

וְקִשּׁוּר לְעֵלָּא לְעֵלָּא עַד צָר כָּל הָעוֹלָמִים כְּלָם הַמְּנַהִיג וּפּוֹעֵל אֶת כָּל

and its nature remains **bound up above and beyond**, all the way up **until He who formed all the worlds, who directs and activates everything**.

וְהוּא יִתְבָּרַךְ וַיִּתְעַלֶּה שְׁמוֹ מִחֲלִיף אוֹתָם וּמִשְׁנָה וּפּוֹעֵל בָּהֶם

And He, may His name be blessed and exalted, modifies them and causes change in them and acts upon them

לְפִי הַצָּרִיךְ לְתִקּוּנָם וּלְכוּנֹת תְּכִלִּיתָם כְּמוֹ שְׂוִיתָבֵּאֵר בְּסֻמוֹךְ.

according to the necessities of their rectification and their purpose, as will be explained below.

טַעַם הָג' וְהוּא קְרוֹב לְטַעַם הַב'

1. **The third reason** which discusses the *orot makifim* (the transcendent, enveloping light) **has an affinity with the second reason** – which speaks about *orot pnimi'im* (immanent light)⁹:

כִּי הִנֵּה רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש וְכוּנָתוֹ בְּבְרִיאַת עוֹלָמוֹ

The third reason is that His will and intention in creating His universe

הָרִי הָיָה לְבְרָא הָמוֹן בְּרוּאִים לְאִיו תְּכִלִּית וּלְהַחֲלִיף עֲלֵיהֶם כָּל הַשְּׁנוּיִם הָרַבִּים וְהַעֲצוּמִים

was to create an unlimited number of creatures and to impose upon them the many and drastic changes

אֲשֶׁר עוֹבֵר עֲלֵיהֶם בְּכָל מִשְׁךְ זְמוֹ מִצָּב מְדַרְגָּתָם הַתַּחְתּוֹנָה

that they undergo throughout the duration of their situation on the lower level i.e. not on their root level, but on the level of each individual creature.

שֶׁיִּסָּד בָּהֶם מִסּוֹד הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה [וְכִמוֹ שֶׁבִּאֲרָנוּ בְּדַע"ה ח"ב וּבכ"מ מְדַבְּרִינוּ]

This He established within them in the mystery of the Supernal Thought [as we explained in Sefer haDe'ah¹⁰ part 2 and in a number of places].

וע"י כל אותן השנויים העצומים המתחלפים עליהם תמיד בגזרת
נורא עלילות

****By way of those drastic changes that they constantly undergo, due to the decree of the Awesome-in-¹¹His-deeds i.e. God**

השם מפעלות בשמים ובארץ ובכל צבאיהם (וכמו שבארנו שם
כ"ז)

Who placed His works in heaven and earth¹² and among all of their hosts (as explained there).

הנה עי"ז מזדכך חמריותם ונקשרים ומתאחדים כל פרטי
המציאות כלם זב"ז וזב"ז

– in this way the materiality of every detail of existence is refined and they become bound one to the other and united with each other.

וכלם באדם שהוא מבחר כל היצור

And all of them within man¹³ who is the choicest of all creations.

ועי"ז מתעלים מדרגה למדרגה ויתקנו כלם ע"י האדם

And in this way they are all elevated from level to level and all are rectified by man –

שבו תלוי תקון הכל לעלות עמו למעלה למעלה למקורם הראשון
אשר לקחו משם

upon whom the entire rectification depends – to ascend with him to the highest levels, to their original source from whence they derive,

וכדי להשביעם מנועם זיו צהצוה העליון

and to satiate them with the blissful radiance of the supernal purity –

אור פני מלך חיים באין סוף ותכלית

the light of the King's countenance which is infinite and never-ending life.¹⁴

וכמו שבארנו בארוכה כ"ז בספר הכללים כלל ט"ז וי"ז

As we explained in *Sefer Hakelalim*, Klal 15, 17.

וכל התקון והעלוי הזה הנה הוא רק ע"י צורתם אשר נשאר עקרים
למעלה

All of this rectification and elevation is only by virtue of their *tzurah*, the primary aspect of which remains above,

והם קשורים ותלויים זב"ז עד לעלא לעלא כנז'

and they are bound together and depend on one another to the highest levels, as mentioned above.

וְשֵׁם בְּמִקְוָרָם הִנֵּה מִתְאַחֲדִים צוּרוֹת כָּל הַמְצִיאִית כֻּלָּם בְּאַחֲדוּת
גְּמוּרָה

In their source the *tzurahs* of all things in existence are united in one complete unity

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁכֻּלָּם נִמְשְׁכוּ מִמִּקְוֹר אֶחָד
since they all derive from a single source.

וְעִי"ז הֵם נִקְשָׁרִים וְנִתְלִים זב"ז גַּם לְמַטָּה
By virtue thereof because they all derive from a single source they are bound together and depend upon one another below as well.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁנּוֹדַע שֶׁפְּרָטִי כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת כֻּלָּם נִצְרָכִים זֶה לָזֶה וְנִעָזֵר הָאֶחָד
ע"י חֲבֵרוֹ

As is known, individual entities throughout creation all need each other, and one entity is aided by another.

וְהֵם נִתְלִים זב"ז וְכֻלָּם בְּאָדָם וְאָדָם בְּכֻלָּם
And they are all dependent upon one another, and all of them upon man, and man upon all of them.

וְהֵם מִתְתַּקְּנִים וּמִתְעַלִּים ע"י הָאָדָם
They are rectified and ascend through man.

וכ"ז הוּא ע"י שֶׁמִּתְנַהֲגִים כֻּלָּם מִצּוּרָתָם הַנִּשְׁאָר לְמַעַלָּה וְאוֹתוֹ
הַצּוּרָה מְנַהִיגוֹ תָּמִיד לְתַכְלִיתוֹ

All of this is by way of being directed by their *tzurah* that remains above, and that *tzurah* directs each entity towards its purpose

וּמִחֲלִיף עָלָיו כָּל הַשִּׁנּוּיִם מִהַפְּעָלוֹת וְהַתְקוּנִים שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ
and modifies the entity with all the changes that come about from the activities and rectifications that are done with it

עַד שֶׁלִּבְסוֹף מִחְזִירוֹ אֵלָיו
until in the end it returns to it – to its original *tzurah* state, before it became invested in matter.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁאֵנוּ רוֹאִין ג"כ שֶׁסּוֹף כָּל דָּבָר שֶׁחוֹזֵר לִיסוּדוֹ וְחוֹזְרִים כֻּלָּם
לְשֵׁרֶשׁ

As we also see that in the end everything returns to its elemental state¹⁵ and all things return to their root,

עד כי לעת קץ תקוין האחרון יעלו כלם לתקון סוד האחדות
השלימה

Until in final era with the last rectification all of them will ascend into the rectification of unity,

שהוא תכלית כוננתו ית"ש בכל בריאת עולמו וכמו שבארנו כ"ז
בספר הכללים הנז'.

which was God's primary intention when He created His world, as we explained in *Sefer HaKlalom*.

והרי לנו עכ"פ מה שאנו רואין בסדר כל המציאות שבהעוה"ז

So at least we can conclude that what we see throughout existence in this world

כי נסדר כ"א מחמר וצורה שהוא גוף ונשמה כלי ואור חיצוניות
ופנימיות

is that every entity is comprised of matter and *tzurah*, body and soul, vessel and light, outer aspect and inner aspect,

ומתנהג החיצוניות ע"י הפנימיות שבו

and that the outer aspect is directed by its inner aspect.

ואותה הפנימיות שהוא האור ונשמה עומד עקרה למעלה

And that same inner aspect, which is its light and soul exists primarily above,

ורק הקצה התחתון שלה הוא אשר מתפשט למטה ויורד ומתלבש
בתוך הגוף לנשמה שבו

and only its lowest extremity extends down below and descends to become clothed in the body the physical aspect of any existing entity¹⁶ as the soul within.

ודרך אותה הקצה התחתון הנה שואב הגוף חיותו וכל כח קיומו
מלמעלה כל עת מציאותו הנגזר עליו

It is by way of this lowest extremity of the *tzurah* that the body draws its life and the power of its continued existence¹⁷ from above, for as long as its existence is decreed.

ואותה הנשמה שהוא הצורה העקרית דכל מציאות אשר עומד
למעלה

That soul, which is the primary *tzurah* of all existence, stands above

הנה הוא פועל בהמציאות תמיד ואינו מניחה רגע אחת בלא
פעלה

and acts upon that existence continuously, not letting up acting upon it for a single moment.

וכל פעלתו בה הוא כדי לתקן חמריותה למטה

And its entire effect on it on the world below is for the purpose of rectifying its corporeality below

ולהחזירה אליו לבסוף להתאחד עמו לנצח

and then return it the corporeal element to itself the *tzurah* in the end to be united with it forever.

כי קדם שירדה חמר דהמציאות למטה היתה גם היא עם
הפנימיות למעלה כלולה עמו

Because before the corporeal aspect of existence descended below, it was together with the inner aspect above and was integrated with it with the inner aspect

אלא שכלילותה בו אשר מתחילה היה רק בכח לבד

However, that integration with it with the inner dimension, was initially only in potential since actual corporeality does not exist above,

ולכן הורידה למטה כדי להוציא את מציאותה ותכונתה מהכח אל
הפועל

and therefore He lowered it the corporeal aspect to down below in order to bring it into actual existence and reveal its nature from a state of potential to actual.

ואחר שנשלמה בכ"ז הנה מחזירה אליו להתתקן עמו ולהשיג את
תכלית מציאותה

Once all this is completed, then the *tzurah* brings it the corporeal body back to him to the soul to be rectified together with him the soul and to achieve the ultimate purpose of its existence

אשר לזה נמצאת שהוא להעלותה מעלוי לעלוי עד אין סוף
ותכלית

for which it the body was brought out into existence from higher spiritual dimensions – which is to elevate it from one lofty level to the next without limitation or constraint.

כי זכות ועלוי ותקון גדול הוא להנשמה באשר מתתקן¹⁸ הגוף על
ידו

For it is a great merit, and a spiritual elevation and rectification for the soul when the body becomes rectified by it.

כִּי שְׁנֵיהֶם לֹא נִבְרְאוּ אֶלָּא רַק לְתַכְלִית זֶה שְׁתּוּקוֹ הַגּוּף ע"י הַנִּשְׁמָה
שָׁבוּ

For both of them, body and soul, were created for no other purpose than this exclusively – that the body would be rectified by the soul within it.

וְהוּא עֲלוּי גָדוֹל לְהַנִּשְׁמָה ג"כ כְּאֲשֶׁר שְׁמִשְׁלִים אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ אֲשֶׁר
שׁוֹלַח לָזֶה

And this is a great boost for the soul as well when it completes its task for which it was sent down to become fused with the body in this world.

וְעִי"ז הֵנָּה הֵם עוֹלִים שְׁנֵיהֶם בְּעֲלוּי רַב לְהִתְעַנֵּג וּלְהִתְעַדָּן בְּאוֹר פְּנֵי
עֲצָמוֹ ית"ש

It is through this *tikkun* that both of them soul and body ascend to the heights to delight in and become refined in the very light of His countenance, may His Name be blessed,

וּלְהִדְבֵּק וּלְהִתְיַחַד בְּאוֹר קִדְשׁוֹ בְּתַכְלִית תְּקוּן הָאֲחֵרוֹן
and to cleave to and be united with the light of His holiness with the completion of the final *tikkun*

כְּכוֹנֶנְתּוֹ ית"ש בְּכָל בְּרִיאַת עוֹלָמוֹ.

as was God's intention in creating His world.

וְהִרִי נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ עכ"פ כִּי כָּל נִשְׁמָה וְצוּרָה עֲקָרָה הִיא לְמַעְלָה

At minimum, we have clarified for ourselves that every soul and *tzurah* resides primarily above,

וְרַק הַקְּצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שָׁלָה הוּא אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט לַמָּטָה בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוּף
וְהַחֲמֵר

and only their lowest extremity extends down below into a body and matter.

וְעַל יְדֵה מִתְתַּקֵּן וְנִעָשֶׂה כָּל הַתְּקוּנִים בָּלָם

And by this means the soul or *tzurah* descending below to elevate the body all of the rectifications are achieved.

וְכֹן נִתְבָּאֵר מִמִּילָא מְדַבְּרִינוּ ג"כ שֶׁכָּל עוֹלָם תַּחְתּוֹן לִגְבֵי עֲלִיוֹן הֵנָּה
הוּא רַק כְּמַר מִדְּלִי נִגְדוֹ

In addition, from what we have said it is self-evident that every lower world, compared to the higher world, is merely like a drop in a bucket,

שְׁהָרִי כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דֶּהֱתַחְתּוֹן הֵנָּה הוּא רַק מָה שֶׁהָיָה כְּלוּל
בְּתַחֲלָה בְּכַח דֶּהֱעֵלִיּוֹן

since the existence of the lower world was initially included in potential in the upper world from which it derives.

וְכָל מְצִיאוֹתָיו וְיִצְיָאָתוֹ לַפֶּעַל הוּא ג' כ' רַק מִשְׁפַּעַת דָּאוֹר הָעֵלִיּוֹן אֲשֶׁר
מִשְׁפִּיעַ בּוֹ תָּמִיד וּכְכֹל הַנֶּ"ל

And its entire existence of the lower world and its emergence into reality is also only by virtue of the outflow of light from the upper world which flows into it continuously, as was all explained above.

וּא' כ' הָרִי נִמְצָא שְׁכָל תַּחְתּוֹן לְגִבִּי עֲלִיּוֹן הֵנָּה הוּא רַק כֹּחַ וְהֶאֱרָה
וְשָׁפַע מִמֶּנּוּ לְבַד

Being that this is so, it turns out that every lower world compared with a higher one is merely a manifestation of the power and radiance and outflow from it from the higher world.

וְהוּא אֵינוֹ עוֹמֵד לְעַצְמוֹ כָּלֹל אֶלָּא שֶׁהוּא קָשׁוּר לְמַעְלָה וְתָלוּי בּוֹ
לְעוֹלָם:

And it does not exist independently at all; instead it is bound up above and always depends on the world above.

Footnotes

1. As noted in the previous chapter, 'form' is more than just the shape of something; a thing's 'form' is its essence or definition — what it is. Human form, for example, is what it is to be a human being. 'Matter,' on the other hand, is simply what it is made of. We will use the term *tzurah* for 'form' throughout. ↩
2. Makover. ↩
3. See Palms 91:1 – יָשָׁב בְּסִתְרָא עֲלִיּוֹן ↩
4. Makover. ↩
5. A more literal translation: "it does not receive any addition or withdrawal from him." ↩
6. 'Generally and specifically' refers to the worlds, as will become clear shortly. In other words, 'to the worlds in general, and to specific worlds, each according to its particular intention.' ↩
7. Since Creation came about *yesh mi-ayin* (*ex nihilo*), the creative force which brings it into existence must constantly recreate it in order for it to exist. If this force would be withdrawn for even a moment, creation would revert to absolute nothingness. See *Sha'ar HaYichud v'haEmunah* chap. 2. ↩

8. *Nefesh* here is meant in terms of the spiritual life-force of existence. [↩](#)
9. *Meir haLeshem*. [↩](#)
10. *Sefer HaDe'ah* is an abbreviation of *Drushei Olam HaTohu*, an important section of his magnum opus titled *Leshem Sh'vo v'achlama*. [↩](#)
11. See Psalms 66:5. [↩](#)
12. See Psalms 46:9. [↩](#)
13. Cf. *Kohelet* (Ecclesiastes) 3:11 [↩](#)
14. Cf. *Mishlei* (Proverbs) 16:15 [↩](#)
15. See Rambam *Yesodei Hatorah* 4:1, 3 – All material things eventually revert to the four elements from which they are composed, fire, air, water, earth... [↩](#)
16. According to the Arizal, even inanimate objects have a 'soul' and spiritual life-force. See *Etz Chayim, Shaar* 50 (ch. 2, 10). [↩](#)
17. Alternatively: "its ability to exist." [↩](#)
18. In modern Hebrew the *hitpa'el* form is הִתְקַדְּשׁ – it is rectified. [↩](#)

G A T E

*Shaar 3 — Five levels of form: nefesh,
ruakh, neshama, chaya, yehida (narnhai)*

Chapter 1 — The worlds of bia (briah, yetzirah, asiyah), their nature and expression in man.

Shaar 3 Chapter 1

וּמַעֲתָה נֶאֱמַר עוֹד כִּי הֵנָּה כָּלֵל הַמְצִיאוֹת הוּא נִחְלָק לִג' מַדְרָגוֹת

Now it can further be stated that all of existence is divided into three levels

וְהֵם נִבְרָאִים נוֹצְרִים נַעֲשִׂים

which are: those aspects that are created; those that are formed; those that are made

וְנִקְרָאִים בְּשֵׁם ג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יִצְרָאָה עֲשִׂיָּא

and they are called three Worlds – *Beriah, Yetzirah, Asiyah*.

כִּי כ"א הוּא עוֹלָם מָלֵא מִכָּל כְּלָלִי וּפְרָטִי הַמְצִיאוֹת כָּלָם

For each of them is a world filled with all types of general and specific existence.

אֲלָא שֶׁבְּזֶה הֵם בְּבִחִי' נִבְרָאִים וְהוּא חֲדוּשׁ הָעֶצֶם דְּכָל מְצִיאוֹת

However, in this world (*Beriah*) they are *created*, meaning the initiation of the ethereal substance¹ of all existence

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם יֵצֵאוּ וְנִבְרָאוּ יֵשׁ מֵאִין

which emerges there as created being from nothing i.e. *ex nihilo*.

וּבְזֶה הֵם בְּבִחִי' נוֹצְרִים שֶׁשָּׁם יֵצֵא כ"א בְּצוּרָתוֹ וְצִיּוּרוֹ הַכּוֹמָדִי
וְהַגְּבּוּלִי

Whereas in this other world, the World of *Yetzirah*, they are *formed*, for it is there that each of them emerges in its form, in a quantitative and limited configuration.

מִשָּׂא"כ [מָה שֶׁאִין כּוֹן] הַנִּבְרָאִים אֵין גְּלוּי לָהֶם לַמַּטֵּה צוּרָתָם
הַכּוֹמָדִית² כָּלֵל

This is not the case with the merely created beings of the World of *Beriah* – they are not revealed below in a quantitative form at all;

וְנִבְחָנִים רַק עַל הָאֵיכוֹת שֶׁבֵּהֶם לְבַד

they are discerned only by qualitative differences among them.

וּבְזֶה הֵם בְּבִחִי' נַעֲשִׂים שֶׁשָּׁם נִגְמַר חֲמֻרֵיהֶם הֵן בְּהֶעָצֶם וְהֵן
בְּהַצִּיּוֹר

And in this next World, the World of *Asiyah*, they are *made*; their corporeal aspect is completed there in both substance and form.

משא"כ בְּהִיצִיָּהּ וּמַכְש"כ [וּמִכָּל שְׁכֵן] בְּהִבְרִיָּאָה לֹא יֵרְדּוּ עַדִּין
לְחֹמֶר הָעֶקָרִי וְהַמְּמָשִׁי כָּלֵל

This is not the case in the World of Yetzirah, and all the more so in the World of Beriah, where they have not yet descended into base materiality and tangible substance at all.

אך עכ"פ הוא כי כ"א לפי בחינתו הוא עולם מלא מכל כללי ופרטי
המציאות כלם

Nevertheless, each World according to its attributes is a complete World comprising all the general and specific aspects of existence as manifested on that plane of reality.

שכל מה שישנו בזה ישנו בזה ונחתם כל תחתון בכל פרטי
המציאות שבו מהעליון שעליו

For whatever is in this lower World is also in that higher World,³ and the lower level World, in all its details, is stamped with the impression⁴ of the higher World above it.

שהעליון עם התחתון הם כחותם ונחתם

For the higher and lower Worlds are as signet-ring is to seal,

שכל מה שיש בְּהַחוּתָם מַעֲתִיקוּ בְּהִנְחָתָם וְכָל מָה שֶׁבְּהִנְחָתָם הוּא
רק מֵהַחוּתָם

so that whatever contours there are in the signet-ring is copied onto the wax seal, and whatever there is in the wax seal is exclusively from the signet-ring.

אֲלֹא שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁהוּא יוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹן הֵנָּה נִתְעַלָּה כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת שָׁבוּ
בְּמַדְרָגָה יוֹתֵר נְעֻלָּה

Albeit that the existential character of the higher level is superior to,

וְיוֹתֵר זֶה הוּא בְּחִמְרוֹ וְהוּא בְּצוּרָתוֹ הִרְבֵּה מֵאֵד מְאוּתוֹ שֶׁלִּמְטָה הִימְנוּ.

and is much more refined in substance and form, than the one below it.

וְהֵנָּה כָּל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם בְּכָלֵלוֹ הוּא בְּתִכּוּנֹת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם

Now each of the Worlds in a general sense displays the format of human stature,⁵ called a *partzuf*,

שֶׁכָּל מָה שֶׁיִּשְׁנֶה בְּאָדָם יִשְׁנֶה בְּעוֹלָם וְכָל מָה שֶׁבְּהַעֲלָם הוּא בְּאָדָם

so that everything all the human characteristics that man has is also in the World, and everything in the World is also in man.

וְאִין בְּזֶה אֵלָּא מָה שֶׁבְּזֶה וּכְמ"ש בְּאַבוֹת דֶּר' נָתָן פ' ל"א וְכֵן הָרַמְבַּ"ם
בְּמוֹרָה ח"א פ' ע"ב

And there is nothing in either man or the World that is not in the other, as stated in *Avot d'Rabbi Natan* chapter 31⁶ and also in Rambam's *Moreh Nevuchin* part 1, chapter 72.

וְכַנֻּדָּע שְׁלֵזָה נִקְרָא הָאָדָם עוֹלָם קָטָן וְכֵן נִקְרָא ג"כ כָּל עוֹלָם בְּשֵׁם
אָדָם

As is known, it is for this reason that man is called a *microcosm*⁷ and each World is called 'man' – *Adam*.

וְהֵם אָדָם דְּבְרִיָּאָה אָדָם דִּיצִירָה אָדָם דְּעִשְׂיָה

They are: *Adam of Beriah, Adam of Yetzirah, Adam of Asiyah*.

כִּי כ"א הוּא קוֹמָה שְׁלֵמָה מְתַכַּנֶּת פְּרָצוֹף אָדָם שְׁלֵם מְמָשׁ.

For each of them of the three Worlds is a complete structure in the format of a complete human *partzuf*, as will be explained.

וְהִנֵּה ע"ד שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ בְּהִמְצִיאוֹת בְּכָל־ל שֶׁהוּא נִחְלָק לִג' מַדְרָגוֹת

Now similar to what we said about existence in general – that it is divided into three levels –

שֶׁהֵם הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה

which are the Worlds of *Beriah, Yetzirah, Asiyah* –

הִנֵּה עַד"ז הוּא ג"כ בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם בִּפְרָט.

similarly, each world individually can be subdivided into three categories.

כִּי כָּל עוֹלָם הֵרִי הוּא בְּתַכּוּנַת פְּרָצוֹף אָדָם כְּנִז'

Because each world is in the format of a human *partzuf*, as mentioned.

וְכָל פְּרָצוֹף אָדָם הִנֵּה הוּא נִחְלָק לִג' בְּחִי' שֶׁהֵם ג' מַדְרָגוֹת הֵן בְּאֶרֶךְ
וְהֵן בְּעָבִי

Now the human form is divided into three aspects, which represent three levels, both vertically and horizontally:

בְּאֶרֶךְ הוּא רֹאשׁ גּוּיָה בֶּטֶן

Along the vertical axis these are the head, the torso and the abdomen.

וּבְעָבִי הוּא בָּשָׂר גִּדִּין עֲצָמוֹת

On the horizontal plane they are flesh, *gidin*,⁸ bones

וְהֵם ג' חֲלָקֵי הַגּוּף שֶׁהֵם חִיצוֹן תִּיכוֹן פְּנִימִי

corresponding to three sections of the body – outer, middle, inner.

וְהֵם ג' בְּחִי' כ"א בְּמִדְרָגָה בַּפִּנִּי עַצְמוֹ] [בְּפִנֵּי עַצְמוֹ]

They are three aspects, each of which is a level on its own,

כִּי בָּהֶם שׁוֹכְנִים הַג' חֲלָקֵי צוּרָה הַיְדוּעִים שֶׁהֵם נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נְשָׁמָה

and in each of them resides one of the three well-known aspects of the *tzurah* – *nefesh, ruach, neshama*.

כִּי הַנֶּפֶשׁ הִיא שְׂרוּיָה בְּהַבֶּשֶׁר שֶׁהוּא הַחֶלֶק הַחִיצוֹן שֶׁל הַגּוּף

Nefesh resides in the flesh and is the outer layer of the body.

וְעֵקֶר מִשְׁכָּנָהּ וּמְקוֹמָהּ אֲשֶׁר מִשָּׁם הִיא מֵתַפְשֶׁטֶת וּמַחֲיָה אֶת כָּל

הַגּוּף הוּא בְּהַכְבֵּד

It's primary 'seat' and location – from which it spreads out to give life to the entire body – is the liver.⁹

שֶׁהוּא הַתְּחִלַּת הַמַּעֲיִם וְהַבֶּטֶן חֶלֶק הַתְּחִתּוֹן דֶּה־הַגּוּף

The liver is located in the area from the beginning of the intestines and the abdomen, the bottom part of the body, i.e. the lower half of the torso.

וּר"ל כִּי עֵקֶר עֲצָמוֹת אֹר הַנֶּפֶשׁ הוּא בְּאֵמֶת ג"כ בְּלִב אֶךְ גִּלּוּיוֹ הוּא בְּכַבֵּד. ע"י
[דְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁעַד טֶנֶת"א פ"ה אוֹת ס"ג וְשֵׁם פ"ו אוֹת ב]

[i.e. the primary essence of the light of the soul is truly only in the heart, but its revelation is in the liver. See our *Shaar Tant*"a chapter 5, subsection 63; *ibid*.

chapter 6 subsection 2].¹⁰

וְהָרוּחַ הוּא שְׂרוּי בְּהַגְדִּין שֶׁהוּא הַחֶלֶק הַתִּיכוֹן וְהָאֲמָצְעִי שֶׁבִּגְוֶיף

וְעֵקֶר מִשְׁכָּנוֹ וּמְקוֹמוֹ הוּא בְּלִב

The level of *Ruach* resides in the *gidin*, the intermediate (horizontally) and middle part (vertically) of the body, and its primary residence and place is the heart,

שֶׁהוּא הַנִּקְרָא בְּסֵפֶר יִצְיָרָה בְּשֵׁם גְּוִיָּה מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהוּא עֵקֶר מְצִיאת
הָאָדָם.

which is called 'torso' in *Sefer Yetzirah* as it is the primary organ necessary for a person to exist.

וְהַנְּשָׁמָה הִיא שְׂרוּיָה בַּעֲצָמוֹת ר"ל בַּמֶּחֱ שֶׁבַּהֶעֱצָמוֹת

The level called *neshama* resides in the bones, that is, in the marrow of the bones.¹¹

וְהוּא מ"ש כָּל עֲצָמוֹתֵי תַאמְרָנָה וְהוּא הַחֶלֶק הַפְּנִימִי שֶׁבַּהֶגּוּף

And this is the significance of the verse "all my bones declare..."¹² and this is the inner aspect of the body.

וְעָקֵר מִשְׁכָּנָהּ וּמִקוֹמָהּ הוּא בְּהִמּוּחַ שְׁבִירָאשׁ שֶׁהוּא הַחֶלֶק הָעֲלִיוֹן
שֶׁבְּהִגּוּף.

The primary residence of the *neshama* is in the brain in the head, the topmost part of the body.

וְהֵנָּה אֵלּוּ הֵג' מִדְּרָגוֹת שֶׁהֵם רֹאשׁ, גִּוְיָה, בֶּטֶן שְׁבִירָאֲרַךְ אֲשֶׁר סִימָנָם
הוּא מל"ך [מֶמֶח לֵב כֶּבֶד]

The initial letters of these three – the head, the torso and the abdomen along the vertical axis – form the word *melech* meaning 'king.'

The initial letters of the central organs of the head, torso and abdomen (i.e. *mo'ach*, the brain; *lev* the heart; *caveid* the liver) are *mem*, *lamed*, *caf* – *melech* – king, for each is a 'king' in its domain.

וְכֹן פְּנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן שֶׁבְּעֵבְיוֹ אֲשֶׁר סִימָנָם הוּא פת"ח עִם הֵנֶר"ן
שֶׁבָּהֶם

Similarly inner, middle, outer on the horizontal plane form the word *petach* 'opening' together with the *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama* within them.

The initial letters of *pnimi* (inner), *tichon* (middle), *chitzon* (outer) form the word *petach* – 'opening.' (Note that vowels in Hebrew are not signified by letters, but rather by vowel points, so they can be ignored when emphasizing the initial letters). The implication seems to be that these form the opening to a spiritual path inwards.

הֵנָּה הֵם הֵג' בְּחִי דְּבִירָאָה יִצִּירָה עֲשִׂיָּה אֲשֶׁר הֵם בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף
וּפְרָצוּף

These correspond to *Beriah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*, which are in each and every *partzuf*.

Each *partzuf* can be subdivided into these three levels *Beriah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*, corresponding to the brain, heart and liver, as will be explained.

כִּי הַנֶּשְׁמָה וְהַמָּח עִם הַחֶלֶק הַפְּנִימִי שֶׁבְּהִגּוּף הוּא בְּחִי בִּירָאָה
שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

The *neshama* and brain are part of the inner aspect of the body, corresponding to *Beriah* in each *partzuf*.

וְהוּא מ"ש רז"ל [רַבּוּתֵינוּ זְכוּרָנָם לְבִרְכָּהּ] יוֹמָא (פּה, א) מֵהִיכֹן הִנָּלַד
נוֹצֵר מֵרֹאשׁוֹ כו'

This is what our rabbis of blessed memory were referring to in the Talmud, Tractate *Yoma* (85a): "From where does a fetus develop? From its head..."¹³

אבא שאול אומר מטבורו ומשלח שרשיו אילך ואילך

One of the Talmudic Sages, Abba Shaul, said that development begins from the navel i.e. from where the embryo is attached to the placenta, which sends out its 'roots' this way and that.¹⁴

ואמרו שם עד כאן לא קאמר אבא שאול אלא לענין יצירה כו'

The following is a discussion regarding the extent to which one is obligated to check whether a person buried under rubble is still alive, if at first glance he appears to be dead. One opinion states that one need only check his nostrils to see if he is breathing. Another opinion maintains that one must check the person's heartbeat.

Now the rabbis there opined that Abba Shaul's expressed his view only as regards the formation and development of the embryo

אבל לענין נפש אפי' אבא שאול מודה דעקר חיותיה באפיה

But as regards a danger to life, even Abba Shaul agrees that life is discerned primarily by the breath in the nostrils.

For a complete discussion see Babylonian Talmud, Tractate *Yoma* page 85a.

וע' בתוספת שם שהקשו כי בנדה כ"ה א' אמר אבא שאול ג"כ כי תחלת ברייתו מראשו ואומר רבנו תם שם כי בנדה צ"ל כרשוו וכן הוא בערוך ע"ש אמןם בתוספתא נדה פ"ו כתוב שם ג"כ כמו הגרסא שלפנינו אך במדרש ויקרא רבה פ' י"ד¹⁵ [סימן ח' שם איתא בגרסת ר"ת והערוך

אך באמת הנה אלו ואלו הם דברי א"ח [אלקים חיים]

But in truth both views are the word of the living God.

In Talmudic law, when there are two or more opinions regarding a law (*halacha*), only one opinion can be followed practically. Yet both opinions are regarded as the word of God, as long as they are both valid interpretations of Scripture. In Kabbalistic literature, two (or more) opinions can be accepted as valid, as in the following case, where one view applies in the World of *Beriah*, another in the World of *Yetzirah*, and a third in the World of *Asiyah*:

כי בבחי' הבריאה של הולד שהוא התחלת מציאותו ויצאתו אשר מאין ליש

Because in terms of the aspect of *Beriah* (corresponding to creation *ex nihilo*) of the fetus – the beginning of its existence and its emergence from nothing into existence –

הנה ראשיתו מראשו דהוא מהמח שבו כי משם הוא שרש החיות
the beginning of its development starts from the head, which is the brain, for there is the root i.e. origin of its life.

More specifically, this beginning point is *chochmah*, and it is therefore called the 'beginning' as in the verse – 'רִאשִׁית חֲכָמָה יְרָאתָה' (Psalms 111:10). And it emerges from nothing, as the verse in Job 28:12 states וְהַחֲכָמָה מֵאֵין תִּמְצָא.

וְשֵׁם הוּא רִאשִׁית הָעֶצֶם וְנִקְדָּתוֹ הַפְּנִימִית אֲשֶׁר מִשָּׁם נִמְשָׁךְ
הַהֲתַהוּוּת שֶׁל הַזֶּלֶד

and there is the beginning of its essence and its inner point of existence, from which the coming into being of the fetus is drawn down.

וְהוּא מֵה שֶׁאָמְרוּ כִּי לְעֵנֶינּוּ חִיּוּתֶיהָ גַם אֲבָא שָׂאוֹל מוֹדֶה שֶׁשֵּׁם הוּא
שְׂרִשׁוֹ בְּעֶצֶם

As the Sages said in the excerpt from the Talmud cited above: even Abba Shaul acknowledges that there the head and brain is the essential root-source of the rest of the embryo.

אֲךָ זֶהוּ רַק בְּבַחֲי' הָאִיכוֹת שֶׁבּו שֶׁהוּא בַּחֲי' הַבְּרִיאָה שֶׁבּו

However, this is only in a qualitative sense, which is its aspect of *Beriah* – creation from nothing.

אֲבָל בְּבַחֲי' הַיְצִירָה שֶׁל הַזֶּלֶד שֶׁהוּא מְצִיאֻתוֹ בְּכַמּוֹת

But the aspect of *Yetzirah* of the fetus, which is its existence in quantitative terms –

הִנֵּה בְּזֶה נַעֲשֶׂה הַהֲתַחֲלָה מֵהַחֶלֶק הָאֲמֻצָּעִי שֶׁבִּגּוּף וְהוּא מ"ש
מִטְבוֹר

in this aspect the beginning is from the middle part of the body, from the navel

–

וּר"ל מִטְבוֹר הַלֵּב עַד טְבוֹר הַגּוּף שֶׁשֵּׁם הוּא הַחֶלֶק הָאֲמֻצָּעִי שֶׁבִּגּוּף

meaning, from the 'navel of the heart' (the intention here seems to be the aorta)¹⁶
to the navel of the body, which is located in the center of the body

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֵׁם דָּכַל מִדֵּי מִמְצִיעֶתָהּ מִיתָצֵר

as our Sages state there¹⁷ 'everything forms around its center.'

וּמִתַּחִיל מְצִיאֻתוֹ אֲשֶׁר בְּבַחֲי' יְצִירָה

In terms of the aspect of formation in *Yetzirah* its existence begins there.

מֵהָרוּחַ וְהַלֵּב שֶׁהוּא הַחֶלֶק הָאֲמֻצָּעִי שֶׁבִּגּוּף וּמִשְׁלַח שְׂרָשָׁיו אֵילָךְ
וְאֵילָךְ

From the level of *ruach* and the heart, which is the middle part of the body, sending its roots out this way and that – the arteries extending from the heart branch out into all areas of the body.

As noted earlier in this chapter, the primary 'residence' of *ruach* is in the heart.

כִּי הָרוּחַ וְהַלֵּב שֶׁהוּא בְּאִמְצַע הוּא בְּחִי הַיְצִירָה שֶׁבְּהַפְּרָצוֹן וְהוּא
הַגּוּיָה

for the *ruach* and the heart are centrally located and correspond to *Yetzirah* of the *partzuf*, which is the torso in terms of the body.

וּמִצִּיאוֹתוֹ הוּא מִטְבוֹר הַלֵּב עַד טְבוֹר הַגּוֹף

And it ranges from the 'navel of the heart' – again, possibly the aorta – to the navel of the body.

וְהוּא כָּל חֶלֶק הַגּוֹף אֲשֶׁר לְפָנִים מִן הַפְּרָסָא הַמִּפְסִיק בֵּין הַלֵּב
וְהַרְיָאָה לְבֵין הַכֶּבֶד וְהַמַּעֲיִם

It's that section of the body that spans the area from above the diaphragm separating the heart and lungs from the liver and intestines,¹⁸ to the top of the chest.

וְכִ"ז הוּא בְּחִי הַיְצִירָה שֶׁבְּגוֹף.

All of this is the *Yetzirah* aspect of the body.

אֲךָ הַנֶּפֶשׁ עִם הַכֶּבֶד וְכָל חֶלֶק הַחִיצוֹן וְהַתְּחִתּוֹן שֶׁבְּגוֹף הוּא בְּחִי
עֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוֹן

However, the *nefesh* and its corresponding organ, the liver, and the entire outer layer of the lower body, is the aspect of *Asiyah* of every *partzuf*.

כִּי שֵׁם נִגְמַר תְּקוּנוֹ בְּכָל עֲבִיּוֹתוֹ וְחִמְרֵיּוֹתוֹ הַנִּצְרָךְ אֵלָיו לְקִיּוּמוֹ
בַּעוֹה"ז [בַּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה].

It is there that its – the body's – construction is completed in all of the coarseness and corporeality needed for its continued survival in this physical world.

וְכֵן הִנֵּה יִשְׁנָם עַד"ז [עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה] כָּל אֱלוֹהֵי הַג' בְּחִי וּמִדְּרָגוֹת בְּכָל
עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם ג"כ

There are similar parallels to all of these aspects and levels mentioned above in all of the Worlds as well.

These comparisons apply not only to the various aspects of the human form, but also to the metaphysical Worlds themselves as well.

כִּי אֵין בְּרִיאַת וִיצִירַת וְעֲשִׂיַת הָאָדָם אֲלָא רַק מֵאוֹתוֹן הַבְּחִי אֲשֶׁר
יִשְׁנָם בְּהַעֲלָם

For the aspects of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* in man are only derivatives of those aspects that exist as concealed planes of reality, the Worlds,

וכמ"ש בַּאֲבוֹת דֶּר' נָתַן פ' ל"א וְכַנִּז'

as is written in *Avot d'Rabbi Natan* chapter 31, as mentioned above.

(וְהֵם הֵג' מִדְּרָגוֹת שֶׁבְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִי' אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל עוֹלָם שֶׁהֵם כח"ב חג"ת נהי"מ כְּנֻדָּע)

(And these are the three levels among the ten *sefirot* i.e. three groups of the *sefirot*, corresponding to ¹⁹ *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*, in each of the Worlds – *keter-chochmah-binah*; *chesed-gevurah-tiferet*; *netzach-hod-yesod-malchut*, as is known).

וְנִמְצָא כִּי אֵלוֹ הֵג' מִדְּרָגוֹת דְּבִרְיָאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה הֵנָּה הֵם יִשְׁנָם הֵן
בְּפִרְטוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל אָדָם בְּפִרְט

It thus becomes apparent that these three levels – *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* – are manifested in specific instances, in each person individually,

וְהֵן בְּכָלִיּוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ

as well as generally, in each of the worlds separately,

וְהֵן בְּכָלִי כָּלִיּוֹת שֶׁהֵם הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

and also in a universal sense – the three Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* in general.

כִּי בְּכָלִי כָּלִיּוֹת הֵיוּ כָּל הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת יַחַד ג"כ רַק כָּלִיּוֹת פְּרָצוּי אָדָם
אֶחָד

In this universal sense, all three Worlds together also form a single *partzuf* in the format of an individual human.

The reference here appears to be to the World of *Atzilut*.²⁰

וְכֵן הוּא כָּל עוֹלָם בִּפְנֵי ע"ה הֵן כ"א בְּחִי קוֹמַת פְּרָצוּי אָדָם בְּכָל
תְּכוּנוֹתָיו כַּנִּז'.

And so too in every World individually: each one is designed according to the stature of man with all of his characteristics, as mentioned above.

וְהָרִי נִבְחָן בְּחִי בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה בְּכָל עוֹלָם גּוֹפָה וְכֵן בְּכָל אָדָם
גּוֹפָה

Thus the aspects of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* have been identified in each of the worlds, as well as in each person himself.

וְכִבְּרָ אִמְרָנוּ כִּי אֵלוֹ הֵג' מִדְּרָגוֹת שֶׁבְּאָדָם הֵנָּה הֵם הַנִּשְׁמָה רוּחַ נֶפֶשׁ
שָׁבוּ

We already stated that these three levels in man are the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* within him.

וְכֵן הֵם ג"כ בְּחִי הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם גּוֹפָה

And so too are there *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* within each world individually,

וְכֵן הוּא בְּכָלֵי כָלֻלוֹת

And so too in a universal sense –

כִּי עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה הוּא בְּבִחִי נִשְׁמָה וְעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה הוּא רוּחַ וְעוֹלָם
הָעֲשִׂיָּה הוּא נֶפֶשׁ

the World of *Beriah* is primarily the aspect of *neshama*, the World of *Yetzirah* is primarily *ruach* and *Asiyah* is primarily *nefesh*,

הַגֵּם שֶׁיֵּשׁ נר"נ בכ"א מֵהֶם עֲצָמוּ ג"כ

even though there is also *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* i.e. all three aspects within each of these Worlds themselves.

אֲמָנָם בְּהַעֲרֹךְ כָּלֵל כָּל עוֹלָם זֶה כְּנֶגֶד זֶה

Nevertheless, when comparing one world to another in a general sense,

הֵנָּה נִבְחָן כ"א לְגַבִּי חִבְרוּ רַק בְּבִחִי מִדְּרָגָה אַחַת לְבַד

each World is distinguished from the others as manifesting only a single level:

כִּי כָלֵל כָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה כְּלָה שֶׁהִיא הַתַּחְתּוֹנָה וְהַחִיצוֹנָה לְכֻלָּם

For example: the entire World of *Asiyah*, which is the lowest and most external of all the Worlds,

הֵנָּה נִבְחָן כָּל הַג' חֻלְקֵי הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבָּה כֻּלָּם רַק בְּבִחִי נֶפֶשׁ לְבַד

all three levels of *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* in it are all only *nefesh*,

כִּי הֵם רַק הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּהֶנֶפֶשׁ גּוֹפָה וְהִיא כְּלָה רַק הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכָּלֵלִי

since they are *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* of the *nefesh* itself, which in its entirety is the general category of *nefesh* only.

וְכָל עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה בְּכָלֵל שֶׁהוּא הָאֲמֻצָּעִי לְכֻלָּם הוּא כְּלוּ בְּחִי רוּחַ

Similarly, the entire World of *Yetzirah*, the intermediate layer of all three, in its entirety is the aspect of *ruach*.

וְהַנֶּר"נ שָׁבוּ הֵם רַק הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ הַכָּלֵלִי

And its *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* levels are *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* in the general category of *ruach*.

וְכָל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה בְּכָלֵל שֶׁהוּא הָעֲלִיוֹן וְהַפְּנִימִי לְכֻלָּם

So too, the entire World of *Beriah*, which is the highest and most inward of all the three Worlds,

הַנֶּהֱנֶה הַנֶּהֱנֶה שֶׁבּוֹ כָּל בְּחִי נִשְׁמָה וְהֵם הַנֶּהֱנֶה שֶׁבְּהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכֶּלֶלִי

its *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshamah* levels are *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshamah* in the general category of *neshamah*.

כִּי כ"א הוּא כָּלֹל מִכָּל הַבְּחִי וַיִּשְׁנֶם בַּכ"א כָּלֵלִים וּפְרָטִים וּפְרָטִים
פְּרָטִים עַד אֵין חֶקֶר

Each of them the Worlds includes all of them, and in each of them comprise general categories and specific details and details of details to an unfathomable degree,

וַיִּכְמוּ שְׂתִיבָאָר עוֹד בַּע"ה לִקְמוֹן בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ:

as we will explain in the paragraphs ahead, God willing.

Footnotes

1. Although the word used here is עֶצֶם, which can also have the meaning of "essence," in this context it means 'stuff' or substance, indicating the emergence of being *ex nihilo*. See Ramban Genesis 1:1: ואֵין אֶצְלָנוּ בְּלִשׁוֹן הַקֹּדֶשׁ בְּהוֹצָאת הַיֵּשׁ מֵאֵין אֶלָּא לִשׁוֹן "בְּרָא" ... אֲבָל הוֹצִיא מִן הָאֶפֶס הַגִּמּוּר הַמּוֹחֵלֵט יִסּוּד דֶּק מֵאֵד, אֵין בּוֹ מִמֶּשׁ, אֲבָל הוּא כּוֹחַ מִמְצִיא, מוֹכֵן לִקְבֹּל ... הַצּוּרָה וְלִצְאָת מִן הַכּוֹחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל ↵
2. in the original. Emended according to *Meir HaLeshem* ↵
3. Perhaps we can describe this using a hologram as a paradigm. ↵
4. 'Impression' here is meant in the sense of a signet ring used to stamp a unique seal in wax that reveals all the contours of the signet ring. Perhaps encryption would be a good modern example. ↵
5. Although the word *partzuf* is generally used for facial features, in this context it refers to the entire human stature. See *Meir HaLeshem*. ↵
6. "Rabbi Eliezer, the son of Rabbi Yose HaGalili, taught: everything that the blessed Holy One created in His universe, He also created in man." The text lists quite a number of such parallels. ↵
7. *Tikunei Zohar* 116b. ↵
8. The regular translation of גִּידִין is 'tendons.' However, in *Etz Chaim* (41:1) we see that גִּידִין includes tendons (called הַלְבָּנִים), arteries (גִּידִין) (הַדּוּפְקִים) and veins (גִּידִין בְּלִי דּוּפְקִים). ↵
9. See *Zohar* II p. 76a; *Etz Chaim* (9:2). ↵
10. In this parenthetical note the Baal HaLeshem offers a resolution to an apparent contradiction in *Etz Chaim* regarding the primary seat of *nefesh* –

whether it is in the heart or the liver. The solution is that both are correct: its primary abode is in the heart, but its revelation is in the liver. [↩](#)

11. See *Etz Chaim* (26:1). [↩](#)

12. Psalms 35:10 – כָּל עֲצָמוֹתַי תִּאֲמַרְנָה יְהוָה מִי כָמוֹךָ [↩](#)

13. This is confirmed by medical science. The embryo's brain and spinal cord begin to develop in the fifth week of pregnancy, before most other internal organs, and long before the limbs. [↩](#)

14. The placenta first starts to form soon after the egg has been fertilized. Later the placenta forms tiny hair-like projections (villi) that extend into the wall of the uterus. Blood vessels from the embryo, which pass through the umbilical cord to the placenta, develop in the villi. [↩](#)

15. This parenthetical remark presents an abstruse comparison of various sources in an attempt to clarify Abba Saul's view of this matter and what he actually said. We have left it untranslated as it is not germane at all to our discussion. [↩](#)

16. The aorta is the main and largest artery in the human body, originating from the left ventricle of the heart and extending down to the abdomen, where it splits into two smaller arteries. It seems that just as the navel is the source from which the embryo receives all its nourishment, so too the body receives all its life-force via the blood from the aorta, which is therefore called 'the navel of the heart.' [↩](#)

17. *Yoma* 85a. [↩](#)

18. The diaphragm is a dome-shaped, muscular and membranous structure that separates the thoracic (chest) and abdominal cavities. [↩](#)

19. Makover. [↩](#)

20. *Meir HaLeshem*. [↩](#)

Chapter 2 — Though there are 5 levels in nefesh, ruakh, neshama, chaya and yeshida, only the first 3 reside in the body. This is the same for the worlds.

Shaar 3 Chapter 2

אָמַנְט מָה שְׁאָמְרָנוּ שְׁחֻלְקֵי הַצּוּרָה הֵם ג' וְהֵם נר"נ

However, what we said in the previous chapter that there are three aspects of *tzurah* – *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* –

הִנֵּה הָאֲמֶת הוּא שְׁחֻלְקֵי הַצּוּרָה הֵם חֲמִשָּׁה וְהֵם נרנח"י

in truth there are actually five aspects of *tzurah* – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*.

וְכִמּוֹ שְׁאָמְרוּ רז"ל בְּבִרְאשִׁית רַבָּה פ' י"ד סִימָן ט' וְכֵן בְּדִבְרֵי רַבָּה פ' ב' סִימָן ל"ו

As our Sages taught in *Midrash Bereishit Rabba* (14, 9), and similarly in *Devarim Rabba* (2:36):

חֲמִשָּׁה שְׁמוֹת יֵשׁ לְנֶשְׁמָה נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נֶשְׁמָה חַיָּה יְחִידָה וְהֵם בְּאֶמֶת
ה' בְּחִי נֶשְׁמָה כ"א גְבוּהָ מִחֲבֵרוֹ

"The soul has five names: *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*." And they are actually five aspects of the soul (*neshama*) with each one on a higher level than the other.

The fact that there are five names of the soul indicates that there are five different levels, signifying five different types of relationship to the One Above. Perhaps this can be compared to a man who is called 'son' by his parents, 'father' by his children, 'boss' by his employees, 'friend' by his colleagues and so on. Each relationship is indicated by a different name.¹

אֲךָ מָה שְׁאָמְרָנוּ שֶׁהֵם ג' הוּא מִשּׁוּם כִּי מְקוֹמָם וּמִשְׁכָּנָם בְּהַגּוּף הוּא
רַק ג' לְבַד

Although we stated earlier that there are three aspects to the soul, not five, this is because as regards their place and manifestation in the body there are only three –

שֶׁהֵם נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נֶשְׁמָה וְעַל יְדֵיהֶם נִתְחַלֵּק הַגּוּף לִג' מַדְרָגוֹת שֶׁהֵם
רַג"ב [רֹאשׁ גּוּיָה בֶטֶן] וּפִת"ח [פְּנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן] כָּנ"ל.

nefesh, *ruach* and *neshama*. And as a result, the body is also divided into three levels, which are the head, torso and abdomen along the vertical axis, and the inner, middle, outer on the horizontal plane, as explained above in chapter 1.

ולא נמצא בהגוף מקומות וחדרים לחלקי הצורה אלא רק ג' לבד

In the body there are only three places i.e. organs for housing the three aspects of the *tzurah* –

שהם מח לב כבד והם המקום ומעון לנר"נ

– the brain, the heart and the liver. They are the locus and the housing for the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* in this order, as explained above.

אבל להחיה והיחידה לא נמצא להם כלים בהגוף להתלבש בהם

But as for *chaya* and *yechida* – there are no bodily organs² in which they are vested

כי אין בכם הגוף לקבלם מחמת אורם הגדול

since the body does not have the ability to receive them, due to their great light.

אלא שהחיה היא בתוך הנשמה שהנשמה היא הגוף והכלי שלה
והיחידה היא שורה בתוך החיה.

How then are *chaya* and *yechida* expressed? Instead of being manifested in any bodily organ, *chaya* is infused within the *neshama* which acts as its 'body' and 'vessel,' and *yechida* resides within *chaya*.

והעקר הוא כי הסיה והיחידה הנה הם אינם מתלבשים בעקר
אורם בהגוף כלל

The main point being that the primary light of *chaya* and *yechida* are not clothed in the body at all.

אלא שהם מרחפת על הגוף מבחוץ

Rather they hover³ above the body from outside of it,

כי החיה היא מרחפת על הנר"נ שבהגוף והיא להם בבחי' אור
מקיר

since *chaya* hovers tenuously, as a transcending light,⁴ above the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* that are within the body.

והיחידה היא מרחפת על החיה והוא מקיר למקיר

And *yechida* hovers above *chaya* as transcendent⁵ i.e. transcending even the transcending quality of *chaya*.

ומה שאמרנו שהם מתלבשים בהנשמה הוא רק הארתם לבד

So when we said that they are 'clothed' in the *neshama* this is referring to their radiance alone.

אבל הם עצמם אינם מתלבשים בהגוף כלל

But they themselves are not clothed within the body at all.

אֵלָא הֵם רַק בְּבַחֲיָי מְקִיף וּמְקִיף לְמְקִיף

Rather, they are only in a state of transcending (*makif*) and transcendent (*makif* of *makif*) respectively.

וּמִשּׁוּם שֶׁהֵם אֵינָם מִתְפַּשְׁטִים לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַגּוּף מִמֶּשׁ וְלֹא נִמְצָא
בְּהַגּוּף אֵלָא רַק ג' כֵּלִים לַהֲנֵר"נ לְבַד

And because they do not extend and spread out to become actually clothed in the body, there are only three vessels in the body for *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* –

שֶׁהֵם מֵחַ לֵב כִּבְד כִּנּוֹי

the brain, the heart and the liver, as mentioned.

לְכֹן אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁחֲלָקֵי הַצּוּרָה אֲשֶׁר בְּהַגּוּף הֵם ג' שֶׁהֵם הֲנֵר"נ.

Therefore we stated that there are only three aspects of *tzurah* in the body – *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*.

וְהִנֵּה ע"ד שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ בְּכָל אָדָם בְּפֶרֶט כֵּן הוּא עַד"ז בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בְּכָל

Now in the same way that we described this structure as regards individual human beings, so too as regards the Worlds in general:

כִּי הִנֵּה הֵם ג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה אֲשֶׁר הֵם כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת
הַנִּפְרָדִים

There are three Worlds – *Beriah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah* – which are in the category of 'disconnected' worlds,

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהֵם כֻּלָּם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלל

since they are not Godly at all, as opposed to the World of *Atzilut*, which is fully connected to the *Ohr Ein Sof*.

וְהִנֵּה הֵם ג' כֵּלִים לְקַבֵּל בְּתוֹכָם אֶת הֲנֵר"נ הַכָּלְלִי

And they the disconnected worlds act as vessels in which to receive the macro-level i.e. the non-personal, or the universal *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*.

כִּי הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכָּלְלִי הוּא בְּעֲשִׂיָּה וְהָרוּחַ הַכָּלְלִי הוּא בְּיְצִירָה וְהַנֶּשְׁמָה
הַכָּלְלִי בְּבְרִיאָה

The macro-*nefesh* is in *Asiyah*, macro-*ruach* in *Yetzirah*, and the macro-*neshama* in *Beriah*.

אֲבָל לַחֲיָה וְיַחֲדָה הַכָּלְלִים לֹא נִמְצָא עוֹד עוֹלָמוֹת נִבְרָאִים לְהִיּוֹת
כֵּלִים לָהֶם

But as for macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* – there are no created worlds to contain them.⁶

אֵלָא הוּא כִּי הַסִּיָּה וְהַיְחִידָה הַכְּלָלִיִּים הֵם רַק מְרֻחָף עֲלֵיהֶם
מִבְחוּץ בְּבַחֲוֵי מְקִיר וּמְקִיר לְמְקִיר

Rather, the macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* merely hover above them, outside of them in a state of transcending (*makif*) and transcendent (*makif of makif*) respectively,

וְלֹא נִכְנָס מֵהֶם בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת מִבְּפָנִים אֵלָא רַק הָאֲרָתָם לְבַד.

and nothing from them enters the created worlds, other than a mere radiance.

וְהִנֵּה ע"ד שְׁאֵמְרָנוּ שֵׁשֶׁנָּם ה' צוּרוֹת כְּלָלִיִּים שֶׁהֵם נִרְנַח"י

Now in the same way that we said there are five general *tzurot* (plural of *tzurah*) – i.e. *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*,

כֵּן הוּא ג"כ שֶׁכ"א מֵאלוֹ הָה' הוּא כָּלוּל ג"כ מֵה' שֵׁשֶׁנָּם ה' בְּחִי
נִרְנַח"י

so too, each one of the five is also comprised of five aspects – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*:

בְּהִנָּפֶשׁ הַכְּלָלִי נֶפֶשׁ שְׁבִנְפֶשׁ רוּחַ שְׁבִנְפֶשׁ נִשְׁמָה שְׁבִנְפֶשׁ חַיָּה
שְׁבִנְפֶשׁ יְחִידָה שְׁבִנְפֶשׁ – וְכֻלָּם הֵם נֶפֶשׁ הַכְּלָלִי

On the macro-level of *nefesh*, there is *nefesh* of *nefesh*, *ruach* of *nefesh*, *neshama* of *nefesh*, *chaya* of *nefesh*, *yechida* of *nefesh* – and all of them are aspects of the macro-level of *nefesh*.

וְכֵן עַד"ז ה' בְּחִי נִרְנַח"י בְּהַרוּחַ הַכְּלָלִי וְכֵן ה' בְּחִי נִרְנַח"י בְּהַנִּשְׁמָה
הַכְּלָלִי

Similarly, there are five aspects of *ruach* on the macro-level – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *ruach*, and five aspects of *neshama* on the macro-level – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *neshama*,

וְה' בְּחִי נִרְנַח"י בְּהַחַיָּה הַכְּלָלִי וְה' בְּחִי נִרְנַח"י בְּהַיְחִידָה הַכְּלָלִי.

and five aspects of *chaya* on the macro-level – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *chaya*, and five aspects of *yechida* on the macro-level – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *yechida*.

וְכֵן ע"ד שְׁאֵמְרָנוּ שֶׁהַסִּיָּה וְהַיְחִידָה הַכְּלָלִיִּים לֹא נִמְצָא לָהֶם כֵּלִים
בְּהַגּוּף

And just as we said that the macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* have no vessels in the 'body' i.e. within the created worlds,

וְהֵם אֵינָם מְתַלְבָּשִׁים בְּהַגּוּף אֲלָא שְׁנִשְׁאָרִים מִבְּחוּץ בְּבַחֲי' מְקִיר
וּמְקִיר לְמְקִיר

and they are not clothed within the 'body' but remain outside of them as *makif*
and *makif of makif*,

כֵּן הוּא עַד"ז בְּהַחֲיָה וְהַיְחִידָה הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בַּכ"א מֵהִנְרַנְח"י
הַכְּלָלִיִּים

so too regarding the sub-divisions of *chaya* and *yechida* in each of the macro-
levels of *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*.

הִנֵּה הֵם ג"כ אֵינָם מְתַלְבָּשִׁים בְּהַגּוּף אֲלָא שְׁנִשְׁאָרִים ג"כ רַק בְּבַחֲי'
מְקִיר וּמְקִיר לְמְקִיר

Likewise, they are not clothed in the body but also remain in a state of *makif*
and *makif of makif*.

וְכַגּוֹן הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכְּלָלִי אֲשֶׁר אֶמְרָנוּ שֶׁהוּא מְתַלְבֵּשׁ בְּהַגּוּף וּמְקוֹמוֹ וְגַלְוִיו
הוּא בְּהַכְבֵּד

For example *nefesh* in the macro sense, which we said is clothed in the body and
is situated in the liver, where it is revealed,

וּמִשָּׁם הוּא מְשַׁלַּח פְּאוּרֹתָיו² בְּכָל הַגּוּף כֻּלּוֹ

and from there it sends forth its shoots throughout the entire body

וּמֵאִיר וְשׁוֹלֵט בְּחֻלְקֵי הַחִיצוֹנִית דְּהַגּוּף וְכַנֵּ"ל

and it illuminates the external aspects of the body and controls it, as explained
previously –

הִנֵּה כָּל הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת הַזֶּה הִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּבַחֲי' הִנֵּה נ' שְׁבִנְפֶּשׁ

Now this 'clothing' within the body is only as regards the aspects of *nefesh*,
ruach and *neshama* of *nefesh*,

אֲבָל הַחֲיָה וְהַיְחִידָה שֶׁבְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ הִנֵּה הֵם אֵינָם מְתַלְבָּשִׁים בְּהַגּוּף
אֲלָא רַק בְּהֶאָרָתָם לְבַד

but *chaya* and *yechida* of *nefesh* are not clothed within the body, other than as a
mere radiance –

אֲבָל עֶקֶר אוֹרָם נִשְׁאָר מִבְּחוּץ בְּבַחֲי' מְקִיר וּמְקִיר לְמְקִיר

but their primary light remains on the outside, as *makif* and *makif of makif*.

וְכֵן עַד"ז בְּהַרוּחַ הַכְּלָלִי הַמְתַּלְבֵּשׁ בְּהֵלֶב וּמֵאִיר וְשׁוֹלֵט בְּהַחֲלָק
הָאֻמְצָעִי שֶׁבְּגּוּף

In a similar manner, *ruach* in the macro sense is clothed in the heart and illuminates and controls the middle part of the body on the horizontal plane, as explained in chapter 1.

וְהִנֵּה הוּא כָּלוּל מִנִּרְנַח"י שֶׁהֵם הַנִּרְנַח"י שֶׁבִּהְיוֹם הַכֶּלְלִי וְכִנּוּ

It too comprises the micro levels of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*, which are the *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *ruach* at the macro level.

הִנֵּה אֵינוֹ מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהֵלֶב וְהַגּוֹף אֲלֵא רַק בַּהֶר"נ שֶׁבּוֹ לְבַד

However, only *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* are clothed in the heart and the body,

אֲבָל הַחֵיָה וְהַיְחִידָה שֶׁבּוֹ הֵם נִשְׂאָר מִבְּחוּץ בְּבִחִי' מְקִיף וּמְקִיף
לְמְקִיף

while *chaya* and *yechida* remain on the outside as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

וְכֵן הוּא עַד"ז בְּהַחֵיָה וְהַיְחִידָה הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בִּכ"א מִהַנִּרְנַח"י
הַכֶּלְלִיִּים

And so too regarding the micro-level *chaya* and *yechida* of each of *ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* –

הִנֵּה הֵם ג"כ אֵינָם מִתְלַבֵּשִׁים בְּהַגּוֹף אֲלֵא שֶׁנִּשְׂאָרִים ג"כ רַק בְּבִחִי'
מְקִיף וּמְקִיף לְמְקִיף.

– they the *chaya* and *yechida* are not clothed within the body, but likewise remain as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

וְכֵן עַד"ז הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכֶּלְלִי אֲשֶׁר הִיא מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהֶמוֹם וּמְאִיר וְשׁוֹלֵט
בְּהַחֲלֵק הַפְּנִימִי שֶׁבְּגוֹף

Similarly regarding the macro level of *neshama*, which is clothed in the brain and illuminates and controls the inner part of the body on the horizontal plane, as explained in chapter 1 –

וְהִנֵּה הִיא כָּלוּלָה מִנִּרְנַח"י שֶׁהֵם הַנִּרְנַח"י שֶׁבִּהְיוֹם הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכֶּלְלִי

– it too comprises the micro levels of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*, which are the *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *neshama* at the macro level.

הִנֵּה אֵינוֹ מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהֶמוֹם וְהַגּוֹף אֲלֵא רַק בַּהֶר"נ שֶׁבּוֹ לְבַד

Only *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* are clothed in the brain and the body,

אֲבָל הַחֵיָה וְהַיְחִידָה שֶׁבּוֹ הֵם אֵינָם מִתְלַבֵּשִׁים בְּהַגּוֹף כָּלֵל

chaya and *yechida* are not clothed within the body at all,

אֲלֵא שֶׁהֵם נִשְׂאָר מִבְּחוּץ בְּבִחִי' מְקִיף וּמְקִיף לְמְקִיף

but remain on the outside as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי יֵשׁ לְכָל גּוֹף ו' מְנֵי מְקִיפִים פְּרָטִיִּים

So we find that for every body there are six specific levels of *makif* –

וְהֵם הַחֲדָה וְהַיְחִידָה אֲשֶׁר בַּכ"א מֵהֶג' אִוְרוֹת נר"נ הַכְּלָלִיִּים

chaya and *yechida* for each of the macro-level lights of *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama*.

וְהוּא לְבַד הַחֲדָה וְהַיְחִידָה הַכְּלָלִיִּים שֶׁהֵם כָּלֵם רַק מְקִיפִים לְבַד
בְּכָל הָה' בְּחִי' נִרְנַח"י שֶׁבַכ"א מֵהֶם

And this is besides the macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* which are entirely *makif* in each of their five aspects of *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*.

In other words, all the sub-levels of *chaya* (i.e. *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *chaya*), and all the sub-levels of *yechida* (i.e. *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *yechida*) remain in a state of *makif*.

וְהָרִי הֵם בְּסֵךְ הַכָּל ט"ז מְנֵי מְקִיפִים לְכָל פְּרָצוֹף וּפְרָצוֹף וְכֵן הוּא
בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם.

Accordingly, there are in total sixteen types of *makif* in each and every *partzuf*, and so too in each World.

The sixteen are: the six specific levels of *makif*, comprising the *chaya* and *yechida* of each of *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama*, plus the five sub-levels each of *chaya* and *yechida* themselves, making sixteen.

אָמֵנָם הוּא כִּי כ"ז הוּא רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלֵל

However, this is only in a general sense.

אָבֵל בְּפְרָטִיּוֹת הֵמָּה מִתְרַבִּים הָאֶרֶת הִנִּרְנַח"י שֶׁבַכ"א בְּהִפְנִימִים
וְהַמְקִיפִים שֶׁבָּהֶם לְפְרָטִים רַבִּים אִין חֶקֶר

But more specifically the radiances of *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* in each of the immanent and transcendent aspects increase in detail to an incalculable amount,

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר בְּהַדְרוּשִׁים וְע' דְּבָרֵינוּ בְּשַׁעַר הָעֵקוּדִים פ"ב אוֹת ז' סִי'
ב'.

as is explained in various expositions. See also our comments to *Sha'ar haAkudim* chapter 2, paragraph 7 (b).

וְעִנִּין צֶרֶךְ וְתוֹעֵלָת הַמְקִיפִים ע' דְּבָרֵינוּ שֵׁם אוֹת ח'

As for the need for and benefit of the *makifim*, see our comments there to paragraph 8.

וכן יתבאר כ"ז ג"כ קצת לפנינו בשערים הבאים בעה"י.

This will also be explained to a lesser extent in the sections below.

אמנם דע כי הנה הגם שאמרנו שחלקי הצורה המתלבשים בהגוף
הנה הם ג' שהם נר"נ

Know however that even though we stated that the aspects of *tzurah* which are clothed in the body are only three, *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama*,

ואמרנו כי נתיסד להם ג' כלים בהגוף שהם מוח לב כבד והם מקום
ומעון להנר"נ וכנ"ל

and we stated that there are three vessels in the body which were reserved for them – the brain, the heart and the liver – which are the place and residence for the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* listed here in the order of the vessels in which they are manifested, as mentioned,

הנה האמת הוא כי עקר הצורה המתלבש בהגוף ממש הם רק
שנים שהם נפש ורוח לבד

the truth is that the primary aspects of *tzurah* which become clothed in the body are only *nefesh* and *ruach*.

והנר"נ דהנפש והרוח הם אשר מתלבשים במוח לב כבד

It is the *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* of *nefesh* and *ruach* alone that are fully clothed in the heart and liver,

אבל הנשמה הכללית היא אינה מתלבש בהמוח אלא רק בהקצה
התחתון שלה

whereas *neshama* on the macro level is not clothed in the brain other than via its lowest extremity.

כי עקר מדרגת האדם הוא רק הנפש והרוח אבל הנשמה היא
באמת למעלה ממדרגתו

This is because man's spiritual level is defined primarily by his *nefesh* and *ruach*, whereas his *neshama* is really beyond his spiritual level

ואינה מתלבשת בהאדם אלא רק כדי להתעלה ולהתגדל על ידה
למעלה ממדרגתו

and is clothed in him (via its lowest extremity) only in order for him to thereby become elevated and distinguished beyond his level.

שהוא נפש ורוח ולהתעלה על ידה למדרגת הנשמה ג"כ

So that the *nefesh* and *ruach* that he is (i.e. that define him) can be elevated by his *neshama* to the level of *neshama*.

ומשום שְׁעֵקֶר מְדֻרְגֵּת הָאָדָם הוּא רַק נֶפֶשׁ וְרוּחַ

And since man's spiritual level is defined primarily by his *nefesh* and *ruach* alone,

לְכֹן הֵם אֲשֶׁר מִתְלַבָּשִׁים וּמִשְׁתַּתְּפִים עִם הַגּוּף וְחֹמֶר וְנִעֲשִׂים חֵד עִמּוֹ

Therefore they become clothed in the body and corporeality and form a partnership with him and become one with him.

אָבֵל הַנִּשְׁמָה אֵין לָהּ הַשְׁתּוּוּת עִם הַגּוּף כָּלֵל אֶלָּא רַק בְּהַקְצָה הַיּוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן שְׁבָה לְבַד

But the *neshama* has no common ground with the body at all other than via its lowest extremity.

וּבִזָּה לְבַד הִיא מִתְלַבֶּשֶׁת בּוֹ וְהִתְלַבְּשׁוּתָהּ הוּא ג"כ רַק ע"י הַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבָרוּחַ אֲשֶׁר מְקוּמָהּ הוּא בְּהֵמוֹחַ

It is only this that is clothed in the body, and also only the *neshama* of *ruach*⁸ whose place is in the brain.

וְמָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל שְׁהָרוּחַ הוּא בַּלֵּב הוּא רַק הָרוּחַ שְׁבָרוּחַ

What we said above – that *ruach* is revealed in the heart – refers only to *ruach* of *ruach*.

אָבֵל הַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבָרוּחַ שׁוֹרָה ג"כ רַק בְּהֵמוֹחַ וְהוּא עֵקֶר הַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבָאָדָם

But the *neshama* of *ruach* rests only in the brain, and this is primarily what we refer to when discussing the *neshama* in man.

אֲשֶׁר בְּמִדְרַגַּת הָאָדָם וּבִתּוֹךְ אוֹתָהּ הַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבָרוּחַ

On the level that defines man – i.e. his *nefesh* and *ruach* alone, as explained above – in his *neshama* of *ruach*

מִתְלַבָּשִׁים הֵנּוּ שְׁבֵה־נִשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּית

is clothed the *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* of *neshama* in the macro-sense –

בְּהַקְצָה הַיּוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן שְׁבָהֶם וְכִדִּי לְהַתְעַלָּה וּלְהַתְגַּדֵּל עַל יְדוֹ לְמַעְלָה מִמִּדְרַגָּתוֹ

but only their lowest extremes. And this is for the purpose of thereby elevating and magnifying his *ruach* beyond its innate spiritual level.

וְע"י אוֹתָהּ הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּית קָשׁוּר הָאָדָם לְמַעְלָה לְמַעְלָה

And via that *neshama* on the macro-level a person is connected above and beyond.

וְעַל יְדֵה שׁוֹרָה הַשְׁכִּינָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וּמֵיחַד שְׁמוֹ עֲלֵיהֶם

And by means of that *neshama* on the macro-level the *Shechinah* rests upon the Jewish People as a whole and He unites His Name upon them,

כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר כ"ז לַמָּטָה בְּאֵר הַיָּטִיב בְּעֶזְרַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ:

all of which will be explained fully below, with God's help.

Footnotes

1. See *Shemot Rabbah* 3:6 – God's response to Moses when he wished to know His name was "according to My deeds I am called. When I judge the world I am called *Elokim*; when I wage war on the wicked I am called *Tzva'ot*..."
אמר ליה הקדוש ברוך הוא למשה שמי אתה מבקש לידע לפי מעשי אני נקרא פעמים שאני נקרא באל שדי בצבאות באלהים בה' כשאני דן את הבריות אני נקרא אלהים וכשאני עושה מלחמה ברשעים אני נקרא צבאות וכשאני תולה על חטאיו של אדם אני נקרא אל שדי וכשאני מרחם על עולמי וכשאני נקרא ה' שאין ה' אלא מדת רחמים... [↵](#)
2. Literally, 'vessels.' [↵](#)
3. The word מרחף in Hebrew has the sense of an ethereal higher plane tenuously making an appearance on a lower plane, as in Genesis 1:2 וְרוּחַ יְיָ מְרַחֵף עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם – And the spirit of God hovered tenuously over the surface of the waters. [↵](#)
4. 'Transcending light': *Ohr makif* is often translated as 'surrounding or enveloping light' to contrast it with the internalized, immanent light that fills the vessel it fills from within. 'Transcending light' is a more precise characterization. [↵](#)
5. We will use *transcendent* for *makif l'makif* and *transcending* for *makif*. [↵](#)
6. Literally: "There can no longer be found created worlds to be vessels for them." [↵](#)
7. See Ezekiel 17:6 וַתְּהִי לְגִפּוֹ וַתַּעַשׂ בְּדִים וַתְּשַׁלַּח פְּאוֹרוֹת [↵](#)
8. But not the level of *neshama* itself. [↵](#)

Chapter 3 — The generic nefesh and ruakh of the lower worlds bi" a are not at all Divine energy in and of themselves.

Shaar 3 Chapter 3

וְהִנֵּה אֲמַרְנוּ כִּי יֵשׁ נִרְנַח"י בְּכָלֵיִם וְנִרְנַח"י פְּרָטִיִּים

We said in the previous chapter that there is a macro-level *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*, and also micro-levels of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*. We will abbreviate this below as *nrnch*"y where appropriate.

וְהִינּוּ שֶׁכ"א מֵהִנִּרְנַח"י הַכְּלָלִיִּים הִנֵּה כָּלֹל כ"א ג"כ מִנִּרְנַח"י
וְכַנ"ל

That is to say, each of the macro-levels of *nrnch*"y also comprises micro-levels of *nrnch*"y.

אֲמָנָם הִנֵּה יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּין הִנִּרְנַח"י הַכְּלָלִיִּים לִהִנִּרְנַח"י
הַפְּרָטִיִּים

Nevertheless, there is a tremendous difference between the macro-level *nrnch*"y and the micro-level *nrnch*"y,

כִּי הִנִּרְנַח"י הַכְּלָלִיִּים הִנֵּה הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכְּלָלִיִּים הֵם נִבְרָאִים
נוֹצְרִים נַעֲשִׂים

because the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *nrnch*"y are created, formed and made,

וְהֵם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלֹל

and they are not Godly at all (according to what we will explain below).

אָבֵל הַנִּשְׁמָה וְהַחַיָּה וְהַיְחִידָה הַכְּלָלִיִּים אֵלֹהֵי הַג' הֵם כָּלֵם אֱלֹהוֹת
גָּמוּר

But *neshama, chaya* and *yechida* in the macro sense – all three – are all entirely Godliness,

גַּם בְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

even in the Worlds of *Beriah, Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*.

שְׂאֵפִי בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הִנֵּה מֵהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכְּלָלִית וְלִמְעַלָּה כָּלֹל אֱלֹהוֹת
גָּמוּר

So that even in the World of *Asiyah* the macro-level of *neshama* and above are all entirely Godliness,

כי הנשמה הכללית אשר גם בהעשיה הנה היא מעולם האצילות
since the macro-level of *neshama*, even in *Asiyah*, is from the World of *Atzilut*
אשר הוא אלהות גמור כמו שיתבאר בשערים הבאים.

which is entirely Godliness, as will be explained in the coming sections.
אמנם הנרנח"י הפרטיים אשר ישנם גם בהנפש והרוח הכלליים
However, the micro-level *nfnch* "y, which are sub-strata in macro-level *nefesh*
and *ruach* as well,

הנה יש בהם בחי' שהם אלהות ויש בהם בחי' שאינם אלהות
have aspects which are Godliness and aspects which are not Godliness.
ויש חלוק בזה בין העולמות

In this respect there is a difference between the Worlds:

כי בעולם העשיה הנה האלהות שבהם רק היחידה לבד שבהם
in the World of *Asiyah* the Godliness in it is only in its *yechida*,¹

כי היחידה הפרטית אשר גם בהרוח והנפש הכלליים דהעשיה
הוא אלהות גמור
since the micro-level *yechida*, even in macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Asiyah*, is
entirely Godliness.

אבל מהחיה ולמטה אשר בהרוח והנפש הכלליים דהעשיה הם
אינם אלהות כלל.
But from *chaya* and below in the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Asiyah* is not
Godliness at all.

ובעולם היצירה הנה גם החיה הפרטית אשר בהרוח והנפש
הכלליים דהיצירה ג"כ אלהות גמור
In the World of *Yetzirah* even micro-level *chaya* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*
of *Yetzirah* is entirely Godliness.

אך מהנשמה הפרטית ולמטה אשר בהרוח ונפש הכלליים
דהיצירה
But the micro-level *neshama* and lower of the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*
הם אינם אלהות כלל.

are not Godliness at all.

ובעולם הבריאה הנה גם הנשמה הפרטית אשר בהרוח והנפש
הכללים דהבריאה ג"כ אלהות גמור

However, in the World of *Beriah* even the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Beriah* is also entirely Godliness.

ורק הרוח והנפש הפרטיים אשר ברוח ונפש הכלליים דהבריא

Only the micro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Beriah*

הם אינם אלהות כלל.

are not Godliness at all.

ונמצא כי בעולם הבריא הנה אלהות מהנשמה ולמעלה לעולם

It turns out that the World of *Beriah* is Godliness from the level of *neshama* and above,

ר"ל גם הנשמה הפרטית אשר ברוח ונפש הכלליים שבה

i.e. including the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* in it – in the World of *Beriah*.

אבל בעולם היצירה הנה האלהות אשר גם ברוח והנפש הכלליים שבו רק מהחיה ולמעלה.

But in the World of *Yetzirah* there is Godliness in the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* only from the level of *chaya* and above i.e. *yechida*.

אך בעולם העשייה לא הנה אלהות ברוח ונפש הכלליים שבה

Whereas in the World of *Asiyah* there is no Godliness in its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*

אלא רק היחידה לבד שבהם.

other than in its *yechida*.

והרי נמצא מכ"ז כי היחידה היא לעולם אלהות

So it emerges from all of this that *yechida* is always Godliness,

ור"ל גם היחידה הפרטית אשר גם ברוח ונפש הכלליים דהעשייה

meaning to say, including the micro-level *yechida* of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level.

אבל הרוח והנפש הפרטיים דהרוח ונפש הכלליים

But the micro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*

הם לעולם אינם אלהות אפי' בעולם הבריא

are never Godliness, even in the World of *Beriah*.

אך הנשמה והחיה הנה בעולם הבריא הם ג"כ אלהות גמור לעולם

Whereas *neshama* and *chaya* in the World of *Beriah* are also always entirely Godliness.

ור"ל אפי' הנשמה והחיה הפרטיים אשר גם בהרוח והנפש
הכלליים

Meaning to say, even the micro-level *neshama* and *chaya* of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level are entirely Godliness.

אבל ביצירה הנה האלהות רק מהחיה לבד אך לא מהנשמה
ולמטה

But in the World of *Yetzirah* there is Godliness only in *chaya* and above, but not from *neshama* and below.

ובעולם העשייה הוא רק היחידה לבד ולא מהחיה ולמטה.

And in the World of *Asiyah* only *yechida* is Godliness, but from *chaya* down is not.

וכ"ז הוא רק בהנשמה והחיה הפרטיים אשר ברוח ונפש הכלליים

All of this is only as regards the micro-level *neshama* and *chaya* of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level,

אבל הנשמה והחיה הכללים ומכש"כ היחידה

but as for macro-level *neshama* and *chaya* —

הם כלם לעולם אלהות גמור בכל חלקי הנרנח"י שבהם גם בעולם
העשייה

– they are always entirely Godliness in all their aspects of *nnrch*"y, even in the World of *Asiyah*.

וכמ"ש האריז"ל בשער הצלם פ"א ובשער השמות פ' א' ב' ובכ"מ

[As the Arizal writes in *Shaar HaTzelem* chapter 1, and in *Shaar HaShemot* chapters 1 & 2, and in a number of other places.

וכן כתב ג"כ הגר"א ז"ל בהיכלות פראשית היכל א' בספר יהל אור
דף י"א ע"ד.

The GR"A also writes thus in his commentary on the section of the *Zohar* known as the *Heichalot*, *Bereishit*, *Heichal* 1, printed in his book *Yahel Ohr* p. 11d.

ובמה שכתבתי החלוק בין הכללים להפרטים

And this distinction between the macro and micro levels that we wrote about

בזה יתישב דברי הגר"א בלקוטיו שבסוף הספד"צ דה"מ ידוע
שהבדל עצמי כו' ע"ש

resolves an apparent contradiction in the words of the GR" A in his *Likutim* at the end of his commentary on the section of the *Zohar* known as the *Sifra d'Tziniuta*, beginning with "It is known that there is an essential difference..."

שְׁהוּא נִרְאָה כְּסוּתָר אֶת עֲצָמוֹ לְמָה שֶׁכָּתַב בְּהִיכְלוֹת הַנִּזְ'

in which he appears to contradict himself regarding his commentary to the aforementioned *Heichalot*.

אָבֵל לְפִי מָה שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי הוּא נִיחָא

But according to our explanation written above, there is no problem,

כִּי בְּלִקוּטָיו שֵׁם מְדַבֵּר בַּהֲנַנְח"י שֶׁבִּנְפֶּשׁ רוּחַ הַכָּלָלִים

because in his *Likutim* he is referring to *nrnch*"y of *nefesh* and *ruach* on the macro-level,

כִּי וְקֵץ הֵם לְבַד הֵם עֶקֶר מְדֻרְגָּת דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

since only they are the primary level of the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* –

וְהוּא מְדֻרְגָּת הָאָדָם וְהַיָּוֵן:]

and this is the level of man. Understand this.]

To summarize the contents of this chapter, the diagram² below may help:

Macro-level *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* are always Godliness, but –

	<i>Nefesh</i> (micro)	<i>Ruach</i> (micro)	<i>Neshama</i> (micro)	<i>Chaya</i> (micro)	<i>Yechida</i> (micro)
<i>Beriah</i>	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Godliness	Godliness	Godliness
<i>Yetzirah</i>	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Godliness	Godliness
<i>Asiyah</i>	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Godliness

Thus, micro-level *nefesh* and *ruach* are never Godliness, whereas micro-level *yechida* is always Godliness.

Footnotes

1. Literally, "...the Godliness in them is only in their *yechida*." [↩](#)
2. From the Makover edition. [↩](#)

Chapter 4 — The locations of all the specific aspects of the nefesh, ruakh and neshama are the brain, heart and liver.

Shaar 3 Chapter 4

ידע כי הנשמה הפרטית אשר גם ברוח והנפש הכלליים

Know that micro-level *neshama*, even of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level,

הנה מקומם הוא ג"כ רק במוח

is also located only in the brain – so that not only the level of *neshama* of *neshama* resides in the brain, but even *neshama* of *ruach* and of *nefesh* resides there, as will be explained below.¹

והוא מה שאנו רואין שיש בחי' מ' גם לבהמה

This is evident in that we see that even animals have a brain.

וכן יש בחי' מ' גם לנפש הצומחת שבכל מין צומח

Furthermore, there is some semblance of a brain² in the vegetal life-force³ of every type of plant.

וכן הוא גם לנפש המרכבת שבכל חלקי הדומם

And the same is so even regarding the integrating existential force⁴ that permeates all aspects of the inanimate world.

והוא המקום דהנקדה הפנימית דכל גשם שהיא הנושא אותו

This is the central inner point of all matter that sustains its existence (as stated in *Sefer Yetzirah* 4:4, see GR"A⁵),

כי שם שוכן הצורה העקרית דכל מציאות

for it is there that the primary *tzurah* of every entity resides,

שכ"א הוא כלול מחמר וצורה כנ"ל שער ב'

since every entity is comprised of matter and form, as explained above in *Shaar* 2.

ואותו המקום דהנקדה הפנימית אשר בו שוכן הנפש המרכבת

Now within that inner point resides the integrating existential force

שהיא הצורה אשר ישנו גם בהדומם הוא בחי' המ' שבו

which is the *tzurah* that is present even in the inanimate world – and that is its brain.

וְשֵׁם הוּא שְׂרִשׁוֹ וְהִתְחַלְתּוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּחִי' הָרֹאשׁ שָׁבוּ.

And there is its root and its beginning, which can therefore be referred to as its 'head.'

וְעַ' שְׁעַר פְּרָקֵי הַצֵּלָם רפ"ב שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁם הָרַב כִּי אֵין דְּבַר שְׂאִין בּוֹ
נִרְנַח"י

See the section of *Eitz Chaim* titled *Pirkei HaTzelem* beginning of chapter 2, where Rabbi Chaim Vital states that there is nothing that does not have *nrnch* "y,

וְהוּא כָּלְלוֹת הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַמְרַכֶּבֶת שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ שִׁישְׁנוּ גַם בַּהֲדוּמָם

which is the general integrating existential force that is also present in inanimate entities

וְהוּא הַכֹּחַ הַמְקַיֵּם אֶת הַרְכָּבָתוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּחִי' נֶפֶשׁ דִּהְדוּמָם

as the sustaining force that integrates their various elements. This is the *nefesh* of the inanimate world.

וְעַ' בְּדִבְרֵי הָרַב בְּשְׁעַר קָצוֹר אַבִּי"ע פ"ב וְשֵׁם פ"י בְּדַה"מ הַדוּמָם
ע"ש.

See Rabbi Chaim Vital's words in the section of *Eitz Chaim* titled *Kitzur Abiy* "a chapter 2, and chapter 10 beginning with the words, 'The inanimate.'

וְנִחְזֹר לְהַעֲנִין כִּי הִנֵּה עכ"פ הוּא כִּי מְקוּמָהּ שֶׁל הַנִּשְׁמָה הַפְּרִטִית

Let's return now to our subject, which is that in any event, the proper place of the micro-level *neshama*,

אֲשֶׁר גַּם בְּהַרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים הוּא ג"כ רַק בְּהַמוֹחַ

even of the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*, is also only in the brain.

וְעַל זֶה נִתְּיָסַד ג' מְקוּמוֹת בְּהַגּוּף דְּכָל פָּרְצוּף שֶׁהֵם מֶלֶח לֵב כְּבֵד

It was due to this that three places were established in the body of each *partzuf* – the brain, the heart and the liver –

כִּי הֵם הַמְשָׁכָן וְהַמְעוֹן לַהֲנֵר"נ הַפְּרִטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בְּהַרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ
הַכִּלְלִיִּים

because they are the abode and home for micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*⁶ of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

שֶׁהֵם עֶקֶר מַדְרַגַּת שֶׁל כָּל פָּרְצוּף וְכָנ"ל

which are the primary levels of each *partzuf*, as mentioned above.

וְלִכְךָ נִתְּיָסַד לַהֲנֵר"נ שְׁבָהֶם ג' כָּלִים מל"כ

And therefore, for the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* three vessels were designated – the brain, the heart and the liver –

וְהֵם מְעוֹן וּמְדוֹר לָהֶם שְׁבֵהֵם הֵם שׁוֹכְנִים

and they serve as their housing and a lodging in which they reside.

אָבֵל הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית שֶׁהִיא כֻּלָּה אֱלֹהוּת אֵין לָהּ הַשְׁתּוּוֹת כָּלֵל עִם שׁוֹם גּוּף וְכָלִי

But the macro-level *neshama*, which is entirely Godliness, has nothing in common with any bodily entity or receptacle.

וְלָכֵן לֹא נִתְּיַסַּד לָהּ כָּלִי כָּלֵל בְּהַגּוּף לְקַבֵּל אוֹתָהּ בְּתוֹכָהּ

And for this reason no receptacle in the body was assigned to the *neshama* in which to receive her.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהִיא שׁוֹכֶנֶת בְּתוֹךְ הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּהֵרוּם אֲשֶׁר בְּמִחָה

Instead she resides in the *neshama* of *ruach* in the brain.

שֶׁהַנִּשְׁמָה דְּהֵרוּם הוּא הַכָּלִי שֶׁלָּהּ

Thus the *neshama* of *ruach* is her – the macro-level *neshama*'s – receptacle

וְשָׁם הִיא מִתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּהַקְצָה הַיּוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן דֶּהֱנֵר"נ שֶׁלָּהּ

and there she spreads forth via the lowest extremity of her micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*,

וּבִזְזָה לְבַד הוּא מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף.

so that only this aspect is clothed in the entire *partzuf*.

וְהִנֵּה בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה אֲשֶׁר הָאֱלֹהוּת שְׁבָהּ הִיא רַק הַיְחִידָה דְּהֵרוּם וְנִפְשׁ וְכָנ"ל פ"ג

Now in the World of *Asiyah*, where the only Godliness is in *yechida* of *ruach* and *nefesh*, as explained in chapter 3,

הִנֵּה מִתְיַחֶדֶת הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית בְּהָאָדָם ע"י הַיְחִידָה שֶׁבּוּ

the macro-level *neshama* unites with a person via their micro-level *yechida*.

וְהַיְחִידָה הַרִי הִיא מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהָאֲרָתָהּ בְּהַחֲיָה

And this *yechida* spreads forth and its radiance becomes clothed in *chaya*,

וְהַחֲיָה בְּהַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבָמָח (שֶׁהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּרוּחַ וְנִפְשׁ כָּנ"ל) וְכָנ"ל פ"ב.

and *chaya* in the *neshama* in the brain (which is the *neshama* of *ruach* and *nefesh*, as mentioned) – as was explained above in chapter 2.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה מְתִיחֶדֶת הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

And in the World of *Yetzirah* the macro-level *neshama* unites with the entire *partzuf*

ע"י הַיְחִידָה וְהַחֲזִיה שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ

via the *yechida* and *chaya* of *ruach* and *nefesh*.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה מְתִיחֶדֶת הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית שָׁבָה

And in the World of *Beriah* the macro-level *neshama* in it is united with it – with the World of *Beriah* –

ע"י הַיְחִידָה וְהַחֲזִיה וְהַנִּשְׁמָה אֲשֶׁר בְּהָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ

via the *yechida*, *chaya* and *neshama* of *ruach* and *nefesh*.

וְאוֹתוֹן הַנִּשְׁמָה וְהַחֲזִיה וְהַיְחִידָה דְרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ שָׁבָה

And that *neshama*, *chaya* and *yechida* of its *ruach* and *nefesh*

הֵם הַג' ר' [ג' רָאשִׁין] דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה הַנִּקְרָא כֶּסֶף הַכְּבוֹד

are the three 'heads' i.e. *binah*, *chochmah* and *keter* (from lowest to highest)⁷ of the World of *Beriah*, which is called *Kisei Hakavod* – the Throne of Glory.

וְהֵנָּה הֵם בְּהִיבֵל הַז' דְּבְרִיאָה שֶׁהוּא בְּחִי' הַמִּחָה שָׁבָה

In fact they are vested in the seventh Chamber of *Beriah* which is the aspect of 'brain' within it – i.e. *keter*, *chochmah* and *binah* of *Beriah* are its 'intellectual' aspect, referred to here as *mo'ach* or brain.

וּבָהֶם מִתְפַּשְׁטֶת וּמְתִיחֶדֶת הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דְּהַבְּרִיאָה וְכַמ"ש
בְּשַׁעַר כֶּסֶף הַכְּבוֹד פ"א.

And through them the macro-level *neshama* spreads into and unites with *Beriah*, as it states in *Eitz Chaim*, *Shaar Kisei HaKavod* chapter 1.

אָמְנָם מָה שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ שֶׁהַנִּשְׁמָה דְרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ הֵם בְּהִמּוּם

However, our statement at the beginning of this chapter that micro-level *neshama* of the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* are vested in the brain needs elucidation –

הִנֵּה עָקֵר הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּהִמּוּם עֲצָמוֹ הוּא רַק הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּהָרוּחַ

in fact the primary aspect of the *neshama* vested in the brain itself is only the *neshama* of *ruach*, but not the *neshama* of *nefesh* –

אָבֵל הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּנֶפֶשׁ הִנֵּה הִיא אֵינָה בְּהִמּוּם עֲצָמוֹ

since the *neshama* of *nefesh* is not vested in the brain itself

אֶלָּא רַק בְּהִקְרוּמִין דְּהִמּוּם וְהִקְרוּמִין

but rather in the membranes, called the meninges⁸ (or *krumin* in Aramaic) surrounding the brain.

הם בבחי' בשר שהוא משרש הדם והכבד מקום משכן דהנפש

For our purposes these are in the same category as flesh – from the same root as the blood and the liver in which the *nefesh* physical life-force resides.

ואותן הקרומין הנה בהיות הגלד בבחי' עבור שאז אין בו רק נפש לבד

Regarding these *krumin*-membranes – when the fetus is in the womb, when only *nefesh* is manifested in them (this state is called *ibbur*) –

הנה אותן הקרומין אז בו במציאות מחין ממש והם המחין דעבור
then these *krumin*-membranes have the de facto status of brain in the fetus, and they are called *mochin d'ibbur* (prenatal intellect).⁹

Mochin d'ibbur is a state of developing (but still immature) intellect.

אך אח"כ בגדלות כשנגמר בו המחין האמתי

But later, in the state of maturity when the real brain has developed – in our analogy, when the child has developed into an adult and has gained intellectual maturity –

הנה נעשה מהמחין דעבור לקרומין על המחין

then the *mochin d'ibbur* (prenatal intellect) become the membranes surrounding the brain rather than the mere de facto status of brain in the fetus.

ושם שורה בו הנשמה דהנפש

There, as they surround the fully developed brain, the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh* resides therein in the *krumin*-membranes,

והוא לבוש על הנשמה דהרום שהוא בהמום ממש

which function as the 'garment' or surrounding membrane enveloping the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* which is vested in the actual brain,

כמו הקרומין שהם לבוש על המחין

just like the *krumin*-membranes that function as a 'garment' surrounding the brain.

ונמצא כי עכ"פ הוא שהם שניהם בהמום שבראש זה בהמום ממש וזה בהקרום.

So it turns out in any event that both of them (*neshama* of *ruach* and *neshama* of *nefesh*) are vested in the brain in the head – this *neshama* of *ruach* in the

actual brain, and that *neshama* of *nefesh* in the membrane surrounding the brain.

וכן עד"ז בְּהָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּשִׁנְיָהֶם כִּי הֵן הָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּרוּחַ וְהֵן הָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּנֶפֶשׁ
שִׁנְיָהֶם הֵם בְּלֵב

And similarly regarding *ruach* in both of them – both micro-level *ruach* of macro-level *ruach* and micro-level *ruach* of macro-level *nefesh* are both vested in the heart.

וְזֶהוּ מְצִיאת הַשְּׁנֵי חֲלָלִים שֶׁבְּלֵב בְּאֶחָד רוּחַ וְאֶחָד דָּם

And this is the parallel to the existence of two chambers in the heart – in one *ruach* and in the other blood i.e. the *nefesh*, "for the blood is the *nefesh*" (Deut. 12:23) – as the Baal haLeshem will explain shortly –

הַיְמִין רוּחַ וְהַשְּׂמָאל דָּם

in the right, *ruach*; in the left, blood.¹⁰

וְהֵם הָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּרוּחַ וְהָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּנֶפֶשׁ

When we said that *ruach* and *nefesh* are vested in the heart, these are *ruach* of *ruach*, and *ruach* of *nefesh*.

וְמָה שֶׁהוּא דָּם הוּא מְשֻׁרֵשׁ הַכָּבֵד אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ שֵׁשׁ הוּא עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתוֹ
וְגִלּוּיֹ

The reason that *nefesh* is referred to as 'blood' is because it is rooted in the liver, for there is its primary existence and where it is primarily revealed,

כִּי עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתוֹ וְגִלּוּיֹ דֵּהֲנֶפֶשׁ הוּא רֶק בְּכָבֵד.

since the primary aspect of the existence and revelation of the *nefesh* is only in the liver.¹¹

וכן הוא עד"ז בְּהִנָּפֵשׁ שֶׁבְּשִׁנְיָהֶם כִּי הֵן הִנָּפֵשׁ שֶׁבְּרוּחַ וְהֵן הִנָּפֵשׁ
דֵּהֲנֶפֶשׁ

The same concept applies to the *nefesh* in both of them, since *nefesh* of *ruach* and *nefesh* of *nefesh*

שִׁנְיָהֶם הֵם בְּהַכָּבֵד הִנָּפֵשׁ דֵּהָרוּחַ מִבְּפָנִים וְהִנָּפֵשׁ דֵּהֲנֶפֶשׁ מִבְּחוּץ

are both vested in the liver – *nefesh* of *ruach* inwardly, and *nefesh* of *nefesh* outwardly.

'Inwardly' and 'outwardly' here possibly refer to two of the general functions of the liver – metabolism and synthesis of nutrients (inward), and purifying the blood of toxins (outward).

וְהוּא אֲשֶׁר מְשַׁתַּתֵּף וּמְתַעֲרֵב עִם הַדָּם וְהַבֶּשֶׂר

It is the liver that interfaces and intermingles with the blood and flesh,

וכמ"ש (דברים יב, כג) כי הדם הוא הנפש ולא תאכל הנפש עם הבשר

as it is written (Deut. 12:23) "For the blood is the life *nefesh* and you shall not eat the life *nefesh* with the meat."

והוא הנפש דנפש אשר הוא משתתף ומתערב עם הדם והבשר

This is the level of *nefesh* of *nefesh* which interfaces and intermingles with the blood and flesh.

אכל הנפש דהרוח הוא מפנים אליו ושניהם הם בכבד

But *nefesh* of *ruach* is internal to that, although both of them are in the liver.

וזהו הענין מה שתלוי טריפת הכבד בשעור ב' זיתים

This is the concept that the kosher or non-kosher status of a liver is determined by the measure of two olives'-worth:

כזית במקום מרה ושם הוא הנפש שבנפש

if there is an olive's-worth in the area of the gall-bladder where the *nefesh* of *nefesh* is situated,

וכזית במקום חיותו ששם הוא הנפש דהרוח שבנפש

and an olive's-worth in the place of its life i.e. in the place from which it receives its nourishment, so that the animal can survive, which is the *nefesh* of *ruach* of *nefesh*, then it is kosher.¹²

ונקרא הוא מקום חיותו כי הרוח הוא עקר החיים.

And it is called 'the place of its life' since *ruach* is the primary aspect of life.

והרי נתבאר לנו מכ"ז כי הן הנר"נ דהרוח והן הנר"נ דהנפש

All the above clarifies for us that the *neschama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of *ruach* as well as the *neschama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of *nefesh* –

שניהם הם במח לב כבד שהם ראש גויה בטן

both of them are vested in the brain, heart and liver, which are housed in the head, torso and the abdominal section.

וכן הם שניהם בכל חלקי פנימי תיכון חיצון דהגוף שאמרנו לעיל
פ"א

Both of them are also vested in all parts of the body – inner, middle and outer, as described in chapter 1 above.

וְהָרִי הֵם מִתְחִילִים שְׁגִיָּהֵם מִן הַמֶּחֱ וְכֵן הֵם מִתְפַּשְּׁטִים שְׁגִיָּהֵם עַד
סוֹף הַגּוּף:

And both of them begin in the brain, and both of them spread into the body all the way down to the final i.e. the lowest and least important aspects of the body.

Footnotes

1. Makover. [↵](#)
2. Perhaps we can refer to this as the plant's 'situational-awareness' or 'survival-intelligence'. [↵](#)
3. Literally, 'plant soul.' [↵](#)
4. Literally, 'the soul that combines....' [↵](#)
5. Every material object is demarcated by six spatial dimensions (right, left, front, back, above, below) radiating from its central point. [↵](#)
6. We have listed them in this order specifically, corresponding to the brain, the heart and the liver. [↵](#)
7. *Binah*, *chochmah* and *keter* in this order, so that they correspond to *neshama* (*binah*), *chaya* (*chochmah*) and *yechida* (*keter*) mentioned in the previous line. [↵](#)
8. There are three layers of meninges: dura mater (closest to the bone), arachnoid loosely around the brain, pia mater is closely attached to the brain and spinal cord surface. [↵](#)
9. Recent studies also suggest that rather than acting as a passive connective tissue 'neural container' during development, the meninges may also interact with and regulate cranial skull and neural development. [↵](#)
10. In general the Sages relied on the knowledge of their times. See *Moreh Nevuchim* 3:14. [↵](#)
11. As noted in *Eitz Chaim* 1:3. [↵](#)
12. *Chulin* 46a, Rashi; Tur and *Shulchan Aruch Yoreh De'ah* 41:1. [↵](#)

Chapter 5 — Just as we find nefesh, ruakh and neshama one above the other and one inside the other, we also have each grouping within each of them.

Shaar 3 Chapter 5

אָמַנְם מָה שֵׁישׁ לְכַאוֹרָה לְתַמָּה בְּזֶה כִּי הוּא נֶגֶד הַנוֹדָע

However, at first glance, what we just said¹ – that *neshama* of *ruach* and *nefesh* is in the brain, rather than *neshama* of *neshama*² – seems surprising, because it contradicts what we know,

וְנֶגֶד מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ

and it goes against everything we said above –

שֶׁיִּשְׁנֹו לַכ"א מֵהֵנָּה נֶמְקֹום מִיַּחַד בְּהִגּוּף וְהֵם הֵג' כְּלִים מִן לֵב כֶּבֶד

that *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* [from here on abbreviated as NR"N for the macro-level and nr"n for the micro-level] each have a designated location in the body, which are the three 'vessels' for the three parts of the soul – the brain, the heart and the liver –

שֶׁהַנֶּשְׁמָה הִיא לְמַעַלָּה בְּהַמוֹחַ וְהָרוּחַ הוּא בְּאֶמְצַע שֶׁהוּא בֶּלֶב

such that the *neshama* is located above in the brain, *ruach* in the middle, in the heart,

וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הוּא לְמַטָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּכֶבֶד

and *nefesh* below, in the liver.

כִּי כִּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּכָלִלוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֵּן הוּא בְּפִרְטוֹת כָּל פְּרָצוּף

The answer is that just as it is in the general or universal i.e. macro-level Worlds, so too is it in the individual or local i.e. micro-level of every *partzuf*:

In order to maintain the proper perspective regarding these two aspects – the general/universal as opposed to the individual/local – and thus avoid misunderstanding, we will refer to them as macro-level and micro-level respectively.

וּבְכָלִלוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת שֶׁהֵם בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה

in the macro-level Worlds – *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* –

וּבְרִיָּאָה הִיא נֶשְׁמָה וְיְצִירָה רוּחַ וְהַעֲשִׂיָּה נֶפֶשׁ

Beriah is *neshama*, *Yetzirah* is *ruach* and *Asiyah* is *nefesh*.

הָרִי הֵם בְּכָל עֶקְרָם זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה לְגִמְרִי

Thus inherently they are one above the other completely, as discrete levels with no overlap.

וְהֵם הֵנֶר"נ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

And they are *neshama, ruach* and *nefesh* [NR"N] on the macro-level.

וְכֵן הוּא בִּפְרָטוֹת ג"כ שֶׁבְּמָקוֹם שֶׁמִּסְתִּים הָעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁם מִתְחִיל
הַתְּחִתּוֹן

And similarly on the micro-level – where the higher level ends, only there does the lower level begin, with no overlap.

אֲבָל לְפִי מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ עֲתָה הִרִי יִהְיֶה נִמְצָא שֶׁאֵין חֲלוּק מְקוֹמוֹת
בֵּינֵיהֶם כָּלֵל

But according to what we just said – that nr"n are arranged in an integrated, overlapping manner, not one below the other – it would turn out that there is no separation of place i.e. (spiritual) boundary separating them at all,

כִּי הִרִי הֵם שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם בְּמֹחַ שֶׁהוּא הַנְּשָׁמָה שֶׁבָּהֶם

since all three of them are manifested in the brain which is the *neshama*-level among them,

וְשְׁלֹשֶׁתָם בְּלֵב שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ שֶׁבָּהֶם

and all three of them are manifested in the heart which is the *ruach*-level among them,

וְשְׁלֹשֶׁתָם בְּכַבֵּד שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁבָּהֶם

and all three of them are manifested in the liver which is the *nefesh*-level among them.

וְהוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁגַם הֵנֶר"נ דִּהְנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית

This is according to our statement that NR"N of *neshama* at the macro-level

הֵם מִתְפַּשְׁטִים ג"כ וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים עִם הַקֶּצֶה הַיּוֹתֵר תְּחִתּוֹן שֶׁבָּהֶם
בְּהָרוּחַ

also spread forth and become clothed – via their lowest edge – in *ruach*.

וּפְשׁוּט הוּא שְׂאוֹתָן הַבְּחִי' דֵּהֶנֶר"נ הֵם מִתְפַּשְׁטִים וּמִתְחַלְקִים ג"כ

And it is obvious that those aspects of NR"N also spread out and subdivide

ע"ד הַסֵּדֶר דֵּהֶנֶר"נ שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

in the same manner and order as NR"N of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

וְהִרִי הֵווּ שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם בְּהַמוֹחַ וְשְׁלֹשֶׁתָם בְּהַלֵּב וְשְׁלֹשֶׁתָם בְּהַכֵּבֵד

so that all three of them are vested in the brain, all three of them in the heart, and all three of them in the liver.

וא"כ הרי אין חלוק מקומות בין מעלה ומטה בהנר"נ הכלליים

Accordingly, there is no separation i.e. no boundary separating between upper and lower of the macro-level NR"N

אשר בכל פרצוף ופרצוף גופה כלל.

that is in each *partzuf* itself; none at all.

משא"כ בהנר"נ הכלליים דהעולמות הרי הם חלוקים במקומם לגמרי

But this is not so as regards the macro-level NR"N of the Worlds.

שהרי עולם הבריאה שהיא הנשמה הכללית דהעולמות

Thus the World of *Beriah*, which is the macro-level Neshama of the Worlds,

היא עומדת בכל עקרה למעלה

is located entirely there in the upper segment of the map of the Worlds.

ועולם היצירה שהוא הרוח הכללי הוא עומד בכל עקרו באמצע

And the World of *Yetzirah*, which is the macro-level Ruach of the Worlds, is located entirely in the middle segment of the map of the Worlds.

ועולם העשיה שהיא הנפש הכללי היא בכל עקרה למטה

And the World of *Asiyah*, which is the macro-level Nefesh of the Worlds, is located entirely in the lower segment of the map of the Worlds.

והרי לא הוו הנר"נ הכלליים שבהעולמות

Hence the NR"N of the macro-level Worlds

עם הנר"נ הכלליים שבכל פרצוף ופרצוף בסדר אחד כלל

and the NR"N of each macro-level *partzuf* are not of one configuration i.e. they do not parallel each other.

והוא לכאורה קושיא גדולה כי הרי לעיל פ' א' וב'

Now this would seem to present a tremendous difficulty, for above in chapters 1 and 2

אמרנו שסדר מציאת העולמות עם סדר בגין כל פרצוף שוים הם בכל וכל:

we stated that the manner in which the existence of the Worlds is arranged, and the manner in which each *partzuf* is configured, is identical in every respect!

אך הענין בזה הוא כי הרי כבר מתבאר מדברינו לעיל פ"א

However, the solution to this conundrum was already comprehensible from what we said in chapter 1 –

כי כל נר"נ הנה כשם שהם חלוקים בין מעלה ומטה

that in all instances of NR"N, just as there is a distinction between top and bottom i.e. on the vertical plane,

שהנשמה הוא למעלה והרוח באמצע והנפש למטה

so that *neshama* is in the top segment, *ruach* is in the middle segment, and *nefesh* is in the bottom segment,

כן הם חלוקים ג"כ בין פנימי לחיצון

so too are they distinct in terms of inner and outer i.e. on the horizontal plane.

שהנשמה היא בחלק הפנימי שבגוף

Thus the *neshama* is in the inner layer of the body,

והרוח הוא בחלק התיכון והנפש בחלק החיצון

ruach is the central layer, and *nefesh* is in the outer layer.

והרי הם ג' מדרגות בגבה שהם מעלה ואמצע ומטה

Thus there are three levels vertically – top, mid-level, bottom –

וכן ג' מדרגות בעברו שהם פנימי תיכון חיצון

and so too there are three layers horizontally – inner, central and outer.

והנה הם תשע בחי' שהם ראש תוך סוף

Thus in all there are nine aspects: top, middle, bottom – transliterated: *rosh*, *toch*, *sof* –

שכ"א הוא כלול מג' שהם פנימי תיכון חיצון

such that each of them comprises three subdivisions – inner, central, outer –

והנה הם הנר"נ שבנשמה והוא במח

and these are nr"n of *neshama* in the brain;

והנר"נ שברוח והוא בלב

nr"n of *ruach* in the heart;

והנר"נ שבנפש בנפש והוא בכבד והם ט'

and nr"n of *nefesh* in the liver – making 9 altogether, since each of the three macro-levels is subdivided into three.

[ועם שרש הנעלם דכ"א אשר ממנו הוא יוצא ונמשך הוא עשר]

[Author's note: Together with the hidden root of each of them – from which they emerge and are drawn down – there are 10.

וְהֵם בְּחִי הָעֵשָׂר סְפִי שִׁשְׁנָם בַּכ"א

These are the 10 *sefirot* that are in each level:

כִּי הֵנֵר"נ שְׁבַהּ נִשְׁמָה בְּהַפְנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן שְׁבַהּ הֵם חִב"ד [חֲכָמָה, בִּינָה, דַּעַת].

The nr"n of *neshama* in its inner, central and outer layers are *chochmah*, *binah* and *da'at*.

וְהֵנֵר"נ דְּהַרוּחַ בְּהַפְת"ח [פְּנִימִי, תִיכוֹן, חִיצוֹן] שְׁבֹ. הֵם חֲג"ת [חֶסֶד, גְּבוּרָה, תִּפְאָרֶת].

The nr"n of *ruach* in its inner, central and outer layers are *chesed*, *gevurah* and *tiferet*.

וְהֵנֵר"נ דְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּהַפְת"ח שְׁבַהּ הֵם נה"י [נֶצַח, הוֹד, יְסוֹד]

And the nr"n of *nefesh* in its inner, central and outer layers are *netzach*, *hod*, *yesod*.

וְהַמַּלְכוּת הִנֵּה הוּא פְּרָצוּף בַּפִּנ"ע פְּרָצוּף הַנוֹקְבָא

(And *malchut* is an independent *partzuf*, called the *partzuf* of *nukvah*, the female *partzuf*,

שִׁשְׁנָם בָּהּ ג"כ כָּל אוֹתָן הָעֵשָׂר)

which also has all those ten *sefirot* in it). End of author's note.]

וְכ"ז הוּא הֵן בְּכָל־לִוְיֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת וְהֵן בְּפִרְטוֹת כָּל עוֹלָם וְכָל פְּרָצוּף

And all this is so in the Worlds on the macro-level, and also on the micro-level in each world and each *partzuf*,

כִּי כ"א הוּא כָּלֹל מִנֵּר"נ כָּנ"ל

since each of them the macro-levels of NR"N is comprised of micro-level nr"n, as explained above,

וַיִּשְׁנָם בַּכ"א כָּל הַתִּשְׁעָ בְּחִי שֶׁהֵם ג' חֲלָקִי נר"נ וְהֵם הִי סְפִי שֶׁבַכ"א.

such that there is in each of them all nine aspects – the three layers of the inner, central and outer layers of each of NR"N – and these are the ten *sefirot* in each of them.

As explained above: the nr"n of the inner layer (*neshama*) are *chochmah*, *binah* and *da'at*; the nr"n of the central layer (*ruach*) are *chesed*, *gevurah* and *tiferet*; and the nr"n of the outer layer (*nefesh*) are *netzach*, *hod*, *yesod* – plus *malchut*.

וְהִנֵּה הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁהֵם הֵנֶר"נ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

Now in the three worlds, *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, which are the macro-level NR"N,

וַיֵּשְׁנָם בַּכ"א מֵהֶם הִתְשַׁע בְּחִי' הֵנָּה

the nine aspects mentioned are present in each of them.

הִרִי דַעַת לְנִבּוֹן נִקְל³

Behold, (Proverbs 14:6) "...wisdom will come easily to one who understands"⁴

כִּי הֵג' חֲלָקֵי רוּחַ הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בְּרֹאשׁ תוֹךְ סוֹף דְּהִנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית,
שֶׁהִיא עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה,

that the three micro-level aspects of *ruach* – the aspect of *ruach* of *rosh*, *toch*, *sof* of the macro-level *neshama*, which corresponds to the World of *Beriah*,

וְהֵם בְּחֲלָקֵי הַתִּיכוֹן שֶׁבָּהֶם,

are the subsections of their central layer horizontally, since we are referring to *ruach*, the central layer –

הִנֵּה הֵם הַשְּׂרֵשׁ לְכָל עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה כֻּלּוֹ

– they the three micro-level components of the macro-level i.e. macro-level *Neshama* are the root of the entire World of *Yetzirah*,

שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי בְּכָל פְּרָטִיו שָׁבוּ

which is the macro-level *Ruach* with all of its subsections.

וְכֵן הֵג' חֲלָקֵי נֶפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בְּרֹאשׁ תוֹךְ סוֹף דְּהִנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית

Similarly, the three micro-level components of the *rosh*, *toch*, *sof* of the macro-level *neshama*,

שֶׁהוּא בְּחֲלָקֵי הַחִיצוֹן שֶׁבָּהֶם

which is their outer layer horizontally,

הִנֵּה הֵם הַשְּׂרֵשׁ לְכָל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה כֻּלָּה

are the root of the entire World of *Asiyah*,

שֶׁהִיא הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי בְּכָל פְּרָטִיהָ שָׁבָה:

which is the macro-level *Nefesh* with all of its details.

וְהַעֲנִינוּ בְּבִאּוּר הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה מַחֲלָק הָרוּחַ הַפְּרָטִי שֶׁבִּהֵנֶר"נ דְּהִנְשָׁמָה
דְּבְרִיאָה

The explanation of this concept is that from the micro-level *ruach* of nr"n of *neshama* of *Beriah*,

שהוא החלק התיכון שבה

which is its central layer horizontally,

הנה מזה נמשך הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנשמה דהיצירה

from this is drawn the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *neshama* of *Yetzirah* (#1 in Diagram 6)

שהוא החלק הפנימי שבה

which is its inner layer horizontally.

כי מהרום דהנשמה שבהנשמה הכללי נעשה הנשמה שבנשמה
דהרום הכללי

So that from the *ruach* of *neshama* of macro-level Neshama is produced *neshama* of *neshama* of macro-level Ruach. (See Diagram 1 below and #1 in Diagram 6).

אמנם אח"כ מתפשט ומסתעף גם היא לנר"נ

Nevertheless, subsequently it too spreads out and branches out to micro-nr"n

והם הנר"נ שבהנשמה דהיצירה.

and they comprise nr"n of *neshama* in *Yetzirah*.

ומחלק הרום הפרטי דהנר"נ שבהרום דבריא

And from the micro-level *ruach* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Beriah*

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהרום דהיצירה

– from this is drawn down and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *ruach* in *Yetzirah* (#3 in Diagram 6).

כי מרום שבהרום דהנשמה הכללי

Since from *ruach* of *ruach* of the macro-level Neshama

נעשה מזה הנשמה שברום אשר בהרום הכללי

is produced *neshama* of *ruach* of macro-level Ruach. (#3 in Diagram 6)

אמנם אח"כ מתפשט ומסתעף גם היא לנר"נ

Nevertheless, subsequently it too spreads forth and branches out into nr"n –

והם הנר"נ שבהרום דהיצירה.

and comprises the nr"n of *ruach* of *Yetzirah*.

ומחלק הרום הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנפש דבריא

And from the micro-level *ruach* of nr"n of Nefesh of *Beriah*

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנפש דהיצירה

– from this is drawn down and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* (#5 in Diagram 6),

כי מהרום שבנפש דהנשמה הכללי

since from *ruach* of *nefesh* of the macro-level *neshama* in *Beriah*

נעשה מזה הנשמה שבנפש דהרום הכללי

is produced *neshama* of *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach*. (See Diagram 2; #5 in Diagram 6)

אמנם מתפשט ומסתער גם היא לנר"נ והם הנר"נ שבהנפש
דהיצירה

However, it too spreads forth and branches out into nr"n of *nefesh* of *Yetzirah*.

והרי נמשך כל היצירה מהבריאה מהחלק התיכון שבה

Thus the entirety of *Yetzirah* is drawn from *Beriah*, from its central layer (i.e. from *ruach* of *neshama*, *ruach* of *ruach*, and *ruach* of *nefesh*).

ונעשה כל הרום הכללי בכל פרטי הג' חלקי נר"נ שבו

And the entire macro-level *ruach* which is *Yetzirah* is produced with all its micro-level aspects of nr"n

מהרום הפרטי אשר בהג' חלקי נר"נ שבהנשמה הכללי.

from micro-level *ruach* of the three-part nr"n of macro-level *neshama* in *Beriah* — i.e. from *ruach* of *neshama* (#1), from *ruach* of *ruach* (#3), and from *ruach* of *nefesh* (#5).

Diagram 1 — Micro-level *ruach* of *Beriah* as the root of macro-level *ruach* (*Yetzirah*)

<i>Beriah</i> (source)	→	<i>Yetzirah</i> (derived)
<i>ruach</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Yetzirah</i> (#1 in Diagram 6)
<i>ruach</i> of RUACH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of RUACH of <i>Yetzirah</i> (#3 in Diagram 6)
<i>ruach</i> of NEFESH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NEFESH of <i>Yetzirah</i> (#5 in Diagram 6)

Thus the three micro-levels of *ruach* of nr"n of *Beriah* (#1, 3, 5 in Diagram 6) are the respective origins of the three micro-levels of *neshama* in *Yetzirah*.

ועד"ז העולם העשייה שהיא הנפש הכללי בכל הג' חלקי נר"נ שבה

Similarly the World of *Asiyah*, which is the macro-level Nefesh with its three divisions of nr"n,

הנה נעשה היא מכל בחי' הנפש הפרטי

is produced from all the aspects of micro-level *nefesh*

אשר בהג' חלקי נר"נ דעולם הבריאה שהיא הנשמה הכללי

in each of the three aspects of nr"n of the World of *Beriah*, which is the macro-level *neshama* (#2, 4, 6 in Diagram 6),

ומכל בחי' נפש הפרטי אשר בהג' חלקי נר"נ דעולם היצירה שהוא הרוח הכללי

and in addition⁵ from all the micro-levels of *nefesh* in each of the three aspects of nr"n of the World of *Yetzirah*, which is the macro-level *ruach*,

והיינו כי מחלק הנפש הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנשמה דבריאה

i.e. the micro-level of *nefesh* in each of nr"n of *neshama* of the World of *Beriah* (#2, 4, 6 in Diagram 6)

שהוא חלק החיצון שבה

— note that this micro-level of *nefesh* is its outermost layer —

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ

from this outermost layer is drawn and produced the micro-level *neshama* of each of nr"n of *Asiyah* (#2, 4, 6 in Diagram 6),

דהנשמה דהעשיה שהוא החלק הפנימי שבה

such that the *neshama* of the World of *Asiyah* constitutes its inner layer.

כי מהנפש דהנשמה שבהנשמה הכללי

Hence from *nefesh* of *neshama* of the macro-level *neshama* of *Beriah*

נעשה הנשמה שבהנשמה דהנפש הכללי

is produced *neshama* of *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh* of *Asiyah* (#2 in Diagram 6).

והחלק הרוח דהנר"נ שבהנשמה דהעשיה

And the aspect of *ruach* of nr"n of the *neshama* of *Asiyah*

הנה הוא נמשך ונעשה מחלק הנפש דהנר"נ שבהנשמה דהיצירה

is drawn forth and produced from the *nefesh* of nr"n of the *neshama* of *Yetzirah*. (#7 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש דהנשמה שבהרוח הכללי נעשה הרוח דהנשמה
שבהנפש הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* is produced *ruach* of *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh*. (#7 in Diagram 6)

אמנם אם"כ הנה מתפשט גם הוא לאור דבחי' נפש ג"כ

Nevertheless, subsequently it too spreads into the light of the aspect of *nefesh* as well,

והם הנר"נ שבהנשמה דהעשיה.

and they constitute nr"n of the *neshama* of *Asiyah*.

ומחלק הנפש הפרטי דהנר"נ שבהרוח דבריה

And from the micro-level *nefesh* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Beriah*

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהרוח דהעשיה

– from this is drawn and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Asiyah*. (#4 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש שבהרוח דהנשמה הכללי נעשה הנשמה דהרוח
שבהנפש הכללי.

Because from the *nefesh* of *ruach* of macro-level *neshama* of *Beriah*, is produced the *neshama* of *ruach* of macro-level *Nefesh* in *Asiyah*.

וחלק הרוח שבו הנה הוא נמשך ונעשה מחלק הנפש דהנר"נ
דהרוח דהיצירה

And the aspect of *ruach* therein i.e. the *ruach* of *ruach* of *Asiyah*, is drawn down and produced from the *nefesh* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Yetzirah*. (#8 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש שברוח דהרוח הכללי נעשה הרוח דרוח שבהנפש
הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *ruach* of macro-level *ruach* (*Yetzirah*) is produced the *ruach* of *ruach* of macro-level *Nefesh* of *Asiyah*.

אמנם אם"כ הוא מתפשט לאור דבחי' נפש ג"כ

However, subsequently it too spreads into the light of the aspect of *nefesh* as well,

והם הנר"נ שבהרוח דהעשיה.

and they constitute nr"n of the *ruach* of *Asiyah*.

ומחלק הנפש הפרטי דהנר"נ שבהנפש דבריה

And from the micro-level *nefesh* of nr"n of *nefesh* of *Beriah* (#6 in Diagram 6),

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנפש דהעשיה
 – from this is drawn and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *nefesh* of *Asiyah*. (#6 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש שבנפש דהנשמה הכללי נעשה הנשמה שבנפש דהנפש
 הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *nefesh* of macro-level *neshama* is produced the *neshama* of *nefesh* of macro-level *nefesh*.

וחלק הרוח שבה הוא נמשך ונעשה מהנפש דהנר"נ שבהנפש
 דהיצירה

And the aspect of *ruach* therein of *nefesh* of *Asiyah* is drawn down and produced from the *nefesh* of nr"n of *nefesh* of *Yetzirah*.

כי מהנפש שבנפש דהרוח הכללי נעשה הרוח שבנפש שבהנפש
 הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *nefesh* of macro-level *Ruach* (*Yetzirah*) is produced the *ruach* of *nefesh* of macro-level *nefesh* (*Asiyah*). (See Diagram 3, and #9 in Diagram 6).

אמנם אח"כ הוא מתפשט לאור הנפש ג"כ

However, subsequently it too spreads into the light of the aspect of *nefesh* as well,

והם הנר"נ דהנפש דהעשיה.

and they comprise nr"n of the *nefesh* of *Asiyah*.

Diagram 2 — Micro-level *nefesh* of *Beriah* as the root of macro-level *Neshama* of *Nefesh* (*Asiyah*)

<i>Beriah</i> (source)	→	<i>Asiyah</i> (derived)
<i>nefesh</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Asiyah</i> (#2)
<i>nefesh</i> of RUACH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of RUACH of <i>Asiyah</i> (#4)
<i>nefesh</i> of NEFESH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NEFESH of <i>Asiyah</i> (#6)

Diagram 3 — Micro-level *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* as the root of macro-level *Ruach* of *Nefesh* (*Asiyah*)

<i>Yetzirah</i> (source)	→	<i>Asiyah</i> (derived)
<i>nefesh</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Yetzirah</i>	→	Root of <i>ruach</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Asiyah</i> (#7)
<i>nefesh</i> of RUACH of <i>Yetzirah</i>	→	Root of <i>ruach</i> of RUACH of <i>Asiyah</i> (#8)
<i>nefesh</i> of NEFESH of <i>Yetzirah</i>	→	Root of <i>ruach</i> of NEFESH of <i>Asiyah</i> (#9)

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי בָנִינוּ כָּל הָעֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁהִיא הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי

Thus we find that constructing the World of *Asiyah*, which is the macro-level Nefesh –

בְּכָל פְּרָטִי הֵג' חֲלָקִי נר"נ שְׁבָה

in each of the three aspects of nr"n thereof of the World of *Asiyah* –

הֵנָּה הוּא מֵהֵג' חֲלָקִי נֶפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִיִּים דְּהַנֶּשְׁמָה וְהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

is from the three micro-level aspects of *nefesh* of macro-level *neshama* and *Ruach*,

שֶׁהֵם הַבְּרִיאָה וְהַיְצִירָה

which are i.e. correspond to the Worlds of *Beriah* and *Yetzirah* respectively,

וְהוּא מַחֲלֵק הַחִיצוֹן שְׁבָהֶם.

and are of their outer layer.⁶

וְכֹן הָרִי נִמְצָא ג"כ כִּי עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה הִיא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ וְהַנֶּשְׁמָה לְהַיְצִירָה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה.

We also find that the World of *Beriah* is the root and the *neshama* of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*,

וְעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה הוּא הָרוּחַ לְהַבְּרִיאָה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה,

and that *Yetzirah* is the *ruach* of *Beriah* and *Asiyah*,

וְעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הִיא הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְהַבְּרִיאָה וְהַיְצִירָה.

and that *Asiyah* is the *nefesh* of *Beriah* and *Yetzirah*.

כִּי עֶקֶר הַגִּלּוּי דְרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר נִעְשָׂה בְּהַבְּרִיאָה

This is because the primary emergence of *ruach* and *nefesh* generated in *Beriah*

הוּא רַק אַחֵר שֶׁיֵּצֵא וְנִעְשָׂה עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה

is only after the Worlds of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* emerge and are produced.

The primary aspect of *Beriah* is *neshama* (since it characterizes *Beriah* on the macro-level) and therefore it has no 'need' for *ruach* and *nefesh*. However, once *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* are created, the *ruach* of *Beriah* becomes the source of the *neshama* of *Yetzirah* (#a in Diagram 6), and *nefesh* of *Beriah* becomes the source of the *neshama* of *Asiyah* (#b in Diagram 6).

אֲבָל מִקֵּדָם הָיָה כָּל בְּחִי' רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה רַק בְּכֹחַ וְלֹא בִפְעֻלָּה.

But prior to this, any aspect of *ruach* and *nefesh* in the World of *Beriah* was only in potential, but was not actualized.

וַיֵּצֵא הָרוּחַ בְּבְרִיָּא מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל רַק לְצֶרֶךְ הַמְצִיאוֹת
דְּהִיצִירָה וְעַל יָדוֹ

Thus *ruach* emerged from a state of potential to actual in *Beriah* only for the requirements of the existence of *Yetzirah*, and by way thereof.

וְכֵן הַגְּלוּי דְּמְצִיאוֹת הַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּא וְהִיצִירָה

And likewise the emergence of the actualization of *nefesh* in the Worlds of *Beriah* and *Yetzirah*

הוּא רַק לְצֶרֶךְ הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה וְעַל יָדָהּ דְּוָקָא

is only for the requirements of the existence of *Asiyah*, and precisely by way thereof.

nefesh of *Beriah* is required for *neshama* of *Asiyah* (#b in Diagram 6), and *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* is required for *ruach* of *Asiyah* (#c in Diagram 6).

וְהָרִי הָיָה הָעֲשִׂיָּה הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְשִׁנְיָהּם וְהִיצִירָה הָרוּחַ לְשִׁנְיָהּם
וְהַבְּרִיָּא נִשְׁמָה לְשִׁנְיָהּם

Thus *Asiyah* constitutes the *nefesh* of both of them – of *Beriah* and *Yetzirah*; and *Yetzirah* constitutes the *ruach* of both of them – of *Beriah* and *Asiyah*; and *Beriah* constitutes the *neshama* of both of them – of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*.

כִּי לֹא נִתְגַּלּוּ כ"א בְּכָל הַג' בְּחִי' נר"נ שְׁבוּ אֶלָּא ע"י שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם דְּוָקָא

This is because none of them became revealed in all three aspects of its nr"n, other than precisely by way of all three of them.

אֲבָל מִקֵּדָם שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם כ"א עַל שְׁלֵמוֹתוֹ הָיָה כ"א רַק בְּבִחִינָתוֹ
לְבַד

But prior to all three emerging in a state of completion with all three aspects of nr"n, each of them possessed only its own aspect –

הַבְּרִיָּא בְּבִחִי' נִשְׁמָה וְהִיצִירָה רוּחַ וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה נֶפֶשׁ

Beriah had only *neshama*, *Yetzirah* had only *ruach*, and *Asiyah* had only *nefesh*
–

וְשָׂאָר הַב' בְּחִי' הָיָה בַּכ"א רַק בְּכֹחַ וְלֹא בַּפֶּעַל

while the other two aspects were only in potential in each of them, but were not actualized.

וְנִגְמַר וְנִשְׁלַם כ"א רַק ע"י שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם דְּוָקָא וְהָרִי הֵם כְּלוּלִים זֶה בְּזֶה

Hence each one of them becomes complete and fulfilled only by way of all three of them, and thus they are all inter-included, one with the other.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר הַסֵּפֶר יְצִירָה פ"א מִשְׁנָה ז'

And this is what it states in *Sefer Yetzirah*, chapter 1 mishnah 7:

עֶשֶׂר סְפִי בְּלִימָה נְעוּץ סוּפֵן בְּתַחֲלָתוֹ וּתְחִלָּתוֹ בְּסוּפֵן

"The ten *sefirot* without substance (*bli mah*, meaning 'of incomprehensible nature') – their end is wedged in their beginning, and their beginning in their end."

וְהוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאֱמָרְנוּ כִּי הֵם מְשֻׁרָשִׁים וְכְלוּלִים זֶב"ז

This is according to what we said above that they are rooted in each other, and are inter-included with one another,

וּמִתְגַּלִּים זֶה ע"י זֶה וְנִמְשָׁכִים וְנִנְעָשִׁים זֶה מִזֶּה:

and become revealed one via the other, and they are drawn from and produced from each other.

וְהִנֵּה הַג' חֲלָקֵי נר"נ אֲשֶׁר אֱמָרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְכֵן בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

Now regarding the three sections called nr"n which we stated are in every World, and in every *partzuf* –

הִנֵּה הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּהַנְשָׁמָה הוּא בְּחִי הַנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם
וְשֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

The nr"n of *neshama* is the aspect of macro-level Neshama in each World and in each *partzuf*.

The *neshama* level of each World and the *neshama* level of each *partzuf* of that World ultimately derive from the macro-macro-level Neshama of *Beriah*.

וְהַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּהַרוּחַ הוּא בְּחִי רוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם וְשֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

And the nr"n of *ruach* is the aspect of macro-level Ruach in each World and in each *partzuf*.

The *ruach* level of each World ultimately derives from the macro-macro-level *ruach* of *Yetzirah*.

וְהַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּנֶפֶשׁ הוּא בְּחִי נֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם וְשֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

And the nr"n of *nefesh* is the aspect of macro-level Nefesh in each World and in each *partzuf*.

The *nefesh* level of each World ultimately derives from the macro-macro-level *nefesh* of *Asiyah*.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הַנֶּר"נ הַכִּלְלִיִּים שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם וְשֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

Thus we find that the macro-level nr"n in each of the Worlds and in each *partzuf*

הנה הם ג"כ באמת רק זה למעלה מזה לגמרי

are also in fact only arrayed one completely above the other without overlap,

כי הרי הם מסודרים בראש תוך סוף

so that they are arranged in the manner of *rosh, toch, sof* – or top, middle, bottom – with no overlap.

והרי הם זה למעלה מזה לגמרי כמו הנר"נ דכללי כללות⁷

Hence they are arrayed one completely above the other, just like the NR" N of the macro-macro-level,

שהם העולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה שהם זה למעלה מזה לגמרי

– i.e. the general or macro-macro-level Worlds of *Beriah, Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, which are arrayed one completely above the other with no overlap,

שהקרקע דהעליון הוא הגג דהתחתון

so that the floor of the upper World is the roof of the lower World,

כי הם בבחי' עליות זו על גבי זו וכמ"ש הרב בשער דרושי אבי"ע פ' י"ד

and they are like the ascending floors of a building, one on top of the other, as Rabbi Chaim Vital writes in the name of the Arizal in *Eitz Chaim, Shaar Drushei Abiy*"a chapter 14.

כן הוא ג"כ הבחי' נר"נ הכלליים שבכל עולם ושבכל פרצוף

And so too regarding the aspect of macro-level nr"n in each World and in each *partzuf* –

הם זה למעלה מזה עד שבמקום שמסתיים העליון שם מתחיל התחתון

they too are arrayed one above the other to the extent that where the upper one ends, only then does the lower one begin, and again there is no overlap.

אלא שעכ"ז המה הם כלולים זב"ז ג"כ

Nevertheless, they are all inter-included one with the other as well.

Even though each level is distinct and there is no overlap between the Worlds or between the *partzufim*, the inner structure of all the Worlds is similar, as will be explained.

והוא ע"י כי מה שהם יורדים זה מזה ע"י שהם מסדרים בראש תוך
סוף

This is due to the fact that although they descend from one another since they are arrayed in the manner of *rosh, toch, sof* (top, middle, bottom – vertically),

הנה הם חוזרים ועולים זב"ז ע"י הסדר דפנימי תיכון חיצון
they also return and ascend via one another due to their inner configuration of inner, central and outer layers horizontally.

כי התך והתיכון הם משרש אחד ונעשים לבחי' אחת

The inner layer horizontally and the middle section vertically stem from the same root and become one composite aspect.

וכן הסוף והחיצון שהם משרש אחד נעשים לבחי' אחת.

Also the bottom section (*sof*) and the outer layer (*chitzon*) stem from the same root and become one composite aspect.

והרי נמצא כי הגם שהם יורדים זה מזה עכ"ז הנה הם חוזרים
ועולים זה בזה

Thus we find that they descend from one another, nevertheless, they also return and ascend into one another,

והם עומדים כלולים זב"ז לעולם.

and they always maintain their inter-included state.

וכ"ז הנה הוא הן בכל עולם ובכל פרצופים הפרטיים

Now all of this is in each of the worlds and in all of the micro-level *partzufim*

והן בהעולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה הכלליים

as well as in the macro-macro-worlds of *Beriah, Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*.

והרי לנו כי האמת הוא שהכלל והפרט הם שניהם מסדרים בסדר
אחד

Thus we come to the conclusion that in truth the macro-macro-level i.e. NR"N and their sub-levels i.e. nr"n are arranged in the identical manner –

כי הרי בשניהם הוה עקר הנשמה הכללית למעלה

since in both of them the primary aspect of macro-level *neshama* is above at the top,

ועקר רוח הכללי באמצע ועקר הנפש הכללי למטה

and the primary aspect of macro-level *ruach* is in the middle, and the primary aspect of macro-level *nefesh* is below at the bottom.

אֵלָא שֶׁ"י הַסֵּדֶר דֵּהֶפְנִימִי תִיכּוֹן חִיצוֹן שְׁבָהֶם

However, via the arrangement of inner, central and outer,

הֵנָּה כָּלּוּל הַנְּשָׁמָה דכ"א שְׁבִשְׁנֵיהֶם לְמַטָּה ג"כ⁸

the *neshama* of each level in both of them is integrated below into the Worlds of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* as well,

וְהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ דכ"א שְׁבִשְׁנֵיהֶם לְמַעְלָה ג"כ וְהֵם כָּלּוּלִים זב"ז
לְעוֹלָם:

and the *nefesh* and *ruach* of each level in both of them is above in *Beriah*⁹ as well, and they are forever inter-included with one another.

וְהֵנָּה כְּאֶשֶׁר תִּתְּבוּגֵן בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ הַלָּלוּ

Now when you contemplate all of these words of ours,

תָּבִין כִּי עֲצָמוֹת הָעֵקָרִי דֵּהֶנְשָׁמָה¹⁰

you will understand that what we refer to primarily as 'the *neshama* itself'

הֵנָּה הוּא וְכָךְ חֵלֶק הַנְּשָׁמָה הַפְּרָטִי מֵהֵנָּה נ שְׁבִשְׁנֵיהֶם

is actually only the micro-level aspect of *neshama* of nr"n of macro-level *Neshama*

וְהוּא חֵלֶק הַפְּנִימִי דֵּהֶנְשָׁמָה הָעוֹמֵד לְמַעְלָה שֶׁהוּא הַנְּשָׁמָה
דְּנֶשְׁמָה.

i.e. the inner aspect of the *Neshama* as it is above, that is to say, the *neshama* of macro-level *Neshama*.

וְעֲצָמוֹת הָעֵקָרִי דֵּהָרוּחַ הֵנָּה הוּא וְכָךְ חֵלֶק הָרוּחַ הַפְּרָטִי מֵהֵנָּה נ
דְּהָרוּחַ

And what we refer to primarily as 'the *ruach* itself' is actually only the micro-level aspect of *ruach* of nr"n of macro-level *Ruach*

וְהוּא חֵלֶק הַתִּיכּוֹן דֵּהָרוּחַ הָעוֹמֵד בְּאֶמְצַע שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ דְּרוּחַ.

which is the central layer horizontally of the *ruach* that is situated in the middle vertically, that is to say the *ruach* of macro-level *Ruach*.

וְעֲצָמוֹת הָעֵקָרִי דֵּהַנֶּפֶשׁ הֵנָּה הוּא וְכָךְ חֵלֶק הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִי מֵהֵנָּה נ
שְׁבִשְׁנֵיהֶם

And what we refer to primarily as 'the *nefesh* itself' is actually only the micro-level aspect of *nefesh* of nr"n of macro-level *Nefesh*

וְהִיא הַחֵלֶק הַתְּתוּנָה וְהַחִיצוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ דְּנֶפֶשׁ.

which is the lowest and outermost layer, that is to say the *nefesh* of macro-level Nefesh.

Diagram 4 — The primary aspect of each soul-level¹¹

Vertical section	Horizontal layers	Primary aspect
NESHAMA (top)	inner / central / outer	<i>neshama</i> of nr"n
RUACH (middle)	inner / central / outer	<i>ruach</i> of nr"n
NEFESH (bottom)	inner / central / outer	<i>nefesh</i> of nr"n

וְהָרִי הָזֶה עֶקֶר הַנִּשְׁמָה רַק הַפְּנִימִי דִּהְעֵלִיּוֹן

Thus the primary aspect of *neshama* is the inner layer of the uppermost level,

וְעֶקֶר הַנֶּפֶשׁ רַק הַחִיצוֹן דִּהִתְחַתּוֹן

and the primary aspect of *nefesh* is the outer layer of the lowest level,

וְעֶקֶר הָרוּחַ הוּא רַק הָאֶמְצָעִי דְאֶמְצָעִי.

and the primary aspect of *ruach* is the central layer of the middle section.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי גַם בְּעֶצְמוֹת הָעֶקֶרִי שְׁבָהֵם

Thus we find that even in terms of the primary aspect of what they are,

הָרִי הָזֶה ג"כ עֶקֶר הַנִּשְׁמָה לְמַעַלָּה וּמִבְּפָנִים,

the main aspect of *neshama* is also at the topmost level and innermost layer,

וְעֶקֶר הָרוּחַ בְּאֶמְצָע וּבִתְיֻכּוֹן

and the main aspect of *ruach* is in the mid-level and the central layer,

וְעֶקֶר הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְמַטָּה וּבַחִיצוֹן:

and the main aspect of *nefesh* is also at the bottom-most and outermost level.

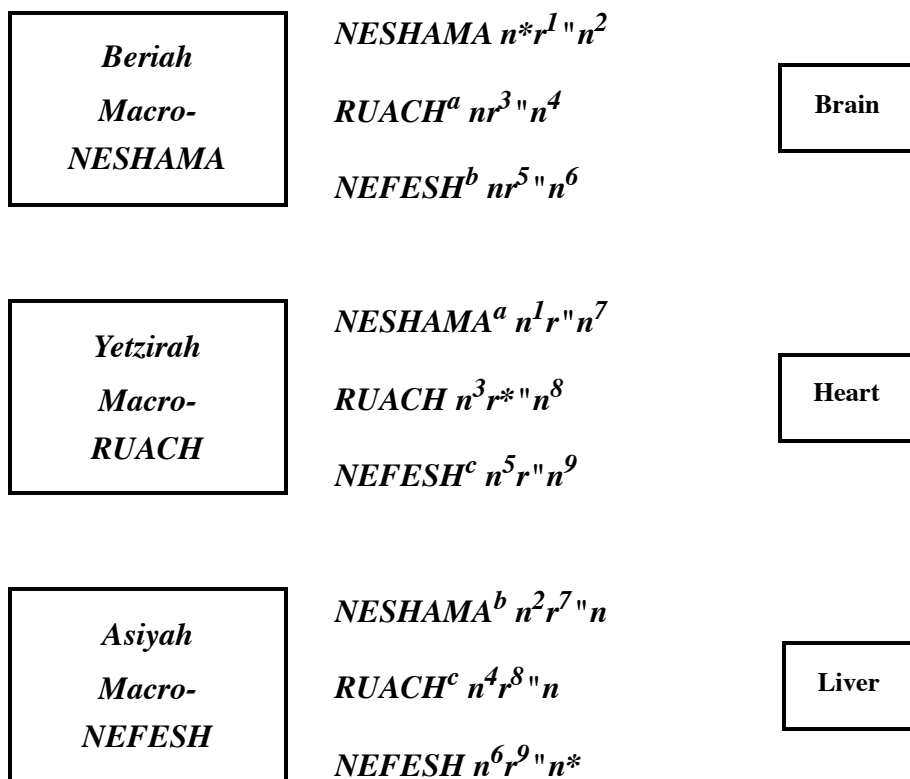
Diagram 5 — The nine aspects with the ten *sefirot*¹²

	Inner (<i>pnimi</i>)	Central (<i>tichon</i>)	Outer (<i>chitzon</i>)	Soul- level	Organ
Top (<i>rosh</i>)	<i>chochmah</i>	<i>binah</i>	<i>da'at</i>	<i>neshama</i>	Brain – מוח
Middle (<i>toch</i>)	<i>chesed</i>	<i>gevurah</i>	<i>tiferet</i>	<i>ruach</i>	Heart – לב
Bottom (<i>sof</i>)	<i>netzach</i>	<i>hod</i>	<i>yesod</i>	<i>nefesh</i>	Liver – כבד

Diagram 6 — Inter-level correspondences¹³

In Diagram 6: The root of *neshama* of *Yetzirah* is from *ruach* of *Beriah* (**a**); the root of the *neshama* of *Asiyah* is from *nefesh* of *Beriah* (**b**); the root of the *ruach* of *Asiyah* is from *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* (**c**).

The nine aspects of *rosh*, *toch*, *sof* are depicted below. Soul-levels in CAPS are the macro-levels. The raised numbers show the relationship between each higher micro-level and the lower micro-level that derives from it.



* The primary reflection of this soul-level

אֲמָנָם סֶדֶר יִצְיָאָתָם זֶה מִזֶּה וְכָל מִצְיָאָת פְּרִטִּיָּהִם

However, the way they emerge one from the other, and the manner of emergence of all their sub-levels the micro-levels of nr^n –

הרי כבר אמרנו כי הנשמה שבהרוח הכללי אשר בלב

we already discussed – that the *neshama* of macro-level Ruach in the heart (#a in Diagram 6)

הנה היא נמשך ונעשה מהרוח שבמוח

is drawn down and produced from the *ruach* in the brain, (#a in Diagram 6)

שהיא הרוח שבהנשמה הכללי

which is the *ruach* of macro-macro-level Neshama.

כי מהרוח שבנשמה נעשה נשמה שברוח

Because from *ruach* of macro-macro-level Neshama is produced *neshama* of macro-macro-level Ruach,

והיא מתפשט ומסתעף לכל הנר"נ שבו שהם הנר"נ דהרוח הכללי.

which spreads forth and branches out to all of its nr"n, which is the nr"n of macro-level *ruach*.

וכן הנשמה שבהנפש הכללי אשר בהכבד

And similarly, the *neshama* of macro-macro-level Nefesh in the liver (#b in Diagram 6)

הנה היא נמשך ונעשה מהנפש שבהנשמה הכללי אשר במוח

is drawn down and produced from the *nefesh* of macro-macro-level Neshama in the brain,

כי מהנפש דהנשמה נעשה הנשמה שבנפש.

because from *nefesh* of Neshama is produced *neshama* of Nefesh.

והרוח דהנפש הכללי אשר בכבד הנה הוא נעשה מהנפש אשר

בהרוח הכללי שבלב

Now *ruach* of macro-macro-level Nefesh in the liver is produced from *nefesh* of macro-macro-level Ruach in the heart, (#c in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש דהרוח נעשה הרוח שבנפש.

because from *nefesh* of macro-macro-level Ruach is produced *ruach* of macro-macro-level Nefesh.

ונמצא כי הרוח והנפש שבהנשמה הכללי שבמוח

Thus we find that *ruach* and *nefesh* respectively of macro-level Neshama in the brain

הם השורש להנשמה שבהרוח הכללי שבלב

are the root of *neshama* of macro-macro-level Ruach in the heart

וְהַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבַּהֲנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְי שֶׁבְּכַבֵּד.

and of *neshama* of macro-macro-level Nefesh in the liver.

וְכֹן לֹא נִתְגַּלָּה מְצִיאוֹתָם בַּהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי

In addition, the presence of *ruach* and *nefesh* in the macro-macro-level Neshama was not revealed

אֶלָּא רַק לְצַרֵּךְ הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְיִים וְעַל יָדָם דּוֹקָא

other than for the requirements of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*, and explicitly via them, as was explained previously.

אֲבָל קִדְּם שֶׁהִגִּיעַ עֵת הַמְצִיאוֹת דִּהְרוּם וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְיִים

But prior to the advent of the proper time for revealing the presence of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

הָיוּ הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִיִּים שֶׁבַּהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי רַק בְּכַח לְבַד וְלֹא בְּפֶעַל

the micro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of macro-level Neshama were only in a state of potential, but were not actualized.

וְהָיוּ בְּכַח בַּחֲנִינֵת הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבָּהּ שֶׁהִיא הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּנִשְׁמָה.

Instead, they were in a state of potential in the aspect of *neshama*, that is to say *neshama* of Neshama.

אֲמָנָם אוֹתָהּ הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּנִשְׁמָה שֶׁהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְיִית

However, that level of *neshama* of Neshama, which is the macro-level *neshama* of Neshama,

הִנֵּה הִיא אֵינָה שְׂרֵשׁ לְשׁוּם דָּבָר כִּי הִיא רַק עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתָהּ גּוֹפָה

is not a source for anything else, since it is just primary existence itself.

Accordingly, there is no link to the levels below it, as we see clearly in Diagram 6, where n (*neshama* of Neshama) is not marked with any raised letter or number.

וּר"ל שֶׁהִיא אֵינָה לְצַרֵּךְ זֹלָתָהּ אֶלָּא לְצַרֵּךְ עַצְמוֹ

Meaning to say, it is not for the sake of something else, but rather for its own sake,

כִּי הִיא עֶקֶר עַצְמוֹתָהּ וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ לְעִיל בְּסֻמוֹךְ

since this is its primary essence, as we just explained above –

כִּי עֶקֶר עַצְמוֹת דִּהְנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי הוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּנִשְׁמָה.

the primary essence of the macro-level *neshama* is the *neshama* of *neshama*.

וְעַד"ז הוּא בִּהְרוּם הַכִּלְי שֶׁבִּלְב

Similarly regarding macro-level *ruach* in the heart –

כִּי הַנֶּפֶשׁ שָׁבוּ הִנֵּה הִיא הַשָּׁרֵשׁ לְהָרוּם שֶׁבְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי אֲשֶׁר בִּכְבֹּד
וּכְנֻזָּר

the micro-level of *nefesh* therein i.e. *nefesh* of *ruach* is the root of *ruach* of
macro-level *nefesh* in the liver, as mentioned above.

וְלֹא נִתְגַּלָּה אוֹתוֹ הַנֶּפֶשׁ שָׁבוּ אֶלָּא רַק לְצַרְךָ הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי וְעַל יְדֵה
דְּוָקָא

Now this micro-level *nefesh* was not revealed therein in *ruach* other than for the
needs of the macro-level *nefesh*.

אָבֵל קֹדֶם שֶׁהִגִּיעַ עַת הַמְצִיאוֹת דֵּהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי

But, prior to the advent of the proper time for the presence of the macro-level
nefesh to become revealed,

הָיָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִי שֶׁבְּהָרוּם הַכִּלְלִי רַק בְּכֹחַ לִבָּד וְלֹא בִּפְעֹל

the micro-level *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach* was only in a state of potential, and
was not actualized.

וְהָיָה בְּכֹחַ בְּהָרוּם שָׁבוּ שֶׁהוּא הָרוּם דָּרוּם.

Instead, it was in a state of potential in the aspect of *ruach*, that is to say *ruach*
of *ruach*.

אָמְנָם אוֹתוֹ הָרוּם דָּרוּם שֶׁהוּא הָרוּם דָּרוּם הַכִּלְלִי

However, *ruach* of *ruach*, that is the micro-level *ruach* of macro-level *ruach*,

הִנֵּה הוּא אֵינוֹ שָׁרֵשׁ לְשׁוּם דָּבָר ר"ל שֶׁהוּא אֵינוֹ לְצַרְךָ זֹלָתוֹ

is not the root of anything. Meaning to say it is not there for the sake of
something else,

אֶלָּא שֶׁהוּא עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה וְכֵן"ל בְּסִמּוֹךְ

but rather its primary existence is for itself, as was just explained –

שֶׁעֶקֶר הָעֲצָמוֹת דֵּהָרוּם הַכִּלְלִי הוּא הָרוּם דָּרוּם.

since the primary essence of macro-level *ruach* is *ruach* of *ruach*.

וְהַנֶּשְׁמָה שָׁבוּ ר"ל הַנֶּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּהָרוּם הַכִּלְלִי

And the level of *neshama* therein, meaning to say *neshama* of macro-level
ruach,

הִנֵּה הִיא בְּחִי' תְּלִיתוֹ לְמַעַלָּה בְּהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי, ¹⁴

is linked in to the level above, to the macro-level *neshama*,

וכן"ל שהיא מהרוח שבהנשמה הכללי

as was explained previously – that it is from *ruach* of macro-level *neshama* (#3 in the diagram above).

To recap: the root of the *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* (corresponding to *Yetzirah*) is from *ruach* of *neshama* (corresponding to *Beriah*); the root of the *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh* (corresponding to *Asiyah*) is from *nefesh* of *Beriah*; the root of the *ruach* of macro-level *nefesh* (corresponding to *Asiyah*) is from *nefesh* of *Yetzirah*.

ועומד הנשמה שברוח בבחי' המציאות

And the *neshama* of *ruach* is in the state of actualized existence – unlike the *ruach* and *nefesh* levels of *ruach*, which were only in a state of potential but were not actualized –

אשר בה ועל ידה הוא קשור למעלה בהנשמה הכללי

so that in it, and via it – in and via the *ruach* of *neshama* – it the *neshama* of *ruach* is bound up above to the macro-level *neshama*.

וכן יש להנשמה הכללי ג"כ בחי' אחת המרמז על תלייתה למעלה

[Author's Note: Similarly, the macro-level *neshama* also has an aspect that hints to its being linked in to a higher level –

והוא ספירת הכתר המרמז בקיצו של י' דהוי"ה הכללית שבנשמה

to the *sefirah* of *Keter*, hinted to by the 'thorn' on top of the letter *yud* of the macro-level Name Y-H-V-H of the *neshama*,

שהיא ספירת העשרית העליונה אשר אמרנו לעיל בדברנו

which is the tenth *sefirah* above, counting from below to above, as we mentioned previously.

שהיא השורש הנעלם שבה. והבן.]

And this is the hidden root of the macro-level *neshama*. Understand this well.
End of author's note.]

ועד"ז הנפש הכללי שהיא בכבד כי הנה הנפש שבה הוא עקר
מציאותה גופה

Similarly regarding macro-level *nefesh* in the liver –

כי הנה הנפש שבה הוא עקר מציאותה גופה

the micro-level of *nefesh* therein i.e. *nefesh* of *nefesh* is its primary existence,

שהוא עצמותה העקרי וכמו שאמרנו לעיל בסמוך

since this is its primary essence, as we just explained above.

שְׁעֵצְמוֹת הָעֶקְרִי דִּהְנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלִּי הוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ שְׁבִנְפֶשׁ

Since the primary essence of the macro-level *nefesh* is the *nefesh* of *nefesh*.

וְהָרוּחַ שָׁבָה הוּא תְּלִיטָה לְמַעְלָה

And the aspect of *ruach* therein in the macro-level *nefesh* links the *nefesh* in to a higher level –

וּר"ל כִּי הוּא בְּחִי' הַמְּצִיאוֹת אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ וְעַל יָדוֹ הִיא קְשׁוּרָה לְמַעְלָה
בְּהָרוּחַ הַכִּלִּי

meaning to say that it is that 'entity' in which and through which it the *nefesh* is bound above into macro-level *ruach* – #9 in the diagram above.

וְהַנֶּשְׁמָה שָׁבָה הוּא תְּלִיטָה לְמַעְלָה בְּהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּי

And the aspect of *neshama* therein of *nefesh* links the *nefesh* in to macro-level *neshama* – #6 in the Diagram 6.

כִּי מִהַנֶּשְׁמָה וְהָרוּחַ הַכִּלִּיִּים נִמְשָׁךְ וְנִעָשָׂה הַנֶּשְׁמָה וְהָרוּחַ שָׁבָה

Because from macro-level *neshama* and *ruach*, is drawn down and produced therein in macro-level *neshama* #2 in the diagram and *ruach* #4 in the diagram respectively.

וּבָהֶם הִיא קְשׁוּרָה לְמַעְלָה וְהוּא עֲצֻמוֹתָהּ הָעֶקְרִי שָׁבָה, שֶׁהִיא
הַנֶּפֶשׁ שְׁבִנְפֶשׁ

And via them it the macro-level *nefesh* is bound up above, and this – *nefesh* of *nefesh* – is the primary essence thereof of macro-level *nefesh*.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ אֵיךְ שֶׁהֵם כְּלוּלִים זֶה בְּזֶה וּכְנִז'.

Thus we have the manner in which one is inter-included in the other, as mentioned,

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאָר לָנוּ בַּכ"ז בַּעֲזֵה"י כֹּל הָעֲנִין עַל נִכּוֹן:

and thus the entire matter – each subject in the proper way – has been explained, with God's help.

Footnotes

1. In the previous chapter. ↩

2. Makover. ↩

3. משלי יד, ו: [בְּקֶשׁ לֵץ חֲכָמָה וְאִין] וְדַעַת לְנִבּוֹן נָקַל. ↩

4. A person who understands these matters can deduce that the micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of the World of *Beriah* constitute the root of the

- micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of the Worlds of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, as will be explained at length in the following paragraphs (Makover). ↩
5. The World of *Beriah* as well as the World of *Yetzirah* both have a hand in producing the World of *Asiyah* – *Beriah* donates the micro-level *neshama* of all of nr"n of *Asiyah*, while *Yetzirah* donates the micro-level *ruach* of all of nr"n of *Asiyah*. ↩
 6. Makover. ↩
 7. I.e. in the most general sense, ignoring the subsets. ↩
 8. Makover. ↩
 9. Makover. ↩
 10. It seems that the Baal HaLeshem is not actually referring to the essence of the soul here, although one could have interpreted it that way. Hence we have rendered it "primarily as 'the *neshama* itself'" rather than "the primary essence of the *neshama*." Similarly when he refers to *ruach* and *nefesh* in the next paragraphs. ↩
 11. Based on a diagram in Makover. ↩
 12. Based on diagrams in Makover. ↩
 13. Based on Makover. ↩
 14. can be translated literally as "is dependent upon." תליתו
 However, the intention here is more like "hangs down from"
 ↩ "...or "dangles down from" – hence "is linked in to

Chapter 6 — Ruakh and nefesh are the basis of creation as we know it. They are intertwined from above via the neshama.

Shaar 3 Chapter 6

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה - הקדמות ושערים - שער ג פרק ו
אָמַנְם הָרִי עֲדִין הַדָּבָר צָרִיךְ בָּאוּר כִּי הָרִי אָמַנְנוּ לְעֵיל ספ"ב ופ"ד

However, this matter still requires some explanation, because as we said above (end of chapter 2 and chapter 4)

שָׁכַל הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית עֲצָמָה הִנֵּה הִיא לְעוֹלָם רַק אוֹר אֱלֹהוּת
– the entire macro-level neshama itself is always only Godly light,

וְאֵין לָהּ כְּלִי כָּלל בְּהַגּוּף לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ
and it does not have any ‘receptacle’ in the body at all in which to be clothed,

כִּי אֵין לָהּ הַשְׁתּוּוּת עִם שׁוּם גּוּף וְכִלִּי
since it the neshama has no equivalence or affinity to a body or vessel of any sort.

Since the neshama is nothing less than a lofty spiritual existence, while the body is a lowly material entity, there is no affinity at all between them. How then can they interface with each other?

וְעַקֵּר הַמַּחֲ אֲשֶׁר הוּא כְּלִי לְהַנִּשְׁמָה הִנֵּה הוּא רַק לְהַנִּשְׁמָה שְׂבָרוֹחַ
And that primary aspect of the brain that is a receptacle to the neshama is only as regards neshama of ruach , but not neshama itself.

וּא " כ הָרִי יִהְיֶה נִמְצָא לִפִּי " ז שְׂמִכָּל הַנֵּר " נ ח " י הַכִּלְלִי
If this is so, it would therefore turn out that of all the aspects of macro level nr”n ch”y 1

אֲשֶׁר יֵשׁ לָהֶם הַשְׁתּוּוּת עִם הַגּוּף הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי
וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי

that could have any affinity or potential interface with a body, there are only two: macro- ruach and macro- nefesh .

כִּי הֵם אוֹרוֹת נִבְרָאִים כְּמוֹ הַגּוּף
This is because they are created 2 light 3 , similar to a body which is also created.

Even though ruach and nefesh are spiritual existences, they are nevertheless created spiritual existences. Since they are created , they have some affinity with

the physical body.

וְהֵם אֲשֶׁר מְשֻׁתָּפוּיִם עִמּוֹ לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ

These – macro- ruach and macro- nefesh – are the ones the only levels of soul that have some affinity with the body , and therefore can interface with the physical body to become clothed in it.

אָבֵל מִהִנְשָׁמָה וְלִמְעָלָה וְהִיא בְּכָלֵל הוּא רַק אֹר אֶלּוֹהֵי הַמָּאִיר
בְּהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ

But from the macro-level of neshama and up , including the level of neshama itself , there is only the Godly light illuminating ruach and nefesh,

לְהַשְׁפִּיעַ בָּהֶם שֹׁפַע הַחַיּוּת לְהַחְיֹת אֶת הַגּוּף

that flows into them in a stream of life-force that enlivens the body.

אָבֵל הִיא בְּעֶצְמָהּ אֵין לָהּ הַשְׁתּוּוּת עִם שׁוּם גּוּף וְכָלִי לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ
כָּלֵל

But the macro-level of neshama itself does not have any affinity at all with any type of body or vessel keli (kelim in the plural) in which it could be clothed.

וְאֵל " כִּי הָרִי צָרִיךְ בְּאוֹר לִפִּי " זֵכִי לָמָּה נִסְדְּרוּ ג' כָּלִים בְּהַגּוּף שֶׁהֵם
מִחַ לֵב כִּבְד

Accordingly, we need an explanation as to why there are three receptacles set up in the body – the brain, the heart and the liver,

וּפְנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן שֶׁהֵם כָּלִים לַהֲנֵר " נִשְׁבָּכָל פְּרָצוּף

arrayed as inner, intermediate and outer layers – which are the kelim for the neshama, ruach and nefesh in every partzuf .

וְכֵן בְּכָלֵלוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת הַנִּבְרָאִים שֶׁהֵם ג' כִּי ג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה
יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה

And so too as regards the created Worlds in general – the three Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, but not Atzilut, which is emanated, not created,

וְאֶמְרָנוּ כִּי הֵם לַהֲנֵר " נִהְכָּלָלִים

and as we stated earlier, they the three Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are also kelim- receptacles for the macro-levels of neshama, ruach and nefesh respectively.

הָרִי מֵאַחֵר שֶׁהָאוֹרוֹת הַנִּבְרָאִים אֲשֶׁר יֵשׁ לָהֶם הַשְׁתּוּוּת עִם הַגּוּף

Hence, since only created lights have some affinity with a body,

הֵם רַק שְׁנִיִּים

of which there are only two macro-level ruach and macro-level nefesh,

א " כ הרי צריך שגם כללות העולמות וכן פרטות הכלים שבכל
פרצוף

accordingly, the macro-level Worlds, and also the micro-level kelim in each partzuf ,

לא יהיו ג " כ רק שנים וכמו מציאות האורות הנבראים שהם רק ב

should also be no more than two, just like the actual created lights, which are only two,

כי הכלים צריך שיהיו רק כמספר האורות המשתפים עמהם
ומתלבשים בהם .

since the number of kelim should correspond to the number of lights that interface with them and become clothed within them.

And yet we see that there are three immanent worlds, Beriah , Yetzirah and Asiyah, and three receptacles in the body, the brain, the heart and the liver.!

ומה שאמרנו כי הג ' כלים שבכל גוף הם רק לפרטי הנר " נ אשר
בהרוח והנפש עצמן

Now what we said regarding the three kelim in each body – the brain, the heart and the liver – this refers only to the kelim for micro-level nr”n of ruach and of nefesh themselves.

And therefore we can perhaps accept this as an explanation as to why there are three kelim in the body.

הלא גם זה גופה צריך באור כי למה נפרטו לג '

But this too requires explanation – why are there three subdivisions

מאחר שכללי אורות הנבראים הם רק שנים

when the macro-level created lights are only two, as mentioned above?

הרי הכלל והפרט הוא לעולם בסדר אחד .

Particularly since we have a rule that macro and micro levels always follow the same pattern.

ועוד כי מאחר שכללות העולמות הנבראים הם ג ' שהם בריאה
יצירה עשייה

Furthermore, since the macro-level created Worlds are three – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah –

הרי משמע מזה שגם כללי האורות הנבראים הם באמת ג " כ ג ':

we can deduce from this that the macro-level created lights are also in fact three.

אך הענין בזה כי האמת הוא כמו שאמרנו שעקרי הנבראים הם רק שנים

However the concept here is that in fact, as we said, the primary aspects of created beings are only two ruach and nefesh.

אך מה שהם ג' עולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה

But the fact that there are three Worlds – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah –

וכן נסדר ג' כלים בכל פרצוף שהם מח לב כבד ופנימי תיכון חיצון וכך " ל

and that there are three kelim are arrayed in each partzuf – the brain, the heart and the liver –

ופנימי תיכון חיצון וכך " ל

arranged as inner, intermediate and outer layers, as explained above,

הנה הוא משום כי באשר שרצונו ית' ש בכל בריאת עולמו

this is because it is His will, may He be blessed, in creating His entire world

הנה היה שיהא כל הבריאה כלו תמיד קשור עמו ותלוי בו לעולם

that all of Creation should always be bound to Him and be dependent upon Him forever.

ולכן סדר והמציא בכל הבריאה כלה הו בכלל והו בפרט

For this reason, He planned on and produced throughout the entire creation, on both macro- and micro-levels

בחי' מציאת מקום אחת שהוא ראוי לקבל בתוכה אורו תמיד

the existence of one place that would be fitting to always receive His light within it,

אשר שם הוא משכן כבודו שהוא אור שכינתו יתברך שמו.

a place where His glory (Kavod), the light of the Divine Presence, the Shechinah , is manifested, may His name be blessed.

והוא בבחי' בית המקדש של מטה ששורה שכינתו בבית קדש הקדשים

And that place is the Holy Temple the Beit HaMikdash below in this world, 4 in which His Shechinah resides, in the Holy of Holies.

כן הוא בכל הבריאה כלה בכלל ובפרט ,

And so it is throughout all of the Creation, on the macro- and micro-levels,

הִנֵּה נִתְיָסַד בְּכֻלָּם בְּחִי ' מְקוֹם אֶחָד אֲשֶׁר עַל יְדוֹ מִתְיָחַד עִם
הַמְצִיאוֹת

in all of them is established one place through which He unites with existence as it is in that World.

כִּי שָׁם מִתְפַּשֵּׁט נְשׁוּרָה אֲוֵרוֹ ית " ש לְמַטָּה

Because it is there, down below, that His light or illumination spreads forth and is manifested ,

וְשָׁם קָשׁוּר וְתָלוּי בּוֹ הַמְצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ לְעוֹלָם

and it is to that place that the entire existence is always bound and on which it depends.

זֶהוּ סוֹד מָה שְׁאֲמְרוּ רַז " ל בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה פ ' נָשָׂא פְּרָשָׁה י " ב סִימָנוֹ ו '

This is the secret of what our Sages declare in Bamidbar Rabba, Naso 12:6 –

מִתְחַלֵּת בְּרִיתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם שְׂרֵתָה הַשְּׂכִינָה בְּתַחְתּוֹנִים

“From the beginning of the creation of the world, the Shechinah was manifested in the lowest plane.”

וְהִנֵּה הוּא ע " פ מָה שְׁאֲמְרָנוּ לְעִיל פ ' ג ' ד '

Now this concurs with what we said above in chapters 3 and 4,

שְׁגָם בְּאוֹר הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְי שֶׁהוּא עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הַזֶּה

that even the light of macro-level nefesh , which is this World of Asiyah ,

הִיחִידָה שָׁבָה אוֹר אֱלֹהוֹת .

the yechida therein is Divine light , not a mere radiance generated from a secondary source.

וְהָרִי שֵׁשׁ מְקוֹם גַּם בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה לְשֹׁכֵן כְּבוֹד בְּתוֹכָהּ

Thus, even in the World of Asiyah , there is a place for the Kavod to be manifested,

לְהִתְפַּשֵּׁט אֲוֵרוֹ שָׁם וּלְהִתְיָחַד עִמָּהּ

and in which His light can spread out and unify with.

וְאֲמְרָנוּ לְעִיל פ " ד כִּי ע " י הִיחִידָה דְּאוֹר הַנֶּפֶשׁ

Now we stated above, chapter 4 , that via the yechida -light of nefesh

הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְיָחַד שָׁם אוֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי שֶׁהִיא כֻּלָּה אוֹר
אֱלֹהוֹת

the light of macro- neshama , which is entirely the aspect of Godliness, spreads forth and becomes one there with nefesh of Asiyah .

השוכן בהיכל קדש הקדשים דהבריאָה ומתפשטת בהארתה משם
ולמטה

Now the light of macro- neshama is manifested in the Holy of Holies of Beriah , and spreads forth its radiance from there on down into the lower worlds,

עד עולם העשיה ומתיחדת באור היחידה שבהעשיה

until it reaches the World of Asiyah and becomes one with the light of yechida of Asiyah , as we just explained.

והיא השכינה השוכן בבית קדש הקדשים של מטה

And this is what is referred to as the Shechinah , which is manifested in the Holy of Holies down below

שהוא מכון נגד היכל קדש הקדשים שבעולם הבריאָה

and is situated precisely in line with the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah ,

שהוא כסא הכבוד וכמו שכתב הרב בשער כסא הכבוד ובדרושי מ "

ומ " ד דרוש א ' סמוך לסופו \ Throne of Glory

Kisei HaKavod , as the Rabbi – Rabbi Chaim Vital in the name of

Rabbi Isaac Luria, the Arizal – wrote in Etz Chaim , Shaar Kisei

.HaKavod , and in Drushei Ma”n u’Ma”d, drush 1 near the end

וכן הוא במדרש תנחומא פ ' ויקהל סימן ו '

This is stated similarly in Midrash Tanchuma, Vayakhel section 6,

שהארון היה מכון כנגד כסא הכבוד של מעלה

that the Ark is situated directly in line with the Throne of Glory above.

ושם ב' פ' פקודי סימן ב ' שההיכל שלמטה מכון כנגד היכל של

מעלה .

And in Midrash Tanchuma, Pekudei section 2, it states that the Heichal the section of the Temple comprising the Holy of Holies, the Holy and the Hall in front of them 5 below is situated directly in line with the Heichal above.

והרי לנו עכ " פ כי הג ' עולמות בריאָה יצירה ועשיה

At the very least then, we have it that the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah

הנה הגם שהם עצמן אינם אלהות כלל והם עולמות נפרדים

– even though they themselves are not Godly at all, but rather are separated Worlds –

עכ " ז הנה אורו ית " ש הוא שוכן בהם תמיד ומתיחד עמם לעולם

even so, His light, may His Name be blessed, always manifests within them and is one with them forever.

והנה הוא שוכן גם בעשיה ע " י היחידה שבה המתפשט בהחיה שבה

Thus the light manifests even in Asiyah , via its yechida which seeps into chaya of Asiyah ,

והחיה בהנשמה שבה (שהוא הנשמה דהרוח דהעשיה וכנ " ל פ " ד ע " ש)

and chaya in turn into neshama of Asiyah (this is the neshama of ruach of Asiyah , as mentioned above chapter 4. See there).

ולכן נתיסד מקום מיוחד על זה בכל פרצוף בפרט

And therefore a special place is established in each individual partzuf

והוא המקום הג ' העליון שהוא המוח

– which is the third and uppermost area of the three – brain, heart, liver – i.e. the brain.

וכן הוא בהעולמות בכלל והוא עולם הג ' העליונה שהוא עולם הבריאה .

And so it is also in the Worlds in general i.e. in the macro-sense – the third and highest World, the uppermost of the three Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah i.e. the World of Beriah, is where a place is set aside.

כי שם הוא המקום אשר אורו ית " ש מתיחד שם עי " ז בהמציאות כלו בכלל ובפרט

Because that is the place with which His blessed light is unified, and through it, the entirety of existence becomes part of this unity, on both macro- and micro-levels.

אבל עקר המציאות דהאורות הנבראים עצמן הם באמת רק שנים והם רוח ונפש .

Nevertheless, in reality, the primary created 6 lights themselves are actually only two , not three – ruach and nefesh .

אלא משום שאורו ית " ש מתיחד עמם ג " כ לעולם

However, because His light is always one with them as well,

לְכַךְ נִתְּיָסַד עַל זֶה מָקוֹם מִיָּחָד לְשֹׁכֵן כְּבוֹד בְּתוֹכָהּ

therefore a special place was established in which the Kavod can manifest,

וְהוּא כְּעֵין מָקוֹם מִקְדָּשׁ וּמִשְׁכָּן אֲשֶׁר שָׁם שׁוֹרָה הַשְּׁכִינָה לְמַטָּה

which is akin to the place in which the Shechinah manifests below in the Mikdash the Temple and the Mishkan the Tabernacle.

כֵּן הוּא בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בְּכָלֵל שֶׁהוּא בְּהִיכָל קֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדָשִׁים דְּעוֹלָם
הַבְּרִיאָה

And so too in the macro-Worlds – in the Heichal of Beriah , in the Holy of Holies of Beriah,

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁהוּא כָּלֵל אֱלֹהוּת

wherein is the macro- neshama, which is all Godliness,

וְשׁוֹכֵן בָּהֶּג 'רֵאשׁוֹנִים דְּהַבְּרִיאָה שֶׁהוּא כִּסֵּא הַכְּבוֹד

is manifested – in the first three sefirot of Beriah chochmah, binah and da'at [often abbreviated as chaba" d] and is called the Throne of Glory Kisei HaKavod ,

וְנִקְרָא כָּל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה עַל שְׁמָהּ שֶׁהוּא בְּשֵׁם נִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי

so that the entire World of Beriah is named after it the World of the Throne because of the macro- neshama that is manifested there. 7

וְכֵן הוּא בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף בִּפְרָט שֶׁהוּא הַמִּחְסָר שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

And so too on the micro-level of partzuf , which is the 'brain' of each partzuf ,

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הוּא הֶג " ר דְּהַרוּחַ שָׁבו

this is where the first three sefirot, chochmah, binah and da'at (chaba" d), of ruach are situated,

וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְיָחַד שָׁם אֹר הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי ג " כ כָּן " ל פ " ד

and where the light of macro- neshama also permeates and unites with it, as mentioned previously, chapter 4.

וְנִמְצָא כִּי הֵגֶם שֶׁהֶאֱמַת הוּא שְׁאִין לְאוֹר הָאֱלֹהוּת שׁוֹם הַשְּׁתוּת
כָּלֵל

Thus we find that even though actually for the Divine light there is no affinity

עִם כָּל בְּחִי ' גּוּף וְכָלִי לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּו ,

to any physical entity or vessel in which to be clothed,

עכ " ז הנה צמצם אור שכינתו ית " ש וְשׁוֹכֵן בָּהֶם עַכ " פ , וע " ד
שְׁאָמְרוּ בְּסִפְרָא וַיִּקְרָא פְּרָשָׁה ב '

nevertheless, He constricted the light of His Shechinah so that it can anyway
manifest within them, 8 as the Sages stated in Sifra, Vayikra 2:

דְּמִשּׁוּם חֲבִתָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל דְּחִיק לְהִיּוֹת מִדְּבַר מַעַל הַכַּפֹּרֶת מִבֵּין שְׁנֵי
הַכְּרֻבִּים .

‘Because of His love for Israel, He forced Himself to speak from on top of the
lid of the Ark, between the two cherubs.’⁹

וּבִבְרָאשִׁית רַבָּה פ ' ד ' סִימָן ד ' כְּשֶׁהוּא רוֹצֶה הֲלֹא אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת
הָאָרֶץ אֲנִי מִלֵּא

And in Midrash Rabba, Bereishit 4:4, when this is what He wants, the verse
states: “Do I not fill the heavens and the earth”? (Jeremiah 23:24)

וְכִשְׁהוּא רוֹצֶה הִיָּה מִדְּבַר עִם מֹשֶׁה מִבֵּין שְׁנֵי בְּדֵי הָאָרוֹן (וע ')
בְּגִמְרָא שְׁבֵת דָּרַפ " ח ע " ב ובשהש " ר פ " א פְּסוּקֵי י " ד סִימָן ג ')

And, when He wished to, He would speak with Moses from between the two
poles of the Ark (see Talmud, Shabbat 88b; Shir Hashirim Rabba chapter 1,
14:3).

כֵּן הוּא עַד " ז בְּכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת בְּכָלֹל וּבִפְרָט

And so it is throughout all of existence, on macro- and micro-levels –

הִנֵּה נִתְּיָסַד בָּהֶם מְקוֹם אֶחָד לְאוֹר שְׁכִינָתוֹ ית " ש כְּעֵין מִקְדָּשׁ
וּמִשְׁכָּן

a place has been established for the light of His blessed Shechinah , just as in
the Mikdash the Temple and the Mishkan the Tabernacle.

וְהוּא הַמֶּחֱ שֶׁל כָּל פְּרָצוּף וְהַיִּכָּל קִדְּשׁ הַקְּדוּשִׁים שֶׁל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה
This is the ‘brain’ of every partzuf and the Chamber of the Holy of \
,Holies of the World of Beriah

וְלִכְךָ נִקְרָא כָּל הַבְּרִיָּאָה כֻּלָּה עַל שֵׁם הָאוֹר דִּהְנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי

and therefore the entire World of Beriah is called by the name of macro-level
neshama –

As noted in the previous chapter, macro-level nefesh corresponds to the World of
Asiyah , ruach to Yetzirah , neshama to Beriah, and chaya to Atzilut.

וְכֵן נִקְרָא הַמֶּחֱ שֶׁל כָּל פְּרָצוּף בְּשֵׁם הַכִּלְי לְהַנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבּוּ כֵּן "
ל פ " ה

In addition, the 'brain' i.e. the chaba"ד of each partzuf is called the receptacle or vessel for the macro-level neshama within it, as explained in chapter 5,

משום שְׁדָרָךְ שֶׁם מְתִיחַד אֹר הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי ג " כ בְּהַעֲלֹמֹת בְּכָל

because by way thereof – by way of the chaba"ד of each partzuf – the light of the macro-level neshama becomes one with the Worlds in general.

וְכֵן בְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף בִּפְרָט וְכֵן ' וְדִי בִּזְה :

This is also the case with each individual partzuf , as mentioned. We have discussed this sufficiently.

וְכֵן הִנֵּה יֵשׁ בִּזְה עֲנֵן עוֹד קָרוֹב אֶל הָאָמוֹר

There is another matter here which is close in subject to what we said above:

כִּי הַעֲלֹמֹת בְּרִיאָה יִצִּירָה עֲשִׂיהָ מָה שֶׁהֵם נִחְשָׁבִים לָג '

The fact that the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are regarded as three separate worlds

הִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּמִקְרָה וְלֹא בְּעֶצֶם כִּי בְּעֶצֶם הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם

is only incidentally so, not inherently so, because in essence they are only two.

וְהוּא כִּי הָרִי אֶמְרָנוּ לְעִיל פ " ה כִּי הָרוּחַ וְנִפְשׁ דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה

The explanation of this is as we said above, in chapter 5, that ruach and nefesh of the World of Beriah

הִנֵּה הֵם הַשָּׂרֵשׁ דְּהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים שֶׁהֵם עוֹלָם הַיִּצִּירָה

וְהָעֲשִׂיהָ

are the root or origin of macro ruach and nefesh i.e. the Worlds of Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהִנֵּה אוֹתוֹ הַשָּׂרֵשׁ אֱלוֹלָא הַחֲטָא

Now that root – the micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah – had it not been for the sin of Adam and Eve partaking of the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge

הָיָה מְתִיחַד עִם הַמְּצִיאוֹת הָעֶקְרִי שֶׁיֵּצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ לְאַחַד מִמֶּשׁ

– would have actually been unified into one with the main aspects of existence which emerged from them.

כִּי הָרוּחַ הַפְּרָטִי שֶׁבְּהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה

Because micro-level ruach of macro- neshama , which is the ruach of the World of Beriah,

הָיָה מְתִיחַד עִם עוֹלָם הַיִּצִּירָה שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי לְאַחַד מִמֶּשׁ

would actually have become united into one with the World of Yetzirah, which is the macro-level of ruach ,

וְכָכָל שָׂרֵשׁ שֶׁמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּהֶעָנָף וּמִתְיַחַד עִמּוֹ וְהֵם אֶחָד מִמֶּשׁ

just like any root that extends into the branches that it nourishes, and they become one entity, literally.

וְכֹן הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִי שֶׁבַּהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי, שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁבְּבְרִיָּאָה,

Similarly, micro-level nefesh of macro-level neshama, which is the nefesh of Beriah,

הָיָה מִתְיַחַד עִם עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה, שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁיֵּצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ, לְאֶחָד מִמֶּשׁ

would have become united with the World of Asiyah, macro-level nefesh which emerged from it from nefesh of Beriah, and become one,

וְכָכָל שָׂרֵשׁ עִם הֶעָנָף וְהָיָה מְקַבֵּל הָעֲשִׂיָּה מִהֲבְרִיָּאָה מִכּוֹן

just like any root that extends into the branches that it nourishes, and Asiyah would have received from Beriah directly,

שֶׁלֹא דֶרֶךְ הַיִּצִּירָה כָּלָל (ע' זוה"ק פ' נח ע"ה ב' ובמ"מ שם).

not via Yetzirah at all (see Zohar I, Noach 5b, and in Mikdash Melech's commentary there).

וְהָרִי הָיָה נִחְשָׁב הֲבְרִיָּאָה עִם הַיִּצִּירָה לְאֶחָד וְכֹן עִם הָעֲשִׂיָּה לְאַחַת

Thus Beriah would have been regarded as one with Yetzirah, and similarly Beriah would have been regarded as one with Asiyah.

וְכ"ז [וְכָל זֶה] הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִיִּים דְּעוֹלָם הֲבְרִיָּאָה

And all of this would have been possible because micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah

הִנֵּה הֵם ג' כ' ר' נִבְרָאִים וְנִבְרָאוּ מִהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית אֲשֶׁר שָׁם

are also created, and were created from the macro-level neshama there in Beriah

שֶׁהָיָה אֲשֶׁר הִמְצִיא אוֹתָם אַחֵר אֲשֶׁר יָרְדָה בְּהֲבְרִיָּאָה וְנִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם

which produced them after descending into Beriah and becoming revealed in them in micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah.

The World of Beriah is characterized specifically by macro-level neshama, as explained above in chapter 5. Now when macro-level neshama becomes subdivided into its micro-level components, specifically ruach and nefesh of Beriah, that macro-

level neshama is regarded as producing its micro-levels, and at the same time it illuminates them – since they are, after all, micro-levels of Beriah .

וְהֵם הַשָּׂרֵשׁ בְּהִיצִירָה וְהַעֲשִׂיָּה וְהֵם אֶחָד עִמָּהֶם

And they the micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah become the root of Yetzirah and Asiyah, as we explained in chapter 5, and are united with them.

כִּי שָׂרֵשׁ הָרוּחַ עִם הָרוּחַ הֵם אֶחָד בְּעֶצֶם

This is because the root of ruach as it is above in Beriah, and ruach below in Yetzirah and Asiyah, are one essentially. They are both of the nature of ruach.

וְכֵן שָׂרֵשׁ הַנֶּפֶשׁ עִם הַנֶּפֶשׁ הֵם אֶחָד בְּעֶצֶם וְכֵן

And so too the root of nefesh as it is above in Beriah is one in essence with nefesh below in Yetzirah and Asiyah. They are both of the nature of nefesh.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הֵג ' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה אֵינָם נִחְשָׁבִים
בְּאַמֶּת לֵג ' כָּל

Thus we have it that the three Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are not really regarded as three at all,

כִּי הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם בְּעֶצֶם וְחִלְקָתָם לֵג ' הוּא רַק בְּמִקְרָה

but rather as two in essence, while their division into three is merely incidental

–

כִּי ע " י הַחֵטָא יָרְדוּ מִמִּדְרָגָתָם וְאֵינוּ מִתְיַחַד הַשָּׂרֵשׁ עִמָּהֶם

as a result of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge etc. they descended from their level, and their root is not unified with them , even though they are dependent upon their root and receive their life-force from it. 10

וְנִתְחַלְקוּ זֶה מִזֶּה וְנַעֲשׂוּ לֵג '

Thus they became separated from one another and became three since Yetzirah and Asiyah became detached from Beriah through the sin.

אָבֵל בְּעֶצֶם הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁי הָעֶקְרִי הוּא לְעוֹלָם רַק אֱלֹהוּת

But in essence they are really only two created worlds – Yetzirah and Asiyah – while the third and main world, Beriah, is always only Godliness.

וְהוּא הַקֵּב " הַלֵּבד שֶׁהוּא הַמְצִיאָם וּמְקִיָּמָם וּמְיַחֲדָם

Nevertheless, only the Holy One, blessed is He, produced them, sustains them and unites them.

וְכֵן מְנַהִיג אֹתָם תָּמִיד בְּתוֹצְאוֹת כָּל פְּעֻלוֹתֵיהֶם שֶׁפְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה .

And only He directs them always, bringing forth all of their effects in this world,

וּמִתְנַהֵג סֵדֶר כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה ע' ד' שְׁאֲמָרוּ בְּנִדְהָ ל' א

and the entire order of Creation behaves as the Talmudic Sages stated in Tractate Niddah 31 a :

ג' שִׁתְּפִין בְּאָדָם הַקֵּב " ה' וְאָבִיו וְאִמּוֹ

“There are three partners in the creation of a person – the Holy One, blessed is He, his father and his mother.” \ The Talmud (Niddah 31a) explains that certain physical aspects of a fetus come from the father, others from the mother, while the Holy One, blessed is He, gives the soul. 11

כֵּן הוּא עַד " ז' סֵדֶר הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה שְׁעָקְרוֹ הֵם שְׁנַיִם

So is it in the order of the entire creation – there are primarily two partners: the father and mother,

וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁי הוּא הַקֵּב " ה' אֲשֶׁר הִמְצִיאָם וּמְנַהִיגָם

and the third partner is the Holy One, blessed is He, who produced them and Who directs or supervises them.

וְהוּא ע' " פ' מָה שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ כִּי עָקְרוֹ שָׁל כָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם
שֶׁהֵם רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ

This is according to what we stated above – that there are only two primary aspects of all created beings : ruach and nefesh.

וְהוּא מ' " ש' רז' " ל' בְּדִבְרֵים רַבִּה פ' וְאֶתְחַנֵּן סִימֵן ל' א

This was stated by our Sages in Midrash Devarim Rabba, V'etchanan 31:

אָמַר הַקֵּב " ה' לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּנֵי כָל מָה שֶׁבְּרָאתִי בְּרָאתִי זִוגוֹת

“Said the Holy Blessed One to Israel i.e. the Jewish People, ‘My children, everything I created, I created in pairs

שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ זִוגוֹת , חֶמֶה וְלִבְנָה זִוגוֹת , אָדָם וְחַוָּה זִוגוֹת , הָעוֹלָם
הַזֶּה וְהָעוֹלָם הַבָּא זִוגוֹת

Heavens and earth – a pair; sun and moon – a pair; Adam and Eve – a pair;
this world and the World-to-Come – a pair

אָבֵל כְּבוֹדִי אֶחָד וּמִיָּחָד כו'

– but My Glory is one and unique .

וְכָל אֵלֵינוּ הַזִּיּוּגוֹת שְׁאֲמָר הֵם כֻּלָּם בְּסוֹד רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ כְּנוֹדָע

Now all of the pairs mentioned are all the mystical secret of ruach and nefesh , as is known. 12

אֵלֶּא שְׁאוֹתָן הָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ הֵנָּה הֵם כ' " א בְּבַחֲי' שֶׁרֶשׁ וּמִצִּיאוֹת

However, ruach and nefesh in those contexts are the aspect of root-source and existential being respectively.

וְהַשָּׁרֵשׁ הוּא תְּכוּנָה מְעֵלָה וְזָךְ גְּבוּהָ מֵאֵד הָרְאוּיָה לְקַבֵּל בְּתוֹכָהּ אֶת
אוֹרוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ

The root-source is a superior quality, pure and very lofty and is worthy of receiving His blessed light within it,

לְהִיּוֹת מִשְׁכָּנוֹ וּמַעוֹן אֱלֹהֵינוּ

serving as an abode and domicile for it for His light.

וְהִיא בֵּית קֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשִׁים שֶׁשָּׁם שׁוֹרָה שְׂכִינָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ

And in the Tabernacle and the Temple this is the Holy of Holies in which His blessed Shechinah dwells.

וּמִמְשִׁיךְ שֶׁפָּעוּ מִמֶּנָּה בְּתוֹצְאוֹת וּפְעֻלַּת הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ וְכָל הַנְּהַגָּתָהּ

And from there He draws down His life-force in bringing forth and implementing all of existence and all Divine supervision of the worlds.

וְהוּא הוּא עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה שֶׁנִּקְרָא כֶּסֶד הַכְּבוֹד

Now all of this is the World of Beriah, also called the Throne of Glory,

כִּי עָלֶיהָ שׁוֹכֵן מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּב " ה

so called because upon it the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed is He, rests

לְהַמְצִיא וּלְהַנְהִיג אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלָּהּ

in order to bring forth and direct all of existence.

אֲבָל הַנִּבְרָאִים עֲצָמוֹ הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם שֶׁהֵם רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ וְהֵם יְסוֹד כָּל
הַנִּבְרָאִים כֻּלָּם

However, created beings themselves are only two – ruach and nefesh – which are the foundation of all created beings.

זֶהוּ מָה שֶׁמִּתְחִיל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא הַתְּחִלַּת מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית בְּאוֹת ב

And this is why the Torah commences with the account of Creation, beginning with the letter bet – the בְּרָאשִׁית of ב .

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהַנִּבְרָאִים הֵם שְׁנַיִם

This is because created beings are only second – the letter bet is the second letter of the Hebrew alphabet and also has the numerical value of 2, both alluding to the second thing, the first being Torah, as the Baal HaLeshem goes on to explain

אָבֵל הַתּוֹרָה עֲצָמָה פֶּתַח בָּא ' שֶׁהוּא א ' דָּאָנְכִי

whereas the Torah itself begins with an aleph, the aleph of Anochi .

The first word of the Ten Commandments, which encapsulates the entire Torah, 13 is אָנְכִי . Thus the Torah itself, in the form of the two tablets of stone, begins with an aleph , which has the numerical value of 1, alluding to the fact that the worlds were created for the sake of Torah. 14

כִּי הוּא עַל הַקֵּב " הַמְמַצִּיא אֶת הַכֹּל וְהוּא אֶחָד

He, the Holy One, blessed be He, brought forth everything, and yet He is One.

וְכֵן הוּא מֵיַחַד אֶת הַב ' יְסוּדוֹת הַנִּבְרָאִים שֶׁהֵם רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ

And He unites these two foundational aspects of created beings – ruach and nefesh –

ע " י שֶׁמִּשְׁפִּיעַ אוֹרוֹ בָּהֶם לְצַרֵּךְ תּוֹלְדוֹת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת כֻּלָּם

by the outflow of His light into them for the purpose of generating all of existence,

הַנֶּעֱשֶׂה מֵהָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִים

which is produced from macro-level ruach and nefesh.

וְאוֹרוֹ הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בָּהֶם הוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית וְהוּא שֶׁתֵּף הַשְּׁלִישִׁי

And the light that spreads into them into macro ruach and nefesh is the light of macro-level neshama , which is the ‘third partner,’

The third partner as mentioned above, where the two primary partners in producing the body of the child are the mother and father, and the third partner is the Holy One, blessed is He, who gives the soul. All of this is an analogy for the Creation as well, where ruach maps to the father, nefesh to the mother, and neshama to the Holy One, blessed is He.

שֶׁהוּא מְאוֹרוֹ עֲצָמוֹ הַמִּשְׁתַּתֵּף בְּהַנִּבְרָאִים בְּקִיּוּמָם וְהַנְהָגָתָם

the light in and of itself i.e. the light of Beriah itself, since neshama is the essential level of Beriah which ‘partners’ with created beings in maintaining and directing them.

וְהִנֵּה עֹקֶר גְּלוּיוֹ שֶׁל אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר שֶׁהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית

Now the primary revelation of that very macro-level neshama light

הוּא בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה שֶׁהִיא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ דִּהְיִצְרָה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה

is in the World of Beriah, which is the root of Yetzirah and Asiyah ,

רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים וְעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה הוּא שְׂרָשָׁם

and they (Yetzirah and Asiyah) are macro-level ruach and nefesh , and the World of Beriah is their root , as explained previously.

ומשום ששם הוא הגלוי דאורו עצמו היורד שם שהיא הנשמה
הכללית כנזכר

And because there in Beriah is where the revelation of its own light the light of macro-level neshama descends, as mentioned,

לכן נקרא כל הבריאה כלה על שמה

therefore the entire Beriah is also called by that name – the ‘World of Creation.’

ובשם נשמה הכללית כי היא מאיר באורו ומתבטלת אליו

The World of Beriah is also called the world of macro-level neshama , since it the World of Beriah is illuminated with that light the light of macro-level neshama .

אבל עקר הבריאה עצמה הרי היא מהנבראים

However, Beriah itself is a created entity

ועצמותה היא ג " כ רק רוח ונפש לבד אלא שהיא בבחי' שרש
אליהם וכנז'

whose essence is also only ruach and nefesh , albeit that it Beriah is their root,

כי הרוח דהבריאה הוא השרש דהיצירה והנפש דהבריאה הוא
השרש דהעשיה

being that ruach of Beriah is the root of Yetzirah, and nefesh of Beriah is the root of Asiyah.

ואלולא החטא היה מתיחד הבריאה עמם

And were it not for the sin of Adam and Eve partaking of the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge Beriah would have united with them with Yetzirah and Asiyah,

ככל שרש שהוא מיוחד עם הענף היוצא ונמשך ממנו

just like any root that becomes one with the branch that emerges out of it and is drawn from it.

ולא היה נבדל מהם הבריאה לעולם בפנ " ע [בפני עצמה] כלל כי
הם רק גלויה .

Nor would it Beriah have become a world disconnected from them Yetzirah and Asiyah at all, since they are only the revelation of Beriah.

אך ע " י החטא הנה נבדל הבריאה לעצמה

However, because of the sin, Beriah did become detached from them and remains a World on its own.

הגהה והוא בסוד קטנות וגדלות]

[Author's note: This is the secret of spiritual immaturity or undeveloped consciousness – katnut, and spiritual maturity or developed consciousness – gadlut :

כִּי עוֹלָמוֹת בִּי " ע הֵם בְּבַחֲי ' בִּינָה זֶו " ו [זַעִיר אֲנִפִּין וְנֻקְבָּא]
כְּנוּדָע .

since the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are under the 'patronage' of binah, zeir' anpin, and nukvah (malchut) respectively, as is known.

Binah is in the state of gadlut since it represents expanded and developed consciousness. Accordingly Beriah is qualitatively different from Yetzirah and Asiyah, where ze'ir anpin and malchut respectively are the primary sefirot in those Worlds. The latter (and particularly malchut) are in an immature and undeveloped state compared with binah .

וּבְסוּד מ " ש הִסֵּף " צ [הִסְפָּרָא דְּצִנְעוּתָא] סֵף " א אֶתָּא מִפְתָּחָא כּו
' וַיִּלְמָאן דְּגָלִי פְתָחָא ... עֵין שֵׁם]

And this is the secret of that which is stated in the Sifra Ditzniuta 15 a subsection of the Zohar on parshat Terumah chapter 1 : “Along comes the key that comprises six attributes... and covers the opening... Woe to one who reveals that opening...” See there. End of note].

The basic idea here is a warning to one who engages in illicit sexual behavior, as Adam did when he coupled with Eve prior to the appropriate time. This was the sin of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil as explained in the Zohar and the writings of the Arizal. This sin caused the World of Beriah to become detached from the Worlds of Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהֵם עֲתָה ג ' עוֹלָמוֹת , וְנֻקְבָּא בְּשֵׁם נִשְׁמָה ,

And this is why there are now three Worlds – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah – but only Beriah is named neshama

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁבָּה מִתְלַבֵּשׁ אֹר הָאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא אֹר אֱלֹהוֹתוֹ ית " ש
הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט לַמַּטֵּה

due to the fact that the light of Atzilut, which is the light i.e. revelation of His blessed Godliness, is clothed in it and spreads out into Beriah below.

וְהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית שֶׁהִיא רַק אֹר אֱלֹהוֹת כֶּן " ל

And this light that illuminates Beriah is the light of macro-level neshama , which is exclusively Godliness, as explained above.

וּמִתְבַּטֵּלַת הַבְּרִיָּאָה אֶל הָאוֹר הַזֶּה הַשּׁוֹכֵן עָלֶיהָ וְנִקְרָאת עַל שְׁמָהּ

And the World of Beriah is existentially nullified to this light that rests upon it and by whose name it is called.

אָבֵל הַבְּרִיָּאָה עֲצָמָהּ הִיא בְּאֶמֶת ג' " כ' רֹחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ שֶׁרֶשׁ דִּיצִירָה
וְעֵשִׂיָּה כֵּן " ל'

But in and of itself Beriah too is actually only ruach and nefesh , which are the roots of Yetzirah and Asiyah respectively, as explained above.

וְכִנְגֻדָּהּ הוּא הַמֶּחֱשֵׁב שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף שֶׁהוּא הַכֹּלִי לַהֲנִשְׁמָה הַפְּרִטִית
שֶׁהִיא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ דְּהָרוּחַ

And corresponding to it to Beriah in every partzuf is its 'brain,' which is a receptacle for the micro-level neshama that is the root of ruach ,

וְכֵן מִתְפַּשֵּׁטֶת וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בָּהּ הָאֶרֶת הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכֹּלֵלִית ג' " כ' וְכֵן " ל' .

and a radiance of macro-level neshama also spreads forth into it and becomes clothed within it, as explained above.

Chapter 7 — The manner in which the five soul levels of nefesh, ruakh, neshama, chaya and yehida of neshama are derived from the world of atsilut.

Shaar 3 Chapter 7

וְהִנֵּה הַגֵּם שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל פ' ג' שֶׁהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית הִיא לְעוֹלָם
אֶלֶהוּת גָּמוּר

Now even though we stated above chapter 3 that the macro-level neshama is always completely Godly,

גַּם בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה עכ"ז הִנֵּה פָּשׁוּט הַדָּבָר שֶׁאִין כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת שְׁוִים
בְּקִבְלָתָהּ

even in the World of Asiyah, nevertheless, it is a simple fact that not all the worlds are equal in terms of how they receive it :

וְאִינוּ דוֹמָה אִיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּהֶבְרִיָּאָה לְאִיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה
שֶׁבְּהִיצִירָה

the quality of the light of the neshama in Beriah is not the same as the quality of the light of the neshama in Yetzirah

The light of the neshama in Beriah is obviously much greater than the light of the neshama in Yetzirah.

וְכֵן אִינוּ דוֹמָה אִיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה דְּהִיצִירָה לְאִיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה
דְּהָעֲשִׂיָּה

Similarly, the quality of the light of the neshama in Yetzirah is not the same as the quality of the light of the neshama in Asiyah.

The light of the neshama in Yetzirah is obviously much greater than the light of the neshama in Asiyah.

וְהָעֲנִין בְּבָאוֹר הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל הַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית שֶׁבְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי
ע"

To explain this matter further: the macro-level neshama in each of the Worlds of BiY”A

הִנֵּה הִיא נִמְשָׁכֶת מֵהַמְּלָכוֹת דְּהָאֲצִילוֹת וּמִבְּחִי' הַגּוֹף וְכֵלִים שֶׁבָּהּ
is drawn from malchut of Atzilut and from the aspect of ‘body’ and ‘vessels’ therein , as the Baal HaLeshem goes on to explain.

כִּי בְּכָל עוֹלָם יֵשׁ אֹר וְכֵלִים שֶׁהוּא צוּרָה וְחֶמֶר

For in every World there are lights and ‘vessels,’ which are also known in Jewish thought 2 as tzurah and chomer form and substance.

ומהכלים דעולם העליון שהם החמר שבו

From the ‘vessels’ of the higher world, which is the chomer therein,

נעשה הצורה והאור שהוא הנשמה דעולם התחתון כנ"ל ש"ע ב
פ"א

comes the tzurah , which is the soul of the lower world, as explained above, 2:1.

וכבר אמרנו לעיל פ"א כי כל גוף הנה הוא נבחר בג' חלקות
שסימנם פת"ח

We already explained above, in chapter 1, that every ‘body’ can be subdivided into three aspects, abbreviated as PTa”CH the initials of pnimi, tichon, chiztoni – the inner, in-between and outer layers.

והנה הנה הנשמה הכללית שבעולם הבריאה מבחי' כלי הפנימי
של המלכות דאצילות

Now the macro-level neshama of Beriah is from the aspect of the inner layer of the vessel of malchut of Atzilut;

והנשמה הכללית שבעולם היצירה היא מבחי' כלי האמצעי
דהמלכות דאצילות

and the macro-level neshama of Yetzirah is from the aspect of the in-between layer of the vessel of malchut of Atzilut;

והנשמה הכללית דעולם העשיה היא מבחי' כלי החיצון
דהמלכות דאצילות.

and the macro-level neshama of Asiyah is from the aspect of the outer layer of the vessel of malchut of Atzilut .

אמנם הרי אמרנו כי הנשמה הכללית הנה היא כלולה ג"כ מכל
הה' בחי' דנרנח"י

However, we also said that the macro-level neshama is comprised of all five aspects of nrnch”y, 3

והנה אותן הנרנח"י שבה הנה הם נמשכו ג"כ מכל הה' פרצופי
האצילות כלם

and those nrnch”y in it in the macro-level neshama are also drawn from all the five partzufim of Atzilut,

מבחי' הג' חלקי הכלים שבכ"א מהם

from the three layers of the vessels – the inner layer, the in-between layer, and the outer layer of each of them,

כִּי יִשְׁנָם בְּחִי ' כָּל הַג' חֲלָקֵי כָּלִים שְׁסִימָנָם פֶּת " ח בְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף
וּפְרָצוֹף

for there are aspects of all three aspects of the vessels, the initials of which are pt"ch – pnimi (inner), tichon (in-between), chitzon (outer) – in each and every partzuf .

וְהִנֵּה הַנִּרְנַח " י שְׁבִהֵנְשָׁמָה הַכְּלָלִית דֶּה־בְּרִיָּאָה

So that the nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Beriah

מֵהָה' כָּלִים הַפְּנִימִים דֶּהָה' פְּרָצוֹפֵי הָאֲצִילוֹת

derive from the inner (pnimi) layer of the vessels of the five partzufim of Atzilut i.e. Arich Anpin, Abba, Imma, Ze'ir Anpin, Malchut.

Therefore, each of the five levels of nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Beriah has a different origin: its yechida derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Arich Anpin ; its chaya derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Abba ; its neshama derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Imma; its ruach derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Ze'ir Anpin ; its nefesh from the inner layer of the vessels of Malchut.

וְהַנִּרְנַח " י שְׁבִהֵנְשָׁמָה הַכְּלָלִית דֶּה־יִצְרָה מֵהָה' כָּלִים הָאֲמֻצָּעִים
דֶּהָה' פְּרָצוֹפֵי הָאֲצִי

Similarly, the nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Yetzirah derive from the in-between (tichon) layer of the vessels of the five partzufim of Atzilut i.e. Arich Anpin, Abba, Imma, Ze'ir Anpin, Malchut.

Therefore, each of the five levels of nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Yetzira has a different origin: its yechida derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Arich Anpin ; its chaya derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Abba ; its neshama derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Imma; its ruach derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Ze'ir Anpin ; its nefesh from the in-between layer of the vessels of Malchut.

וְהַנִּרְנַח " י שְׁבִהֵנְשָׁמָה הַכְּלָלִית דֶּה־עֲשִׂיָּה מֵהָה' כָּלִים הַחִיצוֹנִיִּים
דֶּהָה' פְּרָצוֹפֵי הָאֲצִילוֹת

And so too as regards the nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Asiyah derive from the outer (chitzon) layer of the vessels of the five partzufim of Atzilut i.e. Arich Anpin, Abba, Imma, Ze'ir Anpin, Malchut.

Therefore, each of the five levels of nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Asiyah has a different origin: its yechida derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Arich Anpin ; its chaya derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Abba ; its neshama

derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Imma; its ruach derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Ze'ir Anpin ; its nefesh from the outer layer of the vessels of Malchut.

כי הנה כל ה' פרצופי האצילות הנה הם מתלבשים זב " ז

Now all five of the partzufim of Atzilut are clothed one within the other,

והמלכות היא מבחוץ לכלם וכולל את כלם

while malchut is external to all of them and thus includes all of them.

וכן הוא עד " ז בענין הכלים שלהם המתפשטים בהארותם

And similarly as regards their vessels, the radiance of which spreads forth

להעשות לנשמה הכללית בהעולמות בי " ע הנה הוא ג " כ עד " ז

to become the macro- neshama of the Worlds of BiY"A, also in a similar fashion.

כי מתלבשים כל בחי' הארת כלי הפנימים

So that what becomes clothed in the lower worlds of BiY"A is all aspects of the radiance of the inner layer of the vessels

דכל ה' פרצופי האצילות זה בזה

of all five partzufim of Atzilut, one within the other,

ומתפשט ונמשך בעולם הבריא

and they spread forth and are drawn down into the World of Beriah

ונעשה מהם כלם הנשמה הכללית דהבריא כלולה מנרנח " י

and from all of them is fashioned the macro- neshama of Beriah, comprising
nrnch"y .

וכן מתלבשים כל בחי' הארת כלי האמצעיים דכל ה' פרצופי

האצי' זב " ז

Similarly, the radiances of the in-between layer of the vessels of all five partzufim of Atzilut are clothed one within the other,

ומתפשט ונמשך בעולם היצירה

and they spread forth and are drawn down into the World of Yetzirah

ונעשה מהם כלם הנשמה הכללית דהיצירה כלולה מנרנח " י

and from all of them is fashioned the macro- neshama of Yetzirah, comprising
nrnch"y .

וכן מתלבשים כל בחי' הארת כלי החיצונים דכל ה' פרצופי

האצילות זב " ז

Similarly, the radiances of the outer layer of the vessels of all five partzufim of Atzilut are clothed one within the other,

וּמִתְפָּשָׁטִים וְנִמְשָׁכִים בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה

and they spread forth and are drawn down into the World of Asiyah

וְנִעְשָׂה מֵהֶם כָּלֵם הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דִּהְעֲשִׂיָּה כְּלוּלָה מִנִּרְנַח " י :

and from all of them is fashioned the macro- neshama of Asiyah, comprising nrnch"y .

אָמַנָם הוּא כִּי הֵגַם שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ שֶׁהַצּוּרָה דְּכָל עוֹלָם תִּחְתּוֹן

Nevertheless, although we said that the tzurah 4 of every lower world

הִנֵּה הִיא נִעְשָׂה מִהַחֲמֵר דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁהוּא הַגּוֹף וְכֵלִים שְׁלוֹ

is fashioned from the material aspect of the upper world – it's 'body' and 'vessels' –

וְעִי " ז אָמַרְנוּ כִּי נִעְשָׂה מֵהֶג ' חֲלָקֵי כֵלִים דְּכָל פְּרָצוּפֵי הָאֲצִילוֹת

and consequently we deduced that from the three aspects of the vessels of all of the partzufim visages of Atzilut i.e. the inner, in-between and outer aspects is fashioned

הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי " ע וְכֵנִז '

the macro-level neshama of each of the worlds of BiY" A, as mentioned.

הִנֵּה הָאֲמָת הוּא כִּי נִמְשָׁךְ עִם הַכֵּלִים דְּכָל עֲלִיּוֹן מִהָאֹר וְהַפְּנִימִיּוֹת

שְׁבוּ ג " כ

Now the truth is that with the vessels of all higher levels is drawn down the light and the inner aspects thereof as well.

וְעִי " ז הִנֵּה נִעְשָׂה כָּל תִּחְתּוֹן כְּלוּל מִכָּל הַבְּחִי ' כָּלֵם שֶׁבְּכָל

הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים כָּלֵם

And thereby the lower level comprises all of the aspects of all of the upper levels,

וְכַמ " ש בְּסֹדֶר אֲבִי " ע פ ' א ' ב ' וּבִכ " מ וְכֵן הוּא גַם בְּעֲנִינָיו

as is written in Eitz Chaim in the section titled "The Order of ABiY" A" chaps 1 & 2 and in several places. And so to as regards this matter:

כִּי הִנֵּה נִמְשָׁךְ עִם הֶג ' חֲלָקֵי כֵלִים דִּכ " א מֵהָה ' פְּרָצוּפֵי הָאֲצִי '

For with the three aspects of the vessels of each of them, is drawn forth from the 5 partzufim of Atzilut – Atik, Arich, Abba, Imma, Zeir Anpin and Malchut or Nukbah –

המתפשטים להיות לנשמה כללית בהעולמות בי " ע

that spread forth to become the macro - neshama of the Worlds of BiY”A, (bria, yetsira, asiya)

הנה נמשך עמהם מהאורות דכל פרצוף ופרצוף ג " כ

together with them are also drawn down from the lights from each of the partzufim .

ונמשך מכל חלקי הנרנח " י דכל פרצוף ופרצוף

so that there is drawn down from all the parts of nrnch”y of each partzuf

איזה הארה מהם עם בחי ' הכלי שמתפשט ממנו

some aspect of radiance from them, together with the aspect of the vessel that spreads out from it.

ונעשה מזה הנשמה הכללית דהעולמות בי " ע

And this becomes the level of macro- neshama of the Worlds of BiY”A

כולל ומלבש מכל העליונים כלם אשר לעלא לעלא

which comprises and is clothed within it all aspects of the higher worlds to the very highest levels

[זהו עמק כונת דברי הרב בכל ענין ההתלבשות אשר בשער עגלים וישר ענף ד' ע]
[" ש בדברינו בארוכה]

[And this is indeed the intention of the Rabbi Chaim Vital regarding the entire matter of hitlavshut – ‘enclothing’ or ‘insertion’ of one partzuf in another – as discussed in Eitz Chaim, Sha’ar Iggulim v’Yosher , anaf 4. See our commentary there at length].

ואותו האור הוא אורו ית " ש ממש השוכן בתוך הפנימית דעולמות
בי " ע

This light is in fact His light, may He be blessed, that rests within the inner dimension of the Worlds of BiY”A

בבחי ' נשמה לנשמה (וכמ " ש ברע " מ פ ' בהר ק " ט ב ')

– as the neshama of the neshama (as it states in Zohar vol . III in Raya Mehemna, Behar p. 109b). 5

ומזה האור מתפשט ונמשך כל התורה כלה

And from this light the entire Torah emerges and is drawn down,

אשר בה נברא ונוצר ונעשה כל העולמות בי " ע

and with it with the Torah all the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah were created (Beriah) , formed (Yetzirah) and made (Asiyah), 6

וְכֹן מִתְקַיְמִים וּמִתְנַהֲגִים רַק עַל יְדֵיהּ

and they endure and are directed exclusively by her by the Torah.

וְהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה לְנִשְׁמָה דְּאוֹרִיתָא שְׁאַמְרוּ בְּזוּה " ק בְּהַעֲלִיתָּ קֵן " ב א

The aspect of Torah that achieves all of this is the soul of the soul of Torah i.e. the inner dimension of Torah, Kabbalah, as they state in Zohar Beha'alotcha 152a.

וְכֹן מִזֶּה הָאוֹר הוּא שְׂרֵשׁ נִשְׁמַת כָּלל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכֹם " ש בַּאד " ר קֵם
א ע " ב

Furthermore, from very light is the root of the souls of all Israel, as the Zohar III states in the sub-section called Idra Rabba, p. 141b:

וַיִּפַּח בְּאַפִּיו נִשְׁמַת חַיִּים כּו' בְּגִין לְאַשְׁתַּלְפָּא וּלְעַיִלָא בֵּיהּ

“And He blew into his nostrils the breath of life...” (Genesis 2:7) in order to draw down from above, from Arich Anpin 7 and implant in him in Adam (and in man in general, by extension,)

סְתִימִים דְּסְתִימָא עֲלָאָה עַד סוּפָא דְּכָל סְתִימִין ,

the most hidden of hidden levels above, to the very limit of all hidden things all the way up until Adam Kadmon , the highest ‘world’ or plane of reality, if a person is worthy of this by virtue of his deeds 8

נִשְׁמַתָּא דְּכָל חַיִּי דְּעִילָא וְתַתָּא תַלְיִין מֵהָיָא נִשְׁמַתָּא , וּמִתְקַיְמִי
בָּה כּו' ע " ש

And Adam Kadmon is the ultimate soul of all supernal life above, and it is also the life-force below of the lower worlds BiY”A all of which depend on that soul, and they endure thereby. 9

וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר בְּנִים אַתֶּם לִי " א [לָהּ ' אֱלֹקֵיכֶם] וְכֹם " ש בִּפ ' וַיְחִי רֵם
" ה וִפ ' שְׁלַח קֵן " ט ב '

And therefore it states in the verse (Deuteronomy 14:1) “You are children of the Lord your God,” as stated in Zohar I, Vayechi p. 245, and in Zohar III, Shelach p. 159b.

The highest, or most exalted, of the five worlds is called Adam Kadmon . Adam means “in the likeness of” or “in the image of”, from the Hebrew word domeh . Kadmon means “primordial”, or “primary”, from the Hebrew root kadam . So, Adam Kadmon is the primordial world which is "in the likeness of" the Infinite Light which preceded it and which was concealed in the process of creation. This means that even though Adam Kadmon is a world, meaning that it comes into being through the concealment of the Infinite Light, it is such an elevated

plane of reality that it is “in the likeness of” the Infinite Light (which, by nature, “precedes” the world of Adam Kadmon). In this sense, souls that emerge from Adam Kadmon can be described as God’s children.

אָבֵל שְׁאָר כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלָם נִמְשָׁךְ הִתְהוּוּתָם וְרַק מִכֶּחָ הַכֵּלִים

But all the rest of existence comes into being and descends from the power of the vessels rather than the light.

שֶׁהֵם הַחִיצוֹנִית דְּהֶאֱצִילוֹת וְנִעְלָם בָּהֶם הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הַנִּזְכָּר מֵאֲדָמָה
מֵאֲדָמָה

They the vessels are the outer layer of Atzilut and the inner light mentioned above is very, very concealed within them –

כִּי הוּא לָהֶם וְרַק לְבַחֵי ' שְׂרֵשׁ הַשְּׂרָשִׁים

it is merely the source of their source.

וְאִפִּילוּ הַמַּלְאָכִים שֶׁבִּיצִירָה וְהַשְּׂרָפִים שֶׁבְּבִרְיָה

Even the angels in Yetzirah and the seraphs in Beriah

Different classes of angels are found in each of the worlds – ofanim in Asiyah, melachim in Yetzirah, seraphim in Beriah.

הֵם ג' כ' וְרַק מִהַחִיצוֹנוּת לְבַד וּמִזֶּה נִמְשָׁךְ מְצִיאוֹתָם וְכָל שִׁפְעָם
תְּמִיד

are also only from the outer layer exclusively. It is from there that their existence and constant life-flow is drawn.

וְלָכוּ אֲמָרוּ רַז' ל' בְּדִבְרֵים רַבָּה פ' א' סִימָן י' ב' וְכֵן הוּא בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם
שֶׁבֶת ספ' ו'

And therefore our Sages state in Devarim Rabba 1:12 and in Talmud Yerushalmi Shabbat end of chapter 6 that

עֲתִיד הַקֵּב " ה' לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיצָתוֹ שֶׁל צְדִיקִים לְפָנִים מְחִיצָתוֹ שֶׁל
מַלְאָכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת

in the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will construct a section literally a ‘partition’ for the righteous closer in to the Divine presence 10 than the area designated for the ministering angels.

וּמַלְאָכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת שׁוֹאֲלִין אוֹתוֹ וְאָמְרוּ לָהֶן מָה פָּעַל אֵל

And the ministering angels ask them the righteous saying to them, (Numbers 23:23) “What has God done?” Why have the righteous been given a place even closer to the divine Presence than the ministering angels?

The context of this verse: God redeemed Israel from Egypt, the epicenter of witchcraft and sorcery, and gave them the Torah, without them using magical means

to foretell the future or affect events (see Nedarim 32a; Rashi on the verse). The question is thus in what merit were the righteous are given such a lofty position, even higher than the ministering angels?

וְהוּא מְשׁוּם מָה שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ כִּי נִשְׁמַת יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא מְאֹר הַפְּנִימִי

The answer is as we said above – that the souls of Israel are from the inner light,

וּמִלְאָכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת הֵם רַק מִהַחֲצִיצוֹנִית

while the ministering angels are only from the outer aspects.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הֵגֵם שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ שֶׁהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה

So it turns out that even though we stated that the macro-level neshama of the World of Asiyah

הִיא לַמַּטֶּה בַּמִּדְרָגָה הַרְבֵּה מִהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דְּהִיצִירָה וְהַבְּרִיָּאָה

is on a much lower level than the macro-level neshama of Yetzirah and Beriah,

אֲךָ שָׂרֵשׁ נִשְׁמַת יִשְׂרָאֵל הִיא עוֹלָה עַל כֻּלָּם כִּי הוּא מְאֹר הַפְּנִימִי

nevertheless, the root of the Israelite soul transcends them all, because it is from the inner light,

קו הָאֲמֻצָּעִי הַמְּבָרַח מִן הַקְּצָה אֶל הַקְּצָה

the middle column that extends from end to end,

וּכְנוּדָע דְּנִשְׁמַת יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא חֵלֶק אֱלֹהִים מִמַּעַל וְכַּ"ש כִּי חֵלֶק ה' עִמּוֹ

and as is known the Israelite soul is part of God above, as the verse states, “For God’s portion is His people” (Deuteronomy 32:9).

וְאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּה "ק אַחֲרֵי מוֹת ס"ב ב' דְּהָא אֲנוּן אֲתֵאֲחָדוֹן לְעֵלָא לְעֵלָא

Regarding this, verse the holy Zohar (Acharei Mot 62b) states: They are one with the very highest of levels

וּבַפ' בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"ה א' אֵלֶּיךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל דְּנִשְׁמַתֵּיהוּ תִּלְיָן מִהֵוּא אֲתָר

and in parshat Bereishit 25a: “... those Israelites whose souls derive from that place

דְּאֲתָמַר בֵּיהּ בְּרוּךְ כְּבוֹד ה' מִקוֹמוֹ

regarding which it states (Ezekiel 3:12) ‘Blessed is the glory of God from His place’.”

The Zohar there discusses several general types and levels of soul from the highest levels to the lowest.

אֲמָנָם בְּפִרְטוֹת הַנִּשְׁמָה דָּכ " א יֵשׁ מַדְרָגוֹת רַבּוֹת אִין חֲקָר

All of the above is in a general sense; however, in terms of the individual soul of each person there are innumerable levels,

וְכַמ " ש בִּפ ' מִשְׁפָּטִים צ " ד ב ' וְכֵן בְּרַע " מ פִּנְחָס רַכ " ד סַע " ב

as the Zohar states in parshat Mishpatim 94b, and in Raya Mehemna, Pinchas 224b.

אֲךַ עַכ " פ כִּי כָלָם מִשְׁרָשִׁים וְאַחֲדוֹן לְעֵלָא לְעֵלָא וְכִנְז '

Nevertheless, all of them are rooted in and united with the loftiest of levels, as mentioned.

וְעִי " ז אֶפְשָׁר לֵב " א מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל לְהִתְקַדֵּשׁ בְּקִדְשָׁה שֶׁל מַעְלָה

Consequently, it is possible for each Jewish person to sanctify themselves with supernal sanctity,

וְכַמ " ש וְאַתֶּם הַדְּבָקִים בִּי " א [בָּה ' אֱלֹקֵיכֶם] כּו ':

as is written (Deuteronomy 4:4) , “And you who cleave the Lord your God are all alive today!”

G A T E

*Shaar 4 — Discussion of the first three
levels of the Divine as related to us*

Chapter 1 — The narnhai leading to its final expression on the material plane.

שער ד. פרק א'

Shaar 4 Chapter 1

הנה אמרנו לעיל שער ב' שהצורה שהיא הנשמה

We stated above, Shaar 2 chapter 1 that the *tzurah*, which is the *neshamah*,

הנה היא כח החמר והגוף והיא סבתו בכל עניניו

is the power invested in the material world and the body, and is the cause of all aspects of each of them***.

וא"כ הרי פשוט הוא כי ישנו בהצורה כל תכונת והוראת הגוף כלו.

This being so, it is obvious that all of the qualities and modes of operation relating to the body are in the *tzurah*.

Since the *tzurah* is the source of the qualities and modes of operation of the body, it follows that these qualities and modes of operation must in some way be in the *tzurah*, albeit in a much more elevated manner. An analogy can perhaps be drawn from the way in which an idea is present in thought and how it emerges in speech. The idea expressed in speech is merely an extension of the idea as it is in thought, albeit a mere shadow of the thought, as the Baal HaLeshem will explain.

ואדרבה הוא שעקר תכונותיו דהגוף הנה הוא רק מהצורה שבו,
שהצורה היא האדם העקר.

And to the contrary, the primary qualities of the body are only due to the *tzurah* imbedded within it, since the *tzurah* is the primary aspect of a person,

והגוף הוא רק הכלי שלה שעל ידו מוציא הצורה את כל תכונותיה
וכחותיה מן הכח אל הפועל

whereas the body is merely its vessel by which the *tzurah* manifests all of its qualities and powers from a state of **potential to actuality. **

אבל עקר פירצוף האדם הוא רק הצורה.

So the primary aspect of man is only the *tzurah*, not the body.

אמנם עכ"ז הנה בהצורה לבד עומד שם כל עניני הגוף רק בכח
לבד

Nevertheless, in the *tzurah* itself, all aspects relating to the physical body are only in potential,

וכל הפעלה הרי הוא רק ע"י הגוף

and any action is exclusively via the body.

כִּי כֹאשֶׁר חָסַר אֵיזָה אֲבָר מֵהַגּוּף הָרִי אֵינוֹ פּוֹעֵל בְּהַצּוּרָה מֵאוּמָּה.

And the proof of this is **that when a limb is missing from the body, the aspect of the *tzurah* that corresponds to that limb cannot be expressed at all.**

וְנִמְצָא כִּי הַכֹּחַ וְהַפּוֹעֵל הֵנָּה הוּא הַצּוּרָה.

It turns out that both potential and actual are embedded in the *tzurah*,

אֲבָל הַפְּעֻלָּה וְהַמַּעֲשֶׂה הֵנָּה הוּא בְּהַגּוּף.

whereas the action and the deed are via the body exclusively,

וְלֹא נַעֲשֶׂה שׁוּם דְּבַר אֶלָּא ע"י שְׁנֵיהֶם דְּוָקָא.

so that **nothing is accomplished without both of them.**

וְהֵנָּה אֲמַרְנוּ כִּי חֲלָקֵי הַצּוּרָה הֵם ה' שֶׁהֵם נִרְנַח"י.

Now we said above¹ that there are five parts to the *tzurah*; they are *nrnch* "y – *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya* and *yechida*.

וְאֵלוֹ הֵה' הֵם נַעֲשֶׂה כ"א לְבוּשׁ לַחֲבֵירוֹ

And each one of these five becomes a 'garment' for its companion, i.e. for the level that transcends it.

Whereas the concept of *hishtalshelut* – the chaining down of reality from the very highest levels to the most mundane – is a fundamental concept in the writings and systems of both the Ramak and the Arizal, the concept of 'enclothing' is far more prominent in the writings and system of the Arizal. It explains how higher spiritual levels impact lower ones by becomes 'clothed' in them, and how lower ones in turn become the means by which higher levels are manifested, albeit in a concealed manner. In other words, the higher levels become 'clothed' in a 'body' or 'garment' that acts as a receptacle and thus the means of expression of the higher level, while at the same time obscuring the higher level to a greater or lesser degree, depending on the level of refinement of the 'body' or 'garment.'

שֶׁכָּל תַּחְתּוֹן לְגַבִּי עָלִיוֹן הוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹ גּוּף אֵלָיו

This is because every lower level is regarded as the aspect of 'body' (synonymous with 'garment' here) compared with the higher level

וְכָל עָלִיוֹן הוּא הַצּוּרָה לְהַתַּחְתּוֹן.

and the higher level is regarded as the *tzurah* or soul of the lower,

וְעַקֵּר הַכֹּחַ וְהַפּוֹעֵל הוּא בְּהַעֲלִיוֹן וְעַקֵּר הַפְּעֻלָּה וְהַמַּעֲשֶׂה הוּא בְּהַתַּחְתּוֹן.

so that the primary potential and its actualization (actualization in the sense that is appropriate for the *tzurah*) is in the upper level, whereas the primary activity

and deed is in the lower level.

אָמַנְם הִנֵּה לֹא נִשְׁלָם שׁוּם דָּבָר אֶלָּא רַק ע"י כָּלָם יַחַד דִּוְקָא

Nevertheless, nothing can be achieved without both of them together.

הֵינֵנו ע"י כָּל הַשְּׂשָׁה בְּיַחַד שֶׁהֵם הֵה' חֲלָקֵי צוּרָה דִּנְרַנְח"י.

That is to say, all six aspects together – the five parts of the *tzurah*, *nrnch*"y – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya* and *yechida* –

עִם הַגּוּף כְּשֶׁהֵם כָּלָם בְּיַחַד

with the body in which they become clothed**, all of them together form a single unit.**

כִּי עֲנִין הֵה' חֲלָקֵי צוּרָה דִּנְרַנְח"י

The nature of the five aspects of the *tzurah*, *nrnch*"y,

הוּא כִּי נִתְפָּשֵׁט בָּהֶם הַגְּלוּי דְּכָל תְּכוּנַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם

is that in them is manifested in a revelation of all the qualities of the human *partzuf* – literally 'countenance,' but here implying the entire concept of what it means to be human, as a reflection of the Divine Image (alternatively, we could simply transliterate this as *partzuf Adam*)–

מִגְּלוּי לְגְלוּי עַד הַצּוּרָה הָאַחֲרוֹנָה שֶׁהִיא הַנֶּפֶשׁ

from illumination to illumination or revelation to revelation until the final *tzurah* which is the level of *nefesh*.

וְשֶׁם נִגְמַר כָּל תְּכוּנוֹת וְעֲנִינֵי הָאָדָם בְּכַח כָּכָל הָרְאוּי אֱלֵי

It is there that all the appropriate qualities and characteristics of man are completed in potential.

This is because the level of *nefesh* corresponds to *malchut*, which completes the revelation of the levels of soul,² just like *malchut* completes the revelation of the array of *sefirot*.

אָבֵל עֲדִין הוּא רַק בְּכַח לְבַד אֶלָּא שֶׁהַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁהִיא הַצּוּרָה אַחֲרוֹנָה

Nevertheless, it is still only in a potential state, just that the *nefesh* is the final aspect of *tzurah*,

הִנֵּה בָּהּ נִגְמַר הַגְּלוּי דְּכָל מְצִיאוֹת הַכַּח הָרְאוּי לְתְּכוּנַת עֲנִינֵי פְּרָצוּף
אָדָם מִמָּשׁ

and with it (the *nefesh*) becoming manifested, the revelation of all the latent powers that are appropriate for the characteristics of the *partzuf* of man are in fact complete.

וּמִמֶּנָּה הִנֵּה נִמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִן הַכַּח אֶל הַפְּעֵל ע"י הַגּוּף

And from it from the *nefesh* it the latent powers are drawn down and emerge from potential to actual via the body³

אֲשֶׁר הַנֶּפֶשׁ מִתְעַרֵּב בּוֹ וּמִתְעַלֵּם עִמּוֹ לְהַעֲשׂוֹת לְאֶחָד.

which is infused with the *nefesh* concealed within it, to form a single entity,

וכמ"ש 'כִּי הַדָּם הוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ' וְלֹא תֹאכַל הַנֶּפֶשׁ עִם הַבָּשָׂר.

as it is written, "for the blood is the *nefesh*" (Genesis 17:11), and "be strong and do not eat the blood, for the blood is the *nefesh*, and when you eat meat do not consume the *nefesh* with it" (Deuteronomy 12:23).

It is the *nefesh* 'clothed' in the blood that engenders life, and thus the two together, the *tzurah* and the vessel (the blood, the body etc.) form a single unit.

וְנִמְצָא כִּי גִמַּר הַשְּׁלֵמַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם הוּא רַק ע"י כָּל הַשְּׂשָׁה יַחַד דִּקְא.

So it turns out that the completion of the human *partzuf* is only when all six aspects are together as one.

כִּי בְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ עוֹמֵד בָּהּ הַמַּהוּת דְּפְרָצוּף אָדָם

Because in the *nefesh* is situated the essence of the human *partzuf*

בְּכָל עֲנִינָיו שָׁבוּ רַק בְּכַח אֶבֶל לֹא בִפְעַל

in all of its aspects, albeit that this is only in a potential state and not yet actual.

וּבְהַרְוֹם הִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּבַחֲיָא כַּח לִכְחַ

In *ruach* this is only in a state of latent potential (literally, 'capacity of the capacity') i.e. twice removed from actualization

וּבְהַנְשָׁמָה הִנֵּה בָּהּ הוּא רַק הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ לְהַכֵּחַ דְּכַח.

while in *neschama* only the root of latent potential is there i.e. three times removed from actualization.

וְכֵן הוּא עוֹלָה לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה וְנִתְמַעַט גְּלוּיוֹ וּמַהוּתוֹ

And so too as we progress through the levels higher and higher, the degree of revelation and essential nature of the *tzurah* becomes more and more ethereal⁴

בְּכָל עָלִיוֹן עַד הַצֹּרֶה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הַיְחִידָה

at each progressively higher level, until the final aspect of *tzurah***, which is *yechida*.**

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם עוֹמֵד כָּל הַתְּכוּנָה דְּפְרָצוּף אָדָם בְּלִי מַהוּת כָּלֵל

It is there that the entire human *partzuf* is situated without any defining characteristics at all, since, at this level, the *tzurah* completely transcends the limitations of defining characteristics.

אֵלָא רַק בְּבַחֲי שְׂרֵשׁ לְשְׂרֵשׁ שְׂרֵשׁ הַשְּׂרָשִׁים.

Instead it is merely the aspect of the root of the root of the root of all roots.

כִּי בְּכָל צוּרָה שֶׁהִיא יוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹנָה נִתְמַעֵט וְנִתְעַלֵּם בָּהּ הַגְּלוּי דְּמֵהוּת וְתֵאֵר פְּרָצוּף אָדָם.

This is because the loftier the *tzurah*, the more ethereal or transcendent and concealed the display of the human characteristics and definitions of a *partzuf* become.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא הַיְחִידָה בְּפִי הַמִּקְבָּלִים בְּשֵׁם אֶפֶס וְאֵין

Therefore *yechida* is referred to by the Kabbalists as "*efes*" nothingness and "*ayin*" indiscernible or inscrutable,

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁבָּהּ מְסִתִּים הַהֲשָׁגָה לְגִמְרִי, וְהִיא בְּלִי מֵהוּת מִשָּׁג.

since this is where understanding terminates completely, and it is of an unfathomable nature.

כִּי אֵלּוּ הֵם חֻלְקֵי נִשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף שֶׁהֵם נִרְנַח"י הֵם נִמְשָׁכִים מִהַעֲשֹׂר סְפִירוֹת:

Now these five aspects of the soul in every *partzuf*, i.e. *nrnch* "y", are drawn from the ten *sefirot*:

יְחִידָה – כֶּתֶר. וְהוּא נִקְרָא אֵין, כִּמְ"ש בִּזְוֵה"ק בְּשֵׁלַח ס"ד ב' וּבֵאֵדָר"ז רַפ"ז ב'.

yechida from *keter*, and this is called *ayin*, as the *Zohar*, *Beshalach* 64a and *Idra Zuta* p. 287b state;

חִיָּה הוּא חֻכְמָה ע"ש הַכְּתוּב (קֹהֶלֶת ז') 'הַחֻכְמָה תְּחִיָּה בְּעָלֶיהָ' וְכֵן חֻכָּם גִּימְטְרִיָּא חִיִּים

chaya which is related to the word *chayim* – life is from *chochma***, as in (*Kohelet* 7**:12**) "*chochma*** wisdom preserves the life *chayim* of those who possess it,"

וְהִיא נִמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִן הַכֶּתֶר וּכְמ"ש (אֵיּוֹב כ"ח) 'וְהַחֻכְמָה יֵאֵין חִמְצָא'.

and it (*chochma*) is drawn down from and emerges from *keter*, as the verse (*Job* 28:12**) states, "and wisdom emerges from *ayin*" (i.e. *keter*). We have translated the verse the way it is interpreted here. However, the plain meaning of the text presents this as a question – "where is *chochma* to be found?"

שֶׁהוּא מִהַכֶּתֶר שֶׁנִּקְרָא אֵין לְגִדּוֹל הָעֲלָמוֹ. כִּי הוֹרָאת מַלְת אֵין הוּא בִּר"ת אֵיָה נֶעְלָם.

For it comes from *keter*, which is called *ayin* – inscrutable – due to its profound concealment,**

כִּי הוֹרָאת מַלְת אֵין הוּא בִּר"ת [בְּרֵאשִׁי תְבוּת] 'אַיִה נְעֵלָם'

which is why the word *ayin* can be interpreted as an acronym "where is it concealed?"

The letters *aleph* and *yud* of אֵיִה and the letter *nun* of נְעֵלָם together form the word אֵין.

וְהַחֲכָמָה הוּא נִקְרָא יֵשׁ, כִּמ"ש בִּרְע"מ פְּנִיחָס רִל"ט א'.

By way of contrast with the 'nothingness' of *keter*, ***chochma* itself is called 'yesh' – something –**

וְהִיא יֵשׁ מֵאֵין וְנִתְגַּלָּה מְצִיאוּתָהּ וְלֹא מֵהוּתָהּ.

for it emerges *ex nihilo* in a manner that its existence, but not its essence, is revealed.

נִשְׁמָה בֵּינָה וְנִקְרָא 'הוּא' וְכִמ"ש בִּפ' וְיֵצֵא קִנ"ד ב' כִּי הִיא עֲדִין נִסְתָּר.

Neshama* is associated with the *sefirah* of *binah⁵, which is referred to** in the third person, 'he,' indicating that it is as yet remote from us.**

Binah is a 'feminine' *sefirah*, often referred to in *Zohar* as *imma*, the 'mother' *sefirah*, while *chochma* is a 'male' *sefirah* referred to as the 'father' *sefirah*⁵

וְהָרוּחַ שֶׁהוּא ת"ת הַכּוֹלֵל כָּל הו"ק נִקְרָא אֶתָּה, כִּמ"ש בְּתִקּוּנִים תִּקּוּן י"ט דָּף ט"ל.

Ruach* is associated with the *sefirah* of *tiferet⁵, which includes all of the six extremities** i.e. the six *sefirot* from *chesed* to *yesod* and is called 'you' in the second person. This indicates that it is a level that is close to us, with which we can communicate directly, face-to-face so to speak, as is explained in the *Tikunim* the *Tikunei Zohar*, *Tikun 19*, p. 39.**

הַנֶּפֶשׁ מְלַכּוּת נִקְרָא אָנִי. וְכִמ"ש בִּפ' מִקֶּץ ר"ד ע"ב וּפ' תְּרוּמָה קִנ"ו א' וְכֵן בַּהֲקִי"ז ו' ע"א:

***Nefesh* is associated with the *sefirah* of *malchut*, and is called 'I' in the first person, as the *Zohar*, *parshat Miketz* p. 204b, and *parshat Terumah* 156a, and in the *Introduction to the Zohar* p. 6a state.**

Not only is it close to us, it actually is our life force and thus who we are (in this world).

וְנִחְזֹר עַל הַדְּבָרִים כְּדִי לָבֹא לְכוּנִתָּנוּ

Let's review what we've said in order to proceed to our intention:

כי כל ה' חלקי צורה שהם נרנח"י הנה הם מה שמתפשטים
מגלוי לגלוי לתכונת כל עניני דתאר פרצוף אדם

All five parts of the *tzurah*, the *nrnch* "y, radiate from illumination to illumination or revelation to revelation, thus infusing all of the properties of the human *partzuf* with all its characteristics.

אלא שכל התפשטותם וגלויים הנה הוא רק למציאות הכח לבד
אשר לזה

However, all their radiating forth and illumination is only insofar as their existential aspect of the power, but not its essential inner dimension.

ונמשך הגלוי דהכח אשר לזה מדרגא לדרגא עד הנפש,

And the revelation of that power is drawn down from level to level until the level of *nefesh*,

ושם נשלם אותו הכח אשר לתכונת מהות ותאר פרצוף אדם בכל
הראוי.

where that power becomes complete in the essential qualities and description of what it means to be human in the proper sense.

אך יציאתם מן הכח אל הפועל ממש הוא רק ע"י הגוף

But again, their emergence from potential to actual corporeal reality is only via the body,

כי רק בהגוף נעשה הפעלה אבל כל מה שלמעלה מן הגוף הוא רק
בכח לבד

because it is only an action done with the body, whereas when it is above, transcending the body, it is only in a state of potential.

שהנפש הוא הכח היותר קרוב אשר לזה והרוח הוא הכח לכח

Thus the *nefesh* level of the *tzurah* is the closest capacity to the human being, whereas *ruach* is only the latent potential (literally, 'capacity of the capacity') twice removed.

והנשמה הוא השרש לכ"ז והחיה הוא שרש השרשים

And the level of *neschama* is the root of all of them of the levels below, and *chaya* is the root of the root,

ונתמעט גלויים בכ"א שהוא למעלה

so that the loftier the level the more ethereal or transcendent the revelation becomes,

עד שבהיחידה שהוא השרש לכלם אין בו לכל זה שם ומלה כלל,

until in *yechida*, which is the root of all of them, there is no name or term at all that can describe or define it,

וְנִעְלָם בּוֹ לְגַמְרֵי הַגִּם שְׂכָלָם הֵם מִמֶּנּוּ וּלְכָךְ נִקְרָא אֵין כִּנּוּי.

and in it (in *yechida*) these qualities are completely concealed, even though they all derive therefrom. And this is why *yechida* is called *ayin* – inscrutable.

אָמְנָם עכ"ז הִנֵּה יִדְעַת לְנִבּוֹן נֶקֶל' (משלי יד, ו) שְׂכָל מָה שְּׁאֻמְרָנוּ
מִגְדֵּל הָעֲלֻמָּתָם

Nevertheless, 'wisdom will come easily to the understanding one' (Proverbs 14:6) regarding everything we stated about these very abstruse matters,

אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל יוֹתֵר עָלֵינוּ, הִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּעֶרְךְ הַפְּעֻלָּה הָאַחֲרוֹנָה,

where the loftiest of levels is only very vaguely **related to the final act, **

הַפְּעֻלָּה הַמַּמְשִׁית הַנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּהַגּוּף הַמְּשֻׁג וְהַנִּתְפָּס לְכָל עֵין חֲמָרִי
וְגוֹפָנִי.

i.e. the physical act done with a body that can be comprehended and grasped by an eye that is material and corporeal.

Accordingly, there is no real paradigm by which to evaluate the lower levels by comparing them with the higher levels, since they are basically (almost) incomparable.

אָבָל בְּמַצִּיאוֹת הַנִּרְנַח"י עֲצָמוֹ, בְּהֶעֱרַךְ זֶה כְּנֶגֶד זֶה,

But as regards the *nrnch* "y themselves, when evaluating one against the other,

הִנֵּה נִבְחָן כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן בְּהֶעֱרַךְ הָעָלִיוֹן מִמֶּנּוּ

each lower level can be assessed in comparison with the level above it.

וּבִפְרָט בְּעֶרְךְ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁעָלָיו שֶׁהוּא הָעָלִיוֹן דְּעָלִיוֹן

And this is particularly apropos when evaluating a lower level by comparing it with the third level above – that which is above the level above it i.e. twice removed where the distinctions between them are even more blatant,

הִנֵּה נִבְחָן הַתַּחְתּוֹן נֶגְדוֹ הִיטִיב, בְּכָל תְּכוּנַת מַהוּת וְתֹאֵר אָדָם
מִמֶּשׁ.

so that the lower level can indeed be appraised well in comparison with it, in every aspect of the inner essence and outer description of the human *partzuf*, since they both have the same *tzurah*, albeit one much loftier than the other,

כִּי הָרִי כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן הוּא בְּבִחִי גּוּף וּלְבוּשׁ לְהָעָלִיוֹן שֶׁהוּא נִשְׁמָה אֱלֹיוֹ

since every lower level of *nrnch* "y serves as a 'body' and 'garment' for the higher level which is its soul (*neshama*).

וְנִחָשֵׁב הָעֲלִיּוֹן אֵלָיו בְּבַחֲיוֹ אִיכוֹת וְכֹחַ.

Accordingly, **the higher level is regarded by the lower level as its superior quality and potential,**

וְהַתְּחַתּוֹן הוּא נִחָשֵׁב לְהָעֲלִיּוֹן, שֶׁבוֹ מוֹצִיא אֶת תְּכוּנָתוֹ וְכֹחוֹ מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל וּמִן הָאִיכוֹת אֶל הַכִּמּוּת,

while the lower level is regarded as important to the higher level – as the means by which it expresses its qualities and capabilities, from potential to actual, and from quality to quantity.

וְנִגְמַר בּוֹ הַמַּעֲשֶׂה וְהַפְּעֻלָּה דְּהַצּוּרָה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה כִּי הוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹ חֲמֹר וְגוֹף נִגְדוֹ.

And through it (via the lower level) the actions and effects of the higher *tzurah* are completed, since it the lower level is the aspect of 'material' and 'body' in comparison with it.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הַכְּנוּי דְּפָרְצוּף אָדָם וְכָל הַמַּהוּת וְהַתַּאֲר שֶׁבוֹ הוּא נִדּוֹן בְּעֶרְכּוֹ.

Thus it turns out that the expression 'the human *partzuf*' with its entire inner essence and outer description is amenable to comparative analysis.

דְּכָל עֲלִיּוֹן לְגַבֵּי תְּחַתּוֹן הוּא אֵינוֹ מְכַנֶּה בְּשֵׁם פָּרְצוּף וּבְמַהוּת אָדָם כָּלָל

While the upper level compared to the lower level is not dubbed '*partzuf*' or given any human attributions at all,

אֲבָל כָּל תְּחַתּוֹן לְגַבֵּי עֲלִיּוֹן וּמִכָּל שֶׁכֵּן לְהָעֲלִיּוֹן דְּעֲלִיּוֹן הִנֵּה מְכַנֶּה וּמִתַּאֲר הַתְּחַתּוֹן הַשְּׁלִישִׁי.

such a label and description is applied to the lower level compared to the upper level, and all the more so when compared to an even higher level, as a third-level entity,

כְּגוֹן: הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְגַבֵּי נִשְׁמָה וְכֵן הָרוּחַ לְגַבֵּי הַחַיָּה

for example – *nefesh* is a third-level (i.e. twice-removed) entity in comparison with *neshama*, since the order is *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*. And similarly *ruach* is a third-level (i.e. twice-removed) entity in comparison with *chaya* since the order is *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*,

בְּכָל תְּכוּנָת וּמַהוּת וְתַאֲר פָּרְצוּף אָדָם מִמֶּשׁ

and they are indeed labeled as a human *partzuf* with all the qualities and character and description thereof,

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּהִגּוּף ע"י הַנֶּפֶשׁ רוּחַ שָׁבוּ.

just like the body compared with the *nefesh* and *ruach* vested within it.

וְהִנֵּה כְּבֹד אֲמָרְנוּ לְעֵיל שֶׁעַר ג' ש"א מֵהִנֶּרֶחַ"י הוּא כָּלוּל ג"כ מִנֶּרֶחַ"י,

Now we already explained above in Sha'ar 3 that each of the *nrnch*"y *nefesh*, *ruach*, *nesham*, *chaya*, *yechida* itself comprises *nrnch*"y

וַיִּשְׁנֶם ה' בְּחִי' נִרְנַח"י בְּהִנֶּפֶשׁ וְה' בְּחִי' נִרְנַח"י בְּהָרוּחַ וְכֵן ה' בְּחִי' בְּהִנְשָׁמָה וְה' בְּחִי' בְּהִחְיָה וְה' בְּחִי' בְּהִיחֻדָּה.

so that there are five levels of *nrnch*"y of the *nefesh*, and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *ruach*, and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *neshama*, and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *chaya**, and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *yechida*.

וּא"כ הִרִי כָּל מָה שֶׁאֲמָרְנוּ מֵעַנֵּן הַתַּפְשֻׁטוֹת הַגְּלוּיִם דְּכָל תְּכוּנַת וּמֵהוּת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם,

This being so, then everything we discussed about the concept of radiating forth the revelation of all of the qualities and the character of the human *partzuf*,

אֵיךְ שֶׁנִּתְפָּשֵׁט וְיוֹצֵא מִגְּלוּי לְגָלוּי וּמִדְּרָגָא לְדְרָגָא,

and how they radiate forth from illumination to illumination or revelation to revelation

מֵהַצּוּרָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הִיחֻדָּה עַד הַצּוּרָה הַתַּחְתּוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ.

from the loftiest aspect of the *tzurah***, which is *yechida*, until the lowliest** aspect of the *tzurah***, which is the *nefesh***.

וְכֵן כָּל מָה שֶׁאֲמָרְנוּ מֵעַנֵּן שְׁלִילַת הַתֵּאָר וּמֵהוּת דְּפְרָצוּף אָדָם

Similarly, everything that we stated regarding the negation of descriptors and definitions of human form

אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל צוּרָה הַיּוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹנָה בְּעֶרְךָ הַתַּחְתּוֹן שְׁלֵמָה הַיִּמִּנָּה,

in connection with a higher *tzurah* compared with one below it,

וְאֵיךְ כִּי עִם כָּל זֶה הִנֵּה בְּעֶרְכִּין נִדּוֹן אוֹתוֹ הַמֵּהוּת וְהַתֵּאָר בְּכָלֶם עַל כָּל פָּנִים.

and how, despite this, their essence and description are nevertheless comparable across the board –

הִנֵּה כ"ז הוּא הֵן בַּהֲנִרְנַח"י הַכְּלָלִיִּים וְהֵן בַּהֲנִרְנַח"י הַפְּרָטִיִּים שֶׁבִּכ"א גּוּפָה.

all of this is true regarding both the macro-level *nrnch* "y, and the micro-level *nrnch* "y within each of them – within each of the macro-levels.

וְהִנֵּה הַפְּרָטִיִּים הָרִי הֵם כ"ה בְּחִי' וְכִנְזָכָר.

Thus, fully iterated, there are twenty-five distinct aspects, as mentioned previously.

וא"כ הָרִי אֲנוּ רוֹאִין מִזֶּה שְׂכָל הַתֵּאָר וּמֵהוּת דְּפִרְצוּף אָדָם הַנֶּעֱשֶׂה וְנִגְמָר בְּהִגּוּף הַחֲמָרִי הָעֶקְרִי,

If so, we see from this that the entire description and essence of the human *partzuf* is fashioned and completed via the physical body as the main thing.

כַּמָּה שְׂרָחוּק וּמִשׁוּלָּל הוּא מִבְּחִי' הַצּוּרָה הַיּוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הַיְּחִידָה הַפְּרָטִית

This is so despite how far apart from and how antithetical the body is to the loftiest aspect of the *tzurah* – the micro-level *yechida* –

אֲשֶׁר בְּהַיְּחִידָה הַכְּלָלִית אֲשֶׁר הוּא לְמַעַלָּה וְגִבּוּף מֵהִגּוּף הַחֲמָרִי כ"ה מִדְּרָגוֹת.

of the macro-level *yechida*, which is twenty-five lofty levels above the physical body!

וְגַם כ"ז הוּא רַק בַּהֲכ"ה בְּחִי' דִּנְרַנַּח"י הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בַּהֲנִרְנַח"י הַכְּלָלִיִּים שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה לְבַד.

Moreover, all this is only the twenty-five individual levels of the micro-level *nrnch* "y into which the macro-level *nrnch* "y of the World of *Asiyah* alone is subdivided.

וְכֵן הָרִי יִשְׁנָם כ"ז בְּעוֹלָם הַיְּצִירָה, וְכֵן בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה,

Add to that the fact that all these are also present in the World of *Yetzirah*, and similarly in the World of *Beriah*.

כִּי בְּכָל עוֹלָם הָרִי יִשְׁנָם ה' בְּחִי' נִרְנַח"י כְּלָלִיִּים וְכ"ה בְּחִי' נִרְנַח"י פְּרָטִיִּים

And so too in every world – there are the five aspects of macro-level *nrnch* "y and twenty-five levels of the micro-level *nrnch* "y

וְהֵם בְּסֵךְ הַכֹּל קכ"ה בְּחִי' וְהוּא בְּפִנְיָמִיּוֹת וְכֵן הוּא ג"כ בְּחִיצוֹנִיּוֹת)

(for a total of 125 inner-dimensional aspects, and similarly in the outer dimension,

וְכַמ"ש הָרַב בְּשַׁעַר פְּנִימִיּוֹת וְחִיצוֹנִיּוֹת דְּרוּשׁ י"א וּבכ"מ)

As the rabbi Rabbi Chaim Vital writes in the name of the Arizal in *Sha'ar Pnimiut v'Chitzoniut* [*Sha'ar* 40] chapter 11, and in a number of places).

וְהָרִי אָנוּ רוֹאִין מִכ"ז אֵיךְ שֶׁנֶּעֱלַם וּמִשׁוּלָּל מִהֲשָׁגַת וּתְפִיסַת בְּנֵי אָדָם

So we see from all this the extent of concealment and inaccessibility to man's grasp and understanding

מִלְהִבְחִין שׁוּם תְּמוּנַת מַהוּת וְתֹאֵר גַּם בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה,

by which he could discern an image of the nature of the world of Beriah, or even a description thereof.

הַגַּם שֶׁהוּא בְּאֻמַּת ג' כ"עוֹלָם מָלָא מִכָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת וְהַעֲנִינִים
שֶׁבְּהָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה

This is so despite the fact that Beriah is indeed also a world, replete with its existence and those matters concealed there

וְהוּא כֻּלּוֹ נִבְרָא וּמִחְדָּשׁ וְאִינוּ אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלָל.

and Beriah is a creation and is renewed and originated from nothing, and it is not Godliness at all.

אֲךְ כִּבְרָא אִמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל שֶׁעַר ב' שֶׁמֶהַחֲמֹר דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲלִיוֹן נַעֲשֶׂה הַצּוּרָה
דְּעוֹלָם הַתַּחְתּוֹן

Now we already stated above in *Sha'ar* 2 that the *tzurah* of the lower world is fashioned from the 'material' aspect of the higher world,

וְכָל צוּרָה נֶגֶד הַחֲמֹר הָרִי אֵין בָּהּ תֹּאֵר מִפְּרָצוֹי אָדָם כָּלָל וְכִנְזָכָר.

and that *tzurah* compared with materiality has no human countenance at all, as mentioned.

וּא"כ הָרִי כִּמְהָ רְחוֹק וּמִשׁוּלָּל הוּא מִהֲשָׁגַתְנוּ לְהַשִּׁיג אֶת מַהוּת
הַחֲמֹר וְהַגֶּשֶׁם

This being so, it shows how remote from and inaccessible to our intellectual grasp it is to fathom the essence of 'materiality' and 'physicality' –

אֲשֶׁר גַּם בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה בְּתַכְלִית הָרְחוֹק וְהַשְּׁלִילָה הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי:

even in the World of Beriah, which is as remote and as inaccessible as could possibly be from our understanding.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאִמְרוּ בְּזֶהֱרַח דְּשׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית י"א סע"א: אָמַר ר' יוֹחָנָן בֶּן זַכַּאי:
כִּמְהָ נִצְטַעַר הָהוּא גִבְרָא

This is what is meant when the *Zohar Chadash, Bereishit* 11a⁶ states: Rabbi Yochanan ben Zakkai declared, "How great was the yearning of that great man to behold the Divine Glory.

דְּכַתִּיב בִּיה 'לֹא כֹן עַבְדִּי מֹשֶׁה בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא' לְמַחְזִי חֵד
שְׁמִשָּׁא דְּמִשְׁמָשָׁא קָמִיה

Regarding him the verse (Numbers 12:7) states 'This is not true of My servant Moshe, who is a trusted servant throughout My house'⁷

וְלֹא אֶתִּיהֶבֶת לֵה רְשׁוּתָא, דְּכַתִּיב 'הִרְאֵנִי נָא אֶת כְּבוֹדְךָ'.

and yet he was not granted permission, as when the verse (Exodus 33:18) states, "Please show me Your Glory"

וְהוּא דְּכַתִּיב בִּיה 'כְּבוֹד אֱלִי' וְהוּא מַטְטְרוֹן שֶׁר הַפָּנִים

referring to the one of whom it is written 'he is the glory of God,' – the angel Metatron, the Angel of the Presence.

וְהֵאִיךְ שְׁאִיל מֹשֶׁה לְמַחְמִי דָּא?

Now how did Moshe think to request this? After, all was he not a human being?

אֶלָּא מֹשֶׁה סָבַר כִּיּוֹן דְּחָמָא גּוּפִיה אֲרַבְּעֵן יוֹמִין וְאַרְבָּעֵן לַיְלִין דָּלָא
אָכִיל וְשָׁתִי,

However, Moshe opined that since he saw that his own body did not eat or drink for forty days and nights,

וְהוּא נִזּוֹן מֵאַסְפִּקְלָרְיָא דְּלַעֲיָלָא, סָבַר דְּכַדָּאִי הוּא לְמִשְׁאֵל דָּא.

and he was nourished by a supernal radiance he opined that he was worthy of this request.

וּמָה אֶתִּיב לֵה? 'לֹא תוּכַל לִרְאוֹת אֶת פָּנַי'. הוּא מָרָא דְּאַפְיָא.

But what was the response to him? "You cannot view My countenance" (Exodus 33:20),⁸ referring to the Master of the Presence the Angel Metatron.

וְלֹא יִהְיֶה לֵיה רְשׁוּתָא כּו'

And he was not given permission...⁹

כִּי מַט"ט הֵנָּה הוּא כּוֹלֵל אֶת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

for the Angel Metatron includes all the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Assiya,

וּכְמ"ש בְּזוּה"ק פ' וַיְחִי רַכ"ג רַע"ב: חֵד עוֹלִימָא דְּאוּרְכִיה מְרִישָׁא
דְּעֵלְמָא לְסִיפֵי דְּעֵלְמָא.

as the holy Zohar (Vayechi 223b) states in reference to the Angel Metatron: One 'youth' who extends from the beginning of the world of Beriah to the end of the world of Assiyah.¹⁰

וְאָמְרוּ עוֹד בְּתִקּוּנֵי תִקּוּן ס"ח שֶׁכָּל דְּיוֹקְנֵי דְּמַלְאַכְיָא

The *Tikunim* (Tikun 68) states further that all the images of the angels

וְדִּיּוּקָנֵינוּ דְּנִשְׁמָתֵינוּ וְדִּיּוּקָנֵינוּ דְּכָל מָה דְּאֵתְבָרִי בְּשִׁמְיָא וּבְאַרְעָא כְּלָם
כְּלוּלִים בּוּ.

and all the images of the soul, and all the images of whatever was created in the
heavens and earth are all included in him in Metatron,

כִּי הוּא צוּרָתָם וְלֹכֵן לֹא הָיָה אִפְשָׁר גַּם לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ ע"ה בְּהִיּוּתוֹ
בַּהֲעוּרָה"ז לְרֹאוֹתוֹ בְּחוּשׁ.

for he is their form, and therefore even Moshe Rabbeinu could not apprehend
him with his sense of sight while he Moshe was in this world.

כִּי אֵי אִפְשָׁר לְאָדָם לְרֹאוֹת תַּאֲר הַצּוּרָה בְּשׁוּם אִפֹּן

Because it is absolutely impossible for a person to see the image of a *tzurah*,

מֵאַחֵר שֶׁבַּעֲרַךְ הַגּוּף אֵין לְהַצּוּרָה תְּמוּנָה וְתַאֲר כָּלֵל וְכִנּוּי:

since, compared with the body, the *tzurah* does not have a picture and an image
at all, as mentioned.

הַתְּבוּנוֹת בְּכָל הַדְּבָרִים הֵלְלוּ הַגַּם שִׁפְשׁוּטִים הֵם,

So contemplate all of these matters, even though they are straightforward,

וְקַח אוֹתָם בְּלִבְךָ כִּי הֵם מֵהַקְדָּמוֹת הַנִּצְרָכוֹת מְאֹד

and take them to heart, for they are the exceedingly necessary introduction

לְכָל מִי שֶׁרוֹצֶה לְכַנֵּס בְּעֵדֶן גֵּן אֱלֹהִים

for anyone who wishes to enter Eden, the Garden of God,

וּלְטַעַם טַעַם עֵץ הַחַיִּים כְּדֵי לְהִדְבֵּק בְּאֱלֹהִים חַיִּים,

and savor the taste of the Tree of Life in order to cleave to the Living God.

וְהַקְדָּמָנוּ כ"ז לְהַרְחִיק אֶת הַתְּפִיסָה וְהַדְמִיוֹן מִכָּל מָה שֶׁנִּדְבָּר עוֹד
בְּזֶה לַמַּטָּה.

We have made this introduction in order to dissociate people from the mistaken
idea and erroneous impression that will be discussed below.

וְע"ז אָמְרוּ (בְּהַקְדָּמַת הַזֹּהַר ז' רע"א) 'וְאִם רָץ לִבְךָ שׁוּב לְאֶחָד'.

In this regard, our Sages declared (in the Introduction to the *Zohar* p. 7a) "If
your heart runs, return to the One,"

כִּי גַם וְהַחַיּוֹת שֶׁבְּמִרְכָּבָה הֵם רָצוּא וְשׁוּב:

because even the angels of the Divine Chariot (the *Merkava*), known as the
*chayot***, are in a state of 'running and returning'*** (See Ezekiel 1:14).

The intention here is that even the holy angels, who are capable of great profundity
of thought, grasp these lofty ideas only fleetingly and must return to a lower level in

order to process them.¹¹

Footnotes

1. Shaar 3, chapter 2.
2. Makover.
3. Thus the *nefesh* is the intermediary by which the body and the higher levels of soul become connected, as the Baal HaLeshem will explain below (Makover).
4. Another way of saying this is that the 'footprint' of the *tzurah* becomes less and less obvious.
5. *Chochmah* as an unformed flash of revelation or insight is compared to a drop of semen, while *binah*, which develops and fleshes out the seminal idea, is compared to the womb where the drop develops into a fully formed embryo. See e.g. Ramak's *Eilimah ma'ayan* 3, *tamar* 6, chapter 15; *Etiz Chaim sha'ar* 39, chap. 6.
6. p. 13b in our printed version.
7. The context: Aaron and Miriam criticized Moshe for divorcing his wife Tzipora, which he had done due to the fact that he was always on call to God and could not fulfill his marital duties. They argued that they too were prophets had received Divine communication, and yet they remained married. In response, God called Moshe and Miriam and Aaron to the Tent of Meeting where He declared that Moshe's prophecy was different from theirs – "I make Myself known to them in a vision; I speak to them in a dream. This is not true of My servant Moshe, who is a trusted servant throughout My house. With him I speak face to face..."
8. The entire verse: וַיֹּאמֶר לֹא תוֹכַל לִרְאוֹת אֶת פָּנַי כִּי לֹא יִרְאֵנִי הָאָדָם וְחַי
9. The *Zohar* ibid continues: "until his soul departed from him" on the day of his passing from this world.
10. His head in Beriah, his body in Yetzirah, and his feet in Asiyah. Makover.
11. See Makover.

Chapter 2 — The revelation of the Divine Light in the world of Atsilus and in the worlds of Bi"a (bria, yetsira, asiya) via His Holy Names.

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 2

Parts of Bi'a that are Divine and those that are not.

Matter of God's Names.

ומעתה נאמר עוד כי הנה לעיל שער ג' נתבאר כי מהנשמה
הכללית ולמעלה

Now we can state further, after what was explained in Sha'ar 3 chapter 3 – that from the macro-level *neshama* and above

הוא כלו אלהות גמור גם בכל העולמות בי"ע.

is all completely Godliness, even in the Worlds of BiY" A Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וכן ברוח ונפש הכלליים הנה אמרנו שם ג"כ

Similarly, regarding macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*, we also stated there in Sha'ar 3, chapter 3

כי היחידה שבהם הוא אלהות גמור גם בהעשייה.

that their level of *yechida* i.e. the micro-level *yechida* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* is also completely Godliness.

ובעולם היצירה הנה גם החיה אלהות.

And in the World of Yetzirah the level of *chaya* is also Godliness.

ובעולם הבריאה הנה גם הנשמה אלהות.

And in the World of Beriah even the level of *neshama* is Godliness.

והנה כל אלו הבחינות הגם שהם אלהות גמור

Thus it is that all of these aspects, even though they are completely Godliness,

עכ"ז הנה נתצמצמו ועומדים בבחינת צורה פנימית

are nevertheless constrained into the state of an internal *tzurah* (a configuration of spiritual powers and qualities defined by certain parameters

לכל התוארים דתכונת קומת פרצוף אדם אשר בהעולמות בי"ע.

with all the demarcations of the stature of the *partzuf* or the 'persona' of Adam in the Worlds of BiY" A.

וכגון היחידה שבהרוח ונפש דעולם העשייה.

For example, the *yechidah* of *ruach* and *nefesh* of the World of Asiyah,

וכן מהנשמה הכללית שבה ולמעלה,

and from its macro-level of *neschama* and above,

הגם שהם אלהות גמור, הנה הם עומדים בבחי' צורה פנימית

even though they are completely Godliness, they nevertheless have the status of an internal *tzurah* a defined configuration of spiritual powers etc. –

שהוא נשמה לנשמה לכל התוארי דתכונת קומת אדם דעשיה

as the *neschama* of the *neschama* for all the parameters of the stature of Adam of Asiyah

אשר הם מהחיה הפרטית דהרוח ונפש שבה ולמטה,

and this *neschama* of *neschama* is from the micro-level *chaya* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* and below.

In other words, in the persona of Adam of Asiyah, the macro level *ruach* and *nefesh* are not Godliness from the micro-level of *chaya* and below.

ובעולם היצירה אשר החיה והיחידה דהרוח ונפש שבו,

In the World of Yetzirah, where the micro-level *chaya* and *yechida* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

וכן מהנשמה הכללית שבו ולמעלה,

and even its macro-level *neschama* and above,

הנה הגם שהם אלהות גמור, עכ"ז הנה הם עומדים בבחי' צורה פנימית

even though they are completely Godliness, nevertheless, they are in a state of an internal *tzurah* –

שהוא נשמה לנשמה לכל התוארי דתכונת קומת אדם בהיצירה

which is the *neschama* of the *neschama* for all the parameters of the stature of Adam of Yetzirah,

אשר הם מהנשמה הפרטית דהרוח ונפש שבו ולמטה.

that are from the micro-level *neschama* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* and below.

In the World of Yetzirah, the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* are not Godliness from the micro-level of *neschama* and below.

ובעולם הבריאה אשר מהנשמה הפרטית והכללית שבה ולמעלה
הוא כלו אלהות גמור.

In the World of Beriah, from the micro-level and macro-level *neshama* and above is all completely Godliness,

עכ"ז הנה הם עומדים בבחי' צורה ונשמה פנימית

nevertheless, they are in a state of internal *tzurah* and *neshama*

לכל התוארי דתכונות קומת אדם דהבריאה

for all the parameters of the stature of Adam of Beriah;

אשר הם מהרוח הפרטי דרוח ונפש שבה ולמטה:

i.e. from micro-level *ruach* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* and below.

In the World of Beriah, the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* are not Godliness from the micro-level of *ruach* and below.

אמנם ראוי לנו לדעת מאד, כי עכ"ז הנה יש חלוק גדול

****However, it is proper for us to know that there is still a big distinction ****

בין כל אותן הצורות אשר הם מהבי"ע עצמן, והם אינם אלהות.

between all those *tzurot* (configurations, plural of *tzurah*) that are from BiY" A themselves, and are not Godliness,

לכל אותן הבחי' הנזכרים שהם אלהות.

and all those aspects mentioned that *are* Godliness.

הגם שהם מתלבשים ועומדים בהם בבחי' צורה פנימית להם

This is so **even though** the latter Godly aspects **are clothed in an inner state within them** in the aspects that are not Godliness **as their internal *tzurah*.**

כי כל אותן הצורות אשר הם אינם אלהות והם מהמציאות
דהעולמות עצמן.

Because all those *tzurot* that are not Godliness, but are part of the reality of the worlds themselves,

הנה כל התכונות והאיכות והכחות דקומת אדם שבהם

all of the characteristics and the qualities and faculties of the stature of Adam in them

הנה הם עצמיים בהם והם מחיבים עליהם, כי כל זה הוא עקר
מציאותם.

are intrinsic to them i.e. they are essential to who they are, **and they are 'compelled' by them, since all of them** – their characteristics and the qualities and faculties – **are their primary existence.**

'Compelled by them' in this context means that these characteristics etc. form the intrinsic parameters and classifications of their existence.

שְׁכָל צוּרָתָם וְתוֹאֲרָם וְתִמְוִנָתָם הוּא עֲצֻמִּית בָּהֶם,

For their entire *tzurah* and their description and image are intrinsic to them,

וְרַק זֶהוּ מְצִיאוֹתָם גּוֹפָה לֹא זוּלָתָהּ.

and are their very existence, to the exclusion of any others – other qualities and characteristics do not define their existence.

מִשָּׂא"כ כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַבְּחִי' הַמֵּתְלַבָּשִׁים בָּהֶם מֵאֲלָהוּת.

But this is not so regarding all those Godly aspects that become clothed within them

Note that the following parenthetical statement will continue for several lines:

הִנֵּה הַגֵּם שֶׁהֵם נִתְצַמְצְמוּ ג"כ וּמֵתְלַבָּשִׁים וְעוֹמְדִים בְּבְחִי' צוּרָה פְּנִימִית

- for even though they also become constricted, and become clothed within them as an inner *tzurah*,

וּפְנִימִית לְפְנִימִית לְכָל אוֹתוֹן הַתְּכוּנוֹת וְהַתּוֹאֲרִים אֲשֶׁר בְּהַצּוּרוֹת דְּהַבִּי"ע עֲצֻמָּן.

and as the innermost aspect of all those characteristics and parameters of the *tzurot* of AbiY" A,

וְהֵרִי מֵתּוֹאֲרִים הֵם מֵעַתָּה ג"כ בְּכָל אוֹתוֹן הַתּוֹאֲרִים כָּלָם,

and they too are characterized from this point on by all those parameters,

וְלֹא עוֹד אֵלָּא שְׁכָל שֶׁהוּא יוֹתֵר פְּנִימִי הִנֵּה הוּא יוֹתֵר עֲקָרִי

(and furthermore, the more internal it is the more fundamental it is,

וְהוּא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ לְכָל הָעֲנִינִים כָּלָם אֲשֶׁר נִבְחַן וְנִעֲשָׂה בְּהַחֲצוּנִית

so that it serves as the root-cause for all of those aspects that are identified and produced externally

וּבְהַחֲצוּנִית דְּחִיצוּנִית אֲשֶׁר הוּא מֵתְלַבֵּשׁ בָּהֶם,

including the outermost aspects in which it becomes cloaked) –

שְׁכָל הָעֲנִינִים שֶׁבָּהֶם כָּלָם הֵם מִסְתַּעְפִּים וְנִמְצָאִים וְנִעֲשִׂים רַק מִמֶּנּוּ.

all of these external aspects branch out of and emerge from and are produced by it exclusively by the inner *tzurah*. This is the end of the parenthetical statement.

עכ"ז הנה כל אותן הענינים כלם אינם ח"ו תוארים עצמיים בהם כלל,

Nevertheless, of all those matters, none of them are parameters integral to them, God forbid.

אלא שהם רק ע"ד המשל שאמרו ברע"מ פ' בא מ"ב ב'

Instead, they are like the analogy given in *Raya Mehemna*, Bo p. 42b

מהמים הנכנסים בהכלי שנעשה בהמים צורת הכלי

of water poured into a container, where the water takes on the shape of the container

אם עגל או משלש או מרבע וצורת כל גבוליה.

- whether round or triangular or square – according to the shape of its the container's boundaries.

ובהכלי הנה הם צורת עצמיים

As regards the container, the *tzurah* is an integral aspect thereof;

אבל בהמים הרי אינם עצמיים כלל

however, as regards the water in the container, the *tzurah* is not an integral aspect of it at all.

אלא שנעשה הצורה בהמים ע"י הכלי

Rather the water temporarily acquires that *tzurah* from the container

כי נתצמצמו המים בגבולי הכלי

because the water becomes confined within the boundaries of the container

ונצטיר בהם ע"י הכלי כל צורת הגבולים שבה.

and is shaped by them, as long as it is in the container whose entire shape is defined by those boundaries.

The water itself has no inherent shape or *tzurah*, it merely temporarily acquires the shape imposed on it by the vessel as long as it remains contained therein.

וכן הוא עד"ז בעניננו, כי כל אותן האורות פנימיות שהם אלהות

Similarly with our concept: all those intrinsic Godly illuminations i.e. those manifested as immanent, innate *tzurot*,

באשר שמתפשטים להיות שרש להנרנח"י דהבי"ע

when they diffuse throughout to become the root-cause of the *nrnch*"y of BiY"A

לְכָל הַכָּחוֹת וְהַתְּכוּנוֹת מֵהוּיּוֹת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם שֶׁרָצָה בָּהֶם,

as the soul-roots for all the powers and characteristics defining the persona of the *partzuf* of man the way He wanted them to be,

הִנֵּה נִקְרָא אוֹתוֹ הַשֵּׁרֶשׁ אַחֵר שֶׁרָצָה לְהַמְצִיא אֶת כָּל הַתְּכוּנוֹת
דְּמָהוּת אָדָם וּלְהַתְפַּשֵּׁט בַּהֲיוּתָם,

that root-cause is named – since He wished to produce all of the characteristics delineating the *partzuf* of man, and extend into their existence –

הִנֵּה נִקְרָא הוּא בְּכָל הַתּוֹאֲרִים הֵלְלוּ ג"כ ע"י הַתְּלַבְּשׁוּ בָּהֶם,

and is designated by all those parameters, by virtue of being clothed within them,

In other words, the soul-root clothed within those human characteristics etc. is given the same name that the sum of those human characteristics is known by – Adam

וע"ד הַמִּים שֶׁנֶּצְטִירוּ בְּכָל גְּבוּלֵי הַכֵּלִי ע"י הַכֵּלִי וְכַנְזָכָר.

similar to the way all the contours of the container are ascribed to the water in it, as mentioned.

אָבָל אֵין כָּל הַתּוֹאֲרִים הֵלְלוּ עֲצָמִיִּים בּוֹ ח"ו [חֶסֶד וְשָׁלוֹם]

However, just like the water in a container, none of these contours are part of its the water's essence, heaven forbid,

כִּי עֲצָמוּתָם מִמֶּשׁ הוּא רַק בַּהֲבִי"ע גּוֹפָה.

since they are fundamentally merely characteristics of BiY" A itself, and not of their root-cause in Atzilut.

אֲלֹא ע"י שֶׁהַתְּפִשֵּׁט אֹרֹךְ רְצוֹנוֹ בְּמַצִּיאוֹתָם נִקְרָא הוּא ג"כ בָּהֶם כָּלָם,

But because His will spreads though their existence, it the light of His will is also referred to by all those terms

ע"י שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה אֹרֹךְ רְצוֹנוֹ לְהִיּוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ לְכָל זֶה.

by virtue of the light of His will being revealed as their root-cause.

וְהוּא ע"ד שֶׁכְּתוּב (הוֹשֵׁעַ יב, יא) "וַיִּבְדּוּ הַנְּבִיאִים אֶדְמָה",

This is similar to what is written in the verse, "Through the Prophets I am depicted in metaphors" (*Hosea 12:11*)

שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה לְכָל אֶחָד כְּפִי כָחוֹ.

– for He is revealed to each Prophet according to his individual aptitudes.

וכמ"ש בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא רַבְתִּי פִּיסקָא כ"א: "בְּדַמּוּיוֹת הָרַבָּה נִדְמָה לָהֶם,

As it states in *Pesikta Rabbati* (21): "He appeared to them to the Prophets in many guises –

לְזֶה עֹמֵד לְזֶה יוֹשֵׁב, לְזֶה בָּחוּר לְזֶה זָקֵן כּו' עֵין שָׁם וְכֵן בְּמַכִּילָתָא
בְּשֵׁלַח, יִתְרוֹ.

to this one He was standing, and to another, sitting. To this one He appeared as a young man, to another as an elder, and so on. A similar teaching is found in *Mechilta, parshat Beshalach* and *parshat Yitro*.

כֵּן נִתְגַּלָּה עַד"ז לְצֶרֶךְ כָּלל הָעוֹלָמוֹת דְּבִי"ע

Similarly, He becomes revealed according to the needs of the Worlds of BiY"A in general,

לְהִיּוֹת שְׂרָשׁ לְכָל הַתּוֹאֲרִים הַלְלוּ אֲשֶׁר הִמְצִיא אֶת הָעוֹלָמוֹת
עֲלֵיהֶם,

thus becoming the root-cause of all those representations such as Creator, Former, Maker etc. by way of which He produces the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah respectively.

וְנִקְרָא הוּא ג"כ בְּאוֹתָן הַתּוֹאֲרִים עַל שֵׁם שֶׁהוּא שְׂרָשׁ.

And He too is referred to by way of those same designations because He is their root-cause.

וְעֵין בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ בְּעֵקֶדִים פ"ג אוֹת ה' וּבִסְפֵר הַדַּע"ה ח"א דָּרוֹשׁ ה'
סִימָן ז' בְּאֵרוֹכָה בְּזֶה.

**See in our exposition *Akudim* chapter 3, *siman* 5, and in *Sefer Ha'De'ah* part 1, *Drush* 5, *siman* 5 and *siman* 7 at length in this regard. **

וְעַל כָּל פָּנִים הוּא כִּי בּוֹ אֵינָם עֲצָמִים ח"ו,

In any event, these representations and designation are not of His essence, heaven forbid.

אֶלָּא שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם לְהִיּוֹת שְׂרָשׁ לְהִבִּי"ע.

They apply only because He is revealed in them as the root-cause of BiY"A

וְגַם לֹא נִקְרָא בּוֹ אֶלָּא ע"י הִבִּי"ע

and they only refer to Him via BiY"A

אַחַר שֶׁמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּפָנִימִית פְּנִימִיּוֹתָם לְהִמְצִיאָם בְּדֶרֶךְ זֶה.

after He permeates them and becomes clothed in their innermost aspect in order to produce them thereby.

וְרָצוֹנוֹ לומר בְּכָל זֶה כִּי הָרִי בְּהִמְשָׁל מֵהֵמָּה שֶׁבְּכָלִי שְׁאִמְרָנוּ,

The intention here is that the analogy we mentioned of water in a container –

הנה המים כאשר נכנסים בהכלי ונעשה גם בהם כל צורת גבולי הכלי וכנזכר

where the water enters the container and is shaped by the boundaries of the container –

הנה הגם שכל אותה הצורה אינה עצמית בהם אבל על כל פנים הוא כי היא מחיבת בהם.

albeit that the entire shape of the water imposed on it by the container is not of its essence, nevertheless, the water is in fact compelled into that shape by those boundaries,

שגבולי הכלי מתגבר על תכונת הנוזל שבמים ומצמצם אותם בגבוליה נגד טבעם.

so that the boundaries of the container override the fluidity of the water and constrict it to the container's boundaries, contrary to their nature.

משא"כ בעניננו הנה כל התוארים שנעשה לאור אלה

This is not so as regards this matter – the Godly light bounded by the vessels of the *sefirot* – all of the metaphoric descriptive terms and parameters that are attributed to the Godly light,

ע"י שמתפשט בהתהוות המהות אדם דהבי"ע

by virtue of that light extending into the creation of the 'persona' of Adam of BiY"A,

ונעשה נשמה וצורה פנימית להם

where it becomes their soul and inner form,

ונתצמצם אותו האור ג"כ לכל התוארים הללו אשר המציא אותם בהבי"ע.

and that same light is also constrained into all of those descriptive terms or titles which it produced in BiY"A,

הנה כל הצמצום הזה הנעשה בו הוא אינה מחיבת בו ח"ו.

all of those constraints imposed on it on that light do not compel Him in any way, heaven forbid.

אלא שהוא רק רצונית.

Instead, those constraints are discretionary and are by choice.

כי הרי אדרבה הוא שאותו האור הוא מעמיד את כל התארי דמהות אדם שבהבי"ע

On the contrary, it is the light itself that establishes all of the parameters of the metaphor delineating the 'persona' of Adam in the Worlds of BiY" A.

It is not the parameters and characteristics of the *partzuf* that define the contours of the light; it is the Godly light that ultimately defines the parameters and characteristics of the *partzuf*.

וּמוֹצִיא וּמַהֲוֶה אוֹתָם בְּרָצוֹנוֹ וּמִתְצַמֵּץ בְּרָצוֹנוֹ לְהַמְצִיָּאם בְּכָל
הַתּוֹאֲרִים הָאֵלֶּה

It is the Godly light that **produces and creates them according to His will, and by His will the light is constricted into all these descriptive metaphors**

וְלִהְיוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ לָהֶם בְּכָל עֵת קִיּוּמָם וְהוּא רַק רָצוֹנִית בּוֹ "וּבְרָצוֹתוֹ
חוֹגֵג וּבְרָצוֹתוֹ מְמוֹגֵג".

to become their root-cause throughout their being, and this is discretionary i.e. not compelled, as the prayer-book¹ states, "like molten glass in the hands of the glass-blower – **he shapes it as he wishes and he melts it as he wishes...**

Just like a glass-blower decides the shape of the glass vessel he makes, so too, God designs the *partzufim* in whatever way He chooses.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הִבְחִנַּת כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַתּוֹאֲרִים אֲשֶׁר בְּאוֹר אֱלֹהִים
שֶׁבְּפִנִּימִיּוֹתָם הוּא לֹא בִּפְעֹל,

So it turns out that discerning all those metaphoric descriptions that are in the Godly light, that in their inner core they are not actually manifest,

שֶׁהוּא בּוֹ עֶצְמוֹ ח"ו,

in other words, they are not **in Him, heaven forbid,**

אֲלֹא רַק בִּפְעֻלָּה שֶׁהוּא לִפְעֹל וְלַעֲשׂוֹת אוֹתוֹן הַתּוֹאֲרִים הָעֶצְמִיִּים
בְּמַצִּיאוֹת הַבִּי"ע

rather, they are manifested through an activity – when He brings about and creates those metaphoric descriptions that are an essential aspect of the existence of BiY" A.

שֶׁהֵם כֻּלָּם בְּמַהוּת אָדָם כִּנּוּי לְכִנּוּיָּהֶם.

All of them are characteristics delineating the fundamental persona of Adam, as mentioned, and as is known.

The Baal HaLeshem here is expounding the Midrash² which declares that all the Names and appellations ascribed to Hashem are only names of His *activities*, but not of Himself – "According to My deeds am I called," as he will state explicitly later in this chapter.

אָבֵל הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הַמוֹצִיא אוֹתָם בְּכָל זֶה, הֵנָּה אֵין בְּעֶצְמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה
שׁוּם הִבְחָנָה מֵהֶם.

Whereas the inner Divine light that produces them in their entirety, has no trace of them within Himself.

וְהוּא ע"ד כָּל מַצִּיר אִמּוֹן שֶׁמַּצִּיר אֵיזָה צוּרָה

This can be compared to an expert artist who paints a picture on a canvas –

הֵנָּה לֹא נִבְחָן אוֹתָהּ הַצּוּרָה בְּמַחְשַׁבַת הָאִמּוֹן

surely that picture itself cannot be identified in the artist's mind;

אֲלֹא רַק מָה שֶׁנוֹגַע לְאוֹתָהּ הַפְּעֻלָּה לְבַד, וְהוּא רַק מָה שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ
מִמֶּנּוּ לְהַפְּעֻלָּה.

only that which is relevant to that particular activity, and which is drawn from it from the artist's imagination into that activity.

שֶׁהֵרִי כָּל צִיּוֹר הַפְּעֻלָּה אֲשֶׁר נַעֲשִׂית בְּמַחְשַׁבְתּוֹ הֵרִי הוּא רַק לְצִרְךָ
הַפְּעֻלָּה,

Accordingly, the entire act of forming the picture in his mind is only for the sake of the activity of painting that image on the canvas

וְאֵינוֹ נוֹגַע בְּאַמֶּת לוֹ לְעֶצְמוֹ כָּלֵל.

but it does not truly impact him the artist at all.

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (מְלָאכִי ג') "כִּי אֲנִי ה' לֹא שִׁנִּיתִי".

This is the meaning of the verse that states (*Malachi 3:6*) "For I, God, have not changed."

כִּי הֵרִי כָּל הַצְמָצוּם הַזֶּה הַנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּאוֹרוֹ

For the entire *tzimtzum* the contraction of the *Ohr Ein Sof* which is implemented in His light

הֵנָּה הוּא רַק מָה שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ מִמֶּנּוּ לְצוּרַת הָעוֹלָמוֹת,

is drawn from Him only for the purpose of structuring the Worlds.

אָבֵל בּוֹ בְּעֶצְמוֹ זוּלַת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ הֵנָּה לֹא נַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ שׁוּם שְׁנוִי כָּלֵל:

But in Himself, other than in His actions, there is no change at all.

וְהֵנָּה כָּל הַתּוֹאֲרִים שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּאוֹתוֹ אוֹר אֱלֹהִים, בְּבַחֲיִנַת
רְצוֹנִית כְּנֻזָּכָר,

Thus all of the descriptive metaphorical terms we mentioned that are initiated in that Godly light are by virtue of His will, as noted,

ע"י שרצה להיות שרש לכל התוארים העצמיים והעקריים
שבהבי"ע.

– due to His desire that there be a root-cause above³ for all those descriptive terms and metaphors that are essential and primary in BiY"A –

הנה הם עשרה שמות הקדושים המבארים בזוה"ק פ' ויקרא י' וי"א
and those are the ten Holy Names explained in the Holy Zohar, Vayikra p. 10, 11

וכן בתקונים תקון ע' קמ"א סע"ב וקמ"ב רע"ב, והובא בבאור
היטיב בדברי הרב בסוף שער דרושי אבי"ע והם:

and in the *Tikunim* (the *Tikunei Zohar*), *Tikun 70* at the bottom of p. 141b and the top of p. 142b

אֱהִיָּהּ יְהִי הַיְיָ בְּנִקּוּד אֱלֹהִים. אֵל. אֱלֹהִים. הַיְיָ. הַיְיָ צְבָאוֹת.
אֱלֹהִים צְבָאוֹת. אֵל חַי שְׂדֵי אֲדֹנֵי.

These ten Names are: *Ehye*"h; *Ya*"h; *Havaye* vocalized as *E-lohim*; *E-l*; *E-lohim*; *Havaye*; *Havaye Tzva'ot*; *E-lohim Tzva'ot*; *E-l Chai Sha-dai*; *Adon-ai*.

כי אלו העשרה שמות הם אורו וגלוייו ית"ש אשר נתגלה בהם

For these ten Names are the lights and revelations the *sefirot* in which He becomes revealed, may He be blessed,

להיות שרש לתוצאות כל המהות אדם שבהעולמות בי"ע.

and they become the root-cause of the developments of the entire persona of Adam in the Worlds of BiY"A:

כי הג' ראשונות, שהם אֱהִיָּה יְהִי הַיְיָ בְּנִקּוּד אֱלֹהִים,

For the first three Names, *Ehye*"h; *Ya*"h; *Havaye* vocalized as *E-lohim*,

הם הגלוי והשרש להקרקפתא והגלגלתא כלו בכללות הג' מחין
שבו.

are the revelation and root of the entire head and skull, including the three aspects of the brain therein.

Specifically, *Ehye*"h corresponds to *keter*; *Ya*"h corresponds to *chochmah*; *Havaye* vocalized as *E-lohim* corresponds to *binah*.

הב' שמות אל אלהים הם הגלוי והשרש להב' ידים ימין ושמאל.

And the two Names *E-l* and *E-lohim* are the revelation and the root of the two arms, right and left.

The right arm (*chesed*) corresponds to *E-l*, and the left (*gevurah*) to *E-lohim*

שם הַיְיָ ב"ה כשהוא בלי נקדה הוא הגלוי והשרש לכללות הגוף,

The Name Havaye, blessed is He, without vowel points, is the revelation and root of the torso in general corresponding to *tiferet*

אֲשֶׁר עַד הַטְּבוֹר אֲשֶׁר שֵׁם הַלֵּב וְהַרְיָאָה שֶׁהַחַיִּים תָּלוּי בָּהֶם.

from the neck down **where the heart and lungs are situated (upon them life depends) – until the navel.**

הַיְוִה צְבֹאוֹת אֱלֹהִים צְבֹאוֹת הֵם הַגְּלוּי וְהַשָּׁרֵשׁ לְהַתְרִין כּוֹלֵין תְּרִין בִּיעוֹ תְּרִין יִרְכִין.

Havaye Tzva'ot and E-lohim Tzva'ot are revelation and root of the two kidneys, the two testicles and the two thighs corresponding to *netzach* and *hod*.

אֵל חַי שְׂדֵי הוּא כָּלוּ שֵׁם אֶחָד, וְהוּא הַגְּלוּי וְהַשָּׁרֵשׁ לְאוֹת בְּרִית קֹדֶשׁ.

E-I Chai Sha-dai is all one Name, and it is the revelation and root of the organ that bears the sign of the holy covenant, corresponding to *yesod*.

אֲדֹנֵי הוּא הַגְּלוּי וְהַשָּׁרֵשׁ לְכָל פְּרָצוֹף הַנִּקְבָּא אֲשֶׁר הִיא שְׁלִימוֹ דְּאָדָם.

Adon-ai is the revelation and root of the entire *partzuf* of *nukvah malchut*, the female element, which is the completion of the stature of Adam and corresponds to *malchut*,

כִּי עַל יְדֵה נַעֲשֶׂה אָדָם שָׁלֵם וְכַמ"ש "זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בָּרָאם... וַיִּקְרָא אֶת שֵׁמָם אָדָם".

because it is through her *nukvah* or *malchut*, that Adam becomes complete, as the verse (Genesis 5:2) **states, "Male and female He created them... and He called their name Adam." **

וְהָרִי הָיוּ אֵלּוּ הָעֶשְׂרֵה שִׁמּוֹת הַגְּלוּיִם שֶׁבְּאוֹר אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם

Thus these ten Names are revelations of the Godly light which is revealed in them

לְהַעֲשׂוֹת שָׁרֵשׁ לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּקוֹמַת אָדָם דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

so that they become the root of the entire being of the stature of Adam in the Worlds of Biy"A.

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁאָמַר הוּא ית"ש לְמַשָּׁה רַבְּנּוּ ע"ה (בשמו"ר פ"ג סִימָן ו')

****This is as the Holy One, blessed is He, said to Moses our Master, peace be upon him (*Midrash Rabba, Exodus 3:6*) ****

"שְׁמִי אֵתָּה מִבְּקֵשׁ לֵידַע? לִפִּי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי נִקְרָא".

"My Name you wish to know? According to My deeds I am called."

כִּי כָּל גְּלוּיָיו וְשִׁמּוֹתָיו הוּא רַק לְפַעֲלוּתָיו לְבַד,

This is because all of His revelations and Names refer only to His actions,

וְכָל מָה שֶׁאֲנוּ אוֹמְרִים בּוֹ שֶׁנִּתְצַמְצַם הֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּמָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה לַפְעֻלָּתוֹ.

and everything that we say about Him that expresses limitation (i.e. whatever is constricted by the *Tzimtzum*) refers only to that which becomes revealed as an action of His.

וּבִאוּתוֹ הַגִּלּוּי הַנִּמְשָׁךְ מֵאַמְתּוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה לַפְעֻלּוֹתָיו הֵנָּה בְּזֶה לְבַד נִתְצַמְצַם,

It is in that revelation that is drawn down from His true recondite i.e. incomprehensible Self into His actions – it is only in this that He is constrained, but not in His essence,

וְהוּא גִלּוּיוֹ וְהוּא שְׁמוֹ. אֲבָל זוּלַת גִּלּוּיוֹ לַפְעֻלָּתוֹ הָרִי לֹא נִתְצַמְצַם כָּלֵל

and that revelation from Him is His Name. But besides His being revealed in His actions, He is not constrained by the *tzimtzum* at all;

וְלֹא נִתְפָּס בְּשֵׁם כָּלֵל. כִּי אֵין גָּבול אֵלָיו וְאֵין גִּלּוּי אֵלָיו:

He is not captured within a Name at all, for He is without limitations and there is nothing that can reveal Him.

אֲמָנָם כָּל אוֹתוֹ הַגִּלּוּיִם אֲשֶׁר לַפְעֻלּוֹתָיו,

However, all those revelations via His actions,

הֵנָּה הוּא מָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה הוּא עֲצָמוֹ בָּהֶם אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְצַמְצַם,

– are that He Himself is revealed in them even after the *tzimtzum* –

וְהֵם הַשְּׁמוֹת שֶׁל אֲמָתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ לֹא זוּלַת ח"ו.

such that those revelations are His true Names, not anything else, heaven forbid.

אֲלֹא שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בְּכָל אוֹתוֹ הַשְּׁמוֹת כֹּלֵן רַק אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְצַמְצַם,

However, He is revealed in all of those Names only after the *tzimtzum*;

אֲבָל הֵם עַל אֲמָתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ.

but they still refer to His true being.

וּכְשֶׁאֲנוּ קוֹרְאִים אוֹתוֹ בְּשְׁמוֹ וְכֵן כְּשֶׁאֲנוּ עוֹבְדִים לְשְׁמוֹ,

So that when we call out to Him by Name, and when we toil in our spiritual service **for His sake, **

כִּי כָּל הָעֲבוּדָה הוּא רַק לְשְׁמוֹ כִּמוֹ שִׁיתְבָּאֵר לְקָמוֹ, הֵנָּה עוֹמֵד הַקְּרִיָּאָה וְהָעֲבוּדָה אֵלָיו עֲצָמוֹ,

all that toil is only for His sake, as we will explain below, that calling out and that service is to Him Himself –

שהוא לכל אמתת עצמותו הנעלמה אליו גופה.

it is entirely to His true concealed essence itself.

כי הוא עצמו נתגלה ע"י הצמצום בהשם הויה ב"ה ובכל השמות וכינוים המסתעפים ממנו.

For He Himself is revealed when He constricts Himself into His Name Havaye, may He be blessed.

והוא על דרך האדם היושב בבית ומשתמש באור החלון שהוא ד' על ד',

This may be compared to a person who sits in his house and uses the light coming through a window measuring four cubits square,

והרי נתצמצם ג"כ האור בהחלון לפי צורת החלון.

– the light has become constricted to the shape of the window.

הרי אותו אור החלון שמשתמש בו הנה הוא אותו האור עצמו אשר מחוץ לחלון

But the light that he uses as it filters through the window is the very same light that is outside the window,

וממלא את כל חלל העולם כלו, כי הרי הוא נמשך כאחד עם האור שהוא בלא צמצום כלל.

that fills the entire open space of the world; for the light coming through the window is drawn down together with the light that is not constricted at all by the window.

והוא מה שאמרו (יתרו פ"א) "הוא ושמהוה חד הוא":

This is as our Sages **stated (**Zohar II, Yitro 86a) "He and His Name are one.

והנה נתבאר לנו מכל דברינו כאן, שכל הכח פנימי ופנימית לפנימי

Thus, from all of our discussion here, we have clarified that every immanent faculty or power i.e. when a Godly light is contained in a vessel, and every intrinsic aspect of that immanent faculty

דכל התוארי צורות הבי"ע אשר ישנם באור אלהותו ית"ש,

across the entire spectrum of descriptive terms for the various *tzurot* of BiY"A as they are their root-cause in the blessed Godly light,

ע"י שנתגלה להיות שרש להם ומתפשט ומתלבש במציאותם

by becoming revealed as the root-cause of those *tzurot* as they spread into them and become clothed within their existence

הִנֵּה הֵם אֵינָם עֲצָמִים בּוֹ ח"ו.

they these descriptive terms, and even these faculties or powers are nevertheless **not** part of His essence, heaven forbid.

אֵלָּא שֶׁהֵם רַק רְצוֹנִיּוֹת בּוֹ אַחֵר שֶׁרָצָה לְהִתְצַמֵּץ לְהִיּוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ לָזֶה.

Instead they are only discretionary or voluntary in Him – after He decided to impose that constriction in order to become the root-cause thereof.

וְגַם גְּלוּיִים הוּא רַק ע"י הַבִּי"ע. וְכֵן "ל מִמָּשָׁל הַמַּיִם שֶׁבַּכְּלִי.

Furthermore, these illuminations are only via BiY"A, as mentioned above regarding the analogy of water in a container.

וּכְבָּר בְּאַרְנוֹ לְעֵיל פָּרָק א' אֵיךְ שֶׁבְּאַמַּת הִנֵּה רְחוֹק וּמִשּׁוּלָּל הוּא

Now we already explained above in chapter 1 to what extent it is very far from and indeed precluded from us

מִלְתַּפּוֹס אֵיזָה צִיּוֹר וְתֹאֵר וְתִמּוּנָה גַּם בְּהָאֻרוֹת הַיּוֹתֵר פְּנִימִים אֲשֶׁר גַּם מֵהַבִּי"ע עֲצָמוֹ,

to grasp some form or description or image, even of the most immanent illuminations that are from BiY"A itself,

וּמִכַּש"כ [וּמִכָּל שֶׁכֵּן] בְּהָאֹר אֱלוֹהִי שֶׁהוּא רַק הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ הַשָּׂרָשִׁים לָהֶם.

and how much more so in the Godly light which is only the root-cause of their root.

וְגַם כָּל מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁנֶּעֱשֶׂה אֹרֹךְ ית"ש צוּרָה פְּנִימִית לָהֶם,

In addition, everything that we said about His light becoming their inner *tzurah*,

הִנֵּה כְּבָר אֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל שֶׁעַר א' וְכֵן יִתְבָּאֵר עוֹד לְקִמּוֹ בְּדִבְרֵינוּ,

we already stated above in *sha'ar* 1, and it will be explained more further on,

כִּי הוּא רַק בְּתִמְצִית אֹרֹךְ וְהֶאֱרָתוֹ לְבַד מֵהָאֹר שֶׁל מַעְלָה.

that this is only a distillation and a radiance of the light from above.

אֲבָל עֶקֶר אֹר גְּלוּיֹ שֶׁהֵם הָאֻרוֹת דְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים עֲצָמוֹ,

But the primary light of His revelations, which are the lights vested in all of the Holy Names themselves

הִנֵּה הֵם רַק בְּאַצִּילוֹת לְבַד, וְכִמוֹ שֶׁיִּסְדּוּ "וּשְׁכִינַת עֶזוֹ בְּגִבְיָהּ מְרוֹמִים".

these are all in Atzilut alone, as they the *Anshei Knesset HaGedola* established in the *Aleinu* prayer – "and the abode of His majesty is in the loftiest heights."

אֵלֶּא שְׁבִתְמַצִּית אוֹרוֹ בְּרָא וַיֵּצֵר וַעֲשָׂה אֶת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת דְּבִי"ע.

Nevertheless, with a distillation of His light He created, formed and made all the Worlds of BiY" A.

Created corresponds to the World of Beriah, formed corresponds to the World of Yetzirah, and made corresponds to the World of Asiya.

וְהוּא שֶׁרֶשׁ לָהֶם בְּכָל מַצִּיאוֹתָם וְקִיּוּמָם וּבְכָל הַנַּעֲשֶׂה בָּהֶם תָּמִיד

which is the root-cause of their entire existence and their continuity, and of everything that occurs with them at all times.

שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּשְׁמָה לַנֶּשְׁמָה לְכָלֶם, אֲבָל אוֹרוֹ עֲצֻמוֹ הוּא נֶעְלָם בְּתַכְלִית הָהָעֶלָם:

For this is the soul of all their souls. But His own light is concealed absolutely.

Footnotes

1. *Machzor* for Yom Kippur, *piyut* כִּי הִנֵּה פְּחוּמָר [↩](#)

2. See *Shemot Rabba* 3:6 [↩](#)

3. In Atzilut. Cf. Makover note 49. [↩](#)

Chapter 3 — The first three levels of unfolding from above to below (hitpashtut) of Divine Light.

Sha'ar 4, Chapter 3

Divinity is far away from us.

וְהִנֵּה נִדְבֵּר בְּעֵנִין הַזֶּה בְּעֶמֶק יוֹתֵר קִצָּת

Let's now discuss this matter the revelation of His light in a little greater depth

וְנִתְחִיל וְנֹאמַר כִּי כָּל מָה שְׁאַמְרָנוּ מִבְּחִינַת אוֹר אֱלֹהוֹתוֹ ית"ש

We'll begin by saying that everything we said about the aspect of His Godly light (may He be blessed)

אֲשֶׁר נִתְפָּשֵׁט וְנִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַעֲלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְנִעֲשֶׂה צוּרָה לַהֲצוּרָה דְּבִי"ע

that spreads out and becomes clothed in the Worlds of BiY"A, becoming the *tzurah* of the *tzurah* of BiY"A

וְרָצוֹנוּ לֹאמַר הַנִּשְׁמָה לַנִּשְׁמָה לַהֲבִי"ע

- in other words, as explained in the previous chapter, the *neslama* of the *neslama* of BiY"A –

הִנֵּה אוֹתוֹ בְּחִי' אֱלֹהוֹת הַמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ שֵׁם הוּא בְּאֵמֶת רְחוֹק

that aspect of Godliness clothed therein in the Worlds of BiY"A is in truth very distant

מִמְדְּרֹגַת אֲמִתּוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה הָעֲצֻמוֹתִית בּוֹ הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד.

from His hidden essential true Being – very, very distant!

כִּי כָּל מִלַּת וְתֹאֵר אֱלֹהוֹת אֲשֶׁר הוּא ית"ש נִקְרָא בּוֹ,

Because every word and descriptive term for Godliness by which He is called

הִנֵּה הוּא כְּבִיכּוֹל רַק בְּבְחִי' מְדֻרְגָּה הַחֲמִישִׁית מִמְדְּרֹגוֹת הַכְּלָלִיִּים

is, so to speak, only the fifth of the general levels

אֲשֶׁר מֵאַחֵר אֲמִתּוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה וְלִמְטָה.

that ensue from His true concealed being on and down.

The Baal HaLeshem will explain shortly that there are five levels of revelation. The only one we have any access to is the fifth and lowest one.¹

וְהִגַּם שְׁכָל בְּחִי' אֱלֹהוֹת ית"ש הִנֵּה הוּא מֵעַצֵּם הָאֲחָדוֹת לְעוֹלָם,

Now even though every aspect of His Godliness is always part of His essential oneness.

אך הוא ע"ד שאנו רואין חלקת המדרגות בקדשת אורו ית"ש

nevertheless, this can be compared to the division we see of His holy light into five levels of holiness

המתפשט ונמשך בעוה"ז בכל דבר שבקדשה.

that spread out and are drawn down into this world in every holy matter.

כי הרי יש חלוק בין קדשת התורה לקדשת הנביאים וכתובים,

For example: there is a difference between the holiness of the Torah and the holiness of the Prophets and the Writings,

וכו בין קדשת בית המדרש לקדשה בית הכנסת וכמ"ש במגלה כ"ז ע"א.

and between the holiness of a Beit Midrash study hall and a Beit Kneset prayer hall, as is documented in Tractate *Megilah* 27a.

וכו בין כל העשר קדושות שבארץ ישראל. בכלים פ"א.

And similarly there are differences between the ten levels of holiness in the Land of Israel, as mentioned in Mishnah **Keilim 1:**6 ff.

וכו יש חלוק בין קדשת השמות שאינם נמחקים

And similarly there is a difference between the holiness of the Names that may not be erased

לקדשת שאר כל התורה, וכיוצא בזה הרבה.

and the holiness of the rest of Torah, and likewise in numerous similar cases.

וכ"ז הוא ע"ד הכתוב (איוב י"ט) "ומבשרי אחזה אלוה".

All of this similar to the way the verse (Job 19:26**) "From my flesh I see God" is explained:

כי הוא ע"ד חיות האדם,

– Just as with the life-force of a person,

שהגם שהנשמה הוא ממלא אותו בכל מלואו ונעשה על ידו כל הגוף כלו חי

albeit that the soul fills the entire body, by virtue of which the entire body is alive,

עכ"ז הרי יש חלוק גדול בין החיות שבמוח ולב להחיות שבשאר אברים.

nevertheless, there is a tremendous difference between the life-force of the brain and the heart and the life-force of the rest of the body.

The implication is that since the life of the body depends upon the brain and the heart (the *vital* organs), the life-force invested in them is superior to that animating the rest of the body. For if a limb had to be removed (God forbid) this would not cause the person's death (under normal circumstances), whereas removing a vital organ would.

וכן הוא עד"ז בכל גלוייו ית"ש אשר נתגלה ויצא בהם מאמתתו הנעלמה,

And similarly with all of God's revelations that are revealed from and emerge from His true concealed being –

הנה הנה ממשיך גלוייו בבחי' חלקת מדרגות רבות אין חקר.

His revelations are drawn down in innumerable diverse levels.

Some of these levels are seen to be absolutely vital, i.e. the existence of the worlds depends upon them; other levels are of lesser importance and are perhaps even discretionary.

אך מדרגות הכוללים הנה הם ה' מדרגות,

But in general there are five levels,

והוא שרש השרשים לה' בחי' נשמה שבכל עולם שהם נרנח"י.

and He is the root-cause of all the roots of the five levels of soul in each of the Worlds, which are *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya and yechida* (nrnch"y).

ואור אלהותו ית"ש המתפשט ומתלבש בבחי' נשמה לנשמה בהעולמות בי"ע.

And His Godly light that spreads forth and clothes itself in the *nesnema* of the *nesnema* of the Worlds of BiY"A

הנה הוא רק המדרגה החמישית.

is merely the fifth level down.

ואלו הם ה' מדרגות:

Now these are the five levels:

א' הוא אור אין סוף המזכר בכל דברי הזוה"ק והאריז"ל.

1. **The *Ohr Ein Sof* the Infinite Light mentioned throughout the *Zohar* and the writings of the *Arizal*.**

והוא גלוייו הראשונה מאמתתו הנעלמה

This is the first revelation from His true concealed being

אשר אין לנו ולא לשום נברא וגם לא להנאצלים כלם שום תפיסה

of which we have no conceptual grasp at all, nor does any other creation, not even those emanated beings in the World of Atzilut**.*

וְשׁוּם שֵׁם וּמִלָּה בְּמָה לְכַנּוּתוֹ וּלְדַבֵּר בּוֹ אֵלָּא רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ שְׁלִילָה לְבַד.

There is no Name or word with which He can be designated, or by which we can refer to Him, other than in a manner of repudiation – i.e. He is *not* this, and *not* that and *cannot* be described by any name, descriptive title or phrase.

הַיֵּינוּ לְשַׁלֵּל מִשָּׁם כָּל עֲנֵן הַמּוֹרָה אֵיזָה חֶסְרוֹן לַפְּשִׁיטוֹתוֹ

That is to say, we reject or disavow from there any concept that would indicate any deficiency in His uncompounded or non-complex existence,

The idea of Divine simplicity or His uncompounded, uniform essential existence is fundamental in Jewish thought in general and in Kabbalistic thought in particular.

וּלְרוֹמְמוֹת מַעֲלַת אֲמִתּוֹ.

Similarly, we reject or disavow any concept of deficiency in the sublime transcendence of His true being

וְכֵן לְשַׁלֵּל מִשָּׁם אֵיזָה הַשָּׂגָה וְאַפְשָׁרִית הַדְּבוּר בּוֹ.

And we also reject from there any conceptualization or possibility of a reference to Him in speech.

כִּי הוּא מְרוֹמָם וְנִעְלָה עַל כָּל דְּבוּר וּמִלָּה וְעַל כָּל מַחֲשָׁבָה וְשִׁכָּל.

This is because He transcends all utterances, words, and thoughts or concepts,

וּכְבָּר כָּתַב הַגָּר"א ז"ל בְּלִקּוּטָיו שֶׁבְּסוֹף סֵפֶד"צ [סִפְרָא דְּצִנְיֵעוּתָא] הַנִּדְפָּס בְּוִילְנָא תרמ"ב.

as the Vilna Gaon, of blessed memory, wrote in his Collected Works at the end of *Sifra d'Tzniuta*, printed in Vilna 5642 (1881/2) –

שֶׁגַם אֵין סוֹף אָסוּר לְקֵרוֹתוֹ וְאָסוּר לְחַשֵּׁב בּוֹ כָּלֵל וּכְלָל.

that it is forbidden to refer to Him even as *Ein Sof* ("the Infinite One"), and it is absolutely forbidden to contemplate Him, i.e. in His essence.

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה גְלוּיָו הָרֵאשׁוֹן מֵאֲמִתּוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה בְּבַחֲי' אֹר אֵין סוֹף.

Now the first revelation from His true concealed being is the aspect of *Ohr Ein Sof*, the Infinite Light.

וּבְאוֹתוֹ הַגְּלוּי הָרֵאשׁוֹן הִנֵּה אָסוּר ג"כ לְהַבְחִין שָׁם

And even in that first revelation it is forbidden to attempt to discern

שׁוּם חִלּוּק בְּחִי' וְחִלּוּק מִדְּרָגָה כָּלֵל וְלֹא שׁוּם שֵׁם וְכַנּוּי.

any distinctions or distinct levels at all, nor any appellation,

כי הוא אור פשוט בתכלית הפשיטות.

since it is all undifferentiated uniform light of absolute simplicity – simple in the sense of being uncompounded and fundamental.

ועקר מלת אין סוף הרי הוא ג"כ רק הוראת שלילה,

Furthermore, the primary meaning of the term "*Ein Sof*" also indicates only rejection or disavowal,

שהוא מורה שמחולל משם כל חלקת מדרגה בו ושום הבחנה.

denoting the repudiation of any division into levels, or any other distinction in Him.

ורק בזה לבד נתגלה בו שאין סוף לאורו ולרוממותו

And this is the only manner in which it is revealed that there is no limit to His illumination and loftiness,

והוא פשוט בתכלית הפשיטות,

and that He is absolutely undifferentiated uniform simplicity – simple in the sense of being uniform, uncompounded and undistinguishable, as mentioned.

והנה הוא גליו הראשון אשר מאחר אמתתו הנעלמה העצמותית שבו.

This is all regarding His first revelation subsequent to His true concealed essential existence.

הגלוי הב' הוא בהעלם דקו וצמצום.

The second revelation is the concealment that constitutes the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*.

The *kav* is the limited revelation (the 'line' of light stretching from the edge of the *Ohr Ein Sof* downward) that ensues **after** the *tzimtzum* (the concealment of His infinite revelation in order to make room for finite revelation). Accordingly, we understand that the order here – first the *kav* and then the *tzimtzum* – should not be taken literally.²

והנה הוא ירידת מדרגה הרבה מאד ממדרגה הראשונה דאור אין סוף.

****And it is a tremendous descent from the first level, the *Ohr Ein Sof*****

כי הנה בתחלה נתצמצם שם באותו המקום מהאור דאין סוף לגמרי,

since the *Ohr Ein Sof* was first removed completely by the act of *tzimtzum* from that same place (where the *Ohr Ein Sof* was originally) leaving the *chalat*³ (the

void) that remained after the *tzimtzum*

וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה לְמַעַלָּה וַכְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר עֲנִינוּ הַצְמָצוּם בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלֵל
בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ לְקָמוּ.

and the *Ohr Ein Sof* light was removed and lifted up above thereby forming the *chalal*, as will be explained regarding the concept of *tzimtzum* in general further on in our work.

וְאַחֲ"כ הִנֵּה חֲזָר וְנִתְפָּשֵׁט שֵׁם בְּבַחֲ"י קוֹ דֵּק מְאֹרֵי אֵין סוֹף הָרָאוֹן.

Subsequently the light was returned to spread forth there into the *chalal* in the form of a thin line of light, called the *kav*, from the original *Ohr Ein Sof*,

וּמִמֶּנּוּ וְעַל יָדוֹ נִאֲצְלוּ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם, וְכֵן כָּלָם כְּלוּלִים בּוֹ כִּי הוּא
שֶׁרֶשׁ הַכֹּל.

so that by means of the *kav* all the worlds were emanated, and wherein all of them are included, since it the *kav* is the root of everything in existence.

וְנִקְרָא אוֹתוֹ הָעוֹלָם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם בְּשֵׁם אֲוִירָא עֲלָאָה.

Now the region of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*⁴ is called *avira ila'a* supernal space,

וְכֵן טְהִירוֹ עֲלָאָה וְכֵן אֲוִיר קְדָמוֹן וַכְּמוֹ שֶׁמִּתְבָּאֵר כ"ז בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ בְּשַׁעַר
עֲגָלִים וְיִשָּׁר עֲנָף ב'.

and it is also called *tehiru ila'a***, the supernal purity, and also *avir kadmon* primordial space, as will all be explained in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher* of our work, section 2.

וְהִנֵּה כָּאן הִתְחִיל גְּלוּיּוֹ ית"ש בְּאַיִזָּה חֲלוּק בְּחִינוֹת.

It is here that His revelation first began to exhibit distinct levels of sorts,

כִּי בְּהִגְלִיּוֹ הָרָאוֹן דָּאֵין סוֹף הָרִי אֵין שֵׁם חֲלוּק בְּחִינַת כָּלֵל

since in the first revelation of the *Ein Sof* there were no distinct aspects;

אֵלָּא שֶׁהוּא אֹרֹךְ פְּשוּט כְּנִז'.

instead it was a simple, undifferentiated uniform light.

אֲבָל כָּאן בְּהִעָלָם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הִגְלִיּוֹ הַשֵּׁנִי,

But here, in the concealment forming the *kav* and *tzimtzum*, which is the second revelation,

הִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה בְּאַיִזָּה חֲלוּק בְּחִי' עַל כָּל פְּנִים.

certain distinctive levels in some sense were revealed,

כִּי הָרִי יֵשׁ כָּאן ב' בְּחִי' שֶׁהֵם הַצְמָצוּם וְהַקוֹ.

for there are indeed two aspects here, the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*,

וְהוּא סְלוּק וְאוֹר, הָעֶדֶר וּמְצִיאוֹת, וְהֵם הַשְּׂרֵשׁ דְּחֻסָּדִים וּגְבוּרוֹת,

constituting removal and revelation, absence and presence, and these are the root of the *chasadim* the aspects of 'kindness' and *gevurot* the aspects of 'restriction,' also known as

אוֹר וְחֹשֶׁךְ, וְכֵן דִּין וְרַחֲמִים.

light and dark, and also strict justice and compassion.

אֲךָ יוֹתֵר מִזֶּה לֹא נִתְגַּלָּה כָּאֵן כִּי לֹא נִתְגַּלָּה בְּשׁוּם חִלּוּק מִדְּרָגוֹת
בְּהַצְמָצוּם עֲצָמוֹ

But more than this was not revealed here at this stage, since no distinct levels were manifested in the *tzimtzum* itself,

וְלֹא בְּשׁוּם חִלּוּק מִדְּרָגוֹת בְּאוֹר הַקוֹ עֲצָמוֹ.

nor were there distinct levels in the light of the *kav* itself. ⁵

וְהַגֵּם שֶׁהָאֵמֶת הוּא כִּי בְּהִעָלֵם הִנֵּה מִשְׂרֵשׁ שֵׁם כָּל הַחִלּוּקֵי מִדְּרָגוֹת
כֻּלָּם.

This is so, even though in reality all the distinct levels that emerge later have their root there in a concealed form.

אֲשֶׁר יֵצֵא מִשֵּׁם אַח"כ בְּכָל הַגְּלוּיִם דְּלִמְטָה,

All the distinct levels just mentioned emerge later in all the revelations below

כִּי יֵרָק הוּא הַשְּׂרֵשׁ לְכָל הַגְּלוּיִם כֻּלָּם

because this is the only root of all the later revelations,

וְהָיָה כָּל מָה שִׁיוֹצֵא בְּעֵנֶף וְהַפְּרִי הִנֵּה בְּהִכָּרֵם שֶׁכָּלוּל הַכֹּל בְּהַשְּׂרֵשׁ.

and everything that develops in the branch and the fruit was necessarily included in the root.

אֲמָנָם הִנֵּה עוֹמֵד שֵׁם הַכֹּל יֵרָק בְּהִעָלֵם גָּדוֹל

Now indeed everything is in a state of great concealment there,

וְכָל גְּלוּיָו הוּא יֵרָק בִּב' בְּחִינוֹת כְּלָלִיִּים

and all revelations from there are only two general aspects –

וְהֵם הַשְּׂרֵשׁ דְּחֻסָּדִים וּגְבוּרוֹת כְּנִזְכָּר.

the root of the *chasadim* the aspects of 'kindness' and *gevurot* the aspects of 'restriction.'

הַגְּלוּיִ הַשְּׁלִישִׁי הוּא הָעוֹלָם דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן,

The third revelation is the World of Adam Kadmon

וְהוּא יוֹצֵא וְנִתְפָּשֵׁט מִהָעוֹלָם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם.

which emerges and spreads out from the region of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*.

וְהִנֵּה כָּאן נִתְגַּלָּה בְּחִלּוּק מִדְּרָגוֹת ג"כ,

Here too distinct levels are revealed

כִּי נִתְגַּלָּה בּוֹ בְּעֶשְׂרֵה מִדְּרָגוֹת שֶׁהֵם מִדְּרָגוֹת דְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת מִכֶּתֶר
עַד הַמַּלְכוּת.

- indeed, ten levels are revealed therein, which are the ten levels of the *sefirot* from *keter* to *malchut*.

וְאֵלּוּ הֵי' מִדְּרָגוֹת הֵם נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אָדָם,

And these ten levels together are called 'Adam'

כִּי הוּא שָׂרֵשׁ הַשָּׂרָשִׁים דְּתִכּוּנַת אָדָם שְׁלֵם.

for this is the root of the root of all the characteristics of the complete Adam,

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁכְּתִבְנוּ לְעֵיל שְׁעַר ג' פ"א דְּכָל עוֹלָם הוּא בְּתִכּוּנַת קוֹמָה
שְׁלֵמָה

and, as we mentioned above (Sha'ar 3 chapter 1), every World has the characteristics forming a complete stature,

מִבְּחִינַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם שְׁלֵם,

of the aspect of Adam as a complete *partzuf*.

וְכָאן הוּא הָרָאשִׁית וְהַתְּחִלָּה אֲשֶׁר לָזֶה.

**And this is the head and the beginning thereof. **

וּר"ל כִּי עֲנִין הַתְּהוּוֹת כָּל עוֹלָם וּבְנִינּוֹ

Meaning to say, the coming into being of every World and its development,

אֲשֶׁר נִבְנָה וְנִסְדָּר בְּסֵדֶר הַכִּנּוּחַ,

built and structured in a manner that can be titled

פְּרָצוּף אָדָם הוּא מִתְחִיל מִכָּאן וְלִהְלָאָה,

the '*partzuf* of Adam,' begins from here and on,

אֲבָל לֹא בְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת דְּאִין סוּף שְׁלִמְעָלָה.

but not in the *Ein Sof* infinite Worlds above.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא הוּא בְּשֵׁם אָדָם קְדָמוֹן כִּי מִמֶּנּוּ וּלְמַטָּה בְּסֵדֶר בְּנִין כָּל
עוֹלָם

And that is why this aspect is called 'Adam Kadmon' – kadmon signifying 'primordial' – because from here and below is the system of construction of every world

בְּסֵדֶר דְּתַכּוּנַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם וְהוּא הָרָאוּשׁוֹן לָזֶה.

according to the paradigm of the *partzuf* of Adam, and this *partzuf* – Adam Kadmon – is the first of them.

אָמֵנָם עֵקֶר עֵמֶק הַטַּעַם מָה שֶּׁהוּא נִקְרָא בִּשְׁם אָדָם

But for the primary and profound reason that this level is called Adam

עֵינֵינוּ דִּבְרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים כָּלֵל י"ז עֲנָף א'.

see our explanation in *Sefer HaKelalim*, klal 17 anaf 1.⁶

וְהִנֵּה הַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹתוֹ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר הוּא נִקְרָא בִּשְׁם אָדָם קַדְמוֹן

Thus the revelation of the World called Adam Kadmon

הִנֵּה הוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי לְגְלוּיָיו ית"ש.

is the third of His revelations, may He be blessed,

אָמֵנָם הוּא הַגְּלוּי הָרָאוּשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בּוֹ בְּבַחֲי עֲשָׂרָה מַדְרָגוֹת

although it is the first revelation in which are revealed the aspect of ten levels,

שֶׁהוּא סוּד הָעֵשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת כְּמוֹ שִׁיתִּבְאָר,

which are the mystery of the ten *sefirot*, as will be explained.

וְכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלֵם אֲשֶׁר מִמֶּנּוּ וּלְמַטָּה הֵם כָּלֵם בְּהִגְלוּי דְּעֵשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת,

All the Worlds, from this one Adam Kadmon and down are all characterized **by the revelation of ten *sefirot*, **

וְהוּא הָרָאוּשׁוֹן לָהֶם.

and this one Adam Kadmon is the first of them.

אָמֵנָם דַּע כִּי כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַג' גְּלוּיִם שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ הִנֵּה הֵם רַק בְּסוּד רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר.

However, be aware that all three of those revelations mentioned are all according to the mystery of will (*ratzon*)⁷, thinking to oneself (*machshava*)⁸ and mulling over how to communicate a thought⁹ to someone else (*hirhur*)¹⁰.

כִּי הָרָצוֹן הִנֵּה הוּא קֵדָם לְהַמְחָשָׁבָה שֶׁ"י שְׂרוּצָה בְּהִדְבָּר

Will precedes thinking to oneself – when a person strongly wants something

עִי"ז חוֹשֵׁב בּוֹ, וְהוּא הָרָצוֹן סִבַּת הַמַּחְשָׁבָה.

this *causes* him to think to himself about it. Thus the will is the cause of his thinking.

וְהַמַּחְשָׁבָה הוּא קִדָּם לְהִרְהוּר וְהוּא עֲצָמוּתוֹ וְעִקְרוֹ.

And his thinking (*machshava*) precedes mulling over the idea in a practical sense (*hirhur*), and is indeed of its essence and at its root.

כִּי הִרְהוּר הוּא הַתְּפַשְׁטוֹת הַמַּחְשָׁבָה וְגִלּוּיוֹ.

For an idea is an instance of the faculty of *machshava* at work and its revelation,

שֶׁהַמַּחְשָׁבָה לְבַד אֵין לָהּ גִּלּוּי כָּלֵל וְהִיא רַק כַּחַ לְבַד

since thinking on its own is not revealed to others, and is merely a potential state,

וְהִיא כַּחַ נִבְדָּל הַיּוֹצֵא מֵהָרָצוֹן וְהִיא תּוֹלְדָתוֹ.

and is indeed a potential detached from manifestation that emerges from the will and is the product thereof.

אָמֵנָם הִיא רַק עֶצֶם כַּחַ לְבַד בְּלִי גִלּוּי כָּלֵל.

Machshava is in fact only an intrinsic potential, and is not revealed at all – it is thinking to oneself.

אָךְ הִיא מִתְּפַשֵּׁט תִּכְרָךְ לְמַצִּיאת הִרְהוּר וְשֵׁם הִיא מִתְגַּלֶּה.

However, when *machshava* is activated to think about how to communicate this idea to another person, it is immediately manifested as an instance of thought, and there it becomes revealed.

וְהִיא פְּעֻלַּת הַמַּחְשָׁבָה הַיּוֹצֵא מִמְּנָה מֵהַכַּחַ אֶל הַפֶּעַל.

Hirhur is thus the effect of thinking and emerges from it – from a state of potential into actuality.

וְהִנֵּה הִנֵּה כָּל הַג' גִּלּוּיִם הַנִּזְכָּרִים

Thus we have all three stages of revelation mentioned above – the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, and *Adam Kadmon*, paralleling

בְּבַחֲיִנַת רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר אֲשֶׁר מֵהַמְּאֲצִיל ית"ש.

the aspect of will, thinking and mulling over an idea (in that order) from the Emanator, may He be blessed.

וּכְבֹּר לְמַדְנוּ רַבְּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ הָרַמ"ק ז"ל כִּי הַמַּחְשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה אֵינָה כְּמַחְשַׁבַת בְּנֵי אָדָם.

Our holy master, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero, of blessed memory, already taught us that Supernal 'Thinking' is not anything like human thinking.

שָׂאֵם יַחֲשַׁב הָאָדָם לַפֶּעַל אִיזָה פְּעֻלָּה לֹא מִפְּנֵי זֶה יַעֲשֶׂה רָשָׁם

For if a person would think about doing a certain act, this would not have any impact

וַיִּתְּהוּהוּ מִמְּנָה שׁוּם צִיּוּר כָּלֵל עַד שִׁיּוּצִיא מַחֲשַׁבְתּוֹ לַפַּעַל דּוֹקָא.

that could create in some form – until the person actually put his idea into action.

וְאִין הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה כֵּן

But Supernal 'Thinking' is not like that.

אֲלָא בַּעֲלֹת הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה לְשׁוּם הַיִּתְּ אֵיזָה מְצִיאוֹת

Instead, when it arises in the Supernal Thinking to bring something into reality,

מִיָּד נִצְטִיר שֵׁם בַּמַּחֲשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה הַצּוּרָה הִיא בַּמְצִיאוֹת דָּק.

immediately there is formed in the Supernal Thinking the format of that thing as a rarefied existence.

וַיִּתְּעֵלָה הַמְצִיאוֹת הַהוּא מִן הַהִנָּה הַמִּתְהַוָּה בַּמְצִיאוֹת הַמִּתְגַּלָּה,

Now the preeminence of that existence over the actual being of revealed existence,

כְּהִבְדֵּל הַצּוּרָה הַשְׁכֵּלִית וְכַעֲלִיּוּהָ מִן הַצּוּרָה הַגְּשָׁמִית.

is akin to the difference between a mental image and its preeminence over a physical shape,

וְכַהֲבֵדֵל צוּרַת הַמַּשְׁכָּל אֶל הַמְרָגֵשׁ.

and is like the difference between the contours of a concept and that of a feeling.

וְכַמֵּ"שׁ כ"ז בְּסִפְרֵי אֵילָמָה מַעֲיִן ב' תָּמַר א' פ' ט"ז וְכֵן שֵׁם מַעֲיִן ד'
תָּמַר א' פ"ב

All this is explained in Rabbi Moshe Cordovero's book *Elimah, ma'ayan 2, tamar 1*, chapter 16, and *ibid. ma'ayan 4, tamar 1*, chapter 2

וְכֵן אָמַר ג"כ בְּפִרְדֵּס שְׁעַר הַצַּחֲצָחוֹת פ"ג וְכַנֵּ"ל בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ שְׁעַר א'
פ"ח.

and he states the same thing also in *Pardes Rimonim, Sha'ar HaTzachtzachot***, chapter 3, and above in this work *Sha'ar 1* chapter 8.**

וְכַמֵּ"ז הוּא ג"כ בְּעֵנִינֵנוּ בְּכָל הַג' גְּלוּיִם הַנִּזְכָּרִים.

All of this also applies to our subject regarding all the three revelations mentioned:

כִּי הַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן הֵנָּה הוּא בְּבַחֲי' רָצוֹן.

The first revelation, as noted, is the aspect of *ratzon* (the Divine Will)

ששם הוא הרצון לכל גלוייו כלם ולכל פעולותיו כלם.

wherein resides the *ratzon* for each and every one of His revelations, and for all of His deeds.

והגם שהגלוי הראשון הרי אִמְרָנוּ כִּי הוּא בְּבַחִי הָאוֹר דא"ס,

The very first revelation is the aspect of *Ohr Ein Sof* – infinite revelation – as we stated,

וְכָל פְּעֻלוֹתָיו כֻּלָּם הֵרִי הֵם בְּבַחִי גְבוּל וּמִדָּה,

whereas all of His deeds are performed within boundaries and limitations. Now these seem to be contradictory statements.

אֲךָ כִּבְר בְּאִרְנֵנוּ בְּסִפְר הַכְּלָלִים כָּלֵל ב' וּבְעִגּוּלִים וְיִשָּׁר עֲנָף ב' אוֹת י"ח וְאוֹת כ'

**However, we have already explained in *Sefer HaClalim*, clal 2 of *Igulim v'Yosher*, section 2:18, 20 **

כִּי יִסּוּד הָרֵאשׁוֹן דְּכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ הוּא בְּאֵמֶת רַק אוֹר אֵין סוֹף,

that the very first foundation of all existence is in fact only the *Ohr Ein Sof*

וְנִתְיֻסַּד כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ רַק עַל אוֹר אֵין סוֹף וּמִמֶּנּוּ יֵצְאוּ וְאֵלָיו יָשׁוּבוּ.

and all of existence in its entirety is founded only upon the *Ohr Ein Sof***, from whence everything emerged and to which everything returns.**

וְכֵן רַק הוּא מְסַתֵּפֵל עֲלֵיהֶם תָּמִיד וּמְנַהִיג אוֹתָם,

Furthermore, it is only He who oversees them constantly and who guides them with His Divine Providence,

וּמִזֶּה הוּא כָּל הַהִנָּהֲגָה הַנִּעְלָמָה דְּכָל הַכְּבִשֵּׁי דְרַחֲמָנָא

and from there stems the entire hidden providence pertaining to the secrets of the Merciful One¹¹

שֶׁנִּלְאָה כָּל שֶׁכֵּל לִמְצֹא טַעַם לָהֶם.

which all human intellect struggles to find a reason for.

וְהוּא מְהַנְהִיג דְאוֹר אֵין סוֹף הַמְּנַהִיג אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת תָּמִיד לְתַכְלִית תִּקּוּן הָאֲחֵרוֹן.

This is the manner in which the *Ohr Ein Sof* guides all of existence continuously towards its final rectification.

וְזֶהוּ כָּל עֵקֶר הָעֲנָנִין מֵה שְׁהִיָּה הַגְּלוֹי הָרֵאשׁוֹן רַק אוֹר אֵין סוֹף,

This is the entire fundamental reason that the first revelation was only *Ohr Ein Sof*,

כי רק הוא היסוד דכל המציאות כלו ועליו הם עומדים תמיד

for only He is the foundation of all existence, and it is upon Him that they endure throughout time,

כמו שבארנו כ"ז שם בארכה.

As we have explained above.

וע' עוד דברינו בזה בדע"ה ח"א דרש'ה' סימן ה' אות כ', כ"א.

**See more on this matter in *Deah* part 1, essay 5, chapter 5 #20, 21. **

והרי עכ"פ הוא כי הגלוי הראשון שהוא האור דאין סוף

In any event, we have it that the first revelation is the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

הנה הוא בחי' הרצון לכל גלוייו כלם ולכל פעלותיו כלם,

which is the aspect of the overarching *ratzon* for all His revelations and all of His deeds.

וזהו מה שנמצא באיזה דברי קדושי עליון

This is precisely what we find in the words of some of the most exalted holy rabbis¹²

שאומרים שכל מה שאנו מדברים ממנו ית"ש הוא רק מרצונו.

who declare that whatever we can say about Him refers only to His will,

כי רק בזה לבד נתגלה בגלוי הראשון,

for in this manner alone was the first revelation,

ורק זה הוא הראשית והשרש לכל הגלויים כלם.

and only this is the beginning and the root of all the subsequent revelations.

הגלוי השני שהוא העולם דהקו וצמצום ונקרא בשם אור קדמון
וכנ"ל,

The second revelation is the region of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*, called *avir kadmon* – primordial space.

הנה הוא בבחי' מחשבה הנמשך ויוצא מן הרצון ומיוחד עמו כן
הוא הקו.

This is the aspect of *machshava* that is drawn out of and emerges from *ratzon*, while remaining united with it, and this is true of the *kav* as well.

כי נמשך מאין סוף עצמו וכן הצמצום הוא דבוק ומיוחד באין סוף
ממש

Because the *kav* is drawn from the *Ein Sof* Himself¹³, and the *tzimtzum*¹⁴ also cleaves to and is united with the *Ein Sof*, literally.

כי הוא ממנו עצמו, וכמו שבארנו בעגלים וישר ענף ב'.

This is because it emerges from Him Himself, as we explained in *Igulim v'Yosher, anaf 2*.

ולכן נקרא העולם הזה בשם טהירו עלאה

And therefore that plane is referred to as the *tehiru ila'ah* – the Supernal Purity

כי בו הוא הקף האור דא"ס כמו שבארנו שם.

because it is surrounded by the *Ohr Ein Sof*, as explained there.

והוא בבחי' מחשבה מהמאציל ית"ש.

This is the aspect of *machshava* of the blessed Emanator

והוא עדיו סתם ונעלם כי הוא רק בבחי' כח המחשבה בעצמה

which is as yet closed off and concealed from any recipient since it is merely in a state of potential *machshava* on its own i.e. prior to the intention to communicate it to any recipient

אשר כל מציאותה הוא רק בחי' כח לבד וכנ"ל.

being that *machshava's* entire existence is exclusively in a state of potential, as explained above.

הגלוי השלישי שהוא העולם דאדם קדמון.

The third revelation is the World of Adam Kadmon

הנה הוא בבחי' הרהור, שהוא התפשטות המחשבה וגלוי וכן"ל.

which is the aspect of *hirhur* – an instance of *machshava* i.e. a specific thought and its revelation, as explained above.

וכן הוא האדם קדמון כי בו נתגלה הבחנת דכל העשרה מדרגות

The same is true of Adam Kadmon since here the distinctions between all the ten levels of the *sefirot* are revealed.

כי על זה היה כל הרצון והמחשבה שהם הב' גלויים הראשונים.

Indeed it was to this end that there were *ratzon* and *machshava*, the first two revelations,

ונתגלה פעלתם בבחי' יציאה מן הכח אל הפעל באדם קדמון
שהוא הגלוי השלישי.

so that their effects would be revealed in emerging from potential to actual as Adam Kadmon, the third revelation,

וע"ד ההרהור שהוא יוצא מן הרצון והמחשבה

similar to the manner in which *hirhur* emerges from *ratzon* and *machshava*,

שהם בכם לבד והם נעלמים

which are merely in a state of potential and are therefore concealed,

ויוצאים ומתגלים בהרהור.

and emerge and are revealed by *hirhur*.

אמנם כל הגלוי דהרהור הרי הוא עדין ג"כ רק בלב החושב לבד

However, *hirhur* is as yet only revealed in the heart of the thinker,

ואין גלוי מהם עדין לזולתו מאומה,

and no revelation at all therefrom is accessible to someone else

כי הוא רק התפשטות המחשבה בנזכר.

since the *hirhur* is merely an instance of *machshava*, as mentioned.

כן הוא כל אלו הג' גלויים שאמרנו הנה הם הכל רק בבחי' מחשבת
המאציל עצמו,

So too regarding all three revelations mentioned – the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and *kav*, and Adam Kadmon – all of them are only in the thoughts of the Emanator Himself,

והנה כל אלו הג' גלויים הנזכרים בבחי' רצון ומחשבה והרהור
בהמאציל ית"ש.

and all three revelations just mentioned are dubbed *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* in the Emanator, blessed is He.

והוא אור דאין סוף – רצון. הקו וצמצום – מחשבה. אדם קדמון –
הרהור.

So that *Ohr Ein Sof* is compared to *ratzon*; the *kav* and *tzimtzum* to *machshava*, and Adam Kadmon to *hirhur*,

והם מציאת גלוייו שבהמאציל עצמו

and they signify the presence of these revelations within the Emanator Himself,

וע"פ מה שאמרנו מדברי קדוש ה' הרמ"ק ז"ל וכן"ל.

according to what we have cited from the words of the holy Rabbi Moshe Cordovero, of blessed memory, as mentioned.

אך גלוייו אשר הוא בבחי' פעלה ומעשה ממנו ית"ש,

However, His revelations as *effects* and *actions* stemming from Him

הנה הוא רק משם ולמטה כי מאחר הג' גלויים הנזכרים שהם כלם
בהמאציל עצמו.

are only from there on down, since the first three revelations just mentioned are
all within the Emanator Himself.

הנה משם ולמטה מתחיל גלוייו ית"ש אשר בבחי' פעלה ממש.

Thus only from there on down begin His revelations as *actual effects* and
actions

והוא נחלק לשתיים שהן ארבע וכמו שיתבאר:

which are divided into two that are four, as will be explained.¹⁵

Footnotes

1. Makover. ↩

2. Unless the intention is that since the *kav* emerges from the *Ohr Ein Sof* that was removed from the *chalal*-void therefore it is higher than the *chalal*-void, which is identified with the *tzimtzum*, and therefore it is appropriate to list the *kav* first and then the *tzimtzum*. However, this is mere speculation on the part of the translator. ↩

3. Makover. ↩

4. Note that the *tzimtzum* preceded the *kav*, and technically the phrase should have read 'the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*.' ↩

5. Presumably this refers to the very top of the *kav* as it first emerges from the *Ohr Ein Sof*, prior to the stage when it circles around the inner perimeter of the *chalal*, forming the various *sefirot* of the *igulim* of *Adam Kadmon*. See *Eitz Chaim sh'ar 1 anaf* 2: ↩

6. ד"ה והנה ↩

7. Corresponding to the *Ohr Ein Sof* (Makover has this as corresponding to *Ein Sof*, but that seems to be an error). ↩

8. Corresponding to the *tzimtzum* and the *kav* (Makover). ↩

9. Corresponding to *Adam Kadmon* (Makover). ↩

10. The Vilna Gaon, of blessed memory, in his commentary to the *Tikunei Zohar* (p. 20c ד"ה בריש הורמנותא דמלכא) explains that *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirkhur* correspond to *keter*, *chochmah* and *binah* (in that order). In his commentary on *Sefer Yetzirah* (p. 10c) he explains that *machshava* is when a person contemplates an idea but does not put it into words (even in his own

- mind) that could be communicated, whereas *hirhur* is mulling over how to communicate an idea to someone else. (*Meir haLeshem*). [↩](#)
11. See *Berachot* 10a: When King Chizkiyahu became gravely ill, Isaiah the Prophet visited him and told him that the reason for his illness was that he had not established a family. When King Chizkiyahu replied that he had avoided having children because he knew by Divine Inspiration (*ruach hakodesh*) that he would have children who would not follow in the ways of Torah, Isaiah replied "what business do you have interfering in the secrets of the Merciful One? You must do your part, and He will do as He wishes." [↩](#)
 12. See Ramchal, *Kla"ch, petach* 25; *Likutim* printed at the end of the GR"A's commentary on *Sifra d'Tzinuta* 38b. [↩](#)
 13. I.e. from the *Ohr Ein Sof* that was removed by the *tzimtzum*. See *Eitz Chaim shaar* 1, *anaf* 2. (Meir HaLeshem). [↩](#)
 14. I.e. the *reshimu* – traces of the root of the *gevurot* mentioned above – that remained after the *tzimtzum*. (Meir HaLeshem). [↩](#)
 15. "Two that are four" is a fairly common Rabbinic statement in the *Mishnah* (e.g. *Shabbat* 1:1; *Sh'vuot* 2:1; *Nega'im* 1:1. The intention is to classify a subject broadly and then specify sub-categories. [↩](#)

Chapter 4 — The fourth level of unfolding from above to below (hitpashtut) of Divine Light, the world of Atsilus.

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 4

Revelation of His Actualization

הָיָה גְלוּיּוֹ בַּפְעֻלָּתוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּזֶה בַּפְעַל מִמֶּשׁ

Now we will discuss His revelation within His actions – where He is revealed in actuality –

הָיָה הוּא בְּכָל הַמְצִיאוֹת דָּהֲד' עוֹלָמוֹת אֲצִילוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה,

this takes place throughout the existence of the four Worlds, Atzilut, Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהָיָה הָיָה גְלוּיּוֹ בָּזֶה בְּשְׁנֵי בַּחֲיִנוֹת,

His revelation in this manner is of two types:

אֶחָד בַּבְּחִינַת פְּעֻלָּה שְׁחוּץ מִמֶּנּוּ,

One is the type of activity outside of Himself;

וְאֶחָד בַּבְּחִינַת פְּעֻלָּה שֶׁהִיא אֶצְלוֹ

and the other is the type of activity that is with Him

וּמִיָּחָד עִמּוֹ עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂית חֵד עִמּוֹ.

and is united with Him to the extent that it becomes one with Him.

וְהָיָה הֵם שְׁתֵּי שֶׁהֵם הֵב' בַּחֲיִנוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים,

Now these 'two that are four'¹ as just mentioned

וְהֵן אַרְבַּע שֶׁהֵם הֲד' עוֹלָמוֹת אֲבִי"ע.

are the four worlds of ABY"A – Atzilut, Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי הָיָה מִהַגְלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי הֵנ"ל שֶׁהוּא אָדָם קַדְמוֹן.

That is to say, from the third revelation mentioned above – Adam Kadmon –

אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה רְצוֹנוֹ וּמַחֲשַׁבְתּוֹ ית"ש לְהַמְצִיא מְצִיאוֹת עַל תְּכוֹנַת אָדָם

in which His *ratzon*² and *machashava*³ are revealed and produce an existence in the format of Adam,

שהוא בנוי ומיסד על עשרה מדרגות כח"ב חג"ת נהי"ם [כתר-
חקמה-בינה; חסד-גבורה-תפארת; נצח-הוד-יסוד-מלכות]

i.e. with the ten levels the ten *sefirot keter-chochmah-binah; chesed-gevurah-tiferet; netzach-hod-yesod-malchut***4**

ומסדר בג' קוים חח"נ בימין

arranged in three columns: *chochmah-chesed-netzach* on the right;

בג"ה בשמאל

binah-gevurah-hod on the left;

כת"ם באמצע.

keter-tiferet-yesod-malchut in the middle

הנה יצא במחשבתו לפעל והוציא מאותו הגלוי השלישי שהוא
האדם קדמון

Thus it arose in His thought (i.e. at the level of *machshava*) to produce and
emanate from that third revelation, Adam Kadmon,

בכחו ועל ידו,

with the capability thereof and by means thereof,

והמציא את כל העשרה מדרגות שהם העשר ספירות

to bring out all of the ten levels, which are the ten *sefirot*,

כח"ב חג"ת נהי"ם במציאות ממש.

*keter-chochmah-binah; chesed-gevurah-tiferet; netzach-hod-yesod-malchut***5**
into actual manifest existence.

והוא יציאתו ית"ש מה שיצא מהכח אל הפעל.

This is His emergence, blessed is His Name, from potential to actual.

Although the Baal HaLeshem does not mention it explicitly here, it is self-
understood that this revelation is of course post-*tzimtzum* and *kav*.

והוא הגלוי הרביעי שנמשך ויצא מהגלוי השלישי

This is the fourth revelation, which is drawn from and emerges out of the third
revelation, Adam Kadmon,

ובו יצא בפעולה ממש.

and by way of which it emerges into actuality.

והנה אותה המציאות הנה היא מציאות ספירי ובהירה כזו,

Now that existence is so luminous and radiant

עַד שְׁאִינוּ נוֹפֵל עָלֶיהָ לֹא שֵׁם עֲשִׂיהָ וְלֹא שֵׁם יִצְרָהּ וְלֹא שֵׁם בְּרִיאָה
כִּי הִיא זָכָה וְדָקָה מְאֹד,

that it cannot be labeled 'made' or 'formed' or 'created' – terms associated with
the lower worlds of Asiya, Yetzirah and Beriah,⁶ because it is so pure and refined,
לְמַעַלְהָ הִרְבֵּה מִכָּל הָאִיכוֹת וְהָעֲצָמוֹת דִּהְבְּרִיאָה,
that it far transcends the entire quality and essence of created being,
וְהַשֵּׁם שֶׁלָּהּ הוּא אֲצִילוּת,

and is named 'Atzilut,'

עַל שֵׁם הַכְּתוּב "וְאֶצְלָתִי מִן הָרוּחַ אֲשֶׁר עָלֶיךָ",
as in the verse (Numbers 11:17) "I will emanate (v'Atzalti) from the spirit that is
upon you and place it on them" – on the seventy elders,

כִּי הִיא נֶאֱצְלָה מֵאֲ"ק [מֵאָדָם קַדְמוֹן] וְנִשְׁפָּע מִמֶּנּוּ,
for it was emanated (ne'etzlah) from Adam Kadmon and is impacted by it,
וּמִשּׁוֹם שֶׁהוּא לְמַעַלְהָ וּמְרוֹמָם מְאִיכוֹת הָעֲצָמוֹת דְּכָל נִבְרָא.
and because it is loftier than, and is elevated beyond the essential qualities of
every created being.

לָכֵן אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְשׁוֹם נִבְרָא לְהַשִּׁיג אֶת מַהוּת אוֹתָהּ הַמְצִיאוֹת מֶה
שֶׁהִיא,

Therefore it is impossible for any created being to grasp the inner disposition of
that existence and what defines it.

וְהוּא מֶה שֶׁקוֹרָא אוֹתוֹן הַסֵּפֶר יִצְרָה בְּשֵׁם עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת בְּלִימָה,

This is why that they are called 'the ten sefirot bli mah' – ten undefined sefirot –
in Sefer Yetzirah,⁷

וּר"ל שֶׁהֵם בְּלִי מַהוּת מִשְׁגַּח.

meaning that that they are without discernible character.

וְכֵן אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְשׁוֹם נִבְרָא לְהִבִּין בְּדִיוֹק הוֹרָאת וּבִאִוֵּר דְּשֵׁם וּמִלָּת
אֲצִילוּת מֶה שֶׁהוּא,

It is similarly impossible for any created being to understand exactly the
significance and meaning of the word *Atzilut*, and what it is,

כִּי כָּל שֵׁם הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ מֵעֵצָם הַמְצִיאוֹת וּמִשְׁרָשׁ הַתְּהוּוֹתוֹ,

because every name is drawn from the essential existence and the root from
which it came into being,

וְכִנּוּדָע בְּמָה שֶׁכְּתוּב וַיִּקְרָא הָאָדָם שְׁמוֹת, וכמ"ש בְּתַקּוּנִים תִּקּוּן
מ"ט***.

as is known from the verse (Genesis 2:20) "He (Adam) gave names to all the animals...", as it states in the *Tikunim* (*Tikunei Zohar*) **Tikun 49**.

וְלָכוּ כְּשֵׁם שֶׁנֶּעְלָם מִכָּל נִבְרָא לְהַשִּׁיג אֶת מַהוּת הָאֲצִילוּת

Therefore, just as the essence of Atzilut is impenetrable to the grasp of a created being,

כֵּן נֶעְלָם מִכָּל נִבְרָא לְהִבִּין בְּדִיוק הוֹרָאת דָּשֵׁם אֲצִילוּת ג"כ,

so too is it beyond the comprehension of every created being to understand precisely the significance of the name Atzilut,

כִּי הוּא לְמַעְלָה וּמְרוֹמִים מַעְצָם אִיכוּת כָּל נִבְרָא,

since it is loftier than, and is elevated above the essential quality of every created being,

וְהָרִי אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַשִּׁיג ג"כ אֶת הוֹרָאת שְׁמוּ בְּדִיוק:

making it impossible to also grasp the significance of its name precisely.

אֲמָנָם הוּא הִנֵּה כָּל הַנִּאֲצָלִים כָּלָם

Now although it is true that all things emanated

הִנֵּה הֵגֶם שֶׁהֵם לְמַעְלָה הִרְבֵּה מִכָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים כָּלָם,

are much loftier than all of the other creations,

עַם כָּל זֶה הִנֵּה הֵם מֵצֵד עֲצָמָם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוּת כָּלָל,

nevertheless, in and of themselves they are not Godliness at all,

כִּי הֵם נִאֲצְלוּ וְנִמְצְאוּ מִחֲדָשׁ אַחֵר שְׁלֹא הָיוּ,

since they were emanated and emerged anew from non-existence i.e. *ex nihilo*,

וְאֵינָם אֱלֹהוּת אֶלָּא מֵצֵד יַחֲוֹדוּ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ בָּהֶם,

and they are not Godliness other than in terms of His unification with them, blessed be His Name.

כִּי הָאֵין סוּף הִתְיַחַד בָּהֶם וְנִעְשָׂה חֵד מִמֶּשׁ עִמָּהֶם

Because the *Ein Sof* united Himself with them and He actually became one with them,

וְהֵם מַעֲתָה אֱלֹהוּת גָּמוּר עַל יְדוּ יַחִיד וּמִיַּחַד,

so that now they are wholly Godliness as a result of this, and are one and united with Him.

כִּי הֵם תְּכוּנָה יְקָרָה נְעֲלָה וּמְרוֹמָם כְּזוֹ.

Thus they are now of a very precious and lofty character and are elevated to the extent that

שְׂרָאוִים לְקַבֵּל אֶת יְחִידוֹ בָּהֶם וּלְהַעֲשׂוֹת עִמּוֹ חֵד מִמֶּשׁ.

they are worthy of receiving his Oneness in them to become one with Him literally.

אָבֵל הֵם מִצַּד עֲצָמָם זוּלַת יְחִידוֹ בָּהֶם, אֵינָם אֱלֹהוּת כָּלֵל.

But in and of themselves, without his unity in them, they are not Godliness at all,

וכמ"ש אליהו זכור לטוב בתפלתו

as Elijah (may he be remembered for good) said in his prayer⁸:

"וְכֵד אַנֶּת תִּסְתַּלַּק מִנִּיהוּ אֲשֶׁתִּצְרֹן כָּלְהוּ שְׁמֵהוּ כְּגוֹפָא בְּלֹא נִשְׁמָתָא".

"if You were to remove Yourself from them, all those Names i.e. from the *sefirot* of *Atzilut* they would be like a body without a soul."

אָמְנָם מֵאַחַר שֶׁהִתְיַחַד עִמָּהֶם, וְהוּא מֵעַת הִתְקוּן דִּמְעָשָׁה בְּרֵאשִׁית וַיִּמָּאֵז וּלְהִלָּאָה,

But since He united Himself with them – from the time of the *Tikun* during the Work of Creation and on –

The account of Creation in the first chapter of Genesis reveals that first the World of Chaos, called *Tohu*, was created. *Tohu* was a deliberately unstable world that shattered and fell apart, and only then was the rectified world of *Atzilut*, known also as the World of *Tikun* (rectification), created. The World of *Tikun* rectifies the World of *Tohu*. His Godliness was not manifested in, or united with, the World of *Tohu*.

הֵנָּה לֹא סָר וְלֹא יָסִיר יְחִידוֹ מֵהֶם לְעוֹלָמִים,

He did not and will not ever remove his Oneness from them.

וּמִיַּחַד עִמָּהֶם בְּיַחֲוֹד עֲצוּם מְאֹד עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂים חֵד עִמּוֹ.

Thus He unites with them in a potent unity to the extent that they become one with Him,

וְעִי"ז נִתְגַּלָּה הוּא לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם עַל יְדֵיהֶם,

and in this manner He becomes revealed, so that He can be called by Name through them,

כִּי הֵם עֲצָמָם נַעֲשִׂים לְשֵׁמוֹ, וְהוּא כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים כֻּלָּם,

since they themselves become His Name. And this is true of all the Holy Names

אֲשֶׁר הוּא עֲצָמוֹ נִקְרָא בָּהֶם ע"י הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹ בְּאַצִּילוּת

by which He Himself is called through becoming clothed in Atzilut

וְהִתְיַחֲדוּ עִמָּהֶם לְהִיּוֹתָם חֵד עִמּוֹ,

and by unifying with them so that they become one with Him.

וְעַיִן שֶׁהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בָּהֶם נַעֲשׂוּ הֵם כָּלֶם ג' כ לַחַד וּכְמ"ש אֵלֵיהֶו זל"ט

Moreover, through His becoming clothed within them they also all become one in themselves, as Elijah declared:

וְאַנֶּת הוּא דְקָשִׁיר לוֹן וּמִיַּחַד לוֹן וּבְגִין דְּאַנֶּת מְלָגָאוּ

"You are He who binds them together and unifies them, and because You are within them,

כָּל מָאן דְּאַפְרִישׁ חֵד מִן חֲבֵרִיה מֵאֵלֹן עֶשֶׂר סְפִירִין אֶתְחַשֵּׁב לִיה
כְּאֵלֹן אֶפְרִישׁ בְּךָ."

anyone who separates one of them from the other of these ten *sefirot* is regarded as if he made a separation in You,"

כִּי הֵם מֵעַתָּה אֱלֹהוּת גָּמוּר יַחֲדִיד וּמִיַּחַד,

because from now on they are wholly Godliness, one and united,

וְהוּא ע"י יַחֲדוֹ בָּהֶם, שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂים חֵד עַל יְדוֹ וְחֵד עִמּוֹ:

by way of His oneness in them, and thus they are made into a unity by Him, and become one with Him.

וְהוּא מ"ש הוּא ית"ש לֹא יִהְיֶה לָךְ אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים עַל פָּנָי

This is what is stated in the verse (Exodus 20:3), "You shall not give credence to the gods of others in My Presence."⁹

וּר"ל זוּלַת הָאֲצִילוּת שֶׁהוּא פָּנָיו,

Meaning to say that this commandment applies even outside of the world of Atzilut which is His 'Presence,'

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא מִתְיַחֲד וּמִתְגַּלֶּה וְהוּא פָּנָיו מִמַּשׁ,

since that is where He is revealed and there He is one and is in a state of revelation. This is therefore referred to as 'His Presence', literally.

וּכְמ"ש בְּזוֹה"ק פ' אֶמּוֹר צ"ג ע"ב, בִּקְשׁוּ פָּנָי, אֵלֵינוּ עֲטָרֵי מְלָכָא (ר"ל
הָעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת)

As is written in the Holy Zohar *parshat Emor* 93b on the verse (Psalms 27:8) "... seek My Presence¹⁰" – this refers to those crowns of the King (i.e. the ten *sefirot*)

דָּאָהוּ אֶחָד בָּהֶן, וְאַנּוֹן בֵּיהּ, אֵינוֹן שְׁמִיהּ, וְאִיהוּ וּשְׁמִיהּ מְלָכָא חֲדָא
הוּא,

with which He unites, and they are united with Him; they are His Name, and He and His Name are One.

בגין כך אמר דוד את פניך ה' אבקש (ר"ל שיאר פניו אליו).

For this reason King David declared (Psalms ibid) "Your Presence¹¹, O Lord, I seek" (meaning to say David prayed that His Presence shine upon him).

וכן אמרו בזוה"ק יתרו פ"ו א', על פני, לאפקא אפי מלכא.

And so too, in the Holy Zohar *Yitro* 86a on the verse (Exodus 20:3) "in My Presence" – 'this excludes the Presence of the King from the category of "the gods of others" or "other gods" mentioned in the above prohibition.

דבהו אתחזי מלכא קדישא, ואנון שמייה והוא אנון.

for in them in the *sefirot* the Holy King is revealed; they the *sefirot* are His Name and through them He guides all the worlds**¹²** and He is them' He is essentially the life-force of the *sefirot***¹³**

הוא שמייה דכתיב אני ה' הוא שמי, הוא ושמייה חד הוא.

'He is His Name', as is written (Isaiah 42:8) "I am God, this is My Name" – that is to say, 'He and His Name are one!'¹⁴

וכן כתב ג"כ הרח"ו ז"ל בפ' שמות ג' ע"ב בהגהות מהרח"ו שם אות ד' ע"ש,

Rabbi Chaim Vital writes in similar vein in a comment on the *Zohar*, *Exodus* p. 3b, and in his *Hagahot Maharchu* para. 4.

ולזה רמז גם הרמב"ן בפ' שם יתרו בפסוק ל"א לא יהיה לך,

The Ramban (Nachmanides) also alludes to this interpretation in his commentary to the section in *Yitro* on the verse (20:3) "You shall not give credence to the gods of others..."

ויאמר כי בזה יבא כל הכתוב כפשוטו ומשמעו,

And he declares that with this interpretation the entire verse can be understood simply and at its face value.

וכן כתבו הרקנטי והציוני ורבונו בחיי בפ' שם יתרו שם,

And so too write the Recanati,¹⁵ the Tzioni¹⁶ and Rabbeinu Bachye¹⁷ on that verse in *Yitro*.

וכ"ז הוא כי ע"י יחדו באצילות נעשה כל האצילות כלו אלהות גמור,

This is all because of His unifying with the World of Atzilut, so that the entire Atzilut became wholly Godliness.

כִּי מֵעַת הַתְּקוּן אֲשֶׁר לְצַרֵּךְ מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרֵאשִׁית הִנֵּה הַתִּיחַד א"ס ית"ש
בְּאַצִּילוֹת

Because from the time of the *Tikun* that was necessary to rectify the Work of Creation, from that time on, the Infinite One, blessed is He, united himself with the world of Atzilut.

During the early process of creation the World of *Tohu* was formed. *Tohu* was a deliberately unstable world that shattered and had to be reconstructed as the World of *Tikun*, which is essentially the World of Atzilut,¹⁸ as explained in a previous note.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה עִם הָאַצִּילוֹת חֵד גָּמוּר וְעִי"ז הִנֵּה כָּל הָאַצִּילוֹת כֻּלּוֹ אֱלֹהוֹת
גָּמוּר יְחִיד וּמְיֻחָד.

He made Himself absolutely one with the world of Atzilut, and thus the entire Atzilut is wholly Godliness, one and united.

אָבֵל זֹלַת יְחִידוֹ בָּהֶם וְקֹדֶם שֶׁהַתִּיחַד עִמָּהֶם,

But without His oneness in them in the *sefirot*, prior to His uniting Himself with them the *sefirot* of Atzilut

הִנֵּה הֵם מֵצֵד עֲצָמָם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלֵל וְכָלֵל,

in and of themselves, they are not Godliness at all.

וְלִכּוֹן אֵרַע בָּהֶם בְּעוֹלָם הַתְּהוֹ כָּל מָה שֶׁאֵרַע. וַיֵּצֵא מֵהֶם אֶז כָּל מָה
שִׁיָּצָא:

And therefore what occurred to them in the world of *Tohu* occurred, the vessels shattered and what transpired, transpired.

וְהָאֱמֶת וְהַעֲקָר הוּא כִּי אֶז לֹא הָיוּ נִקְרָאִים בְּשֵׁם אַצִּילוֹת כָּלֵל

The truth and the main point is that then prior to this first *tikun* they were not called 'Atzilut' at all

וְלֹא בְּשֵׁמוֹת הַסְּפִירוֹת כָּלֵל,

and not by the names of the *sefirot* at all. Prior to this point all the revelations were transcendent and therefore undefinable,

וְכַמ"ש בַּאד"ר פ' נִשְׂא דָף קל"ה ע"ב, וְכִלְהוֹ אֶתְקִרוּן בְּשִׁמְהוֹ אַחֲרָנִין
מִן קִדְמָאִין כו' ע"ש.

As is written in the *Idra Rabba*,¹⁹ page 135b: "...and all of them are now in the World of Atzilut called by names other than the initial ones."

In this section of the *Zohar* Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai explains the fate of the seven *sefirot* of the World of *Tohu* which shattered and fell. The names given initially were

Bela, which comes to be called *da'at* in Atzilut; Yovav becomes *chesed*; Chusham, *gevurah* etc.

ושמות הספירות ושם אצילות הוא נתחדש ונעשה בהם רק מעת
התקון

Thus **the names of the *sefirot*, and indeed the name Atzilut itself****, were all innovated and became relevant to them only from the time of Tikun,**

אשר לצורך מעשה בראשית ומאז ולהלאה.

for the needs of the Work of Creation and on.

והוא מעת אשר התיחד המאציל ית"ש בהם להקרא שם בשמו.

That is – from the time that the blessed Emanator unified Himself in them so that they could be called by His Name.

ונעשו מאז ולהלאה אלהות גמור על ידו ובנזכר.

As a result, from then on, they the *sefirot* of Atzilut became wholly Godliness, as mentioned.

וכן נקראו מאז ולהלאה בשמות הספירות

And they are also called from then on by the names of the *sefirot* as we now know them:

כח"ב חג"ת נהי"מ, ובשם אצילות,

keter-chochmah-binah; chesed-gevurah-tiferet; netzach-hod-yesod-malchut, and that world itself is known **by the name Atzilut.**

וזהו מה שאמר האריז"ל, בשער הצלם פ"א ובשער השמות פ"א
ובכ"מ,

The following are the words of the Arizal in *Etz Chaim Sha'ar HaTzelem* chapter 1 and *Shaar HaShemot* chapter 1, and in a number of other places:

כי כל האצילות כלו הוא אלהות גמור אחד יחיד ומיוחד,

All of Atzilut is wholly Godliness, one, unique and united.

כי הרי מעת אשר זכו לשם האצילות,

Because from the time that they were worthy of being called Atzilut,

והוא מאחר אשר התיחד עמם ובנזכר,

i.e. from when He united Himself with them, as mentioned,

הנה מאז ולהלאה הנה האצילות באמת אלהות גמור על ידו וככל
מה שאמרנו.

from then on Atzilut was truly wholly Godliness, because of this and everything else we explained above.

וע' בזה בדברינו בספר הדע"ה ח"א פרוש ה' סי' ז'.

See further in *Sefer HaDe'ah* section 1 drush 5:7

שם הארכנו בזה ובארנו כל זה באר היטיב, ע"ש ותמצא כל מבקשך בענינים הללו:

where we explain at length and clarify this subject well. Search there and you will find what you seek regarding these matters.

והנה כל העשר ספירן כלם הנה הגם שהם נעלה ומרום במדרגה ומעלה

Now all the ten *sefirot*, even though they are of a very lofty and exalted status,

וגבוהים מאד מתכנת כל נברא,

far above the qualities of all created beings,

אמנם בעצמותם ותכונתם המתחס להם

nevertheless, the essence and the character associated with them with the *sefirot* of Atzilut

הנה יש בהם מצד עצמם (ר"ל זולת יחודו בהם)

in and of themselves (aside from His unification in them) they have

כל הענינים כלם וכל הסדר כלו כמו בהעולמות ב"ע.

all of the same conceptual content, and the same entire order of that of the lower Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

ואדרבה הוא, כי בהם הוא השרש לכל זה.

On the contrary, it is in them the *sefirot* of Atzilut that the root of all these aspects of BiY"A is to be found, and therefore these similarities exist.

והוא כי גם עקר כל מציאותם הם ג"כ רק השרשים לכל המציאות דב"ע

For their existence the existence of the *sefirot* of Atzilut is primarily to serve as the roots of the existence of BiY"A²⁰

ולכן מסדרים הם ג"כ בכל הענינים אשר בהבי"ע, בבחינת שרש להם.

and therefore they the *sefirot* of Atzilut are arranged in exactly the same manner as in BiY"A, as constituting their root.

אֵלָא שְׁבָכַל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם הוּא לְפִי עֶרְכּוֹ וּלְפִי מַהוּתוֹ וְעֲצָמוּתוֹ
הַמְתִּיחַס אֱלִיּוֹ.

The only difference being that the manifestation of the *sefirot* in each of the worlds is according to the character and essence associated with it with each world.

וּכְשֶׁם שֶׁמַּהוּת כָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת הִרִי הוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל נִבְרָא

Just as the inner nature of all of Atzilut is concealed from all created beings,

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהוּא נֶעְלָה וּמְרוֹמָם מֵהֶם,

since it is so exalted and elevated above them,

כֵּן הוּא נֶעְלָם מִלְּהִשְׁגִּי אֵיךְ שְׁעוֹמְדִים שָׁם כָּל אוֹתוֹ הָעֲנִינִים כָּלָם
ג"כ, גַּם בְּרוֹמְמוֹת מַעְלָתָם,

so too is it masked from our comprehension how all the features of the lower worlds are also present there, even in the very loftiest echelons.

אָבֵל עכ"פ הוּא כִּי לְפִי עֶרְכָּם הַמְתִּיחַס לָהֶם

But in any event this is so, and however worthy the stature attributed to them is,

הֵנָּה יִשְׁנוּ בָּהֶם כָּל הָעֲנִינִים אֲשֶׁר בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

all the same concepts manifested in the worlds of BiY" A are found in them too.

כִּי אֲדָרְבָּה הוּא שְׁבַאֲצִילוֹת הוּא הִיסוֹד וְהַשְׁרָשׁ לְכָל זֶה.

And on the contrary, that which is in Atzilut is the foundation and root of all these qualities in the lower worlds.

וְשָׁם הוּא הַכֹּל בְּעֵצָם, וְכַמ"ש הַגֵּר"א בְּסֵפֶר יִצִּירָה פ"א מְשַׁנָּה ב' אֲפֹן
ג',

But there everything is an integral part of the essence of the World of Atzilut, as the Gaon of Vilna writes in his commentary to *Sefer Yetzirah* 1:2, third approach:

כִּי כָל דָּבָר שֶׁהוּא בְּמִקְרָה הוּא בְּשִׁרְשָׁם בְּעֵצָם

Anything that appears here as happenstance has its roots in the essence,

וְעִמָּד שָׁם בְּהוֹה תָּמִיד, כִּי כָל הָאֲצִילוֹת הִרִי הוּא אֱלֹהוּת כְּנֻזָּר:

where it is exists in the continuous present, since Atzilut is indeed Godliness, as mentioned.

וְהָעֲנִין הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְפָּשֵׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּאוֹרוֹ

The concept is as follows: the blessed Emanator spread forth and clothed His light

בְּכָל הַסְפִירוֹת דְּאֶצִּילוֹת וְנַעֲשֶׂה חֵד עִמָּהֶם

in all the *sefirot* of Atzilut, and became one with them.

הִנֵּה הוּא פָּעַל וּפּוֹעֵל עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֶת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּבִי"ע בְּכַמוּתָם
וְאִיכוּתָם וְכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם וּפְעֻלוֹתֵיהֶם.

Now by means thereof i.e. via the *sefirot* of Atzilut He brought into being, and He continues to sustain the existence of the Worlds of BiY"A in quantity and quality in all matters pertaining to them and in all their effects.

הַכֹּל ע"פ סֵדֶר אוֹתוֹ הָעֲנִינִים הַמְסֻדָּר בְּאֶצִּילוֹת לְפִי עֶרֶךְ הַמַּתִּיחֵס
שָׁם,

Everything is according to the structure of those matters as arranged in Atzilut, and according to the principles that pertain there.

זֶהוּ גִלּוּיוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּאֶצִּילוֹת.

And this is His revelation as it is revealed in Atzilut,

הֵיִינוּ בְּמְצִיאוֹת הַתְּהוּוֹת הַנֶּאֱצָלִים עֲצָמוֹ

that is to say, in bringing into being the emanations of Atzilut itself

וְהַתְּלַבְּשׁוּ בָּהֶם וְיַחְדּוֹ עִמָּהֶם בְּכָל סֵדֶר וְעֲנִינָם,

and clothing Himself within them and uniting with them throughout their structure and the principles that pertain there,

וּלְפַעַל עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֶת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּהִבִּי"ע בְּכָל אוֹתוֹ הַסֵּדֶר
וְהָעֲנִינִים ג"כ,

and via them, the entire existence of BiY"A is imbued with that same entire structure and the principles that pertain there as well.

וְע"י כ"ז הִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם,

By means of all this He becomes revealed to be called by Name

כִּי ע"י הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹ וְגִלּוּיוֹ בְּאֶצִּילוֹת וּבְכָל עֲנִינֵי הַנִּזְכָּר,

– by clothing Himself in the *sefirot* and His revelations in Atzilut in all the matters mentioned,

הִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁמוֹ הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁהוּא הַשֵּׁם הַזֶּה ב"ה

He becomes revealed so that He can be called by His great Name, the blessed Name Havaye the ineffable Name,

וּבְכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַמְּסֻתָּעִים מִמֶּנּוּ, וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ לְפִי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי נִקְרָא,

and all the other holy Names that derive from that Name, as we explained previously, "according to My deeds I am called."

כי השמות הם עצמם עצם כל הכחות והפעלות.

This is because the Names themselves are those very powers and actions,

והרי יצא מעתה להקרא בשם.

and thus He emerged from now on to be called by Name.

והוא גלוי הרביעי ממדרגת אמתתו הנעלמה.

This is the fourth revelation from His true concealed being

והוא בחי' גלוי אשר בפעלה ממש.

- His revelation of Himself within His deeds, literally.

ובזה הנה הנה הוא ית"ש שרש כל נמצא ויסוד כל נברא.

In this manner He becomes the root of everything in existence, and the foundation of all created things.

והוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו שהאצילות הוא היסוד והשרש דכל העולמות בי"ע עם כל עניניהם.

This concurs with our statement that Atzilut is the foundation and the root of all the Worlds of BiY"A and all of their aspects,

והוא עם האצילות הרי הוא חד עמהם כנ"ל

and He, as He clothes Himself in Atzilut and becomes one with Atzilut, is one with them (the lower worlds) as well, as mentioned above.

וא"כ הרי נתגלה ע"י התלבשו באצילות להיות שרש הכל. והבן כ"ז היטיב:

This being so, He becomes revealed by clothing Himself in Atzilut where He becomes the root of everything. Understand all this well!

והנה זהו שאמרו בזהר הקדש ויקרא י"א ב' בענין העשרה שמות

This is in fact what the holy Zohar states (*Vayikra* 11b) regarding the Ten Names,

דעשר ספי' דאצילות שאמרנו לעיל פ"ב.

which correspond to the ten *sefirot* mentioned above in chapter 2.

אמרו שם ואילין אנון כתרין קדישין דמלכא, דהוא אשתמודע בהו

This is what they said there: "These are the holy crowns of the King; through them He is known

. ואינון שמיא והוא אנון עכ"ל ("שמתלבש בהם ומתגלה בהם בכל הגלויים הנז')

(because He is clothed within them and reveals Himself in them in all the manners of revelation mentioned). They are His Name, and He is them."

וְהוּא ע"פ מָה שְׁאִמְרָנוּ כִּי כָל הָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא מַעֲתָה הוּא עֲצָמוֹ
יִת"ש.

**This concurs with what we stated earlier that the entire Atzilut from now on is
He himself, blessed is He,**

אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּזֶה הוּא עֲצָמוֹ אַחֵר שֶׁיֵּרֵד מִמִּדְרָגָה לְמִדְרָגָה.

for in this way He Himself is revealed, having descended level after level,

שֶׁהוּא מִדְרָגָה הָרְבִיעִית מֵאֲמִתּוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה,

this being the fourth level from His true hidden being.

וּבִמִּדְרָגָה הָרְבִיעִי הַזֶּה הֵנָּה יֵצֵא בְּבַחֲיִנַת פְּעֻלָּה מִמַּשׁ,

It is at this fourth level that His actual effects emerge

וְנִתְגַּלָּה בּוֹ כְּבִיכּוֹל בְּבַחֲיִנַת יְצִיאָה מִן הַכַּח אֶל הַפְּעֵל,

**and where He becomes revealed, so to speak, as emerging from potential to
actual.**

וְהֵנָּה הוּא גָלוּי גָמוּר וְהוּא גָלוּי שְׁמוֹ,

This is full revelation – the revelation of His Name –

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר עַקֵּר הַדְּבָרִים בְּזֶה לְקַמּוֹן פ"ו בַּעַה"י:

the main points of which will be explained below in chapter 6, God willing.

Footnotes

1. As we noted at the end of the previous chapter "two that are four" is a fairly common Rabbinic statement in the *Mishnah* (e.g. *Shabbat* 1:1; *Sh'vuot* 2:1; *Nega'im* 1:1). The intention is to classify a subject broadly and then specify sub-categories. [↪](#)
2. The mystery of the Divine Will as explained in the previous chapter. [↪](#)
3. The concept of God 'thinking to Himself' (so to speak), as explained in the previous chapter. [↪](#)
4. In the text the ten *sefirot* are listed in abbreviated form, with the first six arranged in triads *k-ch-b*; *ch-g-t*, and then the last four as a group *n-h-y-m* [↪](#)
5. In the text the ten *sefirot* are again listed in abbreviated form, as in the previous footnote. [↪](#)
6. Cf. Isaiah 43:7: כָּל הַנִּקְרָא בְּשֵׁמִי וְלִכְבוֹדִי בְּרָאֹתַי וְיִצְרֹתַי אֶף עֲשִׂיתִיו – a verse that alludes to all four Worlds. See *Pardes* 16:1. [↪](#)
7. 1:4. [↪](#)
8. *Tikunei Zohar*, Intro. p. 19a. [↪](#)

9. An alternative translation: "You shall not give credence to other gods in My Presence." ↩
10. Alternatively: "My Countenance." ↩
11. Alternatively: "My Countenance." ↩
12. *Matok Midvash* on the *Zohar ad loc.* ↩
13. *Matok Midvash* on the *Zohar ad loc.* ↩
14. Here ends the quote from the *Zohar.* ↩
15. Rabbi Menachem Recanati (late 13th C to early 14th C) was an Italian Kabbalist who wrote a Kabbalistic commentary on the Torah, another on the Prayers and a third on the Mitzvot. ↩
16. Rabbi Meanchem Tzioni, a 14th C German Kabbalist who wrote a Kabbalistic commentary on the Torah, and a commentary on *Sefer Yetzirah.* ↩
17. Rabbeinu Bachye (d. 1340) was a Spanish Kabbalist who wrote a commentary on the Torah combining various modes of explanation, including Kabbalah. He also authored several other works. ↩
18. See *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar HaKlalim* ch. 2; *sha'ar* 9:1; 10:1; 11:7; 13:3. ↩
19. *Zohar III, Nasso.* ↩
20. The Divine intention is not the revelations themselves, even the loftiest revelations, but rather Torah and mitzvot in this world. It may be argued that this follows from what is later taught in this text that all that happens above, so to speak, is for the sake of what takes place below. ↩

Chapter 5 — The fifth level of the revelation of Divine Light, the worlds of Bi" a (briah, yetzira, asiya).

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 5

Various aspects of His Revelations

הַמַּדְרָגָה הַחֲמִישִׁית מִגְלוּיָיו הוּא מָה שִׁיִּצָּא אֹחַ"כ לַפֶּעַל ע"י
הָאֲצִילוֹת

The fifth level of His revelations following Atzilut, the fourth-level, is what emerged afterwards to bring about, via Atzilut,

אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע [בְּרִיָּאָה, יִצְרָה, עֲשִׂיָּה]
the entire existence of the Worlds of BiY"A [Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah]

בְּכָל מְצִיאוֹתָם בְּכָל וּבְפָרֵט וּבְכָל עֲנִיְיָהֶם וְתַלְוֹכוֹתֵיהֶם,
in all of their existence in general and specifically, and in all of the matters associated with them and the way in which they operate,

אֲשֶׁר מֵעַתָּה שֶׁנִּבְרָאוּ וְנוֹצְרוּ וְנַעֲשׂוּ עַד סוֹף זְמַן קִיּוֹמָם,
from the time that they were created, formed, and made until the end of their existence.

'Created' alludes to Beriah, 'formed' alludes to Yetzirah, 'made' alludes to Asiyah.

שֶׁהוּא כָּל הַהִנְהָגָה אֲשֶׁר עַד עַתָּה הִתְקוּן הָעָתִיד.

This includes the entire manner in which they are divinely guided or conducted until their future *tikun*.

הִנֵּה כ"ז הוּא גְלוּיֵי הַחֲמִישִׁית שִׁיּוּצָא וּמִתְגַּלֶּה מִגְלוּיֵי הָרְבִיעִי
שֶׁבְּאֲצִילוֹת.

All of this is His fifth revelation that emerges out of, and is revealed from, His fourth revelation – that is Atzilut.

וְהוּא הַמְּצִיאוֹת וְהַהִנְהָגָה דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁבְּרָא וַיִּצֶר וַעֲשָׂה

This is the existence and divine guidance of the Worlds of BiY"A which He created, formed and made,

וּמְנַהִיג אוֹתָם ע"י גְלוּיֵי שֶׁבְּאֲצִילוֹת.

and which He guides via His revelation in Atzilut.

וַיְרִידְתּוֹ בַּפְּעֻלַת הַבִּי"ע הוּא גְלוּיֵי הַחֲמִישִׁי

This descent into bringing the Worlds of BiY" A into reality is His fifth revelation

שְׁהוּא מְדֻרְגָּה הַחֲמִישִׁי מֵאַמְתָּתוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה ית"ש:

– the fifth level from His true concealed Being, blessed is His Name.

וְהִנֵּה הַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן הָרִי אֲמָרְנוּ לְעֵיל פ"ג שְׁהוּא נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אֵין סוֹף,

Now the first revelation we mentioned above in chapter 3 is called *Ein Sof*,

וְכֵמוֹ שְׁאַמְרְנוּ שֵׁם שֶׁא"ס הוּא ג"כ מְכַלֵּל הַגְּלוּיִם.

and as we said there *Ein Sof* is also in the category of revelation, which is why we refer to this revelation as *Ohr Ein Sof*, the revelation of *Ein Sof*

וְכֵן נִקְרָא הוּא ג"כ בְּשֵׁם מַאֲצִיל עֲלִיוֹן,

and also as *Supernal Emanator* (*Ma'atzil Elyon*),

וְכֵן הוּא נִקְרָא עוֹד בְּשֵׁם עֶלְת עַל כָּל הָעֲלוֹת ע' זוה"ק [זֹהַר הַקֹּדֶשׁ] בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"ב ע"ב.

and he is also called *Exalted over all the exalted ones* (see *Zohar, Bereishit 22b*).

וְהַגְּלוּי הַשֵּׁנִי הוּא הַצִּמְצוּם וְהַקּוֹ, וְכֵן נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם טְהִירוֹ עֲלֵאָה.

The second revelation is the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, also called the 'supernal clear light', the word טְהִירוֹ is an Aramaic word for light

וְכֵן בְּשֵׁם אֲוִיר קִדְמוֹן, אֲוִירָא קִדְמָאָה סְתִימָאָה, אֲוִירָא עֲלֵאָה. ע' זֹהַר בְּרֵאשִׁית ט"ו א' ט"ז ב'.

and primordial 'space'¹ (*avir kadmon*), or the hidden supernal 'space' (*avira kadma'a ila'a*), or ethereal 'space' (*avira ila'a*) See *Zohar Bereishit 15a, 16b*

וְהַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא אָדָם קִדְמוֹן, וְכֵן נִקְרָא הוּא בְּשֵׁם פֶּתֶר עֲלִיוֹן סִתָּם וְטָמִיר.

The third Revelation is *Adam Kadmon* which is also called supernal *keter*, which is hidden and concealed.

ע' תִּקּוּנִים תִּקּוּן ע' קל"ח א'.

See *Tikunim* (*Tikunei Zohar*), *Tikun 70*, page 138a.

וְהִנֵּה אֱלוֹ הַב' שֶׁהֵם גְּלוּי הַב' וְהַג', הִנֵּה הֵם כְּלוּלִים בְּהָא'.

Now these two just mentioned as the second and third revelation are actually included in the first,

וְהֵם נִקְרָאִים בְּשֵׁם עוֹלָמוֹת דָּאִין סוֹף כִּי הֵם בּוֹ עֲצָמוֹ,

and they are called the Infinite Worlds, because they are as yet within Him,

הַרְצוֹן וְהַמַּחְשָׁבָה וְהַהֲרֹוּר שֶׁבּוֹ כֵּן"ל פ"ג.

and are referred to as *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* as discussed in chapter 3 of this section.

וְאֵלּוּ הֵג' גְּלוּיִם הֵם בְּסוּד אָפֶס, אִין, א"א (אֲרִיךְ אֲנִפִּין).

[These three revelations are also the mystery of Nothingness, non-being² and *Arich Anpin*

וְכֵן רַדל"א [רִישָׁא דְלֹא אֲתִידַע] עֲתִיק (כִּי רַדל"א הוּא הֵג' רִאשׁוֹנִים שֶׁבּוֹ וְעֲתִיק הוּא הַזֵּה תַּחְתּוֹנִים שֶׁבּוֹ) א"א,

And are also known as *Radl"a* [*Reisha d'lo ityada* – the 'head' which cannot be known], *Atik* (since *Radl"a* refers to the first three *sefirot* of *keter*, while *Atik* refers to the lower seven) and *Arich Anpin*

וְכֵן הֵם הֵג' צִחְצֻחוֹת הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים הַכִּלְלִיִּים.

and also as the three supernal, inclusive 'brilliant illuminations'

וְכֵן סוּד הֵג' רִישִׁין הַכִּלְלִיִּים. וְהַשִּׁי"ת יִכְפֹּר.

also referred to as the mystery of the three all-inclusive heads.³ May God grant me forgiveness for divulging these secrets.

וְע' בַּהֲגֹר"א בְּתִקּוּנִים רִישׁ תִּקּוּן ע' דָּף קל"ח ע"א וּבַתז"ח [תִּקּוּנֵי זֶהָר חֲדָשׁ] דָּף נ' ע"א ד"ה בְּרִישׁ]:

See GR"A *Tikunim*, *Tikun 70*, p. 138a; *Tikunei Zohar Chadash* p. 50a, starting with the words *B'reish*. The note ends here.

וְהִנֵּה כָּל אֱלֹוֵי הֵג' גְּלוּיִם הָרִאשׁוֹנִים הֵנָּה הֵג' שְׁאֲנֵי קוֹרְאִים אוֹתָם בְּשֵׁם גְּלוּיִים

Now all these first three revelations, even though we refer to them as 'revelations,'

אֲךְ אֵינָם גְּלוּיִם אֲלֹא רַק בְּעֶרְךְ אֲמַתְתּוֹ הַנֶּעְלָמָה ית"ש אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה.

are not actually revelations per se, but only relative to their true concealed Source above, may His Name be blessed.

וּבְעֶרְךְ זֶה הֵנָּה בְּחִי' א"ס וְהַעוֹלָמוֹת דֹּא"ס ג"כ מְכַלֵּל הַגְּלוּיִם וְכֵן"ל פ"ג.

But relative to that to His concealed essence the aspects of *Ein Sof*⁴ and the infinite worlds are in the category of revelation, as noted in chapter 3.

אֲבָל בְּאֵמֶת הִנֵּה הֵם אֵינָם גְּלוּיִם מִמֶּשׁ כָּלֵל מֵאַחֵר שֶׁהֵם רַק
בְּבַחֲיִנַת מַחֲשָׁבָה וְרָצוֹן.

Although in truth they are not really 'revelations' at all, since they are merely the aspects of *machshava* (internal thought) and *ratzon* (will)

ובא"ס עֲצָמוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר אֵין בוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה כָּלֵל בְּשׁוּם אוֹת וּנְקֻדָּה
in the *Ein Sof* Himself, blessed be His Name, which no letter or vowel point can express.

וא"כ הִרִי הוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת שְׁלֵמָטָה בְּתַכְלִית הָהֶעָלָם
It follows that He is hidden from all the worlds below with the utmost concealment.

וְכֹן גַּם הַקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם וְאָדָם קִדְמָאָה שֶׁהֵם מֵהָעוֹלָמוֹת דָּא"ס
Similarly, even the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* and *Adam Kadmon*, which are in the category of the Infinite Worlds,

הֵם כָּלָם טָמִיר וְנֶעְלָם מִפְּלֶא וּמִכְסָּה:
are all also hidden and concealed, invisible and obscured.

אָמֵנָם הַגְּלוּי הָרַבִּיעִי שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ אֲשֶׁר בוֹ יֵצֵא מִן הַכַּח אֶל הַפַּעַל
כְּבִיכּוֹל

However, the fourth revelation that we mentioned – the World of Atzilut – by which He emerged from a state of potential to actual, so to speak,

הִנֵּה שָׁם הוּא עֶקֶר גְּלוּיּוֹ כִּי שָׁם נִתְגַּלָּה הַמְּאֲצִיל א"ס ית"ש
that is where the primary revelation takes place, for it is there that the blessed Infinite Emanator is revealed

לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם גָּמוּר וְהוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה, וְהוּא גְּלוּיּוֹ שְׁבִהָאֲצִילוֹת.
in a manner that He can be referred to by an actual name, the Name *Havaye*⁵, may He be blessed, and this is His revelation in Atzilut.

כִּי ע"י הַתְּלַבְּשׁוּ בְּאֲצִילוֹת וְיִחַדּוּ בָהֶם, ר"ל בְּהַעֲשֵׂר סְפִירוֹת.
By means of clothing Himself in Atzilut, and manifesting His Oneness therein, that is to say, in the ten *sefirot*,

נִקְרָא הַמְּאֲצִיל א"ס עֲצָמוֹ יְהוּ"ה ב"ה וְכֵן"ל.
the Infinite Emanator Himself is called *Havaye*, blessed is He, as mentioned above.

וְהִרִי הוּא גְּלוּי מִמֶּשׁ כִּי נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם שֶׁהוּא שֵׁם הָעֶצֶם
ית"ש:

Now this is indeed revelation, for He is revealed in a manner that He can be called by Name, the Essential Name, may His Name be blessed.

אך הגלוי החמישי אשר נתגלה בו במציאות העולמות בי"ע.

However, the fifth revelation, which becomes manifest in the Worlds of BiY"A, הנה הוא נקרא בשם אלהים,

is referred to by the Name *Elokim*,

והוא מה שנאמר (בראשית א א) בראשית ברא אלהים

as is stated in the verse (Genesis 1:1), "In the beginning God (*Elokim*) created..."

וכן הוא בכל העשרה מאמרות כלם ויאמר אלהים,

Indeed, all of the Ten Utterances through which the world was created**⁶ begin with the words "And *Elokim* said..."

כי גלוי בכל המציאות דהעולמות בי"ע הוא רק בשם אלהים.

since what He reveals of Himself throughout the existence of the Worlds of BiY"A is only in the Name *Elokim*

, עין שם היטיב (עין זוה"ק בראשית כ' ע"א),

(See *Zohar Bereishit* 20a). Delve into that passage well,

ובהגר"א בספד"צ [ספרא דצניעותא] ספ"ה ד"ה כתיב ויתהלך

and see the commentary of the GR"A to *Sifra d'Tzniuta* end of chap. 5, the words beginning "It is written, 'And he Enoch walked together with...'"⁷

ושם פ"ג ד"ה כתיב ויאמר, והוא גימטריא הכסא

Also *ibid.* chap. 3, the words beginning "It is written, 'And he said...' " where he explains that the Name *Elokim* has the numerical value *gematria* of 'the Throne' – both add up to 86 –

שהוא עולם הבריאה הנקרא כסא הכבוד ע"ש

which is the World of Beriah, called 'the Throne of Glory,' (see there)

שעליו שורה אור קדשתו ית"ש אשר באצילות.

upon which rests the light of His holiness as it is in Atzilut.

ושם מתגלה כבודו שהוא שכינתו ית"ש המתפשט ושוכן בהבי"ע.

And it is there that His Glory is revealed. This is the blessed *Shechinah*, which spreads forth to and lodges in BiY"A,

כי שם, ר"ל בעולם הבריאה, הנה שם הוא הבית המקדש של מעלה

since there, i.e. in the World of Beriah, is the Supernal Temple,

הַמְכֹּון כְּנֶגֶד בֵּיהֶמ"ק שֶׁל מֶטָה,

which corresponds precisely⁸ to the Temple below.

וְנִקְרָא בֵּיהֶמ"ק שֶׁל מַעֲלָה בְּשֵׁם כְּסֵא הַכְּבוֹד, וּבֵיהֶמ"ק שֶׁל מֶטָה
בְּשֵׁם הַדּוֹם וְגָלְיוֹ,

The Supernal Temple is called "the Throne of Glory," and the Temple below is called "His footrest,"

וְכַמ"ש בְּדִבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א' כ"ח, ה⁹ לְבָנוֹת בֵּית כו' לְהַדּוֹם וְגָלְיָ
אֱלֹהֵינוּ,

as the verse states (I Chronicles 28:2) "...to build a House of rest for the Ark of the Covenant of God, as a footrest for our Lord..."

ע' דִּבְרֵינוּ בְּאַרְכָּה בָּזָה בְּסִפּוֹר הַדַּע"ה ח"א דְּרוֹשׁ ה' סִי ז'.

See at length our *Sefer haDe'ah* part 1, *drush* 5:7

וְעַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי גָלְיוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּהַעֲלָמוֹת בִּי"ע הֵנָּה הוּא בְּשֵׁם
אֱלֹהִים.

In any event, what He reveals of Himself in the Worlds of BiY" A is through the Name *Elokim*,

אֲבָל הָאוֹר דֶּה־שֵׁם הוִי"ה ב"ה הוּא גָּנוֹז וְנִעְלָם שֵׁם וְגִלְיוֹ הוּא רַק
בְּאַצִּילוֹת:

whereas the light of the blessed Name *Havaye* is concealed and hidden there, and is revealed only in Atzilut.

אֲמָנָם כָּל עֶקֶר הַגָּלְוִי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים

In fact, the primary revelation of the Name *Elokim*

הוּא מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ רַק מִגָּלְיוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּהַשֵּׁם הוִי"ה ב"ה.

flows forth from, and is drawn only from His revelation that is within the Name *Havaye*, blessed is He.

כִּי אֱלֹהִים שְׁמִסְפָּרוֹ פ"ו הִיא נִמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִהַמְלִוִי דְּמִסְפָּר הַשֵּׁם
הוִי"ה ב"ה

This is because the numerical value or *gematria* of *Elokim*, which is 86, is drawn from and emerges out of the *milui** of the numerical value (*gematria*) of the Name *Havaye*,

*The *milui* of any letter is its full iteration when spelled out. E.g. the letter א spelled out in full is א"ל (aleph = aleph, lamed, pai). The *Baal HaLeshem* uses the same idea here to expand the numerical value of the Name *Havaye*

שְׁמִסְפְּרוֹ הוּא כ"ו, וּמְלוּיֹו הוּא כָּ"ף ו"ו, וְהָרִי הָהָה הַמְלוּי פ"ו,

whose numerical value (*gematria*) is 26 since $20 = \text{כ}$ and $6 = \text{ו}$, and the *milui* of which is written out as כָּ"ף ו"ו – thus the *milui* (i.e. the additional letters besides the כ and ו) is $86 = \text{פ"ו}$.

וְלָכֵן 'מְלוּי' גִּימְטְרִיָּא אֱלֹהִים (ע"ח תְּקוּן ג')

Thus the *milui* of the *gematria* of the Name *Havaye* is the *gematria* of *Elokim* = 86,

כִּי הִיא נִמְשָׁךְ מִמְסַפֵּר הַמְלוּי לְבַד,

since it is drawn only from the *gematria* of the *milui* but not from the *gematria* of the Name *Havaye* itself.

וְכֵן הוּא עוֹד כִּי הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה דַּאֲלֵפִי"ן

Furthermore, the Name *Havaye* when spelled out with the *aleph-milui*

The letters of the Name *Havaye* itself can be spelled in a number of ways: the *milui* of the first letter *yud* is always the same – יו"ד, but the *milui* of the last three letters of the Name can be spelled with the *yud-milui* $72 = \text{ה"י ו"ו ה"י}$, the *alpeh-milui* $45 = \text{ה"א ו"ו ה"א}$, the *hai-milui* $52 = \text{ה"ו ה"ו ה"ה}$, or with a *yud-aleph* combination $63 = \text{ה"י ו"ו ה"י}$. Now the *aleph-milui*

שֶׁהוּא בְּחִי' הָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי דְּאֲצִילוֹת וְגִלּוּי,

is the aspect of the inclusive *ruach* of Atzilut and its revelation

The 72 value name (with the *yud-milui*) is the soul-level of *yechida* consciousness; the 63 value name (a *yud-aleph* combination) is the level of *chaya* consciousness; the 45 value name (the *alpeh-milui*) is the level of *ruach* consciousness, and the 52 value name (the *hai-milui*) is the level of *nefesh* consciousness, as will be explained shortly.

וְכַמ"ש אֱלִיָּהוּ זָכוֹר לְטוֹב מְלַגְאוֹ אִיהוּ יו"ד ה"א וָא"ו ה"א דְּאִיָּהוּ
אֲרַח אֲצִילוֹת

As Eliyahu (who is remembered for the good) stated: "Within i.e. within the *sefirot*, which is the outer aspect, is the animating and illuminating consciousness – יו"ד ה"א וָא"ו ה"א which is the path of Atzilut i.e. the manner in which the soul-consciousness is drawn down into Atzilut.¹⁰

וְהוּא הַשֵּׁם הַמְפָּרֵשׁ הָעֶקְרִי בְּשֶׁהוּא בְּנִקּוּד מוֹצֵא אוֹתִיּוֹתָיו הַפְּשׁוּטִים חֲצִק'צ'
[(=חִירִיק, צִירִי, קִמֶץ, צִירִי)].

[This is the explicit and primary Name, whose vowel-points articulating the basic letters of the Name are *chirik*, *tzeirei*, *kametz*, *tzeirei*].¹¹

וְהִיא גִימְטְרִיָּא מ"ה, וּבְמְלוּי הוּא מ"ם ה"א שְׁמִסְפְּרוֹ פ"ו כְּמִסְפֵּר
אֱלֹהִים,

The numerical value (*gematria*) of the letters of the name together with their *milui* is **45** (in Hebrew letters 45 = מ"ה), **and with the milui of 86 = א"ה**, **the same gematria** as the name אלהים – *Elokim*.

כי ממנו עצמו הנה נמשך ומתגלה בשם אלהים.

Thus in and of itself the name Havaye is drawn down and revealed by the name Elokim

והוא כל העולמות בי"ע שנעשים בשם אלהים.

as all the worlds of BiY"A, which are created with the name Elokim.

הנה הם נעשים רק מאצילות שהוא האור דהשם הוי"ה ב"ה

Thus they are made only from Atzilut, which is the light of the name Havaye,

ויכמו שחתם התורה בסוף כל מעשה בראשית (ב, ד)

in the same way that the Torah concludes the account of the work of Creation (Genesis 2, 4),

ואמר ביום עשות יהוה אלהים ארץ ושמים,

stating: "...on the day that Havaye Elokim made earth and heaven" using both Divine Names.

אלא שהאור דהשם הוי"ה ב"ה הוא גנוז ונעלם שם.

However, the light of the name Havaye is concealed and obscured there,

וגלויים הוא רק בהאור דשם אלהים.

and the revelation is only from the light of the name Elokim.

וכן הוא אלהים בגימטריא הטבע כי בו נעשה הטבע כלו.

It is also the case that the name Elokim is the same gematria as hateva – Nature,¹²

אלא שעקרו ויסודו הוא האור דהשם הוי"ה ב"ה הגנוז בו

although the root and foundation of Nature is the light of the blessed Name Havaye that is concealed therein.

ולכן אין להטבע קיום החלטי אלא 'ברצותו חוגג וברצותו ממוגג'.

and therefore Nature has no absolute existence, but "when He wishes He extrudes [the glass] and when He wishes He melts it"¹³

וע' בזה בדברינו בספר הכללים כלל ב' ענ"ג בארקה.

See our comments on this in Sefer HaKlalim, klal 2:3 at length,

ובחלק הבאורים בעגלים וישר ענף ב' אות י"ח ואות כ':

and the explanatory section of Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher 2:18, 20.

אָמַנְם מָה שְׁאִמְרָנוּ שְׁאֵלוּ ב' הַגְּלוּיִם, הָרַבִּיעִי וְהַחֲמִישִׁי,

However, as regards our earlier statement that these two revelations, the fourth and the fifth,

הֵם הַשְּׁמוֹת הוּי"ה אֱלֹהִים, וְהַגְּלוּי דָּשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה הוּא בְּאַצִּילוֹת
are the names *Havaye* and *Elokim*, and that the revelation of the blessed Name *Havaye* is in *Atzilut*,

וְהַגְּלוּי דָּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים הוּא בְּעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע
while the name *Elokim* is manifested in BiY"A,

הֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּכָלְלוֹת וּבְעֶצְמוֹתָם הָעֶקְרִי שְׁבָהֶם,
this is only in a general sense, in their primary essence,

כִּי כָּלֵל הָאַצִּילוֹת וְהָעֶצְמוֹת הָעֶקְרִי שָׁבוּ הוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה.
since *Atzilut* in general, and the primary essence within it, is the blessed Name *Havaye*.

וְכָלֵל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְהָעֶצְמוֹת הָעֶקְרִי שְׁבָהֶם הוּא הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים
הַכָּלְלִי

Whereas the Worlds of BiY"A in general, and the primary essence within them is in general the Name *Elokim*

הַמֵּתִפְשֵׁט וְיוֹצֵא מֵהַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה הַכָּלְלִי דְּהָאַצִּילוֹת.
which spreads forth and emerges from the general Name *Havaye* of *Atzilut*.

אָבֵל בְּפִרְטוּיֹת הֵנָּה יִשָּׁנָם כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת כָּלָם בְּאַצִּילוֹת
But in specific terms, all the Names are present in *Atzilut*,¹⁴

כִּי הֵם בְּבַחֲיִנַת פְּנִימִית וְחִיצוֹנִית; נִשְׁמָה, רוּחַ, נֶפֶשׁ; גּוּף, וּלְבוּשׁ
וְהִיכָל.

since they are expressed in the aspects of inner and outer; *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*; body, garment, chamber.¹⁵

ע' לְקוּטֵי הַגֶּר"א בְּסוּף אֲגָדוֹת בְּרָכוֹת דִּף מ"ג ע"ב.

See *Likutei HaGra* end of *Agadot*, *Berachot* 43b.

וְכֹן יִשָּׁנָם עַד"ז כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת כָּלָם בְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

In a similar manner, all the Names are distributed throughout the Worlds of BiY"A,

וְהֵם נִבְחָנִים בְּכָלְלוֹת וּפְרָטוֹת וּפְרָטֵי פְרָטוֹת.

and they can be differentiated by whether they apply generally, specifically or in a particular instance of a specific situation,

וכן בפנימית ופנימית לפנימית, ובחיצונית וחיצונית לחיצונית.

and whether they apply to the inner dimension or to the innermost aspect of the inner dimension, or to the outer dimension or to the outermost aspect of the outer dimension.

והם מתחלפים לפי ערך המדרגות כי מה שהוא פנימית לזה הוא חיצונית לזה.

They also change according to the stature of the various levels, for what is the inner dimension in one situation, is the outer dimension in another.

וכן מתחלפים תמיד בגלויים, לפי מצב העולמות וזכותם ולפי העת והזמן.

There are also constant changes in terms of revelation, according to the status of the worlds and their refinement, and according to the time and the season,

ואינו דומה יום אחד לחברו ושעה אחת לחברתה

so that one day is not similar to another, and one hour is not the same as another –

אבל כלם ישנם בכלם אלא שזה בהעלם וזה בגלוי.

instead, all of them all of the Names are present at all levels, just that at any level a certain Name may be concealed, while another is revealed.

ועין בזה בארפה בתקונים תקון כ"ב דף ע"ב ב' וע"ג א'.

See at length *Tikunim*, *Tikun 22*, p. 72b, 73a¹⁶

ואמר שם דלבושין איהו משתני בהון לכמה שנוין

where it states that He 'changes His garments' a number of times –

ולבושין דאהו לבוש בצפרא לא לביש ברמשא

the garments He wears in the morning He does not wear in the evening,

ולבושין דלביש יומא חדא לא לביש יומא תנינא.

and the garments He wears one day, He doesn't wear a second day,

והכי בכל יומא וירחא ושתא ושבטא ויומין טבין כו' כו'.

and so too every day, every month, every year, every Sabbath and Yom Tov...

He changes His garments.

ומלגאו מינה כו' נהיר קב"ה דאהו הוי"ה, פנשמתא בגופא, לגו מכלא

And inside of those garments shines the Holy One, blessed be He, who is Havaye, and like the soul within the body in man, He is within everything,

הֵהוּא דִּאֶחֶיד כָּלָא וְקָשֶׁר כָּלָא כו' דְּבִכָּל חַד וְחַד רְשִׁים אַרְבַּע אֲתִנּוּ
כו'.

He unifies all things and binds all things together... and in each one of them in every creature is engraved the four letters of His Name.

עוֹד שֵׁם דָּף ע"ב סוּף ע"א: וְכָל חַד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל דְּהוּא אָמַר נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמַע

Also there in the *Tikunim*, p. 72a¹⁷ it states: ****Each Israelite who declared
Whatever God says, we will do, and we will obey' (Exodus 24:7)

הָהוּא שְׂרִיא בְּפוּמִיהּ וְהוּא אוֹלִיף לִיהּ אוֹרִיטָא כְּלָהּ.

an angel rested upon his mouth and taught him the entire Torah.¹⁸

וּלְבַתֵּר מְלִיל עֲמַהוּן מִן שְׂמִיא וְאַרְעָא, הֵה"ד מִן הַשְּׁמַיִם הַשְּׁמִיעֵךְ
אֶת קִלּוֹ...
את קלל.

**And after this He spoke to them from the heavens and the earth, as the verse
(Deuteronomy 4:36) states, "From the heavens He enabled you to hear His
voice..."**

וְעַל הָאָרֶץ הִרְאָךְ אֶת אֲשׁוּ הַגְּדוֹלָהּ כו'.

and upon the earth He showed you His great fire..."

לְבַתֵּר הָהוּא מִמְּלִל עֲמַהוּן מֵאַרְבַּע סְטְרִין כו'

After this He spoke to them from all four directions at once

לְאַחֲזָאָה דְּמְכָל אֲתֵר מְלִיל עֲמַהוּן וְלֹא הָהוּא אֲתֵר לְעֵלָא וְתַתָּא דְּלֹא
מְלִיל עֲמַהוּן.

**to demonstrate that from every place He spoke to them, and there was no place
above or below from which He did not speak to them,**

לְאַחֲזָאָה דְּמֵלָא כָּל הָאָרֶץ כְּבוֹדוֹ.

showing that 'the whole world is filled with His glory' (Isaiah 6:3).

דָּאָהוּ סְבִיל עֲלָאִין וְתַתָּאִין וְאִיהוּ סְמִיךְ עֲלָא וְתַתָּא כו'

For He upholds the upper and the lower worlds,

אִיהוּ סְבִיל כּוֹלָא וְקָשֶׁר כּוֹלָא וּמִיחַד כּוֹלָא כו'.

He lifts up all things and binds them all together and unifies all...

וְאִיהוּ אֲתִקְרִי בְּכָל שְׁמָהוּן לְאַשְׁתַּמוּדְעָא תּוֹקְפִיהּ בְּכָל שְׁמָא וְשְׁמָא
כו' וְלִית לִיהּ שְׁמָא יְדִיעָא כו' ע"ש:

He is called all the holy names to make known His power in each and every name... and yet He has no knowable name.

וְהִנֵּה כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת כֻּלָּם הֵם מִסְתַּעְפִּים מִהַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה

Now all the holy names derive from the Name *Havaye*, may He be blessed.

וְכֵן כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָהּ כִּי הִיא כְּלָהּ שְׁמוֹתָיו שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה.

Furthermore, the entire Torah is the names of the Holy One, blessed is He,¹⁹

וכמ"ש בפ' ויקרא י"ג ע"ב. דְּהָא אֲוִרִיתָא כְּלָהּ שְׁמָא דקב"ה הוּי.

as the Zohar III *Vayikra* 13b states: The entire Torah is the Name of the Holy Blessed One,

וְכָל מֶאֵן דְּאֲנָשִׁי (שְׁשׁוּכַח) מְלוּלֵי אֲוִרִיתָא וְלֹא בְּעֵי לְמַלְעֵי בְּהַ כְּאֵלוֹ
אֲנָשִׁי לִקְב"ה.

and anyone who forgets the words of Torah, and does not desire to study them – it is as if he forgets about the Holy Blessed One.

וּבִפְרָשֶׁת יִתְרוֹ צ' ע"ב וְאֲוִרִיתָא כּוֹלָא שְׁמָא חַד הוּי.

And Zohar II *Yitro* 90b states the entire Torah is one single name –

שְׁמָא קַדִּישָׁא דקב"ה מְמַשׁ. מֶאֵן דְּזָכִי בְּאֲוִרִיתָא זָכִי בְּשְׁמָא קַדִּישָׁא.

the holy name of the Holy Blessed One, literally. Thus one who merits Torah knowledge is deemed worthy of the holy name.

ר' יוֹסִי אָמַר בַּקב"ה מְמַשׁ זָכִי דְּהָא הוּא וְשְׁמִיהּ חַד הוּא:

Rabbi Yose declared: he is deemed worthy of the Holy Blessed One Himself, since He and His name are one.

וְהִנֵּה כָּל הַתּוֹרָה הִנֵּה הִיא ג"כ ע"פ אֵלוֹ ב' הַגְּלוּיִם הַכְּלָלִיִּים.

Thus the entire Torah is also revealed in these two general types of revelation:

אֶחָד הוּא גְלוּיֵי שְׁבַאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּהָאוֹר דְּכָלְלוֹת שֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה

one, His revelation in Atzilut, which is in general the Name *Havaye*,

וְנִקְרָא הִיא תּוֹרַת הָאֲצִילוֹת.

and is called the 'Torah of Atzilut,'

וְאֶחָד הוּא גְלוּיֵי שְׁבִהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁהֵם בְּהָאוֹר וְגְלוּיֵי דְשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים

and the other, His revelation in the Worlds of BiY"A, which are the revelation and light of the name *Elokim*,

וְנִקְרָא הִיא תּוֹרַת הַבְּרִיָּאָה.

and is called the 'Torah of Beriah.'

ואלולא החטא דעץ הדעת היה זוכה אדם הראשון לתורה
האצילות.

Now were it not for the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, Adam would have been
worthy of the Torah of Atzilut,

כי היה נתן לו כל התורה כלה וכמ"ש "וינחמה בגן עדן לעבדה
ולשמרה".

since the entire Torah would have been given to him, as the verse states "He
placed him Adam in the Garden of Eden to work it and to guard it." (Genesis
2:15).

ואמרו בפדר"א [בפרקי דרבי אליעזר] פ' י"ב לעסק בדברי תורה

Commenting on this verse, *Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer* chapter 12²⁰ states: 'to work it'
means 'to occupy himself with the words of Torah,'

ולשמר את דרך עץ החיים והוא אוריתא דאצילות

And 'to guard it' means to guard the path to the Tree of Life, which is the Torah
of Atzilut,

שעקרה על יחודי אורות עליונים

the primary aspect of which is unification of the supernal illuminations,

שהם הפנימית דכל התורה והמצות.

that are the inner dimension of all of Torah and mitzvot.

ועל זה אמרו (עבודה זרה דף ג') שהקב"ה עוסק בתורה,

Regarding this the Sages stated (*Avodah Zara* 3b) that the Holy Blessed One
occupies Himself with Torah i.e. with the inner dimension of Torah.

כי אור פנימית התורה היא כחות כל הבריאה כלה בכלל ובפרט
ובפרטי פרטית.

For the light of the inner dimension of Torah is the animating power of the
entire Creation in general, specifically, and down to the minutest detail.

וכל מציאות המתחלפים ומתחדשים בכל עת וכל מקריהם שבכל
רגע

And the entire existence, as it changes and is renewed all the time,

וכל מקריהם שבכל רגע

and all the events that take place at every moment,

הוא נמשך הכל מגלויי אור פנימית התורה

are all drawn from the revelations of light of the inner dimension of Torah

שְׁמִתְגַּלִּית בְּכָל עֵת בְּגִלּוּיִם חֲדָשִׁים מֵעֵסֶק הַקֵּב"ה שְׁעוֹסֶק בָּהּ בְּכָל יוֹם:

that are revealed in all the new illuminations produced by the Holy Blessed One occupying Himself therein every day.

זֶה הָיָה עֲנֵן הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהָיָה נָתַן לְאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן אֱלֹלָא הַחֲטָא.

Now this was the Torah that would have been given to Adam, were it not for the sin of partaking of the Tree of Knowledge.

וְכֵן הָיָה נָתַן לָנוּ ג"כ אֱלוֹ שְׁזָכֵינוּ לְהַלּוּחוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת

And so too would it have been granted to us, had we merited the first Tablets,

וכמ"ש "אֲנִי אֶמְרָתִי אֱלֹהִים אֶתָּם".

as the verse (Psalms 82:6) states, "I said, 'You are *Elokim*...'"

The one speaking here is God, so some translate this as "you are angelic" as the name *Elokim* often refers to angels. The implication is that we would have lived forever, like the angels, had Adam not sinned.

וְע' דְּבָרֵינוּ נִזְכָּר בְּזֶה בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב דְּרוֹשׁ ד' מַעֲנֵי י"ב וְהִלָּאָה.

See some of our awe-inspiring words cited in our commentary on this in *Sefer HaDe'ah II* 4:12.

כִּי כ"ז הוּא מְרוֹמְמוֹת מַעֲלֵת גְּדֻלַּת תּוֹרָה הַקְדוֹשָׁה

For all of this is from the loftiest rungs of the greatness of the holy Torah,

שֶׁהִיא מִיִּסְדַּ מִרְמָ"ח וְשֵׁס"ה וְכָל מִצְוָה וּמִצְוָה הִרִי הִיא כּוֹלֵל פְּרָטִים רַבִּים אִין חִקָּר.

the basis of which is the 248 positive commandments and the 365 prohibitions; and each of the mitzvot includes innumerable details that cannot be fathomed.

וְהוּא בְּאֶשֶׁר שֶׁהוּא הִיִּסוּד וְהִשְׁרֵשׁ דְּכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כְּלָה

This is because it the Torah is the foundation and root of all existence

שֶׁהִיא נִתְיִסְדָּה ג"כ עַל תְּכֻנַּת פְּרָצוֹף אָדָם כְּנוֹדָע וּכמ"ש בַּאֲדָר"נ ס"פ ל"א.

which is also based on the characteristics of the human *partzuf*, as is known, and as *Idra d'R. Natan* (end of chap. 31) states.

וְכָל הַמּוֹן בְּרוּאִים לְאִין תְּכֻלִּית הַנִּמְצָא בְּהַמְּצִיאוֹת

The vast array – without limit – of creatures that exist

הֵנָּה הֵם רַק פְּרָטֵי הַקּוֹמָה הַכְּלָלִי.

are merely the specifics of a general structure

אבל כלם הם רק כללות קומת פראוץ אדם שלם.

and all are merely part of the general stature of a complete human *partzuf*.

ובפרט מין האדם ר"ל האישים שבכל דור

This is particularly the case with humans, i.e. the individuals in each generation

הנה הנה כללות כל דור רק אדם אחד שלם עם כלל המציאות יחד.

in a sense comprise a single complete person, together with the entire existence.

ולכן הם נצרכים זה לזה (רצוני לומר אדם אחד לחברו ולכל המציאות שבהעלם)

And therefore they need each other (by which I mean to say one person needs another, as well as needing everything in existence in the world),

ומשתמשים זה בזה [זה בזה] ונעזר כ"א [כל אחד] ע"י חברו

and they benefit one another, and one helps the other,

והם כלם רק כללות אדם אחד שלם.

thus together comprising a single complete 'Adam.'

'Adam' is meant here as a spiritual profile in the macro-sense. The idea seems to be that all things together have a symbiotic, interdependent relationship and form a single unit – 'Adam.'

וכן הוא בכללי כללות בכל הדורות כלם אשר מאדה"ר

And so too on the general macro-level: all the generations from Adam

עד סוף כל הדורות הנה הם כלם רק קומת פראוץ אחד,

until the last generation are all one *partzuf*-stature,

כי כשם שכל דור הקודם הוא רק הסבה להדור הבא

just as every preceding generation is the cause of the generation that follows,

כן הוא כל דור הבא הוא התכלית להדור הקודם

so too, every future generation is the objective of the one previous to it.

והם כלם רק קומת פראוץ אדם שלם

In this way, they form one single *partzuf* of a complete 'Adam.'

זה עמק בנות מאמרם ז"ל עדיות פ"ב מ"ט. האב זוכה לבנו כו' במספר הדורות) לפניו,

This is the deep mystical intention of the statement of our Sages in *Eduyot* 2:9:

The *Mishnah* there states: "A father bequeaths to his son attractiveness, strength,

wealth, wisdom, life-span and God's promises to him **for a number of generations to come**²¹....

The Baal HaLeshem now explains the latter mystically, as follows:

כי מה שנוגע לתקון הקומה הכללי מכל הדורות שלפניו,

What is relevant to rectifying the macro-profile of Adam spanning all the previous generations –

הנה זה מוסר ומזכה כל אב לבנו.

that is what the father contributes and bequeaths to his son.

כי תקון כל דור הוא תלוי בכלם דוקא, כי הם קומה אחת.

This is because the *tikun* of every generation depends upon all of its members, since they all form a single macro-profile,

ומעבב כ"א על תקון זולתו. (ע' דברינו בזה בארכה קצת בחלק
הבאורים שער עקודים פ"ג אות מ' סי' ג').

and each individual can prevent the *tikun* of another. (See more on this in our commentary section to *Shaar Akudim* chap. 3, 40:3).

והרי עכ"פ הוא כי כללות הקומת אדם הוא כולל פרטים רבים אין
חקר,

In any event, we conclude that the macro-profile of Adam includes innumerable details

והם מתחלפים ומתחדשים בהתחדשות כל דור

that change and arise anew in every generation,

ובמציאות כל איש, הן בהאדם והן בהעלם.

and in the existence of every individual, whether in man or in the world.

וכ"ז הנה הוא נמשך ונעשה מגלויי אור התורה

And all of this is drawn down and brought about by the revelation of the light of the Torah,

שמתחלפים ומתחדשים גלוייה תמיד במה שהקב"ה עוסק בה
בכל יום,

whose illuminations constantly change and are renewed by the Holy One, blessed is He, occupying Himself with it every day.

כי התורה היא אמון פדגוג, אמון רבבא כלי אומנתו של הקב"ה.

Because the Torah is referred to (in *Midrash Rabba*, *Bereishit* 1:1) as 'the master teacher, the great master, the implement of the Holy One, blessed is He,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל ע"פ אוֹרָה וְגִלּוּיָהּ וְכַמּ"ש בְּרִישׁ ב"ר [בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה].

and everything is achieved with its light and revelation, as is written in at the beginning of *Bereishit Rabba* ibid.

וְהִנֵּה הָעֵקֶר בַּכ"ז הוּא אוֹרִיתָא דְאַצִּילוֹת שֶׁהִיא תּוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּב"ה

Now the main point in all of this is that we are referring here to the Torah of Atzilut, which is the Torah of the Holy One, blessed is He,

הַמְאִירָה וּמִתְגַּלֶּה ע"פ גִּלּוּי אוֹר דֵּהֶשֶׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה וְכִנְזָכָר:

that shines forth and is revealed according to the revelations of the light of the blessed Name *Havaya*, as mentioned.

אָמְנָם הִנֵּה גִלּוּיָהּ לְמַעַלָּה הוּא לְפִי עֵרֶךְ גִּלּוּיָהּ לְמַטָּה,

Although the revelation above is commensurate with the revelation below,

וְכַמּ"ש "וְאֲשִׁים דְּבָרִי בְּפִיךָ... לְנַטַע שָׁמַיִם וְלִיסֹד אָרֶץ."

as the verse (Isaiah 51:16) states, "And I have placed My words in your mouth... to implant the heavens and set a foundation for the earth,"

"My words" the revelation above; "in your mouth" the revelation below. "Set a foundation for earth, the revelation of Torah in Beriah; "to implant the heavens" – the revelation of Torah in Atzilut.²²

אֲךָ לְמַטָּה הִנֵּה הִיא אֵינָה בְּגִלּוּיָהּ אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת

nevertheless, below in the lower worlds it the Torah is not revealed in the same manner as in Atzilut,

אֶלָּא רַק בְּגִלּוּי דְאֹור הָשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים,

but merely as the light of the name *Elokim*,

אֲשֶׁר הוּא ע"פ הָרְאוּי רַק לְתַכּוּנַת וְאִיכוֹת הַבְּרִיאָה.

which is the proper revelation for the nature and quality of Beriah,

וְהִיא רַק תַּמְצִית הָאָרָה מִהָאֹור דְאַצִּילוֹת.

and is merely the condensation of a radiance of the light of Atzilut.

זֶהוּ שְׁאֵמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ קֹהֶלֶת רַפ"ב כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהָאָדָם לוֹמֵד
בְּהָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה

This is the meaning of the statement in *Midrash Kohelet beg. Chap. 2*: "All the Torah a person learn is this world

הַכֵּל הוּא לִפְנֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּהָעוֹלָם הַבָּא.

is as fleeting as a breath²³ compared with Torah in the World to Come...

The Midrash continues: Because in this world we forget the Torah we have learned, whereas in the World to Come it will be set permanently within us.

זֶהוּ הָעֵנִין ג"כ מ"ש "פָּנִים בְּפָנִים דָּבַר ה' עִמָּכֶם".

This is also the concept expressed in the verse (Deuteronomy 5:4): "God spoke with you face-to-face."

וַיֵּשׁ שָׁם פְּסִיק בֵּין פָּנִים בְּפָנִים, כִּי לֹא הִשְׁיגוּ אֶת הַפָּנִים דְּהַשֵּׁם
הוּא"ה מִמֶּשׁ

A cantillation note denoting a slight pause, called a *psik*, is placed between the words **face-to-face**, like this: פָּנִים | בְּפָנִים because they did not achieve true face-to-face communion with *Havaye*,

אֶלָּא רַק ע"י הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים.

but rather via the name *Elokim*.

זֶהוּ ג"כ מ"ש וַיְדַבֵּר אֱלֹהִים כּו' אֲנֹכִי הוּא"ה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

This is also the meaning of the verse (Exodus 20:2): "And *Elokim* spoke... I am *Havaye* your God..."

וְלֹא הִשְׁיגוּ אֶת הָאוֹר דְּהַשֵּׁם הוּא"ה ב"ה

and they did not attain the light of the blessed Name *Havaye*

אֶלָּא רַק ע"י הָאוֹר דְּהַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים.

other than via the light of the name *Elokim*, which is why the verse begins "And *Elokim* spoke..."

וְכֵן "וַיּוֹצֵא מֹשֶׁה אֶת הָעָם לְקִרְאָת הָאֱלֹהִים" כּו'

The verse (Exodus 19:17) can be interpreted **similarly**: "And Moshe brought the people forth from the camp **towards *Elokim*...**"

Note that the name *Elokim* is the focus of the verse.

הָגַם שְׁכָתוֹב וְהָרַס סִינֵי כּו' מִפְּנֵי אֲשֶׁר יָרַד עָלָיו ה'.

Now even though the next verse (Exodus 19:18) states: "All of Mount Sinai was smoking because *Havaye* had descended upon it in fire..."

Here the verse uses the essential Name, *Havaye*, not the name *Elokim*, which seems to contradict the previous verse,

אָמְנָם אֱלֹהֵי הַב' מִיְּנֵי גִלּוּיִם הֵם בְּאֶמֶת אֶחָד,

However, the explanation is that **these two types of revelation are in fact one**,

אֶלָּא שֶׁהֵם בְּבַחֲיַת פְּנִימִית וְחִיצוֹנִית, זֶה מִסְתַּעַר מִזֶּה.

only that they are two aspects of the same revelation – the **inner and outer aspects**, *Havaye* and *Elokim* respectively, **one of which derives from the other** –

Elokim derives from *Havaye*, as explained earlier.

וְהוּא מֶה שֶׁכָּתוּב בּוֹ וְאַתְחִנֶּן אֶת הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה דְּבַר הוּי"ה אֶל כָּל
קְהֵלְכֶם

The same point is understood from the verse written in *Parshat V'etchanan* (Deuteronomy 5:19): "These words *Havaye* spoke to your entire congregation..." the message comes from *Havaye* but is delivered through *Elokim*,

כִּי רַק הוּא הָיָה נוֹתֵן הַתּוֹרָה בְּאַמֶּת וּכְמֹ"ש אֲנֹכִי הוּי"ה אֱלֹהֶיךָ
for it was only He who truly gave us the Torah, as is written (Exodus 20:2), "I am *Havaye* your Lord,"

אֲלֹא שֶׁהֵם לֹא הִשְׁיִגוּהוּ רַק ע"י הָאוֹר דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים.
albeit that they did not apprehend the light of that Name, other than via the name *Elokim*.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁכָּתוּב "אַתָּה הָרָאָתָּ לְדַעַת כִּי הוּי"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים" כּו'
This is also the meaning of the verse (Deuteronomy 4:35): "You have been shown in order to know that *Havaye* is *Elokim*..."

כִּי הֵגַם שְׁלֹא רָאוּ אֶת הַגְּלוֹי אוֹר דְּהֵשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה בְּעֶצְמוֹ
for although they did not see the revelation of the light of the Name of *Havaye* Himself,

אֲךָ הוֹכִיחוּ לְדַעַת ע"י הַגְּלוֹי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים כִּי הוּי"ה הוּא עֲצֻמוֹ
אֱלֹהִים אֵין עוֹד:

they were "shown in order to know that *Havaye* Himself is *Elokim*... there is none other."

וְהָרִי לָנוּ עַכ"פּ כִּי כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּידֵינוּ הִיא בְּהַגְּלוֹי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים,
Thus we have it that the entire revelation of the Torah in our possession is via revelation of the name *Elokim*,

וְהָאוֹר דְּהֵשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה הִיא גָּנוּז וְנִעְלָם בָּהּ וְהוּא בְּפִנְיֵמִיתָהּ
תָּמִיד.

and the light of the Name *Havaye*, may He be blessed, is concealed and obscured, but it is always in her the Torah's inner dimension.

וְזֶהוּ מ"ש בְּזוֹהַר ק בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"ג סע"א וְכֵן בַּתְּז"ח דָּף מ"א סע"ב
Indeed, this is what the holy *Zohar*, *Bereishit* 23a and *Tikunei Zohar Chadash* 41b state –

שְׁאוּרֵיתָא דְלָן הִיא אוּרֵיתָא דְּבְרִיָּא.

that our Torah is the Torah of Beriah, and is therefore the revelation of the name *Elokim*,²⁴

וְלָכֵן הִיא מֵיָסֵד עַל טָהוֹר וְטָמֵא אָסוּר וּמִתֵּר חַיֵּב זָכָא.

and therefore it is based on the categories of (and the distinctions between) pure and impure, prohibited and permissible, culpable and innocent,

כִּי הִיא מֵהַגְלוֹי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים שֶׁהוּא שֵׁם הַמְּשַׁתָּף כַּמ"ש בַּפ' מִשְׁפָּטִים צ"ו א'.

since it is from the revelation of the name *Elokim*, the 'associate' name, as the *Zohar Mishpatim* 96a states.

אָבֵל בְּאַצִּילוֹת הוּא הַכֹּל קָדֵשׁ וְשֵׁם לֹא יִגוּרָךְ רַע.

But in Atzilut everything is holy, and there "no evil abides with You" (Psalms 5:5).

אֲךָ בִּירִידָתָהּ לְמִטָּה מִתְּפַשְׁטִין לַמ"ט פָּנִים טָהוֹר וּמ"ט פָּנִים טָמֵא וּבִסּוֹד עֵץ הַדַּעַת.

However, when the revelation descends below it divides into 49 aspects of purity and 49 aspects of impurity, which is the mystery of the Tree of Knowledge,

וְנִעְשָׂה שֵׁם הַטָּמֵא וְהָאָסוּר מִצַּד הַזֹּהֶמָא וְהָרַע הַנִּעְשָׂה בְּבִי"ע.

where the impure and the forbidden are produced due to the spiritual poison and the evil that are produced in BiY" A.

וְהִזָּה הַטָּמֵא וְהָאָסוּר שֶׁבְּהַתּוֹרָה כְּדִי לְהִתְרַחֵק מֵמָנָה.

And so the impure and the forbidden are outlined in the Torah so that we can distance ourselves from them.

אָבֵל בְּאַצִּילוֹת שֵׁם הוּא הַכֹּל בְּסוֹד עֵץ הַחַיִּים וְהַכֹּל קָדֵשׁ.

But in Atzilut everything is the mystery of the Tree of Life, and everything is holy,

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא הַגְלוֹי אֹר דְּהֶשֶׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה שֶׁהוּא הַגְלוֹי דְּמִדְרָגָה הָרְבִיעִית כָּנ"ל.

since there in Atzilut is the revelation of the Name *Havaye*, may He be blessed, which is the fourth stage of revelation, as mentioned above.

אָבֵל מֵאַחֵר הָאֲצִילוֹת וְלִמְטָה הָנָה כָּל גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש

But post-Atzilut – below that lofty spiritual world – all of His revelations,

הֵן בְּהַתּוֹרָה וְהֵן בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת רַק בְּהַגְלִיּוֹי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים וְהוּא הַגְלוֹי הַחֲמִישִׁי.

whether in Torah or in created existence, are only from the name *Elokim*, which is the fifth stage of revelation.

וְהִירֵי נִמְצָא שְׂכָל מָה שְּׁאֲנוּ מְשִׁיגִים מֵאֱלֹהוּתוֹ ית"ש

Thus it turns out that everything we can comprehend of His blessed Godliness

הִנֵּה הוּא רַק הַגִּלּוּי הַחֲמִישִׁי אֲשֶׁר מֵאַחֵר אֲמַתְתּוֹ הִנְעֲלָמָה וּלְמָטָה
וְכֵן "ל רפ"ג:

is only the fifth stage of revelation after His true concealed Being

אֲמָנָם הִנֵּה יִשְׁנָם בְּאוֹתוֹ הַגִּלּוּי

Nevertheless, within that severely limited revelation,

הַגִּם שֶׁהוּא רַק תְּמִצִּית הָאָרָה לְבַד מֵהַגִּלּוּי הָרְבִיעִי וְכֵן "ל,

even though it is merely the condensation of a radiance of the fourth stage of revelation,

עכ"ז הִנֵּה יִשְׁנָם בּוֹ כָּל הָעֲנִינִים וְהַפְּרָטִים כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת

with all of that, it has within it all the principles and details that there are in Atzilut,

וְכֵן כָּל אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה שֶׁהוּא גַם אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל הַג' גִּלּוּיִים
הָרִאשׁוֹנִים,

and also that which is far beyond Atzilut – everything in those first three revelations.

כִּי בְּכָל גִּלּוּי וְגִלּוּי וּמִדְרָגָה וּמִדְרָגָה הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִעְתָּק כְּמוֹ
מִחוּתָם לְנִחְתָּם,

Because in each and every revelation, and each and every level, there spreads forth and is replicated – as from a seal into the sealed i.e. like the seal of a signet ring pressed into wax –

כָּל הַבְּחִינּוֹת כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר בְּהַגִּלּוּי וּמִדְרָגָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה וְהֵם נִמְשָׁכִים
כֻּלָּם בְּאַחַד.

all the aspects of the higher revelation and level, and they are all drawn down as one.

כִּי אֲמַתְתּוֹ הִנְעֲלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא אֲשֶׁר נִמְשָׁךְ וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט מִגִּלּוּי
לְגִלּוּי,

Because His hidden true being itself is what is drawn down and spreads forth from revelation to revelation –

מִהַעֲלָמָתוֹ לְהַגִּלּוּי דְּאוֹר א"ס,

from His concealed state to the revelation of the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

ומשם להגלוי דאור קדמון,

and from there to the revelation of the *avir kadmon* (primordial 'space'),

ומשם לאדם קדמון, ומשם להאצילות,

and from there to Adam Kadmon, and then to Atzilut,

ומשם לאור אלהותי שבהבי"ע הממציא את כל, ומקים את הכל,

and from there to the Godly light invested in BiY"A that produces everything and sustains everything,

ומשגיח בכל ומנהיג את הכל, ואפס זולתו.

and which oversees everything, and guides everything, and besides whom there is nothing.

והוא מה שנאמר (דברים ו, ד) "שמע ישראל יהוה אלהינו יהוה אחד".

This is as the verse (Deuteronomy 6:4) states, "Hear O Israel, God our Lord, God is one."

We have translated the Name *Havaye* as 'God' and the name *Elokim* as 'Lord.'

וביאורו וכוונתו הפשוטה הנה הוא כי הוי"ה אלהינו הנה הוא אחד בכל גלוייו כלם,

Now the explanation and simple intention of the verse is that *Havaye*, who is our Lord *Elokeinu* (the possessive form of *Elokim*), is one in all of His revelations.

כי מפשיטותו הנעלמה האמתית נתגלה להמציא את הכל

Because from His simple (in the sense of uncompounded, elemental) concealed true being He became revealed in order to produce everything there is

שהם כל העולמות אשר מאחר העלמתו עד סוף האצילות,

– all of the worlds that emerge after His state of concealment, until the final aspect of Atzilut –

שנתגלה מציאותם ולא מהותם,

in all of these only their being is revealed but not their true nature,

והמהוה את הכל שהם העולמות דבי"ע.

and He is the one who brought everything into being – referring to the Worlds of BiY"A.

והוא לבדו מנהיג את הכל תמיד וכמו שנאמר (דברים ד, לט) "כי יהוה הוא האלהים בשמים ממעל ועל הארץ מתחת אין עוד";

**And He alone guides all things always, as the verse states (Deuteronomy 4:39)
"For Havaye is Elokim in the heavens above, and on the earth below; there is no
other," and**

"יְהוָה מֶלֶךְ יְהוָה מֶלֶךְ יְהוָה יִמְלֹךְ לְעֹלָם וָעֶד",

Havaye is King, Havaye was King, Havaye will be King,

וְתִמְסַר אֱלֹהֵינוּ נַפְשֵׁךְ עַל כָּל זֶה בְּעֶקְדַת יִצְחָק בֶּן אַבְרָהָם

**and devote your life to Him in all this to the point of martyrdom like the Isaac,
the son of Abraham, was willing to do at the akeidah the binding of Isaac.**

בָּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ לְעֹלָם וָעֶד:

Blessed be the name of His glorious kingdom for ever!

Footnotes

1. None of the translations here should be taken literally. There is no actual 'space' in the spiritual worlds above. ↵
2. See *Eitz Chaim* 42:1 – *Ein Sof* is called 'Nothingness' because it cannot be grasped at all and has no form or substance, and *Keter* is referred to as 'non-being'. ↵
3. Known as *gulgalta*, *avira* and *mocha stima'a* of *Arich Anpin* in which *chesed*, *gevurah* and *tiferet* of *Atik* become clothed. See *Eitz Chaim* 13:2; *Sha'ar Ma'amarei Rashbi*, *Sifra d'Tzinuta* 1 (Makover). ↵
4. I.e. *Ohr Ein Sof* ↵
5. The four letter Name י-ה-ו-ה ↵
6. See *Avot* 5:1 "בעשרה מאמרות נברא העולם" ↵
7. See p. 36c where he explains that the name *Elokim* alludes to the World of *Beriah*. See also *Eitz Chaim*, *Sha'ar Mochin d'Katnut* ch. 3. (*Me'ir HaLeshem*). ↵
8. Literally, is 'opposite' the Temple below. ↵
9. Note that the original text references 28:5, a printing error. It should be 28:2. ↵
10. *Matok miDevash*, *Intro. Tikunei Zohar* p. 17a. ↵
11. Thus the name with the vowel points is: י-ה-ו-ה – see *Eitz Chaim* 44:1 that this name is associated with *da'at* of *ze'ir anpin*. ↵
12. for a total of 86, the same *gematria* as 70=ע; 2=ב; 9=ט; 5=ה
↵.the name *Elokim*
13. This line is from one of the *piyutim* sung during *Kol Nidrei* on Yom Kippur.
It compares God to a glass-blower who shapes the vessel at will. ↵

14. As mentioned earlier, each of the *sefirot* of Atzilut has one of the Names in particular associated with it. ↩
15. Each of these aspects represents a different aspect or level of Divine revelation in the World of Atzilut. ↩
16. In the current form of the *Tikunim* this appears on p. 65a, 65b. ↩
17. In the current form of the *Tikunim* this appears on p. 64b. ↩
18. *Matok miDevash* compares this to the angelic teacher (the *maggid*) that Rabbi Yosef Caro merited due to his devotion to Torah. ↩
19. Ramban, Intro. *Sefer Bereishit*. See also Zohar cited in the text below. ↩
20. In current versions: chapter 11. ↩
21. See Bartenura. ↩
22. *Meir HaLeshem*. ↩
23. Some translate הבל as 'vanity,' but this seems difficult to justify. Why would the Torah be called vanity simply because we forget it? On the other hand, 'fleeting as a breath' seems to be more contextually appropriate. This term may also be understood as nothing at all, ie. No possible way to compare the two since we are dealing with two totally different dimensions of consciousness. ↩
24. *Makover*. ↩

Chapter 6 — The division between the first three revelations and the final two.

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 6

More on Revelations from Will to Actualization

וְהִנֵּה אֲמַרְנוּ כִּי אֵלוּ ב' הַגְּלוּיִים הַד' וְהָה'

We stated in the previous chapter that these two revelations, the fourth i.e. the revelation in Atzilut and the fifth i.e. the revelation in BiY"A (out of five in total)

הֵנָּה הֵם גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּבַחֲיוּ פְעֻלָּה.

are His revelations that are manifested in action.

כִּי הֵג' גְּלוּיִם הָרֵאשׁוֹנִים הֵם בְּבַחֲיו רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר כִּנָּ"ל פ"ג.

The first three revelations are the aspect of *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* as discussed in chapter 3 of this section.

אֲךָ הֵב' גְּלוּיִים הָאַחֲרוֹנִים שֶׁהֵם הַד' וְהָה'

However, the latter two revelations, the fourth and the fifth,

הֵנָּה הֵם גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש בְּבַחֲיוּ יִצְיָאָה מֵהַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפְּעֹל.

are His revelations in the sense of emerging from potential to actual –

וְהֵם הָאֲצִילוֹת וְהַבִּי"ע, כִּי בָהֶם שְׁנֵיהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה בְּפְעֻלָּתוֹ.

i.e. Atzilut and BiY"A, because it is in these two that His actions are revealed.

וְלָכֵן כְּתִיב עַל שְׁנֵיהֶם לָשׁוֹן עֲשִׂיהַּ

And this is why the term *asiyah* – action – applies to both of them,

וְכַמ"ש כִּי שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים עָשָׂה ה' אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת הָאָרֶץ

as the verse (Exodus 20:11) states, "For six days God made – *asah* – the heavens and the earth."

וְאָמַר שֵׁשֶׁת וְלֹא בְּשֵׁשֶׁת כִּי קָאִי עַל הו"ק דְּאֲצִילוֹת וְהֵם הַשֵּׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית.

Now the verse states "six days" שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים and not "*in six days*" because it refers to the six extremities of Atzilut the six *sefirot* comprising *ze'ir anpin*: *chesed*, *gevurah*, *tiferet*, *netzach*, *hod* and *yesod*. These are called 'extremities' because they will eventually come to define the parameters of space – up, down and four directions, right and left, front and back. These are the six 'days' of Creation, וַיִּכְמוּ שְׁרָמְזוֹ הָרַמְבַּ"ן ז"ל שֶׁשׁ וְכֵן הוּא בְּזוּה"ק בְּרֵאשִׁית ל"א סע"א וְע' בְּתַקוּנִים רִישׁ תַּקוּן י"א.

as Ramban hints to in his commentary *ad loc*, and so too in the Holy Zohar, Bereishit 31a. See also *Tikunim*, beginning of *Tikun 11*

וְהָרִי לָנוּ לְשׁוֹן מַעֲשֵׂה וּפְעֻלָּה גַם עַל הָאֲצִילוֹת.

So here we have an example of action and activity even in Atzilut.

כִּי בְּאֲצִילוֹת וּמַכּוֹל שֶׁכֵּן בְּבִי"ע הִנֵּה בָּהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה הַמַּאֲצִיל בְּבַחֲיוֹ
יִצְיָאָה מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפֶּעַל וְכֵנֶז':

For in Atzilut, and all the more so in BiY" A, the Emanator is revealed in the aspect of emerging from potential to actual, as mentioned previously.

אָמְנָם הִנֵּה יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּין בַּחֲיוֹ פְּעֻלָּתוֹ שֶׁבְּאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא גִלּוּיוֹ
הָרְבִיעִי

However, there is a tremendous difference between the aspects of His action in Atzilut, which is the fourth stage of His revelation

לַפְעֻלָּתוֹ שֶׁבְּבִי"ע שֶׁהוּא גִלּוּיוֹ הַחֲמִישִׁי.

and His action in BiY" A, which is the fifth stage of His revelation.

וְהוּא כִּי הָרִי כְּבֹר אָמְרָנוּ שֶׁכָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת הִנֵּה הוּא מְצִיאוֹת נֶעְלָה
וּמְרוֹמָם כְּזוֹ

And this is the difference: we already noted that Atzilut is a type of lofty and elevated existence

אֲשֶׁר רְאוּיָה לְהִתְקַדֵּשׁ בְּאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש

that is worthy of being sanctified with the light of His holiness, may His Name be blessed,

וְהִתְיַחַד אוֹרוֹ בָּהּ עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂית חֵד עִמּוֹ וְהָיָה מַעֲתָה אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר.

and He united His light with it with Atzilut to the extent that it became one with Him, and from that point on it became complete Godliness.

כִּי מֵעַתָּה שֶׁהִתְיַחַד אוֹרוֹ בְּאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא מִמַּעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית וְהִלָּאָה

For the moment that He merged His light with Atzilut, which was from the act of Creation and on,

הָיָה כָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת הָיָה וְהוּא כָּל חֵד וְנִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת

all of Atzilut and He, became one. And this was revealed via Atzilut

לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם שֶׁהוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה.

in that it came to be called by the Name, the Name *Havaye*, blessed is He.

וּא"כ נִמְצָא שֶׁכָּל פְּעֻלַּת הָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא כְּבִיכּוֹל בַּחֲיוֹ פְּעֻלָּה בְּעֶצְמוֹתוֹ
ית"ש,

Accordingly, it turns out that the entire procedure of activating Atzilut is, so to speak, an activity within His essence, blessed be His Name,

כי על ידה נעשה ונפעל הוא עצמו בהוראת ותאר קדשת השם
יהו"ה ב"ה

since this action effectuated that He Himself came to be expressed and described by the holiness of the Name *Havaye*,

ובכל תאר הוראת קדשת השמות כלם המסתעפים ממנו.

and by all of the descriptions and expressions of all the holy names that derive from it.

משא"כ בפעלתו שבבי"ע שהוא גלויי החמישי

This is not so with respect to His activities in BiY"A, the fifth revelation

הנה פעל אותם בבחי' פעלה כזו שיהיו חוץ ממנו.

which was effectuated in a manner that categorizes the activity involved as
'outside of Him'¹

כי המציא אותם כלם במציאות נבדל ונפרד מאלהות

since all such activities are produced as an existence separate and distinct from Godliness,

ואין מציאותם גופה שום אלהות כלל וכלל ח"ו.

and their existence itself is not Godly in any way,² heaven forbid.

ולכן נקראים כלם בשם עולמות הנפרדים.

For this reason all of them the Worlds of BiY"A are referred to as separated worlds

כי הם נפרד ונבדל מאלהות, ובהם הוא כל הפרוד והרבוים.

since they are separated and distinct from Godliness, and in them in separation and multiplicity.

ועליהם נאמר לא יהיה לך אלהים אחרים על פני ור"ל זולת
האצילות כנ"ל פ"ד

Regarding them the verse (Exodus 20:3) states "You shall not recognize the gods of others in My presence" – meaning to exclude Atzilut, as noted above in chapter 4.

The Worlds of BiY"A are separated from His presence, whereas "My presence" is manifested in Atzilut, as just explained.

כי הם כלם רק נבראים נוצרים נעשים.

Because all of them the Worlds of BiY"A are only created, formed and made, and are not unified with His presence.

ואסור בכל חמר אסור לכנות ולתאר על שום דבר מהמציאות
שבהעולמות ב"ע

And therefore it is strictly forbidden to ascribe or assign to any aspect of the existence of the Worlds of BiY"A

שום תאר אלהותו יתברך.

any description pertaining to His blessed Godliness.

ולכן נקרא הוא ית"ש עליהם בשם אדנ"י.

And therefore in relationship to them He is called by the name Ad'nai,

שהוא כמו אדון על עבדיו כי הם אינם מיוחדים בעצמותו

like a master (*adon*) to his servants, who are not one with Him,

להקרא באלהותו יתברך כלל וכלל ח"ו.

that His Godliness could be attributed to them at all, heaven forbid.

משא"כ כל האצילות כלו הנה הוא ית"ש מתיחד שם ביחוד עצום
מאד

But this is not so as regards all of Atzilut, with which He is united with an excessively powerful unity

עד שנעשית חד עמו והיא כלה אלהות גמור על ידו.

to the extent that it Atzilut becomes one with Him, and in its entirety it is completely Godly as a result.

והרי יש חלוק גדול בין אלו ב' הגלגלים ג"כ

Thus there is a huge difference between these two revelations as well,

הגם ששניהם הם בבחי' פעלה וכנז':

even though both of them are in the category of activity as opposed to *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* which are all 'inside' of Him, so to speak.

אמנם מה שאמרנו שכל העולמות ב"ע אינם אלהות כלל

However, our statement that the Worlds of BiY"A are not Godliness at all,

והם עולמות נפרדים הנה הוא רק מציאותם גופה.

that they are separated worlds, this only applies to their existence.

אבל בפנימית פנימיותם הנה הוא ית"ש אינו נבדל גם מהם כלל
וכלל ח"ו.

However, in their innermost being, He is not separated from them at all, heaven forfend,

כי מתפשט תמיד בהארתו בהם, וכמו שמתבאר לעיל שער ג'
since His radiance continuously spreads forth in them, as explained in Shaar 3,

כל הבחי' דאור אלהות המתפשט ועומד בהעולמות בי"ע ע"ש.
that all aspects of the Godly light spread forth and are manifested in the Worlds of BiY"A. See there in *Sha'ar* 3**.**

והנה עומד בהם אורו ית"ש תמיד בבחי' נשמה לנשמה
Now manifested in them in the Worlds of BiY"A continuously is His light, as the aspect of *neshama* of *neshama* – the soul of their soul.

ועל ידו הוא כל קיומם וכן כל עקר מציאותם והתהוותם.
It is through this that they endure, and in fact their primary existence and coming into being is also by virtue of this *neshama* of *neshama*.

וכן על ידו הוא כל תהלוכותיהם בכל מקריהם שהוא כל המעשים
כלם.

It is also through this that their entire development and all the events that occur with them unfold; including all of their actions.

אך אורו וקדשותו שבהם הוא בהעלם גדול מאד
However, His light and holiness in them is greatly concealed

ואינו נכר כלל אלא מצד תהלוכותיהם וכל מקריהם ומאורעותיהם
and is not recognized at all, other than in their development and all the events and occurrences that take place with them,

וכמ"ש בזוה"ק פ' וירא ק"ג ב' קב"ה אתידע ולא אתידע
as the holy *Zohar* (vol. 1) states (*Vayera* 103b): The Holy One, blessed is He, is known as He manifests Himself in the lower Worlds but is not known in His essence.³

בגין דאיהו נשמתא לנשמתא רוחא לרוחא גנזי וטמיר מכלא כו'
ע"ש.

since He is the *neshama* of the *neshama*, the *ruach* of *ruach*, hidden and concealed from all. See there,

וכן בפ' בהר ק"ט ב' דאנת' הוא נשמה לנשמות כו'
and also in (*Zohar* III) *parshat Behar* 109b: "You are the *neshama* of *neshamas*...

אֵינְתָּ לְבַר מִכֵּלָּא וּלְגוּ מִכֵּלָּא וּלְכָל סִטְרָא וּלְעֵלָּא מִכֵּלָּא וּלְתַתָּא מִכֵּלָּא כו'.

You are beyond all things and within all things, in all directions and above and below..."

וְכֵן בִּפ' פִּנְחָס רכ"ה א' אִיהוּ סוּבְב עַל כָּל עֲלָמִין כו' אִיהוּ מִמַּלְא כָּל עֲלָמִין כו'.

Also in (*Zohar* III) *parshat Pinchas* 125a: "He transcends all worlds... and He fills all worlds..." the transcendent light is called *sovev kol almin*, and the immanent light filling the worlds is called *memalei kol almin*.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּהַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנִים ז' א'

The Introduction to the *Tikunim* (*Tikunei Zohar*) p. 7a, also makes the same point.

וְנוֹדָע הוּא מָה שֶׁהָעַמִּיקוּ בְּזֶה אֵיזָה חֲכָמִים ז"ל

[It is known that there are some Sages who delved into this deeply,

אָמְנָם הָאֲרִיז"ל אֲשֶׁר גָּלָה לָנוּ כָּל סוּד וְכָל סֵתֶר נֶעְלָם לֹא פִּרַּשׁ בּוֹ.

but the Arizal, who revealed to all of us all the secrets and all hidden matters, did not explain it that way.

וְדַעְתּוֹ הוּא בְּעֵינָיו מִמַּלְא וְסוּבְב רַק ע"פ מ"ש בַּע"ח שֶׁעַר עֵינָיו וְיִשָּׁר עֲנָף ב' וְעֲנָף ד'.

His view regarding *sovev kol almin* and *memalei kol almin* is only according to what it states in *Eitz Chaim, sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher, anaf* 2 and 4

שְׁאוּרוֹ ית"ש מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּכָלֶם בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָם וְכֵן הוּא מְקִיר אוֹתָם מִבְּחוּץ.

that His light is clothed within all of them in their innermost being (*memalei kol almin*), and He also envelops them from without (*sovev kol almin*),

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר קֶצֶת סֵדֶר הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת לְקַמֵּן שֶׁעַר ה'.

as will be explained somewhat – regarding the order of 'enclothing' – below, *Sha'ar* 5.

'Enclothing' is the process whereby higher spiritual forces and profiles (called *kochot* and *partzufim*) affect and influence lower ones from within, rather than at a distance.

וְכֵן אָמַר הָאֲרִיז"ל מִפְּרָשׁ בְּסִפְר שֶׁעַר הַקְדָּמוֹת דָּף ו' ע"א

Indeed the Arizal stated this explicitly in the work *Sha'ar Hakdamot* p. 6a,

וְכֵן בְּמִבּוֹא שְׁעָרִים שֶׁעַר א' פ"ב וְכֵן בְּסִפְר מַאֲמָרֵי רִשְׁבִּי פ' בְּהַר ע"ש וְתִמְצָא מִפְּרָשׁ.

and in *Mevo Sha'arim, Sha'ar 1* chapter 2, and in the work *Mamarei Rashbi, Behar* where you will find it stated explicitly.]

ואותו ההתלבשות שהוא מתלבש גם בכל הבי"ע כלם

This 'enclothing' – in which He is clothed throughout BiY" A as well –

הוא אור שכיתו ית"ש שהוא המלכות דאצילות

is the light of His *Shechinah*, which is *malchut* of Atzilut

השרוי ושוכן בפנימית דפנימית דכל העולמות בי"ע כלם.

that reposes and dwells in the innermost being of all the Worlds of BiY" A,

וממנו הוא עצם כח דכל התהוותם תמיד וכן כל מה שנעשה בהם תמיד.

and from it from the *Shechinah* is itself the very force that maintains their continued existence, and whatever transpires with them at all times.

כי הוא הנשמה לנשמה רוחא לרוחא כנז'.

For He is the *neschama* of the *neschama*, and the *ruach* of the *ruach*, as mentioned.

In other words, the *sine qua non* of their existence is only Godliness, so that without Godliness at their innermost core, they would simply not exist.

אמנם הוא בהם בהעלם גדול, וכל גלוי הוא רק בהתורה ע"י ישראל.

He is in them, however, in a deeply concealed manner, and all His revelations are only in the Torah and through Israel,

כי בקיומה ושמיירתה מתפשט ומתגלה אור קדשותו

because through observing it i.e. fulfilling the positive commandments, and guarding it guarding against transgressing the prohibitions, the light of His holiness expands and becomes revealed.

ויכירו וידעו כל ישרי תבל כי הוא לבדו עשה ועושה לכל המעשים.

So that all the inhabitants of the earth will come to recognize and know that He alone did and does all actions,

וכמ"ש (ישעיה כט, כג-24) כי בראתו ילדיו מעשה ידי בקרבו יקדישו שמי כו' וידעו תעי רוח בינה כו'.

as the verse (Isaiah 29:23-24) states, "when he (Jacob) sees his children, My handiwork in their midst, who will sanctify My Name... Those of misguided spirit will attain understanding...

שיכירו הכל כי ה' הוא האלהים אין עוד מלבדו.

All will come to recognize that *Havaye* God in His transcendence is *Elokim* God enclothing Himself in the world in an immanent manifestation – **there is none other than Him** as the verse (Deuteronomy 4:35) states.

וְהוּא אֹרֶךְ אֱלֹהוּתוֹ ית"ש הָעוֹמֵד בְּבִי"ע שֶׁהוּא גִלּוּי הַחֲמִישִׁי וְכָנ"ל:

And this is the light of His blessed Godliness which inheres in BiY"A, which is His fifth revelation, as mentioned above.

וְהִרִי נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ עֲנִין גִּלּוּי ית"ש בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלֵל

Thus we have clarified for ourselves, in general, the concept of His revelations, may His name be blessed,

כִּי הֵנָּה הֵם בְּה' מְדֻרְגּוֹת כָּלְלִיִּים:

in which there are five general levels:

הַג' הָרְאשׁוֹנִים הֵם בְּבִחִי' רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר.

The first three are called *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur*, as explained previously.

וְהֵם גִּלּוּי אֲשֶׁר בְּבִחִי' א"ס שֶׁקֶדֶם הַצְמָצוֹם וְלִמְעַלָּה מִהַצְמָצוֹם.

These are: 1) His revelation as the aspect of *Ein Sof*,⁴ prior to, and above the *tzimtzum*;

וְהָעוֹלָם דְּקוֹ וְצְמָצוֹם שֶׁנִּקְרָא אֲוִיר הַקְדָּמוֹן וְטִהֲרִיר עֲלֵאָה

2) The realm of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*⁵ which is called *avir kadmon* and *t'hiru ila'a*;

וְהָעוֹלָם דְּאָדָם קְדָמוֹן הֵם הָעוֹלָמוֹת דָּא"ס.

3) The World of Adam Kadmon. These are the three infinite revelations, called 'the infinite worlds.'

וְשְׁנֵי הָאַחֲרוֹנִים הֵם בְּבִחִי' פְּעֻלָּה

The other two of the five revelations mentioned above are the aspect of 'action':

וְהוּא אֶחָד הָעוֹלָם דְּאַצִּילוּת שֶׁהוּא כָּלֵל אֱלֹהוּת גָּמוּר

One of them is the World of Atzilut, which is all complete Godliness,

וְהַשְּׁנֵי הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁהֵם עוֹלָמוֹת הַנִּפְרָדִים:

and the second is the Worlds of BiY"A, which are the separated worlds.

וְהֵנָּה בְּמָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁגָּלָה ית"ש בְּבִחִי' פְּעֻלָּה הוּא רַק בְּאַצִּילוּת וּבִי"ע

Now when we said that He revealed Himself in the category of 'activity' only in Atzilut and BiY"A,

וְאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם ב' פְּעֻלוֹת מַחְלָקוֹת וְכַנִּז'.

and we also noted that these are two separate activities i.e. emanating Atzilut and producing BiY"A constitute two different actions.

הנה יובן לנו בזה שרש הדברים אשר אמרנו לעיל שער ג' פ' ה' ו'

We can now understand this matter in its root discussed above *Sha'ar 3* chapters 5 and 6:

שהנבראים הם רק שנים שהם רוח ונפש,

We stated over there that there are only two entities in the category of 'created' – *ruach* and *nefesh*, whereas *neshama*, *chaya* and *yechida* are not in the category of *created*, as the author is about to state, since they are 'within' the Creator.

אבל הנשמה, ומכל שכן החיה והיחידה, הם למעלה מהבריאה.

But *neshama*, and all the more so, *chaya* and *yechida*, are above creation.

והוא כי הרי אמרנו לעיל פ"ג שהם גלויים הנז' הם השרשים להנרנח"י.

And as we stated above *Sha'ar 4* chapter 3 the five revelations mentioned there are the roots of *nrnch*"y,⁶

וכשם שהם גלויים הראשונים הם בבחי' אור א"ס והם למעלה מהפעלה

and just as the first three revelations there are in the category of *Ohr Ein Sof*, transcending the category of action,

כן הוא היחידה חיה נשמה למעלה מהבריאה שהוא למעלה מהגוף.

so too, *yechida*, *chaya* and *neshama* transcend creation, corresponding to the body, which they transcend.

וכן הוא עוד כי כשם שאמרנו שפעלתו אשר בהבי"ע שהוא גלויי החמישי

Furthermore, just as we explained that His activity in BiY"A is the fifth revelation,

הנה פעל אותם שיהיו חוץ ממנו שהם אינם אלהות כלל וכנ"ל,

which He produced to exist 'outside' of Himself, in the sense that they are not Godliness at all,

כן הוא ג"כ בחי' הנפש שהיא כנגדו כי היא הענף דהגלוי החמישי,

so too, as regarding the corresponding aspect of *nefesh* (which corresponds to BiY"A) – it is merely a branch of the fifth revelation,

שהגלוי החמישי הוא שרשה וכנז'.

for the fifth revelation is its root, as mentioned.

הנה הנה הנפש לעולם בבחי' לבר מגופא שהיא אינה מעקר
האדם.

Accordingly, the aspect of *nefesh* is always in the category of extrinsic since it is not part of the intrinsic aspects of man

כי עקר האדם הוא רק הרוח חג"ת [חסד, גבורה, תפארת]

since the primary aspect of man is only *ruach*, corresponding to *chesed, gevurah, tiferet***, **

אבל הנפש נהי"ם [נצח, הוד, יסוד, מלכות]

whereas *nefesh* corresponding to *netzach, hod, yesod, malchut*

היא רק השרש למה שלמטה ממדרגת האדם

is merely the root of what is below the level of man,

והיא עומדת בהאדם רק לקשר אותו

and only exists in man in order to connect him

לכל מה שלמטה ממנו שהוא לקשרו עם הגוף והעולם.

to whatever is below him – i.e. to connect him to the body and to the world.

ולכן נקרא הנפש לבר מגופיה

This is why the *nefesh* is referred to as extrinsic,

וכמ"ש בזוה"ק בראשית כא ע"ב. ופ' תולדות קמו א'. ופ' וישלח קסו א'. ופ' פקודי
(רנז ב'. ופ' נשא קמ"ג א')

(as stated in *Zohar* vol. I *Bereishit* 21b, *Toldot* 146a; vol. II *Vayishlach* 166a, *Pekudei* 257b; vol. III *Nasso* 143a)

כי היא כנגד גליו החמישי וכנז' והבן:

since it corresponds to His fifth revelation, as explained. Understand this.

ידע כי כל ה' גלויים שאמרנו הנה ה'ה שיעור מציאות הגלוי דכל
עליון

Know also that regarding all five revelations we mentioned – the degree of disclosure of all higher revelations

רק לפי צרך הגלוי דהתחתון שיוצא ממנו

is commensurate with the need for revelation of the levels below, that emerge from it from the higher level

כי הם כלם רק להיות סבה זה לזה.

since they all constitute the cause one for the other.

ולכן כל הבחינות שישנם בזה ישנם בזה, והם כלם בסדר אחד,

And therefore all the aspects that exist in one level, exist in the other one as well, and all of them constitute a single arrangement,

אלא שבכ"א הוא לפי ערכו

except that each of them is according to its spiritual status,

וכל עליון בכל בחינותיו הוא הסבה להתחתון ולכל בחינותיו.

and every higher level in all of its aspects is the cause for the lower level in all of its aspects.

וכן הוא תכליתו ג"כ כי הסבה עצמו הוא התכלית

And so too is it regarding its peak aspiration, because its cause *is* its peak aspiration,

שתכלית כל דבר שחוזר לסבתו ולסבת סבתו עד הסיבה הראשונה:

since the peak aspiration of every entity is to return to its cause, and to the cause of its cause, all the way up until the First Cause.

והנה סדר המאציל ית"ש את כל אותן הגלויים כלם

Now the blessed Emanator arranged all of those revelations in a manner that

שיהא כל עליון נצרך להתחתון (ר"ל שהתחתון צריך להעליון) בהכרח וחיוב,

the higher level is needed by the lower level (i.e. the lower needs the higher⁷) of necessity and as a requisite

כי הרי רק הוא סבתו ותכליתו.

since the higher level is its only cause and its peak aspiration.

אבל כל תחתון הוא נצרך להעליון רק בכונה ורצון,

Conversely, every lower level is needed by the higher level only in terms of intention and desire ('desire' in the sense of will)

כי עליו היה כוננתו ורצונו, ורק לזה נתפשט ונתגלה,

since this the lower level was the intention and desire of the higher level, and it was only for this purpose that it spread forth and became revealed,

והיה כל גלוי רק מה שנוגע להתחתון להיות סבתו.

so that its entire revelation is only that which is relevant becoming the cause of the lower level.

וא"כ נמצא שהם כלם באמת סבות זה לזה

Thus it turns out that they are all actually causes for one another,

וכן הם כלם תכליות זה לזה,

and also the peak aspiration for each other.

כי הרי כשם שכל עליון הוא הסבה והתכלית להתחתון בנז',

Because just as every higher level is the cause and the peak aspiration of the lower level, as mentioned,

כן הוא ג"כ כל תחתון סבה ותכלית להעליון,

so too is every lower level the cause and the peak aspiration of the higher level,

שהרי סבת ותכלית הגלוי דכל עליון

since the cause and purpose of the revelation of the higher level

הוא כדי להביא על ידו את השני אליו על מציאותו ותכליתו.

is to thereby bring the second one the lower level up to it to the level of the cause existentially and in terms of what it ultimately aspires to

ובזה יושלם תכליתו דהעליון ג"כ והבן כל הדברים:

And in this way the ultimate purpose of the higher level is also fulfilled.

Understand these matters well.

והנה בכל אלו ה' גלויים כלם יש רשות להלב לחשב ולהשכל להתבונן

Now regarding all these five revelations, the heart has permission to think, theorize and meditate

בכל סדרי מציאותם ובהרצון שבהם.

on the entire order of their existence and the Divine will invested in them.

אבל למעלה מאלו ה' גלויים כלם פיה מלדבר ולבך מלהרהר,

But beyond these five revelations, "prevent your mouth from speaking, and your heart from ruminating" as the *Sefer Yetzirah* (1:8) states in connection with the *sefirot* of Atzilut.⁸

וגם ההתבוננות באלו ה' אינו בכלם שוה.

And even as regards contemplating these five – not all are equal,

ולא הטר אלא בכל אחד לפי ערכו בכל יוטר עליון רק בכללות ורק במחשבה,

so that it is only permitted to contemplate each one according to its stature, and the more elevated it is the more general the idea must be, and only in thought,

וגם זה רק ברצוא ושוב,

and even then, only in a manner of *ratzo v'shov*,⁹ literally, 'to and fro' i.e. not for extended periods of time. As soon as one's thoughts soar up to the highest levels one must immediately return to where one is grounded.

וביותר תחתון גם בפרטות ובדבור,

Whereas regarding lower levels it is permitted even in detail and in speech.

אמנם התר הדבור שבו הוא רק לפי ערך העליון שעליו,

Nevertheless, permission to speak about these levels is only in comparison with what is above it,

אבל לא בערך התחתון שלמטה ממנו.

but not in comparison with what is below it. In other words, speaking about higher levels is comparatively restricted, and the lower the level, the more it is permitted to speak about it. Thus the degree to which one can discuss a lower level clearly does not transfer to the next level up.

כי בזה נבחן הוא לעליון ובכל משפטיו וחקותיו.

Indeed, this is what distinguishes it as a higher level as regards all of its rational and super-rational laws.

וגם ההתבוננות המתר בכל אחד

Also, regarding the contemplation which is allowed at each level

צריכים לזהר מאד לדעת שהוא רק לפי ערכו המתחס אליו,

one must take exceptional care that it is only according to the spiritual stature thereof of that level.

והבו גם כל זה (והמעין בדברינו בספר הכללים ובספר הדע"ה
ובחלק הבאורים

Understand this too (and one who examines our words in *Sefer HaKlalim* and in *Sefer HaDe'ah*, and in the elucidations at the end of this work

ימצא מבאר כל אותן הדברים כפול ומשלש כמה פעמים):

will find these matters explained two and three times over.

אמנם כל אלו הה' גלוים הנה הם נמשכים זה מזה

Nevertheless, all of these five revelations are drawn one from the other,

ומשפעים זה מזה וקשורים ומיחדים זב"ז,

and are affected by one another and are bound to each other and are united one with another –

כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן בְּהֶעָלִיוֹן שֶׁעָלָיו עַד אֲמַתָּתוֹ הַפְּשׁוּטָה הַנֶּעְלָמָה

each lower level with the one above it, all the way up to His true, simple in the sense of uncompounded **hidden Being**

אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה מִכָּל הַגְּלוּיִם כָּלָם.

that transcends all revelation.

כִּי הוּא אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּהִגְלֵי הָרִאשׁוֹן, וּמִמֶּנּוּ לְהִשְׁנִי וּמִמֶּנּוּ לְהִשְׁלִישִׁי וְכֵן כּו' כּו' בְּנִ"ל ספ"ד.

For He is revealed in the very first revelation, and from there to the second, and then to the third etc. as explained above end of chapter 4,

אָבֵל בְּאֲמַתָּתוֹ הַנֶּעְלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם

But as regards His true hidden Being itself which is revealed within them within these levels

הִנֵּה אָסוּר וְנִמְנָע וּמִשּׁוּלָּל מִכָּל לֵב לְחַשֵּׁב וּמִכָּל שֶׁכֵּל לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן,

– it is forbidden and permission is withheld and denied to any heart to think about, and all the more so to contemplate,

כִּי רַק הוּא לְבַדּוֹ ית"ש יִדְעֶה אֶת עֲצָמוֹ וּמִכִּיר אֶת אֲמַתָּתוֹ יִתְבַּרַךְ
וְיִתְעַלָּה שְׁמוֹ לְעַד:

for He alone knows Himself and is aware of His true being, may His Name be blessed and exalted forever.

Footnotes

1. I have placed this phrase in quotes since in reality nothing is actually outside of His aegis, as will be explained below. [↵](#)
2. And therefore the name revealed in BiY"A is *Elokim*, as explained in the previous chapter (Makover). [↵](#)
3. Rabbi Avraham Galanti and other commentaries on the *Zohar*. [↵](#)
4. I.e. the *Ohr Ein Sof*. [↵](#)
5. As noted previously, the *kav* follows the *tzimtzum*, and not vice versa, despite their reverse order in this sentence. [↵](#)
6. These are the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and *kav*, Adam Kadmon, Atzilut and BiY"A. [↵](#)
7. The Hebrew text here clarifies the intention. Since we have translated the text according to the intended meaning, this parenthetical statement may seem

unnecessary. ↩

8. *Meir haLeshem* notes an apparent contradiction here since the *Sefer Yetzirah* (ibid.) seemingly allows only contemplation of the *sefirot* of Atzilut, whereas the Ba'al haLeshem allows contemplation of many levels beyond Atzilut! He concludes that this seems to depend upon the depth of contemplation. ↩

9. See Ezekiel 1:14. ↩

G A T E

*Shaar 5 — The five general Divine
revelations*

Chapter 1 — Two varieties of the five revelations: one above the other and one within the other.

Sha'ar 5 Chapter 1

Various ways of picturing the relationships between the Revelations

הַחֲמִשָּׁה גְּלוּיִם שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ בְּשַׁעַר ד'

Of the five revelations discussed in Sha'ar 4,¹

הִנֵּה בְּעֵינֵינוּ מָה שֶׁנוֹגַע מִזֶּה לָזֶה יֵשׁ בְּזֶה ב' בַּחֲדֵי

two aspects of the relationship between one revelation and the another² are relevant here:

א' מָה שֶׁהֵם זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה; ב' מָה שֶׁהֵם מִתְּפָשְׁטִים וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים
זֶה בְּזֶה

1. That they are completely one above the other³

2. They flow into and become clothed within one another.

Now these two points appear to contradict each other – if the higher one is completely above the lower one, how do they flow into and become clothed one in the other? The answer is –

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי בְּעֵקֶר עֲצֻמוֹת הַגְּלוּי דכ"א

That is to say, in the primary essential revelation of each of them,

הִנֵּה הֵם זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה לְגַמְרִי, אַךְ בְּהֶאָרְתָּם הֵם מִתְלַבָּשִׁים זב"ז
[זֶה בְּזֶה].

one transcends the other completely, with no overlap, but their *radiances* are clothed one within the other i.e. they flow into and become clothed one in the other,

כִּי מִתְּפָשֵׁט הָאֶרֶץ מִכָּל עָלְיוֹן וְיוֹרֵד וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן כְּמוֹ
שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר לְמַטָּה פ"ב.

since a radiance from every higher level descends and becomes clothed in the lower level**, as will be explained below, chapter 2.**

אַבֵּל בְּעֵקֶר מְצִיאוֹתָם וּמִדְּרָגָתָם הִנֵּה הֵם זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה לְגַמְרִי.

But as regards their primary existence and level, one transcends the other completely,

כִּי יֵשְׁנוּ לֹכ"א בַּחֲדֵי מָקוֹם וּמַעוֹן בְּפָנֵי עֲצָמוֹ

because each of them has a separate sacred space⁴ and abode exclusive to it,
וְאֵינוֹ נִכְנָס כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן בְּגִבּוֹל הָעָלְיוֹן מֵאוּמָּה.

and the lower level does not enter the border of the higher level at all.

כִּי הִנֵּה אוֹר אֵין סוּף ית"ש שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הָרָאשׁוֹן הִנֵּה הוּא לְמַעְלָה
מֵהַכֹּל

The *Ohr Ein Sof* is the first revelation and transcends everything else.

וְכֵן הוּא ג"כ מִבְּחוּץ לְהַכֹּל כִּי הוּא מְקִיף לְכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם מְכַל
סְבִיבוֹתֵיהֶם

Furthermore, it also envelops everything from the outside since it surrounds all
the worlds on every side

וְהֵם כֻּלָּם לְמַטָּה מִמֶּנּוּ בַּמַּדְרָגָה וְאֵין שׁוּם עוֹלָם שֶׁיִּכְנָס בְּמַחְצָתוֹ
מֵאוּמָּה.

so that all of them are below it in terms of their level, and no World can enter
into its parameters at all.

וַיִּשְׁנֶנּוּ גַם בְּחִי' שְׁפָה וּפְרָגוֹד לְהַפְסִיק בֵּינוּ לְבֵין כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת

There is also an edge and a barrier, so to speak, separating it from all the worlds

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁמִּתְבָּאֵר בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּעֵגְלִים וַיֵּשֶׁר עֲנָף ב'.

as will be explained in exposition in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher, anaf 2*.

וְאַחֲרָיו הוּא הָעוֹלָם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשֵּׁנִי.

The subsequent level is the world of the kav and the tzimtzum, which constitute
the second revelation.

וְהִנֵּה הַצִּמְצוּם הוּא כְּעֵין אֲוִיר וּמְקוֹם פָּנוּי אֲשֶׁר בְּתוֹכוֹ נִמְצְאוּ וְנַעֲשׂוּ
כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

Now the tzimtzum forms something like an empty space and a void in which all
of the worlds are found and made

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא אֲוִיר הַקְּדָמוֹן כִּנ"ל שֶׁע"ד פ"ג

And that is why it is referred to as *Avir Kadmon*, as mentioned previously in
Sha'ar 4 chapter 3.

כִּי הוּא כְּעֵין חֶלֶל וְאֲוִיר פָּנוּי וְהוּא קְדָמוֹן לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת.

Because it is like a void and empty space that precedes all of existence.

כִּי קֵדָם הַכֹּל הָאֲצִיל הַמְּאֲצִיל ית"ש מְקוֹם לְהַמְצִיאוֹת

Because, first and foremost, the Emanator emanated a space for existence

וְהוּא הַנוֹשֵׂא בְּתוֹכוֹ אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלוּ.

that sustains the entire existence within it.

וְעָלְיוֹ רִמְזָה הַתּוֹרָה מ"ש הִנֵּה מָקוֹם אֵתִי.

This is what the Torah is hinting to in the verse (Exodus 33:21), "There is a sacred space with Me..."

אָמַנְם אוֹתוֹ הַמָּקוֹם הִנֵּה הוּא אֵינוֹ פָּנוּי מִמֶּשׁ וּבִבְחִי רִיקְנִי וְהָעֵדֶר
ח"ו

However, that sacred space is not literally void and empty, from which everything is negated, heaven forfend,

כִּי אֵין רִיקְנִי כָּלָל וּכְמ"ש הָרַב הַקְּדוֹשׁ מֵהַרִּי"ג [הָרַב יוֹסֵף גִּיקַטִּילִיא] בְּסֵפֶר גִּנַּת אֶגֶז ח"ב שְׂאִין רִיקוֹת בְּעוֹלָם.

for there is no 'emptiness' at all, as Rabbi Joseph Gikatilla (1238-1410) writes in his *Ginat Egoz*, part II – that there is no vacuum in the spiritual universe.

וְכֹן כָּתַב ג"כ רַבֵּנוּ הַקְּדוֹשׁ הָרַמ"ק ז"ל בְּאַלְמִימָה מ"א תָּמַר ב' פ' י"ז

Our holy rabbi, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero (1522-1570) writes similarly in his *Elimah, ma'ayan 1, tamar 2* chapter 17

שְׂאִין רִיקוֹת וְהָעֵדֶר ח"ו וְכֹן אָמַר הָרַמְבַּ"ם בְּמוֹרָה ח"א ר"פ ע"ב וְה' ע"ג וּבַח"ב פ"ל.

that there is no vacuum and void, heaven forfend. And so writes the Rambam Maimonides in his *Moreh Nevuchin*, part 1, chapters 72, 73 and in part 2, chapter 30.

אָמַנְם מָה שֶׁקְּרָאֵנוּ אוֹתוֹ בְּשֵׁם מָקוֹם כִּי הִנֵּה שֵׁם הוּא שְׁפָעַת כָּחוֹ
יִתְבָּרֵךְ

However, the fact that we refer to it as 'makom' 'place' or 'sacred space' is because that is to where His power flows –

הַנוֹשֵׂא אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלוּ, וְהִרִי הוּא הַמָּקוֹם לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת.

the power that sustains all of existence, and constitutes the sacred space or the boundary conditions for the entire existence.⁵

וְאָמַר הָאַרִיז"ל בְּסֵפֶר שַׁעַר הַקְּדָמוֹת דָּךְ ט' סע"ד

The Arizal stated in the work *Sha'ar haHakdamot 9d*

כִּי הַמָּקוֹם הוּא יוֹתֵר זָךְ וּמַעוֹלָה וְגָדוֹל בְּמַעֲלָה וּמִדְרָגָה מִן הָעוֹלָם
עֲצָמוֹ.

that the space in which the universe is contained is more refined, and loftier in quality and level, than the world itself.

ולכן נקרא הקב"ה מקומו של עולם

And therefore the Holy One, blessed be He, is called the 'Place' of the universe, וכמו שאמרו רז"ל ברוך המקום שנתן תורה לישראל עד כאן לשונו.

as our Sages declared⁶, "Blessed is the 'Place' who gave the Torah to the Jewish people" end quote,

וע' בראשית רבה פרשה ס"ח סימן ט' ע"ש.

and see Bereishit Rabba 68:9.⁷

והוא מה שכתוב (איוב כ"ו) "תולה ארץ על בלי מה" שהוא בלי מהות משג

This is as the verse (Job 26:7) states: "He suspends the earth upon nothingness" – i.e. an incomprehensible essence –

כי הוא שפעת כחו יתברך הנשא את כל העולמות וכלם עומדים עליו.

since it is the outflow of His blessed power that sustains all the worlds, and everything is based upon it,

והרי הם תלויים ועומדים בלכחו של הקב"ה שהוא בלי מהות משג.

and all of them are dependent upon, and are based upon, the power of the Holy One, blessed be He, which cannot be comprehended.

והוא האויר קדמון אשר בהצמצום הנז' הנושא את כל:

This power is the *Avir Kadmon* that results from the *tzimtzum* mentioned, and this is what sustains everything.

והנה פשוט הדבר כי אותו הכח הנושא את כל העולמות

Now it is obvious that the power that sustains all of the worlds

הנה הוא נבחן בחלקת מדרגות רבות,

can be categorized into many levels,

והוא לפי ערך כל עולם הנשוא עליו.

according to the nature of each world that is sustained thereby.⁸

כי אינו דומה קדשת השפע והכח שהוא המקום דהאצילות

For the holiness of the flow and the power in the sacred space of Atzilut is not at all similar

לקדשת השפּע וְהכח שֶׁהוא הַמָּקוֹם דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה.

to the holiness of the flow and the power in the sacred space of the World of Beriah.

וְכֵן אֵינוֹ דוֹמָה קִדְשֵׁי הַמָּקוֹם דְּהַבְּרִיָּאָה לְקִדְשֵׁי הַמָּקוֹם דְּהַיְצִירָה

Similarly, the holiness of the sacred space of Beriah is not at all similar to the holiness of the sacred space of Yetzirah.

וְכֵן הַמָּקוֹם דְּהַיְצִירָה לְהַמָּקוֹם דְּעֵשְׂיָה

And so too, the sacred space of Yetzirah is not at all similar to the holiness of the sacred space of Asiyah.

וְנִבְחַח קִדְשֵׁי הַמָּקוֹם דַּכ"א לְפִי עֶרֶךְ מַעֲלַת הַמְּצִיאוֹת וְהָעוֹלָם שְׁבִתוֹכֹו

The holiness of the sacred space of each of them is distinct, commensurate with its existential level and the world within it,

וְאֵינוֹ נִכְנָס כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן בְּגִבּוֹל הַמָּקוֹם דְּהָעֲלִיּוֹן מֵאוּמָּה.

so that no lower level ever enters the boundaries of the higher level.

וְהוּא ע"ד שְׁאֲמָרוֹ רז"ל ב"ב ע"ה א' שֶׁהִקְבִּ"ה עוֹשֶׂה לְכָל צַדִּיק וְצַדִּיק חוֹפֶה לְפִי כְבוֹדֹו

This is comparable to what our Sages said in Tractate *Bava Batra* 75a – that the Holy One, blessed is He, makes a canopy over each and every righteous person according to His⁹ honor,

וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד נִכְוָה מִחֻפְתּוֹ שֶׁל חֲבֵרוֹ.

and "each of them is scalded by the canopy of his friend."

This is not out of jealousy, which is a despicable trait, but rather out of a recognition that each person is rewarded according to his achievements, and the fact that someone else managed to achieve what he didn't causes the person to burn with regret.¹⁰

זֶהוּ ג"כ מָה שְׁנֵאָמַר בְּמִשְׁנֵה רַבֵּנוּ ע"ה מֵאַחַז פְּנֵי כֶסֶף פָּרָשׁ עָלָיו עֲנָנוּ (אִיּוֹב כ"ו)

This is also the intention of the verse (Job 26:9) said regarding Moshe our Teacher, peace be upon him: "He grasped the front of the Throne; He spread out His radiance¹¹ over him."

וְאֲמָרוֹ רז"ל סִכָּה ה' א' אֲשֶׁתְּרַבּוּבִי אֲשֶׁתְּרַבֵּב לִיה כֶּסֶף וְנִקַּט בֵּיהּ.

Our Sages declared (*Sukkah* 5a) "The Throne was drawn down for him, and he (Moses) took hold of it."¹²

כי הכסא הוא עולם הבריאה ושם היה השגת משה רבנו ע"ה

For the 'Throne' is the World of Beriah, and it was to there that our Teacher Moshe's grasp extended

בהיכל קדש הקדשים דבריאה כמ"ש האריז"ל בלקוטי ש"ס ברכות
(הובא בספר אור עינים)

- Specifically to the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah, as the Arizal states in *Likutei Shas, Berachot* (cited in the work *Ohr Einayim*).

והיה מקומו של משה רבנו ע"ה גם בהיותו בעוה"ז המקום
דהבריאה ממשי

So Moshe's sacred space, even when he was in this world, was actually the sacred space of Beriah.

(וע' בספר אילמה להרמ"ק ז"ל מ"א ת"א פ' כ"ב דף ט' ע"ב)

(See Ramak's *Eilimah, ma'ayan 1, tamar 1, chapter 22 p. 9b*).

ולכך נאמר בו כי המקום אשר אתה עומד עליו אדמת קדש הוא

Therefore, regarding him the verse (Exodus 3:5) states, "The place upon which you stand is holy ground,"

כי לעולם הוא המקום לפי ערך מדרגת המציאות שעומד בו.

for it is always so that the sacred space is distinguished according to that which resides in it.

Accordingly, since Moshe Rabbeinu was on the level of the World of Beriah, the place upon which he stood became holy ground.

וכשם שנבדל כ"א מחברו במציאותו כן נבדל כ"א מחברו במקומו.

And just as every person is separated from another as a fact of simple existence, so is he separated from him in terms of sacred space.

ובכל מקום שהוא מקומו עמו, ואינו נכנס כל אחד במקום חברו
מאומה

And wherever he is, his sacred space is with him, and no person can enter into the sacred space of his friend at all.

וכן הוא בענייננו בענין הצמצום שהוא הגלוי השני.

And so too is it as regards our subject – the idea of the *tzimtzum*, which is the second revelation:

הגם שהוא המקום הכולל בתוכו את כל העולמות כלם

Even though it is the sacred space that includes within it all of the worlds,

וְכָל הַמְצִיאוּת אֲשֶׁר מֵעוֹלָם וְעַד עוֹלָם הִנֵּה הֵם כֻּלָּם בְּתוֹכוֹ שֶׁהוּא
הַמָּקוֹם לְכֻלָּם.

and all the forms of existence from world to world – all of them are within it,
for it is the sacred space of them all –

עכ"ז הִנֵּה הוּא נִבְחַן לְכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם וּלְכָל מְצִיאוֹת וּמְצִיאוֹת שָׁבוּ
לַמָּקוֹם בִּפְנֵי"ע

nevertheless, it is distinct for each and every world, and for every existing entity
within it, as its own discrete sacred space,

חֲלוּק בַּמַּדְרָגָה וְנִבְדָּל מִזּוּלָּתוֹ.

with its own separate spiritual level, and distinct from any other entity.

וְלֹא עוֹד אֵלָּא שֶׁעֵקֶר הַצִּמְצוּם גּוֹפֶה בָּמָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי
הַשָּׁנִי

Furthermore, the primary characteristic of the *tzimtzum* itself, since it is the
second revelation,

הִנֵּה הוּא בְּאֵמֶת לְמַעְלָה מִכָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

is that it transcends *all* of the worlds.

כִּי הִנֵּה אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַצִּמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם

For we stated that the *tzimtzum* is sacred space

הִנֵּה הוּא הַכֹּחַ הַנוֹשֵׂא אֶת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת וְהוּא שֹׁפֵעַ נִשְׁפָּע מִמֶּנּוּ
יֵת"ש וְכָנ"ל.

which is the power that sustains all of existence; and it is an outflow from Him,
may His Name be blessed, as explained above.

וַיֵּשׁ לְכָל שֹׁפֵעַ הַתְּחִלָּה וְרֵאשִׁית שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ מִתְּפַשֵּׁט וּמִתְגַּלֶּה.

Now every outflow has a beginning and a starting point from which it emerges
and is revealed.

וְאוֹתוֹ הַתְּחִלָּה וְרֵאשִׁית הוּא שְׂרָשׁוֹ וְהוּא גְבוּהָ וְנִעְלָם

And this beginning and starting point is the root of the outflow, and it is lofty
and concealed in this particular case,

כִּי הוּא יֵצֵאתוֹ מֵהַמַּאֲצִיל א"ס יֵת"ש.

since it emerges from the Emanator, the blessed *Ein Sof*.

וְאוֹתוֹ הַשְּׂרָשׁ הוּא הָעוֹלָם דָּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם עֲצָמוֹ שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִהַכֹּל

This root is the world of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* itself, which transcends
everything,

וְהוּא אֲשֶׁר נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אָוִיר הַקְדָּמוֹן וְטְהִירוֹ עֲלֵאָה

and is called the *Avir Kadmon* primordial space and *Tehiru Ila'ah* the supernal purity.

כִּי שָׁם הוּא תִקְף הָאוֹר דַּא"ס וְעָלָיו נֶאֱמַר הִנֵּה מָקוֹם אֶתִי כֵּן"ל

For that is where the potency of the *Ohr Ein Sof* is manifested, and it is in reference to this that the verse states "There is a sacred space with Me..." as mentioned above.

כִּי הוּא רַק עִם הַמְאֲצִיל עֲצָמוֹ לַמַּעֲלָה מֵהַכֹּל.

For it is only with the Emanator Himself, transcending everything.

It cannot be said to be *with* anything else, since it is incomparably loftier than any other emanated or created entity.

וְכֵן הוּא בִּמְכַש"כ [בְּמַכֵּל שָׁכֵן] בְּעֵנֵינוּ אוֹר הַקּוֹ אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִכְנָס בְּתוֹךְ הַצִּמְצוּם

And similarly, but all the more so, regarding the light of the *kav* that spreads forth and enters into the *tzimtzum* – this is called the *reishit hakav* that 'touches' the *Ein Sof* and transcends the *tzimtzum* at its top end, and terminates in the void at its bottom end**[13](#)** –

וּמִמֶּנּוּ יֵצֵא וְנִעֲשֶׂה כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם.

and from it from the *kav* all of the worlds emerge and are made.

הִנֵּה עֶקֶר אוֹר הַקּוֹ עֲצָמוֹ הוּא עוֹמֵד לַמַּעֲלָה מֵהַכֹּל

Thus the primary aspect of the light of the *kav* stands above everything.

וְהוּא עִם הַצִּמְצוּם הַמְקִיפּוֹ עוֹלָם גָּמוּר בִּפְנֵי ע

And so the *kav*, together with the *tzimtzum*, constitute a complete discrete world.

כִּי הֵם כְּלוּלִים מֵעוֹלָם מָלֵא וְהוּא עוֹמֵד בְּכָל עֶקְרוֹ לַמַּעֲלָה מֵהַכֹּל

For they comprise a full world, which in its primary nature transcends everything,

ר"ל לַמַּעֲלָה גַם מֵאָדָם קְדָמוֹן

meaning to say, above even Adam Kadmon.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם בִּפְנֵי ע שֶׁהוּא בְּשֵׁם קוֹ וְצִמְצוּם כִּי הוּא עוֹלָם בִּפְנֵי ע
וְהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשָּׁנִי כֵּן"ל:

And this is why the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* are referred to as being 'discrete,' because they are a distinct world. This is the second revelation.

וְהִנֵּה בְּתַחֲתִיתוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּתַחֲתִית הַקּוֹ בְּהִקְצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שְׁלוֹ

The above was regarding the beginning and starting point of the outflow. **But the endpoint** of the initial outflow, **which is the bottom part of the kav, at its bottom end,**

הִנֵּה שָׁם מִתְחִיל אָדָם קַדְמוֹן וְכִמוּ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוּ בְּעֵגְלִים וַיֵּשֶׁר עֲנָף ב'
that is where Adam Kadmon begins, as we explained in *Igulim v'Yosher, anaf*
2.¹⁴

וְנִמְשָׁךְ וַיּוֹצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ בְּכָל הָעֲשָׂרָה מַדְרָגוֹת שֶׁבּוֹ שֶׁהֵם מִכְתָּר עַד
הַמַּלְכוּת

It Adam Kadmon is drawn down from and emerges from it from the *kav* once it enters into the *chalal* with all its ten levels – from *keter* to *malchut* –

וְעוֹמֵד כָּל אָדָם קַדְמוֹן לְמַטָּה מֵעֵקֶר הַקּוֹ כָּלוּ.
so that all of Adam Kadmon is situated below the primary aspect of the entire
kav.

וְהִנֵּה הָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן הַגָּם כִּי בְּעֵרֶךְ עֲצָמוּתוֹ גּוֹפָה הִנֵּה הוּא עוֹלָם
מָלָא וְשָׁלֵם

Now Adam Kadmon, although it is in itself is a full and complete world,

מִכָּל בְּחִי' הִי' סִפִּי כָּלָם אֲמָנָם בְּעֵרֶךְ הָאֲצִילוֹת
comprising all the ten *sefirot*, nevertheless, in comparison to Atzilut,

הִנֵּה נִבְחַן כָּל הִי"ס [הָעֵשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת] דָּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן רַק לְבַחִי' הַג'ר
[ג' רָאשִׁין]

all the ten *sefirot* of Adam Kadmon are regarded as the three 'head' *sefirot* –

שֶׁהֵם הַכַּח"ב לְבַד וְכָל הָעֲשָׂרָה הַסִּפִּי שֶׁבּוֹ הֵם הָעֵשֶׂר הַסְּפִירוֹת
אֲשֶׁר בַּהַכַּח"ב גּוֹפָה

keter, chochmah, binah only, and all ten *sefirot* therein in Adam Kadmon are the
ten *sefirot* of *k'cha"b* [*keter, chochmah, binah*] itself

כִּי כ"א הוּא כָּלוּל מֵעֵשֶׂר כְּנוֹדָע

since each of them each of those *sefirot* is comprised of all ten, as is known,

וְכָל הָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא נִבְחַן כְּנִגְדּוֹ רַק לְבַחִי' הַז' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת

whereas all of Atzilut is regarded in comparison as merely the seven lower
sefirot

שֶׁהֵם ז"א וּמַלְכוּת הַכְּלָלִיִּים.

which are *ze'ir anpin* comprising the six *sefirot* from *chesed* to *yesod* and *malchut*
in a macro sense.

והא"ק הוא בערך האצילות בבחי' א"א [אריך אנפין] ואו"א [אבא ואמא] הכלליים

Thus A"K Adam Kadmon compared to Atzilut is the aspect of the macro-level *Arich Anpin*, the lowest aspect of *keter*, and *Abba chochmah* and *Imma binah*,

וכמו שיתבאר ענין הפרצופים לקמן שער ז'.

as will be explained later in Sha'ar 7 regarding the *partzufim* the clusters of interacting *sefirot*.

והנה מתחיל האצילות שהוא ז"א ומלכות

Now the World of **Atzilut**, which is primarily *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* (whereas the ten sefirot of A"K are regarded as only *keter*, *chochmah*, *binah* in the macro-sense, as just explained) **begins**

מתחת עקרו דהא"ק לגמרי שהוא מתחת דא"א ואו"א.

below the primary aspect of Adam Kadmon, i.e. below *arich anpin*, *abba* and *imma* (the *partzufim* of *keter*, *chochmah*, *binah*, as just explained).

אמנם הוא כי הנה אותן הא"א ואו"א

Indeed it is the case that *arich anpin*, *abba* and *imma*

הנה הם מתפשטים בהנה"י שלהם שהוא מבחי' הטבור ולמטה שבהם,

extend downward into their *nh"i netzach, hod, yesod*, which is from the aspect of their 'navel' and below,

In Kabbalah, based on the verse (Genesis 1:26), "Let us make man in Our image, in Our likeness," the human form is used as an analogy for understanding the structure and the dynamics of the spiritual worlds, as we know. As the author will soon explain, the 'navel' represents a dividing point between the upper half of Adam Kadmon and its lower half.

Now although the primary aspects of *arich anpin*, *abba* and *imma* end at the dividing line, the 'navel,' nevertheless when it arose in His will to reveal them somewhat, then *arich anpin*, *abba* and *imma* extended as a radiance into their *nh"i* which then become clothed within Atzilut, as will be explained.

ומתלבשים בהז"א ומלכות שהוא האצילות,

and they *nh"i* then become clothed in macro-level *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* of A"K, which is Atzilut.

כי כן הוא הסדר לעולם שכל תחתון נעשה ויוצא מהנה"י דהעליון

For this is always the order – every lower level is made by, and emerges from, the *nh"i* of the higher level,

ומתלבש הנה"י דהעליון בהתחתון ונעשה בו לעצם מעצמו ובשר
מבשרו

and the *nh"i* of the higher level is clothed in the lower level, becoming 'bone of its bone and flesh of its flesh' – paraphrasing Genesis 2:23 (regarding the creation of Eve from Adam). However, the intention here may be to translate עצם here as 'essence,' rather than 'bone.' Thus the *nh"i* of the higher level becomes the essence (and outer layer, the 'flesh') of the lower level.

וע"י זה הנה נחשב הא"ק עם האצילות לבחי' פרצוף אחד

Accordingly, A"K and Atzilut can be thought of as a single *partzuf*,

אלא שמטבורו ולמעלה נקרא בשם א"ק ומטבורו ולמטה נקרא
בשם אצילות.

except that from the 'navel' and above is called A"K, and from the navel and down is called Atzilut.

אך עכ"פ הוא כי עקר הא"ק עצמו הוא למעלה מהאצילות לגמרי

But nevertheless the primary aspect of A"K itself transcends Atzilut completely,

ואינו מתחיל האצילות אלא רק למטה מעקרו דהא"ק שהוא
למטה מהטבור שבו.

so that Atzilut doesn't even begin until below the primary aspect of A"K, i.e., below its 'navel.'

וכן הוא עד"ז במכש"כ בהעולמות בי"ע

The same is true, and all the more so, regarding the worlds of BiY"A –

כי הנה אחר שמסתים האצילות שהוא כלו אלהות גמור

because only after Atzilut, which is all Godliness, is complete

הנה נעשה שם מסך ומחיצה.

then a screen (*masach*) and a 'fence' is made to separate Atzilut from BiY"A.

וכמו שמתבאר ענין המסך בדברינו בספר הכללים כלל י"ט.

The concept of a *masach* is explained in *Sefer HaKlalim*, klal 19.

ועי"ז נתן אפשרות למציאת הנבראים משם ולמטה.

It is via this *masach* that the existence of created beings, and from thereon down, is made possible.

ותחת המסך מתחיל עולם הבריא

The World of Beriah begins below this *masach*,

ונמשך כל שפעת מציאותו והתהוותו רק דרך המסך.

and all of the flow animating its existence and its coming into being is exclusively through the *masach*,

וְנִמְשָׁךְ עִי"ז רַק תִּמְצִית הָאֶרֶה לְבַד מֵהָאֲצִילוֹת

and only a distillation of the radiance from Atzilut is drawn down through it.

אָמֵנָם בְּאוֹתוֹ הַתִּמְצִית הָאֶרֶה נַעֲשֶׂה כָּל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה כְּלוּ.

Nevertheless, from that distillation of the radiance from Atzilut, filtering through the *masach*, the entire World of Beriah is produced.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה בְּכָל הַסֵּדֶר וְהַפְּרָטִים אֲשֶׁר בְּהָאֲצִילוֹת

And it is fashioned according to the entire arrangement and the details of Atzilut,

כִּי נִחְתָּם מֵהָאֲצִילוֹת כְּמוֹ מַחוֹתָם לְנִחְתָּם.

since it is stamped with the seal from Atzilut, as from a seal into the sealed i.e. like the seal of a signet ring pressed into wax, as explained in *Sha'ar* 4:5**.*

וְכֹן עַד"ז מִבְּרִיָּאָה לְהִיצִיָּה כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה מָסַךְ תַּחַת עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה,

And similarly from Beriah to Yetzirah – a *masach* is fashioned beneath the World of Beriah, separating Beriah from Yetzirah

וְשָׁם תַּחַת הַמָּסַךְ נּוֹצֵר עוֹלָם הִיצִיָּה מֵהַבְּרִיָּאָה כְּמוֹ מַחוֹתָם לְנִחְתָּם.

and there, under the *masach*, the World of Yetzirah is formed from Beriah in the same manner as the process outlined above – as from a seal into the sealed.

אָמֵנָם כָּל שְׁפָעַת מְצִיאוֹתוֹ הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ ג"כ רַק מֵהָאֲצִילוֹת לְעוֹלָם,

Nevertheless, the entire flow animating its existence is also always drawn exclusively from Atzilut,

אֲלֹא שֶׁהוּא דֶּרֶךְ כָּל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה וְדֶרֶךְ הַמָּסַךְ אֲשֶׁר בֵּין הַבְּרִיָּאָה לְהִיצִיָּה.

except that this is via the World of Beriah and through the *masach* between Beriah and Yetzirah.

וְכֹן עַד"ז בְּהִמְצִיאוֹת דְּכָל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה

And in the same way with the existence of the World of Asiyah,

כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה מָסַךְ בֵּין הִיצִיָּה לְהָעֲשִׂיָּה

because a *masach* is made between Yetzirah and Asiyah,

וְשָׁם תַּחַת הַמָּסַךְ מֵתַחִיל כָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה

and there, below the *masach*, the World of Asiyah begins

וְנִמְשָׁךְ כָּל שִׁפְעַת מְצִיאוֹתֶיהָ ג"כ רַק מֵהָאֲצִילוֹת תָּמִיד

and the entire flow animating its existence is also always drawn exclusively from Atzilut,

אֲלָא שֶׁהוּא דֶּרֶךְ כָּל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה וְדֶרֶךְ כָּל עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה

except that this is via the entire World of Beriah and via the entire World of Yetzirah,

וְגַם דֶּרֶךְ הַמָּסַךְ אֲשֶׁר מִתַּחַת לְהַיְצִירָה וְנַעֲשֶׂה עִי"ז כָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה

and through the *masach* under Yetzirah. And in this way the entire World of Asiyah is made,

בְּכָל הַסֵּדֶר וְהַפְּרָטִים כְּמוֹ עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה כִּי נִחְתָּם מֵהַיְצִירָה כְּמוֹ מִחוּתָם לְנִחְתָּם.

with the entire arrangement and the details like Yetzirah, since it is sealed from Yetzirah, as from a seal into the sealed.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הֵנָּה עוֹמְדִים כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם זֶה לַמָּטָה מִזֶּה לְגִמְרִי

Thus it turns out that all of the worlds are situated one completely below the other with no overlap –

כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן הוּא לַמָּטָה לְגִמְרִי מֵהָעֲלִיּוֹן שְׁעָלִיו.

every lower level is totally below the level above it.

עוֹלָם הַצְּמֻצוֹם וְהַקּוֹ שֶׁהוּא הָאָוִיר קִדְמוֹן וְהַטְּהִירוֹ עֲלָאָה הוּא לַמַּעְלָה מֵהָאָדָם קִדְמוֹן

Thus the World of the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, which is the *Avir Kadmon* and *Tehiru Ila'ah*, fully transcends Adam Kadmon,

וְאָדָם קִדְמוֹן הָעֶקְרִי הוּא לַמַּעְלָה לְגִמְרִי מֵהָאֲצִילוֹת

and the primary aspect of Adam Kadmon fully transcends Atzilut,

וְהָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא לַמַּעְלָה לְגִמְרִי מֵהַבְּרִיָּאָה וְהַבְּרִיָּאָה הוּא לַמַּעְלָה לְגִמְרִי מֵהַיְצִירָה

and Atzilut fully transcends Beriah, and Beriah fully transcends Yetzirah,

וְהַיְצִירָה הוּא לַמַּעְלָה לְגִמְרִי מֵעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה.

and Yetzirah fully transcends the World of Asiyah.

וְכָל אֵלּוּ הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם הֵרִי בְּאֶרְנוֹ לְעֵיל שַׁעַר ד'

And regarding all of these worlds, we explained in *Sha'ar 4*

כי הנה הם מהה' בחי' גלוייו ית"ש אשר נתפשט מגלוי לגלוי עד
סוף כל המציאות כלו

that they are from the five aspects of His revelations, which spread forth from
revelation to revelation to the end of all existence.

והרי הוו ה' גלויים כ"א זה למעלה מזה.

Thus there are five revelations and each of them is one above the other.

אמנם הוא כי הנה הם כלם מתפשטים ומתלבשים זב"ז בהארתם
עכ"פ.

Nevertheless, all of them spread forth and become clothed one in the other, at
least via their radiances.

כי הנה הגלוי הראשון שהוא גלוי ית"ש אשר בבחי' א"ס

Now from the first revelation, His revelation as *Ein Sof* i.e. the *Ohr Ein Sof*

הנה ממנו עצמו הרי נמשך הקו וכן כל בחי' הצמצום

from this is drawn the *kav* and all the aspects of the *tzimtzum*,

הרי אמרנו ששם הוא השרש דהשפעה וכח הנושא את כל העולמות
כלם

for as we said, that is where the root of the flow and power that sustains all of
the worlds.

ואותו השרש הנה הוא הרשימה אור שנשאר מאור א"ס שהיה שם
קדם שנסתלק

And that root is the *reshima* the trace of the light that remains from the *Ohr Ein Sof*
that was there prior to being removed from the *chalal* via the *tzimtzum*.

וכן הוא משפיע תמיד מאותו אור א"ס שלמעלה

It the *reshima* is continuously influenced by that same *Ohr Ein Sof* above

וקשור ומיוחד תמיד במקורו.

and is always bound to and united with its source.

והרי נמצא כי כל הקו וצמצום שהוא הגלוי השני

Thus it turns out that the entire *kav* and the *tzimtzum*, which constitute the
second revelation,

הנה כל מציאותו הוא הארת אור דאור א"ס עצמו שהוא הגלוי
הראשון.

its entire existence is the radiance of the *Ohr Ein Sof* itself, which is the first revelation.

וְהָרִי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט הַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּהִגְלִי הַשְּׁנִי לְעוֹלָם.

Hence the first revelation always irradiates the second one,

כִּי הָרִי כָּל הַקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁנִי

for the entire *kav* and *tzimtzum*, which constitute the second revelation,

הֵנָּה הִיא רֶק הַתְּפַשֻּׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶץ מְאֻרוֹ עֲצָמוֹ.

is merely the spreading out of a radiance from His light itself.

וְכֵן הוּא עַד"ז בְּהִגְלִי הַשְּׁנִי עִם הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא אָדָם קַדְמוֹן.

And similarly as regards the second revelation in relation to the third, which is Adam Kadmon,

כִּי הָרִי אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁכָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דֶּהָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן

for as we stated the entire existence of Adam Kadmon

הֵנָּה הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מֵהַקְּצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן דֶּהָקוֹ וּמִמֶּנּוּ נֶעֱשֶׂה כָּל מְצִיאוֹתָיו.

is drawn down and emerges from the bottom end of the *kav*, from which its entire existence is produced.

וְהֵנָּה עוֹמֵד הַקְּצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן דֶּהָקוֹ בְּהַא"ק לְעוֹלָם וּמִיחָד עִמּוֹ

Now the bottom end of the *kav* is always situated within A"K and is unified with it,

כְּשָׁרֵשׁ עִם הָאֵילָן וּמִשְׁפָּע מִמֶּנּוּ תָּמִיד.

like a tree-root to a tree which is continually nourished thereby.

וְהָרִי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ הַקוֹ שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁנִי בְּהָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי לְעוֹלָם.

Thus the *kav*, the second revelation, diffuses into Adam Kadmon, which is always the third revelation.

וְכֵן הוּא עַד"ז בַּא"ק עִם הָאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא הַגְּלוּי הָרְבִיעִי.

And similarly with A"K and Atzilut, which is the fourth revelation,

כִּי הָרִי אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁכָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא נִחְשָׁב לַחֲלָק מִמֶּנּוּ מִמָּשׁ

for as we said, the entire Atzilut is regarded as a part thereof of A"K

כִּי הוּא הַמְּצִיאוֹת אֲשֶׁר מֵהַטְּבוֹר וּלְמַטָּה שָׁבוּ,

– it is the existence that extends from the 'navel' of A"K and down –

וְנִחְשָׁבִים שְׁנֵיהֶם לְכָלְלוֹת פְּרָצוֹף אֶחָד

so that both of them are regarded as a single macro-partzuf:

זֶה מֵהַטְּבוֹר וְלִמְעָלָה וְזֶה מֵהַטְּבוֹר וְלִמְטָה וְכַנ"ל.

this one A"K from the 'navel' and above, and the other one Atzilut from the 'navel' on down.

וְכֵן הוּא עַד"ז ג"כ מֵהָאֲצִילוֹת לְהַעֲלֹמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁהֵם מְגֻלּוּיֵי הַחֲמִישִׁי

So too, in a similar manner from Atzilut to BiY"A, which comprise the fifth revelation.

כִּי הֵגַם שְׁאַמְרָנוּ שִׁישׁ מָסַךְ בֵּינֵיהֶם

For although we stated that there is a *masach* between them between Atzilut and BiY"A

אָמְנָם הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט הָאֶרֶת הַד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּאֲצִילוֹת

nevertheless, the four lowest *sefirot of malchut* of Atzilut spread forth

וַיּוֹרֵד דֶּרֶךְ הַמָּסַךְ וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַבְרִיָּאָה וְעוֹמֵד שָׁם לְעוֹלָם

and descend, via the *masach*, to become clothed in Beriah where it is always situated,

וְכַמ"ש בְּשַׁעַר כֶּסֶף הַכְּבוֹד סַפ"א וּבַכ"מ.

as stated explicitly in *Sha'ar Kisei HaKavod* end of chapter 1, and in a number of other places.

וְכֵן הוּא עַד"ז מֵהַבְרִיָּאָה לִיצִירָה, וּמִהִיצִירָה לַעֲשִׂיָּה

And so too, in a similar manner, from Beriah to Yetzirah, and from Yetzirah to Asiyah,

כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן מֵהַד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהָעֲלִיּוֹן.

for all lower levels are produced from the four lowest *sefirot of malchut* of the higher level,

וְנִמְשָׁךְ הָאֶרֶת הַד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהָעֲלִיּוֹן וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַתַּחְתּוֹן

and a radiance from the four lowest *sefirot* of the higher level diffuses into and becomes clothed in the lower level,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ לְעֶצֶם מְעַצְמִיו וּבָשָׂר מִבָּשָׂרוֹ,

becoming 'bone of its bone and flesh of its flesh'

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר עוֹד עֲנֵן הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת לְמִטָּה,

[this concept of *hitlavshut* – 'clothing' – will be explained more below]

ועי"ז הנה הם כלם קשורים ומיחדים זב"ז לעולם:

and in this way they are all bound together and united one with the other forever.

והרי נתבאר לנו מכ"ז כי כל העולמות כלם

From all this it has become clear that for all the worlds, without exception,

הנה עקרים הם זה למעלה מזה וזה למטה מזה

are arranged, in terms of their primary qualities, one above the other, and one below the other with no overlap,

שעקרו ומדרגתו דכל עליון הוא למעלה לגמרי מהתחתון.

so that the primary aspect and level of every higher world completely transcends the one below it.

אמנם הנה הם מתפשטים בהארצתם ומתלבשים זב"ז ונעשים עי"ז כלם אחד.

Nevertheless, their radiances extend outward and become clothed within one another, making all of them unified thereby,

כי כל המציאות דהתחתון וכל קיומו וחיותו ושפעו וכל עניניו הוא רק מההארה דכל עליון.

since the entire existence of the lower level, all of its continued survival, its animating force, its inflow, and all matters associated with it are merely from a radiance of the level above it.

והם כלם מקללות ה' גלוייו ית"ש אשר נתגלה בהם מאמתתו הנעלמה

And all of them stem from His five macro-revelations in which He is revealed in His true concealed Being,

וירד ומתפשט ממדרגה למדרגה שהוא מה שנמשך מגלוי לגלוי

which descends and spreads forth from level to level – i.e. what is drawn down from revelation to revelation –

מרום מעלה אשר בחביון עזו דאור א"ס ית"ש

from the very loftiest heights "there where His hidden strength is" (Habbakuk 3:4),

עד גלוי התחתון שבהעולמות בי"ע.

until His revelation below in the worlds of BiY" A.

ונמשך ומיחד אורו בכלם, ומזה הם נמצאים ונעשים,

He draws down and merges His light into all of them, and by virtue thereof they exist and are made,

אֶלָּא שְׂאוּרוֹ הַנִּמְשָׁךְ בָּהֶם הוּא בַּכ"א לְפִי מִדְרָגָתוֹ הָרְאוּי אֵלָיו,

except that His light is drawn into each of them into each World according to its proper level.¹⁵

אָבֵל עַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי אוּרוֹ נִמְשָׁךְ בְּכֻלָּם בְּאַחַדוֹת אֶחָד,

But nevertheless, His light is drawn into all of them in one unified stream

וְכֻלָּם תְּלוּיִם בְּאוּרוֹ וְעוֹמְדִים רַק עָלָיו.

and all of them are dependent upon His light continue to stand only by virtue thereof.¹⁶

כִּי בְּזֶה הוּא מְהִירָה הַכֹּל וּמְנַהִיג אֶת הַכֹּל וְעוֹשֶׂה אֶת כָּל הַמַּעֲשִׂים.

For in this way He brings everything into being and guides all things, and carries out all activities.

זֶהוּ שְׁנֵאמַר וַיִּדְעַת הַיּוֹם וְהַשַּׁבָּת אֶל לְבַבְךָ

This is the import of the statement in the verses (Deuteronomy 4:39) "You shall know this day and take to your heart

כִּי יְהוָה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים בְּשָׁמַיִם מִמַּעַל וְעַל הָאָרֶץ מִתַּחַת אֵין עוֹד,

that God is the Lord in heaven above and on earth below; there is none other."

שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד

"Hear O Israel, God our Lord, God is One (Deuteronomy 6:4)

בְּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ לְעֹלָם וָעֶד:

Blessed is the Name of His glorious Kingdom forever!¹⁷

Footnotes

1. Chapter 3 ff [↩](#)

2. Makover. [↩](#)

3. See *Mevo She'arim* 13a that each higher world is completely beyond the world below it. This is true as regards all three aspects – *makifim*, *igulim* and *yosher*. (*Meir HaLeshem*). [↩](#)

4. We have translated **מְקוֹם** here as 'sacred space,' to distinguish it from the usual translation as 'place,' which has only geographical connotations. [↩](#)

5. *Meir HaLeshem* (fn. 203) explains that this is the *reshimu* that remains after the *tzimtzum*, and each world that unfolds (as the *kav* descends) is sustained by a different aspect of the *reshimu*. [↩](#)

6. Pesach Hagadah, near the beginning. ↩
7. *Bereishit Rabba* chap 68:9 "He is the 'place' of the world, but His world is not His place" ↩
8. As noted above, *Meir HaLeshem* (fn. 203) explains that the *reshimu* that remains after the *tzimtzum* is what sustains the worlds, and each world that unfolds (as the *kav* descends) is sustained by a different aspect of the *reshimu*. ↩
9. This follows Maharsha's explanation, that the honor is Hashem's, not the Tzaddik's: according to the extent that Heaven became honored through the service of the Tzaddik in this world, will his reward be in the World-to-Come. ↩
10. Cf. *Mesilat Yesharim* chap. 4, 1 ↩
11. here is a word made from two other words – *piresh ziv*: פרשז
He spread His radiance – the radiance of the *Shechinah* –
↩ .over Moses
12. The Talmud is discussing a Beraita where R. Yose declares that the *Shechinah* never descended below (to the lower worlds), and Moshe and Eliyahu never ascended on high, based on the verse (Psalms 116:16): "The heavens are Hashem's, and the earth He gave to man" (implying that man never ascended to the heavens). The Talmud presents various Amoraim arguing against R. Yose's position, and his responses, including the one mentioned in the text above. ↩
13. See *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar 1, anaf 2*: ↩
14. This is rather puzzling, since the Arizal does not seem to explain it this way. See *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar 1 anaf 2* where he explains that the *kav* enters the *chalal* (the void) and then circles around the inner perimeter of the void, after which it circles again making another circle within the first one, and so on, until ten circles are complete. These are the ten sefirot of *iggulim* of *Adam Kadmon*. Accordingly, we have to assume that the author is referring to the *reishit hakav*, the first section of the *kav* before it enters the *chalal*. It is the bottom end of the *reishit hakav* that enters the *chalal*. ↩
15. Makover notes that this is the 'sacred space' of each world. ↩
16. This is the concept of the inter-inclusion of all the levels of light and their becoming clothed within one another (Makover). ↩
17. This declaration first appears in the *Mishnah*, *Yoma* 3:8. Makover notes that the *Shema* and *Baruch Shem* verses correspond to the higher and lower unity mentioned in *Zohar* I, 18b. ↩

Chapter 2 — Two aspects of illumination: the makif (transcendent, surrounding) and the penimi (inner, immanent light).

Two aspects that equal four.

Multidimensional Relationships

הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ הָאֶרֶץ כָּל אֹר עוֹלָם עָלְיוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן,

This 'clothing' (*hitlavshut*) that we mentioned, where a radiance of the light of the entire upper world clothes itself in the lower world

הֵנָּה פְּרִטְיָהֶם הֵם רַבִּים אֵין חֶקֶר, וְכֵמוּ שִׁיתְבָּאֵר שְׂרָשֵׁי הַפְּרָטִים
בְּזֶה בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ לְקֶמֶן.

– the details thereof are so numerous as to be unfathomable, as will be explained in our discussion of the origins of the details later on.

אֲךָ כָּלֹלוֹת הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הֵנָּה הֵם בְּבַחֲי שְׁתֵּים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע.

But in general the concept of *hitlavshut* is divided into 'two that are four.'¹

וְהַשְּׁתֵּים הוּא אֶחָד מִבְּפָנִים וְאֶחָד מִבְּחוּץ,

The two main categories are one from the inside and one from the outside. In *Mishnah* 'the inside' is the private domain, such as one's house, and 'the outside' is the public domain, such as the street or the market-place. Here, however, the author uses these terms for two types of illumination, as he will explain shortly.

וּבְכָל א' מֵהֶם הוּא בְּשֵׁתִי בָּחִי, אֶחָד לְפִי מִדְּרָגָתוֹ וְאֶחָד לְמַעַלָּה
מִמִּדְּרָגָתוֹ,

And each of them is sub-divided into two aspects: one, at its level; and the other, above its level.

וְהָרִי הֵם אַרְבַּע.

Thus they are four.

וְהַשְּׁתֵּים אֲשֶׁר מִבְּפָנִים וּמִבְּחוּץ הוּא,

The two main aspects – from inside and from outside are:

כִּי הֵנָּה בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם וְכֵן בְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף וּפְרָצוֹף,

in each world and in each spiritual profile (*partzuf*)

הֵנָּה יֵשׁ בּו' ב' מִיָּנִי אֹרוֹת כְּלָלִים אֶחָד אֹר פְּנִימִי שֶׁהוּא עוֹמֵד בּו'
מִבְּפָנִים לְהִגּוֹף,

there are two types of light in general: the inner illumination (*ohr pnimi*) that resides inside the body,

וְהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה פְּנִימִית שָׁבוּ,

this is the *neshama* the soul internalized within him,

וְאַחַד אֹר מְקִיף שְׂמִקִּיף עָלָיו מִבְּחוּץ.

and the other is the surrounding light (*ohr makif*) that envelops him from without.

וְאֵלּוּ הֵב' מִנִּי אֲוֵרוֹת הַנָּה מְשַׁרְשֵׁם הֵם אֶחָד,

Now these two types of light are one in their root,

כִּי בְּאֶשֶׁר נִכְנָס וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ אֹר עוֹלָם עָלָיו,

because when the light of the higher world enters and clothes itself in the lower world,

וְכֵן אֹר פְּרָצוּף עָלָיו בְּהַעֲלָם וְהַפְּרָצוּף שְׁלֵמָטָה מִמֶּנּוּ לְהַנִּשְׁמָה שָׁבוּ,

and similarly, when the light of the upper *partzuf* the spiritual profile clothes itself in the world and the *partzuf* below it, as the *neshama* soul within it,

הַנָּה נִחְלַק הָאֹר לִב' חֲלָקִים – חֶלֶק אֶחָד נִכְנָס וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ מִבְּפָנִים,

then the light is divided into two sections – one part enters into and is clothed inwardly,

וְחֶלֶק אֶחָד הַיּוֹתֵר גָּדוֹל הוּא נִשְׂאָר מִבְּחוּץ וּמְקִיפוֹ מִסְבִּיב.

and the other greater part remains outside it, enveloping it all around.

וּמִשּׁוּם שֶׁמְשַׁרְשֵׁם הֵם אֶחָד חֲשֵׁקָם הוּא תָּמִיד לְהִדְבֵּק זֶה בָּזֶה,

But because in their origin they these lights are one, their desire is always to cleave to one another,

וּמִשְׁלַח הַפְּנִימִי אֶת הָאֲרֵתוֹ מִבְּפָנִים לְחוּץ לְהִדְבֵּק עִם הָאֹר מְקִיף.

so the inner aspect (the *ohr pnimi*) sends its radiance from within to the outside to cleave to the enveloping light (the *ohr makif*),

וְהָאֹר מְקִיף מְשַׁלַּח אֶת הָאֲרֵתוֹ מִבְּחוּץ לְפָנִים לְהִדְבֵּק עִם הָאֹר פְּנִימִי,

and the *ohr makif* sends its radiance from outside inwards to cleave to the *ohr pnimi*.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְמַלֵּא כָּל הַגּוּף מֵאֹר הָעֲלִיּוֹן מִבֵּית וּמִבְּחוּץ

In this way, the entire body becomes filled with supernal light, inside and out.

וְהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה שָׁבוּ, וְנַעֲשֶׂה עַל יְדֵי זֶה כְּלוּ חֵי.

And this is the *neshama* the soul within them, by which it becomes fully alive.

וְהָרִי הֵם שְׁתֵּי בָחִי שֶׁמְתַלְבֵּשׁ כָּל עֲלִיוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

Thus there are two aspects of clothing of any upper in the lower:

אֶחָד אֹר פְּנִימִי וְאֶחָד אֹר מְקִיף, וְהֵם הַשְּׁתֵּים שְׁאֻמְרָנוּ.

one is the *ohr pnimi*, and the other is the *ohr makif*.

אָמְנָם כָּל אֶחָד מֵאלוֹ הֵנָּה הוּא נִחָלָק גַּם כֵּן לְב' וְהָרִי הוּא אַרְבַּע.

Nevertheless, each of them is subdivided into two, so that there are four aspects in total.

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי הֵתְלַבְּשׁוּת דְּכָל אֶחָד הֵנָּה הוּא בָב' בָּחִי,

That is to say, the enclothing of each of them is expressed in two aspects:

אֶחָד הוּא כִּי נִתְצַמָּצַם עַל יְדֵי יְרִידָתוֹ בַּמָּקוֹם הַתְּחַתּוֹן לְמִדְרַגַּת הַתְּחַתּוֹן עֲצֻמוֹ

1) The higher level becomes reduced due to its descent to the place of the lower level itself,

וּמִתְיַחַד עִמּוֹ בְּמִדְרַגָּתוֹ וְנַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ לַעֲצָם מַעֲצָמִיו וּבָשָׂר מִבָּשָׂרוֹ,

where it unites with the lower aspect on its level, becoming 'bone of its bone, and flesh of its flesh' as explained earlier.

וְהָרִי יוֹרֵד אוֹתוֹ הֵאָרָה מִמִּדְרַגָּתוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה

Thus, that radiance descends from its level above,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה לְמִדְרַגַּת הַתְּחַתּוֹן אֲשֶׁר לְמַטָּה.

and adjusts to the level of the lower aspect.

וְהַשְּׁנִי הוּא כִּי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ גַּם בְּהָאֶרֶת מִדְרַגָּתוֹ הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה גַּם כֵּן.

2) The higher level permeates and becomes clothed within it within the lower aspect together with the radiance of its own level – the higher level.

וְעוֹמֵד אוֹתוֹ הֵאָרָה בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן בְּמִדְרַגָּתוֹ הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה לְעוֹלָם

And that upper radiance as it is clothed in the lower level always maintains its superior level.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הֵנָּה נִתֵּן כֹּחַ וְאַפְשָׁרִית בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן לְזַכֵּךְ אֶת עַצְמוֹ

In this way it empowers and enables the lower level to refine itself

וּלְהִתְעַלֵּה גַּם הוּא לְמִדְרַגַּת הָעֲלִיוֹן.

and ascend to the rank of the higher level as well.

אֲמָנָם אוֹתוֹ הַחֶלֶק אוֹר אֲשֶׁר עוֹמֵד בְּהַתְּחַתּוֹן בְּמַדְרָגְתּוֹ הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה,

However, that aspect of the light that permeates the lower level while maintaining its own loftier rank

הֵנָּה הוּא אֵינוֹ עוֹמֵד בּוֹ בְּמַצָּב אֶחָד לְעוֹלָם,

does not remain in the same state forever,

כִּי לַפְּעָמִים נִתְעַלֵּם וְאֵינוֹ נִכָּר אוֹרוֹ כָּלֵל, שְׁאִינוֹ מִתְגַּלֶּה בְּהַתְּחַתּוֹן
מְאוּמָּה,

because sometimes its light becomes concealed and is not recognizable at all, since it does not become revealed at all in the lower level, i.e. in the terms of the lower level

וְעוֹמֵד אַז הַתְּחַתּוֹן עַל מַדְרָגְתּוֹ לְבַד.

so that the lower level then remains alone at its level and is not affected by the illumination hidden within it.

וּלְפְעָמִים הוּא מְאִיר בּוֹ וּמִתְגַּלֶּה וּמִתְעַלֶּה אַז הַתְּחַתּוֹן כָּלוּ עַל יָדוֹ.

But at other times the light of the higher level illuminates it the lower level and becomes revealed, and then all of the lower level ascends thereby.

וְהַגְּלוּי הַזֶּה הוּא אֵינוֹ בְּשַׁעוֹר קָצוֹב,

Now this illumination is not in a preset measure –

כִּי לַפְּעָמִים מִתְרַבֶּה וּלְפְעָמִים מִתְמַעֵט וְכֵן מִתְנַהֵג תָּמִיד בְּחֶסֶר
וְיִתֵּר,

at times it waxes and at other times it wanes. This is the manner of its conduct, always decreasing or increasing,

שֶׁלַּפְּעָמִים יִחְסַר וּלְפְעָמִים יַעֲדִיר,

so that sometimes it is depleted and at other times, brimming over.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִמְשָׁךְ תְּהִלּוֹכוֹת כָּל אֶחָד תָּמִיד בְּעוֹלָה וְיוֹרֵד,

In this way, the life-direction of each person unfolds, constantly ascending and descending,

כִּי הוּא תְּלִוֵי בְּזֶה, אִם שֶׁמִּתְעַלֵּם בּוֹ הָאוֹר הָעֲלִיּוֹן אוֹ שֶׁמִּתְגַּלֶּה
וּמְאִיר בּוֹ.

depending upon this: whether the supernal light is concealed within them, or whether it becomes revealed and illuminates them.

וְסִבַּת סְדְרֵי הַשְּׁנוּיִים הֵלְלוּ הוּא תְּלִוֵי גַם כֵּן בִּב' בְּחִי'.

And the reason for the sequences of these changes

כי לפעמים הוא על ידי מעשה התחתונים,

is that sometimes this comes about through the actions of those below,

כי כשהתחתונים הם זכאים אז מתגלה ומאיר בהם האור העליון

for when those below are worthy, then the supernal light is revealed and illuminates them,

ומתעלים הם וכל העולם כלו עמם.

and they ascend, together with the entire world.

וכשהתחתונים הם חייבים, אז מתעלם מהם האור העליון

And when those below are spiritually flawed, then the supernal light becomes concealed from them,

ויורדים הם וכן העולם כלו עמם.

and they sink down, dragging down with them the entire world.

אך לפעמים הנה נעשה כל השנויים הללו

But sometimes all of these changes take place

ומתנהג כל זה רק על פי כבשי דרחמנא.

in a manner that is kept a secret by the Merciful One,²

והוא בהנהגתו הנעלמה יתברך שמו המנהיג את הכל תמיד
לכוננתו התכליתית

Who, in His hidden Providence, guides everything always towards its ultimate purpose

אשר יתגלה בתכלית תקון האחרון.

that will be revealed at the completion of the final *tikun* (rectification)

presumably referring to the *tikun* that will take place before (or perhaps at the beginning of) the Messianic era. Ramchal³ explains that Moses will return then to rectify the *erev rav* (those who made the golden calf).

ונעלם סבת וטעם השנויים הללו מכל בריה.

But the cause of and reason for all these changes is concealed from every created being,

וכמו שנמצא מענינים הללו שאמר הקדוש ברוך הוא למשה רבנו
עליו השלום

just as we find regarding similar matters when the Holy One, blessed is He, said to Moshe when He questioned the need for so much suffering:

שתק כך עליה במחשבה לפני (מנחות כט, ב).

"Silent! It arose thus in thought before Me" (*Tractate Menachot 29b*)

וְכוֹן עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּמַדָּה טוֹבָה, וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְחִנַּנְתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אַחֲרָיו
וְרַחֲמֵתִי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אַרְחָם (בְּרָכוֹת ז, א)

A similar response applies to a benevolent quality, as it states "I will show grace to whom I choose to show grace, and I will be compassionate to those whom I choose to be compassionate" (*Berachot 7a*)

אֲף עַל פִּי שְׂאִינוּ כְּדָאֵי וְהִגּוּן לְכָךְ.

even if the person is not worthy thereof.

וְכוֹן אָמְרוּ שֵׁם עַל זֶה בְּשִׁמוֹת רַבָּה (סוֹף פְּרָשָׁה מ"ה): אוֹצֵר גָּדוֹל שֶׁל
מִתְּנַת חֲנָם יֵשׁ לוֹ לְהַקְדֹּשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא,

And similarly the Sages declare in Midrash *Shemot Rabba* (*parsha 45, end*): The Holy One, blessed be He, has a giant storehouse of free gifts

שְׁמִי שֶׁאֵין לוֹ בְּשִׁכְרוֹ עוֹשֶׂה לוֹ חֲנָם וְנוֹתֵן לוֹ מִזֶּה,

from which they give a free handout to a person who did not earn his reward.

וְנִעְשָׂה עֲנִיִּים כְּאֵלוֹ הַרְבֵּה תָּמִיד בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר,

Many such instances are found in every generation throughout time.

וְהֵם מִכַּבְּשֵׁי דִּרְחֻמָּא אֲשֶׁר נֶעְלָם סִבְתָּם מִכָּל בְּרִיָּה.

These are of the secrets of the Merciful One, the reasons for which are hidden from every created being.

וְכָל זֶה הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ וּבָא מֵהַחֶלֶק הָעֲלִיוֹן דֶּהֱתַלְבָּשׁוֹת הָאוֹר

And all of this is drawn down from and originates in the upper aspect of the clothing of the light.

אֲשֶׁר הוּא לֹא נִתְצַמָּצַם לְמַדְרַגַּת הַתַּחְתּוֹן כִּנְזָכָר, וְלָכֵן הוּא מִתְנַהֵג
לְמַעְלָה מִן הַמַּדָּה,

From the aspect that is not reduced to the level of the lower entity, as mentioned above, and therefore its conduct transcends limitations –

שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִכָּל הַחֻקִּים וְגִבּוּלִים דֶּהֱתַחְתּוֹן, כִּי הוּא כֹּלֵי רַק
מֵאוֹר שֶׁל מַעְלָה,

it surpasses the laws and limitations of the lower aspect, since it is entirely from the supernal light,

וְלָכֵן נֶעְלָם סִבְתָּם מֵהַתַּחְתּוֹן לְגִמְרִי.

which is why it remains completely concealed from the lower beings.

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר עַל כָּל פָּנִים כִּי הֵתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הָעֲלִיוֹן אֲשֶׁר בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן הִנֵּה
הוּא בְּשֵׁתִים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע.

Thus, in any event, we have explained that the 'enclothing' of the upper in the lower is 'two that are four' –

אֶחָד מִבְּפָנִים וְאֶחָד מִבַּחוּץ, וְהֵם אֹרֹךְ פָּנִימִי וְאֹרֹךְ מְקִיף
one from the inside, and one from the outside, i.e. the *ohr pnimi* and the *ohr makif*.

וְכָל אֶחָד מֵהֶם עֹמֵד בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן בִּב' בְּחִי',

And each of them manifests within the lower entity in two ways:

אֶחָד בְּצִמְצוּם וְאֶחָד שְׁלֵא בְּצִמְצוּם,
one where the light is reduced, and one where it is not reduced.

וּבִזְזָה הִנֵּה מִתְנַהֵּג כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן עַל יְדֵי הָעֲלִיוֹן.

In this manner every lower entity is steered by the higher aspect,

אִם בְּמִדָּה אִם לְמַעַלָּה מִן הַמִּדָּה וְכִנְזָפָר.
whether in a limited manner, or in an unlimited manner, as mentioned.

וְנִדְעָה הוּא שֶׁכָּל אֹרֹךְ וְנִשְׁמָה הִנֵּה הוּא מֵה' בְּחִי' נִרְנַח"י

Now, as is known, the light of every soul originates in one of the five aspects of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya* or *yechida*. These are five levels of soul or five levels of consciousness, regarding which the Arizal states: The five names of the soul (found in Scripture⁴) correspond to the five *partzufim* (spiritual profiles): *nefesh* corresponds to *malchut*; *ruach* to *tiferet*; *neshama* to *binah*; *chaya* to *chochmah*; *yechida* to *keter*.⁵

וְכֻלָּם הֵם בָּאִים וְנִמְשָׁכִים מִלְּמַעַלָּה.

All of them come from and are drawn down from above,

וּבְכָל אֶחָד הוּא הֵתְלַבְּשׁוֹת דְּשֵׁתִים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ. וְהֵם כ'
בְּחִי'.

and each of them is subject to **enclothing** in the manner of **two that are four** – two aspects of *ohr pnimi* and two aspects of *ohr makif* – as we stated. Thus there are **twenty aspects** in all.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי מֵה' שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הוּא בְּשֵׁתִים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע
הוּא רַק בְּכָלְלוֹת.

Thus it turns out that our statement that the modes of **enclothing** are 'two that are four' is only in a general sense,

אָבֵל בְּפִרְטוֹת הֵם מִתְפָּרְטִים לָךְ. וּבִאֲמַת כִּי הֵם מִתְרַבִּים לְפִרְטִים
אִין חֶקֶר,

but specifically they are subdivided into twenty. And in truth these multiply into
innumerable details,

וּכְמוֹ שִׁיתִּבְאָר קֶצֶת בְּזֶה לְקֶמֶן. אֲמַנָּם כִּבְר אֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל פֶּרֶק א',

as will be explained somewhat below. Nevertheless, we already stated in chapter
1 above

שֶׁכָּל הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת מֵהָעֲלִיוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן הֵנָּה הוּא רַק מֵהָאֶרֶץ הָעֲלִיוֹן

that all enclathing of the upper level in the lower is only in terms of the
radiance of the upper level

אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ מֵהַקְּצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שָׁבוּ.

that spreads out and is drawn down from its the upper level's lowest extremity.

זֶה לְבַד הוּא אֲשֶׁר מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן בְּמִצִּיאוֹתָיו וְקִיּוּמוֹ וְכָל
הַנְּהָגָתוֹ בְּנִזְכָּר,

And it is this alone that becomes clothed in the being and the sustained
existence and conduct of the lower level, as mentioned.

אָבֵל עָקְרוּ דָּכָל עוֹלָם עֲלִיוֹן וְכָל פְּרָצוֹף עֲלִיוֹן

Whereas the primary aspect of every higher world and supernal spiritual
profile (*partzuf*)

הֵנָּה הוּא לְמַעְלָה לְגִמְרֵי מֵהִתְחַתּוֹן כֻּלּוֹ וְכִנְזָכָר לְעֵיל פֶּרֶק א':

completely transcends the lower aspect, as explained in chapter 1.

Footnotes

1. This is a fairly common Talmudic expression of categorizing various items
Cf. *Mishnah Shvu'ot* 1:1; *Shabbat* 1:1 [↩](#)
2. See Tractate *Berachot* 10a (*Meir HaLeshem*). [↩](#)
3. See Ramchal's *Megillat S'tarim*, *Shiv'im panim* ch. 4. [↩](#)
4. See *Bereishit Rabba* 14:9. [↩](#)
5. *Eitz Chaim*, *Sha'ar* 6, chapter 5. [↩](#)

Chapter 3 — The enclothing and overlapping of the levels of the heikhalot (Divine palaces), physical bodies, and the neshama.

The matter of enclothing of levels.

A cosmic mystery.

הִנֵּה מָה שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל פ"ב מִהֶהֱתַלְבְּשׁוֹת הָעֲלִיּוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן

That which we stated above (chapter 2) regarding the upper level 'clothing' itself in the lower level

הוא אינו מהעליון הסמוך אליו לבד אלא שהוא מכל העליונים
כלם

applies not only to the upper level closest to the lower level, but to *all* levels above any lower level.

וְנִמְצָא שֶׁבְּכָל תַּחְתּוֹן מִתְרַבֶּה הֶהֱתַלְבְּשׁוֹת לְפִי עֶרֶךְ רַבּוּי הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים
שְׁעָלָיו

It turns out that regarding any lower level – the *hitlavshut* (enclothing) increases the more levels there are above it,

שֶׁכֵּל מִי שֶׁהוא יוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן מִתְרַבֶּה בּוֹ הֶהֱתַלְבְּשׁוֹת

so that the lowest level is subject to multiple degrees of *hitlavshut*,

כִּי מִסְפַּר הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים שְׁעָלָיו הֵרִי הוא יוֹתֵר מְרַבֶּה.

since the number of levels above it is the maximum with all the preceding levels enveloping and enclothing the lowest level, as will be explained.

וְכֵן הוא עוֹד כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל עוֹלָם וְכָל פְּרָצוֹף הֵרִי הוא מְסַדֵּר מְפָרְטִים
רַבִּים אִין חֶקֶר

Furthermore, this is also because every World and every *partzuf* comprises innumerable details,

וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ כָּל עֲלִיּוֹן וְכֵן כָּל הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים כֻּלָּם בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן מִכָּל הַפְּרָטִים
כֻּלָּם שֶׁבְּכָל אֶחָד

and when a higher level, as well as all the higher levels above it, become clothed in a lower level, together with all the details of all of them all the levels above that lower level,

וְכָלּוֹל כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן מִכָּל הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים כֻּלָּם מִכָּל פְּרָטֵיהֶם.

then every lower level includes in itself all the higher levels with all of their details.

וּנְבָאָר הַדָּבָר בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלָל כִּי הַפְּרָטִים עֲצָמָם הֵרִי הֵם רַבּוֹ לֵאמֹר מִסְפָּר.

Let us explain this in a general sense, since the details themselves are innumerable and cannot be described specifically.

אֲךָ בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלָל הֵנָּה הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה בְּנִין כָּל עוֹלָם הוּא מִיָּסֵד עַל שְׁנֵי דְבָרִים

In general the structure of each world is based on two things –

הֵיִינוּ הָאָדָם וְהָעוֹלָם.

the person and the World.

וּבִפְרָטוֹת הֵנָּה הֵם ד' – הֵיִינוּ הַיְכָלוֹת וּלְבוּשִׁים וְגוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת.

More specifically, there are four aspects: chambers, garments, bodies and souls.

וְהַיְכָלוֹת הוּא בְּבַחֲי' הַבְּתִים שֶׁהָאָדָם יוֹשֵׁב בְּתוֹכָם.

'Chambers' or *heichalot* are like the houses in which people live in the sense that they are the broadest and most inclusive category. Perhaps we can refer to this in more modern terminology as "the situational context."

וּבְכָלֵל הָעוֹלָם הֵנָּה הֵם הַד' יְסוּדוֹת – אֵשׁ, רוּחַ, מַיִם, עָפָר – שֶׁהֵם הַד' יְסוּדוֹת הַתַּחְתּוֹנִים

In a general sense, in the world these are the four elemental properties – fire, air, water and earth. These are the four lower elemental properties or foundations.

These four foundational properties described in medieval metaphysics seem to be of a more theoretical and classificatory nature than actual physical elements in the modern sense. In more current terminology perhaps we could say that the element of 'fire' is equivalent to temperature; 'air' – perhaps a synonym for pressure; 'water' – viscosity; and earth – density. All of them are properties of substances rather than elements comprising the substances.

וְכֹן כָּל הַגִּלְגָּלִים כֻּלָּם שֶׁהֵם נִכְלָלִים גַּם כֵּן בְּד' וְהֵם הַד' יְסוּדוֹת הָעֲלִיוֹנִים

Similarly, all the *galgalim* often translated as 'spheres' or 'orbits' are also categorized into four – these are the four elements in a supernal sense.

The 'spheres' or 'orbits' seem to represent a basic method of classification, and therefore they are called 'orbits' in terms of their inclusivity – what they surround and include within themselves. However, elsewhere they are described as living, conscious entities of some sort, as Maimonides states in *Yesodei haTorah* (the first section of his magnum opus, *Mishneh Torah*) 3:9 – "the spheres possess a soul, knowledge, and intellect. They are alive and stand in recognition of the One who spoke and [thus brought] the world into being. According to their rank and status

each one praises and glorifies their Creator ..." They are not to be confused with *sefirot*.

וְכָל זֶה הֵם בְּבַחֲי הַיְכָלוֹת וּבִתִּים שֶׁהָאָדָם יוֹשֵׁב בְּתוֹכָם

All the above are the category of *heichalot* 'chambers' and houses similar to those in which a person dwells, or "the situational context."

וְהֵנָּה הֵם כָּלֵם עֲגָלִים כִּי גַם הַד' יְסֻדוֹת – אֵשׁ, רוּחַ, מַיִם, עָפָר –
הַתְּחִתּוֹנִים

All of them are 'circular' in the sense that they encompass the properties of whatever they circumscribe. Even the four elemental properties of fire, air, water and earth of this material world

הֵם גַּם כֵּן עֲגָלִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּם ז"ל בִּיסוּדֵי הַתּוֹרָה פ"ג סִימָן
י'

are also 'circular,' as Rambam writes in *Mishneh Torah, Yesodei haTorah 3:10.*

וְהֵנָּה הֵם הַיְכָלוֹת שֶׁהוּא כָּלֵל הָעוֹלָם

And these are the *heichalot* which include the entire world within them.

וְכֵן יִשְׁנָם עֲגָלִים שֶׁהֵם הַיְכָלוֹת לְכָל פְּרָצוֹף וּפְרָצוֹף בִּפְנֵי עֲצָמוֹ וְהוּא
בְּחִי אַחַת.

Similarly, there are *igulim* concentric spiritual orbits which are the *heichalot* for each *partzuf* individually. This is all the first aspect.

בְּחִי ב' הוּא הַלְבוּשִׁים.

The second aspect of the classification mentioned at the beginning of this chapter (chambers, garments, bodies and souls) is 'garments.'

וְהֵנָּה הֵם הָאוֹרוֹת מְקִיפִים אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁנָם לְכָל פְּרָצוֹף וּפְרָצוֹף כֵּן ל"פ ב'
וַיִּתְּבָא עוֹד עֲנִין הַמְּקִיפִים לְקִמּוֹן שַׁעַר ו'.

These are the 'encompassing lights' *makifim* from here on associated with each and every *partzuf*, as mentioned above in chapter 2. These will be explained further in *Sha'ar 6*.

The 'encompassing lights' are Divine emanations or illuminations of an order that cannot be confined within limited creatures. Thus are said to encompass or envelop them in a pervasive and transcendent manner, as the author will explain.

וְהָאוֹרוֹת מְקִיפִים הֵם מִבְּחוּץ לַהֲגוּף וְאֵינָם דְּבוּק עִמּוֹ כֹּךְ וְלָכֵן
הֵם בְּבַחֲינַת לְבוּשִׁים.

These lights envelop the body i.e. the entities they 'adorn' from the outside, and are not so close-fitting so to speak. Therefore they are called 'garments.'

ואחר כך הוא הגוף עם הנשמה שהוא עקר האדם והפרצוף

Next in the classification system mentioned above **is the body, together with the soul neshama which is the primary aspect of a person and a partzuf.**

והרי הם ד' בחי' היכלות ולבושים וגופות ונשמות.

****Thus there are four aspects altogether – chambers–*heichalot*, garments–*levushim*, bodies–**gufim* and souls–*neshamot*.**

והנה אלו הד' בחי' הם שתיים כנגד שתיים

Now these four aspects are arranged in parallel pairs:

כי הגופות עם הנשמות הרי הם מחברים ומיוחדים זה בזה –

bodies and souls are connected and unified one with the other –

שהנשמות הוא בתוך הגופים והם אחד.

souls within bodies form a single entity;

וכן הוא על דרך זה הלבושים שהם האור מקיף עם ההיכלות

****and similarly with garments–**levushim* which are encompassing light – and *heichalot***

שהם העגלים הם גם כן מחברים יחד.

which are the *igulim*. They too are connected,

כי האור מקיף הוא עומד לעולם בתוך העגלים – האור מקיף
מבפנים והעגלים מבחוץ.

since the encompassing light is always situated within the system of *igulim* – the encompassing light inside them, and the *igulim* surrounding them on the outside.

והם שניהם מקיפים ומסבבים על הגוף ונשמה של האדם מבחוץ

And these latter two encompass and surround the body and the soul of a person on the outside,

ואינם דבוקים עמו ממש כי אורם הוא גדול

and are not closely fitted to him, since their light is abundant,

ואינם מאירים להגוף אלא רק לאט לאט ובהדרגה גדולה

and they do not illuminate the body other than to a very small degree, and even that in many gradations, depending on the spiritual status of the recipient.

וכדי שלא יתבטל הגוף ממציאותו המכרך לו.

All of this is so that the body will not become nullified in the existence it needs in order to continue to exist.

וְכָל זֶה הֵנָּה הוּא בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם

This is true of every World –

שְׁכָל עוֹלָם הִיא כָּלּוּל מֵהִיכָלוֹת וּלְבוּשִׁים וְגוֹפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת

each World comprises chambers, garments, bodies and souls.

וְכֵן עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בִּפְרָטִי כָּל פְּרָצוּף שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם

And so too, with each individual *partzuf* in each World –

הֵנָּה כָּלּוּל כָּל פְּרָצוּף מֵאַלּוֹ הַד' בְּחִינּוֹת

each *partzuf* is endowed with these four aspects,

וּבָהֶם מְתַלְבֵּשׁ כָּל פְּרָצוּף עָלְיוֹן בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן וְכֵן כָּל עוֹלָם עָלְיוֹן
בְּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

and by way thereof, every higher *partzuf* clothes itself in the lower *partzuf*, and every higher World in a lower World.

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט הָאָרֶז מֵהִיכָלוֹת דִּהְעָלְיוֹן שֶׁהוּא מֵהֶעֱגָלִים
שָׁבוּ¹

Meaning to say, from the *heichalot* of the upper level, from its *igulim*, a radiance spreads forth

וּמִלְבִּישׁ עַל הֵהִיכָלוֹת דִּהִתְחַתּוֹן בְּהִשְׁתִּי בְּחִינּוֹת הַנ"ל פ"ב

and garbs both aspects of the *heichalot* of the lower level mentioned above in chapter 2 –

שֶׁהוּא אֶחָד בְּמִדְרָגָתוֹ וְאַחַת לְמַעַלָּה מִמִּדְרָגָתוֹ.

one at its level i.e. the level of the lower world, and one above its level.

וְכֵן מִתְפַּשֵּׁט עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה הָאָרֶז הַלְבוּשִׁים דִּהְעָלְיוֹן שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹרוֹת
מְקִיפִים שָׁבוּ

In addition, and in a similar manner, the radiance of the upper garment, i.e. the *makifim* thereof, unfurl

וּמִלְבִּישׁ עַל הָאוֹר מְקִיף דִּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

and clothe the encompassing light of the lower level.

וְכֵן מִתְפַּשֵּׁט תַּמְצִית וְהָאָרֶז מֵהִיכָלוֹת דִּהְעָלְיוֹן וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהִיכָלוֹת
דִּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

Similarly, a distillation of the light and radiance from the bodies of the higher entities percolate down to become clothed in the bodies of the lower entities.

וְכֵן הָאָרֶז מֵהִנְשָׁמוֹת דִּהְעָלְיוֹן בְּהִנְשָׁמוֹת דִּהִתְחַתּוֹן.

So too, a radiance from the souls of the upper level illuminates the souls of the lower level.

וסדר עמידתם דאותן ההתלבשות

The order in which the *hitlavshut* enclathing is established

הנה הוא על דרך סדר עמידתן דהמציאות העקרי שבהם

replicates the manner in which their primary existential qualities were set in order.

כי כמו שאמרנו דכל אותן הד' בחי' שבכל אחד עצמו

Because just as we stated that all four aspects in each individual

עומד הגוף והנשמה מבפנים וההיכלות והלבושים מבחוץ.

are arranged in a manner that the body and the soul are internal, and the *heichalot* and garments are external,

כן הוא על דרך זה ההתלבשות דהעליון אשר בהתחתון

so too, regarding the garbing of the upper upon the lower,

הנה עומד ההתלבשות בהארת הלבושים והיכלות דהעליון

the radiance of the garments and the *heichalot* of the upper level garb

מבחוץ להלבושים וההיכלות דהתחתון.

the garments and the *heichalot* of the lower level externally.

וההתלבשות דהארת הגופות והנשמות דהעליון

And the radiance of the bodies and souls of the upper level are vested

הם עומדים מבפנים להגופות והנשמות דהתחתון.

internally, within the bodies and souls of the lower level.

ונמצא כי כל תחתון הוא מקר מהעליון

Thus it turns out that each lower level is enveloped by the upper level

על ידי הארת הלבושים וההיכלות שבו

via the radiance of its the upper level's garments and *heichalot*

כי הם מקיפים ומסבבים על ההיכלות והלבושים דהתחתון

which envelop and surround the *heichalot* and the garments of the lower level,

ונעשים ללבושים והיכלות אליו.

and become its garments and *heichalot* since it is via them that the upper level envelops the lower.

וכן תחתון הוא מקיף להעליון מצד ההארות דהגופות ונשמות
דהעליון שעומדין בפנימיותו

In addition, the lower level also envelops the higher level in terms of the
radiance of the bodies and souls of the upper level that are vested within it.

והרי כלול כל תחתון בתוך ההארות דהעליון שהם עומדים עליו

Thus every lower level is incorporated into the radiances of the upper level that
supersedes it,

ומאיריו בו מבית ומבחוץ.

and which illuminates it internally and externally.

כי רק על ידי זה הוא כל מציאותו וקיומו וכל תהלוכותיו כנ"ל.

For it is only in this manner that it continues to exist and thrive and develop.

והנה אמרנו שהתלבשות הוא אינו מהעליון שעליו לבד

Now we stated previously that this process of enclothing the lower level is not
only regarding the level immediately above,

אלא שהוא מכל העליונים כלם, ומכלם הוא על דרך שאמרנו.

but rather regarding all the preceding levels, and all operate in the same manner
as we expressed.

ונבאר הדבר בפרטיות בעולם העשיה משום שהוא האחרון לכלם

Let's illustrate this in the World of Asiyah, since it is the final World,

והוא ההתלבשות בו ביותר מכלם,

and the enclothing is more there than anywhere else.

לכן נבאר בו וממילא יובן על כל העולמות שלמעלה.

Therefore, by explaining it the World of Asiyah, all the Worlds above it will be
understood automatically.

הנה עולם העשיה אשר הוא למטה מכל העולמות כלם הנה הוא
כלול מכלם,

Now the World of Asiyah, which is the lowest of all the worlds, is comprised of
all of them –

שכל העולמות העליונים אשר למעלה למעלה הנה כלם כלולים
בו

because all of the higher Worlds, even the very highest – are included therein in
Asiyah.

כי לעולם הוא שכל תחתון הוא כלול מכל העליונים שעליו.

For it is always the case that every lower level includes some aspect of all the higher levels above it,

שְׁכָל הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים אֲשֶׁר עָלָיו הָגֵם שֶׁהֵם לְמַעַלָּה לְגַמְרִי

so that all the higher levels above it – even though they completely transcend it

–

עַל כָּל פָּנִים הֵנָּה הֵם מִתְפַּשְׁטִים בּוֹ בְּהֶאֱרָתָם בְּפָנִימִיּוּתוֹ

nevertheless percolate down into it by way of their radiances that are absorbed within it.

וְכֹן מְסַבְּבִים וּמְקִיפִים אוֹתוֹ בְּהֶאֱרָתָם בְּחִיצוֹנִיּוּתוֹ.

In addition, radiances from above surround and envelop it externally.

וְעוֹמֵד כָּל תַּחְתּוֹנוֹ וְרַק בְּכֹחַ וְהֶאֱרָת כָּל הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים הַמְשַׁפְּיעִים בּוֹ

Thus every lower level endures only by virtue of the power and radiance that flow down from the higher levels,

וּמְאִירִים עָלָיו מִבֵּית וּמִבְחוּץ.

illuminating it the lower level from within and from without.

וְהֵנָּה עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה אֲשֶׁר מְקוֹמוֹ הוּא לְמַטָּה לְגַמְרִי מְעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה
וְכַנֶּ"ל פ"א

Now the World of Asiyah, which is situated entirely below the World of Yetzirah, i.e. with no actual overlap, as mentioned above in chapter 1,

וְהֵנָּה הוּא מִיָּסֵד וּמִסֻּדָּר מִד' בְּחִי' שֶׁהֵם הַיְכָלוֹת וּלְבוּשִׁים וְגוֹפוֹת
וְנִשְׁמוֹת.

is based on, and arranged according to, the four aspects mentioned earlier – chambers, garments, bodies and souls.

וְהַגּוֹפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת הֵם מִבְּפָנִים וְהַיְכָלוֹת וּלְבוּשִׁים הֵם מִבְּחוּץ
וְכַנֶּזֶר.

The effects of bodies and souls are internal, whereas the effects of chambers and garments are external.

וְהֵנָּה בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוֹפוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דִּהְעֲשִׂיָּה בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָם

Now within the bodies and souls of Asiyah, internally,

הֵנָּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ שֵׁם הָאֶרֶת הַגּוֹפוֹת וְהַנִּשְׁמוֹת דְּכָל הַיְצִירָה
כָּלָה

the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Yetzirah percolates down and become vested within Asiyah, internally.

וּבְתוֹכָם עוֹמֵד הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹת דֶּהֱאֶרֶת הַגּוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דְּכָל הַבְּרִיאָה
כָּלָה

And within them within the bodies and souls of Yetzirah **the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Beriah percolates down and becomes vested in** Yetzirah.

וּבְתוֹכָם עוֹמֵד הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת הַגּוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דְּכָל הָאֲצִילוֹת כָּלוּ

And within them within the bodies and souls of Beriah **the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Atzilut percolate down and become vested in** Beriah.

וּבְתוֹכָם עוֹמֵד הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת בְּחֵי' הַגּוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן
כָּלוּ

And within them within the bodies and souls of Atzilut **the radiance of the bodies and souls of the entire Adam Kadmon** (abbreviated as A"K) **percolate down and become vested in** Atzilut.

וּבְתוֹכָם עוֹמֵד הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת מְאוֹר הַקּוֹ דְּאִין סוֹף

And within them within the bodies and souls of A"K **a radiance from the light of the kav and the Ein Sof,**

הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמְאִיר בְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם עַל יְדֵי הָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן
וְהָאֲצִילוֹת.

percolates down and illuminates all of the worlds by way of A"K and Atzilut.

וְהָרִי נִמָּצָא כִּי כָל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הֵגֵם שֶׁהִיא בְּכָלֶּה לְמַטָּה לְגַמְרִי
מִכָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם

So it turns out that the entire World of Asiyah, albeit in general completely below all the Worlds,

וּמְקוֹמָהּ הוּא מִתַּחַת סִיוָם עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה לְגַמְרִי,

being that it is situated well below the bottom of the World of Yetzirah,

עַל כָּל פָּנִים הִנֵּה כָּלוּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה בְּתוֹכָהּ וּבְפִנְיֶיהָ

nevertheless, the World of Asiyah includes within itself, internally,

מִכָּל הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת דְּכָל הָעֲלִיוֹנִים כָּלָם אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה
עַד אִין סוֹף יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ.

all of the radiance of all the upper levels to the very highest rank – until the Infinite One, blessed is His Name.

כִּי יוֹרֵד הָאֶרֶת דְּכָל עֲלִיוֹן עַל יְדֵי הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹתוֹ בְּהָעוֹלָם שֶׁתַּחְתָּיו

This is because the radiance of the upper level descends by diffusing its light into the World below it,

וְיורדים על דרך זה מעולם לעולם עד שמתפשט ומתלבש הארת כלם גם בעשיה.

and in this way it descends from World to World, until a radiance from all of them extends into and becomes vested in Asiyah.

כי רק על ידי זה נעשה כל מציאותה ורק מזה היא מתקיים ומתנהג תמיד:

Because it is only in this manner that Asiyah comes into existence, and only in this fashion does it endure and is it constantly guided.

אמנם פשוט הדבר כי הגם שאמרנו שמתפשט ומתלבש בה

It is obvious that although we stated that percolating down and becoming clothed in it in Asiyah

ההארות דכל העליונים כלם על כל פנים הנה אינם שווים בה,

are the radiances of all the upper levels, nevertheless, they are not evenly distributed therein –

כי אינו דומה ההארה אשר מתפשט בה מהיצירה והבריאה

since the radiance of Yetzirah or Beriah that extends into it into Asiyah is not the same as

לההארה אשר מתפשט בה מהאצילות ואדם קדמון.

the radiance of Atzilut and A"K that extend into it.

כי כל היותר עליון מתמעט בהארתו בה ואינו מתפשט בה

Because the higher the level from which the radiance emerges the more its radiance is reduced, and the less it percolates down into it,

אלא רק בהארה ממעט מאד עד שמתעלם בה ואינו נפר בה כלל.

other than as a greatly diminished radiance that becomes concealed within it within Asiyah and is not recognizable in it at all.

אך על כל פנים הנה אותה המעט ממנו נחשב בה לרב והוא עקר כח מציאותה וקיומה.

Nevertheless, the slight radiance thereof of A"K and Atzilut is regarded as the primary power energizing her Asiyah's existence and continuity.

והרי מתפשטים בה הארת כלם על כל פנים:

In any event the radiance of all levels percolate down into it into Asiyah.

וְהִנֵּה עַל דֶּרֶךְ שְׁאֻמְרָנוּ בְּהִתְפָּשְׁטוֹת הָאֲרוֹת דְּאוֹרוֹת הַגּוֹפּוֹת
וְהַנְּשָׁמוֹת

Now in the same manner in which we explained the spreading forth of the
radiances of the bodies and souls

דְּכָל הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים כָּלָם הַמִּתְפָּשְׁטִים וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה
of all the higher levels that percolate down to become clothed in the World of
Asiyah,

בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָהּ וּבְפָנִימִיּוּת פְּנִימִיּוּתָהּ
internally, and in the inner aspects of its interior,

כֵּן הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּהִתְפָּשְׁטוֹת הָאֲרוֹת דְּאוֹרוֹת הַהִיכָלוֹת שֶׁהֵם
הָעֲגָלִים

so too, regarding the spreading forth of the radiances of the light of the
"chambers" which we referred to earlier as "the situational context," which are the
igulim,

וְדְאוֹרוֹת הַלְּבוּשִׁים שֶׁהֵם הַמְּקִיפִים
and the lights of the 'garments,' which are the *makifim*:

הִנֵּה מִתְפָּשְׁטִים גַּם כֵּן בְּהֶאָרְתָּם בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה מִכָּל הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים
כָּלָם

the radiances from all of the upper levels also spread downwards upon the
World of Asiyah.

אָלָא שֶׁסֹּדֵר עֲמִידָתָם הוּא לְהִפְךָ מֵהָאֶרֶת הָאוֹרוֹת וְהַגּוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת.
However, the order in which they are arranged is the opposite of the radiance of
the lights of bodies and souls,

כִּי הָאֶרֶת הָאוֹרוֹת וְהַגּוֹפּוֹת וְנִשְׁמוֹת הֵם מִתְפָּשְׁטִים וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים
מִבְּפָנִים.

since the radiance of the lights of bodies and souls percolate down and are
absorbed internally within Asiyah,

אָבֵל הָאֶרֶת הָאוֹרוֹת וְהָעֲגָלִים וְהַמְּקִיפִים
whereas the radiance of the lights of the *igulim* and the *makifim* of the higher
Worlds

הִנֵּה הֵם מִתְפָּשְׁטִים וּמִסְבָּבִים וּמְקִיפִים מִבְּחוּץ לְהָעֲגוּלִים דְּהָעֲשִׂיָּה
spread forth and envelop and surround the *igulim* of Asiyah

וְהֵם כּוֹלְלִים אֶת כָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה בְּתוֹכָם.

and thus subsume the entire World of Asiyah within them.

כִּי מִחוּץ לְהַלְבוּשִׁים וְהַיְכָלוֹת שֶׁהֵם הָעִגְלִים וְהַמְּקִיפִים דִּהְעֵשְׂיָה
עֲצָמָה

Now besides the garments and the chambers, which are the *igulim* and the *makifim* of Asiyah itself,

הִנֵּה יוֹרֵד הָאֶרֶת הָאֹר הַמְּקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים דְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה

a radiance of the light of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Yetzirah
also descend –

וְיוֹרְדִים מִמְּקוֹמָם וּמִתַּפְשָׁטִים וּמִלְבִּישִׁים

coming down from their place and spreading down and enveloping

עַל הָעִגְלִים וְהַמְּקִיפִים הָעֹקְרִים דְּעוֹלָם הָעֵשְׂיָה

the primary *igulim* and the *makifim* of the World of Asiyah itself,

וּמְקִיפִים וּמְסַבִּים עֲלֵיהֶם מִבְּחוּץ וְכוֹלְלִים אֶת כָּל הָעֵשְׂיָה בְּתוֹכָם.

enveloping and surrounding them externally i.e. they are not internalized *within* the *igulim* of Asiyah. Instead, the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Yetzirah include the entire Asiyah within *them*.

וּמִחוּץ לָהֶם הִנֵּה עוֹמֵד וּמְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹת הָאֶרֶת דִּהְמְקִיפִים
וְהָעִגְלִים דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה.

And outside of them i.e. above the lights of Yetzirah, the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Beriah encompass and surround them.

אֲשֶׁר יָרְדוּ מִמְּקוֹמָם וְהַתַּפְשָׁטוֹ בְּהָאֶרֶתָם לְהַקִּיף וּלְסַבֵּב

These *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Beriah descended from their place in Beriah and their radiance spread forth to encompass and surround

עַל הַמְּקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים הָעֹקְרִים דְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה בְּמְקוֹמָם.

the *makifim* and the *igulim* of the World of Yetzirah in their place i.e. as they are in Yetzirah.

הִנֵּה יוֹרֵד הָאֶרֶה מֵהָאֶרֶתָם עִם הָאֶרֶת הַמְּקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים דִּהְיְצִירָה
בְּיַחַד,

Now a radiance of the radiance of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Beriah descends, together with a radiance of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Yetzirah,

וְיוֹרְדִים הֵם גַּם כֵּן בְּמְקוֹם עוֹלָם הָעֵשְׂיָה.

they both descend into the space of the World of Asiyah.

וְהֵם מְקִיפִים וּמְסַבְּבִים עַל הָהָאָרָה דְּהַמְקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים דְּעוֹלָם
הַיְצִירָה

And they envelop and surround the radiance of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Yetzirah

הַמְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב עַל הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים הָעֲקָרִיִּים דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה עֲצֻמָּה.

which in turn envelop and surround the primary *makifim* and the *igulim* of Asiyah itself.

וְהָרִי נִכְלָל כָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה בְּתוֹךְ הָהָאָרוֹת דְּהַמְקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים
דְּהַיְצִירָה וְדְּבְרִיָּאָה.

Thus the entire World of Asiyah is subsumed within the radiances of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Yetzirah and Beriah.

וּמִחוּץ לָהֶם הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְעוֹמֵד הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת הָאָרוֹת דְּהַמְקִיפִים
וְהָעִגְלִים דְּעוֹלָם הָאֲצִילוֹת

And outside i.e. above them, the radiances of the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Atzilut spread out

וְהֵינּוּ מֵאוֹתָן הָהָאָרוֹת דְּהָאֲצִילוֹת אֲשֶׁר יָרְדוּ מִמְּקוֹמָם

– i.e. of those radiances of Atzilut that descended from their place

וְהַתְּפִשְׁטוֹ בְּהָאֲרָתָם לְהִקְיָא וּלְסַבֵּב עַל הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים דְּעוֹלָם
הַבְּרִיָּאָה,

and radiate down to envelop and surround the *makifim* and the *igulim* of Beriah

–

וְעַתָּה הִנֵּה יוֹרֵד הָאָרָה מֵהֶם עַל יְדֵי הָאָרֶת הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים
דְּהַבְּרִיָּאָה וְהַיְצִירָה,

their radiance descends from them via the radiances of the *makifim* and *igulim* of Beriah and Yetzirah,

לְהִקְיָא וּלְסַבֵּב עַל הָעִגְלִים וְהַמְקִיפִים הָעֲקָרִיִּים דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה

to envelop and surround the primary *igulim* and *makifim* of Asiyah,

וְעוֹמְדִים הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה מִבְּפָנִים.

so that the *makifim* and *igulim* of Asiyah are situated within at the center of all the *igulim*,

וְעַלֵּיהֶם וּמִבְּחוּץ לָהֶם הִנֵּה מְקִיף וּמְסַבֵּב הָאָרֶת הַמְקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים
דְּכָל הַיְצִירָה כְּלָה;

and above them, outside of them, is the radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire Yetzirah;

ועליהם ומבחוץ להם מקיף ומסבב ההארה דהארה דהמקיפים
והעגלים דכל הבריאה כלה;

and above *them* i.e. above the *makifim* and *igulim* of Yetzirah and Asiyah, **outside of them, is the radiance of the radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire Beriah;**

ועליהם ומבחוץ מקיף ומסבב

and above *them* i.e. above the *makifim* and *igulim* of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, **outside of them, enveloping and surrounding them all,**

התפשטות הארה דהארה דהמקיפים והעגלים דכל האצילות כלו.
a radiance of a radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire Atzilut spreads forth.

וכן עליהם ומבחוץ הנה מקיף ומסבב גם כן התפשטות הארה
דהארה

Similarly, above *them* i.e. above the *makifim* and *igulim* of Atzilut Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, **externally, enveloping and surrounding them all, a radiance of a radiance spreads forth**

דהמקיפים והעגלים דכל אדם קדמון כלו ונכללו כלם בתוכו.
from the *makifim* and *igulim* of the entire A"K, so that all the *makifim* and *igulim* of all the Worlds are subsumed into it.

ועליהם ועל כלם הנה מקיף ומסבב אור אין סוף שהוא הגלוי
הראשון הנ"ל שער ד' פ"ג

And above all of *them*, enveloping and surrounding all of them, is the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the very first revelation, as mentioned above *Shaar 4* chapter 3,

שהוא למעלה מהכל ומקיף ומסבב את כל.

since the *Ohr Ein Sof* transcends everything and envelops and surrounds everything,

כי כל העולמות כלם הם עומדים כלם בתוכו שהוא בחלל
הצמצום שבתוכו

so that all of the Worlds are subsumed within it, in the *chalal* the void caused by the *tzimtzum* i.e. the contraction within the *Ohr Ein Sof*.

והוא מקיף את כלם והם כלולים בו ותלויים ועומדים בשפעו
ואורו תמיד.

And the *Ohr Ein Sof* encompasses them all, so that all of them are subsumed within it and all are dependent upon Him and always endure only by way of His outflow of life-force and light.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הֵגֶם שֶׁהִיא בְּאֵמֶת לְמַטָּה וּמִתְחַתִּית
כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם

Thus it turns out that the World of Asiyah, although it is indeed down below, lower than all the other Worlds,

עַל כָּל פָּנִים הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשְׁטִים וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים כָּלָם בָּהּ בְּהֶאָרְתָּם.
nevertheless, a radiance from all of them spreads forth and becomes clothed within it within Asiyah,

כִּי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וַיּוֹרֵד הָאֶרֶת דָּכָל אֶחָד מִמְּקוֹמוֹ
in that a radiance spreads forth and descends from its place in each World –

הֵן מֵהַגּוּפוֹת וְהַנְּשָׁמוֹת שֶׁבָּהֶם וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים בָּהּ בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָהּ
from the bodies and from the souls therein, which become clothed within it within Asiyah internally,

וְהֵן מֵהַמְּקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים שֶׁבָּהֶם וּמִלְבִּישִׁים אוֹתָהּ מִסָּבִיב
as well as from the *makifim* and *igulim* of those Worlds, enveloping them externally.

וְהָרִי כְּלוּלָה הָעֲשִׂיָּה בְּתוֹךְ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם עַל יְדֵי הָאֶרֶת
הַמְּקִיפִים וְהָעִגְלִים

Thus Asiyah is subsumed into all of the Worlds via the radiance of the *makifim* and *igulim*

דָּכָל אֶחָד הַמִּתְפַּשְׁטִים מִמְּקוֹמָם לְהַקִּיף אוֹתָהּ.
which each of them of the Worlds radiates out from their place to surround them.

וְכֵן הֵם כָּלָם כְּלוּלִים בָּהּ עַל יְדֵי הָאֶרֶת הַגּוּפוֹת וְהַנְּשָׁמוֹת
In addition, all of them are absorbed into it Asiyah via the radiance of the bodies and souls

דָּכָל אֶחָד הַמִּתְפַּשְׁטִים מִמְּקוֹמָם וּמִתְלַבָּשִׁים בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָהּ.
that each of them percolates down from their place to become clothed within Asiyah internally.

וְכֵן הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם.

And so too regarding every world –

As mentioned in the beginning of this chapter, the same paradigm is true of every lower level in relation to the levels above it.

כי הגם שכל עולם עליון הוא למעלה לגמרי מהעולם השני
שתחתיו,

for even though each higher World completely transcends the World below it,

כי אינו מתחיל השני אלא רק תחת סיומו דהעליון לגמרי,

since the next World down does not even begin until the higher World is totally complete i.e. there is no overlap,

על כל פנים הנה הם מתלבשים זה בזה וכלולים זה בזה על דרך
שבארנו בעולם העשיה.

nevertheless, they become clothed one within the other in the manner we explained regarding the World of Asiyah.

וכל דברינו הללו הנה הם מכונים בדברי הרב בשער עגלים וישר
ענף ד'

All that we have said here is a precise restatement of the words of the Rav Rabbi Isaac Luria in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher, anaf 4*,

וכמו שבארנו שם כל דבריו בזה בעמק וארכה.

as we explained comprehensively in our commentary there, in depth and at length.

ונודע הוא כמה שטרחו המפרשים שם והרבו בקשיות

Now it is known the extent to which the commentators there exerted themselves in expounding the texts discussing these matters, raising numerous questions,

אבל במה שאמרנו כאן שרש הדברים בזה

but what we have stated here is the root of these concepts,

ובפרט בכל מה שכתבנו שם בארכה יתבארו כל דברי הרב באר
היטיב

and in particular our lengthy commentary there explains all the words of the Rav clearly.

ועין עוד דברינו בזה בספר הדעה חלק א' דרוש ה'.

See further our commentary on this in the work titled *Sefer haDe'ah* (Hu Drush Olam HaTohu, a part of *Leshem, Sh'vo v'Achlama*) **part 1, drush 5**.

Footnotes

1. This is the proper spelling (Makover). This emendation also applies to other incidences below. [↩](#)

G A T E

*Shaar 6 — How the Divine Light expands:
tsimtsum, the surrounding and inner lights,
reward and karma*

Chapter 1 — Contraction of Divine Light in the First Revelation as a means of revealing Light via a lower revelation.

Tzimtzum is the agent that facilitates Revelations between worlds.

וְנַחֲזֹר מֵעַתָּה עַל דְּבָרֵינוּ הָרִאשׁוֹנִים אֲשֶׁר לָעִיל שֶׁעַד ד'

Let's now review our original statements above in *Sha'ar* 4

כִּי הִנֵּה אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁם מִפְּרָק ג' וְהִלָּאָה שְׂכָלְלוּת גִּלּוּי יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ

where we said (chapter 3) that His revelation in general

אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלוּ הִנֵּה נִסְדֵּר בָּהּ גִּלּוּי שְׁהֵם ה' מְדֻרָּגוֹת,

that became unveiled throughout existence is arranged in five stages of revelation, which are actually five levels – 1) The *Ohr Ein Sof*; 2) the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*; 3) Adam Kadmon; 4) Atzilut; 5) the Worlds of BiY" A (Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah).

וּבָהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה מְאֻמָּתָתוֹ הַפְּשׁוּטָה הַנִּעְלָמָה

In them in these five stages of revelation is revealed something of His true uncompounded concealed Being,

וְנִתְפָּשֵׁט מִגִּלּוּי לְגִלּוּי שֶׁהוּא מִהַגִּלּוּי דָּאוֹר אֵין סוּף יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ

spreading forth from revelation to revelation, from the very first revelation, the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

עַד גִּלּוּי הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁבְּהֶעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוּ בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁם.

until the very last revelation in the Worlds of BiY" A, as we explained in our elucidation there.

וְהִנֵּה הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת וַיִּצְיָאָתוֹ מִגִּלּוּי לְגִלּוּי הָיָה עַל יְדֵי בְּחִי' צִמְצוּם מִכָּל עֲלִיוֹן לְהִתְחַתּוֹן,

Now the light spread forth and emerged from revelation to revelation by way of the aspect of *tzimtzum* (the withdrawal or contraction of the light) between every higher level and lower level.

וְהִיָּינוּ כִּי לְצַרְךָ יִצְיָאָתוֹ מִכָּל גִּלּוּי הַקּוּדֵם לְגִלּוּי הַשֵּׁנִי אֲשֶׁר תַּחְתּוֹ

That is to say, any prior revelation, for the sake of the emergence of the subsequent revelation below it –

שֶׁהוּא לְמַטָּה מִמֶּנּוּ בְּמִדְרָגָה הִנֵּה נִתְצַמְצַם וְנִסְתַּלַּק

below in the sense of spiritual level, not locality – the light was constricted and withdrawn,

ועָלָה הָאוֹר דִּהְגְּלוֹי הָרֵאשׁוֹן לְמַעַלָּה,

so that the first revelation of the light ascended i.e. it was withdrawn to a higher level

כְּדִי לַתּוֹן מְקוֹם לְגִלּוֹי הַשְּׁנִי וְכִמו שִׁיתְבָּאָר.

in order to make 'space' for the second revelation, as we will explain below – that every revelation includes within itself the next revelation, so that the first one has to be withdrawn in order to make room (figuratively speaking) for the second revelation.¹

אֲמָנָם בְּעֵינֵינוּ הַגְּלוֹי הָרֵאשׁוֹן דָּאִין סוּף

However, as far as the first revelation is concerned of the *Ein Sof*, i.e. the *Ohr Ein Sof*,²

אֵיךְ שֶׁיֵּצֵא בּוֹ מֵאֲמִתּוֹת הַפְּשׁוּטָה הַנִּעְלָמָה,

– how it emerged from His true uncompounded concealed Being

אִין לָנוּ רְשׁוּת לְדַבֵּר וּלְהִתְבּוֹנֵן בָּזֶה מְאוּמָה כָּלֵל

we have no permission at all to discuss or even contemplate,

וְכִמו שֶׁכָּתַבְנוּ לְעִיל שְׁעַר ד' כְּמָה פְּעָמִים בָּזֶה.

as we wrote above in *Sha'ar 4* a number of times.

וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לָנוּ לְדַבֵּר אֶלָּא רַק מֵאַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה וּלְמַטָּה,

We can speak only of after that revelation the *Ohr Ein Sof* and below,

וְהֵינּוּ בְּסֹדֶר יֵצִיאָתוֹ מִהַגְּלוֹי הָרֵאשׁוֹן לַשְּׁנִי

that is to say, the manner in which the second revelation emerged from the first,

וְכִן בְּסֹדֶר יֵצִיאָתוֹ אֲשֶׁר מִהַשְּׁנִי לַשְּׁלִישִׁי, וּמִהַשְּׁלִישִׁי לַהֲרִבְעִי,
וּמִהַרְבִּיעִי לַחֲמִישִׁי.

and similarly, the manner in which the third revelation emerged from the second, the fourth from the third, and the fifth from the fourth.

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה יֵצִיאָתוֹ מִגְּלוֹי לְגִלּוֹי עַל יְדֵי צִמְצוּם,

Now this emerging from revelation to revelation was via a *tzimtzum* in each case.

שֶׁהוּא הַסְתַּלְקוּת וְעֲלִית הָאוֹר לְמַעַלָּה וְכִמו שִׁיתְבָּאָר לְפָנֵינוּ.

This *tzimtzum* is the withdrawal and ascent of the light from its expanded state to a higher plane, as will be explained below.

וְהָעֵינָנוּ הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל גִּלּוֹי וְגִלּוֹי קֵדָם שֶׁיֵּצֵא לְגִלּוֹי הַשְּׁנִי שֶׁתַּחֲתָיו

The idea is this: before any superior revelation extends from its place to a second revelation below it

הנה היה נמשך אותו הגלוי העליון גם בהמקום העתיד לגלוי השני,

that superior revelation also expands into the space where the second revelation would be in the future.

וכן משם ולמטה כלו בכל אחד לפי ערכו.

Similarly from there on all the way down, each level according to its rank.

וכגון גלוי שפאצילות שהוא למעלה וקדם לגלוי שבבי"ע

For example, His revelation in Atzilut (the fourth revelation), which is higher than and precedes His revelation in BiY"A (the fifth revelation),

היה מתפשט מתחילה האור דאצילות גם בכל המקום העתיד להעולמות בי"ע כלן.

– initially the light of Atzilut expanded into the entire future space of all the Worlds of BiY"A as well.

והיה מתפשט מקדם ממקום האצילות עד סוף המקום דהבי"ע

The light that first spread forth from the 'space' of Atzilut until the outer limits of the 'space' of BiY"A,

רק מגלוי אשר מבחי האצילות לבד.

was only the light of Atzilut, since the light of BiY"A was included in the revelation that preceded it – i.e. in the light of the World of Atzilut.

ולכן היה נצרך לצרף גלוי שבבי"ע שישתלק מאותו המקום

Accordingly, for the sake of the revelation in BiY"A, it was necessary to withdraw from that space – the future space of BiY"A

כל האור דבחי האצילות שהיה נמשך שם,

all the light of Atzilut that was manifested there,

ויעלה אותו האור למעלה במקום האצילות כדי לעשות ולתן מקום להעולמות בי"ע

and for that light to ascend into the 'space' of Atzilut in order to allow and make place for the Worlds of BiY"A.

(ועין כל זה בארפה בדברינו בספר הכללים כלל ז' וכלל י"ג).

(See in regard to all this at length in *Sefer HaKlalim*, klal 7 and klal 13).

וכן הגלוי השלישי שהוא הגלוי דאדם קדמון.

Similarly, as regards the third revelation – the revelation of Adam Kadmon –

הָיָה קֶדֶם שֶׁיֵּצֵא וְנִתְפָּשֵׁט לַגִּלּוּי הָרְבִיעִי, שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי אֲשֶׁר
לְאַצִּילוֹת,

prior to emerging from A"K and extending into the fourth revelation, the
revelation of Atzilut,

הָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ הָאוֹר דָּאָדָם קְדָמוֹן גַּם בְּהַמָּקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לְאַצִּילוֹת,

the light of A"K expanded into what would in the future be the 'space' of
Atzilut,

וְהָיָה שֶׁם מִקְדָּם רַק אוֹר דָּאָדָם קְדָמוֹן לְבַד שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי

so that initially there was only the light of A"K, the third revelation.

וְלַמָּקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לְהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע הָיָה אֲזִי אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר דָּאָדָם קְדָמוֹן בְּבַחֲוֵי הַגִּלּוּי
[הַשְּׁנִי].

[And as regards the future 'space' of the Worlds of BiY"A, that same light of
A"K was the aspect of the second revelation]

וְלָכֵן הָיָה נִצָּרָךְ לְצַרֵּךְ גִּלּוּי דְּהַאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁיִּסְתַּלַּק וְיַעֲלֶה מֵאוֹתוֹ
הַמָּקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לְאַצִּילוֹת

And therefore, for the sake of the revelation of Atzilut, it was necessary to
withdraw and elevate from the space that would in the future be the space of
Atzilut,

כָּל הָאוֹר דָּאָדָם קְדָמוֹן שֶׁהָיָה שָׁם,

all the light of Adam Kadmon that was manifested there.

וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה בְּעֶקְרוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה כְּדִי לַעֲשׂוֹת וְלִתֵּן מָקוֹם

It was withdrawn and raised up to its root above in order to make space for

לַגִּלּוּי הַאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא הַגִּלּוּי הָרְבִיעִי,

the revelation of Atzilut, the fourth revelation,

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁמִּתְבָּאֵר כָּל זֶה בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּסִפְרֵי הַכְּלָלִים כָּלֵל ה' ו' וְכָלֵל י"ב

as explained in *Sefer HaKlalim*, klal 5, 6 and klal 12.

וְלַמָּקוֹם הָעֲתִיד לְהִבִּי"ע הָיָה נִחָשֵׁב עַדִּיו הַהֲאָרָה הַנִּשְׁאָר מֵהָאוֹר הַנִּזְכָּר אַחֵר
[סְלוּקוֹ בְּבַחֲוֵי הַגִּלּוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי]

[And as regards the future 'space' of the Worlds of BiY"A, that same radiance
of the remaining light just mentioned, after it was withdrawn, is regarded as in
the category of the third revelation].

וְכֵן עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּהַגִּלּוּי הַשְּׁנִי, שֶׁהוּא הִטָּהִירוֹ עֲלָאָה וְאוֹר קְדָמוֹן,

Similarly as regards the second revelation, the *tehiru ila'a* the supernal purity and *avir kadmon* primordial space, also known as the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* (see *Sha'ar* 4 chapter 3) –

הנה קדם שיצא ונתפשט לגלוי השלישי שהוא אדם קדמון
prior to emerging and expanding into the third revelation, Adam Kadmon,
היה נמשך ונתפשט האור דכל הגלוי השני גם בכל המקום העתיד
לאדם קדמון

the light of the entire second revelation expanded and spread into what would
in the future be the 'space' of Adam Kadmon.

ולמקום האצילות, ומכל שכן להמקום דהבי"ע היה נחשב זה בבחינת הגלוי
[הראשון והבן מאד].

[And as regards the future 'space' of the World of Atzilut, and all the more so,
the future 'space' of the Worlds of BiY" A, that revelation was regarded as in the
category of the first revelation. Understand this well!]

ולכן לצורך הגלוי דאדם קדמון, שהוא הגלוי השלישי, היה נצרך
שיסתלק כל האור העקרי דהגלוי השני למעלה במקומו

And therefore, for the sake of the revelation of A"K, the third revelation, it was
necessary for all the main light³ of the second revelation to be withdrawn back
into its own space above,

וכדי לעשות ולתן מקום לגלוי דאדם קדמון
in order to make space for the revelation of Adam Kadmon.

וכן על דרך זה בהגלוי הראשון שהוא הגלוי דאור אין סוף יתברך
שמו,

And similarly the first revelation, the revelation of the *Ohr Ein Sof*, blessed is
His Name,

שהוא הגלוי הראשון מאמתתו הפשוטה הנעלמה, וכנ"ל שער ד'.
which is the first revelation from His uncompounded true hidden Being, as
mentioned previously, *Sha'ar* 4.

הנה קדם שיצא ממנו לגלוי השני, שהוא האור דהטהירו עלאה
ואויר קדמון,

Now before the second revelation, i.e. the *tehiru ila'a* and *avir kadmon*, emerged
from it from the first revelation, the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

הנה היה אותו הגלוי הראשון דהאור אין סוף גם בכל המקום
דהגלוי השני כלו

the entire first revelation – the *Ohr Ein Sof* – also filled the entire 'space' of the second revelation where the second revelation would be revealed in the future.

וְכֹן מִשָּׁם וּלְמַטָּה, וְהָיָה מֵאִיר מִתְחִילָה בְּכָל מְקוֹם רַק אִוֵּר אֵין סוֹף לְבֵד.

So too, from there on down: from the outset, the *Ohr Ein Sof* alone illuminated all of the 'space'.

וְלָכֵן הָיָה נִצְרָךְ שִׁסְתַּלַּק וַיַּעֲלֶה הָאוֹר דָּאֵין סוֹף מִכָּל אוֹתוֹ הַמְּקוֹם.

And therefore it was necessary for the *Ohr Ein Sof* to be withdrawn from that entire space

כְּדִי לָתֵן וּלְעֲשׂוֹת מְקוֹם לַגְּלוֹי הַשֵּׁנִי,

in order to make place for the second revelation,

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמִּבְאֵר בְּדַבְּרֵי הָרַב בְּשַׁעֲרֵי עֲגָלִים וַיֵּשֶׁר עֲנָךְ ב'

as is explained in the words of the Rabbi the Arizal in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher*, *anaf number 2*.

וְהוּא הַצְמָצוּם הָרִאשׁוֹן הַנּוֹדֵעַ שֶׁהָיָה בְּהַגְלִי הָרִאשׁוֹן.

This making space for the second revelation is the well-known doctrine of *tzimtzum harishon* the initial *tzimtzum* (contraction) within the first revelation, the *Ohr Ein Sof*.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי קִדָּם שִׁיָּצָא כָּל גְּלוֹי שְׁלֵמָטָה,

Therefore it turns out that before any revelation appeared on a lower level,

הָיָה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ הַגְּלוֹי הַקּוֹדֵם בְּכָל מְקוֹם שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ וּלְמַטָּה.

The prior revelation spread out and extended from its point of origin into the entire space below.

אֶךְ לְצַרֵּךְ הַגְּלוֹי שֶׁתַּחֲתָיו נִתְצַמְצַם הַגְּלוֹי הָעֶלְיוֹן וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה לְמַעְלָה

However, for the sake of the revelation below, the higher level illumination was constricted by the *tzimtzum* and ascended to a higher plane

כְּדִי לָתֵן מְקוֹם לַשֵּׁנִי אֵלָיו, וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְגַּלּוּ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם

in order to make place for the next revelation, and in this way all the Worlds became revealed,

בְּגְלוֹי אַחֵר גְּלוֹי כָּל אֶחָד לְמַטָּה בְּמַדְרָגָה מִהַעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁעָלָיו.

through revelation after revelation, each one being on a lower level than the plane above it.

והטעם על זה הוא כי הנה כל אור היותר עליון הנה הוא השרש
לכל מה שתחתיו,

The reason for this for the *tzimtzum* of the higher revelation so that the lower revelation could emerge **is that the higher light is in fact the root of everything below it,**

וכלול בו בכח ובהעלם כל מה שלמטה ממנו.

and the higher level encompasses within it, in a concealed manner, everything that is below it.

וכן היה כוננת גלוי מתחילה לצורך כל המציאות כלו אשר למטה
הימנו

Indeed, this was the intention of that revelation from the outset – the needs of the entirety of existence below its own level,

ויכמו שאמרו "סוף מעשה במחשבה תחלה".

as our Sages put it,⁴ "the final deed was first in thought".

ולכן נתפשט מתחילה בכל המקום דהמציאות כלו,

And therefore, from the outset, it spread into the entire space of existence,

וכדי להעשות על ידי זה שרש לכלם.

in order to become the root of everything thereby.

כי על ידי ירידתו והתרחקו ממקורו

Because through the descent of the light of the lower revelation⁵ **and its resulting distance from its source –**

אחר שנתצמצם ונסתלק העליון שעליו למעלה

following the *tzimtzum* and withdrawal of the superior level of light back up to its higher state

וירד הוא ונתפשט במקום העתיד להעולמות התחתונים,

after it had descended and spread out in the space that would in the future be for the lower Worlds –

הנה נתצמצם על ידי זה ונעשה בו כח ותכונה מאיכות האור
הראוי לכל עולם ועולם, ונעשה על ידי זה שרש לכלם

now it the original light contracts, and within it there is the potential and character of light that is suitable for each world, and thus it becomes the source for everything.

The explanation is this: After the first *tzimtzum* by which the *chalal* (the void) and the *tehiru ila'a* were formed, they became the source and root of all the subsequent revelations. This may allude to the idea of *reshimu* (the residue of the original *Ohr Ein Sof*) which conceals within it all of the future Worlds.⁶

וְלֹא עוֹד אֶלָּא שְׁגָם אַחֵר שֶׁנִּסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה גַם הוּא לְמַעַלָּה לְמִקְוָמוֹ
הָעֶקְרִי הָרְאוּי אֵלָיו,

Furthermore, even after it too the *Ohr Ein Sof* was withdrawn and ascended to its main place – the place most suited for it, above the *chalal*-void,

הִנֵּה הַנִּיחַ לְכָל אֶחָד⁷ רוּשָׁם אֹר מִמֶּנּוּ בְּכָל מָקוֹם וּמִקְוָם לְפִי עָרְכוֹ.
it left a residue of its light in every place for each level according to its stature.
וְאוֹתוֹ הָרָשָׁם הוּא נִשְׁאָר שָׁם לְעוֹלָם,

That residue remains there forever

וְהוּא הַשָּׁרֵשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן וְהַכֹּחַ הַפְּנִימִי לְכָל מְצִיאוֹתוֹ הָעֵתִיד.
and is the first root and the inner powerhouse of the entire future existence.

וְעַל יְדֵי כָל זֶה הִנֵּה עוֹמֵד גַּם כָּל מְצִיאוֹת הַיּוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן
And in this manner the entire existence of even the lowest level
קָשׁוּר וְתָלוּי לְעוֹלָם גַּם בְּהָאֹר הַיּוֹתֵר עָלִיוֹן,

Is eternally bound to, and is dependent upon, the very highest light,

וְתָלוּיִם וְאַחֻדִּים זֶה בְּזֶה לְעוֹלָם
וְתָלוּיִם וְאַחֻדִּים זֶה בְּזֶה לְעוֹלָם
such that they are dependent upon and united one with the other forever.⁸

וְכֹן אֶפְשָׁר עַל יְדֵי זֶה גַּם לְכָל יוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן לְהִתְעַלֵּה מֵעָלְוֵי לְעָלְוֵי,
Furthermore, this enables even the very lowest level to ascend from level to level,

וְלַעֲלוֹת גַּם לְמַדְרַגַּת הַיּוֹתֵר עָלִיוֹן וְכֵמוּ שִׁיחִיָּה בְּתַכְלִית תַּקוֹן
הָאַחֲרוֹן.

ascending to even the very loftiest level, as will take place with the completion of the final *tikun* rectification.

וְלָכֵן הָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ מִתַּחֲלִילָה וְנִתְפַּשֵּׁט כָּל גְּלוּי הַיּוֹתֵר עָלִיוֹן
Therefore, from the outset, every higher revelation was drawn downward and expanded out

קִדְם יְצִיאָתוֹ לְגְלוּי הַשֵּׁנִי בְּכָל הַמָּקוֹם הָעֵתִיד לְהִמְצִיאוֹת כָּלוּ,
prior to the emergence of the second-level revelation in the space where it would be manifested in the future.

וְכַדִּי לְהַמְצִיא עַל יְדֵי זֶה רוֹשֵׁם וְשָׂרֵשׁ לְכֻלָּם וּלְכֻלָּל אֶת כָּלָם בּוֹ.

This was also for the purpose of producing a trace and root for everything, and including everything within it.

אַמְנָם אַחֵר שֶׁעָשָׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בְּזֶה,

Now after producing this trace of the original light, called the *reshimu*,²

הֵנָּה חָזַר וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה לְמִקְוֶמוֹ הָרְאוּי אֵלָיו

the light was once again withdrawn and ascended to its proper place,

וְכַדִּי לְתֵן מָקוֹם לְכָל הַמַּדְרָגוֹת שֶׁתַּחֲתָיו,

in order to make space for the subsequent levels,

וְאֶפְשָׁר לָהֶם מַעֲתָה לְצֵאת עַל מְצִיאוֹתָם גַּם כֵּן.

enabling them now to also emerge in their own manner of existence.

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר עֲנִין צֶרֶךְ הַצִּמְצוּם הַנֶּעֱשָׂה בְּכָל גִּלּוּי וְגִלּוּי שֶׁבְּכָל
הַגִּלּוּיִם כָּלָם.

Thus we have explained the necessity of the *tzimtzum* of all the revelations at every level of revelation,

שֶׁהוּא כַּדִּי לְתֵן מָקוֹם לְשֵׁנִי אֵלָיו

which is to make space for the revelation following it.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵצֵא כָּל חִלּוּקֵי הַמַּדְרָגוֹת כָּלָם,

And in this manner all of the different levels emerged,

שֶׁכָּל תַּחֲתוֹן הוּא בַּמַּדְרָגָה לְמַטָּה הַרְבֵּה מֵהָעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁעָלָיו.

such that every lower level is on a far lower plane than the one above it.

Footnotes

1. Makover. [↩](#)

2. See Makover. [↩](#)

3. i.e. excluding the trace of light that remained. [↩](#)

4. From the *LechaDodi* hymn. [↩](#)

5. Makover. [↩](#)

6. Makover. [↩](#)

7. It seems that this should read לְכָל אֶחָד "for each..." [↩](#)

8. Since every revelation is bound to, and dependent upon, the previous revelation, it follows that *all* revelations are contained within the very first revelation and all of them are bound to, and dependent upon it (Makover). [↩](#)

9. Makover. [↩](#)

Chapter 2 — Concerning contraction (tsimtsum), histaklut and hitpashtut.

Tzimtzum returns to its source, filters the original light and leaves the faintest hint of it, reshimu. Role of the kav.

וְהִנֵּה עֲנִינוּ הַצְמָצוּם עֲצָמוּ הַנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּכָל עָלְיוֹן

Now regarding the idea of the *tsimtsum* itself that takes place at every higher level in order to bring the light down to a lower level,

לְבָאָר עֲנִינוּ בְּדִיוֹק הוּא בְּאַמֶּת סוּד עֵמֶק נוֹרָא מְאֹד

– to explain precisely the concept thereof is indeed a very profound and formidable task,

וְאִין רְשׁוּת לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן בּוֹ כָּלֵל וּמִכָּל שְׁכֵן לְהַעֲלוֹת עַל הַכֶּתֶב.

and we have no permission to even contemplate this, and all the more so to write about it.

וְעַל כִּגוֹן זֶה וְכִיּוֹצֵא בָּזֶה אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ז, א) בְּשֹׁכֵר 'וַיִּסְתֵּר מִשֶּׁה פָּנָיו
[כִּי יֵרָא מִהִבֵּית אֵל הָאֱלֹהִים] (שְׁמוֹת ג, ו)

Regarding matters like these the Sages declared (*Berachot 7a*): As a reward for Moses hiding his face [for he was afraid to gaze at the Almighty (Exodus 3:6)]

זָכָה לְקִלְסֵתָּר פָּנִים בְּשֹׁכֵר כִּי יֵרָא זָכָה לְוִיִּרְאוֹ מִגֶּשֶׁת אֱלֹיוֹ [רֵאָה
שְׁמוֹת לד, ל]

he merited that the divine luster shone from his face, and because 'he was afraid to gaze at...' 'they were afraid to approach him' see what the verse states in Exodus 34:30.

בְּשֹׁכֵר מִהִבֵּית זָכָה לְוִיתְמוּנַת ה' יִבִּיט' [במדבר יב, ח]

As a reward for not gazing earlier he was found worthy of "upon the image of God he gazes" [Numbers 12:8].

וְכֵן נֹאמַר מִשְׁלִי (כה, ב) כְּבֹד אֱלֹהִים הִסְתֵּר דָּבָר.

Similarly, it states in *Mishlei* (Proverbs 25:2) that: "It is the honor of God to conceal a matter," indicating that matters that are not revealed explicitly in the Torah should remain hidden.

אֲמַנָּם בְּאֶשֶׁר שָׁאִין דְּרָכֵי לִסְתֵּם אֶלָּא לְפָרֵשׁ.

However, as it is not my approach to remain silent, but rather to expound,

כִּי כָּל מָה שֶׁחֲנֵנִי אֱלֹהִים מִתַּעֲלוּמוֹת חֻכְמָה הוּא רַק לְהוֹצִיאָם
לְאוֹר

for all the secrets of wisdom to which the Almighty has granted me access, is for the sole purpose of bringing them to light.

ולזאת רמזתי גם הענין הנורא הזה גם כן בכמה מקומות מדברינו

Therefore I have hinted to even this awesome secret in our words in a number of places,

בשער עגולים וישר ענף ב' ובספר הדעה ובספר הכללים

such as in our commentary on *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Iggulim v'Yosher, anaf 2*, and in *Sefer HaDe'ah* (*Drushei Olamot HaTohu*, the second part of his magnum opus *Leshem Shv'o v'Achlama*), and in *Sefer HaK'lalim*.

והמעין האמתי יעמד עליהם ויהי רצון שלא יפשל.

One with a true interest in the matter will come to understand them, and may it be His will that he will not stumble.

ובאשר מלבאר עמק ענינו בפרטיות אי אפשר

But since explaining that concept in depth and in detail is impossible in the current context,

ולזאת לא נדבר עתה אלא בפשטות הענין לבד

we will discuss it now on a superficial level only,

כי בכל ענין יש עמק ופשט, נגלה ונסתר

because in every concept there is its depth and its plain meaning, its revealed and its hidden aspects,

והם מתאימים זה עם זה ומכונים זה בזה.

and they concur with one another and parallel one another.

In other words, the superficial level and the plain meaning do not *conceal* the deeper, esoteric meaning, but parallel it precisely, so that the former reveal the contours of the latter for those who are well versed in the esoteric wisdom.

ולא עוד אלא שהכל הולך אחר הפשט

And furthermore, 'everything follows the plain meaning', as the Talmud (*Shabbat* 63a; *Makkot* 20b) declares regarding verses in Scripture. So that from the plain meaning it is possible to arrive at the deeper meaning.

ולכן נדבר עתה בפשוט לבד והוא זה

So therefore let's now discuss the plain meaning alone, which is this:

כי ענין הצמצום שהוא הסתלקות ועלית האור למעלה

The concept of the *tzimtzum* is the withdrawal and ascent of the light on high.

כָּבֵד אֶמְרָנוּ לְעִיל שְׁעַר ה' פ"א שְׁאִין הַכּוֹנֶה שְׁנִשְׁאָר לַמָּטָה פָּנוּי
וְרִיקָם מִכָּל וְכָל

We already explained above (*Sha'ar 5:1*) that this does not mean that the lower level from which the light was withdrawn remains completely empty and void,

כִּי לְעוֹלָם הוּא שְׁאִין הָעֵדֶר הַחֲלִטִי בְּשׁוּם מָקוֹם

for it is invariably the case that no total absence exists anywhere,

וְלֹא הָיָה וְלֹא יִהְיֶה לְעוֹלָם הָעֵדֶר הַחֲלִטִי בְּשׁוּם זְמַן

and there was never a total absence at any time,

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הַרְמָב"ם ז"ל (מ"נ ב, ל) וְכַמָּה קְדוֹשֵׁי עֲלִיוֹן עָמוּ שְׁאִין
רִיקוּת בְּשׁוּם מָקוֹם וְכַנ"ל שְׁעַר ה' פ"א.

as the Rambam states (*Moreh Nevuchin 2:30*), and a number of distinguished holy Sages agree with him that there is no complete void in any place, as mentioned above *Sha'ar 5:1*.

אֲךָ עֲנֵנוּ הַצִּמְצוּם הֵנָּה הוּא עֲצָמוּ מְצִיאוֹת גַּם כֵּן

Rather, the concept of the *tzimtzum* is that it itself is also an existence and not just an absence.

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי הֵנָּה הוּא בְּחִינַת כַּח פְּרָטִי אֶחָד הַמַּחֲשִׁיךְ וּמַסְתִּיר אֶת
הָאוֹר וּמַגְבִּילוֹ.

That is to say, it the *tzimtzum* is a specific Divine power that obscures and conceals the light and limits it,

וְהוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹ מַסָּךְ הָעוֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הָאוֹר

and it acts as a screen in front of the light.

וְכַאֲשֶׁר נִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה הָאוֹר לְמַעְלָה

When the light was withdrawn and ascended on high

וְהָאוֹר הַהוּא אֲשֶׁר עָלָה הֵנָּה הוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹת אֵין סוֹף

– and the light that ascended was the aspect of infinity (*ein sof*)

אֲשֶׁר אֵין לְהַבְחִין בּוֹ שׁוּם בְּחִינָה גְּבוּלִי כָּלֵל וְשׁוּם כַּח פְּרָטִי כָּלֵל

in which there was absolutely no aspect of limitation, and no discrete powers at all,

כִּי כָּל אוֹר עֲלִיוֹן נֶגֶד הַתַּחְתּוֹן הוּא אֵין סוֹף בְּעֶרְכוֹ

since every superior light is regarded as infinite in comparison to an inferior one,

וְכֵן כָּל הָה' גְּלוּיִים שֶׁחֲשַׁבְנוּ לְעִיל שְׁעַר ד'

and so too, all the five revelations listed in *Sha'ar 4* –

הנה נחשב כל עליון נגד התחתון לבחינת אין סוף

because every superior light is regarded as infinite in comparison to an inferior one,

שלא נבחן בו שום גבולי ושום כח פרטי

since no limitation and no discrete power can be discerned therein.

וכאשר עלה ונסתלק כל עליון למעלה

Now when the entire superior level of light ascended and was withdrawn on high,

הנה על ידי סלוקו ועלייתו נתגלה ונאצל ממנו כח פרטי אחד

due to its withdrawal and ascent, a single discrete power was revealed and emanated

המחשיך ומסתיר את האור שעומד לפניו ונתן הרחקה אליו

that obscured and concealed the light in front of which it was placed, and it provided some distance therefrom.

ונמשך ומתפשט הכח הזה בכל המקום העתיד להמציאות כלו

This power was then drawn down and propagated throughout the future space of the entire existence,

ומחשיך ומבדיל בפני האור שעלה למעלה

obscuring the higher light and separating the lower light from it.¹

ועליו נאמר (תהלים יח, יב) ישת חשך סתרו סביבותיו סבתו

Regarding this the verse (Psalms 18:12) states "He made darkness His concealment, around Him, His shelter"

כי נעשה בפני האור כמסך ופרגוד לפניו.

because it the *tzimtzum* became like a screen and curtain before the light.

וכן נאמר עליו (תהלים צז, ב) ענן וערפל סביביו

Similarly in this regard it states in another verse (Psalms 97:2) 'Cloud and dense darkness surround Him,'

כי הוא כעין עביות העומד בפני האור.

for it is the *tzimtzum* like a dense curtain standing before the light.

והנה כל שעור המשך הכח הלז הוא נקרא בשם חלל ומקום פנוי

Now the entire span of this power of *tzimtzum* is called the *chalal* void and *makom panui* empty space

כי הוא המקום להמציאות העתיד שנעשה בו אחר כך

for it is the place in which future existence would subsequently be fashioned.

והוא החלל דהצמצום אשר בו נעשה כל המציאות כלו

This is the void produced by the *tzimtzum* in which the entire existence is formed,

ונעשה כל המציאות מהצמצום עצמו

and indeed the entire existence is a product of the *tzimtzum* itself.

והיינו כי הנה אותו הצמצום שאמרנו שהוא כח המחשיך ובחינת עביות.

That is to say, from that very *tzimtzum* which we described as the power of darkness and the aspect of condensation or density –

הנה ממנו נמשך ונעשה כל בחינת הגוף וכלים להמציאות שנעשה שם אחר כך

from this itself all aspects of the body and vessels were drawn and fashioned into the form of existence it would be afterwards.

כי אחר שנסתלק האור ממנו,

Because after the light was withdrawn from it from the void,

ונאצל ונעשה על ידי זה כח המחשיך ומסתיר ומגביל את האור כנזכר

through this there was emanated and produced a power of darkening and concealing that limits the light, as mentioned.

הנה אחר שעלה האור ממנו ונשאר אותו הכח למטה לבדו

Now after light ascended from it from the void with the first *tzimtzum* all that remained below was its power to darken and conceal

נחשך עוד יותר ונתוסף בו עבוי על עבוי

it became even darker, and layer upon layer of density was added.

ונשלם על ידי זה בכל תכונות וכחות הגבוליים ככל הנצרך

And thus were completed all the finite characteristics and powers that were necessary

להוציא ממנו ועל ידו את כל החומר והגוף דהמציאות שלמטה.

to produce from it and by it all of the material and the body of existence below.

אִמָּנָם הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה הַצְמָצוּם עֲצָמוּ שֶׁהוּא הַכֹּחַ הַמַּסְתִּיר וּמַגְבִּיל
אֶת הָאוֹר

Indeed, the *tzimtzum* itself, which is the power of obscuring and limiting the light,

כֹּאֲשֶׁר עוֹמֵד הוּא לְבַדּוֹ הֵנָּה לֹא נַעֲשֶׂה בְּאֵמֶת עֵדִין מִמֶּנּוּ שׁוּם דָּבָר
כָּלֵל

were it to stand alone, nothing at all would have actually been produced thereby

—

כִּי הוּא לְבַדּוֹ הֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּבַחֲיִנַת כֹּחַ הַיּוֹלֵי הָעוֹמֵד מוּכָן לְקַבֵּל כָּל
צוּרָה

for on its own, the void is merely a preternatural potential (urpotential, primeval potential) that stands ready to receive any form,

אָבֵל הוּא גּוֹפָה לֹא נִרְאָה בּוֹ עֵדִין שׁוּם צוּרָה כָּלֵל וְאִינוּ נוֹפֵל עָלָיו
שֵׁם מְצִיאוֹת כָּלֵל

while it itself has no visible form at all, and the term 'existence' does not even apply to it.

וְאֶדְרָבָה הוּא כִּי נִרְאָה שֶׁהוּא הַיִּפְךָ הַמְצִיאוֹת

On the contrary, it appears to be the *opposite* of existence,

כִּי הָרִי הַמְצִיאוֹת הָרֵאשׁוֹן עָלָה וְנִסְתַּלַּק

for the first 'manifestation' the *Ohr Ein Sof* ascended and withdrew,

וְהוּא עוֹמֵד לִפְנֵי וּמַחֲשִׁיךְ עָלָיו וּמַסְתִּירוֹ

and it the void stands in front of it and darkens it and conceals it.

וּמְצִיאוֹת אַחֵר עֵדִין לֹא נַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ וְאִם כֵּן הָרִי נִתֵּן לִרְאוֹת בּוֹ כְּמוֹ
חֻלָּל וְאוֹר פְּנוּי,

And since, as yet, no other existence is made within it within the void, this permits what looks like a void and empty space to be perceived within the void.

וְלֹא נִתְגַּלָּה אוֹתוֹ הַכֹּחַ דֵּהַצְמָצוּם בְּבַחֲיִנַת מְצִיאוֹת

Thus the power of *tzimtzum* did not reveal any aspect of existence

אֲלֹא רַק עַל יְדֵי שְׁחֹזר הַמַּאֲצִיל עָלָיו וְהַמְשִׁיךְ בּוֹ אַחֵר כֵּךְ

until after the Supernal Emanator once again beamed into it

כּוֹ אוֹר אֶחָד מֵאוֹר הָרֵאשׁוֹן שֶׁעָלָה,

a line of light called the *kav* from the original light that ascended and became the *igul hagadol*.²

ועל ידי זה הנה נתגלה אז כחו ופועלתו דכל הצמצום גם כן

In this manner the power and effect of the entire *tzimtzum* was also revealed,

כי נעשה הוא עם האור שנתפשט בו לבחינת חמר וצורה,

since it produced, together with the light of the *kav* that spread into it into the void, the aspect of substance and form

והם שניהם מציאות אחת

which are a single entity – form without substance is merely potential, and substance does not manifest without form.

היינו שהם שניהם היסוד והשרש דכל העולם כלו שנעשה בו
בכלליו ופרטיו

That is to say, both of them the *kav* and the void together are the foundation and the root of the entire universe that is fashioned within it within the void generally and specifically.

What is meant by 'general' and 'specific' will be explained below.

כי כל כלל העולם וכל המציאויות הפרטיים שבו

For every general principle regarding the universe, and all the specific existing entities within it,

הנה כלם יוצאים ונעשים מאותו הצורה והחמר דהקו וצמצום

all emerge and manifest from that same form and substance of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*.

והנה פעל האור בהצמצום והצמצום בהאור כל אחד לפי כחו
ותכונתו

Now the light of the *kav* had an effect on the *tzimtzum* and the *tzimtzum* on the light of the *kav* – each according to its function and character

כי האור הנה דרכו הוא להיות מאיר ומתגלה

The nature of light is to illuminate and reveal –

שהוא להוציא ולהמציא עולם מלא ומציאויות שונות

to bring forth and produce a complete universe with all types of existences,

מכל המציאויות כלם הראוי לעולם שלם

including the entire range of existences that are suitable for a complete world,

על ידי האור העליון אשר יצא ממנו

by means of the supernal light from which it the *kav* emerged.

וּבְחִינַת הַצְמָצוּם הִנֵּה טִבְעוֹ הוּא לְצַמְצֵם וְלִתֵּן גָּבּוּל לְכָל דָּבָר

The nature of the *tzimtzum* is to contract and place limitations on everything,

וְלִהְיוֹת לְמַסָּךְ לִפְנֵי

and to obscure and conceal the light and act as a screen before it.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הִנֵּה יוֹצֵא וְנֹעֵשֶׂה מְשֻׁנֵּיהֶם יַחַד מְצִיאווֹת שׁוֹנוֹת
מִפְּרָטִים רַבִּים.

In this manner, from both of them together, different types of existence with all their details, emerge and are produced.

וְהֵינּוּ לְפִי כָּל אִיכוֹת הַכּחוֹת שֶׁיֵּשְׁנָם בְּהָאֹר

In other words, in accordance with the qualities of the powers that there are in the light,

וּלְפִי כָּל תְּכוּנוֹת הַכּחוֹת דֶּה־צְמָצוּם הַמְּסֻתֵירוֹ וּמַגְבִּילוֹ וְנֹעֵשֶׂה לְמַסָּךְ
לִפְנֵי,

and according to all the characteristics and powers of the *tzimtzum* that obscures and limits the light, acting as a figurative screen before it

שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת עֲבִיּוֹת וְגוֹף וְכָלִי

– this is what produces the aspect of denseness and 'body' and vessel.

וְכֹן נֹעֵשֶׂה עַל יְדֹ לְכָל פֶּרֶט וּפְרָט מִהַמְּצִיאווֹת כֻּלָּם

And also due to it the *tzimtzum* every detail of all existing entities is formed.

וְהִרִי יוֹצֵא עַל יְדֵי שְׁנֵיהֶם מְצִיאווֹת שׁוֹנוֹת רַבּוֹת כָּל אֶחָד בְּבְחִינַת
אוֹר וְכָלִי

Thus both of them together produce manifold different types of existences, all of them having the aspects of light and vessel.

שֶׁהִרִי כָּל כַּחַ פְּרָטִי שֶׁבְּהָאוֹר הוּא מְאִיר וּמוֹצִיא וּמַמְצִיא מְצִיאֹת
אֶחָת לְפִי אִיכוֹתוֹ

Because every individual detail in the light of the *kav* shines forth and produces and brings forth one aspect of existence, according to its particular quality,

וְכָל מֶה שֶׁהוּא מוֹצִיא וּמַמְצִיא הִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּבְחִינַת אוֹר וְנִשְׁמָה
לְבַד

and whatever it brings forth and produces is only an aspect of light and soul.

אֲךָ כַּח הַצְמָצוּם אֲשֶׁר מִתְיַחַד עִם הָאוֹר וּמִסְבָּבוֹ מְכַל סְבִיבּוֹ

But the power of the *tzimtzum* that unites with the light of the *kav*, enveloping it all around,

הנה מצמצמו ומגבילו וגורם לו עביות ונעשה עליו לגוף וכלי.

contracts and limits the light of the *kav* and causes it to 'thicken' (or 'condense') becoming a 'body' or 'vessel' for it.

ועל ידי זה הנה יוצאים ונעשים כל המציאויות³ כלם

In this way all entities emerge into existence and are formed

אשר בפרטות ופרטי פרטות כל אחד מחמר וצורה שהוא גוף
ונשמה

so that every detail, and every sub-detail is comprised of substance and form, which is also body and soul.

ומתגלים ומתרבים המציאויות לפי כל הכחות והאיכות שבהאור

These entities are revealed and proliferate according to the powers and qualities inherent in the light,

ולפי כל התכונות והכחות שבהצמצום

and according to all the characteristics and powers in the *tzimtzum*.

והם בחינת קו וצמצום שהם היסוד והשרש דכל עולם

These, the light and the power of constriction, are called the *kav* and *tzimtzum*, and they are the foundation and root of every world,

והם יצאו ונעשו מכל גלוי וגלוי אחר שנסתלק כל עליון ועלה
למעלה כנ"ל פ"א.

and they emerged and were manifested with each and every revelation after the higher aspect withdrew and ascended on high, as explained in chapter 1.

כי מתחילה הנה נעשה על ידי זה הצמצום ואחר כך חזר והאיר
באור קו אחד

For at the outset the withdrawal of the light constitutes a *tzimtzum*, and the subsequent return to illuminate with a single line of light constitutes a revelation of the *kav*.

ומזה יצא העולם התחתון שהוא הגלוי השני

And from this emerges a lower plane, a second revelation.

והיה כל זה מכל אחד ואחד, היינו מאור אין סוף שבהטהירו עלאה
ואויר קדמון לאדם קדמון

This is true at each and every level – between the *Ohr Ein Sof* of the *Tehiru Ila'a* and *Avir Kadmon* and *Adam Kadmon* there is a *tzimtzum* and *kav*,

ומאדם קדמון לאצילות ומהאצילות לבי"ע

and so too from *Adam Kadmon* to *Atzilut*, and from *Atzilut* to *BiY" A*.

כי בכל גלוי עליון היה צמצום והתפשטות קו לצרך הגלוי השני

In each case, there was a *tzimtzum* of the higher level and the extension of a line of light the *kav* for the sake of the second revelation.

שכל הגלוי השני הוא רק בבחינת קו אחד דק מהאור דהגלוי הראשון

Every subsequent revelation is only the aspect of a thin line *kav* of light from the revelation of the light of the previous level,

אשר נתגלה ונתפשט בו אחר שנסתלק, שהוא בהצמצום שנעשה בסלוקו

and becomes revealed and spreads forth after the prior withdrawal.

ועל ידי כל זה הנה ירד המציאות דהגלוי השני

By way of this entire process, the second level of revelation descends and materializes,

בירידת מדרגה הרבה ממדרגת האור העליון שהיה שם בתחלה

descending a huge step down from the higher level of light that was there initially.

ויורדו על ידי זה העולמות כלם במדרגה למטה ממדרגה

And thus all the worlds descended from level to level

עד שהגיע להמציאות דעולם העשיה והעולם הזה

until the World of *Asiyah* and this physical world materialized –

שאינו למטה הימנה בכמותה ואיכותה.

below which there is no lower level in quality or quantity.

כלל היוצא מדברינו כי היה בחינת צמצום וקו מכל גלוי העליון להגלוי שתחתיו

The fundamental principle that emerges from our analysis is that there was an aspect of *tzimtzum* and *kav* between every higher level revelation and the revelation below it,

ואין הצמצום העדר וריקני אלא כח המחסוך ומסתיר את האור וכח הגבולי

and that the *tzimtzum* is not an absence and an emptiness, but rather the power of darkening and concealing the light; it is also the power of limitation,

וְהוּא שֶׁרֶשׁ דְּכָל גּוּף וְכָלִי

and is the source for every body and vessel.

אָמֵנָם לֹא נִרְאָה וְלֹא נַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ שׁוּם דָּבָר אֶלָּא עַל יְדֵי הַקּוֹ דְּנוֹקָא

However, nothing is revealed or produced other than by means of the *kav*.

וְהֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם כְּמוֹ חֶמֶר וְצוּרָה

Together they the *tzimtzum* and the *kav* are comparable to substance and form,

וּמֵהֶם יֵצֵא וְנַעֲשֶׂה כָּל הַמְצִיאוּיוֹת כֻּלָּם דְּכָל עוֹלָם תַּחְתּוֹנָן

and from them the entire existence of the lower world emerges and is produced,

כִּי הֵקוּ וְהִצְמָצוּם הוּא שֶׁרֶשֶׁם

since the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* are their root.

וּבְכָלֵל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם הֵנָּה הוּא הִטְהִירוֹ עֲלֵאָה וְאִוִּיר הַקַּדְמוֹן

In the general category of all Worlds, the *Tehiru Ila'ah* and the *Avir Kadmon*

שֶׁהֵם הֵקוּ וְהִצְמָצוּם הָרִאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר מֵהַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹר אֵין סוֹף

are the original *kav* and *tzimtzum* that constricted the first revelation – the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

כִּי הֵם הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ דְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

for they are the root of *all* the Worlds.

וְעַל יְדֵי הֵקוּ וְהִצְמָצוּם הַנַּעֲשֶׂה מִכָּל עוֹלָם עָלְיוֹן לְהָעוֹלָם שֶׁתַּחְתּוֹנָן

And it is by way of a *kav* and a *tzimtzum* that occur between each higher World and the World below it

וְנַעֲשֶׂה כָּל עוֹלָם שְׁלֵמָטָה רַק מִקּוּ אֶחָד זָק מֵאוֹר הָעֲלִיוֹן

that each World below is produced from a single faint *kav* emerging from the higher level of light.

הֵנָּה עַל יְדֵי זֶה יִרְדּוּ הָעוֹלָמוֹת בַּמַּדְרָגָה לְמַטָּה מִמַּדְרָגָה

In this way the Worlds devolved from level to level,

עַד הַמְצִיאוֹת דֵּהָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה שֶׁהִיא תַּחְתּוֹנָה וְלִמְטָה מִכָּלָם

until this world, the lowest of all the Worlds, came into existence.

אָמֵנָם לְבֵאֵר הַדָּבָר בְּפִרְטִיּוֹת בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם וְסֵדֶר הַשְּׁתַּלְשּׁלוֹתָם

However, to explain this in detail regarding each of the Worlds, and the order in which they devolved,

הנה הם ארכים מאד והם מבארים בדברינו בספר הכללים

would require a very lengthy treatise, and has already been explained in our *Sefer haKlalim*,

שהוא כלו מייסד על זה ושם מתבאר כל הדברים הללו בגמון
וטעמן יעין עוד שם.

which is based entirely on this matter. There all of these concepts are explained in depth and with reasons. See there.

Footnotes

1. See Makover fn. 31. [↩](#)

2. See *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Iggulim v'Yosher sha'ar 1, anaf 2*. [↩](#)

3. This follows the version in *Meir HaLeshem*. [↩](#)

Chapter 3 — The kav (the funnel in tsimtsum) and the matters of the makif (transcendent, surrounding) and the penimi (inner, immanent) lights.

Role of the kav and its attributes. Makifim: surrounding light.

הנה מה שאמרנו כי מתפשט קו אור אחד נדק

Now when we said that a single thin line of light called the *kav* spreads forth

במקום הצמצום מהאור העליון אשר נסתלק ועלה,

into the region of the *tsimtsum* from the higher light that was withdrawn and ascended,

ומאותו הקו אור נעשה כל המציאות דעולם התחתון.

and from that *kav* of light the entire existence of the lower world¹ was fashioned.

הנה ישנו באותו הקו ב' בחי'

Now in this *kav* there are two aspects:

אחד הוא כל ההתלבשות דשתיים שהן ארבע אשר אמרנו לעיל
שער ה' פ"ב ופ"ג

One, the entire process of enclothing – called *hitlavshut* – the 'two that are four' – as we explained above Sha'ar 5, chapters 2 & 3.

והיינו כי יורד ומתפשט מאור העליון וכן מכל העליונים כלם

Meaning to say, there descends and diffuses from the superior light, and from all the superior levels,

ומתלבשים בהארתם בהקו בהבחינת דשתיים שהן ארבע וכמו
שבארנו שם

a radiance that is clothed in the *kav* in the manner of 'two that are four' as explained there in *Sha'ar* 5, chapters 2 & 3**. **

והשני הוא כי הנה עקר העצמות דאור הקו

The second aspect of the *kav* is that the primary essence of the light of the *kav*

הוא באמת זולת כל ההתלבשות הנזכר

is truly independent of the process of 'enclothing' mentioned previously.

אלא שהוא מה ששייך לעצם התחתון גופה משרשו ומעקרו

Instead it is related to the essence of the lower aspect itself, in terms of its root and origin.

כי הנה נתן מהמאציל העליון ית"ש בכל אור עליון

This is because the Supernal Emanator, blessed be His name, imbued every supernal light

שרש ורשם להמציאות דהתחתון

with the root and the imprint of the lower aspects of existence.

והוא מנח גנז וטמיר באור העליון ומוכן לעולם רק להתחתון.

And this root and imprint is located in a concealed and secret manner in the supernal light, and is always primed exclusively for the lower aspects.

ובתחלה הנה הוא משרש בהעליון רק בכח לבד

Initially it the imprint of the lower aspect is rooted in the upper level only in potential,²

אך על ידי ירידת כל אור עליון והתפשטותו בתחלה במקום העתיד להתחתון כנ"ל פ"א,

but, via the descent of the supernal light and its initial diffusion below, into the place where the lower aspects would exist in the future, as explained previously (Part one)

הנה יוצא אז אותו השרש מהכח אל הפעל ומהעלם אל הגלוי

that root then emerges from potential to actual, and from concealment to revelation.

ומתגלה בו אז שהוא השרש דהתחתון.

And then it is revealed as the root of the lower aspect.

וכאשר מסתלק האור ועולה למעלה בעת הצמצום

When the light of the *Ohr Ein Sof* withdraws and ascends at the time of the *tzimtzum*

הנה מסתלק ועולה עמו אותו השרש דהתחתון ג"כ

then the root of the lower aspect ascends together with it.

והנה נתוסף לו בעליתו למעלה תוספת אור וברכה הרבה מאור א"ס העליון

Now when it the lower light ascends above to its root in the higher light,³ abundant additional light and blessing is added to it from the supernal *Ohr Ein Sof*.⁴

כי מקדם לא היה אלא רק בחינת שרש דק וקטן וכגרעיני פרי

For initially the connection of the lower light to the higher light was only like a slender, tiny root, like tiny seeds of a fruit.

אך בעליתו למעלה הנה נתוסף בו אור וברכה מלמעלה

but after its ascent above, light and blessing was added to it,

בתוספת מרבה על העקר

an additional abundance that is greater than the initial outlay.

ונעשה ונשלם לשרש שלם וכן מתלבש בו ומתיחד עמו כל
ההתלבשות דשתיים שהן ארבע

And thus it becomes fully manifested as a complete root, and within it is clothed and integrated the entire *hitlavshut* the 'enclothing process' of two that are four,

מכל האורות העליונים כלם

as well as all the supernal lights.

ומכל זה יורד ונמשך הקו אור בהצמצום ונבנה מהם כל הבנין
דאותו העולם אשר יורד בו וכנ"ל פ"ב:

From all of this the *kav* is drawn down via the *tzimtzum* and the entire edifice of that world that descends via the *kav* is built, as we explained in chapter 2.

והרי נמצא כי הקו הנה הוא מיסד משני בחי'

So it turns out that the *kav* is in fact comprised of two elements:

אחד הוא מאור עצמותו גופה שהוא עצמות האור השני לאותו
העולם

One is the essential light itself, which is the essence of the light appropriate for that world,

שיורד בו אשר הוכן לו מתחלתו מהמאציל עליון

that descends with it with the *kav* and was prepared from the outset for this by the Supernal Emanator.

והוא עקרו וחלקו השני אליו עצמו בסוף מעשה והוא במחשבה
תחלה

And this is the primary aspect and portion assigned to it as the final act of Creation that arose initially in thought.

והשני הוא כל ההתלבשות דשתיים שהן ארבע מכל האורות
העליונים כלם

The second aspect is the *hitlavshut* of 'two that are four' – the two aspects of *olam* (world) and *nefesh* (person)⁵ that subdivide into chambers and garments, bodies and

souls,

הַמְשִׁתָּתִּיפִים עִמּוֹ וּמִתְיַחֲדִים בּוֹ וְכֵן "ל שֶׁ"ה פ"ג.

that join with it with the *kav* and are united in it, as explained above Sha'ar 5 chapter 3.

אָמֵנָם הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה הָאוֹר עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ אֲשֶׁר אָמְרָנוּ שֶׁיִּשְׁנֶה בְּכָל עוֹלָם

Indeed, the essential light that is in every world, as we stated,

הֵנָּה הוּא גַם כֵּן בִּב' בְּחִינֹת אֶחָד פְּנִימִי וְאֶחָד מְקִיף

is also manifested in two aspects: one aspect that is internalized, and the other – encompassing.

כִּי הֵנָּה כָּל מְצִיאת הָקוֹ אֲשֶׁר אָמְרָנוּ הֵנָּה הוּא בְּבִחִינַת אוֹר וְכָלִי

For the entire character of the *kav*, as we mentioned, is that it has two aspects – 'light' and 'vessel.'

כִּי עַל יְדֵי זֶה הוּא רַק בְּבִחִינַת קוֹ דָּק כִּי הַכָּלִי שָׁבוּ מִצְמָצְמוֹ וּמִגְבִּילוֹ

And for this reason it is only a *thin* line of light – because the vessel aspect therein constricts and limits it.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ הַכָּלִי מִכַּח הַצְמָצוֹם אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט בּוֹ

And the 'vessel' is formed in it by the power of the *tzimtzum* that permeates it,

כִּי הָרִי הָקוֹ הוּא מִתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּהַצְמָצוֹם כֵּן"ל.

since the *kav* extends out via the *tzimtzum*, as noted previously.⁶

וְעַל כָּל פְּנִימִים הוּא כִּי הָקוֹ הוּא בְּבִחִינַת אוֹר וְכָלִי

In any event, the *kav* is comprised of 'light and vessel,'

וְכַאֲשֶׁר נִכְנַס הָאוֹר בְּהַכָּלִי הֵנָּה נִחְלָק לְשָׁנִים שְׁלֹשׁ נִכְנַס בְּהַכָּלִי

אֶלָּא רַק חֵלֶק קָטָן מִמֶּנּוּ

and when the light enters the vessel it is divided into two, since only a fraction of the light enters the vessel,

אֲבָל הַחֵלֶק הַיּוֹתֵר גָּדוֹל הוּא נִשְׁאָר מִבְּחוּץ וּמִקִּיפּוֹ מִסָּבִיב

while the majority of the light remains outside of it, enveloping it on all sides.⁷

וְהָרִי לָנוּ כִּי גַם הָאוֹר עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם הֵנָּה הוּא גַם כֵּן בִּב'

בְּחִינֹת אֶחָד פְּנִימִי וְאֶחָד מְקִיף.

Thus we have it that even the essential light in every world also presents in two aspects – one, internalized light (*ohr pnimi*), and the other, enveloping light (*ohr makif*).

וְהִנֵּה תוֹעֵלֶת הַמְּקִיפִים הוּא כִּי הָרִי הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הִנֵּה הוּא
מִצְמָצֵם בְּהַגּוּף וְכָלִי

Now the superiority of the enveloping light is that the *ohr pnimi* the internalized light is constricted within a body and a vessel, whereas the *ohr makif* (the enveloping light) is not constricted by a body or vessel.

וְהֵם אֵינָם מִנְגִּידִים זֶה לָזֶה לְעוֹלָם אֶלָּא אֲדִרְבָּה שְׁמִתִּיחֲדִים זֶה בָּזֶה

Now these lights the *ohr pnimi* and the *ohr makif* do not ever oppose one another. The opposite is true – they unite with one another,

וְאֵינּוּ פוֹעֵל כָּל אֶחָד אֶלָּא ע"י חֲבֵרוֹ

and each of them has an effect via the other as will be explained below.

כִּי פְעֻלַּת כָּל אוֹר הַפְּנִימִי שֶׁהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הָרִי הוּא ע"י הַגּוּף

The *ohr pnimi*, which is the soul the *neshama***, acts via the body** which comes from the *ohr makif*,

וּפְעֻלַּת כָּל הַגּוּף הָרִי הוּא רַק בְּכַח הַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבוֹ

and the entire body acts only by virtue of the soul within it.

וּשְׁנֵיהֶם שׁוֹלְטִים בְּשָׂוָה וּמִסְתַּכְלִים זֶה עַל זֶה

Both of them the body and the soul are equally in control, and each looks to the other for affirmation.

כִּי הַגּוּף מִסְתַּכֵּל עַל הַנִּשְׁמָה לְשֵׂאב מִמֶּנָּה חַיּוּתָהּ תָּמִיד

The body looks to the soul for the life-force that it draws from the soul,

וְהַנִּשְׁמָה מִסְתַּכֵּל עַל הַגּוּף שֶׁלֹּא לִיגַע אוֹתוֹ וְשֶׁלֹּא לַפְעֵל בּוֹ יוֹתֵר
מִכּוּחַ

and the soul looks at the body to ensure that it is not exhausting it, and is not taxing it beyond its capabilities.

וְלָכֵן הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה הַגִּם שֶׁמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּכָל עוֹלָם וּפְרָצוֹף תַּחְתּוֹן

And therefore, although there is clothed in every lower world and *partzuf*

מִכָּל הָאוֹרוֹת הָעֲלִיּוֹנִים כָּלָם וְכָנ"ל שֶׁ"ה פ"ג

some of all the supernal lights, as mentioned in Sha'ar 5 chapter 3,

עִם כָּל זֶה הִנֵּה אֵינָם מִתְגַּלִּים בּוֹ אֶלָּא בְּמַעוֹט הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי

nevertheless, they are not revealed in it in that lower world more than the minimum necessary,

הֵינּוּ לְפִי כַח הַגּוּף וְהַכֹּלִי שְׂיוֹכֵל לְקַבֵּל וְלִסְבֹּל

i.e., according to the capacity of the body to receive and withstand,

ומתצמצמים כל האורות שמתלבשים בו לפי כח הגוף

and all the lights that are clothed in the body are constricted according to the capacity of the body to receive etc.

ומעלים אותו ומזככים אותו רק לאט לאט ובמעוט גדול

And they the lights that are clothed in the body elevate and refine it only gradually, in a greatly reduced manner.

כי באם שהיו מתגלים בו בתקף אורם היתה מתבטל הגוף וכלי מכל
וכל

For if they the illuminations of the soul and likewise the supernal lights would be revealed in the body in their full power, the body and the vessel would be completely nullified,

ואז היתה חוזר גם כל האור בלו למעלה ולשרשו

and then all the light would then return to its source above,

כי אין להאור הפנימי מקום ועמידה בהעולם התחתון

since the *ohr pnimi* has no place and standing in the lower world

אלא רק ע"י הגוף וכלי שמתלבש בו

other than by way of the body and the vessel in which it is clothed.

אמנם האור המקיף הנה הוא אינו כן כי הרי הוא אינו מתלבש
בהגוף והפצוץ כלל

However, this is not so regarding the *ohr makif* since it is not clothed in a body or a *partzuf*⁸ at all,

ולא נתצמצם באורו לפי כח הגוף

and its light is not constricted according to the capacity of the body to receive,

והנה אינו צריך הוא להשתוות את עצמו עם הגוף מאומה

and so it does not have to align itself with the body at all,

כי מה שפועל הוא הנה אינו נמשך פעלתו ע"י הגוף כלל

since the way it operates it not by way of the body at all.

וממנו הוא כל הנסים הנגלים אשר הם כלם למעלה מהטבע
לגמרי

And from it from the *ohr makif* come all the revealed miracles that completely transcend the natural order.

ומשום שלא נמשך פעלתו ע"י הגוף

And since it does not operate via the body,

וְלָכֵן אֶפְשָׁר לוֹ לְצֵאת וּלְהִתְגַּלֵּה בְּתִקְףִי אֹרֹךְ לְמַעַלְה מִכֹּחַ הַגּוּף
לְגִמְרִי

it is possible for the *makif* light to emerge and become revealed in its full strength, completely transcending the limitations of the body,

וְלַעֲשׂוֹת הֶפְכוֹ וְעַם כָּל זֶה אֵינוֹ גּוֹרֵם שׁוּם בְּטוֹל לְהַגּוּף

and act the opposite of it of the body's limitations and still not cause any nullification of the body.⁹

אֲלֹא הוּא עוֹשֶׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ גַּם בְּעֵת שֶׁהַגּוּף קָיָם וּבִתְוֹךְ הַגּוּף עֲצָמוֹ

Instead, it operates while the body continues as usual, and even in the body itself,

וְעַם כָּל זֶה אֵינוֹ מְבַטֵּל אוֹתוֹ וְאֵינוֹ מְזִיז אוֹתוֹ מִמְקוֹמוֹ כְּלָל

yet it still does not nullify the body or move it from its proper place at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהַגּוּף עוֹמֵד עַל עַמְדוֹ וְהָאֹר עוֹשֶׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוּף
עֲצָמוֹ, הַגַּם שֶׁהוּא הֶפְכוֹ לְגִמְרִי.

The body remains as is and the *makif* light operates in the body itself, even though it is completely the opposite of the body i.e. of the body's limitations.

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁמְצִינֵנוּ הַרְבֵּה נִסִּים כִּיּוֹצֵא בּוֹ כְּגוֹן מְקוֹם הָאָרוֹן וְהַכְּרוּבִים
שֶׁלֹּא הִחְזִיקוּ מִדָּה (בְּבֹא בְּתָרָא צ"ט א')

We find many miraculous events of this sort in Scripture, such as 'the Ark and the Cherubim on top of it took up no space' in the Holy Temple**¹⁰** (Bava Batra 99a).

וְכָגוֹן עוֹמְדִים צְפוּפִים וּמִשְׁתַּחֲוִּים רְחוּסִים (אָבוֹת פ"ה)

And for example the people in the Courtyard of the Temple who stood crowded together, yet when they bowed they had plenty of room (Avot 5:5),

וְנֵר שֶׁל מַעֲרְבִי שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה כְּבֶה, וְאֵשׁ שֶׁל מַעֲרָכָה שֶׁהָיָה מִתְגַּבֵּר
(יוֹמָא צ"ט א'),

and the western candle did not go out but burned until it was time to relight the Candelabra in the Temple at dusk, despite the fact that it had the same measure of oil as all the other candles that did go out sometime in the morning.

וְכָגוֹן הַנֵּס דְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה,

And like the miracle of Chanukah where a single jar of oil, that was normally enough for one night only, lasted for eight days.

וְכֹן בֵּר' חֲנִינָא בֶן דְּסָא "מִי שֶׁאָמַר לְשִׁמּוֹן וְיִדְלֶק יֶאֱמַר לְחֻמְץ וְיִדְלֶק"
וְהָיָה דוֹלֵק וְהוֹלֵךְ כָּל הַיּוֹם כְּלוּ (תַּעֲנִית כ"ה)

And similarly with the miracle that happened with **Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa** when his daughter by accident poured vinegar into the candles instead of oil and lit them. Rabbi Chanina told her not to be upset, because **the One Who said "oil shall burn, will say vinegar shall burn"** and they burned the entire day until the Sabbath was over (Talmud **Taanit 25a**).

וְכֹן בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ ע"ה וְחֲנַנְיָה מִיִּשְׁאֵל וְעֲזַרְיָה בְּכַבֵּשׁוֹ הָאֵשׁ
(פְּסָחִים קי"ח א' וְע' זוה"ק אַחֲרֵי מוֹת נ"ז א' וּבַהֲגֵר"א בִּסְפַד"צ פ"א
דַּה"מ דְּכָתִיב זֶה יֵאמַר)

And similarly with our Patriarch Avraham,¹¹ may peace be upon him, and with Chanaya, Mishael and Azarya who were all thrown into a furnace (see Daniel chapter 3; Pesachim 118a; Zohar *Acharei Mot 57a*; GRA in *Sifra d'Tzniuta* chap. 1).

וְכַיּוּצָא בְּזֶה נִסִּים הִרְבֵּה שֶׁהָיָה הַנֵּס בְּתוֹךְ הַטֶּבַע עֲצָמָה גַּם בְּעֵת
שֶׁהַטֶּבַע הָיָה עַל עֲמָדָה

And there were many other miracles that took place clothed in natural events, while the natural order itself remained unchanged.

שֶׁהָיָה לֹא נִתְרַחֲבוּ כְּתָלֵי בֵּית קֹדֶשׁ הַקִּדְּשִׁים בְּשִׁבְלֵי הָאֲרוֹן
וְהַכְּרוּבִים

So, for example, the walls of the Holy-of-Holies did not widen for the Ark and the Cherubim,

וְכֹן לֹא נִתְרַחֲבָה הָעֲזָרָה בְּעֵת שֶׁהִשְׁתַּחֲווּ רוּחִים

nor did the Courtyard expand when they bowed and still had plenty of room, even though the Courtyard was packed.

עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁהִגְבִּיהַ הַפִּתְחֵי שְׁעָרִים בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁהִכְנִיס שְׁלֹמֹה אֶת אֲרוֹן
הַקֹּדֶשׁ לְבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְכַמ"ש בַּמ"ר בְּהַעֲלֵתָּ סִימָן י"ג

However, the natural order was suspended in the case where the gates lifted up when Shlomo King Solomon brought the Holy Ark into the Temple, as *Bamidbar Rabba, Beha'alotecha 13:15* states.¹²

וְהִגֵּם שְׁזָה ג"כ נֵס גָּדוֹל אֲךְ עַל כָּל פָּנִים הָרִי נִשְׁתַּנָּה הַטֶּבַע שָׁם
וְנִתְבַּטְּלָה

Now although this too was a great miracle, nevertheless, the natural order was changed in that case and the laws of nature were temporarily nullified.

וְעַל שֶׁבֶת ל' ע"א וְכֵן בְּמִדְרַשׁ תְּהִלִּים מְזֻמֹּר כ"ד שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֵׁם אוֹתוֹ
הַנֵּס בְּאֶפֶן אַחֵר

See Talmud Shabbat 30a and Midrash Tehillim 24 which describe this miracle in a different way.

אֲךָ עַל כָּל פָּנִים הוּא כִּי נִתְבַּטְּלָה הַטִּבֵּעַ שֵׁם מִשָּׂא"כ בְּעֶנְיָנָנוּ

In any event, the natural order was temporarily nullified in that case, but not in those mentioned above,¹³

הָרִי נִשְׁאָרוּ הַכֶּתֶלִּים עַל מְקוֹמָן וְהָיָה מוֹעֵט מַחְזִיק אֶת הַמְּרֻבָּה

for the walls of the Holy-of-Holies and of the Courtyard remained in place, and a small area held a large number of people.

וְהוּא נֵס יוֹתֵר גָּדוֹל שֶׁנִּשְׁאָר הַטִּבֵּעַ עַל מְקוֹמָהּ וְהַנֵּס נַעֲשֶׂה מְכַל
מָקוֹם וְלֹא בִטְלוּ זֶה אֶת זֶה

This is an even greater miracle, since the natural order was unchanged and the miracle nevertheless took place without one nullifying the other.

וְעַל עוֹד בִּב' ר פ' ה' סִימָן ז' וְכֵן בּוֹיֶק"ר פ"י סִימָן ט' שֶׁחֲשָׁבוּ שֵׁם עוֹד
כִּמָּה נִסִּים ע"ד זֶה

See further: Bereishit Rabba 5:7; Vayikra Rabba 10:9 where they list a number of other miracles of the same sort.

וְכֵן הוּא בֵּר' חֲנִינָה בֶן דּוֹסָא הִנָּז' שֶׁהָרִי לֹא נִתְהַפֵּךְ הַחֲמֵץ לֶשֶׁמֶן

And similarly with the miracle that happened with Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa, who said that vinegar can also burn, since the vinegar was not transformed into oil,

וְכֵן הָרִי לֹא נִתּוּסַף שֶׁמֶן בְּנֵר מַעֲרָבִי וְנֵר חֲנֻכָּה

and similarly, no oil was added to the Western candle, nor to the Chanukah candle,

וְלֹא נִכְבְּהָ הָאֵשׁ בְּכִבְשָׁן בְּחֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וְעֲזַרְיָה

and the fire in the furnace into which Chananya, Mishael and Azarya were thrown.

אֲלֹא הָיָה כָּל הַנִּסִּים הֵלְלוּ בְּתוֹךְ הַטִּבֵּעַ עַצְמָהּ

Rather, all of these miracles took place within the natural order itself.

וְכָל זֶה הֵנָּה הוּא מִבְּחִינַת אוֹר הַמְּקִיף כִּי הוּא הוֹלֵךְ וּמֵאִיר בְּתִקְוָה
אוֹר

All of this is due to the *ohr makif* (the transcendent light) which continues and illuminates with all the power of its light,

וְעוֹשָׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ גַּם בְּעֵת שֶׁהַגּוֹף עוֹמֵד בְּכָל עֲבִיּוֹתוֹ וְצִמְצוּמוֹ וּבְכָל תְּכוּנוֹתָיו

and has its effect even when the body remains in all its coarseness and the constriction of its qualities.

וְעוֹשָׂה הָאוֹר אֶת כָּל פְּעֻלָּתוֹ גַּם בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוֹף עֲצֻמוֹ

Moreover, the *makif* light has its effect even within the body itself

וְעַם כָּל זֶה אֵינוֹ מַבְטֵל אוֹתוֹ כֻּלָּל הַגֵּם שֶׁהוּא הַפְּכוֹ

and yet it does not nullify it the body at all, even though it is its opposite.

וּכ"ז הוּא מְשׁוּם שֶׁכָּל פְּעֻלַּת אוֹר הַמְקִיף הוּא אֵינוֹ ע"י הַגּוֹף כֻּלָּל

And all of this is because the entire operation of the *ohr makif* is not via the body at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהוּא פְּעֻלַּת הָאוֹר עֲצֻמוֹ בְּלִתִּי כָּלִי

Rather, it is an operation of the light itself without a vessel.

וְלָכֵן אֵינוֹ מֵרְחִיק אֶת עֲצֻמוֹ לְהַשְׁתּוֹת עִם הַגּוֹף וְכָלִי כֻּלָּל

And therefore it does not distance itself in order to accord with the body or the vessel at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהוּא עוֹשֶׂה אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ גַּם בְּעֵת שֶׁהֵם עוֹמְדִים בְּכָל עֲנִיּוּתָם

Instead, it produces its effects as they the body and the vessel remain in their totally impoverished state

וְעַם כָּל זֶה אֵינָם מַבְטֵלִים זֶה אֶת זֶה וְאֵינָם סוֹתְרִים זֶה אֶת זֶה הַגֵּם שֶׁהֵם הַפְּכִים

and yet they do not nullify each other the vessel and body do not nullify the light, or vice versa and they do not contradict one another, even though they are opposites.

כִּי זֶהוּ מִפְּעֻלַּת הַנְּסִיטָה לְהַאִיר בְּלִי גְבוּל גַּם בְּתוֹךְ גְּבוּל

For this is one of the miraculous effects of the *ohr makif* – it illuminates in an unlimited manner even within limitation within the vessel and the body that are subject to the laws of nature.

וּבְהִיּוֹת הַכֹּל הוּא בְּכָל, וְאֵין דְּבַר חוּצָץ לְפָנָיו

And being that it the *ohr makif* is everything in the sense of all-encompassing, it is in everything and nothing is a barrier to it,

וְהָרִי הוּא מְאִיר בְּאוֹרוֹ וְדְבוּק וְנוֹגֵעַ גַּם בָּהֶם וְעַכ"ז אֵינוֹ מִזִּיז אוֹתָם מִמְקוֹמָם כֻּלָּל

and so its light illuminates and cleaves to and is relevant to them the vessels and bodies as well, and yet it does not dislodge them from their place at all.

וְהָיָה נִמְצָא כִּי תְכוּנַת אוֹר הַמְקִיף הוּא בְּהִפּוּךְ לַגְּמָרִי מֵהָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי

So it turns out that the characteristics of the *ohr makif* are the opposite of those of the *ohr pnimi*.

כִּי הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הֵנָּה הוּא דוֹחֵק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ לְהַשְׁתּוֹת עִם הַגּוֹף בְּכָל הָאִפְשָׁרִי

Because the *ohr pnimi* exerts itself to accord with the body or the vessel as much as possible,

וְבוֹ תְלוּי כָּל קִיּוֹם הַגּוֹף וּבִטּוּלוֹ כִּי הֵיא מְאִיר בְּהַגּוֹף וּמַחֲיָה אוֹתוֹ

and the entire continuing survival of the body or its nullification depends upon the *ohr pnimi* since it illuminates the body and enlivens it,

וְנִמְשָׁךְ אוֹר חַיּוּתוֹ בְּהַגּוֹף בְּמִדָּה וּבִמְשָׁקָל

and its illumination and life-force is drawn into the body in a limited manner.

כִּי אִם יִתְמַעַט אוֹרוֹ מִמֶּנּוּ מֵהַשְׁעוֹר הַמְסַפִּיק לְכַדֵּי חַיּוּתוֹ

For if the quantity of light from the *ohr pnimi* is less than the measure sufficient to enliven it the body

אוֹ שִׁיתַּגְבֵּר אוֹרוֹ בּוֹ יוֹתֵר מִכַּחוֹ אֲזִי יִחַלֵּשׁ הַגּוֹף וְהוֹלֵךְ וְנָמַס עַד שִׁיָּשׁוּב הָעֶפֶר עַל הָאָרֶץ כְּשֶׁהָיָה

or the light increases to more than the body's capacity to bear it then body will weaken and continue to wane until it returns to the dust of the earth as before.

וְלָכוּ נִמְשָׁךְ וּמִתְגַּלָּה אוֹרוֹ בְּהִגָּר רַק לֹאט לֹאט וּלְפִי כַּח הַגּוֹף שְׂיוֹכֵל לִסְבֵּל

Therefore, its light is drawn down and revealed in the body gradually, according to the ability of the body to sustain the revelation,

כִּי כָּל פְּעֻלָּתוֹ וְגִלּוּיוֹ הוּא לְעוֹלָם רַק ע"י כְּלֵי הַגּוֹף

since its entire activity and revelation is always and only by means of the vessel of the body.

מִשָּׁא"כ אוֹר הַמְקִיף הֵנָּה הוּא אֵינוֹ דוֹחֵק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ לְהַשְׁתּוֹת עִם הַגּוֹף כָּלֵל

But this is not so with the *ohr makif* – it does not exert itself to accord with the body or the vessel at all,

כִּי אֵינוֹ פּוֹעֵל וּמִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הַגּוֹף מְאוּמָּה

since it does not act or become revealed via the body at all,

ואורו הוא תמיד למעלה ממדרגת ומדת הגוף

and its light always transcends the level and limitation of the body.

ובין כשאינו מתגלה כלל ובין כאשר מתגלה בתקף אורו

Whether it the *ohr makif* is not revealed at all, or whether it is revealed with all the power of its light,

הנה אינו גורם שום גרעון להגוף אלא שכל גלוי הוא רק לפעלת הנסיית לבד

it causes absolutely no deficiency in the body, since its entire revelation is only to bring about a miraculous effect,

להאיר ולפעל למעלה מהגבול גם בהיות כל החומר והגבול על מציאותו.

to illuminate and produce effects that transcend limitation, even while all the material and the finite remain in existence.

אמנם דע כי כל מה שאמרנו שהאור המקיף

However, be aware that everything we said regarding the *ohr makif* –

אינו משתנה עם הגוף ואינו תלוי חיותו בו הנה הוא רק על בחינת גלוי דאור המקיף

that it does not exert itself to find affinity with the body, and its life the life of the body is not dependent upon it – this is all in regard to the *revelation* of the *ohr makif*

והראות כחו ותקפו במה שהוא נבדל מהאור הפנימי.

and displaying its strength and power distinct from the *ohr pnimi* which is commensurate with the body it enlivens.

וגלוי הזה היא באמת אינו בתמידות כלל כי הוא רק לעתים ולפרקים.

In truth this revelation of the *ohr makif* is not constant at all; it only happens from time to time.

שהרי הנסים נגלים אינו אלא לפרקים וכן רק במקומות מיוחדים

For revealed miracles are only occasional and in select places,

כי גלוי דאור המקיף בתקף אורו במה שהוא נבדל מהאור הפנימי

since the revelation of the *ohr makif* with all the power of its light, in which it is dissimilar to the *ohr pnimi*,

הנה הוא עתה רק במעוט האפשרי עד לעתיד לבוא

is at this time only to the minimum possible until the future Time-to-Come *l'atid lavo*.

This refers to that aspect of the *ohr makif* that, were it to be revealed, would upend the order of Creation. ¹⁴

אמנם בצמצום ובהעלם הנה פועל ומאיר האור המקיף גם כן
תמיד

However, in a constricted and concealed manner the *ohr makif* does have an effect, and it also shines forth constantly.

ובזה הנה כל תהלוכותיו גם כן רק על דרך אור הפנימי.

In this respect its entire manifestation is also only in the manner of the *ohr pnimi*.

ואדרבה הוא, כי כל פעלת אור הפנימי וכחו

In fact, the opposite is true: all the activity of the *ohr pnimi* and its powers

הנה הוא רק מה שמקבל ושואב מאור המקיף אשר למעלה
ומסביביו

is only by virtue of what it receives and draws out of the *ohr makif* which transcends it and envelops it,

כי בו הוא קשור ואחוד וממנו שואב תמיד כל כחו ואורו

since it is bound to the *ohr makif* and is united with it, and from it the *ohr pnimi* draws all of its power and light,

ועל ידו הנה קשור אור הפנימי למעלה למעלה

and through it the *ohr pnimi* is bound on high

ומתלבש בו הארת כל העליונים כלם

so that all the radiances of the higher levels are clothed within it.

ונמשך תמיד הארת אור המקיף עצמו בהגוף גם כן להדבק עם
האור הפנימי שבו

The radiance of the *ohr makif* itself is drawn down continuously into the body as well, to join with the *ohr pnimi* therein,

כי האור הפנימי הוא משלם הארתו דרך הגוף מבפנים לחוץ

for the *ohr pnimi* sends its radiance via the body from within it to the outside,

והאור המקיף משלם בו הארתו מחוץ לפנים

while the *ohr makif* sends its radiance to it from outside in.

ועל ידי זה נתמלא כל הגוף באורן מבית ומבחוץ

Because of this the body is filled with the light of both of them, within and without,

ונעשה על ידי זה כלו חי באור הנר"נ שבו

and in this way the person is fully alive with the light of the *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* in them.

ובבחינת הזוהר הנה מאיר האור המקיף בכל התכונות כמו האור הפנימי ממש והוא גם כן תדירי

In this respect the *ohr makif* illuminates all the characteristics of a person exactly like the *ohr pnimi*, and it too is continuously active.

וכל מה שאמרנו לעיל מתכונות אור המקיף

Now everything that we said regarding the characteristics of the *ohr makif* –

שהוא בהפך מכל תהלוכות אור הפנימי

that it functions in the opposite way to the *ohr pnimi* –

הנה הוא רק בבחינת גלויו ובמה שמתגלה בתקף אורו להיות מאיר הוא עצמו,

is only as regards the aspect of revelation, and that which is revealed in the full power of its light, being that it itself comes into revelation,

זולת ההשתתפות באור הפנימי,

distinct from its partnership with the *ohr pnimi*.

והאור הזה הוא אינו תדירי ואינו מצוי עתה כלל

This latter aspect of the *ohr makif* is not constant, and is not prevalent at all in our times,

כי בזה הוא נמשך פעלתו בבלתו גבול ותכלית והוא רק אור הנסיי

for this is how its effect is drawn down in an unlimited, unbounded manner, and it is only as miraculous light

אשר למעלה מהטבע לגמרי וגלויי הוא עתה רק במעוט היותר אפשרי וכנ"ל

that transcends nature completely, the revelation of which is only to the minimum degree necessary nowadays, as explained previously.

אבל בהעלם הנה משלח אור המקיף את הארתו בהגוף גם כן תמיד,

Nevertheless, in a concealed manner the *ohr makif* does constantly emit its radiance to the body as well

לְהַחְיוֹת אֶתוֹ מִבְּחוּץ לְפָנִים ע"ד אֹר הַפְּנִימִי שֶׁמַּחְיָה אוֹתוֹ מִבְּפָנִים
לְחוּץ,

to enliven it from the outside in, in the same manner as the *ohr pnimi* enlivens the body from the inside out.

וּבְזֶה הֵנָּה מִתְצַמָּצֵם אֹר הַמְּקִיף ג"כ רַק לְפִי כַח הַגּוֹף

And in this aspect the *ohr makif* is also constricted according to the capability of the body,

וּמִשְׁתַּתְּף בְּזֶה עִם הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי לְעוֹלָם.

and it always partners with the *ohr pnimi*.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא מְכַל זֶה כִּי פִעֻלַּת אֹר הַמְּקִיף הוּא בְּב' בְּחִינּוֹת,

From all the above it emerges that the *ohr makif* is active in two respects:

הֵינּוּ ע"י הַגּוֹף וְשֵׁלָא ע"י הַגּוֹף וְהוּא בְּגָבּוּל וּבִבְלָתִי גָבּוּל.

via the body and not via the body; limited and unlimited.

אֲבָל הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי פִעֻלָּתוֹ הוּא רַק בְּגָבּוּל לְבַד וְרַק ע"י הַגּוֹף לְבַד.

But the effect of the *ohr pnimi* is only limited, and only via the body.

Footnotes

1. It seems that the 'lower world' referred to here refers not only to BiY"A, but to all the worlds post-*tzimtzum*. [↩](#)
2. All of this is *prior* to the diffusion of light from the upper level into the lower. [↩](#)
3. Makover. [↩](#)
4. Makover notes that the author explained in the previous chapter that every superior level is in the category of 'infinite' compared with the levels below it. [↩](#)
5. As noted previously, *Sefer Yetzirah* 6:1 refers to three aspects, *olam shana* and *nefesh* – space, time and being. However, time is only a later manifestation, and only in the lower worlds. Consequently, it is not mentioned here. [↩](#)
6. The Ba'al HaLeshem presents a new insight here – that the *kav* is actually an aspect of the *tzimtzum* (Makover). [↩](#)
7. A second new insight – since the *kav* also has the aspect of 'vessel', it too is divided into *ohr pnimi* and *ohr makif* (Makover). [↩](#)

8. A *partzuf* is the anthropomorphic representation of a *sefirah* or cluster of *sefirot* that fulfills a certain function described by the *partzuf*. For example, the *partzuf* of *Abba* (the *sefirah* of *chochmah*) has a role among the *sefirot* similar to the way a father has a role in the family unit. [↩](#)
9. By way of contrast see *Zohar* I, p.105 regarding all the prophets other than Moshe Rabbeinu: "They would fall on their faces at the time of prophecy and their physical strength would leave them..." [↩](#)
10. See also Talmud, *Megillah* 10b; *Yoma* 21a. Rashi explains: The space on each side of the Ark in the Holy-of-Holies measured ten cubits, and yet the entire space from wall to wall of the Holy-of-Holies measured twenty cubits altogether. So the Ark Moshe made took up no space. [↩](#)
11. He was thrown into a furnace: *Zohar* I, p. 18, 34; *Pirkei d'R' Eliezer* ch. 26; *Bereishit Rabba* 38:19 etc. [↩](#)
12. When King Solomon wanted to bring the Ark into the Holy-of-Holies, the gates were down and he said, "Lift up, gates for the Honored King!" The gates then asked, "And who is the honored king?" [since it could have been understood that Solomon was referring to himself]. But when he clarified that he was talking about the Almighty they immediately lifted up. [↩](#)
13. The miracles mentioned above where miraculous events took place, but they did not nullify the natural order. Rather, they took place within the natural order. [↩](#)
14. Makover. [↩](#)

Chapter 4 — How the makif (transcendent, surrounding) and the penimi (inner, immanent) lights are directed.

The or penimi and or makif have different reasons for how they function.

וְהִנֵּה ע"ד שְׁבָאֲרָנוּ שֵׁשׁ חֲלוּק בֵּין הַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי

As we explained in the previous chapter there is a clear distinction between the illumination from the internalized light (the *ohr pnimi*),

לְהַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹר הַמְּקִיף בְּהַפְּעוּלוֹת הַיּוֹצֵא מֵהֶם

and the illumination from the enveloping light (*ohr makif*) in terms of their effects.

כִּי הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי כָּל גְּלוּיוֹ הוּא ע"י הַגּוֹף וְיוֹצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ רַק פְּעֻלוֹת גְּבוּלִיִּים.

All the revelations from the *ohr pnimi* are via a body or vessel, and what emerge from it are limited effects.

אָבָל הַגְּלוּי דְּאוֹר הַמְּקִיף הוּא דִּוְקָא שְׁלֵא ע"י הַגּוֹף

However, the illumination from the *ohr makif* is explicitly not by way of a body or vessel,

וְיוֹצֵאִים מִמֶּנּוּ פְּעֻלוֹת בְּלֹתִי גְּבוּל וְכֶנֶּ"ל.

and what emerge from it are unlimited effects, as explained above.

כֵּן יֵשׁ חֲלוּק עַד"ז ג"כ בְּסִבַּת פְּעֻלוֹתֵיהֶם הַנִּמְשָׁךְ מֵהֶם לְהֶאָדָם.

Similarly, there is a further distinction along these lines in terms of what causes the effects to be drawn down to man:

כִּי סִבַּת פְּעֻלוֹת אוֹר הַפְּנִימִי וְכָל אוֹרוֹ וְגְלוּיוֹ

The cause of the *ohr pnimi*'s effects that are drawn down to man, and all its light and illumination,

הִנֵּה חֻקְהָ הַמְּאֻצִּיל ית"ש חֻקִּים גְּבוּלִיִּים לְזֶה אֲשֶׁר רַק עַל יְדֵיהֶם

are that the Emanator, may His Name be blessed, fixed (lit. Engraved) limiting laws as the exclusive basis around which

נִסְבֵּב וְנִמְשָׁךְ כָּל אוֹרוֹ וּפְעֻלָּתוֹ לְהֶאָדָם

all its light and effects would revolve, and be drawn down to man,

וְהִנֵּה הֵם כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה הַתַּחְתּוֹנִים בְּזָכוֹת אוֹ בְּחוּבָה

via the actions of those below – whether they arouse merit or liability.

ועל ידיהם נמשך כל פעולות אור הפנימי שהוא מצמצם בגוף וכלי.

Through them are drawn down all the activities of the *ohr pnimi* that are constricted into a body and vessel,

ומתנהג רק ע"פ הדין והמשפט להיות גומל לאיש חסד כמפעל

and it conducts itself according to law and justice, granting a person kindness commensurate with his own actions,

ולרשע רע כרשעתו

and to the wicked person according to his wickedness,

כי תהלוכות אור הפנימי הוא במדה ובמשקל ואינו עובר על גבולו.

since the paths of the *ohr pnimi* are measured and weighed, and do not step out of their bounds.

והוא גלוי ית"ש אשר בכל דרכי הטבע

And this is how He is revealed within the paths of nature

שחקק והטביע בהבריאה מששת ימי בראשית.

which He fixed and set as the disposition of the created world from the six days of Creation.

והם מסדרים בחיוב ונמנע ואפשר ואינו עובר כל אחד את חקו.

These laws of nature are arranged as the necessary, the impossible and the possible but not necessary, and none of them violates its boundaries.

וכ"ז הוא מפעלת אור הפנימי כנ"ל.

All of this is the effect of the *ohr pnimi*.

כן נמשך עד"ז ג"כ כל סבת אורו להאדם הכל רק לפי מעשיו

Similarly, there is drawn down to man the entire source of illumination – all of it only according to his deeds.

כי כשמתנהג ע"פ התורה והמצוה אז הוא בא בשכרו

Thus when a person conducts himself according to Torah and mitzvot, then he receives his reward –

להנות מטוב העולם כי כל העולם לא נברא אלא בשבילו.

and enjoys the goodness of the world, since the entire world was created only for this – for Torah and mitzvot**1** –

וכמו שהם כל הבטחות התורה בברכותיה וטובותיה

just as the Torah promises all its blessings and goodness,

שהם תלויים כלם רק בקיום התורה והמצוה.

which are all dependent upon fulfilling Torah and mitzvot.

וכמ"ש אם בַּחֲקוֹתַי תֵּלְכוּ כו' וְהָיָה אִם שָׁמוֹעַ תִּשְׁמָעוּ כו' וְהָיָה עִקֵּב
תִּשְׁמָעוּ כו'.

And as is written, "If you will go in My statutes..." (Leviticus 26:3), and "If you will indeed obey" (Deuteronomy 11:13), and "When in the end you will obey..." (Deuteronomy 7:12).

וְכֹן לְהִפְךָ כְּשֵׁי־עֲבָרוּ עַל הַתּוֹרָה אַז הוֹלֵךְ כָּל הָעוֹלָם לְנִגְדָם

And the opposite is also true: if they transgress the Torah, the entire world will go against them,

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהוּא כָּל הַקְּלָלוֹת שֶׁבְּתוֹרָה כִּי וְשֶׁבְּמִשְׁנֵה תּוֹרָה

as the curses in Vayikra (Leviticus) and in Devarim (Deuteronomy) state explicitly.

וְכֹן כָּל עֲנָשֵׁי הַתּוֹרָה כָּלָם.

And the same is true of all the punishments in the Torah.

וכ"ז הוּא הַכֹּל מֵהַחֲקִים וּגְבוּלִים דְּהָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי

All of this is in the purview of the statutes and limitations engraved into the *ohr pnimi*,

וְעַל יָדוֹ הוּא כָּל דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה בְּכָל חֲקוֹתֶיהָ וּמִשְׁפָּטֶיהָ,

and by its agency are all the laws of the Torah, its laws and judgments,

כִּי מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְחֻקֵּי הַבְּרִיאָה אֶחָד הֵם.

because the statutes of the Torah and the laws of Nature are one and the same.

שֶׁהָרִי הַבְּרִיאָה נִתְיַסְדָּה בְּטוֹב וְרָע

For since the Creation is established on the basis of good and evil,

וּכְמִ"ש (קִהְלֶת ז', יד) גַּם אֶת זֶה לַעֲמֵת זֶה עָשָׂה הָאֱלֹקִים טוֹב לַעֲמֵת
רָע וְרָע לַעֲמֵת טוֹב

as the verse (Ecclesiastes 7:14) states: "G-d made one thing opposite the other"

(Rashi: Goodness and reward for doing good, as opposed to evil and the punishment for doing evil) – good opposite evil, and evil opposite good.

וְכָל מְצִיאוֹת הָעוֹלָם הוּא הַכֹּל בְּתִמְרוֹה

Thus the way the entire world exists is as an exchange of one thing for another:

חַיִּים וּמֹת עֶשֶׂר וְעֹנֵי מִמְּשָׁלָה וְעֲבָדוֹת זָרַע וְשִׁמְמָה חֲכָמָה וְאוֹלֶת
שְׁלוֹם וּמִלְחָמָה.

life and death, wealth and poverty, leadership and servitude, fruitfulness and desolation, wisdom and foolishness, peace and war.

וְהֵם י"ד עֲתִים לְטוֹבָה וִי"ד עֲתִים לְרָעָה.

****These are the fourteen *itim* (**times) **for the good and fourteen *itim* (**times) for the bad mentioned in Ecclesiastes chapter 3.**

וְהֵם נִמְשָׁכִים בָּלֶם ע"ש מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

All of them are drawn from the statutes of the Torah –

כִּי טוֹבָה שְׁמוּרָה לְטוֹבִים וְרָעָה שְׁמוּרָה לְרָעִים.

because good is kept for those who do good, and evil for those who do evil.

אֲךָ כ"ז הוּא רַק מָה שְׁרָאוּי לְהִיּוֹת ע"פ חֻקֵּי וּגְבוּלֵי דָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי.

However, this is all in regard to what is appropriate according to the set laws and limitation of the *ohr pnimi*,

כִּי עַל יְדוֹ הוּא כָּל מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה בְּשִׁכְרָה וְעֲנָשָׁה שֶׁהֵם הַטוֹב וְהָרַע שֶׁבְּהִבְרִיאתָהּ.

for all the judgments of the Torah, in terms of reward and punishment for good and evil in Creation are by way of it the *ohr pnimi*.

מִשָּׁא"כ אֹר הַמַּקִּיף אֲשֶׁר תְּהִלּוֹת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בְּגִלּוּיוֹ הוּא בְּלִתִּי גָבוּל

But this is not true of the *ohr makif* which performs in a way of limitless revelation

כִּי הוּא אֵינוֹ מִצְמָצֵם כָּלֵל וְכֵן"ל.

since it is not constrained at all, as we discussed previously.

הִנֵּה כְּמוֹ כֵּן לֹא נִמְצָא אֵלָיו בְּהִבְרִיאתָהּ חֻקִּים וּגְבוּלִים כָּלֵל גַּם לְסִבַּת גִּלּוּיוֹ.

Now in similar fashion, no laws or limitations can be found in Creation expressing the reasons for its revelation,

כִּי הוּא לְמַעַלָּה מִהִבְרִיאתָהּ לְגִמְרִי וְהוֹן גִּלּוּיוֹ וְהוֹן סִבַּת גִּלּוּיוֹ.

for it transcends the Creation completely – both in its revelation and the reason for its revelation.

הֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם לְמַעַלָּה מִהִטָּבַע וּלְמַעַלָּה מִהַמָּדָה וְנִעְלָם סִבַּתוֹ מִכָּל בְּרִיָּה.

Both of them transcend nature and limitations, and the reason for it is hidden from every created being.

כי לא ניתן אליו בכל הבריאה כלה שום סיבה לסבב אותו ושום חוק וגבול למנע אותו.

For within Creation there is no reason triggering it nor any law or limitation inhibiting it.

וכבר אמרנו לעיל ספ"ג כי אור המקיף יש בו שני בחי'.

Now we already stated above (end of chapter 3) that the *ohr makif* has two aspects –

כי בבחי' אחת הוא מתיחד תמיד עם האור הפנימי

one aspect thereof is continuously united with the *ohr pnimi*,

ומשתתף גם הוא בכל הפעולות דגבול וצמצום ג"כ.

and it too participates in all the limited and constricted activities regulating the *ohr pnimi*. This is only a radiance of the *ohr makif*, as the author explained at the end of the previous chapter.

אמנם עי"ז הנה נמשך עוד שהגם שעקרו וגילוייו הוא רק לעתיד, וכמו שאמרנו שם,

Nevertheless, as a result of this radiance of the *ohr makif* another great advantage is drawn down (albeit that the primary aspect and revelation thereof will only be in the future, as we mentioned there) –

מכ"ז הנה ע"י יחודו בהאור הפנימי מתנהג האור הפנימי ג"כ תמיד

from all of this, due to the radiance of the *ohr makif* uniting with the *ohr pnimi*, the *ohr pnimi* also always performs

רק ע"פ הכוונה התכליתית אשר לאור המקיף.

only according to the final purpose-oriented intention of the *ohr makif*.

והנה הם כל הכבשי דרחמנא אשר בהנהגה תמיד

Now all of these are the secrets of how the world is always conducted, and are known only to the Merciful One.

אשר נעלם סבתם מכל בריה וכמ"ש וחסנתי את אשר אחן ורחמתי את אשר ארחם

The reasons for the way things are run are hidden from every creature, as the verse (Exodus 33:19) states, "I shall show favor to whom I choose to show favor, and I shall show mercy to whom I choose to show mercy,"

אע"פ שאינו כדאי והגון לכך.

even though they may not be fitting and worthy thereof.

וְכִן שְׁאֵלָה הַנּוֹדֵעַ דְּצָדִיק וְרַע לֹו רָשָׁע וְטוֹב לֹו וְכַמ"ש בְּרָכוֹת ז'.

Thus the well-known question arises regarding a righteous person who suffers and a wicked person who prospers, as the Talmud *Berachot 7a* discusses:

Moshe Rabbeinu wished to know the ways of Hashem, and one of the questions that he asked was this: "Master of the Worlds, why is it that in this world there is a righteous person who prospers and a righteous person who suffers? And a wicked person who prospers, and a wicked person who suffers?" The Almighty answered that a righteous person who prospers is a *perfectly* righteous person, and a righteous person who suffers is not perfectly righteous. Similarly, a wicked person who prospers is not completely wicked, whereas a wicked person who suffers is completely wicked. The Maharsha explains that one who is not completely righteous suffers in this world, so that he will merit the World-to-Come, whereas a person who is not completely wicked prospers in this world in order to reward him now for whatever good deeds he has, but he will not merit the World-to-Come.

וְכִיוֹצֵא בְּזֶה פְּלִיאֹת רַבּוֹת בְּהִנְהָגָה אֲשֶׁר נֶעְלַם סִבָּתָם מִכָּל בְּרִיָּה.

There are many other similar surprising matters regarding Hashem's conduct, the reasons for which are concealed from all created beings.

וְהִנֵּה הֵם מִהִנְהָגָתוֹ הַנֶּעְלָמָה ית"ש אֲשֶׁר מְנַהֵיג הַכֹּל תָּמִיד לְכוֹנֵת תְּכִלִּית הָאֲחֵרוֹן

All of these are products of His hidden manner of conduct, with which He guides everything at all times for the ultimate final purpose known to Him.

וכ"ז הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ וּבָא מֵאוֹר הַמְּקִיף ע"י יְחִוּדוֹ בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי.

And all of this is drawn from and emerges from the *ohr makif* by way of its unifying with the *ohr pnimi*.

וְהֵגֶם שְׁהָרִי נִרְאָה לְפִי זֶה סְתִירוֹת גְּדוּלוֹת

Now even though there appear to be huge contradictions

וּבִטּוֹל רַב בְּכָל הַחֻקִּים וּגְבוּלִים דְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי שֶׁהֵם כָּל מִשְׁפְּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

and a negation of all the statutes and limitations of the *ohr pnimi*, which are all the Laws of the Torah,

אֲךָ הוּא ית"ש גְּדוֹל הָעֶצָה וְרַב הָעֲלִילָה

nevertheless, He (blessed is His Name) "is great in counsel and mighty in deed" (Jeremiah 32:19),

וְעוֹשֶׂה נִפְלְאוֹת גְּדוּלוֹת לְבַדּוֹ,

And "He alone performs great wonders" (Psalms 136:4),

ומעמיד ומישר את הכל בפעולות וסיבובים נעלמים

arranging and organizing everything through hidden actions and indirect events

עד שלא נופל שום דבר ולא זז שום זיז כל שהוא

so that there is no skipping and no shifting, even a little,

מכל משפטי התורה ושכרה וענשה והכל באמת והכל בדיון.

of all the statutes of Torah and its rewards and punishments.

והכל באמת והכל בדיון.

Instead, everything is according to the truth and everything is according to the law.

אלא משום שנעשה כ"ז ע"י אור המקיף וע"י יחודו באור הפנימי
קנז'

But since it is all done by way of the *ohr makif* uniting with the *ohr pnimi*, as mentioned,

לכן נעלמים הם כל הדרכים הללו משום בריה

therefore all of these paths are concealed from any created being,

באשר שפעלת כל אור המקיף וכחו הוא למעלה מהבריאה לגמרי
וכנ"ל

since the activities of the *ohr makif* and its power completely transcend the Creation, as mentioned earlier,

ולכן אי אפשר לשום בריה להשיגו.

and therefore it is impossible for any created being to grasp this.

וזהו מה שכתוב בהי"ג מדות הרחמים שהם מהי"ג תקונים

This is what is meant by describing the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy as 'the Thirteen *Tikunim*'²

והם כלם מגלויי דאור המקיף שהוא למעלה מן המדה.

since they are all from the *ohr makif* that transcends limitations shining out

הנה כתוב שם ארך אפים ורב חסד ואמת.

Among the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy, the following is written (Exodus 34:6):
"Slow to Anger and Abundant in Kindness and Truth."

ואמרו ארך אפים לצדיקים ולרשעים

Regarding this our Sages **declared** (*Eruvin* 22a), He is "**Slow to Anger for the righteous and the wicked...**"

וע' תוספות ב"ק נ' רע"ב מה שהקשו שם כי נראה בזה סתירה מערובין לסנהדרין ע"ש.

[See Tosfot *Bava Kama* 50b who raise an apparent contradiction between Tractates *Eruvin* and *Sanhedrin*.

אך העקר הוא כי בערובין מדבר ברשעי עובדי אלילים

However, the main point is that *Eruvin* is referring to wicked idolaters

כי עליהם נאמר ומשלם לשנאיו אל פניו להאבדו.

regarding whom it states (Deuteronomy 7:10): "He will repay those who hate Him to their face and destroy them."

ועל זה סובב דברי הגמרא בערובין שם כ"ב ע"א. וע"ש י"ט א'.

It is around this verse that Tractate *Eruvin* 22a revolves. And see also 19a there.

אבל בסנהדרין קי"א סע"א שם מדבר ברשעי ישראל כמו שמבאר שם ע"ש.

But Tractate *Sanhedrin* 111a is referring to the wicked of Israel, as is explained there. See there.

ועם רשעי ישראל אינו מתנהג הקב"ה במדת ומשלם לשנאיו אל פניו להאבדו כלל וכלל ח"ו

With the evildoers of Israel the Holy One, blessed be He, does not act in the manner of "He will repay those who hate Him to their face and destroy them" at all, in any way, G-d forbid,

כמו שיתבאר למטה בדברינו. אלא רק]

as will be explained below. Only that... End of note**]

שהוא מאריך אף וגבי דליה וכמ"ש בתנחומא פ' תשא סימן כ"ו

He is "Slow to Anger" but will claim His due, as Midrash Tanchuma, *Parshat Ki Tissa*, 26 expounds

במעשה עגל שנאמר שם וביום פקדי ופקדתי.

regarding the golden calf, where it states (Exodus 32:34), "On the day I make a reckoning, I shall take into account their sin."

ומיסר ומעניש אותם אם בזה ובבא ובאפן שהעושה עברה נשאר והענש נפרע.

He will chasten and punish them, whether in this world or the next, in such a way that the sinner remains, while the sin is paid for.

וְזֶהוּ מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזוֹהַר "ק בְּרֵאשִׁית מ"ו ע"א כִּי בְיוֹם שְׁנֵי דְמַעֲשָׂה
בְּרֵאשִׁית

And this is what the Zohar (*Bereishit* 46a) states: On the Second Day of Creation

אֶתְּבָרִי גִיהֵנִם לְחִיבֵי עֲלָמָא כו' בְּיוֹם תְּלִיתָאִי אֶתְתַּקֵּן יוֹם שְׁנֵי כו'

***Gehinom* Purgatory was created for sinners in this world; on the Third Day of Creation the Second Day was rectified,**

וּבִיה אֲשֶׁתְּלִימוֹ רַחֲמֵי עַל חִיבֵי גִיהֵנִם.

for on that day compassion is achieved for those who are condemned to *Gehinom*;

בְּיוֹמָא תְּלִיתָאָה מִשְׁתַּכְּכִין (ר"ל נִשְׁקָטִים) שְׂבִיבִין דְּגִיהֵנִם כו'.

on the Third Day the fires of *Gehinom* die down etc. (meaning they are diminished).

וְהַכּוֹנֶה הוּא כִּי גַם הַיּוֹרְדֵי גִיהֵנִם אֵינָם נֶאֱבָדִים שֶׁם אֵלָּא נֶעְנְשִׁים
שֶׁם לֹאט לֹאט

The intention here is that those who descend to *Gehinom* are not destroyed there, but merely that they are punished bit by bit,

בְּאוּפֹן שֶׁהַעוֹשָׂה עֲבָרָה נִשָּׂאֵר וְהַעֲנֵשׁ נִפְרָע

in such a way that the sinner remains, while the sin is paid for.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר שְׂבִיבִים ג' נְתִיבָה וְנִשְׁלָם רַחֲמֵי עַל חִיבֵי גִיהֵנִם

This is why it states that on the Third Day of Creation compassion is established and achieved for those who are condemned to *Gehinom*,

וְהוּא כָּל עֲנֻשֵׁי גִיהֵנִם ג"כ רַק לְצֻרוֹ וּלְלַבּוֹן אֲבָל נִשָּׂאֵר לְהַשְׁאֵרָה
נִצָּחִית עכ"פ

and all the punishments of *Gehinom* are also only to decontaminate and get rid of the impurities of sins, but in any event they the sinners remain forever,

וְכֵן הוּא מְפָרֵשׁ בַּזוֹהַר פ' שְׁמוֹת דָּף כ"א ע"ב ע"ש.

as stated explicitly in *Zohar II* 21b.³ See there.

וְכֵן הוּא הַכּוֹנֶה בִּירוֹשְׁלָמִי תַעֲנִית פ"ב ה"א שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁם

This is also the intention of the Talmud *Yerushalmi Taanit* 2:1 [p. 9a] which states:

ר' אֲחָא ר' תַּנְחוּם בִּי ר' חֲזִיָּה בְּשֵׁם ר' יוֹחָנָן: אֶרְךָ אֵין כְּתִיב כָּאֵין
אֶלָּא אֶרְךָ אִפִּים.

Rabbi Acha and Rabbi Tanchum of the House of Rabbi Chiya said ****in the name of Rabbi Yochanan: **אָרַךְ אַף – 'Slow to Anger' in the singular is not stated here, but rather אָרַךְ אַפִּים – 'Slow to Anger' in the plural –**

מֵאַרְיֵךְ רוּחוֹ עַד שֶׁלֹּא יִגָּבֶה. הֵתְחִיל לִגְבוֹת מֵאַרְיֵךְ רוּחוֹ וְגָבֶה.

signifying that **He is slow to anger until He makes His claim** against the sinner to repay the debt owed to Him. **But even once He begins to claim, He is slow to anger while He claims.** And therefore the expression is in the plural, because in both situations He exhibits patience and compassion.

וְהַכּוֹנֵה הוּא ג"כ כִּי אֵינוֹ נִפְרָע בְּפַעַם אַחַת אֲלָא רַק לֵאט לֵאט.

The intention here is that He does not demand repayment in one large sum, but slowly, bit by bit,

**וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בֵּעָבוֹר ז' ד' ע"א רַק אֶתְכֶם יִדְעָתִי מִכָּל מִשְׁפָּחוֹת
הָאֲדָמָה עַל כֵּן אֶפְקֹד כו'**

as explained in Tractate Avodah Zara 4a, on the verse (Amos 3:2) "You alone did I know [or love – Rashi] from among all the families of the earth; therefore I will hold you to account for all your iniquities."

מִשָּׁל למה"ד כו' אֶחָד אוֹהֵבוֹ וְאֶחָד שׁוֹנְאוֹ

Explains the Talmud (ibid.): To what can this be compared? To a person claiming a debt owed to him by two people, one of whom is his friend, and the other his enemy –

אוֹהֵבוֹ נִפְרָע מִמֶּנּוּ מְעַט מְעַט שׁוֹנְאוֹ נִפְרָע מִמֶּנּוּ בְּבַת אַחַת.

He allows his friend to pay back his debt slowly, but his enemy must pay back all at once.

**וְהוּא כַּמ"ש קְדוּשִׁין ל"ו א' שִׁישְׁרָאֵל נִקְרְאוּ בָּנִים לְמָקוֹם אֲפִי בְּזִמְנָן
שֶׁהֵם רָשָׁעִים ח"ו**

This is also as stated in Tractate Kidushin 36a: Israel are called the children of the Omnipresent One, even when they are wicked, Heaven forbid,

וּמִבְּאֵר שֵׁם אֲפִי בְּעוֹבֵד עַב"ז רח"ל.

and the Sages explain there that this is even in a case of idolatry, heaven forbid.

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בְּיוֹמָא נ"ו נ"ז אֲפִי בְּזִמְנָן שֶׁהֵם טְמֵאִים שְׂכִינָה עִמָּהֶם.

And so too it states in Tractate Yoma 56-57 that the Shechinah is with them even when they are ritually impure.

וְלָכֵן כָּל מָה שֶׁגָּבֶה הַקֵּב"ה חוֹבָתוֹ מֵהֶם בִּישׁוּרִים וְעַנְשִׁים

And therefore, to the extent that the Holy One, blessed be He, claims payback for their debt by way of suffering and punishment

אֲשֶׁר בָּזָה וּבָבֵא הוּא הַכֹּל רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ צָרוּף וְלִבּוֹן

in this world and the next, this is all in a manner of cleansing and purging.

אָבֵל עִם רָשָׁעֵי אוֹ"ה הִנֵּה מִתְנַהֵּג הַקֵּב"ה עִמָּהֶם בְּמִדָּה

But with the wicked of the nations He conducts Himself in a measure-for-measure manner –

וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשֹׂנְאָיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהֶאֱבִידוֹ וּכְמ"ש בְּמִדְרַשׁ תְּהִלִּים מִזְמוֹר ז' סִי' י"ז.

repaying those who hate Him to their face and destroying them, as Midrash Tehillim 7:17 explains.

וְהוּא בְּסוֹד הַכְּתוּב הַלּוֹא אָח עָשׂוּ לִיעֲקֹב וְאוֹהֵב אֶת יַעֲקֹב וְאֶת עֵשָׂו שְׂנֵאתִי.

This is the secret expressed in the verse (Malachi 1:2-3): "Was not Esau the brother of Jacob... Yet I loved Jacob, but Esau I detested."

וּכ"ז הוּא מְכַבֵּשׁ דִּרְחֻמָּנָא אֲשֶׁר בְּסוֹד בְּרִית אָבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

All of this is of those matters that are kept secret by the Merciful One, by virtue of the mystical Covenant He made with the Patriarchs and Israel,

שֶׁהוּא בְּהִנָּהֵג אֹר הַמְּקִיף וְיַחְדּוֹ בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי

which is that these matters are conducted by the *ohr makif* as it unites with the *ohr pnimi*.

וְלָכֵן מִתְנַהֵּג עִמָּהֶם בְּרַב חֶסֶד וְאַמֶּת, שְׁעוֹשֶׂה עִמָּם רַב חֶסֶד וְעַכ"ז הוּא וְאַמֶּת

And therefore He acts towards them with 'Abundant Kindness' by letting them repay their debt slowly and nevertheless with Truth by ensuring that they eventually pay up to expiate their transgressions.

שֶׁהַכֹּל בְּמִשְׁפָּט וְהַכֹּל בְּדִין כִּי בְּהֶאֱרַת אֹר הַמְּקִיף הוּא נוֹשֵׂא עוֹן

For everything is according to the Law and with Justice, for by beaming out the *ohr makif* He forgives sin

וְסוֹבֵל וּמַעֲלִים עֵין מְסוּרָרִים וְטוֹב וּמַטִּיב לְרָעִים וּלְטוֹבִים

and patiently bears transgressions and averts His gaze from them, with goodness and doing good to the wicked and to the virtuous,

כִּי הוּא הוֹלֵךְ וּמֵאִיר שְׁלֵא ע"י מַעֲשֵׂה הַתַּחֲתוֹנִים כָּלֵל

because He continues to shine forth in a manner not commensurate with the deeds of those below,

וּלְמַעַלָּה מִן הַמִּדָּה לְגִמְרֵי זֶהוּ מִדַּת וְרַב חֶסֶד

and completely transcending any measure-for-measure response. This is the attribute of 'Abundant Kindness.'

אָבֵל ע"י יְחֻדּוֹ בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הֵנָּה הוּא גּוֹבֵה דְלִיָּה וְאִינוּ מוֹתֵר כָּלָל

But, by way of unifying with the *ohr pnimi* He claims the debt due to Him, and He does not compromise at all.

זֶהוּ מִדַּת וְאַמֶּת וּמִתְיַחֲדִים שְׁנֵיהֶם וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל בְּפַעֲלוֹת וְסִיבּוּבִים
נֶעֱלָמִים

This is the attribute of 'Truth.' Both attributes unite and everything is achieved by way of direct actions as well as indirect and concealed activities

בְּאִפֹּן שְׁמַתְקִימִים שְׁנֵיהֶם וְהוּא וְרַב חֶסֶד וְאַמֶּת בְּיַחַד:

in a manner that both attributes are satisfied – Abundant Kindness and Truth together.

Footnotes

1. See Shabbat 30b: [↩](#)
2. Makover notes that the author does not elaborate on what he means by this. However, the Arizal explains (*Eitz Chaim Sha'ar* 13, chaps. 4-5) that the 13 *Tikunim* flow from *Arich Anpin*, the first level of *keter*, which is an *ohr makif* as opposed to all the other *sefirot*, which are *ohr pnimi*. [↩](#)
3. The Zohar states as follows: [↩](#)

Chapter 5 — The mystery of the 13 tikunim (rectifications) of arikh, din (severity), gehenom (hell) applying to those who do wrong, and who will merit the world to come.

How is it that the 13 Attributes of Mercy flow from the 13 Attributes of Strict Justice? Apparent contradictions are resolved.

אָמַנִם הוּא הִנֵּה לְעֵיל פ"ג בְּאַרְנוֹ כִּי הָאֹר פְּנִימִי וְהָאֹר מְקִיף הֵם
מְשַׁרְשֵׁם אֶחָד הוּא

We explained in chapter 3 that the source of the illumination of the internalized light (the *ohr pnimi*), and the illumination from the enveloping light (*ohr makif*) is one and the same,

כִּי נִמְשָׁךְ הָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי מֵהָאֹר הַמְקִיף כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְבָאָר שָׁם
since the *ohr pnimi* is drawn from the *ohr makif*, as explained there.

וּא"כ הֵרִי נִמְצָא כִּי מִדַּת 'וְאַמֶּת' הוּא עֲצָמוֹ נִמְשָׁךְ מִמִּדַּת 'וְרַב חֶסֶד'

That being so, it turns out that the attribute of 'Truth'¹ is itself drawn from the attribute of 'Abundant Kindness.'²

וְעוֹד כִּי הֵרִי מִדַּת 'וְאַמֶּת' הֵרִי הוּא ג"כ מִי"ג מִדּוֹת הַרַחֲמִים

Furthermore, the attribute of 'Truth' is also one of the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy,

וְהֵם מֵהִי"ג תְּקוּנִים דא"א כִּי 'וְרַב חֶסֶד' הִיא תְּקוּנָה ו' 'וְאַמֶּת' הוּא
תְּקוּנָה ז'

and both of them are among the 'the Thirteen Tikunim,' for 'Abundant Kindness' is the sixth Tikun, and 'Truth' is the seventh Tikun,

וְכָל הִי"ג תְּקוּנִים הֵם כָּלֵם רַק אֹרוֹת מְקִיפִים כִּמ"ש בִּשְׁעָר א"א
פ"ח

and all of the Thirteen Tikunim are exclusively enveloping lights, as is explained in *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Arich Anpin* chapter 8.

אֲךָ לְבָאָר עֲנִינוּ זֶה הוּא בְּאַמֶּת עֵמֶק מְאֹד וְהוּא מֵהֶסּוּדוֹת הַנִּעְלָמִים

However, to explain this concept the Thirteen Tikunim of Arich Anpin one must truly plumb the depths – it is one of the hidden mysteries.

וְעַכ"ז הִנֵּה נִבּוֹא בְּחִזְקַת הַיָּד לְדַבֵּר בְּזֶה מַעֵט וְהוּא רַחוּם יְכַפֵּר.

Nevertheless, we will approach this 'with a strong hand'³ and discuss it briefly, and may Hashem forgive...

הֵנָּה נִדָּע הוּא מִדְּבָרֵי הַזֶּה "ק וְהָאֲרִיז" ל כִּי הִי"ג מְדוּת הֶרְחָמִים
אֲשֶׁר בִּפ' תִּשָּׂא

Now it is known from the words of the Zohar and the Arizal that the 13
Attributes of Mercy in *parshat Ki Tisa* Exodus 34:6 ff.

הֵם נוֹבְעִין וְיוֹצְאִין מֵהִי"ג תִּקּוּנֵי שְׁבַפְסוּק 'מִי א-ל כְּמוֹךָ'⁴ כּו' אֲשֶׁר
בְּמִיכָה בְּסוּפּוֹ

flow and emerge from the 13 Tikunim in the verse (Michah 7:18) "Who, O G-d,
is like You ..." at the end of Michah.

אֲלֹא בְּמִיכָה מְסוּדָרִים שֵׁם בְּדֶרֶךְ שְׂבַח כְּמוֹ שֶׁהֵם לְמַעַלָּה בֵּא"א
עֲצָמוֹ,

Except that in Michah they are arranged as a tribute to the way they are above
in *Arich* itself,

וּבִפ' תִּשָּׂא נֶאֱמָרוּ שֵׁם ע"ש גְּלוּיִים וְהִתְפַּשְׁטוּתָם לְמַטָּה בִּז"א לְצֶרֶךְ
הֶרְחָמִים

whereas in *parshat Ki Tisa* they are stated as revealed aspects flowing down to
Ze'ir Anpin for the purpose of compassion.

כִּי נִתְגַּלּוּ וְנִתְפַּשְׁטוּ מִלְּמַעַלָּה לְמַטָּה שֶׁהוּא מֵא"א לִז"א לְרַחֵם עַל
יִשְׂרָאֵל לְצוּרֶךְ אוֹתוֹ הַמֶּאֱרָע

For they become revealed and flow down from above to below – from *Arich*
Anpin to *Zeir Anpin* – in order to have compassion for Israel as required on that
particular occasion.

וְגִלּוּיִים לְמַטָּה הוּא בְּאוֹתָן הַתְּבוּת וְהַמְּלוּת אֲשֶׁר בִּפ' תִּשָּׂא

Their revelation below is by way of those very same letters and words in *parshat*
*Ki Tisa***.**

וְע' בֵּאד"ר קל"א וּבְדְּבָרֵי הָרַב בְּשֵׁעַר א"א פ"ט

See *Idra Rabba* p. 131 and in the words of the Rabbi – the Arizal – in *Eitz Chaim*,
Sha'ar Arich chapter 9.

וְהִנֵּה נֶאֱמָר בְּפִסּוּק מִי א-ל כְּמוֹךָ כּו' וְעִבֵּר עַל פֶּשַׁע שֶׁהוּא תִּקּוּן ג'

Now the verse states "Who, O G-d, is like You... Who commutes iniquity" –
which is the third Tikun,

וְאָמְרוּ בַּאד"ר קל"ג א' מַאי 'וְעוֹבֵר עַל פֶּשַׁע' דְּאֶקְדִּים שִׁי"ן לִפְ"א
וְנַעֲשֶׂה מִפֶּשַׁע שְׁפָע

and it states in *Idra Rabba* 133a: What is the meaning of "Who commutes iniquity"? He places the letter *shin* before the letter *peh* and thus *pesha* (iniquity) becomes *shefa* (an outflow of benevolence).

'Commutes' is therefore understood here in the sense of 'transpose' or 'switch' – by switching the order of the letters *pesha* becomes *shefa*.⁵

וְהוּא מִדֶּת 'וְחֲנוּן' שֶׁהוּא מִדָּה ג' אֲשֶׁר בִּפ' תִּשָּׂא וְהוּא יוֹתֵר מִ'רַחוּם'

This is the attribute of *v'chanun* (gracious), the third attribute of the 13 in *parshat Ki Tisa***, and it is more than 'compassionate'*** which is the second attribute in *parshat Ki Tisa*,

כִּי הוּא חוֹנֵן וְנַעֲשֶׂה מִפֶּשַׁע שְׁפָע

since He grants grace, and *pesha* is commuted to *shefa*.

וְהִנֵּה הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה הוּא קָשָׁה לְהַבִּין מֵאֵד אֵיךְ אֶפְשָׁר לְהַעֲשׂוֹת מִפֶּשַׁע
שְׁפָע

Now how it is possible for *pesha* to be commuted to *shefa* is a matter very difficult to understand

כִּי לֹא מְצִינוּ כָּזֶה אֶלָּא רַק בְּעוֹשֶׂה תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה

since we only find a similar phenomenon with those who repent out of love,

שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּיוֹמָא פו', ב' שְׂדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשָׂה לוֹ כְּזָכוֹת

regarding which the Sages stated in *Yoma* 86b that "deliberate transgressions are transformed into merits for him."

אֲבָל הִי"ג מִדּוֹת הֵם כָּלֶם בְּרַחֲמִים לְבַד כִּי עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר

But the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy are all compassion exclusively, for regarding them it states,

וְחֲנֹנִי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אֲחֹן וְרַחֲמֹתִי אֶת אֲשֶׁר אֲרַחֵם (שמות לג, יט) אע"פ שאֵינוּ כְּדֹאִי
וְהָיוּ לְכָךְ

"I will be gracious to those whom I wish to show grace, and I will be compassionate to those to whom I wish to show compassion" (Exodus 33:19) even though that person is not worthy thereof.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּשִׁמוֹת רַבָּה ס"פ מ"ה וְכֵן בְּתַנְחוּמָא שָׁם

A similar statement is made in *Shemot Rabba* end of chapter 45, and similarly in *Tanchuma* *ibid*.

כִּי הִי"ג מִדּוֹת הַרַחֲמִים הֵם מְאוּצָר גָּדוֹל שֶׁל מִתְנַת חֲנָם

that the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy are from the great storehouse of unearned gifts.

וְאָמְרוּ בִשְׁמוֹ"ר שֵׁם בְּפָסוּק (שמות לג, יט) 'אֲנִי אֶעֱבִיר כָּל טוֹבִי עַל
פָּנֶיךָ'

And our Sages in *Shemot Rabba* ad loc comment on the verse (Exodus 33:19), "I shall make all My goodness pass before you..."

כִּי 'כָּל טוֹבִי' הוּא מִדַּת הַטּוֹב וּמִדַּת הַפְּרָעָנוּת

"All My goodness" is both the attribute of good and the attribute of retribution

כִּי ע"י מִדַּת הַפְּרָעָנוּת שֶׁהוּא כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר בְּעוֹה"ז וְכוּ
לְאַחַר מִיתָה

because via the attribute of retribution, which includes all of the punishments in this world and also those after death,

הִנֵּה עי"ז יִזְכּוּ כָּלֵם לְכָל טוֹב הָעֵתִיד

by virtue thereof everyone will be worthy of all the goodness that will be bestowed upon them in the future.

וְהוּא הָאוֹצָר גָּדוֹל שֶׁל מִתְּנַת חֲנָם שְׁאֻמְרָנוּ

And this is the enormous storehouse of unearned gifts that we mentioned above.

אָמְנָם עכ"ז אֵיךְ שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה מִפְּשָׁע שֶׁפַּע זֶה קָשָׁה לְהַבִּין

Nevertheless, how *pesha* is transformed into *shefa* is hard to understand.

וְכוּ הוּא עַד"ז צָרִיךְ בְּאוֹר עוֹד כִּי הִנֵּה הַתְּקוּן ז' אֲשֶׁר בְּפָסוּק 'מִי אֵל
כְּמוֹךְ'

Similarly, further explanation is needed regarding the seventh Tikun in the verse in Michah, 'Who, O G-d, is like You',

מָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר שֵׁם (פסוק יט) 'יָשׁוּב יְרַחֲמֵנוּ' וּמִמֶּנּוּ יוֹצֵא וְנִמְשָׁךְ הַמִּדָּה
ז' מֵהִי"ג מִדּוֹת שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת 'וְאֱמֶת'

as it states there (Michah 7:19) 'He will again show us mercy', from which emerges the seventh attribute of the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy mentioned in *Ki Tisa* (Exodus 34:6 ff.) – the attribute of 'and Truth' which the author explained as the source of the revelation of the *ohr pnimi* that is manifested in limitation.⁶

וְהִרִי צָרִיךְ בְּאוֹר אֵיךְ יוֹצֵא מִדַּת 'וְאֱמֶת' מִ'יָּשׁוּב יְרַחֲמֵנוּ'

Accordingly, we need an explanation of how the attribute of 'and Truth' emerges from 'He will again show us mercy'

הָרִי הֵם כְּשֵׁנֵי הַפְּכִים זֶה מִזֶּה כִּי זֶה רַחֲמִים וְזֶה דִּין

since they are like two opposites – one being compassion and the other strict justice.

וע"ד שאמרו בראש השנה י"ז ב': ר' אלעזר רמי כתיב (תהלים סב,
(ג) 'ולך אדני חסד'

This is similar to what our Sages noted in Tractate Rosh HaShana 17b: Rabbi Elazar presents a contradiction – in Psalms 62:13 it is written 'Yours, O Lord, is kindness'

וכתיב (שם) 'כי אתה תשלם לאיש כמעשהו'

and the same verse continues 'For You repay each person according to their deeds.'

בתחלה כי אתה תשלם לאיש כמעשהו ולבסוף 'ולך אדני חסד'
וע"ש בתוספות

How could both of these be true – initially, 'You repay each person according to their deeds,' and yet in the end 'Yours, O Lord, is kindness.' See Tosafot there.⁷

עוד שם אלפא רמי כתיב 'ורב חסד' וכתיב 'ואמת' בתחלה 'ואמת'
ולבסוף 'ורב חסד'

Furthermore, in the same section Ilfa (a second generation Amora from Israel) also presents a contradiction: It is written in the Thirteen Attributes 'Abundant Kindness' and it is written 'and Truth' – but the resolution is initially 'and Truth,' but nevertheless in the end 'Abundant Kindness.'

The resolution of both these contradictions is that the attribute manifested at the outset is replaced by a different attribute later on. However, as the author will ask shortly, how could it be that the attribute of strict justice is *transformed into* compassion? That would seem to be impossible.

אבל שימשך מדת 'ואמת' ממדת 'ישוב ירחמנו' הלא לכאורה זה אי
אפשר בשום פנים

But that the attribute of 'and Truth' can emerge out of the attribute of 'He will again show us mercy' would seem to be impossible at first glance.

וגם תרוצו של הגמרא הוא לכאורה אינו מדקדק

Furthermore the Talmud's resolution of the contradiction does not seem to be precise

כי הרי בהפסוק כתיב להפך בתחלה 'ורב חסד' ואח"כ 'ואמת'.

since the terms in the verse are written in the opposite order – first 'Abundant Kindness' and afterwards 'and Truth,' and not vice versa.

אך הענין בכ"ז הוא כי הנה נודע הוא כמה גדול עמק הדין

However, the idea is as follows: The extent of the depth of Divine Judgment is known to us

והכתוב אומר (קהלת יב, יד) 'האלהים יבא במשפט על כל נעלם'

as the verse states (Ecclesiastes 12:14) 'For G-d will judge every deed – even matters that are hidden – whether good or evil.'

ואמרו (ב"ק נ, א) כל האומר הקב"ה ותרן כו' אמנם כ"ז הוא אינו לנקמה ח"ו

And regarding this our Sages in the Talmud (*Bava Kama* 50a) declared, 'Anyone who says that the Holy One, blessed is He, is lenient' could be forfeiting his life...

אלא כדי לתן שארית ואחרית טוב גם לנפש החוטאת לנקותה מחלאתה וזהמטה

However, in order to permit even a sinning soul to survive and reach a positive ending, by cleansing it of its disease and infection,

ולצרפה וללבנה שתהיה ראויה להשאר בהשאה נצחית ולהאיר באור פני מלך חיים

and refining and purifying it so that it will be worthy of eternal life, and will be illuminated by the light of the Countenance of the Living King, the Almighty,

בימות המשיח אשר מזמן תחית המתים והלאה ולחיי העולם הבא

in the Messianic era from the time of the resurrection and on to life in the World to Come –

והרי נתיסדו כל הז' מדורי גיהנום

for this the seven levels of Gehinnom were established

כמבאר במדרש כונן ובמדרש תהלים י"א ובזהר חדש רות בארכה ועי' עירובין י"ט [ע"א ובזהר"ק תרומה ק"נ ע"ב ובכ"מ]

[as is explained in Midrash Kohen and in Midrash Tehillim 11 and in Zohar Chadash Ruth at length. See also Tractate Eruvin 19a, and Zohar, Terumah 150b, and a number of other places].

וכן הענינים כלם לא לנקמה ח"ו אלא למרוק שיזכו גם הפושעים והמורדים

Similarly, all the punishments mentioned in the Torah and the writings of the Sages are not for the purpose of retribution, Heaven forbid, but rather to cleanse the sinners and rebels so that they too will have the merit

לְהִשָּׁאֵר בְּהִשְׁאָרָה נִצְחִית לְיָמֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם

and will live eternally in the Messianic era and in the World to Come,

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁמֵּצִינוּ בְּאַלִּישֶׁע אַחֵר בְּחִגְיָה ט"ו ב' שֶׁאָמְרוּ עָלָיו לֹא מִדֵּן
לְיַדִּינָהּ וְלֹא לְעֶלְמָא דְּאַתִּי לִיתִי

As we see regarding Elisha Acher in Tractate Chagiga 15b

אָמַר ר' מֵאִיר מוּטָב דְּלִידִינָהּ וְלִיתִי לְעֶלְמָא דְּאַתִּי

regarding whom Rabbi Meir declared, "Better that he be judged and punished accordingly and then he can enter the World to Come.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ כִּי גַם מִי אֲשֶׁר דִּינוֹ הוּא שְׂלֵא יִהְיֶה לוֹ חֶלֶק לְעוֹלָם

Thus we have it that even one whose sentence is such that he should not have a portion in the World to Come,

הֵנָּה הַדִּינִים וְהָעֲנָשִׁים מְמַרְקִין אוֹתוֹ וְיֵשׁ לוֹ תִּקְוָה ע"י הָעֲנָשִׁים

the judgments and punishments cleanse such a person and he is rectified thereby.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין ק"י רע"ב בְּעֵדַת קָרַח כִּי כָּל תְּלָתִין יוֹמִין מִהֶדְרָא
לְהוֹ גִּיהֵנָּם כְּבֶשֶׂר בְּתוֹךְ קַלְחָת

This is also what Tractate Sanhedrin 110b states regarding Korach's band of rebels – that every thirty days Gehinnom returns them to this place, like meat being turned over in a pot

וְעַכְ"ז הֵנָּה אָמְרוּ שָׁם ק"ח א' וק"ט ב' כִּי עָלִיהֶם הוּא אוֹמֵר (שְׁמוּאֵל
א' ב, ו) 'ה' יִמְמִית וּמַחִיָּה מוֹרִיד שְׂאוֹל וַיַּעַל'

And nevertheless, the Sages state there (108a, 109b) that regarding them the verse (Samuel I, 2:6) states, 'G-d brings death and grants life, He lowers into the grave and raises up' – and thus

וַיָּקוּמוּ בְּתַחֲיַת הַמֵּתִים וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם

they will arise with the Resurrection of the Dead and they will be granted life in the World to Come.

וְכֵן הוּא מִפָּרֶשׁ בְּתוֹרָה בְּקַלְלוֹת שְׁבַתֹּרֶת כְּהֻנִּים

And this is stated explicitly in the curses in the Torah in Leviticus parshat Bechukotai

שֶׁמִּפָּרֶשׁ שָׁם גַּם חֲטָא עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה וְכַמ"ש שָׁם (וּיקְרָא כו, ל) 'עַל פְּגָרֵי
גִּלּוּלֵיכֶם'

where it is unambiguous that even the sin of idolatry – as the verse (Leviticus 26:30) states, '...upon the carcasses of your idols' –

עכ"ז הנה נאמר לבסוף (ויקרא כו, מד) ואף גם זאת כו'

and nevertheless at the end of that section it states (Leviticus 26:44), 'But despite all this... I will not despise them, nor reject them and destroy them...'

ומבטיח התורה השארה נצחית לכל ישראל כלם גם בחטא עבודה זרה החמורה רח"ל

Thus the Torah promises eternal life for all Jewish people, even when there is the sin of idolatry, the most severe of all sins, Heaven forbid.

הגם שהדין בזה הוא שלא יהא לו חלק לעוה"ב

This is so even though the law is that he the transgressor will not have a portion in the World to Come,

וכמו שפסק הרמב"ם בפ"ג מהלכות תשובה ה"ו והוא מגמרא ראש השנה י"ז א'

as Maimonides rules in chapter 3 of *Hilhot Teshuvah*, derived from the Talmud Tractate *Rosh HaShana* 17a.

עכ"ז הנה הענשים ממרקים אותו ולא יאבד שום נפש אחת מישראל

Nevertheless, punishments cleanse the person so that not a single Jewish soul will be lost,

וכמ"ש הגר"א באדרת אליהו פ' נצבים פסוק י"ח

As the Vilna Gaon writes in *Aderet Eliyahu* on Nitzavim verse 18

שהקללות שבתו"כ הם נאמרו לכל יחיד ויחיד

that the curses in Leviticus 26:15 are directed at each person individually,

משא"כ הקללות שבמשנה תורה הם נאמרו לכלל ישראל ביחד

whereas the curses in Deuteronomy are directed at the entire Jewish people together.

וזהו שאמרו במגלה ל"א ע"ב הללו בלשון רבים אמורות

This is the meaning of the statement our Sages made in *Megillah* 31b, that these earlier curses are stated in the plural –

ר"ל כי הם אמורות לכל יחיד ויחיד בפני עצמו לכך נאמרו בלשון רבים

meaning to say, they are expressed to each and every individual, and therefore they are stated in the plural –

משא"כ במשנה תורה הם נאמרו רק לכלל ישראל ביחד לכך נאמר
שם בלשון יחיד

whereas the ones in Deuteronomy are said to the people as a whole, and
therefore they are stated in the singular.

והרי לנו מזה ג"כ כי הבטחת 'ואף גם זאת' כו' ומבטיח התורה
השארה נצחית עכ"פ

It turns out that with the promise (Leviticus 26:44) 'But despite all this... I will
not despise them, nor reject them and destroy them...' the Torah assures eternal
life

הנה הוא ג"כ לכל יחיד ויחיד מ'ישראל כי גם מי שדינו הוא שלא
יהא לו חלק לעוה"ב ח"ו

for each and every Jewish individual, since even one whose sentence is that they
will not have a portion in the World to Come,

הנה הענשים כלם וכמו הקללות שבתו"כ וש'משנה תורה
all of the punishments, such as those mentioned in Leviticus and in
Deuteronomy,

ע"ש בהג"א כי זהו מה שנאמר והבדילו ה' לרעה ר"ל

(see GR "A ibid. that this is the meaning of Deuteronomy 29:20 'And God will set
him aside for a bad patch,' Heaven have mercy,

הגם שהם נאמרים רק על כלל ישראל
even though these verses are stated regarding Israel as a whole.

ועי"ז 'התברך בלבבו לאמר שלום יהיה לי' לכן נאמר והבדילו ה' כו'
(ע"ש)

And because of this if the individual 'blesses himself in his heart saying, "Peace
will be with me..." (Deuteronomy 29:18), then 'God will set him aside...' See ad
loc.)

וכו ענשי גיהנם וע"ד שאמרו בעדת קרח כל תלתין יומין מהדרא
להו גיהנם כבשר בתוך קלחת

And the same is true regarding the punishments in Gehinnom as mentioned in
connection with Korach's band of rebels – that every thirty days Gehinnom
returns them to this place, like meat being turned over in a pot, as mentioned
earlier.

הנה כ"ז הם ממרקין ומנקין ויתצרו ויתלבנו⁸ עכ"פ

All of these punishments nevertheless scour and cleanse and refine and purify.

וְהוּא כַּמִּשְׁסוּטָה ט' ע"א 'חֲצִי אֶכְלֶה בָּם' (דברים לב, כג) חֲצִי כָּלִים
וְהֵם אֵינָם כָּלִים

As it states in Tractate Sotah 9a on the verse 'I will finish off My arrows on them' (Deuteronomy 32:23) – My arrows will be finished off, but they will not be finished off,

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (מלאכי ג, ו) אֲנִי ה' לֹא שֶׁנִּיתִי וְאַתֶּם בְּנֵי יַעֲקֹב לֹא
כִּלְיֵתֶם

because it states (Malachi 3:6), 'I God do not change, and you the descendants of Jacob will never be completely destroyed.'

וְעַד ז"ל הוּא הַכּוֹנֵה ג"כ מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י"ז א'

This is similarly the intention of what the Sages stated in Tractate Rosh Hashana 17a

עַל הַפּוֹשְׁעִים וְהַמוֹרְדִים הַיּוֹתֵר גְּדוֹלִים שֶׁהֵם יוֹרְדִין לַגִּיהֵנוֹם וְנִדּוֹנִים
בָּהּ לְדוֹרֵי דוֹרוֹת

regarding the greatest sinners and rebels – that they descend to Gehinnom and are sentenced there for generations, but

גִּיהֵנוֹם כָּלָה וְהֵם אֵינָם כָּלִים הַכּוֹנֵה הוּא ג"כ לְמַעֲלִיּוֹתָא

'Gehinnom will come to an end, but they will not come to an end,' in a positive sense,

כִּי הֵם יִשָּׁאוּ עַכ"פ יִתְקַנּוּ גַם הֵם לְבִסּוּף

for they i.e. their souls will remain alive, and in any event they too will be rectified in the end,

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁהָאֲרִיךְ בָּזָה הַגָּאוֹן קְדוֹשׁ ה' הֵרַם"ע מִפָּאנּוּ ז"ל בְּעֶשְׂרֵה
מֵאֲמָרוֹת מֵאֲמַר חֲקוֹר דִּין חֶלֶק ה' ע"ש

as the holy Rabbi Menachem Azaria de Fano states at length in *Asarah Ma'amarot, Ma'amar Chikur haDin*.

וּמ"ש בְּגִמְרָא נִדּוֹנִין בָּהּ לְדוֹרֵי דוֹרוֹת הַכּוֹנֵה הוּא רַק עַד שֶׁכָּלוּ כָּל
הַדּוֹרוֹת לִצְאָתָא

Now when the Talmud states that they descend to Gehinnom and are sentenced there for generations, the intention is only until all the end of all generations,

וְהוּא בְּזִמְנוֹ תַּחֲיִית הַמֵּתִים שָׂאז לֹא יִהְיֶה עוֹד דּוֹרוֹת חֲדָשִׁים כָּלָל

which is at the time of the Resurrection of the Dead, when there will be no more new generations,

כִּי כִּבְר יִכָּלוּ כָּל הַנְּשָׁמוֹת שֶׁבְּגוֹף כַּמ"ש בִּיבְמוֹת ס"ב סע"א

for no souls will be left in the storehouse of souls called *guf* as Tractate Yevamot 62a states.

וְכֵן מ"ש שֶׁם בְּפוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּגוֹפוֹן שִׁיְהִיו אֲפֹר תַּחַת כַּפּוֹת רַגְלֵי הַצְדִּיקִים

[And similarly when it states there that those Jews who sinned with their bodies will be dust under the soles of the feet of the righteous,

הַכּוֹנֵה הוּא כִּי עִי"ז יִתְעַכַּל הָרַע שֶׁבָּהֶם וְיִשָּׂאֵר הַטּוֹב נָקִי וּמְבָרָר

the intention is that in this way the evil in them will be consumed, and they will remain good and cleansed and pure.

[ועי"ז יִתְקַנּוּ וְיִחְיִי וְיִקְוָמוּ בַתְּחֵה"מ (ע' הַגָּר"א בַּסַּפֶּד"צ פ"א בדה"מ מֶלֶךְ הָרַבִּיעִי)

(See GR "A to *Sefra d'Tzniuta* chap. 1 s.v. 'The fourth king'²). And in this way they will be rectified and will live to arise with the Resurrection of the Dead].

וְעַכ"פ הוּא כִּי ע"י כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר בָּזָה וּבָבֵא יִתְקַנּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל
כָּלָם,

In any event, by means of all of the punishments in this world and the next, the entirety of Israel will be rectified,

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּשְׁמוֹ"ר הַנֶּ"ל כִּי מָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמָר 'כָּל טוֹבִי הוּא מִדַּת הַטּוֹב
וּמִדַּת הַפְּרָעָנוֹת

as it states in Shemot Rabba op. cit. regarding the verse "I shall make all My goodness pass before you..." – this refers to both the attribute of good and the attribute of retribution,

כִּי גַם מִדַּת הַפְּרָעָנוֹת הוּא אֵינוֹ לִנְקָמָה ח"ו אֶלָּא רַק כְּדִי לְזַכּוֹת עַל
יְדֵיהֶם

since the attribute of retribution is not in order to take revenge, Heaven forfend, but rather to make a person worthy

לְכָל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים אֲשֶׁר עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמָר מָה רַב טוֹבָךְ כו'.

of all the promises about the future regarding which the verse (Psalms 31:20) states, "How abundant is Your goodness that You have stored away for those who fear You..."

אָמְנָם כ"ז הוּא רַק לְרָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

However all of the above is only as regards wicked Jews,

אֲבָל לְרָשָׁעֵי עוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים הִנֵּה עֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמָר אִיּוֹב (כ, ז) כ' כְּגִלְלוּ
לְנֶצַח יָאִבֵּד

but regarding wicked idolaters the verse states in Job (20:7), "he will perish forever like his own dung."

וְכֹן דְּנִיָּאל (ט, כז) בְּסוּפּוֹ 'וְעַד כָּלָה וְנִחְרָצָה תִּתֵּן עַל שְׁמָם'

Similarly, Daniel (9:27) states "until the extermination decreed will descend upon the lifeless idol."

וְהַטַּעַם הוּא כִּי רָשָׁעֵי אוֹמוֹת הָעוֹלָם

The reason for this is because regarding the wicked of the nations

הֵינָה אָמְרוּ עֲלֵיהֶם בְּעִירוּבֵין י"ט ע"א רָשָׁעִים אָפִילוּ עַל פְּתָחוֹ שֶׁל
גִּיהֶנָּם אֵינָם חוֹזְרִים בְּתִשׁוּבָה

Our Sages state (Tractate *Eruvin* 19a): The wicked, even at the entrance of Gehinnom, do not repent.

וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם אִיּוֹב (יב, כג) 'מִשְׁגִּיא לַגּוֹיִם וַיֹּאבְדֵם'

And therefore it states in Job (12:23) "He exalts nations and [then] destroys them" if they do not acknowledge that their greatness is due to His beneficence.

וְכֹן (דְּבָרִים ז, י) וּמִשְׁלָם לְשׁוֹנְאָיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהֶאֱבִידוֹ

Similarly (Deuteronomy 7:10), "And He repays His enemies in their lifetime to make them perish" when they do not follow His ways.

אָבֵל בְּרָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הֵנָּה אָמְרוּ בְּעִירוּבֵין שָׁם כִּי הֵם מַצְדִּיקִין עֲלֵיהֶם
אֶת הַדִּין

But as for Jews who act wickedly our Sages state in *Eruvin* ad loc., they acknowledge the righteousness of their sentence,

וְאוֹמְרִים לִפְנֵינוּ "רַב־ש"ע יָפָה דִּנְתָּ יָפָה זָכִיתָ יָפָה חִיבָתָּ וַיָּפָה תִּקְנָתָּ
גִּיהֶנָּם לְרָשָׁעִים, גּוֹ עֵדוֹן לְצַדִּיקִים"

and declare before Him: "Master of the World, You have judged fairly, You have exonerated fairly, You have convicted fairly, You have prepared Gehinnom for the wicked and the Garden of Eden for the righteous."

[וְכֹן בְּגִטִּין (נ"ז, א) תָּא חֲזִי מָה בֵּין פּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְנִבְיָאֵי אוֹמוֹת הָעוֹלָם ע"ש]

[And similarly in Tractate *Gittin* 57a: Come and see the difference between Jewish sinners and the prophets of idolatry]

וּבְאוֹתֵיּוֹת דֶּר' עֲקִיבָא אוֹת ח' מְבָאָר כִּי לֹא דֵי שְׁמַצְדִּיקִין עֲלֵיהֶם אֶת
הַדִּין

The work *Otiot d'Rabbi Akiva*, 8 explains that not only do they acknowledge the righteousness of their judgment

אֲלָא שְׂגָם מְקַבְּלִים עַל עַצְמוֹן אֶת הַדִּין וְאָמַר שָׁם כִּי רָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
they even accept the sentence upon themselves.

וְאָמַר שָׁם כִּי רָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁהֵם רוֹאִין פְּנֵי גֵיהֶנֶם הֵם
מְקַבְּלִים עֲלֵיהֶם בְּעֶצְמוֹן דִּינוֹ שֶׁל גֵּיהֶנֶם

And it states there that Jews who act wickedly, when they see the face of
Gehinnom, they themselves accept the sentence of Gehinnom,

וְשׁוֹבְרִים אֶת לִבָּם בְּתִשְׁבּוּבָה לִפְנֵי הַקֵּב"ה

and their hearts break in *teshuvah* (repentance) before the Holy One, blessed is
He.

וְעַלֵּיהֶם נֹאמַר קְרוֹב ה' לְנִשְׁבָּרֵי לֵב וּמַעֲלִין אוֹתָם וּמוֹשִׁיבֵין אוֹתָם
בִּישִׁיבָה אֶצֶל הַשְּׁכִינָה

Regarding them it states, "God is close to the broken of heart," and He raises
them up and seats them next to the *Shechinah*.

וּמִקְבָּלִים שָׂכָר עַל כָּל חֲטָא שֶׁהָיָה בִּידָם כְּצִדָּקָה

They receive reward as if it was charity for repenting for every sin ascribed to
them

וַיְהִיו עִם הַצְּדִיקִים וְהַחֲסִידִים תְּמִימִים וְיִשְׁרִים בְּעַלֵּי צִדָּקָה וְגוֹמְלֵי
חֲסִידִים

and they will reside – together with the righteous, the pious, the innocent and
the upright, the charitable and the kind,

בְּעַלֵּי תוֹרָה וְאֲנָשֵׁי אֱמוּנָה לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא ע"ש בָּאוֹת ז' ח' בְּאַרְכָּה

the masters of Torah and people of faith – in the World to Come. See there
chaps. 7 & 8 at length.

וְהִגָּם שָׂאִין תִּשְׁבּוּבָה לְאַחֵר מִיתָה אֲךֹ ע"י שֶׁמְקַבְּלִין עַל עֶצְמוֹן דִּינוֹ שֶׁל
גֵּיהֶנֶם

Now although there is no *teshuvah* (repentance) after death, by accepting upon
themselves their sentence in Gehinnom,

וּמִתְמַרְקִין וּמִתְלַבְּנִים שָׁם הֵנָּה מְקַבְּלִים אַח"כ תִּשְׁבּוּבָתָם ג"כ וְכַנִּ"ל
בְּעֵדֵת קָרַח.

where they are scoured out and purified, their *teshuvah* is then also accepted, as
mentioned above regarding Korach's band of rebels.

וְהֵנָּה עַל זֶה הָיָה חֲרָדַת כָּל הַצְּדִיקִים מִרֹב הָעֲנָוָה שֶׁבָּהֶם

This judgment was something even the righteous feared, due to their great
humility,

כְּמוֹ דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ ע"ה שֶׁאָמַר לוֹלָא הָאֲמַנְתִּי כו'

as King David said, 'Had I not trusted that I would see the benevolence of God in the land of life...' (i.e. the World to Come),

וכמ"ש בַּרְכוֹת ד, א וְכֵן ר' יוֹחָנָן בֶּן זִכְאִי שָׁם כח, ב

and as the Talmud explains in Tractate Berachot 4a, and as Rabbi Yochanan ben Zakai declared, *ibid.* 28b.

וְהָיָה הַחֲרָרָה שְׁלֵהֶם אִם שְׂיִזְכּוּ לַמַּעֲלָת הַצַּדִּיקִים ע"י הַמַּעֲשִׂים
טוֹבִים

Their fear was whether they would merit the worthiness of saintly Tzadikim due to their good deeds,

אוּ אוֹלֵי ח"ו רַק ע"י צְרוּף וְלִבּוֹן דְּנוֹקָא וְכִמּוּ שְׂיִתְבָּאָר עוֹד לַמַּטָּה עָקָר
עֵמֶק הָעֲנִיּוֹן בְּזָה.

or whether perhaps, Heaven forbid, this would only be via scouring and refining, as will be explained further below in depth.

אֲמָנָם הִנֵּה בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת בְּזוּה"ק (בְּזוּהַר חֲדָשׁ לְךָ לְךָ וּבְזו"ח רוֹת
וּבְזוּהַר תְּרוּמָה ק"נ ע"ב)

Indeed in a number of places in the holy Zohar (*Zohar Chadash, Lech Lecha; Zohar Chadash, Ruth; Zohar Terumah* p. 150b)

מִבָּאָר כִּי מִי שִׁיּוֹרֵד לַמַּדּוֹר הַשְּׁבִיעִי שְׁנִקְרָא אֲבִדוֹן,

it is explained that one who descends to the seventh level of Gehinnom, which is called 'destruction'

וְהֵם כָּל אֵלּוּ שְׁאֲמָרוּ בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה י"ז א' שֶׁהֵם נִדְּוִנִין לְדוֹרֵי דוֹרוֹת

and this includes all those whom the Talmud Rosh Hashana 17a declares would be sentenced for generations,

הִנֵּה הֵם אֵינָם יוֹצְאִים מִשָּׁם לְעוֹלָם

suggesting that they will never emerge from there,

וְכֵן הוּא בִּגְמָרָא פְּסָחִים נד, א כִּי אוֹר שֶׁל גֵּיהֶנָּם אֵין לוֹ כְּבִיָּה לְעוֹלָם

and so too Tractate Pesachim 54a states that the fires of Gehinnom are never extinguished,

וְלִמְדוּ זֶה מִמְּקָרָא שְׁכָתוֹב וְאִשָּׁם לֹא תִכָּבֶּה

which they the Sages derived from a verse (Isaiah 66:24) that states, "their fire will not be extinguished" –

אֲךָ כִּבְרָתָהּ הִרְמ"ע מִפָּאנּוּ ז"ל בְּמֵאמְרֵי חֲקוֹר דִּין ח"ה פ"ה

but regarding this matter Rabbi Menachem Azaria de Fano already stated in *Asarah Ma'amarot, Ma'amar Chikur haDin* 5:5

שהוא רק כל זמן שהעולם עומד על מדרגה של עתה

that this is only as long as the world remains at its current spiritual level.

וע"ד שאמרו בבראשית רבה (לד, יא) בפסוק (בראשית ח, כב) 'עד כל ימי הארץ'

In similar fashion, Bereishit Rabba (34, 11), on the verse (Genesis 8:22) "all the days of the earth..." states

שהוא רק כל זמן שהשמים והארץ קיימים

that this is only as long as the heavens and earth exist.

אבל כשיבוא אותו יום שכתוב בו (ישעיהו נא, ו) 'כי שמים כעשן נמלחו והארץ כפגד תבלה'

But when the day comes, regarding which it states (Isaiah 51:6), "for the heavens will scatter like smoke and the earth will wear out like a garment" –

באותה שעה (זכריה יא, יא) 'ותפר ביום ההוא' [[וידעו כן עניי הצאן השמרים אתי כי דבר ה' הוא]] כו' ע"ש

at that time "it became annulled on that day and the meek of the flock who paid heed to Me, recognized that is was so, that is was the word of God" (Zechariah 11:11).

כן הוא עד"ז בעניינינו כי מה שאמרו שהאש של גיהנום אין לו כבירה לעולם

And so too in our case – when they said that 'the fires of Gehinnom are never extinguished,'

וכן מה שאמרו שאין יוצאים משם לעולם

and when they said that 'they will never emerge from there' from Gehinnom –

הכונה הוא רק כל זמן שהעולם הוא על המדרגה שהיא עתה the intention is – as long as the world remains at its current spiritual level.

אבל לעתיד לבוא כאשר יתבטל הרע כלו ויכלה כל הטמאה והזמא

But in the future, when evil will be entirely obliterated and all spiritual impurity and contamination will be eliminated,

הנה אז יתבטלו כל הענשים כלם כי 'כל הרשעה כלה כעשן תכלה' then all the punishments without exception will be nullified, for 'all evil will go up in smoke' as we say in the Rosh Hashana prayers.

ואז יטהר הגיהנום ג"כ ויתקדש גם הוא בקדשתו של גן עדן

And then Gehinnom will also be cleaned out and will also be graced with the sanctity of the Garden of Eden,

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ רַז"ל בְּנִדְרִים ח' ע"ב אֵין גִּיהֶנֶם לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא

as our Sages declared in Nedarim 8b: 'There is no Gehinnom in the World to Come.

אֶלָּא הַקב"ה מוֹצִיא חֲמָה מִנִּרְתִּיקָה צְדִיקִים מִתְרַפְּאִים בָּהּ

Instead, the Holy One, blessed is He, will remove the sun from its sheath and the righteous will be healed thereby,

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (מלאכי ג, כ) 'וְזָרְחָה לָכֶם יְרָאִי שְׁמִי שֶׁשֶׁמֶשׁ צִדְקָה וּמִרְפָּא' כו'

as the verse (Malachi 3:20) states, "But a sun of righteousness will shine for You who fear My Name, with healing in its rays..."

וְרָשָׁעִים נִדּוֹנִין בָּהּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (מלאכי ג, יט) 'כִּי הִנֵּה הַיּוֹם בָּא בֵּיעַר
בְּתַנּוּר וְהָיוּ כָּל יָדָיִם וְכָל עֹשֶׂה רָשָׁעָה קֵשׁ וְלֹהֵט אֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבָּא'

While the wicked will be judged thereby, as it states, (Malachi 3:19) "For behold the day is coming, burning like an oven, when all the wicked and all the evildoers will be like straw; and that coming day will burn them up..."

זֶהוּ בְּרָשָׁעֵי עוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים שְׂיִכְלוּ אֶז

referring to the wicked idolaters who will be destroyed then.

אֲבָל בְּרָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר נִתְצָרְפוּ וְנִתְלַבְּנוּ בְּכָל עוֹנָשֵׁי גִיהֶנֶם

But as for the wicked Jews who have been refined and purified by all the punishments of Gehinnom,

וְכִבֵּר כָּלָה עֲנָשָׁם בְּבִטּוֹל הַגִּיהֶנֶם וְנִתְקַנּוּ הִנֵּה עֲלֵיהֶם אָמְרוּ שֶׁהֵם
מִתְרַפְּאִין בָּהּ

once their punishment is nullified with the abolishment of Gehinnom, it states that they will be healed thereby.

וּר"ל כִּי הֵם מִתְרַפְּאִין אֶז מִכָּל מַכּוֹת גִּיהֶנֶם וְתַחֲלוּאֵיהָ

Meaning, they will be healed from all the afflictions of Gehinnom and its miseries.

כִּי אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְמַרְקוּ וְנִתְלַבְּנוּ יִהְיוּ הֵם ג"כ בְּכָלֵל הַצְדִּיקִים כֵּן"ל.

For after they have been cleansed and purified, they too will be counted among the righteous, as mentioned previously.

וּכ"ז יִהְיוּ בְּזִמְנֵן תַּחֲיִית הַמֵּתִים שְׁאֵז 'כָּל הָרָשָׁעָה כָּלָה כְּעָשָׁן תִּכָּלֶה'

All of the above is at the time of the Resurrection of the Dead, when 'all evil will go up in smoke,'

וַיִּתְבַּטֵּל אֶז הַגִּיהֶנֶם ג"כ וַיְהִיָּה הַגֶּמֶר דִּין וְהַכְּלִיּוֹן לְכָל רָשָׁעֵי עוֹבְדֵי
אֱלִילִים

and Gehinnom will be nullified as well and the final judgment and destruction
will devolve upon the wicked idolaters

ע"י הוצאת חמה מנרתיקה וכנז' כי בעת תחית המתים יתבטל
הזהמא וכל עכירות דהגופות

when the sun will be taken out of its sheath, as mentioned. For at the time of the
Resurrection of the Dead spiritual contamination will be eliminated as well as all
the crassness of the body,

וַיִּתְחַלֵּף אֶז כָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ לְמַדְרָגָה יוֹתֵר נָעֲלָה

and the entire world will be transformed to a loftier level.

כי יהיו כל הגופות והחמריים בר ונקי מכל עכירות וזהמא

For all bodies and coarse materiality will become pure and clean of all crassness
and contamination,

וְזָךְ וּמִצְחָצַח כְּמוֹ שֶׁבִּאֲרָנוּ בְּאַרְכָּה בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב

remaining unpolluted and pure, as we explained in our *Sefer Drush Olam*
HaTohu part 2.

ועכ"פ הרי נתבאר לנו כי מה שאמרו על אשו של גיהנם שאין לו
כביה לעולם

In any event, it has been explained for us that when they said that the fires of
Gehinnom are never extinguished,

וכן מה שאמרו על היורד במדריגה הז' שאינו יוצא משם לעולם

and when they said that 'one who descends to the seventh level will never
emerge from there',

הכוונה הוא רק כל הזמן שהעולם עומד על מדרגתה של עתה

the intention is only as long as the world continues at its current spiritual level.

אבל לעתיד לבוא יתבטל כל רע וכל עונש ויתקן הכל

But in the Time to Come, evil and its punishment will be destroyed and
everything will become rectified,

ולא יאבד שום נפש אחת מישראל ויזכו כלם לתחה"מ ולחיי
העוה"ב

so that not a single Jewish soul will be lost, and all of them will merit the
Resurrection of the Dead and the World to Come,

וכמו שיתבאר עוד למטה עמק הענין בזה.

the conceptual depths of which will be explained below.

אָמַנְם דַּע כִּי גַם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל עֲצָמֵן הֵנָּה לֹא כָּל מִי שֶׁאָנוּ רוֹאִין בְּעֵינֵינוּ
שֶׁהוּא מִזֶּרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל

But know this: not everyone who appears to be of Jewish descent

הוּא רֵאִיָּה שֶׁהוּא מִבְּנֵי אַבְרָהָם יִצְחָק וְיַעֲקֹב וְשִׁבְטֵי יִ"ד וּמַע' נֶפֶשׁ
דְּבֵית יַעֲקֹב

is indeed a descendant of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob and the 12 Tribes of God
and the seventy souls who were born to the House of Jacob,

וּמִסְפַּר רַבּוֹא שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ מֵהֶם שְׁהֵם צְבָאוֹת ה' הַמִּיחָדִּים לְשֵׁמוֹ

or of the tens of thousands who emerged from them – the hosts of God who are
devoted to His name.

אֲשֶׁר רַק עֲלֵיהֶם נֹאמַר כִּי חֵלֶק ה' עִמּוֹ יַעֲקֹב חֶבֶל נִחְלָתוֹ

For it is only regarding them that it states (Deuteronomy 32:9), "for part of
God is His people; Jacob is the rope of His legacy."

וְרַק עֲלֵיהֶם נִקְרָא ה' אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְרַק עֲלֵיהֶם נֹאמַר בָּנִים אֲתָם לַה'
אֱלֹהֵיכֶם

Only in regard to them is He called 'God, the Lord of Israel' and only in
reference to them does it state (Deuteronomy 14:1), "You are children to the
Lord your God."

וְרַק עֲלֵיהֶם אָמַרְנוּ שְׁהֵם בְּטוֹחִים כָּלָם עַל הַשְּׂאֲרָה הַנִּצְחִית שֶׁהוּא
לַתַּחַה"מ וְלַחַיִּי הַעוֹה"ב וְכָכָל מָה שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ

And only regarding them did we declare that all of them are certain of eternal
life, which is the Resurrection of the Dead and the life of the World to Come,
and everything else that we said.

וְאֵלּוּלָא הַחֲטָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת לֹא הָיָה הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים
בְּעוֹלָם כָּלָל

Now were it not for the sin of the Tree of Knowledge idolaters would not have
existed in this world at all,

וְלֹא הָיָה יוֹצֵא מֵאֲדָמָה"ר רַק יִשְׂרָאֵל לְבַד

and only the Jewish People would have emerged from Adam.

אֲךָ ע"י הַחֲטָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת הֵנָּה לְבַד מָה שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹבְדֵי
אֱלִילִים בְּהָעוֹלָם

But due the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, not only did the existence of idolaters emerge in the world,

אֶלָּא נִתְעָרְבַּ הָרַבָּה מֵהֶם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל ג"כ

many of them even got mixed in among Jews as well,

וְאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי תִקּוּן נ' כִּי נִתְעָרְבַּ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל ה' מִיָּנִים

as the **Tikunim** the *Tikunei Zohar*, **Tikun 50** states – five types of people, i.e. five nations, became mixed in with the Jews,

אֲשֶׁר סִימָנָם הוּא נֶגַע ר"ע

the initial letters of which spell the words *nega ra* ('a terrible plague').

וְהֵם נְפִילִים גִּבּוֹרִים עֲנָקִים רְפָאִים עַמְלָקִים

These are Nefilim, Giborim, Anakim, Refa'im, Amalakites.

וְכָל אֱלֹהֵי הָה' מִיָּנִים בְּכָלֵל נִקְרְאוּ בְּשֵׁם עָרֵב רַב וְהוּא סוֹד הַכָּתוּב וְגַם עָרֵב רַב עָלָה אִתָּם

And all these five in general are called the *erev rav* the 'mixed multitude' which is the secret meaning of the verse (Exodus 12:38), "and the *erev rav* went up out of Egypt with them."

וְעֵין בְּזוֹה"ק בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"ה א' כ"ז ב' כ"ח ב' כ"ט רע"א מִשְׁפָּטִים ק"כ ע"ב פְּנִיחָס רל"ז א' ב' תִּצָּא רע"ז רע"ב בְּהַעֲלוֹתָךְ קנ"ג רע"ב תִּשָּׂא קצ"א

(See *Zohar Bereishit* 25a, 27b, 28b, 29a; *Zohar Mishpatim* 120b; *Zohar Pinchas* 237a-b; *Zohar Tetzzei* 277b; *Zohar B'Ha'alotecha* 152b; *Zohar Tissa* 191

וְכָל הָעֲנִין שֶׁם וּבְדַבְרֵי הָרַב בְּשֵׁעַר הַפְּסוּקִים פ' שְׁמוֹת בְּאֵרוּכָה (הָרַבָּה).

and the entire matter there in the words of the Master the Arizal in *Sha'ar haPesukim Shemot* at great length).

וְהֵם נִתְעָרְבוּ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּשָּׁנֻם בֵּינֵינוּ הָרַבָּה מֵהֶם

They got mixed in with the Jewish People and there are many of them among us,

וְכַמ"ש בְּגִמְרָא בִּיצָה ל"ב ב' הֵנִי מֵעָרֵב רַב קָא אֲתוּ

as the Talmud states in **Beitza 32b** regarding certain wealthy people in Babylon who were overtly Jewish, yet failed to help another Jew in distress: "These came from the *erev rav*."

וְהֵגַם שְׁאָמְרוּ בְּקִידוּשֵׁין דָּף ע"א א שְׁמִשְׁפָּחָה שְׁנַטְמַעָה נְטַמַּעָה וְהֵם כְּשֵׁרִים לַעֲתִיד לָבֹא

And even though it states in tractate **Kidushin 71a** that a family who became assimilated among the Jewish People **are integrated and will be accepted in the future,**

עכ"ז הנה כל אלו שהם מנשמתין דלהון שהן גלגול דלהון יש בהם חלוק גדול

nevertheless, there is a big difference between all those who are descended from them (from the *erev rav*) who are the incarnation of those people the original mixed multitude that came out of Egypt with the Israelites,

לבין ישראל גמורים והוא כמ"ש שם דף ע' ע"א מעלה יתרה יש בין ישראל לגרים

and those who are born Jewish i.e. the descendants of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob etc. as it states there **Kidushin 71a** – there is an advantage in being born Jewish over becoming Jewish by conversion.

דאילו בישראל כתיב בהו והייתי להם לאלהים [ואח"כ] והמה יהיו לי לעם

Because regarding born Jews it states (Jeremiah 31:32) **"I will be their God"** [and afterwards] **"and they will be My people"** –

שהוא ית"ש מקרב אותם בתחלה

indicating that **He brings them close from the outset**,¹⁰ **"I will be their God"** – from the outset.

ואילו בגרים כתיב 'מי הוא זה ערב את לבו לגשת אלי נאם ה' והייתם לי לעם'

Whereas regarding converts to Judaism it is written (Jeremiah 30:22), **"for who would then embolden his heart to approach Me" says the Lord, 'to be a people to Me?'"**

'ואנכי אהיה לכם לאלהים' [ואח"כ]

[Only afterwards does the verse continue]: **"And I will be God to you."** Thus first they have to approach God with good deeds etc., and then I will be God to you."

כי אין מקרבין אותו מן השמים אלא אם כן הו מקרבין עצמן תחלה להיות טובים (כן פי' רש"י שם)

For Heaven does not bring them close unless they bring themselves close first, by undertaking to be good (as Rashi explains).

וכן הוא כי בכל אלו שנשמתין שלהם הם מערב רב הגם שנולדו מישראל

The same is true of all those whose souls derive from the *erev rav*, even though they are born into a Jewish family –

הִנֵּה הֵם לֹא יִזְכּוּ לְכָל יְעוּדִים הָעֵתִידִים אֲשֶׁר לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

they will not merit all the promises that will be in the future in the Messianic era and in the World to Come,

אֲלֵא רַק אִם יִהְיוּ רְאוּיִים לְכָךְ מִצַּד הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים שֶׁבָּהֶם

unless they are deserving thereof in terms of their good deeds.

אָבֵל בְּלֹא זֶה הִנֵּה יָכֻלוּ גַם הֵם בְּכֻלָּהּ גְּמוּלָהּ וּכְכֹל רִשְׁעֵי אוֹ"ה
נֶאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם גַּם כֵּן

But without that they will also disappear completely. And just like all the other wicked people of the nations, it states in regard to them,

וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשֹׁנָאיו אֶל פָּנָיו לְהַאֲבִידוֹ כַּמִּשְׁלֵם בְּזוּה"ק בְּרֹאשִׁית כה רע"ב ופ' תצא רעז ב'

"He will repay those who despise Him in their lifetime and destroy them (Deuteronomy 7:10) as the *Zohar Bereishit* 25b and *Teitzei* 287b state.

וְאָמְרוּ בִּפְרָשֶׁת בְּרֹאשִׁית שָׁם כ"ה א' עַל הָעֶרֶב רַב דְּנִשְׁמָתֵיהוּ הוּא
מִסְטָרָא דְאֵילָן

They the Sages of the *Zohar* state there (*Bereishit* 25a) regarding the *erev rav* that their souls are from the aspect of those

דְּאִתְמַר בִּהוֹן כִּי שָׁמַיִם כַּעֲשָׁן נִמְלָחוּ כו' וְאֵילָן אֵינָן דְּלֹא בָעָא נַח
רַחֲמֵי עֲלֵיהוּ

about whom it says "the heavens will scatter like smoke" etc. and those are the ones for whom Noah did not beg for Divine compassion.

וְאִתְמַר בִּהוֹן וַיִּמָּחוּ מִן הָאָרֶץ

Regarding them it states (Genesis 7:23) "They were blotted out from the earth"

בְּגִין דְּהוּא מְאִילָן דְּאִתְמַר בִּהוֹן תִּמְחָה אֶת זֵכֶר עַמְלֶק

because they were of those regarding whom it states (Deuteronomy 25:19), "wipe out the memory of Amalek."

וּמֹשֶׁה לֹא אִסְתַּמֵּר מִנִּיהוּ כו' כו' בְּיוֹמָא דִּיתְמַחוּן אֵילָן כו'

And yet Moses was not careful about accepting them to his own detriment. But on that day they the *erev rav*, who enticed the Israelites to worship the golden calf, will be erased...

וַיִּתְחַדֵּשׁ עָלְמָא הַה"ד כִּי כַּאֲשֶׁר הַשָּׁמַיִם הַחֲדָשִׁים וְהָאָרֶץ הַחֲדָשָׁה
כו'

and it will be as if the world is renewed, as it is written (Isaiah 66:22), "Just as the new heavens and the new earth that I will make will endure before Me... so too will your offspring and your name endure."

וְעַל בְּהִגָּר "א בְּתִקּוּנֵי תִקּוּן ג' בְּאַרְכָּה

(See the GRA's commentary to Tikunim, Tikun 3 at length).

וְעַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי הֵם מְעֻרָּבִים בִּישְׂרָאֵל הָרַבָּה מְאֹד

In any event, the fact is that very many of them are mixed in with the Jewish People,

וְהַרְשָׁעִים שֶׁבָּהֶם יִתְבַטְּלוּ בְּבִטּוּל גָּמוּר עִם בִּטּוּל הָרַע וְהַזְהָמָא כָּלָה

and the wicked among them will be nullified completely, together with the nullification of all evil and spiritual contamination.

אָבֵל כָּל מִי שֶׁהוּא מְכַלֵּל יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמֶּשׁ יִתְקַנּוּ כָּלָם וְיִזְכּוּ כָּלָם
לְתַחַה"מ

But any person who is properly counted as a Jew will be rectified and will merit the Resurrection of the Dead

וְלַחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא בְּלִי חֲסוּר אֶחָד מֵהֶם וְע"פ מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ.

and life in the World to Come, with no one left out, as per our discussion above.

Footnotes

1. This is the attribute of the *ohr pnimi*, which is the aspect of limitation, as explained at the end of the previous chapter (Makover). ↩
2. This is the attribute of the *ohr makif*, which is unlimited, as explained at the end of the previous chapter (Makover). ↩
3. Paraphrasing Isaiah 8:11 – אֵלֵי כְחֻזְקַת הַיָּד – ↩
מִיכָּה ז', יח: מִי אֶל כְּמוֹךָ נִשְׂא עֵוֹן וְעָבַר עַל פֶּשַׁע לְשֹׂאֲרֵית
נִחַלְתּוֹ לֹא הִחְזִיק לְעַד אָפּוֹ כִּי חָפֵץ חֶסֶד הוּא ↩
5. See *Sefer Yetzirah* 2:4. ↩
6. Makover. ↩
7. Tosafot explains that 'Yours, O Lord, is kindness' mitigates the strict letter of the law when the Holy One blessed is He sees that the world cannot persevere on the basis of repaying each person only according to their deeds. ↩
8. Perhaps the intention here is the verse in Daniel 12:10: יִתְבָּרְרוּ וְיִתְלַבְּנוּ
וְיִצְרְפוּ רַבִּים ↩

9. He states there that this could be through the process of *gilgul* (reincarnation). ↩
10. God chose the Israelites for who they are [the descendants of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob], not because of their deeds (Makover). ↩

Chapter 6 — Clarification of the matter of the revelation of the qualities of "ve rav hesed" vs. that of "ve emet"

More on the Attributes of Strict Justice as well as purification via mitzvot as well as suffering.

וּמַעֲתָה נִיחָא מָה שֶׁהֵעֲרִינוּ לְעִיל בְּדִבְרֵי רז"ל שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּתְּחִלָּה וְאַמֶּת
וּלְבִסּוּף וְרַב חֶסֶד

And now there is no longer an issue concerning our earlier discussion regarding the words of our Sages (Rosh HaShana 17b – Ilfa's resolution of the contradiction) who explained initially 'and Truth,' but in the end 'Abundant Kindness,'

הַגִּם שֶׁבְּהִכְתּוּב נֹאמַר לְהֶפֶךְ

even though the terms in the verse are stated in the opposite order – first 'Abundant Kindness' and afterwards 'and Truth.'

כִּי אַחֵר שֶׁבְּאֲרָנוּ שֶׁכָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלָם הֵם רַק לְצֹרֶךְ תִּקּוּן

Because as we explained, all punishments that devolve upon a person are only for the sake of rectification (lifting them up) –

שִׁיתִּקְנוּ עִי"ז כָּל רָשָׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלָם לְהִשְׁאָרֵת נֹצְחֵי לְתַחִית הַמֵּתִים
וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

so that all Jews who act wickedly will be rectified and will merit the eternal life of the Resurrection of the Dead and life in the World to Come.

א"כ הֲרִי נִמְשָׁךְ מִדֵּת וְאַמֶּת מָה שֶׁהוּא ית"ש מְשַׁלֵּם לְכָל אִישׁ
כְּמַעֲשֵׂהוּ

This being the case, the attribute of 'and Truth' – where God repays each person according to their deeds – is drawn down

רַק מִמֵּדֶת וְרַב חֶסֶד כִּי ע"י שֶׁהוּא רַב חֶסֶד שֶׁהוּא מְדָה ו' הַיּוֹצֵא
מִתְקוּן ו' שֶׁבִּפְסוּק מִי א-ל כְּמוֹךְ

exclusively from the attribute of 'Abundant Kindness.' And indeed He is of 'Abundant Kindness' – the sixth attribute that emerges from the sixth Tikun in the verse, (Michah 7:18) "Who, O G-d, is like You ..."

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁנֹּאמַר שָׁם כִּי חִפֵּץ חֶסֶד הוּא שֶׁחִפְצוֹ לַעֲשׂוֹת חֶסֶד עִם
הַכֹּל

And this is why it states there "for He desires [to do] kindness" with everyone,

שִׁיזְכוּ הָרָשָׁעִים ג"כ לְכָל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן אֲשֶׁר בְּאוּר פָּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים

so that even the wicked will merit all the good that is hidden away in the light of the King's countenance – in which there is life.

לְכַךְ הוּא מְשַׁלֵּם לְאִישׁ כְּמַעֲשָׂהוּ שֶׁהוּא מַדַּת וְאֶמֶת

And therefore He repays each person according to his deeds, which is the attribute of 'and Truth'

לְצַרְפוֹ וּלְלַבְּנוֹ כְּדִי שְׂיִזְכֶּה עִ"ז לְכָל טוֹב הָעֲתִיד וּכְמוֹ שְׂיִתְבָּאֵר עִמָּךְ הַדְּבָרִים בְּזֶה לְמַטָּה.

in order to purge and refine a person so that he will thereby be worthy of all the goodness of the future, as will be explained in depth below.

וּמָה שְׂכָתוֹב (שְׁמוֹת ל"ד, ו) 'וְרַב חֶסֶד וְאֶמֶת' הוּא מְרִישִׁיה לְסִפִּיָּה מְדַרִּישׁ וּמְסִיפָה לְרִישָׁה מְדַרִּישׁ¹

Now the verse (Exodus 34:6) 'abounding in Kindness and Truth' can be understood in two ways – from beginning to end, or from end to beginning, as will be explained below:

מְרִישָׁה לְסִיפָה מְדַרִּישׁ כִּי ע"י שֶׁהוּא וְרַב חֶסֶד לְכַךְ הוּא וְאֶמֶת

From beginning to end it is interpreted as – since He is 'abounding in Kindness,' therefore there is 'Truth.'

שֶׁמְשַׁלֵּם לְכָל אִישׁ כְּמַעֲשָׂהוּ וּכְדִי לְתַקְּנוֹ בְּנִזְכָּר

For He repays each person according to their deeds in order to rectify them, as mentioned,

כִּי אִלּוּלָא מַדַּת וְרַב חֶסֶד הָיָה רָאוּי שְׁקוּיִם בְּכָל רָשָׁע וּפּוֹשֵׁעַ

since without the attribute of 'abounding in Kindness,' it would be proper for there to be fulfilled upon every wicked transgressor

מִקְרָא שְׂכָתוֹב (אִיּוֹב כ', ז) 'כְּגִלְלוֹ לְנֶצַח יֹאבֵד' וְלֹא הָיָה שׁוּם גִּיהֶנֶם וְעֵנֶשׁ לְאַחַר מִיתָה כָּלֹל

the verse (Job 20:7) that states, "he will perish forever like his own dung" and there would be no Gehinnom and punishment after death at all,

כִּי מֵאִי דְהִנָּה הִנָּה וּמָה תּוֹעֵלֶת יוֹצֵא מִזֶּה

since what was, was. And what benefit would emerge from this?

וְכִי הוּא ית"ש לְנִקְמָה הוּא צָרִיךְ ח"ו וּמָה תּוֹעֵלֶת הוּא מְכָל הָעֵנֶשִׁים שְׁלֹאֲחַר מִיתָה?

Is He then in need of vengeance, Heaven forbid? What benefit would there be from all the punishments that are meted out after death?

וּמ"ש א-ל נְקָמוֹת ה' הֲרִי מְפָרֵשׁ הַכְּתוּב בְּעֶצְמוֹ א-ל נְקָמוֹת הוֹפִיעַ

[And when it states (Psalms 94:1) "God of vengeance, O Lord..." the same verse itself explains: "God of vengeance, appear!"

שֶׁהוּא כְּדִי לְהוֹפִיעַ מִזֶּה אוֹרָה וְטוֹבָה גְּדוֹלָה וְכִמו שִׁיתְבָּאֵר קֶצֶת סוֹד
הַדְּבָרִים לְמַטָּה

so that light and great goodness can be manifested from it, the mystical aspect of which will be explained below.

כִּי הָעֲנָשִׁים עֲצָמוֹן הֵם מִתְּהַפְּכִים אַח"כ לְאוֹר גְּדוֹל

For the punishments themselves will be transformed into great light afterwards.]

וְאִי מִשּׁוּם כְּדִי שִׁיְהֵא יֵרָא הָאָדָם מִלְּחֻטְאוֹ שֶׁהוּא יֵרָאֵת הָעֲנָשׁ

Now if those punishments after death are so that a person will be afraid to sin – i.e. due to the fear of punishment –

הָרִי הָאֲבִדוֹן הַנִּצְחִי וְהַכְּלִיָּה הַגְּמוּרָה הוּא גּוֹפָה הָעֲנָשׁ שֶׁאֵין
לְמַעֲלָה מִזֶּה

being obliterated forever and complete destruction are themselves the ultimate punishment,

כַּמ"ש הרמב"ם ז"ל בפ"ח מֵהַלְכוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה הַלְכָה ה'

as Rambam writes in chapter *Hilchot Teshuva* 8:5.

וְא"כ מָה תּוֹעֵלֶת הִיא מִכָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים שֶׁלֹּאֲחֵר מִיָּתָהּ

But if so, what benefit is there from all the punishments after death?

אַךְ ע"י שֶׁהוּא ית"ש חִפֵּץ חֶסֶד הוּא וְרוֹצֵה בְּתִקְנִתּוֹ שֶׁל רָשָׁעִים

Rather, since He, blessed is He, 'desires [to do] kindness,' and wants the rectification of sinners,

לְכֹן יִסַּד אֶת הַגִּיהֵנּוֹם וְכֹן כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים דְּלֵאֲחֵר מִיָּתָהּ

He therefore established Gehinnom and all the punishments that devolve upon a person after death,

כְּדִי לְתַקְנָם ע"י הַצָּרוּף וְהַלְבוּן וְלְהַבְיָאֵם גַּם הֵם לְכָל יְעוּדִים
הָעֲתִידִים

in order to rectify them by way of spiritual purging and purification so that they too can be brought to all the promises of the future.

וְזֶהוּ וְרַב חֶסֶד וְאֱמֶת אֲשֶׁר מְרִישִׁיהָ לְסִפְיָהּ מְדֻרֵּשׁ

This then is the meaning of 'abounding in Kindness and Truth' as interpreted from beginning to end.

ומספיה לרישיה מדריש כי ע"י שמתנהג עם האדם במדת ואמת

But from end to beginning it is interpreted thus: since He acts towards man with the attribute of Truth,

ומשלם לכל איש כמעשהו עי"ז זוכה למדת ורב חסד

repaying each person according to his deeds, in this way a person merits the attribute of Abundant Kindness.

שהוא לקבל חסדו וטובו ית"ש בכל יעודים העתידים

In other words, they receives His blessed kindness and goodness in all the promises that will come to fruition in the future

אשר לימות המשיח מתחה"מ והלאה ולחיי העוה"ב

in the Messianic era, from the Resurrection of the Dead on, and in life in the World to Come.

והוא מה שאמרו בתחלה ואמת ולבסוף ורב חסד

And this is what they the Sages said – first 'Truth' and in the end 'Abundant Kindness.'

וכן הרי נִיחָא בזה ג"כ מה שהערנו לעיל רפ"ה

This also resolves the question we posed above, in the beginning of chapter 5 –

איך יוצא מדת ואמת שהוא מדה ז' מתקון ישוב ירחמנו שהוא תקון ז' שבפסוק מי אל כמוך

how does the attribute of 'and Truth,' which is the seventh Tikun in the verse in Exodus, uttered by Moshe Rabbeinu (Moses), emerge from the verse in Micha "He will again show us mercy," which is the seventh Tikun in the verse "Who, O God, is like You?"

There seems, at first glance, to be a mismatch between the verses.

אך עתה הרי הוא נִיחָא פשוט כי הרי לא אפשר שיתקיים הבטחת ישוב ירחמנו

But now the answer is straightforward and simple, because it is not possible to fulfill "He will again show us mercy"

שהוא לימות המשיח ולחיי העוה"ב אלא רק ע"י מדת ואמת

– which refers to the Messianic era and to life in the World to Come – were it not for the attribute of 'and Truth.'

והוא ע"ד שאמר הכתוב כי אין לבוא אל שער המלך בלבוש שק

This is similar to the statement in the verse (Esther 4:2) "it was forbidden to enter the king's gate in a garment of sackcloth"

כִּי אִי אָפֶשֶׁר לְכָל רָשָׁע וּפּוֹשַׁע בְּעוֹדוֹ בְּטִמְאַתּוֹ וְצַחֲנָתוֹ ח"ו

for it is forbidden for any wicked person or sinner, while still in his state of spiritual impurity or with his stench of sin, Heaven forbid,

לְכַנֵּס בְּהִיכְלֵי קֹדֶשׁ הַקְדָּשִׁים פְּנִימָה לְהֵנוֹת מִזֵּיו הַשְּׁכִינָה

to enter into the Holy of Holies and bask in the radiance of the Shechinah,

וְלִהְיוֹת בְּמַחֲיצָתוֹ שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה לְהֶאֱיִר 'בְּאוֹר פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים' (ראה משלי טז, טו)

and be within the domain of the Holy One blessed is He, to be illuminated by the light of the King's countenance in which there is life (see Proverbs 16:15),

וּלְקַבֵּל אֶת כָּל טוֹב הַצֵּפוֹן אֲשֶׁר לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

and receive all the goodness hidden away for the Messianic era and the life of the World to Come.

אֲלֹא רַק עַד שְׁיִטְהַר מִכָּל טִמְאַתּוֹ וְזִהְמָתוֹ וְיִתְצַרֵּר וְיִתְלַבֵּן

This is only possible after he has been cleansed of all his spiritual taint and pollution, and he has been purged and purified

בְּכָל הַז' מְדוּרֵי גֵיהֶנּוֹם לְפִי פִשְׁעוֹ וּמִרְדּוֹ עַד שְׁיִתְקַן לְגִמְרֵי

in all seven levels of Gehinnom, commensurate with his sin and insurrection, until he has been completely rectified.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי ע"י שִׁמְשֻׁלָּם לְכָל אִישׁ כְּמַעֲשָׂהוּ בְּלִי וִיתוֹר כָּלֵל –
שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת וְאֶמֶת –

So we find that by repaying a person according to his deeds, without being lenient at all – which is the attribute of "and Truth" –

הִנֵּה עִי"ז יִצְיֵץ וְיִזְרִיחַ אוֹר הַתְּקוּן ז'

precisely through this, the light of the seventh Tikun emerges and shines forth.

שֶׁהוּא יָשׁוּב יִרְחֲמֵנוּ לְהִיטִיב לָנוּ בְּכָל יְעוּדִים הָעָתִידִים

This is the attribute of**, "He will again show us mercy," to grant us the benefit of all the promises the will come to fruition in the future.**

וְהָרִי אִי אָפֶשֶׁר שְׁיִתְקַיֵּם הַבְּטָחַת יָשׁוּב יִרְחֲמֵנוּ אֲלֹא ע"י מִדַּת וְאֶמֶת
נִדְקָא

Thus it is impossible for this promise of "He will again show us mercy" to be fulfilled other than via the attribute of "and Truth."

אֲבָל בְּמִדַּת וְאֶמֶת הִנֵּה יִתְקַיֵּם הַבְּטָחַת יָשׁוּב יִרְחֲמֵנוּ עכ"פ

But with the attribute of "and Truth" the promise of "He will again show us mercy" will indeed be fulfilled,

וַיִּזְכּוּ לָזֶה כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּלָם מִמֶּשׁ וּכְנֻזָּכָר.

and *all* of Israel, literally, will be worthy thereof, as mentioned.

וְעַמֶּק הַדְּבָרִים בַּכ"ז הוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזוֹה"ק (פ' שְׁלַח לךְ קע"ג ע"ב)

Now the depth of these matters is according to what the Holy Zohar states (in *Shlach Lecha* 173b)

בְּפִסּוּק מָה רַב טוֹבְךָ אֲשֶׁר צִפְנִית מֵהוּ אֲשֶׁר צִפְנִית

on the verse (Psalms 31:20) "How abundant is Your goodness that You have stored away for those who fear You."

וְכִי מֵאֵן יִגְזַל וְיִטַּל מִן יָדוֹי מָה דִּהְיָא בְּעֵי לְמִיָּהֵב

For who would steal and grab from His hand that which He intends to give in the future – i.e. the hidden light***² –

דְּכִתִּיב צִפְנִית (ר"ל לָמָּה הוּא צָרִיךְ לִגְנוֹז וּלְהִטְמִין)

as it is written, "that You have stored away"? (Meaning to say – why did He have to store away and conceal it?)

אֵלָּא פּוֹק וְחִמִּי עוֹבְדִין דְּרַחֲמֵנוּ דְּעֵבֵר קב"ה בְּמָה דְּאִיְהוּ מְחִי, בִּיהַי אֲסוּתָא

But the answer is – go out and see the acts of compassion for us that the Holy One blessed is He performs. In that the very thing which brings affliction, that very thing brings healing:

בְּמָה מְחִי בְּשִׂמְאָלָא כו' כְּתִיב 'מִצְּפוֹן תִּפְתַּח הָרָעָה' וּבְצָפוֹן מְחִי

With what does He afflict? With the left hand so to speak, a symbol of harshness, as it is written (Jeremiah 1:14), "from the north the evil will commence" – referring to the Babylonian conquest which destroyed the First Temple.

דְּמִתְמָן נִפְקִי כָּל דִּינִין וְכָל גְּזִירֵין קִשְׁיִין וּבִיָּה שְׂרִי כָּל אֲגַר טָב

From there all the *dinim* severities and harsh decrees emerged, and there too the treasure-trove of reward also resides.

וְכָל טִיבוֹ דְּזָמֵן קב"ה לְמִיָּהֵב לְיִשְׂרָאֵל לְזִמְנָא דְּאִתִּי

As for all the good that the Holy One blessed is He will grant to Israel in the future,

קָרִי קב"ה לְצָפוֹן וַיֵּמָא לִיָּה בֶּךָ יְהִיבִית כָּל טִיבוֹ וְכָל אֲגַר טוֹב לְבָנֵי כו'

the Holy One blessed is He called to the North and said to it, "I am placing all the good and all the reward for My children in you."

הב אגרונו טבין דיהבית בך הה"ד אמר לצפון תני כו' כו' והינו אשר
צפנת כו' ע"ש

When the time comes, "I will say to the North, 'Give...'" (Isaiah 43:6). This is the meaning of "that You have stored away!"

וכן כתב הגר"א בתקונים תקון כ"א דף מז ע"א כי שני דינים הן

The GR "A writes similarly in his commentary on the *Tikunim* (the *Tikunei Zohar*), *Tikun 21 p. 47a*: There are two types of reprisal:

א' רצועה בישא דינא דמסבותא על ראש רשעים יחול

1. The harsh strap of judgment from the aspect of the unholy "which will descend upon the head of the wicked" (Jeremiah 23:19);

ואחד דינא דקדשא יראת ה' והוא שלהובא דרחימותא

2. Judgment from the aspect of the holy – the awe of God – which is a flame of compassion,

וכל התעוררות והשמחה ושקר העוה"ב וכל טובה הכל שם

and all arousal and joy and reward in the World to Come, and all goodness – all of it comes from there from the holy aspect of judgment,

וכמ"ש (תהלים לא, כ) מה רב טובך אשר צפנת

as it states in Psalms (31:20) "How abundant is Your goodness that You have stored away..."

בצפון (שהוא גבורה) (תהלים כג ה) תעריך שלחן לפני (ושלחן הוא
בצפון)

It is stored away in the North (which is the *sefirah* of *gevurah* – severity) as in (Psalms 23:5) "You prepare a table for me..." (the table in the Temple was on the North side of the side of *gevurah*).

והוא יין המשמר בענביו יין המשמח עין לא ראתה כו' ע"ש

The *Tikunei Zohar* continues: This is also the wine that is guarded in its grapes since the Six Days of Creation – referring to the mystical secrets of the Torah.³ It is also the wine that brings joy,⁴ "that no eye has seen but Yours, O Lord" (Isaiah 64:3) – again referring to the deepest mystical secrets of the Torah.

וְכֵן הוּא ג"כ בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת דֶּר' עֲקִיבָא אוֹת ס' שְׁגָם מִתֵּן שְׂכָרוֹן שֶׁל
צַדִּיקִים שֶׁבִּגְן עֵדֶן הוּא ג"כ בְּצִפּוֹן כִּי הֵגֶן עֵדֶן הוּא בְּצִפּוֹן ע"ש

It also states in the work *Otiyot d'Rabbi Akiva***, chapter 60 that the reward for righteous in the Garden of Eden is also in the North, since the Garden of Eden is in the North.** It is concealed within the aspect of *gevurah*.

וְהוּא סוֹד מַעֲלַת וִיקָרַת הַזָּהָב עַל הַכֶּסֶף הַגָּם שֶׁהַכֶּסֶף הוּא מִבְּחִי
הַחֲסָדִים

This is the secret of the superior value of gold over silver, albeit that silver is from the aspect of kindness,

וְהַזָּהָב הוּא מִבְּחִי הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁהֵם דִּינִין

whereas gold is of the aspect of *gevurot* which are severities.

אֲךָ כִּשְׁהַגְּבוּרוֹת הֵם נִמְתָּקִין וּמִתְבַּסְּמִין הֵם יוֹתֵר מֵעֲלוֹת מֵהַחֲסָדִים

But when the *gevurot* become sweetened and fragrant (Kabbalistic terms used to indicate the transformation of negative into positive, evil into good) **then they are superior to aspects of *chesed* kindness.**

כִּי בָהֶם הוּא כָּל הַתְּעוֹרוּרוֹת וְהַשְׂמָחָה וְכֵן כָּל הַשְּׁלֵהוּבִין דִּרְחִימוֹ
הֵוא מֵהֶם

For through them the *gevurot* is there arousal and joy, and all of the flames of love also come from them,

וְכָל טוֹב הַחֲסָדִים וְאוֹרָם וְגִלּוּיִים וּפְעֻלָּתָם הוּא רַק ע"י גְּבוּרוֹת
הַנִּמְתָּקִים

and all the goodness of the aspects of kindness and their light and revelation and their effects are only by way of sweetened *gevurot*.

וְהִנֵּה שָׂרָשׁוֹן שֶׁל הַגְּבוּרוֹת כֻּלָּם לְמַעַלָּה הֵם כֻּלָּם קֹדֶשׁ קֹדְשִׁים

Now the root of all the *gevurot* above is from the Holy of Holies

וּמִמֵּתָקִים וּמִבְּסָמִים בְּתַכְלִית הַמִּתּוֹק

and they become totally sweetened and fragrant,

וְהוּא סוֹד מֵאֲמָרָם ז"ל בְּחִגִּיגָה ה' ע"ב וּמִי אֵיכָא בְּכִיָּה קָמִיה
הַקַּב"ה

which is the mystical explanation of the statement of our Sages in Tractate Chagiga 5b – 'is there then weeping before the Holy One blessed is He?'

This was in response to a statement quoting the verse (Jeremiah 13:17) "... my soul will cry in hidden chambers."

וְהָאֵמַר רַב פָּפָא אֵין עֲצָבוֹת לְפָנֵי הַקָּב"ה שְׁנֵאֵמַר הוּד וְהָדָר לְפָנָיו עַז
וְחִדָּה בְּמִקְמוֹ

The Talmud continues: **But didn't Rav Pappa say, "There is no melancholy in the presence of the Holy One blessed is He, as the verse (I Chronicles 16:27) states, "Glory and majesty are before Him, courage and joy are in His place" – to the exclusion of sadness and weeping?**

הָא בְּבֵיתִי גִּזְאֵי הָא בְּבֵיתִי בְּרָאִי ור"ל כִּי בְּבֵיתִי גִּזְאֵי לִיכָא בְּכֵיהּ

The Talmud resolves the contradiction: **That weeping is in the outer chambers, and this courage and joy are in the inner chambers. Meaning to say, in the inner chambers there is no weeping,**

Note that here Rabbi Elyashiv follows the explanation of Rabbeinu Chananel rather than Rashi who explained it the opposite way – joy in the outer chambers, weeping in the inner chambers. He expounds on this in a very long and learned note at the end of the chapter.

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא הַגְּבוּרוֹת מִמֶּתְקִים

because the sweetened *gevurot* are there in the inner chambers.

וְכֵן שֵׁם י"ב סע"ב כְּתִיב יֵשֶׁת חֹשֶׁךְ סִתְרוּ כו' וּמִי אֵיכָא חֲשׂוּכָא קָמִי
שְׁמִיָּא וְהָא כְּתִיב וְנִהוּרָא עֲמִיה שְׁרִי⁵

Similarly, there in the same Tractate p. 12b the Talmud asks: **It is written (Psalms 18:12) "He makes darkness His concealment..." – is there indeed darkness before the Heavens? Is it not written (Daniel 2:22) "...and light dwells with Him"?**

הָא בְּבֵיתִי גִּזְאֵי הָא בְּבֵיתִי בְּרָאִי כִּי בְּבֵיתִי גִּזְאֵי שֵׁם הָא וְנִהוּרָא עֲמִיה
שְׁרִי

The Talmud resolves the contradiction in the same way as the previous one: **This light is in the inner chambers, and that [darkness] is in the outer chambers.**

כִּי בְּבֵיתִי גִּזְאֵי שֵׁם הָא וְנִהוּרָא עֲמִיה שְׁרִי כִּי שֵׁם הוּא הַגְּבוּרוֹת
מִמֶּתְקִים וּמֵאִירִים בְּשִׁלְהוּבִין דִּרְחִימוֹ

This is because in the inner chambers the light dwells with Him, for there are the sweetened *gevurot*, and they illuminate with flames of love.

וְלָכֵן שֵׁם הוּא כָּלֹא אֹר וְעַז וְחִדָּה בְּמִקְמוֹ וְהִנֵּה הַתַּפְּשׁוּת
הַגְּבוּרוֹת וְגִלּוּיִים לְמֶטָה

Accordingly, there it is all light and courage and joy in His place, due to the sweetened *gevurot* radiating down to and illuminating below

וְשִׁימְתָּקוֹ וְשִׁיטְבִּסְמוֹ לְמֶטָה ג"כ הִנֵּה הוּא ע"י הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה

so that the worlds below will also become sweetened and fragrant – and this is through Torah and fulfilling the Commandments.

כִּי הַתּוֹרָה הִיא כֻּלָּה גְבוּרוֹת מִמִּתְקִים מִיְמִינוֹ אֵשׁ דָּת

For the Torah is entirely sweetened *gevurot* as the verse (Deuteronomy 33:2) states, "From His right hand a fiery law..." denoting the stringencies of law, but coming from 'His right hand' – the aspect of *chesed* and kindness.

וְאָמְרוּ בִירוּשָׁלַיִם שְׁקָלִים פ"ו סוּף הֶלְכָה א'

And it states in Talmud Yerushalmi, Shekalim 6:1 that

הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁנָּתַן הַקֵּב"ה לְמֹשֶׁה אֵשׁ לְבָנָה חֲרוּתָהּ בְּאֵשׁ שְׁחִירָה

'The Torah that God gave to Moses was engraved as white fire on black fire – an image depicting *chesed* as the foreground attribute, and *gevurah* as the background basis,

הִיא אֵשׁ מִבְּלָלֶת מֵאֵשׁ חֲצוּבָה בְּאֵשׁ וּנְתוּנָה מֵאֵשׁ

which is fire mixed with fire, cast in fire and given in fire.'

וְע"י קִיּוֹם הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה נִמְתְּקִים כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת

And through Torah and fulfilling the Commandments all of the *gevurot* are sweetened

וּמִתְגַּלִּים וּמֵאִירִים לְמִטָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר כָּאֵן הוּא כָּל הַסִּיגִים וְהַפְּסָלֹת

and become revealed and illuminate below, i.e. this world, where all the dross and impurities

שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ וְנִעְשׂוּ מִתְקַף הַדִּינִים הַקָּשִׁים

that emerged from and were formed by the power of harsh *dinim* severities,

ע"י הַחֲסָרוֹן דֶּה־מִּתּוֹק שֶׁנִּעְשָׂה בַּעוֹה"ז בְּסִבַּת הַחֲטָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת

due to the lack of sweetening that came about in this world as a result of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge,

וּבְסִבַּת כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת כָּלָם דְּשָׁנֵי אֲלָפִים תִּהְיוּ.

and because of all the generations of the first two thousand years of chaos, prior to our receiving the Torah. That period extended from Adam until Abraham was 52 years old.⁶

הִנֵּה ע"י קִיּוֹם הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה שֶׁהִיא כֻּלָּה גְבוּרוֹת נִמְתְּקִים

Thus through fulfilling Torah and the Commandments, which are all sweetened *gevurot*,

מִתְבַּטֵּל מִן הַדִּינִין לְמַטָּה ג"כ וּמִתְבַּטֵּל עִי"ז הַשָּׁרֵשׁ דְּהַסִּיגִים שֶׁהֵם
רק מִתְקַר הַדִּינִין.

the harsh *dinim* below are made fragrant as well, and by way thereof the root of
the dross, which is a result of the harsh *dinim*, is nullified.

וְעִי"ז נִכְרָתִים כָּל הַסִּיגִים מִשָּׁרֶשׁם בְּקֶדֶשׁ וּמִמִּילָא שֶׁמִּתְבַּטֵּלִים
וְכָלִים

And through this all the dross is cut off from its root in holiness, and
automatically it becomes nullified and expires.

וְהִנֵּה אֱלוֹ שְׁזָכֵנוּ שִׁיתְקִים הַתּוֹרָה בָּנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתֵּן לָנוּ בְּרֵאשׁוֹנָה

Now if only we deserved to have the Torah continue with us as it was given
originally,

בְּקוֹלוֹת וּבִרְקִים וּמִלֵּהָבוֹת אֵשׁ אִזְ כָּבֵד הָיָה נִתְקַן

with thunder and lightning and flames of fire, then everything would already
have been rectified,

וְנִעֲשֶׂה הַמִּתְקַת כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת לְמַטָּה בְּכָל הָרָאוּי וְהָיָה מִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל
הַזֶּהֱמָא כְּלָה

and all of the *gevurot* would have been sweetened down below to the proper
extent, and then all of the spiritual pollution would have been nullified,

וְהָיָה חוּזֵר הָעוֹלָם לְתִקּוּנוֹ כְּמוֹ קֵדֶם הַחֵטָא

and the world would have returned to its rectified state, just as it was prior to
the sin of the Tree of Knowledge**, **

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אֲנִי אֲמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתָּם כו' ע' זוה"ק ס"פ יתרו ופ'
מִשְׁפָּטִים קי"ד רע"א

as the verse (Psalms 82:6) states, "I said, 'you are angelic'..." See Zohar end of
parshat Yitro and *Mishpatim* 114a.

Rashi explains: 'You are angelic' – when I gave you the Torah, I gave it to you so
that that the angel of death would hold no sway over you any longer.

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה הוֹלֵךְ וּמִתְתַּקֵּן הָעוֹלָם מֵאִז

Accordingly, the world would have continued to become rectified from that
time on,

כְּמוֹ בְּהַתְקוּנִים דְּלַעֲתִיד אֲשֶׁר מֵאַחֵר תַּחַח"מ וְהִלָּאָה.

just like the future Tikun after the Resurrection of the Dead and on.

אך מאחר שלא זכינו להאור הגדול דמתן תורה שבתחלה ונשתברו
הלוחות הראשונות

But since we did not merit the great light of Matan Torah when the Torah was given initially, and the first Tables were broken, when Moses cast them down from his hands on seeing the golden calf (see Exodus 32:19),

הנה נשאר היצר הרע בתקפו ומתקיים זהמת העולם כמקדם

the yetzer hara the evil inclination remained in all its strength and the pollution of the world continued as before.

ואין כח מעתה לשום אדם לקיים את כל התורה והמצוה על
שלימותה כהראוי

And now no person has the ability to fulfill the entire Torah and all the mitzvot perfectly, as would be proper,

וכמ"ש אין צדיק בארץ אשר יעשה טוב ולא יחטא

as the verse (Ecclesiastes 7:20) states, "For there is no man on earth so righteous that he that he only does good and never sins."

וכן אמרו במדרש ויקרא רבה פ' י"ד סימן ה' בפסוק 'הו בעוון
חוללתי'

And so too in Midrash Vayikra Rabba 14:5 on the verse (Psalms 51:7) 'In iniquity I was formed' the Sages declare

אפלו חסיד שבחסידים אי אפשר שלא יהיה לו צר אחד מעון

– even with the most pious person it is impossible that there won't be some aspect of sin

והוא מהשאור שבעסה הנשרש בכל אדם בסבת הנחש הקדמוני

which derives from 'the yeast in the dough' i.e. the yetzer hara that is rooted in every person as a result of the nachash hakadmoni literally, the primordial snake, i.e. the initial manifestation of evil.

וכן הוא סוד הכוונה ג"כ באותן שאמרו כי מתו בעטיו של נחש

And this is also the mystical explanation of the Sages regarding those who died due to the poison of the snake,⁷ and for no other reason,

ור"ל שלא היה בהם אלא רק צד אחד מעון אשר מהשאור שבעסה

meaning to say, they had only a single aspect of sin from 'the yeast in the dough'

הנשרש בכל אדם בסבת נחש הקדמוני וכמ"ש האריז"ל סוד ענין
הדברים בזה

that became rooted in every person as a result of the *nachash hakadmoni*, as the Arizal writes regarding the mystical aspects thereof

בספר זהר הקריע דף ס"ט ודף ע' ואמר שם כי אלולא אותו השאור
שבפעה

in the work *Zohar HaRakia* p. 69-70. He writes there that were it not for 'the yeast in the dough'

לא היה האדם בעל בחירה כלל ולא היה שָׂכָר ועונש ונתן בו כ"ז
לטובתו ע"ש בארקה

no man would have free choice at all, and there would be no reward and punishment. Thus all this was done for man's own good. See there.

והרי עכ"פ הוא כי אינו מתקיים עתה התורה על שלימותה בכל
הראוי כלל

In any event, we see that the Torah nowadays cannot be fulfilled perfectly, in a totally perfect way at all.

ולכן הנה מכרח כל הרעות והתלאות העוברים על כל באי עולם

And therefore all the negative events and hardships that engulf the entire world

והנה הם מתקף הדינים קשים הנמשכים ומתגלים תמיד

are from the intensity of the harsh *dinim* that are constantly drawn down and revealed

ע"י כל עון וכל חטאת הנעשים מהתגברות הזהמא והטמאה והרע

due to every act of sin and transgression that are the result of the welling up of pollution and impurity and evil.

והנה יסד המאציל ית"ש שכל עוון וכל חטאת אחר שנעשה

Now the blessed Emanator established that any act of sin and transgression,

הנה מתהפך הוא עצמו לדין קשה ונעשה הוא גופא לסער

itself become transformed into harsh judgment and become a whirlwind

מתחולל על ראש רשעים יחול וכמ"ש ב"ב ס"ז א'

devolving on the head of the wicked, as Tractate Bava Batra 67a states

הוא יצר הרע הוא מלאך המות יורד ומתעלה ועולה ומרגיז נוטל
רשות ונוטל נשמה

– this is the *yetzer hara*, which is also the angel of death, that descends and leads the world astray, and then ascends and arouses anger above, evokes permission to punish, and then takes a life.

וְכֵן הוּא כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר הֵן בַּעוּה"ז וְהֵן לְאַחַר מִיתָה

And so too is it with all the punishment in this world and after death –

הֵנָּה הֵם כֻּלָּם מֵהַחֲטָאִים עֲצָמָן וְכַמ"ש מִשְׁלֵי י"ג חֲטָאִים תִּרְדָּף
רָעָה

all of them derive from the sins themselves, as Proverbs 13:21 states: "Evil pursues sinners."

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ ג"כ בְּרִכּוֹת ל"ג א' אֵין עֲרֹד מִמִּית אֶלָּא הַחֲטָא מִמִּית

And similarly the Sages stated in Tractate Berachot 31a: It is not the *arod* a type of poisonous reptile or animal that kills, but the sin,

כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה הַדִּין וְהָעֲנֵשׁ מֵאוֹתָהּ הַזֹּהֶמָּה וְהָרַע עֲצָמוֹ אֲשֶׁר גָּרְמוֹ אֶת
הַחֲטָא

for the verdict and the punishment are made from the same pollution and the evil that caused the sin itself.

וְהֵם כֻּלָּם אֶחָד מִמֶּשׁ ר"ל שֶׁהַזֹּהֶמָּה וְהַחֲטָא וְהָעֲנֵשׁ הֵם כֻּלָּם רַק
מְצִיאת אֶחָד

And they are all one thing, meaning to say the pollution, the sin, and the punishment are all the same,

אֶלָּא שֶׁמִּתְחַלְפִּים מִצּוּרָה לְצּוּרָה ע"י הָאָדָם הַמוֹצִיא אוֹתָהּ מֵהַכֹּחַ
אֶל הַפּוֹעַל

except that they change from one form to another when man causes them to emerge from potential to actual.

כִּי מִקֵּדָם שָׁנַעֲשֶׂה הַחֲטָא הֵנָּה הָרַע אֲשֶׁר לָזָה רַק בִּכְחַ וְאֵינוֹ עֲדִין
בְּמַצִּיאוֹת כָּלֵל

Before a sin is committed the evil therein was merely potential, but was not yet manifested,

וְכַאֲשֶׁר הָאָדָם עוֹשֶׂה אֶת הַחֲטָא הֵנָּה הוּא הוֹצִיא וְהִמְצִיא אֶת אוֹתוֹ
הָרַע

but when a person commits a sin he brings out and manifests that evil

וְהוּא דְּבוּק עִמּוֹ וּמִיָּחַד בּוֹ עַד שֶׁמוֹצִיא הָרַע אֶת כָּל כֹּחוֹ בּוֹ שֶׁהוּא
הָעֲנֵשׁ

and it cleaves to him and unites with him until the evil is fully manifested in him, and that is his punishment.

וְאֵז כְּלָה וּמִתְבַּטֵּל מִכָּל וְכָל

And then it the evil is entirely nullified.

ר"ל כי גם כח הקדום אשר ממנו יצא אותו הרע אל הפועל

Meaning to say, even the primordial power from which that evil is manifested,

הנה מאחר שיצא כחו בהענש הרי אין עוד מעתה כל אותו כח
להרע כלל וכבר כלה ומתבטל

after it has emerged into actuality in the punishment, it no longer has all the same power of evil at all; it is already spent and nullified.

והרי נמצא כי במה שישד המאציל ית"ש שהחטא עצמו הוא נהפך
לענש

So we find that the principle established by the blessed Emanator – that the sin itself becomes the punishment –

הנה הוא תקון גדול כי עי"ז הולך ומתבטל הרע תמיד

is itself the great rectification, for the evil continuously dissipates.

וכשיכלה כל הענשים יכלה ממילא כל הרע בלו כי אין הרע נצחי
ח"ו

And when all of the punishments have dissipated, all the evil will automatically dissolve, for evil is not forever, Heaven forbid.

שהרי אדרבא הוא שהוא שרש כל ההפסד והאבדון ההחלטי

On the contrary, since it is the root of all deficit and total destruction,

והרע והחטא והענש כלם יתבטלו מכל וכל כי הם כלם אחד
בנזכר.

evil and sin and punishment will all be totally nullified, since they are all one thing, as mentioned.

והנה יסד המאציל ית"ש שיעשה כ"ז רק ע"י האדם עצמו

Now the blessed Emanator established that this can be achieved only by the person himself –

ר"ל כי הן מציאות הרע שהוא יציאתו מהכח אל הפועל והן בטולו

meaning to say, the existence of evil, which is its emergence into actuality, and its nullification –

הנה נעשה כ"ז רק ע"י האדם עצמו והוא שאמרו במדרש תנחומא
פ' בראשית סי' ז'

all of this is the result of man's own actions. And as it states in Midrash Tanchuma Bereishit 7

שֶׁאֵין לָאָדָם טַעֲנָה עַל חַטָּאָיו מִמָּה שֶׁיֵּצֵר לֵב הָאָדָם רַע מִנְעֲרִיו

that a person cannot make a disclaimer for his sins based on the fact that 'the impulse of a person's heart is evil from his youth,'

וּמֵאַחַר שֶׁהוּא רַע מִי יוֹכַל לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ טוֹב

and since he is evil who could possibly make him good? i.e. because he was created with a *yetzer hara* how could he *not* sin?⁸

אָמַר הַקֵּב"ה אֶתְּהָ עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רַע – אֶתְּהָ עֲשִׂיתָ אוֹתוֹ רַע כּו' ע"ש

Such an argument cannot work, for the Holy One blessed is He says, "You did the evil..." in other words, it is not inherently evil. Rather, "you were the one who made it evil..."

וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ כִּי הַתְּחִלָּתָּה מְצִיאת הַיֵּצֶר הַרָּע בְּאָדָם הוּא רַק בְּפֶנֶחַ

And this comports with what we stated – that the initial existence of the *yetzer hara* in a person is merely a potential;

וְאֵינוֹ עַדִּין רַע מִמַּשׁ וְרַק בְּפַעֲלַת הַחַטָּא יוֹצֵא מִן הַפֶּנַח אֶל הַפַּעַל

it is not yet actually evil, and only the act of sin brings it from potential to actual,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה עִי"ז מְצִיאת הָרַע מִמַּשׁ בְּהָאָדָם וְכֵן נַעֲשֶׂה אַח"כ בְּטוֹלוֹ ג"כ
ע"י הָאָדָם

thus creating the existence of actual evil in a person. And therefore its nullification is also by that person.

וְהוּא ע"י הָעֲנֵשׁ שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ וּלְפִי עֶרֶךְ גָּדֹל כַּמּוֹת וְאִיכוֹת הַחַטָּא

This nullification is by way of the punishment that devolves upon them, and is commensurate with the magnitude and gravity of the sin.

הֵנָּה נַעֲשֶׂה מִקֵּדָם כָּל מְצִיאת הָרַע שָׁבוּ

Thus first the actuality of evil is created in them,

וְכֵן נַעֲשֶׂה אַח"כ כָּל בְּטוֹלוֹ בְּהָעֲנֵשׁ אֲשֶׁר הוּא ג"כ בְּעֶרֶךְ זֶה מִמַּשׁ כִּי
הֵם אֶחָד בְּנִזְכָּר

and then it is also nullified is by way of a proportionate punishment, for they are one and the same, as noted.

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל ע"י הָאָדָם עַצְמוֹ

Hence we find that the entire situation is created by the person himself or herself.

וְהִנֵּה מָה שִׁיָּסַד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שִׁיעֲשֶׂה בְּטוֹל הָרַע ע"י הָאָדָם עֲצָמוֹ
הִנֵּה פְּשׁוּט הוּא

So the fundamental principle that the blessed Emanator established –the nullification of evil is by the person himself the perpetrator – is straightforward.

כי מאחר שכל התקון דהעולמות כלם שיתקנו

For since the entire *tikun* of rectifying all the worlds

להאיר באור זיו שכינתו וקדשתו ית"ש מן העולם ועד העולם

to illuminate them with the light of the *Shechinah* the Divine Presence and His blessed Holiness from world to world,

שרק זה הוא תכלית כל התכליות הנה הוא תלוי רק בבטול הרע

for this exclusively is the ultimate purpose – depends entirely on nullifying evil.

**לכן יסד המאציל ית"ש שיעשה בטולו ע"י האדם כדי שיהא האדם
עצמו הסבה**

Therefore the blessed Emanator established that its nullification will be by man, so that man himself is the reason for

**והגורם לכל התקונים כלם אשר לעתיד כי ע"ז יהנה כ"א משלו מה
שהכין לעצמו**

and the cause of all future rectifications. So in this way each person will enjoy his own portion – that which he prepared for himself!

**וע"ד שאמרו (בבא מציעא לח, א) אדם רוצה בקב שלו מתשעה
קבין של חבירו.**

This is akin to what the Sages said (Bava Metzia 38a) – A person prefers a single portion of his own to nine portions belonging to someone else.

[והסבה בזה הוא משום סוד האחדות הגנוז בהעולם]

[The reason for this is the mystery of unity concealed within the world,

**כי העולם משכלל על סוד האחדות וכמו שיהיה בסוף תקון
האחרון**

for the world is graced in a concealed manner with the mystery of unity, just as it will be in a revealed manner when the final *tikun* is completed.

והוא ג"כ היסוד הראשון שבה האבן שתיה שממנה השתת העולם

This was also the mystical secret of the first foundation of the world – the *even shetiya* the foundation-stone from which the entire world spread forth.²

ולכן תכונת כ"א להנות משלו ואדם קרוב אצל עצמו

Therefore it is the nature of each person to enjoy his own portion, since 'a person is his own closest relative.'¹⁰ This is the basis of the principle in Jewish law that a person cannot testify against himself, just as he is not allowed to testify for or against his close relatives,

כִּי אֵין אֶחָדוֹת יוֹתֵר מֵעַצְמוֹ אֶל עַצְמוֹ, וְהֵבֵן הַדְּבָרִים]

since there is no unity greater than the unity of himself with himself.
Understand these matters!]

וּמִשּׁוּם זֶה יָסַד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שִׁיְהֵא הָאָדָם עַצְמוֹ הַסִּבָּה וְהַגֵּרָם

It was for this reason that the blessed Emanator established the rule that a person himself will be the reason and cause

לְכָל הַתְּקוּנִים כָּלָם דְּלַעֲתִיד וְיִהְיֶה כ"א מִשְׁלוֹ

of all the future *tikunim* that he has to do**, and everyone will enjoy his own,**

כִּי זֶה גּוֹפָה הוּא מֵהַתְּקוּנִים דְּסוּד הָאֶחָדוֹת הַשְּׁלִימָה

for this itself is one of the Tikunim of the mystery of complete Oneness.

אָמְנָם מָה שִׁיְסַד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש שִׁיְהֵא גַם מְצִיאת הָרָע

However, the principle that the blessed Emanator established – that the existence of evil,

וְיִצְיָאתוֹ מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל ג"כ רַק ע"י הָאָדָם הוּא עֲנֵן עִמָּק מְאֹד

and that its emergence from potential to actual is also only by way of human agency, is a very profound matter,

וְהוּא נוֹגֵעַ לְכַמָּה סוּדוֹת נַעֲלָמִים אֲשֶׁר בְּאֶרְנוֹ אוֹתָם בְּסִפְרֵי הַדַּע"ה
ח"ב

and is relevant to a number of hidden mysteries that we explained in our Sefer HaDe'ah Drushei Olam haTohu part 2.

אֲךָ מָה שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ לַעֲנִינֵינוּ נֶאֱמַר בְּקִצּוֹר נִמְרָץ וּבְרָמָז

But what we need for our current purposes let us state very briefly, hinting to deeper themes without explaining them here.

כִּי הָרִי עֲנֵן כֹּחַ הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּל הָרָע הֵנָּה נַעֲשֶׂה שְׂרָשׁוֹ בְּכּוֹנֶה מִן
הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש

Now the concept of the potential of all evil to exist, the root of which was formed intentionally by the Emanator, blessed is His Name,

בְּהַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּתוֹקֵף הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים כְּאֲשֶׁר שֶׁהִיוּ בְּלֹא בְּסוּם וְהַמְּתָקָה
כָּלָל

within the existence of harsh *dinim* when they were as yet without any or fragrance of any sweetening at all.

וְהוּא אַחֵר מִיַּתַּת הַמַּלְכִּים דְּסוּד עוֹלָם הַנִּקְדוּת

This was after the 'death of the kings'¹¹ in the mystical secret of the *nekudot* – the embryonic and undeveloped (hence point-like) vessels of that world that could not contain the powerful lights that flooded them.

וְאִזּוּ יֵצֵא עֵקֶר הָרָע בְּמַצִּיאוֹת נוֹרָא מְאֹד

And then the root of evil emerged into a existence, arousing great dread.

וְהָיָה יֵצִיאָתוֹ ג' כ מן הכּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל רַק ע"י רְשָׁעַת הַתַּתְקַע"ד
דְּוֵרוֹת הַנִּזְכָּר בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת בְּדַבְּרֵי רז"ל

There too the evil emerged from a state of potential into actuality via the wickedness of 974 generations mentioned in a number of places in the writings of our Sages.¹²

וְהָגַם שְׁלֹא הָיָה מַצִּיאוֹתָם כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא עֲתָה אֲךְ הָיוּ בְּמַצִּיאוֹת עכ"פ

Now although their existence then was not as it is now, nevertheless, they did exist,

וְהָיוּ רְשָׁעִים גְּדוֹלִים כַּמ"ש בְּמִדְרַשׁ תְּהִלִּים מְזִמּוֹר צ'

and they were extremely evil, as *Midrash Tehillim*, 90 explains.

וְע"י רְשָׁעָתָם יֵצֵא הָרָע מִן הַכּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל וְנִתְחַרְבוּ כָּלָם תַּכְךָ

Due to their evil deeds the evil emerged from potential to actual and destroyed them all instantly,

וְהָרָע נִתְהַפֵּךְ לְסַעַר מִתְחַלֵּל עַל רֹאשׁ רְשָׁעִים יָחוּל וְכַמ"ש בַּחֲגִיגָה
י"ג סע"ב

and the evil was transformed into a whirlwind "which descends upon the head of the wicked" (Jeremiah 23:19), as is explained in Tractate Chagiga 13b.

וְהִנֵּה הָגַם שֶׁנִּרְאָה כָּל הַפְּעֻלוֹת הַלָּלוּ לְקִלְקוֹל גְּדוֹל

Now although all of these activities appear to be massively destructive,

אֲךְ בְּאֻמַּת הָיָה נַעֲשֶׂה כ"ז לְצוּרֶךָ תִּקּוֹן גְּדוֹל כִּי הָרִי יֵצֵא עִי"ז כָּל
כַּחוֹת דְּתַקָּף הַדִּינִים

in truth this was all for the sake of a great *Tikun*, for through this all the powers of the most intense *dinim* emerged

בְּתַכְלִית הַשְּׁלֵמוֹת הַנִּצָּרֶךָ לְהַעֲשׂוֹת לַעֲתִיד עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֶת כָּל
הַיְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים

in the consummate completeness necessary to bring about all the promises for the future

דְּשָׁכַר הָעוֹה"ב אֲשֶׁר הֵם נֶעֱשִׂים רַק בְּהָאוֹרוֹת דְּבַחִי גְבוּרוֹת אַחֵר
שִׁיתְּבַסְמוּ כֵּן"ל

regarding reward in the World to Come, which is produced only by the lights of *gevurot* severities after they have been sweetened and made fragrant, as mentioned above.

וּבְאֲשֶׁר שָׁאִין דֶּרֶךְ לְכַחוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת לְהוֹצִיאָם בְּכָל תִּקְפָּם

And since there is no way for the powers of *gevurah* to bring them out in all their intensity

אֲלֹא רַק בְּשֶׁהֵם מִתְחִילָה בְּלֹא בְּסוּם כָּלֵל כִּי בְּסוּמָם הוּא ע"י אוֹר
קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש הַמִּתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם

unless they start off without any sweetening at all, since the sweetening process is by way of the light of His blessed Holiness becoming revealed in them,

שֶׁהוּא חֶסֶד פָּשוּט וְאֵז מְאִירִים הַגְּבוּרוֹת בְּחֶסֶד וְהֵם דִּינִין דְּקִדְשָׁא

which is pure *chesed* kindness, which then illuminates the *gevurot* with *chesed* and they become powers of *din* in holiness.

שֶׁהֵם עֲנֵג כָּל הָעֲנוּגִים וְעֵדוֹ כָּל הָעֵדוּנִים שֶׁהוּא כָּל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן אֲשֶׁר
לַעֲתִיד לָבוֹא.

They are then the delight of delights and the pleasure of all spiritual pleasures.

אֲךָ עכ"פ כִּי בְּשֶׁהֵם מְבַסְמִים אִי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁיתְּגַלוּ בְּכָל תִּקְפָּם כִּי הֲרִי
הֵם כְּלוּלִים בְּחֶסֶד

But in any event when they have become fragrant and thus diluted it is impossible for them to become revealed in all their strength, since they are already merged into *chesed*.

וְלִכְּנֹה הָיָה הַצֶּרֶךְ לְהוֹצִיאָם מִתְחִילָה בְּלֹא בְּסוּם כָּלֵל

And therefore it was necessary to have them emerge from the outset without any dilution¹³

כְּדִי לְהוֹצִיא כְּחוֹתֵיהֶם בְּכָל תִּקְפָּם בְּתַכְלִית הָאֶפְשָׁרִי

in order to bring out their full strength to the maximum possible.

אָמְנָם כְּאֲשֶׁר שֶׁהֵם בְּלֹא בְּסוּם כָּלֵל וְהֵם עוֹמְדִים בְּהֶעֱלָם אוֹר
קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש מֵהֶם לְגִמְרִי

Nevertheless, when they are without dilution at all, and they are in a state of complete concealment from His holy light;

הִנֵּה בְּאַמֶּת עוֹמְדִים אַז בְּסִכְנָה גְדוֹלָה עֲצוּמָה לְמַאֲד

they are truly in a position of tremendous danger.

זֶהוּ עֲנִין כָּל הַתִּתְקַע"ד דּוֹרוֹת שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ בְּעוֹלָם הַתְּהוֹ שֶׁהוּא
אַחֵר מִיַּתַּת הַמְּלָכִים

This is the idea of the 974 generations we mentioned that emerged in the World of Tohu, which was after the death of the 'kings,'

וְהָיוּ מִתְקַף דִּינִים קָשִׁים וְעִי"ז נִתְּהַפְּכוּ לְדַעַת אַחֲרֵת ¹⁴ רח"ל

who derived from the severest of harsh *dinim* and thus deviated into other ways of thinking or false conjectures, possibly a euphemism for all three cardinal sins – idolatry, murder and sexual impropriety.

וַיֵּצֵא עִי"ז כָּל הָרַע כְּלוּ מִן הַכַּח אֶל הַפּוֹעַל

In this way all of the evil emerged from potential to actual,

שֶׁהוּא מִכְחוֹת תְּקַף דִּינִים קָשִׁים עִי"ז רִשְׁעַת הַתִּתְקַע"ד דּוֹרוֹת
כְּנִזְכָּר.

produced by the intense powers of *dinim* due to the wickedness of those 974 generations, as mentioned above.

וְהִנֵּה עֲלֵיהֶם הוּא סוֹד הַכְּתוּב (קהלת ד, א) דְּמַעַת הָעֲשָׁקִים וְאִין
לָהֶם מְנַחֵם

Regarding them the verse (Ecclesiastes 4:1) states, "...Tears of the oppressed with none to comfort them."

כִּי הֵם בּוֹכִים וְצוֹעֲקִים עַל מָה שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ הֵם מִתְקַף דִּינִים קָשִׁים כ"כ

Mystically interpreted this means that they weep and cry out about why they derive from the most powerful of harsh *dinim* attributes of punitive justice,

וְנַעֲשׂוּ הֵם כְּמִטְרֵה לְחִיצִים לְהוֹצִיא עַל יְדֵיהֶם כָּל הַכְּחוֹת דְּתִקְף
הַדִּינִים

so that they became like a target for the arrows that emerge as all the powers of intense *dinim*,

עִי"ז שֶׁנִּתְּנוּ בְּסִכְנָה גְדוֹלָה כְּזֶה עַד שֶׁכְּמַעַט הָיוּ בְּמִכְרָחִים וְאַנוּסִים
עַל כָּל מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם

because they are in such great danger that they are almost forced and compelled in all of their actions,

מֵאַחֵר שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה כָּל מְצִאוֹתָם מִתְקַף הַדִּינִין אֲשֶׁר הֵם בְּלֹא בְּסוּם
כָּלָל

since their entire existence is produced by the power of those completely undiluted *dinim*.

אָמַנְם עֲתִידִים גַּם הֵם לְהִתְנַחֵם לְעֵתִיד לְבוֹא

However, the time will come when they too will be comforted *le'atid lavo* in 'the Time to Come' – a term that refers to the Messianic era and sometimes to the era of the Resurrection of the Dead.

וְמָה גַּם כִּי בְּאַמְתָּ הֵם אֵינָם יְחִידִים בְּזֶה

Particularly so, since in truth they are not alone in this anguish about their condition.

כִּי מִשְׁתַּתְּפִים עִמָּהֶם כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת כָּלָם אֲשֶׁר עַד בִּיאַת הַמָּשִׁיחַ

For all the generation until the Messiah comes join together with them in their anguish,

כִּי כָּל זְמַן הַגָּלוּת הוּא הָעוֹלָם תָּהוּ וְצַדִּיקִים הֵם מוֹעָטִים

since the entire period of the exile is the World of Tohu, and the righteous are few,

וְעִי"ז הֵנָּה הוּא כָּל הָרָעוֹת וְהַתְּלָאוֹת הָעוֹבְרוֹת עַל כָּל בָּאֵי עוֹלָם

and therefore all this evil and suffering washes over the entire world.

וְמִי שְׂאִינוּ מִתְּתַקֵּן בְּהַתְּלָאוֹת דֵּהוּ"ז הֵנָּה הוּא נִדּוֹן בְּהַעֲנָשִׁים
דְּאַחַר מִיתָה כ"א לְפִי מַעֲשָׁיו.

And anyone who is not rectified by the suffering of this world is sentenced to punishment for their sins after death, each according to his deeds.

כִּי כָּל חַטָּא נִתְהַפֵּךְ לְעֵנָשׁ כִּי הֵם אֶחָד כנ"ל

For every sin is transformed into punishment, because they are all one thing, as explained above.

וְאַחַר שְׁנַעֲשָׂה הָעֵנָשׁ הֵנָּה כָּלָה וּמִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל הָרָע שֶׁבּוּ לְגַמְרֵי

But after the punishment has been administered, all the evil in him is terminated and nullified

וְנִשְׁאַרוּ אֲזַי כָּל תִּקְוַת הַדִּינִים וְכָל כְּחוֹתֵיהֶם שֶׁצָּאוּ וְנִתְּגְלוּ עִי"ז
טְהוֹרִים

and the most intense aspects of the *dinim* and all their powers that emerged and were revealed through this process are pure

וְנִקְיִים מִכָּל סִיג וּפְסוּלֹת וְהֵם רָאוּיִם לְקַבֵּל עֲתֵדָה כָּל בְּסוּם וְהַמְּתָקָה
מֵאוּר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש

and uncontaminated by any dross or waste, and they are ready to accept any dilution and sweetening by the light of His Holiness, may He be blessed,

וְנִכְלְלוּ כָּלֶם עִם שְׁרָשָׁם שֶׁבְּקֹדֶשׁ הַקִּדְּשִׁים

and all of them merge into their roots in the Holy of Holies

וְנִעְשִׂים מֵאֵז לְרֹשְׁפֵי אֵשׁ שֶׁלִּהְבֵּת י"ה שֶׁלְּהוֹבִין דְּרַחֲמֵי

and become from that point on the flames of fire of the Divine Flame¹⁵ – flames of love –

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הוּא כָּל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן לְכָל הַיְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים.

where everything is the hidden goodness mentioned in all the promises that will come to fruition in the future.

וְהִנֵּה הַבְּסוּם וְהַמִּתְקָה מֵאוֹר קֹדֶשְׁתּוֹ ית"ש

Making them the harsh *dinim* fragrant and sweetening them by way of the light of His blessed Holiness

הַנִּמְשָׁךְ וּמִתְגַּלֶּה בְּכָל תִּקְרֵי הַדִּינִין אַחֵר שֶׁנִּעְשָׂה בָּהֶם הָעֲנָשִׁים

that is drawn into and revealed within the most intense aspects of the *dinim*, after the punishment has been administered through them,

הִנֵּה הוּא ג"כ בְּסִבַּת וְגֵרָם כָּל אָדָם בְּעַצְמוֹ

this too is because of, and by means, of every person himself or herself

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאֲמָרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ הַנֶּעֱלָם בְּזֹהַר חֲדָשׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּפֶסוּק אֵלֶּה תוֹלְדוֹת הַשָּׁמַיִם

as the *Midrash HaNe'elam in Zohar Chadash, Bereishit* states on the verse (Genesis 2:4) – 'These are the products of heaven...':

אָמַר רַב הוּנָא אֵין לָךְ רָשָׁע מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁאֵין לוֹ מַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים דְּמַעֲלִיא לְהוּ לַעֲלָמָא דְּאֲתִי

Said Rabbi Huna: "There is no wicked Jew who does not have good deeds that will bring him into the World to Come."

וְהוּא כִּמוֹ שֶׁאֲמָרוּ ג"כ עִירוּבִין י"ט א' פּוֹנְשֵׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִלְּאִים מִצְוֹת קָרָמוֹן

This is the same thing as the Sages declare in Tractate Eruvin 19a: Even the sinners of Israel are as full of *mitzvot* as a pomegranate is full of seeds.

וּבְזֶה הָרִי יִזְכּוּ הַתִּתְקַע"ד דּוֹרוֹת ג"כ כִּי הֵם מִתְגַּלְגְּלִים בְּכָל דּוֹר

So in this way the 974 generations of wicked people will also be meritorious, for they reincarnate in every generation.

וְהָרִי עַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלָם יִזְכּוּ לְכָל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים

Accordingly, at least it is clearly established that all Jews will merit all of the promises for the future.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה כ"ז לַכ"א בְּסִבְתּוֹ עֲצָמוֹ כִּי כָּבֵד יִסַּד הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש

And all of this is due to the person himself or herself because the blessed Emanator established

עֲלִילוֹת וּפְעֻלוֹת נִפְלְאוֹת עַל זֶה שְׁגָם הָרָשָׁע שְׁבִי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִכִּין לַעֲצָמוֹ
the strategies and wondrous means by which even a wicked Jew can prepare himself

אֶת הַיְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים אֲשֶׁר בַּחַיִּים הַנִּצְחִי

for the future promises that will be fulfilled in eternal life.

וְזֶה סוּד מַאֲמָרָם ז"ל בְּאֶדְרָא קל"ג א' הַנ"ל פ"ה

And this is the mystical explanation of the statement of the Sages in *Idra Rabba* 133a, cited earlier in chapter 5,

בְּסוּד הַתְּקוּן דְּעוֹבֵר עַל פְּשָׁע שְׁנַעֲשֶׂה מִפְּשָׁע – שְׁפַע.

regarding the 'Tikun of "Who commutes iniquity" – where *pesha* (iniquity) becomes *shefa* (an outflow of benevolence).

As explained there, 'commutes' is understood in the sense of 'transpose' or 'switch' – by switching the order of the letters *pesha* becomes *shefa*. Now how does this switch come about?

וְהוּא ע"פ מָה שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ כִּי ע"י שְׁנִתְהַפֵּךְ לַעֲנֹשׁ ע"ז כָּלָה וְנִתְבַּטַּל
הַטְּמָאָה וְהָרַע שֶׁבּוֹ

This is according to what we said before that the sin itself is transformed into punishment, and in this way the spiritual impurity in him is terminated and nullified,

וְנִשְׁאָרוּ כָּל מְצִיאת הַכּוֹחוֹת שֶׁנִּתְגַּלוּ ע"ז טְהוּרִים וְנִקְיִים

and all the soul-powers that were revealed thereby remain pure and uncontaminated,

וְנִכְלְלוּ בְּשִׁרְשָׁם וּמִתְבַּסְּמִים וְהָרִי נַעֲשֶׂה הַקְּלִקוּל לְתִקּוּן

and they merge into their root and become fragrant, so that the blemish becomes the rectification

וּמִתְהַפֵּךְ הַפְּשָׁע לְשְׁפַע וְזֶהוּ שְׁאֲמָרוּ בְּאֶדְרָא רַבָּא שָׁם

and *pesha* becomes *shefa*, as they state in the *Idra Rabba*:

בְּאִרְיָךְ אֲנִפִּיּוֹ כְּתִיב וְעוֹבֵר עַל פְּשָׁע וְכָתִיב וְרוּחַ עֲבָרָה וְתִטְהָרֵם

'Regarding *Arich Anpin* it is written, "Who commutes iniquity," and it is written (Job 37:21) "...like clouds in the sky, which are blown away and cleared by the wind."

כי שם אינו נוגע החטא כלל והנה מתגלה שם התקון תכף

For there in *Arich Anpin* sin has no effect at all, so that the *Tikun* is revealed there immediately

ע"י רוחא דפרדשקא דנשיב ממנו כמ"ש שם ק"ל ע"ב

by way of the breath of the nostrils that flows from it – this is meant as an analogy for the flow of life-force down from to *Arich Anpin* to *ze'ir anpin*, as it states there p. 130b,

לדחות ולהרחיק כל סיג ופסולת וזהו שאמר ורוח עברה ותטהרם

to push away and distance itself from any dross and impurities. This is the meaning of "which are blown away and cleared by the wind."

ומגיע ומתעורר למעלה גלוי דגבורות מבשמים תכף

This immediately reaches to and arouses the *gevurot* that have become fragrant

ונעשה שם הכל לתקונים ועומדים כלם מוכן על לעתיד לבוא

and everything there is rectified and stands ready for *l'atid lavo* – the Time to Come.

וזה סוד מ"ש איוב י"ד מי יתן טהור מטמא לא אחד

This is the secret of the verse in Job 14:4 "Who can produce purity from impurity? No one!" –

והוא נדרש הן למעלה והן למטה כי למעלה והוא במקום שאין מגיע הטמאה והרע כלל

This is elucidated as applicable both above in the higher worlds and below in our world: above – this is where impurity and evil do not reach at all,

ונעשה שם הכל לתקונים הרי נתקן ונעשה הטהור מטמא תכף כנזכר

and everything becomes rectified, for the impure becomes pure immediately, as we just explained.

וכן נדרש למטה כי הרי אחר שנתהפך כל חטא ועון ופשע לעונש

And it is also elucidated as applicable down below, because once all sin and transgression has been transformed into punishment –

ועי"ז הנה בלה ומתבטל הטמאה והרע ומתגלה אח"כ התקון והטוב שבה גם למטה

by means of which the impurity and the evil is terminated and nullified, after which the rectification and the goodness in it is revealed below as well,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה גַם לְמַטָּה מִפֶּשַׁע שְׂפַע וְכִמוּ שִׁיְהִיָּה לַעֲתִיד וְהָרִי מִתְתַּקֵּן
וְנַעֲשֶׂה טָהוֹר מִטָּמֵא

so that down below *pesha* becomes *shefa*, as it will be in the future, and thus it is rectified and impure is transformed into pure.

וכמ"ש בזה"ק פקודי רל"ז ע"ב בסוד פרה אדמה

As is written in *Zohar Pikudei* 237b, regarding the mystical explanation of the *para aduma* the red heifer whose ashes are used to purify those who have become spiritually impure through contact with the dead

דָּהָא בְּקִדְמִיתָא טָמֵא וְהִשְׁתָּא דְּאִתְעֵבִיד בִּיה דִּינָא וְאִתְיְהִיב לִיקִידָת
אַשָּׁא בְּנוֹרָא דְּדָלִיק כּו'

– the person was initially spiritually impure, but now that the stringency of the law has been followed, and the red heifer was committed to the flames until it burned to ashes –

הִשְׁתָּא אִיהוּ טָהוֹר מִטָּמֵא, טָהוֹר דְּנִפִּיק מִטָּמֵא, וְכֵן הוּא בְּעִנְיָנֵינוּ.

now he is pure out of impurity, purity that emerged from impurity. And so too, in the matter under discussion.

וְהִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה כ"ז הוּ לְמַעַלָּה וְהוּ לְמַטָּה הַכֹּל ע"י הָאָדָם

Now all of this – both above below – is achieved by man's agency.

כִּי מִצִּיאוֹת הָרַע שֶׁהוּא תּוֹלְדוֹת תְּכֵלִית הַגְּבוּרוֹת הַיּוֹתֵר קָשִׁים

This is because the existence of evil is a product of the most intense harsh judgments *gevurot*

הָרִי יוֹצֵא הוּא מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל רַק ע"י הָאָדָם

which only emerge from potential to actual through man, as explained at length above.

וְכֵן אַח"כ כָּל בְּטוּלוֹ שְׂכֵלָה וּמִתְבַּטֵּל בְּהַעֲנֵשׁ

And similarly, their subsequent nullification – that they are terminated and nullified through punishments,

שֶׁהוּא כָּל הָרָעוֹת וְהַתְּלָאוֹת דִּהְעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְכֵן הָאֵשׁ שֶׁל גִּיהֵנָם
דְּלֵאחֵר מִיָּתָה

which are all the negative events and suffering of this world as well as the fires of Gehinnom after death –

אֲשֶׁר כ"ז הוּא מִהַמְּצִיאוֹת עֲצֻמוֹ דִּהְרַע שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה ע"י הַחֲטָא

all of this is the coming into being of the evil itself that is created through sin,

וְהוּא הוֹלֵךְ וּמִתְבַּטֵּל בְּהַעֲנֵשׁ אֲשֶׁר מִתְיַסֵּר הָאָדָם בּוֹ

and it is continually nullified by way of the punishments by which a person is tormented.

וְע"י כָּל זֶה נִטְהָרוּ כָּל אוֹתָן מְצִיאוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ וְנִמְצְאוּ ע"י
הָאָדָם עַצְמוֹ

And through this, the entire existence of the *gevurot* that surfaced and are there because of the person himself become purified;

וְנִכְלְלוּ בְּשָׂרָשָׁם וּמִתְבַּסְּמִים

they merge into their root and become fragrant.

כִּי מֵאַחַר שֶׁנִּטְהָרוּ הֵרִי נִתְבַּטֵּל הַמַּחְצָה וְהַמָּסָךְ מִבְּדִיל אֲשֶׁר בֵּינָם
לְבֵין שָׂרָשָׁם

Because when they become purified the fence and the barrier separating them from their root is nullified,

וּמִמֵּילָא שֶׁנִּכְלָלִים לְמַעַלָּה בְּקֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשִׁים

and they automatically merge above into the Holy of Holies.

וּבִפְרָט ע"י הַמִּצְוֹת וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים שֶׁיִּשְׁנֶם לְכָל רָשָׁע מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל עכ"פ

And this is particularly so when this is accomplished through the *mitzvot* and good deeds that even every wicked Jew has to his credit,

כֵּן"ל מִגִּמְרָא זוֹהַר חֲדָשׁ וְע"י כ"ז הֵנָּה מִתְבַּסְּמִים וְנִמְתָּקִים כָּל
אוֹתָן הַגְּבוּרוֹת כָּלָם

as cited above from the Gemara and the *Zohar Chadash*. And through this they all those harsh *gevurot* become fragrant and are sweetened,

וְנַעֲשֶׂה בָּהֶם כָּל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים וּשְׂכָר הָעוֹה"ב

and form all of the promises that will come to fruition in the future, as well as the reward in the World to Come.

וְהֵרִי נִמְצָא כִּי יִזְכּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלָם עכ"פ לְטוֹב הָעֲתִיד

So it turns out that every Jew will be worthy of good in the future –

מֵאֲשֶׁר הֵכִין כ"א לְעַצְמוֹ ע"י הַמַּאֲרָעוֹת כָּלָם שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ.

from that which each one prepares for themselves by way of all the events that occur with that person.

1. See Berachot 60a [↪](#)
2. Makover. [↪](#)
3. *Sod* (the mystical secrets of Torah) and *yayin* (wine) both have the numerical value (*gematria*) of 70, indicating a common underlying theme, as the saying (Sanhedrin 38a) goes: "When wine goes in, the secrets come out." [↪](#)
4. See Judges 9:13; Tractate *Berachot* 35a. [↪](#)
5. In Daniel 2:22: וְנִהְיָא [וְנִהְיָא] עֲמָה שְׂרָא [↪](#)
6. See Tractate Avodah Zara 9a. [↪](#)
7. Tractate Shabbat 55b; Bava Batra 17a. They were Benjamin (son of Jacob); Amram, Moses' father; Yishai, King David's father, Calev, King David's son. [↪](#)
8. Makover. [↪](#)
9. The *even shetiya* is a rock that juts out from the top of the Temple Mount. It was in the Holy of Holies, and it served as the base for the Ark. The Talmud (Yoma 54b, Rashi) explains that the entire world spread out from, and was built upon, this rock. [↪](#)
10. Sanhedrin 9b. [↪](#)
11. See Genesis 36:31 ff. The seven kings of Edom 'who ruled and then died' listed there refers to the seven *sefirot* of the World of Tohu – also called the World of *Nekudim*, since the vessels were undeveloped and like embryonic points (*nekudot*) – that shattered and then fell into the lower worlds in a mystical process known as *shevirat hakelim*. See *Etz Chaim* 5:1; 8:2. [↪](#)
12. See *Sefer haDe'ah* part 2, *drush* 2, subsection 2:1. [↪](#)
13. The word בְּסוּם in this context is best translated as 'diluted' rather than 'made fragrant.' [↪](#)
14. This may be a misprint that should read דת אחרת – a different religion or set of beliefs – as in *Sefer Ha-Ikarim* 1:24. [↪](#)
15. See Song of Songs 8:6 רֶשֶׁתִּי רֶשֶׁתִּי אֶשׁ שְׁלֵבִי בְּתֵיךְ [↪](#)

Avnei Miluim — Talmud Hagiga 5b: Explanation of the verse, My soul shall weep in the hidden parts

Explanation of the discussion in the Talmud of the verse, My soul shall cry in the hidden parts.

This is a note the Baal HaLeshem added to the text of this chapter discussing two versions of the Talmudic text. The girsa (version) found in our editions of the Talmud follows Rashi, according to which joy is found in the outer chambers, but weeping in the inner chambers. Rabbi Elyashiv prefers the girsa of Rabbeinu Chananel – that weeping is in the outer chambers, and joy in the inner chambers, and he makes the case as to why this version is the primary one.

The above text that weeping is in the outer chambers, and joy in the inner chambers **is found in an older version** of the Talmud, favored by Rabbeinu Chananel.

However, the version in the current editions of the Talmud follow Rashi's girsa, which is the opposite of the one stated above. This is the wording of the Talmud as currently printed: The verse (Jeremiah 13:17) states: "But if you will not hear it, My soul shall weep in secret [b'mistarim] for your grandeur." Rav Shmuel bar Inya said in the name of Rav: The blessed Holy One has a place where He weeps, and its name is *Mistarim*. What is the meaning of "for your grandeur"? Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak said: G-d weeps for the grandeur of the Jewish people which was taken from them and given to the gentile nations. Rav Shmuel bar Nachmani said: He weeps for the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, which was withdrawn from the world.

The Gemara asks: **But is there weeping before the blessed Holy One? Didn't Rav Pappa say: There is no sadness before the blessed Holy One as the verse states (I Chronicles 16:27): "Grandeur and majesty are before Him; strength and gladness are in His place"?** The Gemara responds: **This is not a difficulty. This statement that Gd weeps is referring to the innermost chambers, where He can weep in secret, whereas the other statement, that He does not weep, is referring to the outer chambers.**

The Gemara then asks: **And is there none no weeping in the outer chambers? Doesn't the verse state (Isaiah 22:12): "And the Lord, G-d of legions, called it a day for weeping and mourning, and shaving off their hair, and donning sackcloth"?** The Gemara responds: **The destruction of the Beit HaMikdash the Temple is different, as even the Angels of Peace cried, as the verse (Isaiah 33:7) states: "Behold, the valiant ones weep outside; the Angels of Peace weep bitterly."** This is the end of the quote from the Gemara.

Rashi explains: The statement that there is weeping refers to **in the innermost chambers, since the verse states, b'mistarim** in secret, i.e. the inner chambers. And he adds: **This is the accepted version: And is there none no weeping in the outer chambers? Doesn't the verse state, "He called it a day for weeping and**

mourning"? But wherever the word 'called' ויקרא appears it signifies audible sound. This is as far as Rashi explains.

Now this Rashi's version is cited in a number of works written after Rashi's time, e.g. *Sefer Ha-Ikkarim*, 4:23; *Sefer Ha-Akeida Sha'ar* 87; and so too in *Yalkut Yirmeya* on the verse 13:17. The *Yalkut* was also compiled after Rashi's time, as is known from the works of historians – see e.g. *Seder HaDorot*, end of section 1.

However, from Rashi's own words – 'this is the accepted version' – it is evident that he also had another version in front of him. And this is indeed noted by the Radvaz in *Magen Avot* #2 that the version of older works it states the opposite: This statement that G-d weeps is referring to the *outer* chambers, whereas the other statement, where there is no weeping, refers to the *inner* chambers. And when the Gemara asks: And is there no weeping... the older version continues: in the *inner* chambers? Doesn't the verse state: "And on that day the Lord called..."

The older version is also cited in Rabbi Yosef Gikatilia's *Sha'arei Tzedek* in the section on the *sefirah* of *binah*. And similarly in Rabbi Todros HaLevi's *Otzar HaKavod*, Tractate *Chagiga* 5b: 'There are other works where it states: "And is there no weeping **in the outer chambers?" (i.e. Rashi's version) but these cannot be correct. See there (**although there are a few words missing there).

But now we have the benefit of Rabbi Chananel's work which was printed in the new Vilna edition of the Talmud from the manuscript. And he too writes exclusively according to the old version, just like the Radvaz.

According to Rashi's version then the Gemara's opinion was initially that "in the inner chambers there is weeping, but not in the outer chambers." But the older version states the opposite, that "in the *outer* chambers there is weeping, but not in the *inner* chambers." But according to the conclusion, when the Beit HaMikdash was destroyed there was weeping everywhere in both the inner and outer chambers. Here there is no disagreement among the versions. But leaving aside the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, there is a distinction between the versions, from one point of view to its opposite.

What motivated Rashi to opt for the other version is straightforward – because the term 'in secret' [*b'mistarim*] clearly implies only the inner chamber which is concealed from the public. But see Rabbeinu Chananel's explanation of why *mistarim* refers to the outer chambers, whereas in the inner chambers there is no weeping, as per the older version. However, this matter needs some 'spice' added to it to make it more palatable.

The concept of the inner chambers and outer chambers is discussed in the Zohar II, *Shemot* 18a. The inner chambers are the sanctuary of Atzilut, whereas the outer chambers are the sanctuary of the worlds of BiY" A. The Zohar *ibid.* explains that with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash there was weeping in the inner chambers as well, but aside from that destruction, there is no sadness

in the presence of the blessed Holy One – i.e. only in the outer chambers but not in the inner ones, as is explained in Zohar III, *Vayikra* 15b. And this is like the view of Rabbeinu Chananel and the older version.

But there is another concept regarding the inner and outer chambers, and both of these are in Atzilut itself, for the letters י"ד *yud*, *hei* of the Name are the inner chambers, meaning the sanctuaries of Abba and Imma. But the letters ו"ו *vav*, *hei* of the Name are the outer chambers, i.e. the sanctuaries of ze'ir anpin and nukvah (*malchut*), since ze'ir anpin and nukvah are below the *parsa* the dividing line between *Arich Anpin* and the other *partzufim* so that they ze'ir anpin and nukvah are *Arich's netzach, hod, yesod*¹ – he ze'ir anpin corresponding to *netzach* and she *nukvah* corresponding to *hod*. Now all the three *sefirot netzach, hod and yesod* are separate from the body the main *sefirot*, just as the legs are separate from the torso, as the *Sifra d'Tzniuta* beginning of chapter 2 states. See the GRA ad loc.

Abba and Imma are also called *nistarot* 'concealed aspects' as Eliyahu taught²: "the *nistarot* – referring to *chochmah* and *binah* – are for G-d alone." And therefore they are the 'inner chambers,' whereas ze'ir anpin and nukvah are the 'outer chambers.' So stated the Rabbi Rabbi Yitzchak Luria, the Arizal, in *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar Pnimit v'Chitzoniyut, drush 9*: Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' referring to the sanctuaries of Abba and Imma, as mentioned.

Thus we have explained that the 'inner chambers' and the 'outer chambers' represent two concepts: 1) The 'inner chambers' are Atzilut, and the 'outer chambers' are BiY" A; 2) In Atzilut itself Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' and ze'ir anpin and nukvah are the 'outer chambers.'

We can now explain the statement of the Rabbis: 'The blessed Holy One has a place and its name is *Mistarim*' in a similar manner to our explanation above. Here too, there are two aspects: 1) the chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah where *malchut* of Atzilut is vested – this is the mystery of 'the appearance of a Man sitting upon the Throne' (see Ezekiel 1:26). And she *malchut* of Atzilut is called 'Esther' because she is concealed within the 'head' i.e. Abba and Imma / *chochmah* and *binah* of Beriah. This is because the name Esther is an expression of concealment,³ as *Raya Mehemna* in Zohar III *Teitzei* 76a states. All of this is explain in the words of the Arizal, *Sha'ar Kisei haKavod*. See chapters 2, 5, 6 there.

This is the meaning of the statement 'The blessed Holy One has a place and its name is *Mistarim*.' And this is what Rabbeinu Chananel said – that the place called '*Mistarim*' refers to the outer chambers, since it is the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, which is an external aspect compared with Atzilut, as mentioned. It is only there that the *Shechinah* is called Esther because of her state of concealment there, since Atzilut is her primary place, as the rabbis established in the *Aleinu* prayer: "The abode of His majesty is in the loftiest

heights," for there she is in full revelation, and she is the final *hei* of the Name Havaye. But when she descends into BiY"A she becomes concealed, and the Name Havaye becomes clothed within the Name A-d-o-n-ai.

Similarly, Beriah is called by the Name E-lohim, which has the same *gematria* numerical value as א"ה הכס – the Throne (=86), since the World of Beriah is the Realm of the Throne, as is known. But in the World of Atzilut she is part of the Name Havaye itself, the final *hei* thereof, for that is where she is fully revealed, as mentioned.

Now at the beginning of the discussion, the Gemara resolves the apparent contradiction between two statements by explaining that 'This statement refers to the innermost chambers, whereas the other statement, refers to the outer chambers' and that in the inner chamber there is no weeping, and weeping is only in the outer chambers. The questioner (or the Gemara itself, presenting contrasting viewpoints which were not actually expressed) is of the opinion that when the Beit HaMikdash was destroyed there was weeping only in the outer chamber, and the fact that the verse states, "My soul shall weep in secret [*b'mistarim*]" refers to the place called 'Mistarim' which is the chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah, where the Shechinah is clothed and becomes concealed. And that is where the weeping takes place, since it is always the outer chamber when compared with Atzilut. And therefore the question arises "and in the inner chambers is there no weeping? Doesn't the verse state: "And on that day A-d-o-n-ai, Havaye Tzva'ot called it a day for weeping and mourning..."?

Now the verse here uses three holy Names A-d-o-n-ai, Havaye, and Tzva'ot – in that order – and they encompass both aspects of the 'inner chambers' we spoke about above – the Name A-d-o-n-ai is in *malchut* of Atzilut, as the Zohar III, Vayikra 11a-b states, and in several other places.

[But the fact that we stated above that this Name is in Beriah, the intention was that in Beriah even the Name Havaye therein is concealed within the Name A-d-o-n-ai exclusively, so that only the light of the Name A-d-o-n-ai is perceived, and so although it is written as י-ה-ו-ה (Havaye) it is read as י-ד-ב-א (A-d-o-n-ai).

But in Atzilut, where the Name Havaye is primary, the Name A-d-o-n-ai is only secondary, since its presence there is merely as the root of the worlds of BiY"A, and it constitutes the outer aspect thereof. However, the essence of Atzilut is the Name Havaye exclusively i.e. Havaye fully iterated with the letter *hei* as the *milui* – יו"ד ה"ה ו"ה ה"ה which is the Name Ba"n =52, that numerically = 2x Havaye⁴ (2x26=52) since it encompasses all of Atzilut, and it is the final *hei* of the macro Name Havaye, because as explained earlier there are macro and micro revelations of the Name Havaye, each of which is illuminated in its own way by the light of the entire Name Havaye. And this is besides the macro Name Havaye that encompasses the entire Atzilut with the light of a single instance of

the Name **Havaye**. In this respect, *malchut* is merely one letter thereof, i.e. the final *hei* of this Name Havaye.

This is also found in Midrash *Pesikta Rabbati* 21: The Name of the Holy One, blessed is He, is Tzva'ot (usually translated as legions). Rabbi Yehuda bar Simon said: 'The bottom line is that this does not apply only to the entire Name, but even a single letter of His Name creates a legion, just like His entire Name.'

This is just as we said – that every letter of the blessed Name Havaye includes the entire Name, including the final *hei*, which is the Name Havaye in *malchut* of Atzilut – the very essence and primary aspect of Atzilut within her.

But since she *malchut* is also the root of the Worlds of BiY"A, the revelation of the Name A-d-o-n-ai (and all the other Names) is also manifested in her, i.e. in her outer aspects.

Thus, in any event, the fact is that the Name A-d-o-n-ai is in *malchut* of Atzilut, which is the Name A-d-o-n-ai in the verse we are discussing.]

Now the Name Havaye Tzva'ot is in *nh"y netzach, hod, yesod* of Atzilut (as it states in Tikunim, Tikun 18, p. 34a – Havaye Tzva'ot is the covenant of circumcision i.e. *yesod* and the two thighs i.e. supports of truth – *netzach* and *hod*). And they also include *chesed, gevurah, tiferet* of Atzilut, as the Rabbi the Arizal states in the *kavanot* of *Kedushah*. See the Intro to the Tikunim p. 11b, and the GRA there beginning with the word *אינון* and Zohar III p. 11b.

Thus, included in the Name A-d-o-n-ai Havaye Tzva'ot are all the seven lower *sefirot* of Atzilut. These are the inner chambers of the first aspect we mentioned above i.e. where we explained that the 'inner chambers' and the 'outer chambers' can be explained in two ways, the first of which is that the 'inner chambers' are Atzilut, and the 'outer chambers' are BiY"A.

Now the verse cited above (Isaiah 22:12) is written with the Name Havaye with the vowels of *Elokim* הַיְהוָה צְבָאוֹת which is *binah*, as the Zohar III 10b states, i.e. supernal Imma as she includes the *chochmah* of Abba, as the Zohar III *parshat Acharei* 65a states. See the note 7 of Rabbi Chaim Vital on that section. Thus Abba and Imma are both included in the Name Havaye with the vowels of *Elokim* (see Zohar I, 26a: Havaye Elokim – Abba and Imma). And these are the inner chambers of the second explanation mentioned above – where Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' and *ze'ir anpin* and *nukvah* are the 'outer chambers' in *Atzilut itself*.

This then is the question the Gemara poses according to the version favored by Rabbeinu Chanel***: And is there no weeping** in the *inner* chambers? Doesn't the verse state (Isaiah 22:12): "And on that day the Lord, G-d of legions, called it a day for weeping and mourning..."?

The Name Havaye is written here with the vowels of *Elokim*, as explained above, so that both these Names allude to both aspects of the inner chambers 1) where the 'inner chambers' are Atzilut, and the 'outer chambers' are BiY"A**,** 2) where

Abba and Imma are the 'inner chambers,' and ze'ir anpin and nukvah are the 'outer chambers' in *Atzilut itself*. Accordingly, it would seem that **there is weeping in the 'inner chambers' according to both explanations! But the Gemara responds: The destruction of the Beit HaMikdash is different, as even the Angels of Peace wept, as the verse states: "Behold, the valiant ones weep outside; the Angels of Peace..."**

At first glance this is surprising. After the Gemara proves that there was weeping in the inner chambers as well, at the very highest levels i.e. even in Abba and Imma of Atzilut, what is the meaning of "even the Angels of Peace cried"? If there was weeping even in the inner chambers, how much more so in the outer chambers? And what does the fact that they were Angels of Peace add?

However, the idea is this: As is known, the angels do not have free choice, and they are fixed and unchanging in all their attributes, similar to fire and water where fire is dry and water is wet and they cannot change and be transformed from one into the other. The same is true of the angels – one that is appointed over peace is the vessel for all sorts of goodness and blessing, and cannot be transformed into weeping and moaning and groaning. But at the time of the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, may heaven have pity, the orders of Creation above and below were disrupted, as our Sages expound on the verse (Lamentations 2:2), "He profaned the kingdom and its leaders," cited in Rashi ad loc. 'the angels above were exchanged.' And this is the meaning of the statement that "the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash is different," for the entire order of Creation was upended. And therefore it is not surprising that there was weeping in even the inner chambers above to the loftiest levels.

Similarly, the *Midrash Tehillim* 20 states that when the Beit HaMikdash was destroyed weeping and wailing overtook the entire world, as the verse states: "And A-d-o-n-ai, Havaye Tzva'ot called it a day for weeping and mourning..." Then the ministering angels said before Him: "Are these weeping and mourning indeed before You? Is it not written, "Grandeur and majesty are before Him; strength and gladness are in His place"? To which He replied: "Is My house not destroyed and weren't My children led away in chains, that I shouldn't be distraught? Is it not written (Psalms 91:15), 'I am with him in times of distress.'" See there.

So it turns out that there was weeping in both aspects of the inner chambers, to the very loftiest levels. And how much more so was there weeping down below, as *Midrash Tehillim* states, that weeping and wailing overtook the entire world. However, when the verse states, "...My soul shall weep in secret [*b'Mistarim*] for your grandeur," and our Sages explain that 'The blessed Holy One has a place where He weeps, and its name is *Mistarim*' we cannot explain as we did above – that this refers to the Holy of Holies of Beriah – because according to the Gemara's conclusion there was weeping even in the inner chambers of Atzilut, as mentioned.

But there is another aspect of the place called *Mistarim* which is at the loftiest of levels – the inner chambers of this highest aspect, referred to earlier as the letters י"ה (*yud, hei*) of the Name i.e. Abba and Imma. At those levels too there is a place called *Mistarim*, regarding which the verse states, "My soul shall weep in secret [*b'mistarim*] for your grandeur," as the Arizal explains in *Sha'ar Ruach HaKodesh* regarding the rectification of conceit, the negative side of grandeur, and similarly in *Sefer HaYichudim* – that the sin of conceit even has an impact on the letters י"ה *yud, hei* of the Name, since the letters י"ה *yud, hei* have the same *gematria* numerical value as the word for conceit גאו"ה.

However, the outside forces the *chitzonim*⁵ do not impact the letters י"ה themselves, only their *milui* (iteration). Now there are three possible *miluim* of the letters י"ה – with a *yud*, like this: יו"ד ה"י or with an *aleph* א ה"ד י or with a *hei* ה"ד ה"י. The blemish cause by conceit impacts only the latter sequence with a *milui hei*, and only the letters of the *milui* itself: וד"ה which has the same letters as דָּוָה – anguish⁶ – which is also the *gematria* of גאו"ה (conceit).

Now the *milui* letters are called '*mistarim*' because their iteration is hidden and concealed within the primary letters. So this then is the meaning of "...My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for your grandeur (גוה)."

[Note that the word גוה here is missing an *aleph* – it should read גאוה = grandeur – because of the blemish done to it to His grandeur. For גאוה grandeur is appropriate only for the blessed Holy One, as the verse (Psalms 93:1) states: ה' מֶלֶךְ גָּאוֹת לְבָשׁ – "G-d has donned grandeur." Now the word גָּאוֹת is written in the plural – once for the primary letters, and once for the *milui*, as mentioned, both of which are appropriate only for the blessed Holy One alone.

Thus, when there is a blemish in the *milui*, the verse states, "...My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for your grandeur (גוה)" – meaning to say, due to the blemish made in it. And this is why the word is written with only a *vav* without the *aleph*, because the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven has been withdrawn, may He have compassion for us, and when His grandeur descends below, it does not descend the way it is Above, Heaven forfend, Heaven forfend, and therefore גוה is written in the defective form, without the *aleph*.]

Now the three *miluim* of the letter *hei*, which are ה"י and ה"א and ה"ה together have the *gematria* of 31 = the Name א-ל that appears in the verse (Exodus 34:6-7) of the Thirteen Attributes of Divine Mercy וחנון א-ל רחום וחנון.

The Name א-ל is also the first of the 13 *Tikunei Dikna*,⁷ situated below the *pe'ot* sidelocks of the head, at the top of the beard, next to the ears. (There lies the secret of "From the straits I called out to י"ה" (Psalms 118:5) – the name י"ה we mentioned earlier. At the top of the beard the *pe'ot* are narrower, and below, near the mouth, they broaden). Thus they are actually two Names, one to the right and one to the left corresponding to the two *pe'ot*, and each of them

comprises three aspects of the Name א-ל-ל – א-ל שד"י and א-ל-ל הוי"ה and א-ל-ל, making six times that the Name א-ל is manifested here and all of them emerge from the Name י-ה with its *milui*.

Now six times the Name א-ל is the numerical value *gematria* of מקו"ם place = 186, which is the mystical secret of the statement of the Sages cited earlier: 'The blessed Holy One has a place, and its name is *Mistarim*,' the actuality of which is six times the Name א-ל, which is the *gematria* of מקו"ם, fashioned out of the letter ה in its three iterations, as mentioned above, of the *milui* of the final *hei* exclusively. But the blemish is only in the *milui*, which is the *mistarim*,** as we explained, and only in the *milui* of the final *hei*, which is the final *milui*, comprising the letters *dalet*, *vav*, *hei* דוה which has the same *germatia* as *grandeur* (גאורה).

This then is the meaning of the verse, "...My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for your grandeur (גורה)" – because of the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven that was withdrawn at the time of the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash**, may the Merciful One have compassion for us.** The destruction of the First Beit HaMikdash impacted the first *hei* of the blessed Name Havaye, as *Zohar II*, 9b states, and look into *ibid*. 4a. See also *Zohar I*, 26a. Now the first *hei* of the blessed Name Havaye is always united with the *yud* (since they are two beloved friends who do not part⁸) and that is the place of the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, as the verse (Psalms 93:1) states: ה' מֶלֶךְ גָּאוֹת לְבָשׁ – "G-d has donned grandeur," as mentioned above.

Given all of this analysis above it is clear that the place of *mistarim* is in the inner chambers of Atzilut as well.

Accordingly we must conclude that there are two aspects: One aspect of *mistarim* is located in the outer chambers, and this is in the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, as explained above; and the other aspect of *mistarim* is in the inner chambers of Atzilut, in the *milui* of the letters י"ה. The destruction of the Beit HaMikdash caused weeping in both aspects, and this is why the verse states *mistarim* in the plural – as the *-im* suffix at the end of the word indicates.

Now regarding these two aspects of weeping, which took place in the two localities of *mistarim*, the Sages in Tractate *Chagiga* 5b asked: "What is the meaning of "for your grandeur"? Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak said: G-d weeps for the grandeur of the Jewish people which was taken from them and given.... to the gentile nations**. Rav Shmuel bar Nachmani said:** He weeps for the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, which was withdrawn from the world.

According to the above analysis, these are not contradictory views. Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak is referring to the weeping in the outer chambers, for that is where the grandeur of Israel is located. This is because the secret of the Shechinah, as manifested in in the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, descended into the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the Beit HaMikdash down

below when the Beit HaMikdash stood, for the Chamber of the Holy of Holies below corresponds to the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah, as the Arizal writes in *Drushei Ma'n uMa'd*, end of *drush* 1. And it the Holy of Holies of Beriah is the Beit HaMikdash on high, regarding which our Sages state in Tractate *Chagiga* 12b: "The Archangel Michael stands and makes sacrificial offerings there of the souls righteous Tsaddikim before the Holy One, blessed is He." The *Midrash haNe'elam* in *Zohar Chadash*, *Noach* (beginning with the words הפתח השלישי) **explains this. (The *Zohar Chadash* states there that this is not in the same manner as all other sacrificial offerings, but rather like a person presenting a gift to a king. So too, the Archangel Michael proffers the souls of righteous Tsaddikim before the Divine Presence the Shechinah in the Supernal Beit HaMikdash, which is the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of the World of Beriah).**

When the Beit HaMikdash stood, then the Supernal Beit HaMikdash descended into the Beit HaMikdash below, similar to the statement in Tractate *Sukkah* 5a: "The Throne extended itself downward..." In the same manner Atzilut extended down until the Ark and the Cherubim on top of the Ark, and the worlds of BiY" A received their life-force and sustenance only via the Beit HaMikdash below. The intention in all of this was to contract His Presence and dwell within the Jewish People themselves, as the verse (Exodus 25:8) states, "Make for Me a Beit HaMikdash, so that I may dwell within them..." The verse does not say "within it," but "within them" – within each Israelite.

This was indeed Moses' request when he asked (Exodus 34:9) "If I have now found favor in your eyes... let the Lord go now in our midst" – within the Israelites, literally. This is such a great and sublime quality that there is nothing loftier than it, as the GRA writes in *Aderet Eliyahu*, *Ki Tisa*, and this is the grandeur of Israel. But with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, may the Merciful One spare us, the Shechinah with withdrawn above as it states in Tractate *Rosh HaShana* 31a: "She the Shechinah ascended and returned to her place, as the verse (Hosea 5:15) states, "I will leave and return to My place." Nowadays the *shefa* the flow of spiritual sustenance is drawn down through exceedingly crooked paths (see *Zohar II Terumah*, p. 152b).

This then is what Rav Shmuel bar Yitzchak was saying – the weeping is "for the grandeur of the Jewish people which was taken from them and given.... to the gentiles," and he is referring to the weeping in the *mistarim* of the outer chambers, for that is where weeping for the grandeur of Israel that has been rescinded takes place.

But Rav Shmuel bar Nachmani said: "He weeps for the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, which was withdrawn from the world." He is referring to the weeping in the *mistarim* of the inner chambers in Atzilut, regarding which it states, "G-d has donned grandeur." This aspect of *mistarim* is in the *milui* of the letters י ה (yud, hei) of the Name, as explained above. When the Beit

HaMikdash stood, and the revelation of the *Shechinah* was down below, then the verse "G-d has donned grandeur" was fulfilled, since the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven was revealed throughout the earth. But with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, may the Merciful One spare us, it states "... My soul shall weep *b'mistarim* for Your grandeur." Examine the words of the Arizal in *Eitz Chaim Sha'ar Mi'ut haYare'ach* chaps 2-3.

As we explained above, the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven is in the letters ה"י of the Name, whereas the grandeur of Israel in the letter ה"ו of the Name, and they depend upon one another, as Tractate *Megillah* 29a and Midrash Tehillim 9:14 and a number of other works state.⁹

This is also the concept of when 'the Name is complete and the Throne is complete' discussed in *Pesikta* on the verse (Deut. 25:17) "Remember what Amalek did to you" cited in Rashi at the end of *Beshalach*. Because when 'the Name is complete' this is the grandeur of the Kingdom of Heaven, and when 'the Throne is complete' is the grandeur of Israel, as the verse (I Chronicles 29:23) states, "and Solomon sat on the Throne of G-d". See Zohar I p. 243a; Tikunei Zohar Chadash 37b and similarly in Tikunim, Tikun 22, p. 76a. This is enough for now.

Now all of this is according to the older prior version of the Talmud, elucidated by Rabbeinu Chananel, which is the primary version as the Radvaz maintains and Rabbi Todros HaLevi writes in *Otzar HaKavod*, as explained above.

However, we found that one of the holy Sages of Truth – a designation for master Kabbalists – a Master of the Secret Teachings, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero in *Pardes, Sha'ar Mehut v'Hanhaga* chap. 12 accepts Rashi's version, that in the inner chambers there is weeping, but not in the outer chambers. This is due to the principle that any outflow is only from above, and whatever is below is what they receive from above. Accordingly, when they said according to this version that there is none in the outer chambers, this is because they have nothing of their own, whereas it is in the inner chambers, since that is the source. He also cites a few statements from the Zohar to prove his point.

Nevertheless, in my own impoverished view the main thrust of his words is very surprising. For it is very well known that all strict judgments above are all sweetened and fragrant and are the flames of compassion, and this is the entire subject of the statement of our Sages that there is no sadness before the blessed Holy One, but only as the verse (I Chronicles 16:27) states "might and joy are in His place". Might and joy are also only from the revelation of *gevurot* (attributes that generally tend to judgment and restriction) but in this case these are sweetened *dinim* judgments and are referred to in the verse (Judges 9:13) as 'the wine that gladdens.' It is inappropriate to even call these types of *gevurot* 'judgments' for that term implies judging each according to his deeds to chastise and punish, Heaven forbid. Indeed, the opposite is true – sweetened *dinim* benefit the

world, and in this way He is good and does good for the wicked and for the righteous.

This is also the concept of the Thirteen Attributes (*Middot*) of Divine Mercy, which are also *gevurot*, which is why they are called *middot*, for they disburse compassion in a measured manner, not broadly. Nevertheless, they subdue all the harsh judgments because they are sweetened *gevurot*, as the Rabbi the Arizal writes regarding all this in *Pri Eitz Chaim Sha'ar haShofar* chaps. 1 & 2. See there.

All of the 13 Attributes of Divine Mercy are found and revealed in *binah*, which is nourished by the last *mazal* – *mazal* in the sense of 'constant outflow*** from *nozel*, flowing, not in the sense of 'constellations' – this is the *mazal* of ונקה "and He cleanses" (Exodus 34:7). This is the 13th Tikun of the 13 *Tikunei Dikna* (see footnote 6) which includes all the others. Thus *binah* is in the category of the inner chambers, as explained above, and therefore it is certainly so and obvious that there "might and joy are in His place" and judgments are not actually revealed other than below, in the outer chambers, for that is where sin and blemish reach and compassion is concealed, so that the *gevurot* become actual *dinim* – harsh judgments – thereby.

Thus there is no claim at all from the fact that whatever is below is only from above, for although this is certainly the case, nevertheless the *dinim* only become revealed in a place where sin and blemish are of great consequence since compassion is concealed. This is only in the outer chambers, whereas the inner chambers are always aromatic.

So it turns out that even though that whatever is below is only from above, the revelation of *dinim* as actual *dinim* i.e. harsh judgments – is always in the world below exclusively. Furthermore, when suffering grows down below, then either through prayer or through crying out in pain, compassion is aroused above, subduing the *dinim* below due to the revelations from above. This means to say that the *gevurot* above are revealed down below, but because those *gevurot* are always fragrant, the *gevurot* below also become fragrant.

In any event, above, in the inner chambers, they the *dinim* are always fragrant, so that there "might and joy are in His place," except at the of the destruction, may the Merciful One spare us, for then the order of Creation was upended completely and weeping and the revelation of *dinim* in the negative sense and weeping impacted on high as well, i.e. to the place of *mistarim* above, as was all explained earlier. Accordingly, the words of the Ramak are very surprising in my view.

In addition the proofs he the Ramak cites from several statements of the Zohar are also surprising in my view. For what the Zohar, *Noach* 61b states regarding the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash: 'And thus there is certainly sadness in His presence in the outer chambers, and this is the meaning of the verse,

"Behold, the valiant ones weep outside..." and "the Lord, G-d of legions, called it a day for weeping and mourning..." – the language of these verses expresses the opposite: that even at the time of destruction weeping took place only in the outer chambers! This is the meaning of: 'And thus there is certainly sadness in His presence in the outer chambers' – where the expression 'certainly' implies that it is as if it said that the possibility for sadness is only there in the outer chambers, and not in the inner chambers at all. Whereas the Ramak explains that the Zohar's intention is that during the destruction sadness was manifested as a new phenomenon even in the outer chambers, like the Talmud states according to Rashi's version.

But the language of the Zohar does not indicate this at all, but rather that even at the time of the destruction there was weeping *only* in the outer chambers, meaning to say, the outer chambers of Atzilut, which is in *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut*, and there sadness is also manifested, as the *Idra Rabba* 144a explains on the verse (Genesis 6:6) "He was saddened to His heart," which is the inner chambers of the first aspect we mentioned above. This is because compared with the Worlds of BiY"A, *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* of Atzilut are called 'inner chambers,' as the Zohar *Shemot*, 18a states. But compared with Abba and Imma, *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* are the only the outer chambers, as explained above.

The Zohar in *parshat Noach* on our subject cited by the Ramak is that even at the time of destruction there was weeping only in *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut*, but not in Abba and Imma. This does not comport with the view of the Talmud in *Chagiga* 5b as explained above, since at the time of the destruction there was weeping even in Abba and Imma, in the place of *mistarim*, as we explained above.

However, the primary view seems to be as later authorities write, that this entire section of the Zohar, which is in parentheses from the words **האי אמריתו וגומר** is not part of the Zohar at all, but an addition from some student, and so it seems from the language as well; it is not the language of the Zohar at all. Accordingly the primary view is that of the Talmud – that at the time of the destruction there was weeping even in the inner chambers above, in both aspects of *mistarim*, which is why *mistarim* is stated in the plural, as we explained. So there was weeping in the place of *mistarim* above as well. And this is understood explicitly from the Zohar *Shemot* 18a, that at that time there was weeping in the inner chambers above, but only in the *mistarim* there, as it states explicitly there 17b – *b'mistarim*. See there.

From all of this it seems that the entire addition in the note in Zohar *Noach* 61b, which states that 'Thus there is certainly sadness in His presence in the outer chambers,' is of the view that even at the time of the destruction there was weeping in *ze'ir anpin* and *malchut* exclusively. But this is not the primary view. Accordingly, whether one explains it this way or that way it cannot be a proof

for the Ramak's view. To the contrary, it stands in contradiction to his words. Understand all of this well and you will see that this is indeed so, since 'truth is its own witness.'¹⁰

The Ramak brings another proof for his view that the primary potency of *dinim* and where weeping is appropriate is only in *binah*, which is of the inner chambers. He cites the Zohar *Noach*, 70b, which states that when supernal fire, which is *binah*, acts to increase the *dinim* down below in *malchut*, then supernal ire becomes even more potent and destroys everything, since it does not cease. Meaning to say that the ire does not abate until the judgment is carried out in full, and this is what transpired during the flood, which is why the entire world was destroyed, and only Noah and his family remained. And even he had to hide away in the Ark, invisible to the eye, as it states there p. 64b. A similar exposition is proffered in Zohar *Pikudei* 227b. But when strict judgment *din* is drawn down from *malchut* alone, without its strength being increased by *binah*, then the *din* is made to be halted, and it does not cause total destruction, Heaven forbid. See there.

The Ramak brings a proof from the above that the primary potency of *dinim* is in *binah*, which is from the inner chambers, and therefore the primary quality of sadness and weeping is relevant there exclusively.

Now although a superficial view of the matters mentioned there would seem to imply that this is indeed so, anyone who is somewhat familiar with the words of the holy Zohar in other places, and particularly the Ramak, for whom the gates of the Zohar were wide open, it is surprising that a holy mouth like his could utter such words! For it is known that *binah* itself is the supernal reservoir from which all blessings emerge (as in Zohar *Noach*, 64b; *Terumah* 162a; *Acharei*, 65a; *Va'etchanan* 264b. And examine *Pri Eitz Chaim*, *Sha'ar haBerachot* chap. 1). For she *binah* is all compassion, albeit that from her side i.e. the left column, which she heads, *dinim* can be aroused as is written in Zohar *Vayikra* 10b and *Acharei* 65a.

But *malchut* is *din* as in Zohar *Noach*, 64b and *Vayikra* 11b, regarding which the Sages stated¹¹ "*dina d'malchuta dina*" which means literally that the law of the state is the law. However *din* also means harsh judgment, as we have been explaining all along, and *malchuta* can mean the state but also alludes to *malchut*. Now all of this is straightforward and is known from the words of all the Kabbalists, and it is true that *binah* is the root specifically of the *gevurot* and she is the 'dark lamp' and the supernal fire mentioned in *parshat Noach* above.

Nevertheless, she *binah* is called only 'pure fire' as explained in the *Idra Rabba* p. 135b because all of the *gevurot* within her are all sweetened and fragrant, as mentioned above. As for what the Zohar states in *parshat Noach*, that sometimes potent *dinim* are also drawn down from her, the Zohar explains in *parshat Acharei* p. 65a that this is only when wicked people change compassion into

harsh judgment. Then certainly *din* is empowered greatly, since the sins of those wicked people caused compassion to be transformed into harsh judgments, and those harsh judgments have an impact all the way up to *binah*.

Now it is well known that the loftier the *sefirah* the more superior its qualities are compared with the lower *sefirot*, and incomparably so, as the Rav the Arizal writes in *Eitz Chaim Mochin d'Tzelem* chap 2 and in *Derushei Abiy'a* chap. 14. Therefore, when a sin has the effect of revealing *dinim* even in *binah*, due to the wicked transforming compassion into harsh judgment, then certainly *dinim* become very powerful. And this is what the Zohar said in *parshat Noach* 70b – that as long as the supernal fire continues to strengthen, then smoke, which is *din* down below, strengthens the ire and destroys everything. This is because the ire does not abate until judgment is carried out in full. But when *din* down below does not continue to grow more powerful together with the *din* above, then a judgment is made and the *din* abates and does not destroy completely. And for this reason the verse (Genesis 8:21) states, "I will not continue to curse the land because of man." In other words, I will not continue to give additional strength to *din* down below. The quote from the Zohar ends here.

All of this is because the *gevurot* of *binah* are without question much greater than the *gevurot* of *malchut*, comparable to the superiority of *binah* over *malchut*, which is immeasurable. But the *gevurot* of *binah* are all fragrant and sweetened, and therefore the entire reward of the World-to-Come and all the concealed goodness is in *binah*, for she is the World-to-Come, as is known.

But when sin and depravity have the effect of revealing *dinim* even in *binah*, because compassion was transformed into harsh judgment and in place of the flames of compassion complete *din* is produced, may the Merciful One spare us, then certainly the *dinim* become very, very powerful, to the point of destruction, Heaven forbid, just as at the time of the Flood.

Now in truth, the blessed Holy One already made a promise that "I will not continue to curse the earth because of man," and He made a covenant in this regard, the Covenant of the Rainbow. Thus *binah* always remains in her praiseworthy loftiness, which are the flames of compassion, and in her are hidden and concealed all the good of the future and the rewards of the World-to-Come. And this is in the inner chambers above, as we said, regarding which it states, "Might and joy are in His place." Only in the place of *mistarim* therein is there sadness and weeping for the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash, as explained above.

Thus it has been explained that the citations from the Zohar are not a proof at all that there is weeping in the inner chambers (other than with the destruction of the Beit HaMikdash), and the words of the Ramak remain very surprising in my view. For the Zohar *Vayikra* 15b states explicitly that sadness is *only* in the outer chambers, and not in the inner chambers, Heaven forbid – meaning the outer chambers of Atzilut, as explained above. It is only up to there that sadness

reaches and no further, Heaven forbend. And this is also what the *Idra Rabba* 144a states on the verse (Genesis 6:6) "He was saddened to His heart," see there.

Now this is just like the original and older version of the Talmud explicated by Rabbeinu Chananel, which is the primary version, as the Radvaz and Rabbi Todros in *Otzer HaKavod* state, as noted earlier. As regards the effort the Ramak made to establish Rashi's version, one who examines his words will see that he did not know that the primary version states the opposite, and he surmised that only Rabbi Todros HaLevi and the *Sha'arei Tzedek* found a different version of the Gemara. See *Pardes*, *Sha'ar* 8:12. And therefore he toiled to establish Rashi's version, which was the original version in his view. But since we have merited the words of Rabbeinu Chananel, and the testimony of the Radvaz that this is the version in the older works, it has become clear that the original version of the Gemara is also found in the words of the Zohar and the Kabbalists. This being so, we need no longer be in doubt about this, and the truth will show the way and will be called the holy way.

Here ends the *Avnei Miluim*

Footnotes

1. *Ze'ir anpin* and *nukvah* 'clothe' Arich from his navel to his feet i.e. forming Arich's *netzach*, *hod* and *yesod*. (Makover) (Note that these anthropomorphisms are not to be taken literally; they are used only to illustrate concepts that can best be understood through our own human experiences). [↩](#)
2. In *Patach Eliyahu*, Intro. to *Tikunei Zohar*. [↩](#)
3. From the word '*hester*' concealment. [↩](#)
4. See *Eitz Chaim*, *Sha'ar Rapa"ch* chap. 3. [↩](#)
5. The waste and refuse of holiness that constitutes evil. [↩](#)
6. As in the verse (Lamentations 5:17) עַל זֶה הָיָה דָּוָה לִבְנוֹ עַל אֱלֹהֵי חָשָׁכוּ [↩](#)
7. The *Dikna* is the metaphoric beard of *Arich Anpin* and possesses thirteen conduits (*tikunei dikna*), which correspond to the Thirteen Attributes of Divine Mercy. [↩](#)
8. These correspond to the *partzufim* of Abba and Imma. [↩](#)
9. Midrash Tehillim states this succinctly: [↩](#)
10. This is a rabbinical expression meaning that the truth stands at its own witness and does not need further proof. [↩](#)
11. See Tractates *Nedarim* 28a; *Gittin* 10b; *Bava Kama* 113a etc. [↩](#)

Chapter 7 — A continuation of an explanation of how the negative (ra) is flipped to positive (tov)

All that God does is for the good. So what about punishment and Hell?

וְהִנֵּה כַּאֲשֶׁר תִּתְּבוֹנוּ בְּכָל הַדְּבָרִים הַלֵּלוּ הֵנָּה תִּרְאֶה

Now when you contemplate all of these matters you will perceive

עֲמֵק מֵאַמְרָם ז"ל בְּרִכּוֹת ס' ע"ב כָּל דְּעָבַד רַחֲמָנָא לְטָב עָבַד

the depth of the Sages' statement (*Berachot* 60b) that "everything the Merciful One did, He did for the good!"

כִּי הָרִי גַם בְּרִיאַת כָּל הָרָע כֻּלּוֹ, וְאֲשֶׁר נִכְשְׁלוּ בוֹ בְּנֵי אָדָם

For even the creation of all evil, in which people have floundered,

וְכָל הַתְּלָאוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה מִזֶּה

and all of the suffering and punishments that were produced thereby,

הֵנָּה עָלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר קֹהֶלֶת ג': רָאִיתִי אֶת הָעֲנָנוּ אֲשֶׁר נָתַן אֱלֹהִים

לְבְנֵי הָאָדָם לְעֲנוֹת בוֹ אֶת הַכֹּל עֹשֶׂה יָפָה בְּעֵתוֹ

regarding them it states (*Kohelet* 3:10-11): "I have observed the matter that God has given man to answer to – He made everything in its proper time."

כִּי הָרִי רַק בִּזְהָה יוֹצֵא כָּל כְּחוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל

Because it is only in this manner that all the powers of *gevurah* (harshness and constriction) emerge from potential to actual.

וְכַנֻּדַּע שֶׁהִגְלוּי הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁל כָּל דְּבָר הֵנָּה הוּא רַק כַּאֲשֶׁר מִתְרַחֵק

מִהַמְּנַגְדּוֹ בְּתַכְלִית הָאַפְשָׁרִי

And as is known, the ultimate revelation of anything is only when it distances itself from its opposite to the maximum degree possible,

וּמִתְהַפֵּךְ מִקְצֵה לְקֵצֵה וְהֵם הָעֲנָנוּ אֲשֶׁר נָתַן אֱלֹהִים לְבְנֵי הָאָדָם

לְעֲנוֹת בוֹ

and it is transformed from one extreme to the other. This is the meaning of 'the matter that God has given man to answer to'

וְעַל זֶה אָמַר אֶת הַכֹּל עֹשֶׂה יָפָה בְּעֵתוֹ כִּי הֵם כֻּלָּם לְתַכְלִית טוֹב

וְיָפָה

And it is in this regard that the verse states, 'He made everything in its proper time' for all of these matters are for the sake of the good and the proper,

אֶלָּא שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הַכֹּל בְּעֵתוֹ כִּי כָּל כְּחוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת

although everything is made in its time since all the powers of *gevurah* and constriction

הַמִּיֻסָּדִים לְמַצִּיאת הָעוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה וְלִכְל הַנְּהָגָתָם
that established the existence of the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, and how they are conducted,

הֵנָּה הֵם בְּהִז' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דְּהֶאֱצִילוֹת שֶׁהֵם הִז' כְּפוֹלוֹת בַּג"ד כַּפֵּר"ת
שֶׁהֵם בְּרַפָּה וְדָגֵשׁ

are located in the seven lower *sefirot* of Atzilut, which are the seven double letters **בג"ד כפר"ת** meaning those letters which take two forms – soft and hard i.e. they are sometimes written with a *dagesh*, and sometimes without a *dagesh*.¹

וְיָמֵיהֶם הוּא כָּל הַתְּמוּרוֹת כַּמ"ש בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה פ"ד

All of the *temurot* – a quality and its opposite, such as life and death, peace and war (or evil), wealth and poverty – come from there, as its states in *Sefer Yetzirah* chapter 4, *mishnah* 1.

וְעַקְרָם דִּהִז"ת הוּא ו' שֶׁהֵם חַג"ת נה"י וְהֵם עֲצָמָם חֲסָדִים

Now the main *sefirot* of the seven lower *sefirot* are six – *chesed, gevurah, tiferet, netzach, hod, yesod* – and they themselves are aspects of *chesed* – these are the six *sefirot* of *ze'ir anpin*, which is characterized primarily by *chesed* – kindness and compassion – whereas the seventh *sefirah*, *malchut*, is characterized by *din*, as the *Baal HaLeshem* goes on to explain...

וּבְהַמְלָכוֹת דַּכ"א שֶׁם הוּא הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁבָּהֶם

And the *malchut* of each of them of the *sefirot* mentioned is the aspect of *gevurot* constrictions or severities in them,

וּכְלָלוֹת הַמְּלָכוֹת כָּלָם הִיא הִז' וְהִיא רֵאשִׁית דְּנִבְרָאִים

and the *malchut* of all of them in general is the seventh *sefirah*, which is the beginning of created beings.

כִּי בָּהּ הוּא הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ לְכָל הַמַּצִּיאוֹת דְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת בְּעֲשָׂרָה מְאֻמְרוֹת

For in her in *malchut* is the root of all existence of the Worlds that were created by the Ten Utterances,² as the *Tikunei Zohar*^{**3**} states: "*malchut* is the mouth" from whence the Ten Utterances issue forth.

וְעַל יָדָהּ הֵם מְתַנְהֲגִים. וְהֵם הַשֶּׁשֶׁת אֲלָפִים שָׁנָה דְּמִשְׁךְ יְמֵי עוֹלָם

And by her *malchut* they are conducted or managed. And these are also the six thousand years that the world endures,⁴

כִּי אֵלּוּ הוּא הֵם הַשֶּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית כַּמ"ש בְּזוֹה"ק בְּרֵאשִׁית ל"א
סע"א

because these six edges the six *sefirot* that define *ze'ir anpin* are the six days of Creation, as the *Zohar Bereishit* 30a explains.

וַנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם דְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהו"ק כַּמ"ש שָׁם כ"ב א' וְכ"ט, ב.

Thus the world was created via the *malchut* of each of these six the six *sefirot* of *ze'ir anpin*, as the *Zohar ibid* writes p. 25a; 29b.

וְכֵן מִתְנַהֵג כָּל אֶלֶף בְּהַמְלָכוֹת דכ"א

And similarly the world is conducted or managed – each millennium by the *malchut* of that millennium.

כִּי אֶלֶף הָרִאשׁוֹן הָיָה בְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהַחֲסֵד וְאֶלֶף הַשֵּׁנִי בְּהַמְלָכוֹת
דְּהַגְבוּרָה

The first millennium was that of *malchut* of *chesed*; the second millennium the *malchut* of *gevurah*;

הַג' בְּהַמְלָכוֹת דְּהַת"ת וְכֵן כו' עַד עֵתָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּהַמְלָכוֹת בְּהִסּוֹד
the third millennium the *malchut* of *tiferet*, and so on, until this moment, which
is the *malchut* of *yesod*.

וְע"י הַנְּהֻגָת כָּל אֶלֶף בְּכָל הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת כֻּלָּם דִּנְעָשָׂה בּוֹ

And through the way each millennium is conducted in all of the events that take place in that millennium

הֵנָּה יּוֹצְאִים עִי"ז כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת דְּאוֹתָהּ הַמְלָכוֹת מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעַל
all the *gevurot* of that *malchut* emerge from potential to actual.

וְהַמְלָכוֹת הֵנָּה הִיא נִקְרָאת עֵת [כַּמ"ש בְּזוּה"ק וַיֵּרָא קַע"ז ע"ב מִקֶּץ
קצ"ח א' ופ' תְּרוּמָה קנ"ה ב']

Now *malchut* is called '*et*' – a period of time – [as the *Zohar* states in *Vayera* 177b; *Miketz* 198a; *Terumah* 155b]

כִּי בָּהּ וְעַל יָדָהּ יּוֹצֵא וְנִעְשָׂה כָּל דְּבָר בְּעֵתוֹ וּבְזִמְנוֹ (ע' זוֹהַר וַיֵּצֵא
קנ"ג א')

because in it and through it *malchut* every event takes place *b'ito* – in its proper time and period.

זֶהוּ שֶׁאֲמַר הַכָּתוּב כִּי אֶת הָעֲנִין אֲשֶׁר נָתַן אֱלֹהִים לְבִנֵּי הָאָדָם
לְעֲנוֹת בּוֹ

This is the meaning then of the verse, "I have observed the matter that God has given man to answer to..."

שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר הֵם נֶגְדַּ דַּעַת הָאָדָם

these are all the events that oppose man's opinion of how things should be.

שְׂרָצוֹנוֹ וְנַפְשׁוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם מְשִׁתּוֹמָמֶת עֲלֵיהֶם עַל מָה עָשָׂה אֱלֹהִים
כָּכָה

His will, and indeed his soul, are astonished by those events – and he asks **why** did God do this?

הִנֵּה אֶת הַכֹּל עָשָׂה יְפָה בְּעֵתוֹ כִּי כָלָם הֵם לְהוֹצִיא אֶת גְּבוּרוֹת
הַמַּלְכוּת

But, the verse declares, "He made everything in its proper time" for all these events are intended to bring out the *gevurot* of *malchut*

מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעַל וְשִׁיּוּצָאֵם כָּלָם בְּסִבַּת וְגֵרָם הָאָדָם דְּיוֹקָא

from potential to actual, and that their emergence is due to, and by the agency of, man explicitly.

וְהוּא מְשׁוּם כִּי סוּפֹן שֶׁל הַגְּבוּרוֹת הוּא לְהַעֲשׂוֹת בָּהֶם כָּל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן

And the reason for this is because the ultimate goal of the *gevurot* is to bring out all the hidden good in them.

וְלָכוּ הֵגֶם שֶׁכָּאֲשֶׁר הֵם יוֹצְאִים וּמִתְגַּלִּים ע"י חֲטָא וְעוֹן הִנֵּה נַעֲשָׂה
בָּהֶם הַטְּמָאָה וְהָרַע

And therefore, even though they the *gevurot* emerge and are revealed by means of transgression and sin, producing impurity and evil,

אֲךָ כָּל טְמָאָה וְרַע הִנֵּה נִתְהַפֵּךְ תִּכְף לַעֲנֵשׁ

all the impurity and evil immediately become transformed into punishment.

וּכְשֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הָעֲנֵשׁ מִהַבֶּעַל הָרַע שָׁבוּ וְנִשְׁאַרוּ הַגְּבוּרוֹת טְהוֹרִים
וְנִקְיִים

Now when the punishment of the perpetrator of evil is accomplished, the *gevurot* remain pure and unsullied

וְהֵם נִכְלָלִים תִּכְף בְּשִׁרְשָׁם שֶׁבִּקְדֹּשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים

and they immediately merge into their source in the Holy of Holies,

וּמִתְבַּסְּמִים וְנִמְתָּקִים וְנַעֲשִׂים הֵם לַעֲדוֹן גֵּן אֱלֹהִים

where they are made fragrant and are sweetened, and become the delightful Garden of the Lord

לְצִמְחַן בָּהֶם כָּל נֹטֵעַ שֶׁעֲשׂוּעִים וְכָל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן לַעֲתִיד לְבוֹא

in which every planting of delight flourishes, and all the goodness is hidden away for the Time to Come.

וְנִמְצָא כִּי בְּאֲשֶׁר יִכָּלֶה הַזֶּהֱמָא וְהָרַע שֶׁהוּא אַחֵר שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הָעֶנֶשׂ

So it turns out that when the pollution and the evil are dispelled, which is after the punishment has been administered,

וְנִצְרָף וְנִתְלַבֵּן הָעוֹשֶׂה עֲבֵרָה מִכָּל חֲלָאָתוֹ וְצַחֲנָתוֹ

and the sinner has been refined and purified of all his infection and stench,

הֵנָּה יִתְהַפְּכוּ כָּל אוֹתָן הַכַּחוֹת דְּתַקַּף הַדִּינִין אֲשֶׁר נַעֲשָׂה הָעֶנֶשׂ
בָּהֶם

then all of those powers of intense *din* will be transformed, after the punishment has been administered,

הֵנָּה יִתְהַפְּכוּ הֵם עֲצָמוֹ לְגִבּוּרוֹת מִמִּתְקִים וְיִהְיוּ כֻּלָּם קָדָשׁ לַה'

and they themselves will be transformed into sweetened *gevurot* and will all be sanctified to God.

וְהֵם עֲצָמוֹ יִהְיוּ הַסִּפָּה לְסִבָּב עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֶת כָּל יְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים
לְבוֹא

Thus they themselves are the indirect cause of promises for the future becoming actualized –

לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

in the Messianic era and in the life of the World to Come.

זֶהוּ ג' כ סוּד הַכְּתוּב וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְהֵנָּה טוֹב מְאֹד

This is also the mystical explanation of the verse (Genesis 1:31) "And God perused all that He had made and indeed it was very good."

וְאָמְרוּ רז"ל בב"ר פ"ה מָאד זֶה מִדַּת יְסוּרִין, מָאד זֶה גִּיהֶנָּם מָאד זֶה
מִלֵּאךְ הַמּוֹת כו' ע"ש

Regarding this verse our Sages declared in Bereishit Rabba 5 – the word *me'od* (= very) is the aspect of suffering, *me'od* is Gehinnom, *me'od* is the angel of death!

וְהוּא כִּי כָּל אֱלוֹ הָעֲנִינִים כֻּלָּם הֵרִי הֵם מִתַּקַּף הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים

This is because all of these concepts just mentioned are from the intensity of harsh *dinim*,

אֲבָל בְּאֲשֶׁר יִתְבַּטֵּל הָרַע וְיִמְתְּקוּ כָּל הַדִּינִים כֻּלָּם

but when evil is nullified and all the *dinim* are sweetened,

הֵרִי יִתְהַפְּכוּ כָּל הַסִּבּוֹת דֶּהֶעֱנָשִׁים שֶׁהֵם הַגִּבּוּרוֹת וְהַדִּינִין הַיּוֹתֵר
גְּדוֹלִים

then all the origins of punishments, which are the greatest *gevurot* and *dinim*, will be transformed

להיות הם עצמן הסבה לכל טוב העתיד

and will themselves be the origin of all good in the future,

וכל מה שהוא עתה סבה לענש יותר גדול יהיה הוא אז סבה לטובה יותר גדולה

so that anything that is currently a cause of the harshest punishment will then become the cause of the greatest good.

והוא ענין טהרתו של גיהנם כי יתהפך הוא עצמו לגן עדן

This is the concept of the purification of Gehinnom, which will itself be transformed into the Garden of Eden,

ע"י שימתקו וייתבסמו כל הדינין שבו ויתהפכו כלם לדינין דקדשא

by virtue of all the *dinim* therein becoming sweetened and fragrant, so that they are all transformed into holy *dinim*

ולשלהובין דרחימו מישראל לאביהם שבשמים ית"ש.

and flames of love from the Jewish People towards their Father in Heaven, may His Name be blessed.

ואין להרהר כי איזה תכלית יהיה מפל ענשי גיהנם אשר לרשעי עובדי אילים

One should not mull over the purpose of all the punishments in Gehinnom for wicked idolaters – the answer the author gives, after quoting and explaining several verses and insights of the Sages, is that their purpose is for the sake of Israel.

אשר עליהם נאמר (איוב יב, כג) משגיא לגוים ויאבדם

Regarding them the idolaters it states (Job 12:23), "He exalts nations and then destroys them"

ולהשמדם עדי עד (תהלים צב, ח) אך דע כי הוא ג"כ לצרך ישראל

and (Psalms 92:8) "When the wicked bloom like grass... it is to destroy them forever,"

ובסוד (איוב כז, יז) יכין [רשע] וצדיק ילבש

and according to the mystical explanation of (Job 27:17), "he [a wicked person] may prepare it, but a righteous person will wear it."

והוא ג"כ בסוד מ"ש יבמות ס"ג א' אין פרענות בא לעולם אלא בשביל ישראל

This is also the mystical secret of the statement of our Sages in Tractate Yevamot 63a: Punishments descend upon the world for the sake of Israel i.e. the Jewish People –

כִּי כָּל הַטּוֹב וְכָל הַתְּמוּרוֹת הוּא הַכֹּל רַק לְצַרְךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל

for all good and its opposite is all for the sake of Israel,

וּכְמ"ש בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּשִׁבִּיל יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ רֵאשִׁית וּבְשִׁבִּילָם נִבְרָאוּ
הַכֹּל

as it states Genesis 1:1 "In the beginning..." which the Midrash Tanchuma, Bereishit 3 interprets as for the sake of Israel, who are called 'the beginning' and everything was created for their sake,

וְכָל מָה שִׁיְסוּבָב לְטוֹבָה מִכָּל הַתְּמוּרוֹת כֻּלָּם וּמִכָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם

as is everything that evolves for the good, from all the qualities and their opposites, and from all the punishments.

וְע"פ מָה שֶׁאֱמָרָם הוּא הַכֹּל רַק לְצַרְךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל כִּי בְשִׁבִּילָם נִבְרָא
הָעוֹלָם וּבְשִׁבִּילָם נַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל

This is according to what our Sages declared – that everything is only for the sake of Israel, because for them was the world created, and everything was made.

וְכָל רָשָׁעֵי עוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים הֵם תּוֹלְדוֹת דְּהָרַע עֲצָמוֹ

Whereas all the wicked idolaters are the products of evil itself,

כִּי אִלּוּלָא מַצִּיאוֹת הָרַע לֹא הָיוּ הֵם כֻּלָּם בְּמַצִּיאוֹת כֻּלָּל

for if evil did not exist they would not exist at all.

וְהֵם מְרֻכָּבָה לְהֶסֶם אֵל אַחֵר וּבִנְיָנוּ שְׁבַעוּה"ז, ע' בְּתִיקוּנִים תִּקּוּן
כ"ד

They are the vehicle for the unholy, 'the other gods' and their entire supporting structure in this world. See Tikunei Zohar, Tikun 24,

וּבִדְבָרֵינוּ בִּסְפָר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב דְּרוֹשׁ ד' עֲנָךְ ד'

and our commentary in the work Drushei Olam HaTohu part 2, 4:4.

וְהֵם ע"ד שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל הֵם מְרֻכָּבָה לְהִשְׁכִּינָה וּמַצִּיאוֹתָהּ וּבִנְיָנָהּ בַּעוּה"ז

Just like Israel, who are the vehicle for the Shechinah the Divine Presence as manifested in malchut and its manifestation and all the structures thereof in this world,

וְכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם דִּישְׂרָאֵל הוּא הַכֹּל בָּהּ כִּי הֵם גּוֹפָה דִּילָהּ אֲבָרִים דִּילָהּ

so that all matters concerning Israel are all in her in *malchut* the *Shechinah* for we are her body and limbs i.e. the practical manifestation of the *Shechinah*,

כֵּן הוּא עַד"ז כִּי כָל עוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים הֵם גּוֹפֵא דָסְמ' אֶל אַחֵר אַבְרִים
דִּילִיָּה

so too, are they – the idolaters – who are the body and limbs of the unholy, 'the other gods.'

וְכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם הוּא הַכֹּל בּוֹ וַיִּתְּבֵטְלוּ הֵם בְּבִטּוּלוֹ לְגִמְרִי

And all matters concerning them are in it in the unholy vehicle, and with its demise they too will be completely nullified.

וְכָל מָה שְּׁאֲמַרְנוּ בְּסִבַּת מְצִיאוֹתָיו הוּא סִבַּת מְצִיאוֹתָם

And everything that we said regarding the cause of its existence is also the cause of their existence.

וְכֵן כָּל מָה שְּׁאֲמַרְנוּ בְּהִכָּרַח בְּטוּלוֹ מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֵשׁ הַהִפְסָד
וְהָאֲבִדוֹן הַחֲלָטִי,

And everything we mentioned regarding the necessity of its nullification, since it is the source of absolute destruction and total annihilation,

הוּא הִכָּרַח בְּטוּלָם, וּמִשּׁוּם שֶׁהֵם מֵעֵצָם הָרַע

this necessitates their nullification, since they derive from the essence of evil,

אֲשֶׁר כָּל עֲצֻמוֹתָם הוּא לְהָרַע וּלְהָרֵס וּלְחַבֵּל

and their entire essence is to harm and destroy and damage.

וְכָל קִיּוּמָם בְּזִמּוֹ קִיּוּמָם הֵנָּה הוּא רַק ע"י תְּמִצִּית הָאֶרֶת הַקְדוּשָׁה
שֶׁמֵאִיר עֲלֵיהֶם מִסְבִּיב

And their entire existence, while they exist, is only from a smidgeon of the radiance of holiness that illuminates them from without,

וּבִסּוֹד (יחזקאל א, ד) וְנִגְיָה לוֹ סְבִיב כַּמ"ש בְּזוֹה"ק יִתְרוֹ ס"ט ע"א

as in the mystical interpretation of the verse in Ezekiel (1:4), "a glow all around it" in *Zohar Yitro* 69a.

וְהֵנָּה נִמְשָׁךְ מְצִיאוֹתָם עַד שְׁיִגְמַר לְצֵאת כָּל כְּחוֹת דְּתוֹקֶף הַדְּנִים
קָשִׁים

Now they will continue to exist until all the powers of intense *dinim* have emerged,

כָּל מָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶם בְּתַכְלִית הַיּוֹתֵר אֲפָשָׁרִי

and all that is in them that serves this purpose to the maximum possible degree.

אָבֵל אַחֵר שִׁיגְמָרוּ לָצֵאת לְגַמְרֵי הָהָה יִסְתַּלֵּק מֵעֲלֵיהֶם סוּד הַגָּגָה
הַנִּזְכָּר

But as soon as it has all emerged completely their secret protection will be withdrawn, as mentioned,

וְאִזְּ יִתְהַפֵּךְ כָּל הָרַע כֵּלּוֹ לֵאשׁ שׁוֹרֵף וַיִּתְקַיֵּם אִזְּ עָלֵיו

and then all of the evil will become a consuming fire, and there will be fulfilled upon them,

וְעַל כָּל תּוֹלְדוֹתָיו שֶׁהֵם כָּל מְרַכְּבָתוֹ וּבְנֵינּוֹ אֲשֶׁר בַּעוֹה"ז

and upon all of their descendants, which are its vehicle and structures in this world,

מִקְרָא שֶׁכְּתוּב מִלֵּאכִי (ג יט-כ) 'הִנֵּה הַיּוֹם בָּא בְּעֵר כְּתָנוֹר וְהָיוּ כָּל
יָדִים וְכָל עֲשֵׂה רָשָׁעָה קֵשׁ וְלֹהֵט אוֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבֹּא... אֲשֶׁר לֹא יַעֲזֹב
לָהֶם שֹׁרֶשׁ וְעֵנָף. וְזָרְחָה לָכֶם יְרֵאִי שְׁמִי שֶׁמֶשׁ צִדְקָה וּמִרְפָּא בִּכְנֻפֶיהָ'
כו'

the verse (Malachi 3:19-20) that states, "For behold the day is coming, burning like an oven, when all the wicked people and all the evildoers will be like straw; and that coming day will burn them up... so that it will not leave them a root or branch. But a sun of righteousness will shine for you who fear My Name, with healing in its rays..."

כִּי יִצְטָרְפוּ וַיִּתְלַבְּנוּ אוֹתָן הַתִּקְוָה דִּינִים קָשִׁים וַיִּכְלָלוּ בְּשִׁרְשָׁם יִמְתָּקוּ
וַיִּתְבַּסְּמוּ

The intense harsh *dinim* will be refine and purify them, and they will merge into their source and become sweetened and fragrant,

וַיַּעֲשׂוּ כָלֶם לְשִׁלְהוּבִין דְּרַחֲמֵי לְיִשְׂרָאֵל

and all of them will become flames of love for Israel.

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים ח, ב) רָשָׁעִים נְדוּנִין בָּהּ וְצַדִּיקִים מְתַרְפְּאִין בָּהּ
וְלֹא עוֹד אֵלָּא שֶׁמֶתְעַדְנִין בָּהּ:

This is what Tractate *Nedarim* 8b states in this regard: The wicked will be judged thereby and the righteous will be healed thereby; furthermore they will be refined thereby.

וְמָה שֶׁמֶתְהַפֵּךְ הָרַע לֵאשׁ שׁוֹרֵף וְלִסְעָר מִתְחַלֵּל הִנֵּה הוּא נוֹהֵג
בְּאַמֶּת תָּמִיד גַּם עַתָּה

That evil will be transformed into a burning fire and 'a tempest that seeks rest – devolving upon the head of the wicked' (Jeremiah 23:19) is always going on, even

now,

כי מזה הוא כל הרעות והתלאות וכל הענשים וכנ"ל

because from there all the bad things, the suffering and all the punishments, derive.

אֵלָא שְׁעֵתָה הִנֵּה יוֹצֵא תֹאֵר כְּחוֹת חֲדָשִׁים מִתְקַף הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים

Only that now new powers appear from the intensity of harsh *dinim*,

וּמִתְחַלְפִים תּוֹלְדוֹתֵיהֶם תָּמִיד כִּי הָרָאוּשׁוֹנִים מִתְבַּטְּלִים וְנִמְתָּקִים

and their progeny constantly changes, because the earlier ones become nullified and are sweetened,

וּמִתְחַדָּשִׁים אֲחֵרִים תַּחֲתֵיהֶם וְכֵן מִתְחַלֵּף כָּל רֶגַע בְּכָחוֹת חֲדָשִׁים

and other ones are generated anew instead of them, and they are also constantly replenished with new powers.

עַד שְׁיִגְמְרוּ לְצֵאת כָּלָם לָעֵת קֵץ הַיָּמִין שֶׁהוּא בְּזִמְנוֹ תַּחֲתֵית הַמֵּתִים

This will continue until all of them have finished emerging – at the end of days, which is the time of the Resurrection of the Dead,

וְאֵז יִתְבַטֵּל הַזְּהֵמָא מִכָּל וְכָל (כמ"ש ב'פ' יתרו ס"ט ב' ובכ"מ)

and then the pollution will be nullified completely (as it states in *Zohar Yitro 69b* et al).

וְאֵז יִתְגַּלוּ וְיִתְפָּשְׁטוּ לְמַטָּה כָּל הַמִּתְקַת הַגְּבוּרוֹת כָּלָם

And then all the sweetened *gevurot* will be revealed and will spread out below.

שֶׁנִּמְתָּקוּ מִכָּל הַתְּלָאוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר בַּעוּהוּ"ז וּבַעוֹלָם הַנִּפְשׁוֹת

They became sweetened from all the suffering and the punishments that accrue in this world, and in the World of Souls,

מֵעַת הַחֵטָא דַּעַד"ע עַד אוֹתָהּ הַזִּמְנוֹ דַּתְחָה"מ

from the time of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge until the time of the Resurrection of the Dead.

וְיֵאִירוּ כָלָם בְּכָל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן לְכָל מִי אֲשֶׁר בְּשֵׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל יִכְנֶה

All of them will shine forth with all the hidden goodness to all those who are called by the name of Israel,

וכמ"ש בִּישְׁעִיָּה (מד, ג-ה) אֶצְק רֹחִי עַל זֶרְעֶךָ וּבִרְכָתִי עַל צֶאֱצָאֶיךָ
וְצִמְחוּ כו'

as the verse states in Isaiah (44, 3-5), "... I shall pour out My spirit upon your offspring and My blessing upon your progeny, and they shall flourish...

זֶה יֹאמַר לֵה' אֲנִי וְזֶה יִקְרָא כְּשֵׁם יַעֲקֹב וְזֶה יִכְתֹּב יְדוֹ לֵה' וּבִשְׁם
יִשְׂרָאֵל יִכְנֶה

This one will say, 'I am God's', and the other one will call himself by the name of Jacob; this one will sign his allegiance to God and adopt the name of Israel."

כִּי יִזְכּוּ כ"א לְפִי מִדְּרָגָתוֹ אֲבָל עכ"פ הוּא כִּי יִזְכּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל כֻּלָּם:

For each one will merit according to his level, but in any event all of Israel will be meritorious.

וְכָל מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ הִנֵּה הוּא עֲנִין מָה שֶׁאֲמָרוּ רז"ל בְּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּא
וּתְנַחוּמָא ס"פ בְּשַׁלַּח (ע' תְּנַחוּמָא שָׁם ס' כ"ג כ"ד)

Everything that we stated above is the same concept propounded by the Sages in Midrash Rabba and Tanchuma end of *Beshalach* (see Tanchuma ad loc 23, 24)

כִּי מִדַּת הַקֵּב"ה הוּא אֵינוֹ כְּמִדַּת בֶּשָׂר וְדָם

that the way of the Holy One, blessed is He is not like the ways of flesh and blood

כִּי מִדַּת בֶּשָׂר וְדָם מַכָּה בְּאֶזְמֵל וּמִרְפָּא בְּרִטָּה

– for the way of flesh and blood is that a wound caused by a knife is healed with ointment,

אֲבָל מִדַּת הַקֵּב"ה בְּמָה שֶׁהוּא מַכָּה בּוֹ הוּא מִרְפָּא

whereas the way of the blessed Holy One is to heal with that very thing that wounded.

וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ כִּי כָּל אוֹתָן הַסְּבוֹת עֲצָמוֹן אֲשֶׁר מֵהֶם הוּא כָּל
הַרְעוֹת

As we said – all of those factors themselves that produced all the evil,

וְהַצָּרוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם הִנֵּה הֵם עֲצָמוֹן יִהְיוּ הַסְּבוֹת לְהַעֲשׂוֹת עַל
יְדֵיהֶם כָּל טוֹב הָעָתִיד

and all the suffering and punishments, they themselves are the factors by which all good in the future will come about.

וְכֵן הוּא ג"כ מ"ש רז"ל בִּילְקוּט תִּהְלִים ה' סוּף רָמַז תֵּרַח

And so too is expounded by our Rabbis' statement in *Yalkut Tehillim* 5, end of allusion 628:

אַל תִּשְׂמַחִי אֹיְבֹתַי לִי כִּי נָפַלְתִּי קָמְתִּי כִּי אֲשַׁב בַּחֲשֵׁךְ ה' אוֹר [עַל הַפְּסוֹק מִיכָה ז, ח] לִי

on the verse [Michah 7:8] "Do not rejoice over me, my enemy, for though I fell, I will rise! Though I sit in darkness, God is a light for me!"

אלולא שְנַפְלִיתִי לֹא קָמְתִי אֱלוּלָא שִׁישְׁבִּיתִי בְּחֹשֶׁךְ לֹא הָיָה אוֹר לִי

The Rabbis explain: were it not that I fell, I would not rise; were it not that I sit in darkness, He would not be a light for me!

וְהוּא ג"כ ע"פ מָה שְׁאֻמְרָנוּ כִּי תוֹצְאוֹת כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת כָּלָם

This accords with what we said – that the result of all the *gevurot*

עַל תְּכִלִּית הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי שֶׁבָּהֶם הֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּאֶשֶׁר שֶׁהֵם
מְסַלְקִים מֵהַחֲסָדִים לְגַמְרִי

that serve the ultimate purpose possible for them – is only when they completely withdraw from the powers of kindness (*chasadim*).

וְכַנ"ל שֶׁהַגְּלוּי הָאֲחֵרוֹן שֶׁל כָּל דָּבָר, ר"ל הַגְּלוּי הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי שָׁבוּ,

As we said earlier – the ultimate revelation of anything, i.e. the maximum revelation possible for that thing,

הוּא דוֹקָא רַק בְּאֶשֶׁר שֶׁמִּתְרוֹחֵק מֵהַמְּגִדוּ בְּתִכְלִית הָאֶפְשָׁרִי
וּמִתְהַפֵּךְ מִקְצֵה לְקְצֵה

is specifically only when its opposite withdraws to the maximum possible and it becomes transformed from one extreme to the other.

וְהָרִי אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַגְּבוֹת לְצֵאת בְּכָל כְּחוֹתֵיהֶם

Thus it is impossible for the *gevurot* to emerge in all their strength

אֲלֹא רַק ע"י שְׁנִתְּגָלוֹ מִתְחִילָה בְּתִקְףִי דִּינִים קָשִׁים בְּתִכְלִית
הָאֶפְשָׁרִי

unless they emerge initially with all the intensity of severe *dinim* to the maximum extent possible.

וְנִבְרָא עי"ז כָּל הָרַע וְתוֹלְדוֹתָיו אֲשֶׁר כָּל תְּכוּנָתוֹ הוּא לְהָרֵס וּלְחַבֵּל

Thus is created all the evil and its progeny, the nature of which is to destroy and damage,

וְהוּא הַחֲטָא וְהָעֲנֵשׁ וּבִזָּה יוֹצֵא כָּל כָּחוֹ וְנִפְסָד וּמִתְבַּטֵּל

and this is the sin and its punishment. In this manner all of its power emerges and is terminated and nullified,

כִּי כָּל עֲצָמוֹ הוּא רַק כֹּחַ הַשְׁחָתָה וְהַהֲעָדָר עַד שֶׁנֶּעְדָּר הוּא גּוּפָה

since its entire being is only the power of destruction and deficiency, until it itself becomes nonexistent.

וְלֹא יִהְיֶה מֵעַתָּה שׁוּם רַע כָּלֵל לֹא חֲטָא וְלֹא עֲנֵשׁ וְלֹא שׁוּם הָעֲדָר
כָּלֵל

From then on there will be no evil at all, no sin and no punishment and no deficiency at all,

וַיִּשְׁאָרוּ כָחוֹת כָּל הַגְּבוּרוֹת טְהוֹרִים וְנִקְיִים מִכָּל סִיג וּפְסֻלָּת
and the powers of all the *gevurot* will remain pure and unsullied by any dross or waste.

וַיִּכָּלְלוּ בְּשִׁרְשָׁן לִהְיוֹת בְּתַכְלִית הַמֵּתוּק וְהַבְּסוּם
They the *gevurot* will merge into their root to become absolutely sweetened and aromatic,

וְאִזּוּ יִתְגַּלֶּה וְיַעֲשֶׂה עַל יְדֵיהֶם כָּל טוֹב הָעָתִיד שֶׁהוּא רַק ע"י הַגְּבוּרוֹת
כַּ"ל

and then they will reveal and fashion all the goodness of the future, which is only by way of the *gevurot* as explained above.

וְהָרִי כ"ז נַעֲשֶׂה רַק ע"י שִׁיָּצְאוּ מִתְחִילָה בְּתַקָּף דִּינִים קָשִׁים
Thus all of this comes about only when the intensity of severe *dinim* emerge from the outset,

שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת כָּלָם אֲשֶׁר מַחֲטֵא עַץ הַדַּעַת וְהַלָּאָה
which are all of the negative events from the sin of the Tree of Knowledge and from then on,

וְע"י כָּל הַתְּלָאוֹת כָּלָם שְׁבָה־עוֹה"ז וְכָל עֲנָשֵׁי גֵיהֶנֶם
and by way of all the suffering in this world, and the punishments in Gehinnom.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ אֱלֹוִלָא נִפְלַתִּי לֹא קָמַתִּי אֱלֹוִלָא שִׁישְׁבַּתִּי בְּחָשֶׁךְ לֹא
הָיָה אוֹר לִי:

This then is what they the Rabbis said – 'were it not that I fell, I would not rise; were it not that I sit in darkness, He would not be a light for me!'

וּמִמֵּילָא הוּא כִּי מִגְדַּל הָרַע וְרַבּוּי תוֹלְדוֹתָיו וּמִגְדַּל הַצָּרוֹת וְרַבּוּי
הַתְּלָאוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים

From the tremendous evil and the multitude of its progeny, and from the great troubles and piles of suffering and punishments, it follows automatically

הָרִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהִבִּין קֶצֶת עֶרְךָ גָּדֹל וְרַבּוּי הַטּוֹבָה דִּלְעָתִיד
that we have some possibility of understanding a little of the quality and quantity of goodness that will be revealed in the future,

כִּי הָרִי כָּל מָה שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה מִהָרַע וּתְלָאוֹתָיו הֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּסֻבּוֹת
הַדִּינִים קָשִׁים

since all the evil and suffering created is only due to the harsh *dinim*

שהם מתולדות כחות הגבורות לבד.

that are only the product of the powers of *gevurot*.

אבל מה שיעשה מכ"ז בטוב העתיד הרי הוא ע"י המתקנות
הגבורות בחסדים

But the future goodness that will be produced from all this is due to the
sweetening of the *gevurot* by the powers of kindness (*chasadim*)

אשר למעלה למעלה עד אין קו ותכלית

which are infinitely superior to the *gevurot*.

והרי יהיה הטוב העתיד ע"י החסדים והגבורות יחד:

Thus the future good is by way of *chasadim* and *gevurot* together.

והוא מה שאמרו סוטה י"א א' כי לעולם מדה טובה מרבה ממדת
פרענות

This is what it states in Tractate *Sotah* 11a – that the attribute of benevolence is
greater than the attribute of punishment.

ובתוספתא סוטה רפ"ד מבאר כי מדה טובה מרבה על אחת חמש
מאות ע"ש

And the *Tosefta Sotah* beginning of chapter 4 explains that the attribute of
benevolence is 500 times greater. See there.

והוא בסוד ה' גלויים הכוללים שבארנו לעיל שער ד' פ"ג

This is the mystical secret of the five general levels of revelation we explained in
Sha'ar 4 chapter 3 – the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, *Adam Kadmon*,
Atzilut and *BiY"A* (*Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* which are counted as a single unit).⁵

שכלם הם בגלוי אור קדשתו ית"ש והם כלם בהמתקת הגבורות

All of them are revelations of the light of His blessed holiness, and they are all
by way of the sweetening of *gevurot*.⁶

והם למעלה על כל תקף הדינים קשים שנעשה בהעלמות בי"ע
ועברה הוא רק בהעשיה

And they transcend all the intensity of the harsh *dinim* that are manifested in
the Worlds of *BiY"A*, and only in *Asiyah* is there transgression.

אבל גלוי מדת טובו ית"ש הוא באור כל ה' גלויים העליונים

But the revelation of His blessed attribute of goodness is in the light of all five of
those supernal revelations,

וכ"א הוא כלול ממאה והם ה' מאות אשר מדה טובה מרבה

each of which comprises one hundred levels – thus the 500 times greater that the attribute of benevolence is than the attribute of punishment.

כי כל התלאות והענשים הרי הם רק מהדינים קשים הנעשים
מכחות הגבורות לבד

For all of the suffering and punishment derive only from the harsh *dinim* that are formed from the *gevurot* alone,

המתגלים למטה מכל הה' גלויים הנז'

and these are revealed only below all of the five revelations mentioned,

אבל כל הטובה דלעתיד הנה הם בכל הה' גילים העליונים כלם
whereas the benevolence of the future is manifested in all of the five supernal revelations,

אשר הם באור קדשת כל החסדים העליונים וכל הגבורות
העליונים

since they are in the holy light of the supernal *chasadim*, and all of the sweetened supernal *gevurot*

שניהם יחד והם הטובה הכלול מה' מאות (500)

both of them together – forming the inclusive goodness that comprises 500 aspects.

שהם הה' גלויים הנז' אשר כ"א הוא כלול ממאה

These are the five revelations mentioned, each of which comprises 100 aspects.

והוא ג"כ סוד עץ החיים מהלך ת"ק שנה שאמרו בבראשית רבא פ'
ט"ו סימן ה'

And this is also the mystical secret of the Tree of Life, the measure of which is 500 years, as stated in *Bereishit Rabba* 15:5.

ולעתיד יחזר העץ הדעת אשר משם הוא עתה שרש הרע ויניקתו

In the future, the Tree of Knowledge, which is the root of evil and its sustenance at this time,

יחזר הוא ג"כ להעץ החיים ויעשו שניהם לאחד

will return to also be the Tree of Life, and both of them will become one,

כמו שכתבנו בזה בארכה בספר הרמ"ה ח"ב

as we have written about at length in the *Sefer Derushei Olam HaTohu* part 2.

ודי בזה כעת שלא לצאת מן הענין יותר מדאי.

Let this now suffice, lest we stray too far from the main subject.

Footnotes

1. Specifically, when any of these letters appear at the beginning of a word they take a *dagesh*, and in the middle of a word – after a *sheva nach* (a resting *sheva*). [↩](#)
2. See Pirkei Avot 5:1 – בעשרה מאמרות נברא העולם [↩](#)
3. Intro, ד"ה פתח אליהו, [↩](#)
4. Sanhedrin 97a. [↩](#)
5. See Makover. [↩](#)
6. Makover notes that the first four revelations mentioned are sweetened in their root. Only when they emerge into *BiY"A* is there any admixture of evil. [↩](#)

Chapter 8 — The purpose of punishment (cause and effect) and rectification (balancing) via the power of the tsadikim (righteous people)

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ מִכָּל דְּבָרֵינוּ כִּי הָעֲנָשִׁים גּוֹפָה הֵם עֲצָמוֹן הַסִּבָּה
לְכָל הַיְעוּדִים הָעֲתִידִים

Thus it has been clarified for us from all the above that the punishments themselves are the reason for all the promises of the future,

כִּי כְמוֹ שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה

because just like Torah and the mitzvot

הֵנָּה נַעֲשׂוּ הֵם גּוֹפָה הַמִּצְוֹת דְּכָל טוֹב הָעֲתִיד וְכַמ"ש שְׂכָר מִצְוָה
מִצְוָה

themselves become the actuality of good in the future, as the Sages declared
"the reward of a mitzvah is the mitzvah" –

שֶׁהַמִּצְוָה גּוֹפָה הִיא עֵצָם הַשְּׂכָר שֶׁהִיא עֲצָמָה הֵנָּה הִיא הַזֵּיו וְהַנֶּעַם
הַנִּצְחִי

that the mitzvah itself is the essence of the reward, since it itself is eternal
radiance and pleasantness,

שֶׁאֵין לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה כּוֹן יְסֹד הַקֵּב"ה פְּעֻלוֹת וְתִקּוּנִים

and there is nothing that surpasses this, for that is the foundation that the
blessed Holy One laid regarding activities in the realm of Torah and mitzvot and
rectifications (Tikunim) –

לְסַבֵּב אֶת הַשְּׂאֵרֶת הַנִּצְחִי וְטוֹב הַצָּפוֹן גַּם לְנַפְשׁ הַחוּטָא

that they bring about eternal life and reveal the hidden good, even for a sinning
soul.

וְהוּא ע"י כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר בָּזָה וּבָבֵא כִּי הֵם נוֹבְעִים וּבָאִים ג"כ רַק
מִהַתּוֹרָה

And this is by way of all the punishments in this world and the next that also
flow and emerge exclusively from the Torah.

כִּי כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים הֵנָּה הֵם בְּמִדָּה וּבְמִשְׁקָל ע"פ מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

Because all of the punishments are measured and weighed according to the laws
of the Torah

לְהַעֲוִירֵם עָלֶיהָ וְהֵם מִהָעֲבֵרוֹת עֲצָמוֹן וְכַמ"ש שְׂכָר עֲבֵרָה עֲבֵרָה

for those who transgress it. And those punishments derive from the transgressions themselves, as the Sages state "the 'reward' of a transgression is the transgression" –

שְׁהַעֲבָרָה גּוֹפָה הִיא עֶצֶם הָעֲנֹשׁ הַיּוֹצֵא וְנִעְשָׂה מִתּוֹקֶף הַדִּינִים
קָשִׁים

in other words, the transgression itself is the essence of the punishment that emerges and is formed by the intensity of the harsh severities (*dinim*)

הַמִּתְגַּלִּים וְנִמְשָׁכִים מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְדִינֶיהָ.

that are revealed and drawn forth from the statutes of the Torah and its laws.

וּכְשֶׁנִּגְמַר פְּעֻלָּתָהּ אֲשֶׁר מִמֶּדֶת הַדִּין וְהַמִּשְׁפָּט שָׁבָה הִנֵּה כָּלָה
וּמִתְבַּטֵּל עִ"ז

And when the attribute of justice and judgment has fulfilled its purpose, this puts an end to and nullifies

כָּל תִּקְוָה וְקִשְׁיוֹת הַדִּינִים וּמִתְבַּסְּמִים וְנִמְתָּקִים כָּל אוֹתָן הַגְּבוּרוֹת

all of the intensity and harshness of the *dinim* and all the *gevurot* aspects of harshness become aromatic and sweetened

וְנִעְשִׂים לְרִשְׁפֵי אֵשׁ שֶׁלֹּהֶבֶת י"ה וְהֵם עֶצְמוֹ מֵעֵתָּה סִבַּת הַגְּלוּי

and are made into 'flares of fire of the flames of God' (see Song of Songs 8:6) and they themselves become from that point on the indirect cause of the revelation

דָּכַל יְעוּדִים הָעֵתִידִים וְכָל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן אֲשֶׁר לַיְמוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי
הָעוֹה"ב

of all the promises for the future, and all the hidden good that will be in the Messianic era and the World to Come.

וְהָרִי הוּוּ הָעֲנָשִׁים גּוֹפָה סִבָּה לְכָל יְעוּדִים הָעֵתִידִים

Thus the punishments themselves are the indirect cause of all the promises for the future,

כִּי בְּאֲשֶׁר יִתְבַּטֵּל הָעֲנֹשׁ יִתְהַפְּכוּ אוֹתָן הַדִּינִין עֶצְמוֹ לְדִינֵי דִקְדָּשָׁא

for when the punishments are nullified, those very *dinim* will be transformed into holy *dinim*.

וּכ"ז הוּא ג"כ רַק מְאוּר קִדְשֵׁת הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוֹת

All of this is also only from the luminousness of the holy Torah and mitzvot,

כִּי כָּל גְּלוּי הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁהָיוּ מִתְחַלְלָה לְסִבַּת הָעֲנֹשׁ

because all the *gevurot* that were originally manifested for the purposes of punishment

הם נתגלו ויצאו רק ממשפטי התורה ודיניה ובמדה ובמשקל ע"פ החקים והמשפטים שבה

are revealed and emerge exclusively from the laws of Torah and its statutes, measured and weighed according to those laws and statutes.

והרי יוצא כל טוב העתיד רק מהתורה לעולם

Thus all the good that will be in the future is exclusively from Torah for all time.

והוא מה שאמר בספר יצירה פ"ב עשרים ושנים אותיות יסוד (שהם יסוד כל דבר)

This is what is meant by the statement in *Sefer Yetzirah* 2:4 that twenty-two foundational letters (i.e. the foundations of everything)

קבעו בגלגל כמין חומה ברל"א שערים וחוזר הגלגל פנים ואחור

He set in a circle like a wall with 231 gates, and the circle turns forwards and backwards.

The commentaries explain that this can be depicted as two concentric circles, each having the entire Hebrew alphabet engraved upon them. One or both wheels rotate forming unique two-letter combinations (one from each circle). We exclude identical letter combinations such as **אא** or **בב** since these are not *unique* 2-letter combinations. The formula for the sum total of combinations would thus be 22×21 divided by $2 = 231$. (We divide by 2 since **אב** and **בא** are the same letters, just in reverse order).

וסימן לדבר אין בטובה למעלה מענג ואין ברעה למטה מנגע

The *Sefer Yetzirah* continues: **A sign of this is – there is nothing in good higher than delight *oneg* (ענג) and nothing in evil lower than plague *nega* (נגע).**

The implication here is as mentioned above – that the intensity and harshness of the *dinim* and all the *gevurot* will become aromatic and sweetened, just like *nega* in a different permutation forms the word *oneg*, as the author states explicitly below.

וע"י משפטה ודיניה שהם הענשים כלם היא מטהר כל טמאה ומהפך כל רעה לטובה וכל נגע לענג.

Thus through the Torah's judgments and *dinim*, which all are the punishments meted out to those who transgress the Torah, everything polluted is purified, and all evil is transformed into good, and all *nega* to *oneg*.

והוא סוד טהרתו של גיהנם לעתיד לבוא שיתהפך הוא עצמו לקדשתו של גן עדן

This is the mystical secret of the decontamination of Gehinom in the future – it will be transformed into the holiness of Gan Eden.

וַיַּעֲשֶׂה כ"ז הַכֹּל רַק מִגְלוּיֵי זוֹהָרֵי אוֹר הַתּוֹרָה

And all of this will be achieved exclusively by way of the revelation of the radiance of the light of Torah –

שְׁאֵחַר שְׁנַעֲשֶׂה מִשְׁפָּטָה וְדִינָה תֵּאִיר וְתִתְגַּלֶּה לְהַמְתִּיק אֶת כָּל
הַגְּבוּרוֹת

for after its the Torah's judgments and *dinim* have been carried out, then the light will shine forth to sweeten the *gevurot*,

וַיִּתְהַפְּכוּ כָּלֶם לְדִינֵין דְּקֻדְשָׁא שְׁבָהֶם הוּא כָּל טוֹב הַצָּפוֹן:

and all of them will be transformed into *dinim* of holiness, in which is all the hidden goodness.

וּבִדְבָרֵינוּ הִלְלוּ יוֹבֵן סוּד מֵאֲמָרָם ז"ל בְּבִרְאשִׁית רַבָּא פ"ב סִימָן ה'

With these words, we can understand the mystery of the statement of the Sages in *Bereishit Rabba* 2, 5:

מִתַּחֲלַת בְּרִיתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם צָפָה הַקֹּב"ה בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים
וּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רָשָׁעִים

From the beginning of the creation of the world the blessed Holy One foresaw the actions of the righteous and the actions of the wicked.

אָבֵל אֵינִי יוֹדֵעַ בְּאִיזָה מֵהֶם חָפֵץ אִם בְּמַעֲשֶׂה אֱלוֹ וְאִם בְּמַעֲשֶׂה אֱלוֹ

But how do we know which one He desired – whether the actions of these the righteous, or the actions of the others, the wicked?

כִּיֵּן דְּכָתִיב וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב הָרִי בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל
צַדִּיקִים חָפֵץ

But since it is written (Genesis 1:4) "the Lord saw that the light was *good*," we know that He desires the actions of the righteous,

וְאֵינִי חָפֵץ בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רָשָׁעִים וְע' בְּמִפְרָשִׁים שֶׁטָּרְחוּ מְאֹד בְּדִבְרֵי
הַמְדַּרְשׁ הַזֶּה

and does not desire the actions of the wicked. See the commentators who expended much effort in explaining this Midrash.

וְכֹן קָרוֹב לְלָשׁוֹן זֶה הוּא ג"כ בְּסִפְרֵי רִישׁ פ' רָאָה רָאָה אֲנֹכִי נָתַן
לְפָנֶיכֶם הַיּוֹם בְּרָכָה וּקְלָלָה

A similar expression is also found in *Sifri, Re'eh* on the verse (Deuteronomy 11:26) "Behold I have placed before you today a blessing and a curse..."

לפי שנאמר החיים והמוות נתתי לפניך הברכה והקללה

The *Sifri* comments: **Since another verse** (Deuteronomy 30:19) **states, "Life and death I have placed before you, the blessing and the curse..."**

שמא יאמרו ישראל הואיל ונתן הקב"ה לפנינו שני דרכים

perhaps a Jew will say: 'Since the blessed Holy One placed before us two paths,

דרך החיים ודרך המוות נלך באיזה מהם שנרצה

the path of life and the path of death, one can traverse whichever one chooses,'

תלמוד לומר ובחרת בחיים למען תחיה אתה וזרעך

in response **the Torah** (in continuation of the verse just quoted) **teaches "and you shall choose life, so that you and your progeny may live."**

והנה הוא מובן ע"פ דברינו כי מאחר שתכלית הבריאה שהוא

בשביל התקון דלעתיד

Now it is understood from what we said that the purpose of creation is the **Tikun** rectification that will be completed in the future,

אשר לימות המשיח ולחיי העולם הבא הנה הוא יעשה עכ"פ

שיתקן הכל

in the Messianic era and in the World to Come, where everything will have been rectified

ע"י הענשים ג"כ כי ע"י כל התלאות שבהעוה"ז והענשים אשר

לאחר מיתה

by way of punishments as well, because through suffering in this world, and punishments after death

יתבטל הרע כלו ויכלה כל הטמאה והזהמא

all of the evil will be nullified, and all spiritual impurity and infection will have been disposed of,

ויהיו כל הענשים גופה ג"כ לסבה גדולה להתקון העתיד ולהגלוי

דטוב הצפון וכנ"ל

and all the punishments themselves will also be the indirect cause of the **Tikun** of the future and the revelation of the hidden good, as mentioned previously.

א"כ שמא יאמר אדם שילך באיזה דרך שירצה

This being so, a person may say to himself that he can traverse whichever path he wishes,

כִּי אֵין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה בָּזָה יוֹתֵר מִבָּזָה, מֵאַחַר שֶׁתְּכַלִּית הַכְּנָה
הָרִי יַעֲשֶׂה עַכ"פּ

since the blessed Holy One's Will is not in this one path, the way of life, more
than that other path, the way of suffering and punishment, and the Divine
intention is accomplished in any event.

*Side note: The central theme of this idea is also found in the הגָּהֶה
– writings of one of the great Jewish thinkers*

וְהוּא הַגָּאוֹן בַּעַל הַחֲנוּךְ בַּמִּצְוָה ס"ט

the great scholar, the author of the Chinuch, mitzvah 69.

שֶׁמִּבָּאֵר בְּדֶרֶךְ זֶה מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ רַז"ל בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת – עֲנֵשׁ שֶׁמַּעֲנֵנוּ,
אֲזִיזָה מִנִּיחָא?

*In this manner he explains the statement the Sages made in a number of places¹ –
'the punishments we heard about; but where is the warning?'*

וְלִכְאוּרָה יִפְּלֵא לָמָּה אֵינוּ מְסַפִּיק הָעֲנֵשׁ לְבַד בְּלִתִּי הָאֲזִיזָה

*Now at first glance this question is astonishing – why is the punishment not
sufficient, without a warning?*

וְאָמַר הוּא ז"ל כִּי לֹא הָאֲזִיזָה הֵייתִי אוֹמֵר כִּי הָרְשׁוֹת בִּיד כָּל
הָרוּצָה

And he answers: for without a warning I might have said that a person is allowed

שֶׁלֹּא יַחֲשׂוּשׁ לַעֲעֹר לַעֲבֹר עַל הַמִּצְוָה וּלְקַבֵּל הָעֲנֵשׁ

*to ignore his own suffering and transgress the commandment and receive his
punishment,*

וְלֹא יִהְיֶה בָּזָה נֶגֶד חֶפְזָה ש"י וּמִצְוֹתוֹ כָּלֵל

and this does not go against the Will of God and His commandments at all,

כִּי כָל מִצְוָה הוּא רַק כְּעֵין מִקַּח וּמִמְכָּר אוֹ שִׁיעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוָה אוֹ
שִׁיִּסְבֵּל הָעֲנֵשׁ

*for every mitzvah is merely a transaction: either do the mitzvah or suffer the
consequences,*

וְאֵין חֶפְזָה הַקֵּב"ה בָּזָה יוֹתֵר מִבָּזָה.

and the Holy One, blessed is He, has no preference for one over the other.

וְלִכּוֹן אָמְרוּ לֹא עֲנֵשׁ אֶלֶּכָּה הַזִּהִיר

*To avoid this misconception the Sages therefore declared that there is no punishment
without a warning first –*

להודיע שרצונו ית"ש הוא במצוותיו דוקא

in order to inform us that His blessed Will is specifically for His commandments to be fulfilled,

ולא נעשה אותו הדבר שהענש בא עליו עכ"ל ע"ש

and that the person not do that which brings punishments upon themselves. This is what the author of the Chinuch says.

והרי קטב הדברים מה שאמרנו ע"כ הגהה

This is the central theme of our analysis. End of note.

לכן אמרה התורה ובחרת בחיים כי רצונו של הקב"ה הוא

This is why the Torah declares, "choose life" because the will of the blessed Holy One

רק שיעשה התקון אשר בתכלית כוננתו ית"ש ע"י קיום התורה
והמצוה דוקא

is that the Tikun He ultimately intended should be accomplished by way of Torah and mitzvot specifically,

להוציא כל כחות הגבורות מן הכח אל הפועל

bringing forth the powers of the *gevurot* from potential to actual,

וכל גלויים היותר אפשרי ע"י גברי כח עשי דברו.

and all the possible revelations by way of the "the brave warriors who do His bidding" (Psalms 103:20).

ואז היו יוצאים כלם בתכלית המתוק והבסוס גם מתחלה

Then everything will emerge completely sweetened and fragrant from the very outset,

כי התורה הנה היא היסוד והשרש והכח דכל המציאות כלו אשר
מן העולם ועד העולם

since the Torah is the foundation and root and potency of all existence from this world to the World to come (see Psalms 106:48).

והרי יש אפשרות בקיומה להוציא כל כחות הגבורות כלם

Thus, by fulfilling the Torah, it is possible to bring out all of the powers of the *gevurot*

בכל השעור המספיק לתכלית כל התקון כלו.

to the full extent needed for the purpose of the entire Tikun.

וא"כ הרי ודאי הוא חפצו של הקב"ה שיעשה התקון אשר בכונת כל הבריאה

This being so, it is certain that the desire of the blessed Holy One is that the Tikun that is the purpose of the entire Creation should be accomplished

רק ע"י קיום התורה והמצוה ולא ע"י הענשים אשר ממשפטיה ודיניה

only by way of Torah and the mitzvot, and not by way of the punishments that result from transgressing her laws and statutes.

והוא מטעם ג' דברים עקריים:

And this is for three primary reasons:

אחד הוא כי אלולא החטא היה נעשה ונשלם כל תקון העולם כלו מיד

1) Were it not for the transgression, the entire Tikun of the world would have been completed immediately

ע"י אדם הראשון עצמו תכף משבת בראשית והיה מתתקן העולם מאז

by Adam himself with the very onset of the first Sabbath of Creation, and the world would have been rectified from that moment,

בהתקון דחיי העולם הבא אשר באלף השביעי שהוא היום שכלו שבת

with the Tikun of the life of the World to Come that will take place now only in the seventh millennium – the era that is all Shabbat.

והיה נשלם אותו התקון תכף בשבת בראשית ולא היה נגנז האור הגנוז כלל

That Tikun would have been completed immediately with the very onset of the first Sabbath of Creation, and the hidden light would not have been concealed in the first place.

אלא שהיה משמש והולך מאז ולעולם וכמו שמתבאר כ"ז בארפה בדברינו בספר הדע"ה ח"ב

Instead, it would have been in continual use from then forever, as is explained at length in our work *Drushei Olam HaTohu* part 2.

וכן גם אפי' אחר שקטא אדה"ר אלו שזכינו להלוחות הראשונות

Similarly, even after Adam's sin, had we merited to receive the first Tablets on which the Ten Commandments were inscribed,

הָיָה חוֹזֵר הָעוֹלָם לְתִקּוּנוֹ ג"כ מֵאִז ע"י מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ ע"ה

the world would also have been restored to its rectified state from then on by Moshe our teacher, peace be upon him,

וְהָיָה מְאִיר וּמִתְגַּלֶּה הָאוֹר הַגָּנוּז מֵאִז כְּמוֹ שִׁיְהִיָּה בְּתִקּוּן הָאַחֲרוֹן

and the hidden light would have shone out and been revealed from then on, as will be when the final Tikun is accomplished.

וְהָרִי גָרַם הַחֵטָא כָּל אַרְיכוֹת הַזְּמַן וְכָל הַקְּלָקוּלִים וְהָרִיסוֹת
הַגְּדוֹלוֹת

But that sin caused the prolonged period of time and all the great damage and destruction

וְהַתְּלָאוֹת הַנוֹרָאוֹת הַנֶּעֱשְׂוֹת בְּעוֹלָם מֵעַתַּת מִתּוֹן חוֹרָה עַד בִּיאַת
הַמָּשִׁיחַ

and the terrible suffering done in this world from the time of the giving of the Torah until the advent of Mashiach.

כִּי אֲלוּלָא הַחֵטָא הָיָה כָּל הַתִּקּוּנִים אֲשֶׁר עוֹמְדִים עָתָה לְהַעֲשׂוֹת רַק
לְעַתִּיד

For were it not for that sin, all of the Tikunim that now remain to be accomplished only in the future

הִנֵּה הָיוּ נֶעֱשִׂים כָּלָם מִכֶּבֶר שֶׁהוּא מֵאִז וּמִקֶּדֶם:

would all already have been completed a long time ago, from that primordial era.

עַנְיָן הַשֵּׁנִי הוּא כִּי הֵגַם שְׁאִמְרָנוּ שְׁכָל הַצָּרוֹת וְהַעֲנָשִׁים

2) The second reason is that even though we said that all the suffering and punishments –

אֲשֶׁר הֵן בַּעוֹה"ז וְהֵן לְאַחֵר מִיְתָה הֵנָּה הֵם כָּלָם תִּקּוּנִים שִׁיתְקוּ
עִי"ז גַּם נֶפֶשׁ הַחוּטָא

both those in this world and after death, are all Tikunim through which the soul of a sinner will also be rectified –

אֲפִי בְּחֻטָּאִים וְעוֹנוֹת הַיּוֹתֵר גְּדוֹלִים וְלֹא יֵאבֵד שׁוּם נֶפֶשׁ אַחַת
מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל

even for the greatest sins and transgressions, and not a single Jewish soul will be lost.

כִּי עַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר שְׁמוּאֵל ב' י"ד וְלֹא יִשָּׂא אֱלֹהִים נֶפֶשׁ

Regarding this the verse states in II Samuel 14:14 "God spares no one..."

(ר"ל שמשלם לכ"א כמפעלו בעוה"ז או לאחר מיתה)

(meaning to say, each person will be repaid according to their deeds, either in this world or after death)

וְחֹשֵׁב מַחְשָׁבוֹת לְבִלְתִּי יָדַח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח

and the verse continues: "making calculations so that no one will be banished from Him."

עכ"ז הנה עקר יסוד המעמיד אותם כל אותו הזמן

Nevertheless, the fundamental principle that maintains them throughout that period,

אשר הם מתתקנים והולכים ע"י הענשים ומתקיימים כל אותו הזמן

during which they are continually rectified by way of punishments, and they nevertheless survive throughout that time,

הנה הוא רק ע"י המעשים טובים של צדיקים אשר ישנם בכל דור דור עכ"פ

is solely because of the good deeds of the righteous *tsaddikim* of each generation.

וכמ"ש סנהדרין צ"ז ב' לא פחות עלמא מתלתין ושתא צדיקי דמקבלי אפי שכינה בכל דרא

As Tractate Sanhedrin 97b states: there are no less than 36 righteous *tsaddikim* in every generation who receive the Divine Presence.

עוד שם דרא דקמי קודשא בריך הוא תמני סרי אלפי כו'

It states further that 18 thousand in a generation stand before the blessed Holy One,

ובחלין צ"ב א' ואפרה לי בחמשה עשר כסף וחמר שערים ולתך שערים

and in Tractate Chulin 92a on the verse (Hosea 3:2) "So I acquired her for myself for fifteen pieces of silver and a measure and a half of barley..."

אלו מ"ה צדיקים שהעולם מתקים בהם שלשים בארץ ישראל וט"ו בחו"ל

– these are the 45 *tsaddikim* upon whom the world is sustained, thirty in the land of Israel and fifteen (the half measure) in the Diaspora.

ובמדך במדבר רבא פ"ג שאין ישראל חסרים לעולם

Midrash Bamidbar Rabba ch. 3 states that among the Jewish people there are never less

מג' צדיקים כאברהם יצחק ויעקב וכן כחנניה מישאל ועזריה

than three tsaddikim like Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, and Chananya, Mishael and Azaryah.

ואמרו שם כי נמצאו לעולם בישראל צדיקים ישרים חסידים בני תורה

The Sages state there that there are always tsaddikim, upright and pious people and Torah scholars among the Jewish People,

אפלו סוריהו (הקוצים שבהם) גומלי חסד אנו

and that even the dropouts (the 'thorns' among them) are benevolent.

והרי לנו כי אלולא הצדיקים לא היה מתקיים העולם כלל

From this we conclude that were it not for the tsaddikim the world would not survive at all.

ונמצא כי כל קיומם של הרשעים כל עת הצרוף והלבון שלהם

So it turns out that the continued survival of wicked people, throughout their period of decontamination and purification –

שהוא כל משך זמן שהם מתתקנים והולכים ע"י הענשים

which is the entire period during which they continue to be rectified through punishments –

הנה הוא רק ע"י המעשים טובים של צדיקים

their continued survival is due only to the good deeds of tsaddikim

שבהם מתקיים העולם ונעשה ע"ז תקון להרשעים ג"כ

through whom the world continues to exist, and this also brings about the rectification of the wicked.

אבל אלולא המעשים טובים של צדיקים היה מתבטל העולם מכל וכל

But were it not for the good deeds of tsaddikim the entire world would be completely destroyed.

והרי נעשית כל אפשרית תקונם של הרשעים רק ע"י הצדיקים
דוקא

Thus all possible rectifications of the wicked come about through the tsaddik.

וְלָכֵן הוּא כִּי גַם אַחֵר שֶׁנִּגְמַר תְּקוּנָם ג"כ הֵנָּה יְהִי לְעוֹלָם רַק
טַפְּלִים לְצַדִּיקִים

And therefore, even after their rectification, they are always subordinate to tsaddikim.

שֶׁצַדִּיקִים הֵם הָעֶקֶר לְעוֹלָם וְהַרְשָׁעִים שֶׁנִּתְקְנוּ הֵם טַפְּלִים לָהֶם
וּכְלוּלִים עִמָּהֶם

For the tsaddikim are always the primary factor, and the wicked who have been rectified are subordinate to them and are included with them,

כִּי רַק הַצַּדִּיקִים הֶעָמִידוּ אוֹתָם

since the tsaddikim were the ones who set them right.

וְהָרִי יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בְּהִיעוּדִים דְּלַעֲתִיד בְּכֹל הַזֵּיו וְהַזֹּהָר וְהַעֲנָג
וְהַנֶּעֱם

Hence there is a great difference between the promises for the future – in terms of the radiance and the luminosity and the delight and pleasantness

אֲשֶׁר לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

that will accrue in the Messianic era and the World to come –

בֵּין הַמַּתְגַּלִּים וְנִמְשָׁכִים ע"י הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים דֶּהַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה

between that which is revealed and drawn down by means of the good deeds deriving from Torah and mitzvot,

לְבֵין הַמַּתְגַּלִּים וְנִמְשָׁכִים ע"י גְּלוּי הַגְּבוּרוֹת שֶׁהֵם הַסְּבוֹת דֶּהָעֲנָשִׁים

and that which is revealed and drawn down by way of the disclosure of the *gevurot* that are the cause of the punishments

הַיּוֹצְאִים מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה

that emerge from the judgments of the Torah and its commandments,

וְהֵגֶם שֶׁיִּכְלְלוּ זֶה בָּזֶה וַיַּעֲשׂוּ כֻלָּם לְאַחַד בְּסוֹד הָעוֹה"ב

even though they will merge one into the other and become one in the mystery of the World to Come.

אֲךָ הַיְסוֹד וְהַמַּעֲמִיד וְהַמְּקוֹר וְהַמַּעֲיֵן הוּא לְעוֹלָם הַצַּדִּיקִים
שֶׁבְּתַחֲלָה שֶׁהֵם הַצַּדִּיקִים גְּמוּרִים

However, the foundation and the pillar and the source and the spring are always those who were tsaddikim from the outset, for they are complete tsaddikim whereas those who become tsaddikim are dependent upon the former.

עַנְיָן הֵג' הוּא כִּי הָרִי כָּל הָרָעוֹת וְהַתְּלָאוֹת וְהָעֲנָשִׁים כֻּלָּם

3) The third reason is that all the evil and the suffering and the punishments

אֲשֶׁר הוּא בְּעוֹלָם הַנִּפְשׁוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְאַחַר מִיתָה

that take place in this world and in the world of souls after death,

הֵנָּה הֵם רַק בְּסוּד הַסֵּתֶר פָּנִים שְׂמֻצְמָצִם וּמַעֲלִים אוֹרוֹ וּקְדֻשָּׁתוֹ
יִת"ש

partake of the mystical secret of 'the hidden presence' of God, who constricts
and conceals His blessed light and holiness,

וּכְמ"ש תְּהִלִּים ה' כִּי לֹא אֵל חַפֵּץ רָשָׁע אֶתָּה לֹא יִגְרָךְ רַע

as it states in Psalms 5:5 "For You are not a God who desires wickedness, no
evil resides with You."

וְכֵן אֵיכָה ג' כִּי לֹא עָנָה מִלְּבוֹ כִּי אֵין הַקֵּב"ה חַפֵּץ לְחַיֵּיב שׁוֹם בְּרִיָּה
וּלְיִסֵּר אוֹתוֹ

Similarly, in Lamentations 3:33: "For He does not torment capriciously..." –
for the blessed Holy One does not wish to find any creature guilty and torment
them.

וּכְמ"ש ג' כִּי יִחְזַק אֱלֹהִים כִּי לֹא אֶחָפֵץ בְּמוֹת הַמֵּת

And as is also written in Ezekiel 18:32 "I do not desire the death of those who
should die..."

וְחַפְצוֹ הוּא תָּמִיד לְהַצְדִּיק אֶת בְּרִיּוֹתָיו וּלְהִיטִיב לָהֶם הוּא בָּזָה וְהוּא
בְּבֹא

Rather, His desire is always to justify His creatures and do good for them, both
in this world and the next,

כִּי הוּא יִת"ש מְשִׁתַּעֲשֶׂע תָּמִיד בַּצְדִּיקִים שֶׁבִּגְן עֵדֶן כְּנוֹדָע

because He, may His Name be blessed, always delights in the tsaddikim in Gan
Eden, as is known.

וְמָה שֶׁיִּסָּד אֶת מַצִּיאוֹת כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים הָרִי הוּא ג' כִּי רַק כְּדִי לְתַקְנָם
כְּנ"ל

And the fact that He established all the punishments is only for the purpose of
rectifying them, as explained above.

וְלָכֵן חַפְצוֹ וְרָצוֹנוֹ יִת"ש הוּא רַק בְּמַעֲשֵׂה הַצְדִּיקִים וְכְדִי לְהִטִּיב
לָהֶם לְאַחַר מִיתָה ג' כ

Therefore, His blessed desire and will is only the actions of tsaddikim, in order
to benefit them after death as well,

בְּכָל הָעֲנוּגִים וְהַעֲדוּנִים שֶׁבָּגוּ עֵדֶן

by granting them **all the delights and spiritual pleasures of Gan Eden.**

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר הַמִּדְרָשׁ כִּי־נִיּוֹן דְּכַתִּיב וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב

This is what the Midrash cited earlier concludes: Since the verse (Genesis 1:4) states: "The Lord saw that the light was good,"

הָיָה בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶם שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים חָפֵץ וְאֵינוֹ חָפֵץ בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רָשָׁעִים

we know that **He desires the actions of the righteous, and does not desire the actions of the wicked.**

כִּי הֵגֵם שְׂגֵם הֵם יִתְקַנּוּ לְבִסּוּף ע"י כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים וַיִּזְכּוּ כָּלָם ע"ז
לְטוֹב הָעָתִיד

For although they too will be rectified in the end by way of punishments, and they will all merit the goodness of the future thereby,

אֲךָ הוּא ית"ש אֵינוֹ חָפֵצוֹ בְּהָעֲנָשִׁים כָּלָל וּלְעוֹלָם יִהְיוּ הַצַּדִּיקִים
הָעֶקֶר בְּזֶה כְּנִזְכָּר

He, may His Name be blessed, does not desire those punishments at all, and tsaddikim are always the main goal, as mentioned.

וְלָכוּ אָמַר הַכָּתוּב וּבַחֲרַתְּ בַּחַיִּים

And therefore the Torah declares, "You shall choose life."

וְכֵן נֶאֱמַר עַל כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה הַצַּדִּיקִים וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב

And so too it states – regarding the actions of tsaddikim – "The Lord saw that the light was good..." i.e. He desires first and foremost the actions of the righteous – Torah and mitzvot – that are compared to light, not the actions of the wicked, who are compared to darkness, even though they will eventually be rectified and will also become righteous.

Footnotes

1. E.g. *Sanhedrin* 54b, 60b, 66a; *Yevamot* 3b. [↩](#)

Chapter 9 — Why the matters of the world to come and the days of the mashiakh (messiah) are not mentioned in the Torah, as well as an explanation of the rectification of the neshamot (souls) of Israel in the world to come

ואחר כל הדברים הללו הנה יובן לנו עוד ענין אחד נעלם

After all the above, we also understand another esoteric matter

מה שנתחבטו בזה כמה קדושי עליון והוא מה שלא נזכר בתורה
מפרש מאומה

– a matter that a number of holy and distinguished scholars were puzzled by –
and that is the fact that it does not state explicitly in Torah anything

מכל עניני דימות המשיח וחי העולם הבא

regarding the Messianic era and the life of the World to Come!

וע' בספר כלי יקר בפ' בחקותי בפסוק והתהלכתי בתוכם

See the *Kli Yakar's* work in *parshat Bechukotai* on the verse (Leviticus 26:12)

"And I will walk among you."

שמביא שם מדברי גדולי עולם ז' תרוצים על זה ע"ש

There he offers seven answers from the words of the greatest thinkers

אמנם אחרון חביב מה שכתב בזה השל"ה בהקדמת תולדות אדם
בבית אחרון ע"ש

However – since 'the later the more cherished'¹ – the *Shelah*² also writes about
this in his 'Introduction to *Toldot Adam*' last section,

דברי פי חכם חן ושפתים ישק

and 'the words of a wise man win favor' (Ecclesiastes 10:12) and 'lips will kiss
his holy words (see Proverbs 24:26).

אך סוד הענין בזה הוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו כי הרי כל התורה כלה

But the mystical explanation of this matter is according to what we noted – that
the entire Torah

לפי גלויה ולבושה שהיא עתה לפנינו (ע' זוה"ק בהעלותך קנ"ב א'
וזוהר חדש פ' כי תבא)

as it is revealed clothed in garments before us at this time (see *Zohar*
Behalotecha 152a and *Zohar Chadash parshat Ki Tavo*) –

הָרִי אֵינוּ מִבְטִיחַ שׁוּם טוֹבָה וְשׁוּם שְׂכָר אֲלָא רַק לַעֲשׂוּיָהּ וּלְשִׁמְרָהּ
לְחֻקָּהּ וּלְדוֹרָשָׁהּ וּלְמִי שֶׁעוֹמֵד נֶאֱמָן בְּקִיּוּמָהּ

does not promise any good nor any reward other than for those who fulfill it
and keep it and examine it and expound it, and for those who remain faithful to
fulfilling it.

וְכָל גְּלוּיָהּ הוּא שְׁנֵדוֹן כ"א לְפִי מַעֲשָׂיו וְהַכֹּל בְּמִשְׁפָּט וְהַכֹּל בְּדִין

All revelations of Torah, in other words, novel insights or deep understanding and
intuitive awareness are judged according to each person's deeds, whether they are
worthy thereof or not, and everything is according to how they are assessed and
adjudicated.

אָמְנָם הַתְּקוּהָ הָעֵתִידִיָּה דְכָל חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל

However, the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for

שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַיְעוּדִים אַחֲרוֹנִים דִּימוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

– which are the final promises regarding the Messianic era and the life of the
World to Come –

הִנֵּה הֵם תְּלוּיִם בְּאַמֶּת רַק בְּבְרִית וְלֹא בְזִכּוֹת

in truth these are dependent only upon the Covenant and not upon merit.

וְהוּא בְרִית אֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל וְהַבְּרִית לֹא תוֹפֵר לַעוֹלָם

This is the Covenant that God made with the Patriarchs³ and with Israel

וְכֵן אוֹמֵר רַבֵּינוּ תָם (בַּתּוֹסַפֶּת שֶׁבֶת נ"ה א' דה"מ וּשְׁמוּאֵל)

And so says Rabeinu Tam (Tractate Shabbat 55a, Tosafot s.v. וּשְׁמוּאֵל)

דְּזִכּוֹת אֲבוֹת תָּמָה אֲבָל בְּרִית אֲבוֹת לֹא תָמָה

– that although the merit of the Patriarchs may have petered out, the Covenant
with the Patriarchs did not expire.

וְכֵן הוּא מִפְּרָשׁ בַּתּוֹרָה בְּסוּף קְלָלוֹת דִּתּוֹרַת כְּהֻנִּים

This is stated explicitly in Torah at the end of the curses in Leviticus:⁴

וְאִף גַּם זֹאת כִּי לֹא מֵאֲסִיתִים וְלֹא גְעֻלֹתִים לְכַלֶּתָם לְהַפֵּר בְּרִיתִי
אִתָּם כִּי אֲנִי ה' אֱלֹהֵיהֶם

"Nevertheless, I will not despise them, nor tire of them that I would destroy
them and break My Covenant with them, since I am God their Lord."

וְהָרִי מִפְּרָשׁ הַהִבְטָחָה עַל הַבְּרִית יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא תוֹפֵר אֶפִּי' בְּחֻטָּא
עב"ז רחמ"ל

Thus, regarding the oath of the Covenant with Israel, it is stated explicitly that it will not be broken, even with the sin of idolatry, Heaven have mercy upon us.

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁמִּפְרָשׁ שֵׁם בִּפְרָשָׁה עַל פִּגְרֵי גִלּוּלֵיכֶם

And as it states unambiguously in the same section (26:30), "upon the carcasses of your idols..." (Emphasis added).

וְאוֹתוֹ הַבְּרִית הַזֶּה הוּא גַם לְכָל יַחֲדִיד וְיַחֲדִיד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל בִּפְרָט וְכַמ"ש
הַגֵּר"א בִּפ' נֶצְבִים וְכַנ"ל בְּדַבְרֵינוּ פ"ה ע"ש

And this covenant is also with each and every individual Jew, not just with the community as a whole, as the GRA writes in *Parshat Nitzavim*, and as we mentioned above in chapter 5.

כִּי סוּד בְּרִית אָבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּאַרְנוֹ בַּכ"מ מִדְּבָרֵינוּ

For the mystical explanation of the Covenant with the Patriarchs and with Israel we explained in a number of places

כִּי הוּא בְּתַר"כ עֲמוּדֵי וְנִתְיבוֹת אוֹר הַנִּזְכָּר בְּתַפְלַת ר' נְחוּנְיָא בֶּן
הַקָּנָה וּבִמְסַכֶּת אֲצִילוֹת

is that it concerns the 620 pillars and channels of light mentioned in the prayer of Rabbi Nechunya ben HaKana, and in *Masechet Atzilut*⁵

What follows is a highly esoteric explanation of the origin of those pillars and channels of light.

וְהֵם בַּחוּרְתָּא דַּא"א הַמְּאִירִים מִחֻכְמָתָא עֲלָאָה סְתִימָאָה אוּרָא
דְּלֹא אֲתַפֵּס, רִישָׁא דְּאֵין

They are among the white hairs of the 'beard' of *Arich Anpin* that shine forth from the hidden *chochmah* above, from the *avira*⁶ that is not grasped, the head of *ayin* nothingness.

וְשֵׁם הוּא סוּד וְשֵׁרֶשׁ הַכֹּל וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּשִׁבִּיל יִשְׂרָאֵל
שֶׁנִּקְרָאוּ רֵאשִׁית

There is the mystical secret of the root of all, and therefore the Sages stated, '*Bereishit* – in the beginning' alludes to Israel, who are called '*reishit* – the first of His crops' (Jeremiah 2:3).

וְאָמְרוּ בַּב"ר ס"א סִימָן ד' מַחֲשַׁבְתָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל קִדְמָה לְכָל דָּבָר

The Sages in *Bereishit Rabba* 1:4 declare that the thought of Israel preceded everything,

כִּי הֵם תְּלוּיִם וּמִשְׁרָשִׁים בְּתַר"כ עֲמוּדֵי אוֹר שֶׁהוּא הַשֵּׁרֶשׁ גַּם לְכָל
הָאֲצִילוֹת כְּלוּ

because they are attached to, and are rooted in, the 620 pillars of light, which is also the root of the entire World of Atzilut.⁷

וְאֵינוֹ מַגִּיעַ שָׁם מַעֲשֵׂה הַתַּחְתּוֹנִים כָּלֵל וְשָׁם הוּא סוּד הַבְּרִית אָבוֹת
וְיִשְׂרָאֵל וְלָכֵן אֵי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁישְׁתַּנָּה

The actions of the lower creations do not have any effect there at all, and that is the secret of the Covenant with the Patriarchs and with Israel, and that is why it cannot change.

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין צ"ח א' אֵין בֶּן דָּוִד בָּא אֶלָּא בְּדוֹר שֶׁכֵּלּוֹ זָכָא
אוּ בְּדוֹר שֶׁכֵּלּוֹ חַיֵּב

This is also what the Sages said in Tractate Sanhedrin 98a: The descent of David i.e. the Mashiach/Messiah will only come to a generation that is either completely worthy, or to a generation that is completely unworthy.

וְע' בְּהֶגֶר"א בְּתַקְוִינִים תִּקְוִין ס"ט קכ"ו ע"א שֶׁאָמַר וַיְדַאֵי אִפֹּן הַשְּׁנִי

See GRA *Tikunim*, *Tikun* 69 p. 126a who speculates that this will certainly be the latter,

וּכְמ"ש בְּפ' שְׁמוֹת ז' ב' יִסְתַּכַּל מֵאֵן אֲנֹנוּ דְקִימִין כּו' וְלֹא יִשְׁתַּכַּח זָכָא
כו' ע"ש

as the Zohar states in Shemot 7b: He will examine those who are living then... and will not find one who is worthy... See there.

[However, the concept of 'completely unworthy' does not mean completely wicked, Heaven forbid, for that is impossible. It simply means that one whose sins are in the majority over their mitzvot is called unworthy, as Tractate Rosh HaShana 16-17 states.]

וְהָרִי לָנוּ דִּימוֹת הַמְּשִׁיחַ אֵינוֹ תָלוּי בְּזָכוֹת וּמַעֲשִׂים כָּלֵל

Thus we have it that the Messianic era does not depend on merit and good deeds at all.

וְכֹן שָׁם בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין צ"ז סע"ב בְּפִלּוּגְתָּא דר' אֱלִיעֶזֶר ור' יְהוֹשֻׁעַ

And so too in Tractate Sanhedrin 97b, in the argument between Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Yehoshua

וְאָמַר ר' יְהוֹשֻׁעַ חֲנָם נִמְכַּרְתֶּם וְלֹא בְכֶסֶף תִּגָּאֲלוּ לֹא בְּתִשְׁבּוּבָה
וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים

Rabbi Yehoshua said, quoting the verse (Isaiah 52:3): 'You were sold for nothing and not with silver will you be redeemed' – 'not with silver' means not with repentance and good deeds.

(There is a printing error in our version of the Talmud. The words of Rabbi Eliezer and the words of Rabbi Yehoshua got switched around, as is proved by the *Beraita* that follows 'The other one said...' as we stated it. The correct version is stated in the earlier *Beraita* there and as printed in the Talmud Yerushalmi *Taanit* 2b. See there).

וְשָׁקְלוּ וְטָרוּ בְּזֶה ר"א ור"י וּלְבַסּוֹף שָׁתַק ר"א כִּמוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר שָׁם

Rabbi Eliezer and Rabbi Yehoshua discuss the matter back and forth, until eventually Rabbi Eliezer fell silent, as explained there.

וְהָרִי הוֹדָה ר"א ג"כ לר"י שֶׁהִגְאֵלָה הָעֵתִידָה אִינוּ תָלוּי בַּתְּשׁוּבָה
וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים כָּלֵל

Hence Rabbi Eliezer acknowledged the correctness of Rabbi Yehoshua's view that the future redemption does not depend upon repentance and good deeds at all.

וְכוֹ כָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן בִּפ' הָאֲזִינוּ שֶׁהִבְטַחַת גְּאֻלָּה הָעֵתִידָה אִין בְּה
תְּנַאי בַּתְּשׁוּבָה וְעִבּוּדָה

So too Ramban writes in his commentary to *Ha'azinu* (Deuteronomy 32:40) that the promise of the future redemption is not conditioned upon repentance and proper service.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהִיא מִבְּטָח לְבוֹא עכ"פ ע"ש

Rather it is promised that it will take place in any event, see there.

וַיִּמָּה שֶׁנִּמְצָא בְּכַמָּה אֲגָדוֹת שֶׁתָּלוּי בַּתְּשׁוּבָה

The fact that we do find in a number of Rabbinic sources that this depends upon repentance,

הִנֵּה הוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין קי"א א'

this is as the Sages declared in Tractate Sanhedrin 111a –

כִּי אֶחָד מֵעִיר מְזַכֶּה כָּל הָעִיר כֻּלָּה וּשְׁנַיִם מִמִּשְׁפָּחָה מְזַכִּין כָּל
הַמִּשְׁפָּחָה כֻּלָּה

that even one in a city makes the whole city meritorious, and two in a family makes the entire family meritorious.

וְכֵן הוּא מִבְּאֵר בַּמִּדְרָשׁ הַנֶּעֱלָם בַּזֹּהַר חֲדָשׁ פ' נח סמוך לְסוּפּוֹ

And so too it states in *Midrash Ne'elam* in the *Zohar Chadash*, *Noach*, near the end of the section –

שֶׁאָמַר שָׁם ר' אֱלִיעֶזֶר בְּפֶרוּשׁ כִּי הֵגַם שֶׁהַכֹּל תָּלוּי בַּתְּשׁוּבָה

that Rabbi Eliezer said explicitly that even though everything depends upon them repenting,

אך אי יחזרו בתשובה אפי' חדא כנישתא בזכותם יתכנש כל
גלותא ע"ש

even if a single community repents the entire exile will be annulled in their merit. See there.

ובאמת הרי ישנם כמה צדיקים בכל דור ודור עכ"פ ל"ו צדיקי
דמקבלי אפי' שכינה

In truth, there are a number of righteous people *Tzadikim* in every generation, and at least 36 *Tzadikim* who receive the Divine Presence.

ובתקונים תקון כ"א נ"א' מבאר כי הם ע"ב ל"ו בארץ ישראל ל"ו בחו"ל ומשמע
(שם כי הם נסתרים כי הם במדרגת לב ע"ש)

(In the *Tikunim Tikunei Zohar Tikun 21 p. 57a* it is explained that there are 72: 36 in Israel, and 36 in the Diaspora. And it appears from there that they are hidden *Tzadikim*, for they are on the level of 'heart.' See there).

מ"ה צדיקים שבהם מתקיים העולם וכנ"ל פ"ח

Elsewhere it states that there are 45 *Tzadikim* through whom the world continues to exist, as we explained above chapter 8.

והרי אינו חסר העולם מכמה צדיקים בכל דור אשר בזכותם יבוא
הגאולה

Thus the world never lacks a number of *Tzadikim* in every generation, in whose merit the redemption will come

לכל ישראל כלם אפי' כשיהיו רבים חייב וכנ"ז

to the entire Jewish people, even if the majority are guilty of sins, as mentioned.

וכן מורה כמה פסוקים ביחזקאל ל"ו - ל"ז ומבאר שם במעט
בפרוש

A number of verses in Ezekiel chapters 36-37 also indicate this, almost explicitly,

שהגאולה האחרונה אינו תלוי בתשובה ומעשים טובים כלל והיא
בטוחה לבוא עכ"פ

that the final redemption is not dependent upon repentance and good deeds, and it is promised that it will take place, no matter what.

ומה גם כי הרי האיש לבוש הבדים שהוא המלאך גבריאל (ע' ב"ר
פ' כ"א סי' ה')

And particularly since 'the man... clothed in linen' (see Ezekiel 9:2), who is the angel Gabriel (see *Bereishit Rabba 21:5*),

בָּא בַשְּׁבוּעָה בְּחַי הָעוֹלָם כִּי לְמוֹעֵד מוֹעֲדִים וְחָצִי כּו' וּכְמ"ש בְּדִנְיָאֵל
י"ב

came and swore by the Life of the World that after an era, an era and a half the redemption would arrive, as it states in Daniel 12:7.

וְאִם שְׁהִיָּה קֶץ הַגְּאֻלָּה תְּלוּי בַתְּשׁוּבָה הָרִי לֹא שִׁינְךָ שְׁבוּעָה עַל זֶה כִּי
תְּשׁוּבָה תְּלוּי בַבְּחִירָה

Now if the final redemption depended upon repentance, an oath would not be relevant, since repentance depends upon choice.

וְהוּא בְּאֵמַת הָרֹאֶה אַחֲרֶנָּה שֶׁמֵּבִיא ר' יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְדַבְּרוֹ וְהוּא רֹאֶה
שֶׁאֵין עָלֶיהָ תְּשׁוּבָה

And this is indeed the last proof that Rabbi Yehoshua brings for his view, a proof to which there can be no response.

וְכֹן נֶאֱמַר ג"כ חֲבִקוּק ב' וְיָפֶחַ לִקְצֹ וְלֹא יִכָּזֵב אִם יִתְמַהֲמָה חֲכָה לוֹ
כִּי בֹא יָבֵא לֹא יֵאָחֵר

And so too it states in Habbakuk 2:3 "...it will speak of the End and it will not deceive. Though it may tarry, await it, for it will surely come; it will not delay."

וְמָה שֶׁאֱמַר לֹא יִכָּזֵב וְלֹא יֵאָחֵר הַכּוֹנֵן מִבְּאֵר שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה שׁוּם עֲכֹב
בְּדַבָּר

When it states that 'it will not deceive' and 'it will not delay' this means that it will not be withheld –

וְכִשְׁיִגִּיעַ עֵת הַקֶּץ הִנֵּה יָבֵא עַכ"פ בֵּין אִם יִהְיוּ זָכָאִי אוֹ חֲטָיִם

when the End-time comes it will come in any event, whether they are worthy or unworthy.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ מִכ"ז כִּי הַגְּאֻלָּה הָעֲתִידָה אֵינוֹ תְּלוּי בְּזָכוֹת וּמַעֲשִׂים כָּלֵל.

So we derive from all this that the future redemption does not depend upon merit and good deeds at all.

וְכֹן גַּם בְּעֲנֵנוּ חַיֵּי עוֹלָם הֵבֵא הָרִי אָמְרוּ ג"כ סְנֵהֲדִרִין ק"ד סע"ב

And also as regards the life of the World to Come, in Tractate Sanhedrin 104b our Sages declared

דֹּרְשֵׁי רְשׁוּמוֹת הָיוּ אוֹמְרִים כֵּלָּן בָּאִין לַעוֹה"ב

'interpreters of the verses'⁸ would say that everyone will enter the World to Come,

שְׁגַם דּוֹאֵג הָאֶדוֹמִי וְאַחִיתּוֹפֶל וְיֶרָבָעַם בֶּן נֶבֶט וְאַחָאָב וּמִנְשֶׁה וְגֵיחָזִי
כֻּלָּם בָּאִים לְעוֹה"ב

even Do'eg haEdomi, Achitofel, Yeravam ben Nevat, Achav, Menashe and
Geichazi, unrepentant sinners all of them, nevertheless, **all of them will enter the
World to Come.**

וְכֹן אָמְרוּ בִּפְסִיקְתָּא רַבְתִּי פְסָקָא א' וּבִירוּשְׁלָמִי כֻּלָּאִים פ' ט
וּכְתוּבוֹת פ' י"ב הֵלְכָה ג'

And similarly it is stated in the *Pesikta Rabbati* 1, and in the Talmud Yerushalmi
Kila'im 9 and *Ketubot* 12:3

שְׁגַם יֶרָבָעַם בֶּן נֶבֶט וְחֻבְרִיו כֻּלָּם יִזְכּוּ לְתַחֲיִית הַמֵּתִים

that even Yeravam ben Nevat and his cronies will all merit the Resurrection of
the Dead.

שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁם עַל הַפָּסוּק נוֹתֵן נִשְׁמָה לָעָם עָלֶיהָ (יִשְׁעִיָּה מ"ב)

They said there, on the verses (Isaiah 42:5), "[God] who gave a soul to the
people upon it,"

וְנָתַתִּי רוּחִי בָכֶם וְחִיִּיתֶם (יְחֶזְקֵאל ל"ז)

and "I have given My spirit to you and have brought you to life" (Ezekiel
37:14):

ר' בְּרַכְיָה שָׁאֵל לֵר' חֶלְבּוֹ ר' חֶלְבּוֹ שָׁאֵל לֵר' אַמִּי ר' אַמִּי שָׁאֵל לֵר'
אֶלְעָזָר ר' אֶלְעָזָר שָׁאֵל לֵר' חֲנִינָא וְאִית דְּאִמְרִין ר' חֲנִינָא שָׁאֵל לֵר'
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֶּן לֵוִי

Rabbi Berachya asked Rabbi Chelbo, and Rabbi Chelbo asked Rabbi Ami, and
Rabbi Ami asked Rabbi Elazar, and Rabbi Elazar asked Rabbi Chanina, and
some say that Rabbi Chanina asked Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi:

אֲפִי כְּגוֹן יֶרָבָעַם בֶּן נֶבֶט וְחֻבְרִיו

Even the likes of Yeravam ben Nevat and his cronies?

אָמַר לֵיהּ גְּפָרִית וּמִלַּח שְׂרָפָה כָּל אֶרֶצָה כו' כִּיּוֹן שֶׁנִּשְׂרָפָה א"י נַעֲשֶׂה
בֵּהֶן מִדַּת הַדִּין

He responded, citing the verse (Deuteronomy 29:22) warning about the dire
consequences of disobeying the Torah: "Sulphur and salt, a conflagration
throughout the Land..." – once it has been burned down, I know that justice
has already been done,

שֶׁכֶּבֶד קִבְּלוּ דִּינָם וַיִּזְכּוּ גַם הֵם לְתַחֲיִית הַמֵּתִים

because they received their penalty and they too will therefore merit the Resurrection of the Dead.

וְהָיָה לָנוּ מִכֵּן שֶׁלֹּא יַעֲכֹב שׁוּם חֵטָא וְעוֹן לֹא לִימּוֹת הַמָּשִׁיחַ וְלֹא לַתַּחֲיַת הַמֵּתִים וְלֹא לַחַיֵּי עוֹלָם הַבָּא

Thus we have it from all this analysis that no sin or transgression can cause the Messianic era, the Resurrection of the Dead, or life in the World to come to be withheld.

וְהוּא ע"פ סוּד הַדְּבָרִים שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לַעֲלֵל פ' ה' ו' ז' ח' כִּי גַם כָּל הָעֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר לְאַחַר מִיתָה

And this is according to the mystical truth we mentioned earlier in chapters 5, 6, 7, 8 that all of the punishments after death

הֵנָּה הֵם כָּלֵם תְּקוּנִים וּפְעוּלוֹת שֶׁיִּזְכּוּ עַל יְדֵיהֶם כָּל נֶפֶשׁ הַחוּטָא ג"כ לְכָל תְּקוּת חֲמַדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל

are all rectifications and activities by which every soul, even a sinful one, will be worthy of the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for.

וּמִי שֶׁלֹּא זָכָה לָבוֹא בְּשִׁכְרוֹ ע"י הַמַּעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים דִּהַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה

And those who were not worthy of reward for their good deeds and Torah and mitzvot

הֵנָּה הוּא יִתְקַן ג"כ עכ"פ ע"י הָעֲנָשִׁים דִּהַז' מְדוּרֵי גֵיהֶנֶם

will also be rectified – at least by way of the punishments of the seven levels of Gehinnom

הַיּוֹצְאִים וְנִמְשָׁכִים מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה וְכֵן לְכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ עֵין עֲלֵיהֶם

that derive from, and are drawn down by, the laws of the Torah and the mitzvot, as explained above. Analyze them carefully.

אָךְ עכ"פ הוּא כִּי לֹא יֵאבֹד שׁוּם נֶפֶשׁ אַחַת מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בַּגְמָרָא עִירובִין כ"א סע"א

But in any event not a single Jewish soul will be lost, as the Gemara *Eruvin* 21a states:

דְּרִישׁ מְרִי בַר מַר מֵאִי דְכְּתִיב וְהֵנָּה שְׁנֵי דִּידָאֵי תֵּאֲנִים מוֹעֲדִים לִפְנֵי הַיֵּכָל ה'

Rabbi Mari bar Mar taught: What is the meaning of the verse (Jeremiah 24:1-2) "God showed me [a vision] in which there were two baskets of figs, prepared before the Sanctuary of God...

הַדּוּד הָאֶחָד תְּאֵנִים טְבוֹת מְאֹד כְּתָאֵר הַבְּכֻרוֹת וְהַדּוּד אֶחָד תְּאֵנִים רְעוֹת מְאֹד אֲשֶׁר לֹא תֵאכְלָנָה מֵרַע.

One basket had very good figs, like the figs that ripen early. And one basket had very bad figs, so bad they were inedible."

תְּאֵנִים הַטּוֹבוֹת אֵלּוּ צְדִיקִים גְּמוּרִים תְּאֵנִים הָרְעוֹת אֵלּוּ רָשָׁעִים גְּמוּרִים

Rabbi Mari bar Mar then offered this interpretation: **the good figs represent the truly righteous, and the bad figs represent the thoroughly wicked.**

וְשָׁמָּה תֹאמַר אֲבִד סִבְרָם וּבָטַל סִכּוּיָם ת"ל הַדּוּדָאִים נִתְּנוּ רִיחַ

Perhaps you will say that the latter's prospects are lost, and their hopes are annulled? Therefore the verse (Song of Songs 7:14) teaches "the mandrakes give forth their scent." The word for mandrakes here is *dudaim*, the same word as the plural for baskets in the verse in Jeremiah, hinting that both baskets of figs will give forth a pleasant scent, as he goes on to state explicitly:

אֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ עֲתִידִין שְׂיִתְּנוּ רִיחַ וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין ל"ז א' וַיֵּרַח אֶת רִיחַ בְּגָדָיו. אֵל תִּקְרִי בְּגָדָיו אֶלָּא בּוֹגְדָיו

These and those – the good and the bad – will in the future give forth their scent. And so too it was stated in Tractate Sanhedrin 37a on the verse (Genesis 27:27) "And he Isaac smelled the fragrance of his garments" – the garments that Jacob was wearing, while pretending to be Esau. The Gemara interprets **do not read it as begadav – his garments – but bogdav – his deception.** Isaac sensed that the person before him was not Esau but Jacob, and he nevertheless blessed him.

וְהֵגַם שְׂפִשְׁטוֹת הַדְּבָרִים הוּא מְשׁוּם שֶׁגַם פּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מְלֵאִים מִצְוֹת כְּרָמוֹן

Now although the simple sense of this is that even Jewish sinners are as full of mitzvot as a pomegranate is full of seeds,

אֲךָ עֲמֹק כְּוִנְתָּם ז"ל הוּא בְּסוּד מִי יִתֵּן טְהוֹר מִטָּמֵא שְׂאֲמָרְנוּ לְעִיל פ"ו

but the depth of the Sages intention is the secret of the verse in Job 14:4, "Who can produce purity from impurity?" as we explained above chapter 6.

וְהִירֵי עכ"פ כִּי יִזְכּוּ כָּלֵם לְכָל תִּקְוַת חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל הָעֶתִיד.

In any event, we have it that all of them will merit the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for.

וְלָכֵן לֹא נִזְכָּר בַּתּוֹרָה מִפְּרָשׁ מְכַל הַיְעוּדִים הָעֶתִידִים הַנִּצְחִיִּים

And this is why the Torah does not mention explicitly any of the eternal promises that will take place in the future,

כי כל התורה לפי גלויה ולבושה שהיא עתה לפנינו הרי נדון כ"א
רק לפי מעשיו

for according to the entire Torah before us in its current state of revelation and the garment it is clothed in, every person is judged by their deeds,

וכ"א הוא בא בשכרו ונאמר בה כרת ואבדון להמודים ופושעים
and each person receives their payback as stated – excision and removal⁹ for the renegades and deliberate sinners.

אך לימות המשיח וחי העוה"ב הרי אין כרת ואבדון כלל
But in the Messianic era and life in the World to Come there is no excision or removal at all,

שהרי גם ירבעם בן נבט אשר חטא והחטיא את הרבים בחטא
עבו"ז החמורה כמה וכמה שנים,

for even Yeravam ben Nevat who sinned and caused multitudes to sin – the sin of idolatry, the most serious of all – and for many years,

ומנשה שהעמיד צלם בהיכל ודואג האדומי שהרג נוב עיר הכהנים
and Menashe who set up an idol in the Sanctuary, and Do'eg the Edomite who put Nov, the city of priests, to death,

גם הם יתקנו ויזכו לתחיית המתים ולחי העוה"ב כנז'
even they will be rectified and will merit the Resurrection of the Dead and life in the World to Come.

וכן עד"ז כל המודים ופושעי ישראל כלם והגם שהרי הוא לכאורה
נגד דיני התורה ומשפטה וענשה

And the same applies to all those who are renegades and deliberate sinners, even though this seems to contradict the laws and judgments of the Torah and her punishments.

וכמו שראינו מאנשי כנה"ג שעלו בדעתם לדחות אותם כלם
And as we saw with the Men of the Great Assembly, who thought to reject all of them those mentioned in the Talmud**¹⁰** and rule that they could not be redeemed, but their opinion was overruled.

וכן רצו למנות את שלמה ג"כ ע"פ דיני התורה ומשפטה
And they the Men of the Great Assembly also wanted to count Shlomo (King Solomon) among those who do not have a portion in the World to come, since some

of his wives caused him to veer off in the wrong direction.¹¹

אָמַנְם הִנֵּה יֵצֵא בֵּת קוֹל מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאָמַר לָהֶם הַמַּעֲמֶמְךָ יִשְׁלַמְנָה
כו'

But a Heavenly voice said to them, regarding the reward or punishment for a person's deeds "is that your prerogative? No, it is Mine!"¹²

וְהוֹדִיעָם בְּזֶה כִּי כָּל פֶּסֶק וְדִין הַנוֹגֵעַ לַחַיִּי הָעוֹה"ב הוּא תָּלוּי בְּכַבְּשִׁי
דְּרַחֲמָנָא

He informed them that any ruling or verdict regarding life in the World to Come depends upon the Merciful One,

וְאִין לְבֵית דִּין שֶׁל מַטָּה לַעֲשׂוֹת בְּזֶה פְּסָקִים וְדִינִים כָּלֵל

and the Rabbinical Court down below in our world may not make rulings or verdicts in this regard.

וְלָכוּ מִבֵּיא הַגְּמָרָא שֶׁם תִּכְרֶה דְּבָרֵי דוֹרְשֵׁי רְשׁוּמוֹת שְׂכָלָן בְּאִין
לְעוֹה"ב

This is why the Gemara there immediately brings the words of the 'interpreters of the verses' that everyone will enter the World to Come.

וְכֵן הוּא בִּירוּשְׁלָמִי סְנֵהֲדִין פ"י סוֹף הֶלְכָּה ב'

The same view is expressed in the Talmud Yerushalmi, *Sanhedrin* 10:2

שֶׁהֵבֵת קוֹל יֵצֵא עַל כָּל אֵלוּ שֶׁנִּמְנָנוּ שֶׁם בְּמִשְׁנָה וְהָיָה הַהִקְפָּדָה עַל
כָּלָן ע"ש

– that the Heavenly Voice was in regard to all those mentioned in the Mishnah, and was emphatically including all of them. See there.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ כִּי רָצוֹן הָעֲלִיּוֹן גָּלָה לָהֶם שֶׁלֹּא יִדְחוּ שׁוּם אֶחָד מֵהֶם וְכָלָן
בְּאִין לְעוֹה"ב

Thus we have it that the Divine Will revealed to them that none of them would be rejected, and all of them would enter the World to Come.

וְהִגַּם שֶׁהוּא נֶגֶד דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה וּמִשְׁפָּטָה אַךְ עַל זֶה הִנֵּה הוּא ית"ש
גָּדוֹל הָעֶצְמָה וְרַב הָעֲלִילָה

And even though this seems to contradict the strict laws and judgments of the Torah, nevertheless, He, may He be blessed, is "great in counsel and mighty in deed" as the verse (Jeremiah 32:19) states.

וַיֵּשׁ לוֹ עֲצוֹת וּפְעֻלוֹת וְסִבּוּבִים מְסֻבּוּבִים שׁוֹנִים שֶׁלֹּא לָזוּז מִהַתּוֹרָה
שׁוּם זִיז כָּל שֶׁהוּא

This means that **He has the counsel and the deeds and roundabout means by which to avoid deviating from the Torah even one iota,**

וְשֵׁלָא לְוֹתֵר מֵאַמָּה וּבִאֲפֹן שְׁהַעוֹשָׁה עֲבֵרָה נִשְׁאַר וְהַעֲנֵשׁ נִפְרָע

without compromising at all, so that the perpetrator of the sin will remain alive and the sin will be paid for.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה עֲצָמָה שְׂיִזְכָּה עַכ"פ לְכָל תִּקּוּת
חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלוּ

And yet everything will be done according to the laws of the Torah itself – so that in any event the individual will merit the hoped for future that all of Israel yearns for.

וְהוּא הַנְּהַגַת מִדּוֹתָיו ית"ש וְרַב חֶסֶד וְאַמֶּת שְׁמִיּוֹשֵׁר אֶת הַכֹּל
בְּתִקּוּנִים מִתִּקּוּנִים שׁוֹנִים הַכֹּל מִהַתּוֹרָה עֲצָמָה

This then is the way the attributes of "abundant kindness" and "truth" operate in harmony to straighten everything out and rectify matters in different ways, and all according to Torah itself.

וּכ"ז הוּא בְּאַמֶּת רַק מִכַּבְּשֵׁי דִרְחֻמָּנָא

And all of this is in truth only from the Merciful One Himself

כְּדֵי לָקִים אֶת הַבְּרִית אֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִתְנַהֵג עִמָּהֶם בְּהִ"ג מִדּוֹת
הַרְחָמִים

in order to fulfill the Covenant He made with the Patriarch and with Israel, towards whom He acts with the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy

שְׁנִקְרָאִים כָּל טוֹבֵי

that are called 'all of My goodness.'¹³

וְהַנְּהַגָּה הַזֶּה בְּכָל דִּרְכֶּיהָ הוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל בְּרִיָּה

This conduct, and the paths by which it travels, is hidden from every created being.

אֲמָנָם הוּא הֵנָּה הֵגֶם שְׁדִרְכֵי הַנְּהַגָּה הַזֹּאת בְּפִרְטוֹת הַמִּתְנַהֵּג עִם
כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד (בְּזֶה וּבִבְּאֵ)

Indeed, the manner in which each individual is treated specifically, in this world and the next,

בְּדִרְכִּים מִדִּרְכִּים שׁוֹנִים הֵנָּה הִיא נֶעְלָמָה מֵעֵינֵי כָל חַי וְלֹא יֵית"ש
לְבַד נִתְכַּנּוּ עֲלֵילוֹת

in all the different types of ways, is hidden from the eyes of every living being, and He alone 'accounts for the deeds' of man (see I Samuel 2:3).

אָמַנְם בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלֵל הִנֵּה הִיא נִרְאָה קִצֵּת לְעֵינֵינוּ ג"כ

But in a general sense we can also get a glimpse with our own eyes

אִיךְ שְׁנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל בַּמִּשְׁפָּט וְהַכֹּל בְּדִין וּמִתְקִים מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

how everything is done according to the statute and the law, and all the statutes of the Torah are fulfilled –

בְּדַנֵּי כְּרִיתוֹת וְאַבְדּוֹן לְהַמְחִיבִים בָּהּ

with respect to the laws of excision and loss to those who are culpable,

עַד שֶׁכַּמֵּעַט כָּבֵר נִפְרַע מֵהֶם דֵּינָם

to the extent that their sentence has almost been carried out fully,

גַּם בַּעוֹה"ז ע"פ דְּרָכֵי הַתּוֹרָה ג"כ

even in this world, according to the ways of Torah as well.

וְהוּא כָּל הַרְעוֹת וְהַתְּלָאוֹת הַגְּדוֹלוֹת וְהַנּוֹרָאוֹת שֶׁמִּתְחַלְּפִים
וְעוֹבְרִים עַל כָּלֵל יִשְׂרָאֵל

And this is via all the bad things that happen and the great and terrible suffering that passes over the Jewish Community,

מֵעַנּוּי וּמֵעַנֵּי וּמִחֲלָאִים רָעִים וְנֶאֱמָנִים וּמִכָּל פְּחָדִים הַבָּאִים מִדָּבָר
וְחֶרֶב וְשָׁבִי וּבִזָּה

including torment, poverty, terrible illnesses and all the fears that arise from plagues and wars and being taken captive and pillaging.

וּכְבָּר אָמְרוּ מִכּוֹת כ"ג א' כָּל חִיבֵי כְּרִיתוֹת שֶׁלְקוּ נִפְטְרוּ יְדֵי כְּרִיתָתָם

As the Sages already declared in Tractate Makkot 23a: All those culpable of sins that are punishable by excision, but suffered lashes, are exempt from excision.

וּבִפְרָט בְּהַכָּאָה שֶׁאֵין לָהּ קֶצֶף הָרִי הוּא חֲמוֹר מִמִּיתָה כַּמ"ש
כְּתוּבוֹת ל"ג רע"ב

And this is particularly so regarding beatings that have no established limits; these are worse than death, as Tractate Ketubot 33b states.

וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁם עוֹד נ"א ע"ב שְׁבוּיֵי מַלְכוּת הָרִי הֵן כְּשִׁבוּיִן

They also said there Ketubot 51b that political prisoners are regarded as captives,

וְשָׁבִי קָשָׁה מִכָּלִם מָמוֹת וּמִחֶרֶב וּמִרָעָב דְּכוּלָּהוּ אֵיתְנָהוּ בָּהּ כַּמ"ש
בָּבָא בִּתְרָא ח' ב'

and being taken captive is the most devastating of all, more than death, war and famine, because it has elements of all of them, as the Sages write in Bava Batra

8b.

וְאָמְרוּ עוֹד בְּמִכּוֹת כ"ב כ"ג וְנִקְלָה אַחִיךָ לְעֵינֶיךָ כִּיֹּן שְׁנִקְלָה הָרִי
הוא בְּאַחִיךָ

The Sages also said (Makkot 22-23) on the verse (Deuteronomy 25:3), "Lest your brother be dishonored in your eyes" – once he has been dishonored, he is like your brother.

וּבְסִנְהֶדְרִין מ"ה א' כִּי בְּזִיוְנוֹי הוּא קָשָׁה מִיִּסּוּרִים

In Tractate Sanhedrin 45a the Sages state: Humiliation is worse than torture.

וּכְבָּר דִּי בְּזִיוֹ וְקֶצֶף שְׁנִתּוֹנִים לְחִרְפָּה וּלְמָשָׁל וּלְשִׁנְיָנָה

It is already more than 'enough contempt and rage' (see Esther 1:18), when they are shamed, derided, and mocked (see Jeremiah 24:9).

וְהָרִי בְּכָל זֶה הִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה כָּל דִּין כְּרִיתוֹת וְדִין ד' מִיתוֹת ב"ד בְּכָל־
יִשְׂרָאֵל

Thus, with all of these things, the Jewish People as a whole have borne the sentence of excision, and the verdict of the four types of death meted out by the Rabbinical court.

וּכְבָּר נִפְרָעוּ וְנִפְטְרוּ מִכָּל וְכָל גַּם ע"פ מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

All of their sins have thus been fully paid for and they are no longer indebted at all, even according to the laws of the Torah.

וְאִם עָדִין נִשְׁאָר בְּאַחַד אֵיזָה חֲטָא וְשִׁמְץ דָּפִי

Now even if there remains for an individual some sin or smidgeon of a defect

הֲלֹא מִיתָה מְמַרְקֶת וְחִבּוּט הַקֶּבֶר וְעַנְשֵׁי גֵיהֶנּוֹם מְנַקִּין אוֹתוֹ

– doesn't death wipe it away, and decomposition in the grave and the punishments of Gehinom cleanse him of his sin?

וְלֹא נִשְׁאָר מַעֲתָה עַל שׁוּם אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל אֵיזָה חוֹב וְשִׁטְר פְּרָעוֹן
מִמִּשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה

And from now on, there does not remain for any Jew any debt or promissory note in terms of the laws of Torah

לְעֵכָב אוֹתוֹ מִתַּקְוָה הָעֲתִידָה וּע"י כ"ז הִנֵּה יִזְכּוּ כָּל־לְכָל תִּקְוָה
חֲמִדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל.

that could prevent him from what we all hope for in the future. By means of all this, everyone will merit what all Jews anticipate and yearn for.

וְהַעֲקָר הוּא כִּי גַם הַתּוֹרָה בְּכָל מִשְׁפָּטָהּ וְעֲנִשָּׁהּ אֵינוֹ נוֹתֵן יָאוֹשׁ כָּלֹל
לְשׁוֹם רָשָׁע וּפּוֹשֵׁעַ

The main point is that all the laws of the Torah and its punishments should not cause despair at all to a wicked person or a sinner

מִהַשְׁאַרְת הַנֶּצְחִי וְכַמ"ש בַּתּוֹרָה כִּהְנִים פ' אָמור כ"ג

regarding the eternal life of his soul, as it states in the Sifra¹⁴ on Leviticus**,
*Emor 23***

בַּפֶּסוּק וְהֶאֱבַדְתִּי אֶת הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִיא מִקֶּרֶב עַמָּהּ

verse (30): "I will remove that soul from among its people":

וְהֶאֱבַדְתִּי מָה ת"ל לְפִי שֶׁהוּא אוֹמֵר כָּרַת בְּכָל מָקוֹם וְאֵינִי יוֹדֵעַ מִהוּ

'I will remove' – what does this teach us? Wherever it states excision, and I do not know that that is,

כִּשֶׁהוּא אוֹמֵר וְהֶאֱבַדְתִּי לָמַד עַל הַכָּרַת שְׁאִינוֹ אֵלָא אֲבָדוֹן

when it states, 'I will remove' this teaches you about excision, which is the removal meant.

וְכַתֵּב שֵׁם הָר"מ מַלְבִּים ז"ל כִּי יֵשׁ הַבְּדֵל בֵּין כְּרִיתָהּ וּבֵין אֲבָדוֹן

The Malbim explains there that there is a difference between excision and removal,

כִּי הַכּוֹרֵת כּוֹרֵת אֶת הָעֵצִים מִשְׁרָשׁוֹ וְקוֹצֵץ הַדָּבָר עֲצָמוֹ

because excision cuts off the thing itself from its root and detaches the thing itself from its source,

וְהַמַּאֲבִיד הוּא רַק שְׁנוּי מְקוֹמוֹת שֶׁלֹּא תַעֲלֶה הַנֶּפֶשׁ אֶל צְרוּר הַחַיִּים
רַק יוֹרֶדֶת לְגִיהֵנוֹם

whereas 'removal' means merely that it changes locality, so that the *nefesh* the aspect of the soul that enlivens the body does not ascend to be bound in the Bond of Life, but instead it descends to Gehinom.

וּבכ"ז אֵינֶה נִכְרֶתֶת רַק נֶאֱבַדֶּת לְזִמּוֹן מִגִּבֹּל כַּמ"ש מִשְׁפָּט רָשָׁעִים
בְּגִיהֵנוֹם י"ב חֹדֶשׁ

Nevertheless it is not cut off completely, but is only 'removed' for a specified time, as the Sages said: The sentence of a wicked person in Gehinom is 12 months maximum.¹⁵

וְכָל אוֹבֵד מִתְבַּקֵּשׁ וְכַמ"ש וּבָאוּ הָאֲבָדִים בְּאַרְץ אַשּׁוּר

And anyone who was 'removed' is subsequently summoned, as the verse (Isaiah 27:13) states: "Those who were removed to the land of Assyria will come... and

prostrate themselves before God in Jerusalem"

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר לְמַד עַל הַכָּרֶת שֶׁאֵינוֹ אֶלָּא אֲבָדוֹן

This is why they said that this teaches you about excision – that it is nothing other than removal.

רְצוֹנוֹ לומר שֶׁאֵינוֹ כְּרִיתָה נִצְחִית רַק אֲבָדוֹן בְּשָׂאוֹל וְאֲבָדוֹן לְשַׁעְתּוֹ עַד יִקְבַּל עָנְשׁוֹ

Meaning to say, this is not permanent excision, only removal to *She'ol* (Gehinom) and temporary removal until the person has undergone their punishment.

כִּי ה' בְּרַחֲמָיו חוֹשֵׁב מַחְשָׁבוֹת בִּלְ תִכָּרֵת הַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּהַחֲלֵט עַכ"ל

For God in His mercy calculates matters so that a soul will never be cut off completely." Here ends the quote from the Sifra.

וְהוּא כַּמ"ש בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין ק"ט ע"ב וַיֵּאבְדוּ מִתּוֹךְ הַקָּהָל

And this is similar to what it states in Tractate Sanhedrin 109b on the verse (Numbers 16:33) "They were lost from among the congregation":

ר' יְהוּדָה בֶּן בְּתִירָה אוֹמֵר הָרִי הוּא כְּאֲבֵדָה הַמִּתְבַּקֶּשֶׁת שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר תַּעֲיִתִי כְּשֶׁה אֵבֶד בִּקְשׁ עַבְדְּךָ

Rabbi Yehuda ben Beteira declared: 'They are like a lost object that their owner is seeking, as it states (Psalms 119:176) "I have strayed like a lost sheep; seek out Your servant..."'

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בַּמִּכּוֹת כ"ד א' עַל הַפָּסוּק וְאֲבֵדְתֶם בְּגוֹיִם שֶׁאֵין זֶה הַכָּרֵחַ כָּלֵל לְאֲבָדוֹן מַחְלֵט ח"ו

And so too in Tractate Makkot 24a on the verse (Leviticus 26:38) "You will become lost among the nations..." – this need not be interpreted at all as complete destruction, Heaven forbid,

אֶלָּא רַק כְּאֲבֵדָה הַמִּתְבַּקֶּשֶׁת וְהָרִי לָנוּ מִכ"ז שְׁגָם בְּמִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה וְדִינֶיהָ וְעֲנִשָּׁהּ

but instead like a lost object that the owner seeks. Thus we have it from all the above that even according to the laws of the Torah and its sentencing and punishments

אֵין בָּהּ כָּלֵל אֲבָדוֹן הַחֲלִטִי ח"ו לְשׁוֹם רָשָׁע וּפּוֹשֵׁעַ

this does not at all imply complete destruction, Heaven forbid, for any wicked person or sinner.

וְעוֹד כִּי הָאֱמֶת הוּא שְׁכָל עֲנִשָּׁה בְּכָל הַקְּלָלוֹת שֶׁבְּתוֹרַת כְּהֻנִּים
וְשֶׁבַּמִּשְׁנֵה תוֹרָה

Furthermore, the truth is that all of the punishments and curses found in
Leviticus and Deuteronomy

הֵנָּה הוּא ג"כ אֶלָּא רַק בְּגִלוּיָהּ וּלְבוּשָׁה שֶׁהִיא עֲתֵּה לְפָנֵינוּ

are all only in the revealed aspects and the 'garments' of the Torah as it is before
us at this time.

אָבֵל בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָהּ וּבְהֶעָלָם הֵנָּה אָמְרוּ בְּזֵהָר חֲדָשׁ פ' כִּי תִבֹּא בְּשֵׁם
אֱלֹהֵיו זְכוּר לְטוֹב

But in its inner dimension and in a concealed manner the *Zohar Chadash*, *Tavo*
states in the name of Elijah, may his memory be a blessing,

כִּי כָל הַבְּטָחוֹת וְנַחֲמוֹת דִּישְׂרָאֵל בְּהֵנִי קָלָלוֹת כְּתִיבִי

that all the promises and consolations of the Torah are expressed in those
curses!

וְאָמְרוּ שֵׁם כִּי בִפְסוּק וְהָיוּ חֲיִיךָ תְּלוּיִם לְךָ מִנֶּגֶד וּפְחָדָה לַיְלָה וַיּוֹמֵם
וְלֹא תֵאֱמִין בְּחַיִּיךָ

For example, they state there on the verse (Deuteronomy 28:66) "Your life will
hang in the balance, and you will be frightened night and day, and you will not
be sure of your livelihood"

הֵנָּה שֵׁם מְרִמֵּז קֵץ הַגְּאֻלָּה.

the *Zohar Chadash* understands that this is an allusion to the final redemption.

וְהָרִי נִרְמַז בְּהַתּוֹרָה גּוֹפָה בְּכָל מִשְׁפָּטָה וְעֲנִשָּׁה כָּל הַיְּעוּדִים
הָעֲתִידִים

Thus it is hinted in the Torah itself that in all the judgments and punishments
are all the guarantees regarding the future.

שֶׁהֵם לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כֻּלָּם גַּם מִי שֶׁעוֹמֵד תַּחַת שִׁבְט כָּל הַקְּלָלוֹת שֶׁבָּהּ
בְּלִי חֲסוֹר אֶחָד מֵהֶם

And this applies to all of Israel without exception, even one who stands under
the threat of all the curses therein.

וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שְׁכָל תִּקְוָה הָעֲתִידָה הֵנָּה הוּא תְּלוּי בְּבְרִית וְלֹא
בְּזִכּוֹת

And this is as we said, that the hope for the future depends upon the Covenant,
and not upon merit,

וכל ברית לא תופר ואי אפשר שישתנה

and no Covenant will be abrogated, nor can it possibly change.

וכמ"ש ג"כ ירמיה ל"א ויש תקנה לאחריתך נאם ה'

And as is written in Jeremiah 31:16 "There is hope for your future, says the Lord."

עוד שם כה אמר ה' נתן שמש לאור יומם חקת ירח וכוכבים לאור לילה כו' אם ימשו החקים האלה כו' גם זרע ישראל ישבתו מהיות גוי לפני כל הימים כה אמר ה' אם ימדו שמים מלמעלה ויחקרו מוסדי ארץ למטה גם אני אמאס בכל זרע ישראל על כל אשר עשו נאם ה'

Furthermore, it also states there (Jeremiah 31:34-36): "Thus says the Lord, Who gives the sun as light by day, the laws of the moon and the stars as lights by night...? If these laws could budge... then so could the seed of Israel cease from being a people before Me forever. Thus says the Lord, If the heavens above could be measured, or the foundations of the earth below be plumbed, so too would I reject the entire seed of Israel because of everything they did, says the Lord."

וכן שם כ"ט כי אנכי ידעתי את המחשבת אשר אנכי חשב עליכם נאם ה' מחשבות שלום ולא לרעה לתת לכם אחרית ותקנה.

Similarly, in Jeremiah 29:11 "For I know what I think about you, says the Lord; thoughts of peace and not of evil, to give you a future and hope."

ומ"ש שלום ולא לרעה הכונה מבאר שגם כל הענשים כלם

When it states, "of peace and not of evil" the intention is clear – all the punishments as well

הם אינם לנקמה ולהשמיד ולהשחית ח"ו אלא רק כדי לתת אחרית ותקנה

are not for the purpose of revenge, to destroy and uproot, Heaven forbid, but only 'to give... a future and hope."

וכן יש כמה כתובים בתנ"ך המורים על זה שלא יעכב שום חטא ועון לתקות העתידה.

There are a number of other verses in the Tanach (Scripture) that also indicate that no sin or transgression can withhold our hopes for the future.

ומשלם לשנאיו אל פניו להאבידו הנה הוא רק ברשעי עובדי אלילים

As for the verse (Deuteronomy 7:10) that states, "**He repays His enemies to their face to destroy them**" – **this applies only to wicked idolaters,**

וכמ"ש במדרש תהלים מזמור ז' וכן בערב רב כנ"ל פ"ה

as *Midrash Tehillim 7* states, and also to the *erev rav* (the mixed multitude who made and worshiped the golden calf), as explained above, chap. 5,

וכמ"ש בזוה"ק בראשית כ"ה ב' וכן בפ' תצא רע"ז ב'

as the holy *Zohar, Bereishit 25b* also states, and in *Tetzei 277b* as well.

אבל בישראל אינו מתנהג הקב"ה במדה זו כלל

But the blessed Holy One does not comport Himself with Israelites in this manner at all,

וכמ"ש בספרי ברכה בפסוק יחי ראובן ואל ימת

as the Sifri explains on the verse (Deuteronomy 33:6) "**May Reuven live and not die**" –

כי לעולם אין מחליפים לא זכות בחובה ולא חובה בזכות

merit is never exchanged for culpability, or culpability for merit.

אלא נותנים מתן שכר על המצות וענשים על העברות

Instead, reward is given for mitzvot fulfilling the Commandments, and punishment for transgression.

וכל עברה וענש אינם נצחיים ח"ו והם נפסקים ומתבטלים וכנ"ל
בכל דברינו

And no transgressions and its punishment are forever, Heaven forbid; rather, they end and are nullified as we explained above.

אבל המצות ושכרן אין להם הפסק לישראל והם נצחיים בהם

However, the mitzvot and their reward have no end and they are eternal for Israelites.

והסבה בזה הוא כי בישראל אשר עליהם נאמר בנים אתם לה'
אלהיכם

The reason for this is that about the Jewish People the verse (Deuteronomy 14:1) states "**You are children to the Lord your God,**"

הנה כל מצוה עצם בו כי אורייתא וישראל חד הוא

thus every mitzvah is an essential part of them, since 'the Torah and Israel are one',¹⁶

אָבֵל הָעֵבֶרָה הוּא רַק מִקְרָה בּוֹ כִּי הוּא מֵהִתְעַרְבוּת רַע בְּטוֹב אֲשֶׁר
ע"י הַחֲטָא דִּעָץ הַדַּעַת

whereas a transgression is merely incidental to them to their essence since it is a composite of good and evil that came about because of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge,

וְלָכֵן מִתְבַּטֵּל הָעֵבֶרָה ע"י הָעֶנֶשׁ וְנִשְׁאָר עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ קוֹדֵשׁ לָהּ

and therefore the transgression is nullified by the punishment meted out to them, and their essence remains sanctified to God.

אָבֵל בְּעוֹבְדֵי אֱלִילִים הוּא לְהִפְךָ כִּי עֲצֻמוֹתָם הוּא מֵעֶצֶם הַסֵּם אֶל
אֲחֵר עֶצֶם הָרַע

But with idol worshippers the opposite is true, since their essence is from the essence of the satanic other god, the essence of evil,

שֶׁהוּא שֶׁרֶשׁ הָאֲבִדוֹן וְהַהִפְסָד וְכֵן"ל פ"ז

which is the root of destruction and annihilation, as explained above in chapter 7.

וְכָל מַצָּוָה וְדָבָר טוֹב שֶׁעוֹשִׂים הוּא אֵינוֹ מֵעֲצֻמוֹתָם אֲלָא מֵהִתְעַרְבוּת
הַטוֹב בָּרַע

And any good deed they do is not part of their essence, but from the admixture of good in the evil

אֲשֶׁר ע"י הַחֲטָא דִּעָץ הַדַּעַת וּמִשְׁרֵשׁ סוּד הַנִּגְהָ הַמֵּאִיר עֲלֵיהֶם
מִסְבִּיב כֵּן"ל פ"ז

that resulted from the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, and from the mystical concept of the glow that radiates to them from all around, as explained in chapter 7.

וְהָרִי הוּא אֵינוֹ שֶׁלָּהֶם כָּלֵל כִּי הָרַע וְהַטוֹב הֵרִי הֵם שְׁנֵי הַפָּכִים

Accordingly, it the good deed is not theirs at all, since good and evil are two opposites.

וְלָכֵן לְעֵתִיד כְּשִׁיבָרֵר הַטוֹב מִהָרַע וְיִתְבַּטֵּל הָרַע מִכָּל וְכָל הִנֵּה
יִתְבַּטְּלוּ הֵם בְּבִטּוֹלָן כִּי הֵם תּוֹלְדוֹתָיו וּמִמֶּנּוּ

And therefore, in the future when good will be purified of evil, and evil will be completely nullified, they too will be annulled with its nullification, since they are its product.

וְכָל מַצָּוָה וְדָבָר טוֹב שֶׁנֶּעֱשָׂה עַל יָדָם בַּעוֹה"ז ע"י הִתְעַרְבוּת טוֹב
בָּרַע הִנֵּז

And any mitzvah or good deed they did in this world, by way of the admixture of good within evil, as mentioned

הִנֵּה מְשַׁלֵּם לָהֶם הַקֵּב"ה בַּעוֹה"ז ג"כ כִּי הוּא ית"ש אֵינוֹ מְקַפֵּחַ
שָׂכָר כָּל בְּרִיָּה

the blessed Holy One will also pay them in this world, because He does not withhold the reward of any creature,

וְהָרִי נֶעֱשֶׂת עַל יָדָם עַכ"פּ וּמִשּׁוּם כ"ז הִנֵּה מִתְּנֶהֱג הַקֵּב"ה עִמָּהֶם
בַּמִּדָּה

and indeed it was done by them, and therefore the blessed Holy One acts towards them measure for measure –

וּמִשְׁלֵם לְשֹׂנְאָיו אֶל פְּנֵיו לְהַאֲבִידוֹ מִשָּׂא"כ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל ח"ו וְכַנִּז'

rewarding those who deserve reward, and repaying those who despise Him to His face with destruction. But this does not apply to the Jewish People, Heaven forfend, as we explained.

וְלָכוּ נֹאמַר עֲלֵיהֶם וְעַמָּךְ כֻּלָּם צְדִיקִים וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק
לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא.

And therefore, about them it states (Isaiah 60:21) "and all of Your people are righteous" and 'all of Israel have a portion in the World to Come.'¹⁷

אֲמַנָם כָּל אֵלוֹ שֶׁחֲשָׁבוּ רַז"ל וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם חֵלֶק לַעוֹה"ב

However, all those whom our Sages reckoned and declared would not have a portion in the World to Come,

הִנֵּה כָּתֹב הַרְקֵאנָטִי פ' תִּשָּׂא בַּפִּסּוּק אֲנִי אֶעֱבִיר כָּל טוֹבֵי בָשָׂם רַבֵּינוּ
עֲזָרָא

Recanati¹⁸ writes in the name of Rabbeinu Ezra¹⁹ on the verse in Parshat Ki Tissa (Exodus 33:19) "I shall make all My goodness pass before you" –

כִּי מֵה שֶׁנִּמְצָא בַּמִּקּוֹמוֹת רַבִּים מְדַבְּרֵי רַז"ל אֵין לוֹ חֵלֶק לַעוֹה"ב

When we find in a number of places in the words of our Sages, that certain people do not have a portion in the World to Come,

ר"ל אֵין לוֹ בֵּית בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ אוֹצֵר שֶׁהוּא בְּרִשּׁוֹתוֹ וְהוּא מוֹשֵׁל עָלָיו
וְזֶהוּ עוֹשִׂין לוֹ מְדוּר לְפִי כְבוֹדוֹ

this means that they do not have an abode of their own, that is their own domain and in their control, as in 'they provide a righteous soul with an abode befitting his honor.'²⁰

וּמִי שֶׁאֵין לוֹ זְכוּת הוּא עוֹמֵד בַּמִּקּוֹם שֶׁעוֹמְדִים רַבִּים עַכ"ל

But someone who does not have that merit stands in a place together with many others. This concludes the words of Rabbi Recanati.

וְכֵן כָּתַב רַבֵּינוּ בְּחַיֵּי סוּף פ' אַחֲרֵי (ע"ש בְּאַרְכָּה וְתַמְצָא כְּדַבְּרֵינוּ)

Rabbeinu Bechaye writes in similar vein at the end of Parshat Acharei (see there at length and find our words corroborated).

וּלפ"ז הָרִי אֶפְשֶׁר לומר כִּי דוֹרְשֵׁי רְשׁוּמוֹת שְׁאַמְרוּ בְּסִנְהֶדְרִין ק"ד
סע"ב כִּלְוֵן בְּאִין לעוה"ב וְכֵן"ל

Accordingly, it is possible to say that the 'interpreters of the verses' mentioned in Tractate Sanhedrin 104b, that all Israelites will enter the World to Come,

הִנֵּה לֹא פְּלִיגִי עַל הַמִּשְׁנָה שֶׁם צ' ע"א בְּמָה שְׁאַמְרוּ וְאֵלּוּ שְׁאִין לָהֶם
חֶלֶק לעוה"ב

do not argue with the Mishnah there Sanhedrin 90a when they said that 'these do not have a portion in the World to Come.'

כִּי הָרִי גַם הַדוֹרְשֵׁי רְשׁוּמוֹת לֹא אָמְרוּ אֶלָּא לְשׁוֹן בְּאִין לעוה"ב

For the 'interpreters of the verses' only said that 'they will enter the World to Come,'

אָבֵל לֹא אָמְרוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם חֶלֶק שֶׁהוּא מְקוֹם מִיחָד הַשֵּׁיךְ לָהֶם

but they did not say that 'they have a *portion* – a space designated for each of them individually – in the World to Come.'

אֶלָּא שֶׁהֵם יִשְׁתַּמְּשׁוּ בְּאוֹרֶן שֶׁל הַזּוֹכִים שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹר הַכִּלְי הַכוֹלֵל
כֻּלָּם

Instead they will be allowed to share in the light of those who are worthy – the all-inclusive light that includes everyone –

וְהוּא כְּעֵין מְקוֹם מַעֲבָר לְרַבִּים וְיִהְיֶה לִפְי"ז הַבְּדֵל גָּדוֹל

which is a sort of passageway for all, and therefore there will be a major difference

בֵּין עַבְדֵי אֱלֹהִים לְאִשֶּׁר לֹא עָבְדוּ כְּגִבְהַ שָׁמַיִם עַל הָאָרֶץ וּבִרְחוֹק
מִזָּרֶחַ מִמַּעֲרָב

between those who served God and those who did not, like the difference between the heights of the heavens and earth, and like the distance between east and west.

וְהִיא ע"ד שְׁאָנוּ רוֹאִין בעוה"ז כִּי הֵגֶם שְׁכָל מִי אֲשֶׁר יַחֲבֵר לַחַיִּים יֵשׁ
לוֹ מְקוֹם וּמִזּוֹן בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה

This is similar to what we see in this world – that although one who is connected to Life has a place and his sustenance in this world,

עכ"ז הרי כִּמָּה הֵבֵדֵל גָּדוֹל בֵּין מִי שֶׁמְכַלְכֵּל אֶת נַפְשׁוֹ בִּלְחֶם לֶאֱכֹל
וּבִגָּד לִלְבֹּשׁ

nevertheless, what a great difference there is between one who sustains their soul with just enough bread to eat and clothing to wear,

לְבִין מִי שֶׁמְתַעֲנֵג אֶת עַצְמוֹ וּמְתַעֲדוֹ כֹּל יָמָיו בְּסִגְלַת מְלָכִים

and one who indulges himself and delights in the delicacies of kings for his entire life.

וְגַם בְּהִזְוָכִים גּוֹפָה הִרִי יִהְיֶה בָּהֶם ג"כ כִּמָּה וְכִמָּה חִלּוּקֵי מַדְרָגוֹת

Even among those who have the merit of a portion in the World to Come there are several different levels,

וְכַמְבָּאֵר בְּכִמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת מַדְבְּרֵי חַז"ל וְאָמְרוּ בְּתַעֲנִית ספ"ק לֹא הִכַּל
לְאוֹרָה וְלֹא הִכַּל לְשִׂמְחָה צְדִיקִים לְאוֹרָה וְיֹשְׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה

as explained in a number of places in the words of our Sages, who said in the first chapter of Tractate Ta'anit: "Not everyone is granted light; not everyone is granted joy – the righteous are granted light and the upright, joy.

וּבַמְדָּרָשׁ תִּהְיֶה לִּם מְזֻמּוֹר י"א סִי' ו' חוֹשֵׁב שֶׁם ז' חִלּוּקֵי מַדְרָגוֹת בֵּין
כְּתוּבֹת הַצְּדִיקִים לְעֵתִיד לְבוֹא ע"ש

Midrash Tehillim 11:6 reckons 7 levels of groups of the righteous in the Time to Come. See there.

וּבְיוֹקְרָא רַבָּא פ"ל סִימָן ב' וּבִגְמָרָא ב"ב ע"ה א' עֵתִיד הַקֶּבֶד
לַעֲשׂוֹת שִׁבְעַת חֲפּוֹת לְכָל צְדִיק וְצְדִיק

In Vayikra Rabba 30:2 and in the Gemara Tractate Bava Batra 75a: In the future the blessed Holy One will make seven wedding canopies for each righteous person,

וְלִכָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד חֲפָה לְפִי כְּבוֹדוֹ וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד נִכְוָה מִחֲפָתוֹ שֶׁל
חֵבְרוֹ

and for each of them the wedding canopy will be according to the level of the person's honor, and each person will be envious of the beauty of his friend's wedding canopy. In other words, he will envy the righteousness that granted his friend such a glorious canopy.

עוֹד שֶׁם בְּעֵנֵינוּ סִבַּת עוֹרוֹ שֶׁל לִוְיָתָן זָכָה עוֹשִׂין לוֹ סֶכֶה לֹא זָכָה עוֹשִׂין
לוֹ צִלְצֹל

In that same source (Bava Batra 75a) it states regarding the covering²¹ that will be made from the skin of the Leviathan: If one is worthy they will make him a covering and four walls**; if he is not** as worthy, they will provide him shade – just a covering without walls;

לא זָכָה עוֹשִׁין לוֹ עֵנֶק לֹא זָכָה עוֹשִׁין לוֹ קָמַעַ

even less worthy, they will make him a necklace, and even less worthy – an ornament hung on a chain around the neck. All of the above are clearly analogies for varying spiritual rewards.

ועד"ז בְּכִמָּה אֲגָדוֹת חֲז"ל בְּעֵנִין חֲלוּקוֹת שׁוֹנוֹת בֵּין מַדְרָגוֹת
הַצְּדִיקִים לַעֲתִיד לָבֹא וּכְנוּדַעַ

Similar statements can be found in the Aggadic²² writings of the Sages regarding the various differences between the levels of the righteous in the Time to Come, as is known.

אָמְנָם ע"פ עֵמֶק הַדְּבָרִים שֶׁאֲמָרְנוּ לְעִיל הִנֵּה יִהְיוּ כָל חֲלָקֹת
הַמַּדְרָגוֹת הַנִּמְצָא בַּדְּבָרִי רז"ל

However, based on the depths of the matters discussed above, all of these various disparate levels among the righteous found in the teachings of the Sages

לְפִי עֵרֶךְ חֲלָקֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ הַנִּשְׁמוֹת דָּכָל אֶחָד כִּי אֵין נִשְׁמָה דּוֹמָה
לַחֲבֵרָתָהּ

parallel the differences there are in the roots of the soul of each individual, because no soul is similar to any other one,

וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד יֵשׁ לוֹ שֶׁרֶשׁ בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ רז"ל בַּפָּסוּק
אֵיפָה הָיִיתָ בְּיַסְדִּי אֶרֶץ

and each person has their own individual root, as our Sages teach on the verse (Job 38:4) "Where were you when I laid the earth's foundation"

בְּשִׁמוֹת רַבָּא פְּרָשָׁה מ' סִימָן ג' וּבכ"מ וְכָל הַתּוֹרָה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים

– in *Shemot Rabba* 40:3 and in a number of other places: The entire Torah, and all good deeds,

וְכוֹ לְהַפְךָ כָּל הַחֲטָאִים וְעֲוֹנוֹת הִנֵּה נוֹגַעַ כ"א לְפִי שֶׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ

and the opposite, all the sins and transgressions, affect a person according to the root of their soul.

וְכוֹ עד"ז בְּשִׁכְרוֹ וְעֲנָשׁוֹ כִּי אֵין שׁוּם אָדָם דּוֹמָה לַחֲבֵרוֹ בְּכָל הַדּוֹרוֹת
כָּלָם

Similarly as regards reward and punishment, for no person is identical to another in this regard even in all previous generations,

ובְּכָל מִשָּׁךְ יְמֵי עוֹלָם כָּלֹ

and even throughout the entire history of the world.

וְכֹן אֵינָם דּוֹמִים בְּכָל תְּהִלּוֹתֵיהֶם וּמַאֲרָעוֹתֵיהֶם בַּעוֹה"ז

Nor are they similar in their paths through life and in the events that occur to them in this world.

וְעַד"ז בְּשִׁכְרוֹ וְעַנְשׁוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְאַחַר מִיתָה בְּגֵן עֵדֶן וּגְיֵהֶנָּם

And the same applies to their rewards or punishments after death in the Garden of Eden or in Gehinom.

וְכֹן הֵם חִלּוּקִים בְּמַדְרָגוֹתֵיהֶם לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא

Similarly, there are divisions between their levels in the World to Come,

וְהַגִּם שְׁהָרֵי בְּתַקּוּיֹהֶם אַחֲרָיו יִכְלָלוּ כָּל הַנִּשְׁמוֹת כָּלָם זב"ז ע"ד שְׁהָיוּ כְּלוּלִים כָּלָם בְּאַדָּם הָרִאשׁוֹן

even though with the final rectification all souls will be integrated, in the same manner that they were all included in Adam.

אֲךָ גַם בְּפָרְצוֹף אֶחָד וְאַדָּם אֶחָד הָרִי אֵינוֹ דּוֹמֶה אֶבֶר אֶחָד לְחֵבֶרֹ

However, even in one composite entity of a single person, one limb is not the same as another.

וּבִזְזָה יִהְיוּ כָּל חִלְקֵת הַמַּדְרָגוֹת לְעֵתִיד לְבֹא וְהָיוּ כ"ז.

This will be the manner in which all the divisions will exist in the future.

Understand all this.

וְכֹן בְּעֵנֵינוּ מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת אֵין לוֹ חֵלֶק לְעוֹלָם הַבָּא

Similarly as regards the statement of the Sages in a number of places that 'such a person has no portion in the World to Come'²³ –

הִנֵּה יִהְיֶה הַכּוֹנֵנָה לְפִי דְבָרֵינוּ עַל כָּל מִשָּׁךְ הַזְמַן עַד שְׁיִגִיעַ עַת הַתַּקּוּן

according to our analysis presented above, the intention is: the entire time *until* the rectification.

כִּי כָּל חֵלְקוֹ וּשְׁכָרוֹ דַּעוּה"ב אֲשֶׁר הִיא מוֹכֵן אֵלָיו

Because his or her entire portion and reward in the World to Come, which is prepared for him or her

בְּאוֹרוֹת הַגְּבוּרוֹת הָעֲלִיוֹנִים דְּשֶׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמָתוֹ

as the illuminations contained in the supernal *gevurot* at the root of his or her soul,

הרי נסתלקו ממנו ונפסק מהם ע"י שנתחלפו אותן כל הכחות
דהגבורות

these are withdrawn from him or her and are terminated due to all the powers of the *gevurot* being transformed

לתקף דינים קשים ע"י אחיזת החיצונים בהם

into the powers of harsh judgments by means of the outside spiritual forces latching onto them.

והרי נאבד חלקו ממנו לגמרי ע"י אותו העברה החמורה

Thus the person's portion is lost to him completely, due to that serious transgression

והשליט את החיצונים בהגבורות דשרש נשמתו אשר שם היה
שכרו וחלקו דעוה"ב

by which he gave dominance to the outside forces over the *gevurot* at the root of his soul – where his reward and portion in the World to Come were located.

ואין לו תקנה מעתה שיחזר לו אלא רק או ע"י תשובה ותפלה
וצדקה המעבירין את רע הגזרה

And now he has no other recourse to return it other than through 'repentance (*teshuvah*), prayer and charitable acts, which remove the awful decree,'²⁴

שהם דוחין את החיצונים ומבטלן כי בתשובה ותפלה וצדקה

for these push away the outside forces and nullify them, because by means of repentance and prayer and charitable acts

מתבסמין ומתמתקין הגבורות ברשפי אש שלהבת יה ושוּרפין
ומכלין את כל אותו הרע שנאחז בהם

the *gevurot* are perfumed and sweetened by the blazing flames of God that burn and destroy all the evil that latches onto them.

אבל בלא תשובה אין לו תקנה שיחזר לו חלקו

But without repentance there is no way to rectify the situation and restore his portion,

אלא רק אחר שיתהפך כל אותו הרע לסער מתחולל ולדין קשה
לפי מדת ומשקל אותו העברה

until after that evil will be transformed into 'a storm that devolves' (Jeremiah 23:19) the harsh verdict upon the head of the perpetrator,²⁵ commensurate with

the seriousness of his transgression.

ועי"ז יתבטל אותו הרע ג"כ אחר שיפרע ממנו מכל וכל ואז יחזר
לתקונו ולחלקו ושכרו

In this way too that evil is nullified, once his debt has been paid completely.
Only then will his status and portion and reward be returned to him,

אחר הצרוף הגדול והלבון כנ"ל בדברינו

after the great scouring and purification we discussed above.

וזהו כוננתם ז"ל בכל אותן העברות שאמרו עליהם אין לו חלק
לעוה"ב

This then is what the Sages mean when they said about certain transgressions
that the person will not have a portion in the World to Come –

והכונה הוא כי אבד חלקו ונפסק ממנו (כי נסתלק ועלה ונתעלם
בשרשו)

the intention is that he loses his portion and it is blocked from him (because it
was retracted above and became concealed in its source),

ואין לו תקנה שיחזר לו אלא ע"י אחד מב' דברים הנז' ע"י זה או ע"י
זה

and he has no recourse to have it returned other than in one of the two ways
mentioned – by way of this repentance, or by way of that his punishment.

אבל לבסוף הנה יתקן עכ"פ והוא ע"י הענשים והצרוף והלבון
וככל מה שאמרנו לעיל

But in the end it will be rectified in any event, via punishments and scouring
and purification, and everything we mentioned earlier.

הגהה – וכן מצאתי מפ"ש בדברי האריז"ל ב"שער הגלגולים סוף
הקדמה כ"ד וכן במאמרי רז"ל סנהדרין דף ו' סע"א מדפוח"ח דגם
כ"ל אלו שאמרו אין להם חלק לעוה"ב הכונה הוא שאין עולים
למ"ן באמא עלאה הנקרא עוה"ב אלא (שאחר שמקבלים ענשם)
הנה הם בסוד מ"ן שבמלכות ע"כ הגהה

*Note: I found this stated explicitly in the words of the Arizal in Sha'ar haGilgulim
end of Intro 24, and also in the statements of our Sages in Sanhedrin 6a (in the new
printing) – that all those about whom it was said 'they have no portion in the World
to Come,' the intention is that they cannot arouse ma"n the 'feminine waters'²⁶ to
Ima ila'ah binah above, which is called 'the World to Come' – until after they receive
their punishment. Thus they are the secret of the ma"n of malchut*. End of note.**

וְזֶהוּ ג"כ עֲנִין הַג' סְפָרִים שֶׁנִּפְתָּחִין בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה שְׁאֲמָרוּ שָׁם ט"ז ב'

This is also the concept of the 3 books that are open on Rosh Hashana, see Tractate Rosh Hashana 16b,

וְכָתְבוּ שָׁם הַתּוֹסֶפֶת שֶׁעֲנִין הַג' סְפָרִים הֵלְלוּ הֵם לַחַיִּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא

regarding which the Tosafot comments: these 3 books are relevant to the World to Come.

וְלִכְאוּרָה יִפְּלֵא מָה שֶׁיֵּךְ לָדוּן עַל חַיִּי עוֹה"ב בְּעוֹד שֶׁהָאָדָם עֹדִין
בעוה"ז

Now at first glance this is astonishing – why is it relevant to discuss life in the World to Come, while a person is still alive in this world?

הֲלֹא אֵין עֵתָה הַזְּמַן לָזֶה וְגַם אִם יֵצֵא חַיִּב בְּדִינוֹ שְׁמָא יִשׁוּב וְיִתְכַּפֵּר
לו

Isn't it so that now is not the time for this discussion? And furthermore, even if he is found guilty in his judgment, perhaps he will repent and be forgiven?

וְכֹן אִם יֵצֵא זָכַאי הֲרִי לֹא יֵאָמֵין בְּקִדְשָׁיו וַיֵּשׁ שְׁקוּנָה עוֹלָמוֹ בְּשָׁעָה
אַחַת וַיֵּשׁ שְׁמֵאֲבָד עוֹלָמוֹ בְּשָׁעָה אַחַת

Similarly, if the person emerges meritorious in his judgement 'He cannot have faith even in His holy beings' (Job 15:15), and 'one person can acquire his world in a moment,²⁷ while another can lose his world in a moment.

וְיִמָּה תוֹעֵלֶת הוּא מָה שֶׁדָּנִים אוֹתוֹ עַל זֶה בְּכָל שָׁנָה הֲרִי רַק הָרִגַע
אַחֲרוֹנָה תוֹכִיחַ

What benefit then is there in judging him in this regard every year, since only his last moment will determine his fate?

אֲךָ הָעֲנִין הוּא כִּי בָּאֵם שֶׁזֹּכָה לַחַיִּי הָעוֹה"ב הִנֵּה נִפְרָעִין מִמֶּנּוּ עַל
עֲוֹנֹתָיו בַּעוה"ז

But the idea is that if he merits the World to Come, then the debt for his transgressions is claimed in this world.

וּבָאֵם שֶׁאֵינוֹ זֹכָה לַחַיִּי עוֹה"ב וְצָרִיךְ לְצֻרוֹ וְלִבּוֹן גָּדוֹל וְהוּא רַק
בְּהַז' מְדוּרֵי גֵיהֶנֶם

And if he is not worthy of the World to Come, then he requires great cleansing and purification, which is only in the seven chambers of Gehinom,

וְכָל הַדִּינִין דְּלֵאחֲרֵי מִיתָה וּמְטִיבִין לוֹ בַּעוה"ז ע"ד שְׁאֲמָרוּ בְּקִדּוּשֵׁין
ט"ל ב' ע"ש כִּי מְסַלְקִין דִּינוֹ עַל לֵאחֲרֵי מִיתָה

and all of the harsh judgments that take place *after* death. But in this world he has it good, as the Sages say in Tractate **Kiddushin 39b**, see there, because they withhold his judgment until after death.

וְלִפְעָמִים מְרִיעִין לוֹ בַּעוֹה"ז כִּי יֵשׁ רָשָׁע וְטוֹב לוֹ רָשָׁע וְרַע לוֹ
הַכֹּל לְפִי עֶרֶךְ בְּמוֹת וְאִיכוֹת עֲוֹנָתוֹ

Now it does sometimes happen that things go badly with him in this world as well, because there are different categories of wicked people – there is a wicked person who has some good in him, and a wicked person who has only evil in him, and everything is according to the quantity and quality of his transgressions.

וְכָל הַמֵּאֲרָעוֹת דִּהְעוּה"ז אִיךְ שְׁמִתְנַהֲגִים עִמּוֹ הוּא תִּלְוִי הַכֹּל לְפִי
מָה שְׁעוֹמֵד בְּדִינוֹ בְּעֵנֶן חַי עוֹה"ב

And all of the events that unfold in this world – how a person is treated – all depends upon the judgment passed on him regarding his life in the World to Come.

וְלָכֵן נִדּוֹן כָּל אָדָם בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה בִּתְחִלָּה וּמִסְתַּכְּלִים עָלָיו אִיךְ
שֶׁהוּא עוֹמֵד בְּדִינוֹ בְּעֵנֶן חַי הַעוֹה"ב

And therefore every person is judged at the beginning of every year, and they the Heavenly Court examine his standing regarding life in the World to Come.

וְאַח"כּ הוּא נִדּוֹן לְפִי זֶה עַל כָּל מֵאֲרָעוֹתָיו דְּחַי הַעוֹה"ז

Only after this is he judged regarding everything that takes place in his life in this world.

וְכֵן הוּא עֵנֶן עוֹד כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת כֻּלָּן הֵרִי הֵם רַק לְחַי הַעוֹה"ב

There is also another concept here: all of the mitzvot only relate to the life of the World to Come,

וְכַמ"ש קְדוּשִׁין ס"ל ב' שֶׁכֵּר מִצְוָה בִּהְיָ עֲלֵמָא לִיכָא

as it states in Tractate **Kiddushin 30b**: There is no reward in this world for a mitzvah.

וְכֵן בַּעֲבוּר"ז ג-ד הַיּוֹם לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ וְלֹא הַיּוֹם לְטַל שְׂכָרוֹ וְכָל חַי הַעוֹה"ז
וְטוֹבוּתָהּ

And so too in Tractate **Avodah Zara** pp. 3-4: Do it the mitzvah today, but their reward is not today, and all of the life of this world and the goodness thereof

הִנֵּה הוּא רַק בְּחֶסֶד וּבִצְדָקָה וְכַמ"ש בְּרָכוֹת י"ז ב' כָּל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ
נִזְוָנִין בִּצְדָקָה ע"ש

is only out of kindness and charity, as it states in Tractate Berachot 17b: The entire world is nourished by charity. See there.

וְהוּא רַק לְצַרְךָ קִיּוּם הָעוֹלָם לַעֲשׂוֹת בָּהּ תּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

And this is only for the sake of the continued existence of the world, to fulfill Torah and mitzvot in it for the sake of the World to Come.

וְלָכֵן נִמְשָׁךְ כָּל חַיֵּי וְצָרָכֵי הָעוֹה"ז לְהָאָדָם רַק לְפִי עֶרְךָ שֶׁהוּא עוֹמֵד בְּדִינוֹ לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

And therefore his entire life and his needs in this world are granted to him according to the degree he stands in judgement regarding the World to Come.

וְלָכֵךְ דָּנִין אֶת הָאָדָם בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה בְּתַחֲלָה עַל חַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב
וְאַח"כּ דָּנִין אוֹתוֹ לִפְי"ז עַל חַיָּיו וְעִנְיָנָיו דֵּהָעוֹה"ז

And therefore a person is judged annually regarding his life in the World to Come at the beginning of the year, and after this he is judged accordingly about his life and the matters concerning it in this world.

וְהִנֵּה כ"ז הוּא נִמְתָּק בְּיוֹתֵר ע"פ דְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ שְׂכָל עִנְיָן דָּאִין לוֹ חֵלֶק לָעוֹה"ב

All of this makes much more sense²⁸ according to what we said – that any matter that does not have a portion in the World to Come,

הַכּוֹנֵה הוּא רַק עַד שֶׁיִּצָּרֵךְ וְיִתְלַבֵּן וְצָרִיךְ לְתַקּוּנִים גְּדוֹלִים לְהַתְתַּקֵּן וּלְבֹא לְמַדְרָגָתוֹ הַקּוֹדֶמֶת

the intention is only until it will be cleansed and purified, which requires great rectifications in order to be rectified and come to its former stature.

אֲךָ הוּא ית"ש הִנֵּה חֹשֵׁב מַחֲשָׁבוֹת לְבָל יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח וּמִסִּבָּב עָלָיו סְבוּבִים שׁוּנִים

But He, may His Name be blessed, He calculates how nothing will be pushed away from Him, and He ensures that certain events take place,

אִם בְּעוֹה"ז אוּ בְּעוֹלָם הַנִּפְשׁוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְאַחַר מִיתָה עַד שְׁיִתְקַן לְבִסּוּף עכ"פ

whether in this world or in the world of souls after death, until it will be rectified eventually.

וְלָכֵן דָּנִין אֶת הָאָדָם בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה מִתְחֵלָה בְּדִין דְּחַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב

This is why a person is judged each year from the outset regarding life in the World to Come,

כְּדִי לְהַסְתַּכֵּל אֵיךְ לְהִתְנַהֵּג עִמּוֹ בְּכָל מַאֲרָעוֹתָיו דְּחַיֵּי עוֹה"ז הַנִּצְרָךְ
לוֹ לְתַקּוֹנוֹ

in order to examine how to act towards a person in all of the events that take place in the life of this world, as necessary for him to achieve his rectification.

וְזֶהוּ הֵג' סְפָרִים שֶׁנִּפְתָּחוּ בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁ ט"ז ב'

These are the three books that are opened on Rosh Hashana, as it states in the Tractate 16b –

וְהֵם עַל חַיֵּי עוֹה"ב וּבְהֵם הוּא בְּצַדִּיקִים גְּמוּרִים וּבְרָשָׁעִים גְּמוּרִים
הַחֲתִימָה ג"כ בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה

and these are about life in the World to Come in regard to the completely righteous and the completely wicked, and this is signed on Rosh Hashana.

אָבֵל בְּחַיֵּי עוֹה"ז הִנֵּה הַחֲתִימָה בְּכֻלָּם רַק בְּיוֹם הַכַּפּוּרִים וְהוּא
כְּדָבָרֵי הַתּוֹסֶפֶת שֶׁ

But, as regards life in *this* world, the final seal for everyone is only on Yom Kippur the Day of Atonement, as the Tosafot explains there.

וְכֵן הִסְכִּים הַגֵּר"א בִּאו"ח סס"י תַּקַּפ"ב ע"ש.

The GRA too agrees with this conclusion in his commentary to *Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim*, chapter 582, see there.

וְתַקְּנוּ לְבַקֵּשׁ עַל הַכְּתִיבָה עַד נְעִילָה מְשׁוּם דָּאִין לְהַחֲזִיק עֲצָמוֹ
לְצַדִּיק גְּמוּר

The Sages established that we offer supplications to be signed for a good year in this world until the *Ne'ilah* prayer, the final prayer on Yom Kippur, because a person should not regard himself as perfectly righteous.

וְהַבְקָשָׁה הוּא הֵן עַל חַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ב וְהֵן עַל חַיֵּי הָעוֹה"ז

This supplication includes both life in the World to Come and life in this world.

וּמוֹעִיל הַבְקָשָׁה אַף לְרָשָׁע גְּמוּר גַּם בְּחַיֵּי עוֹה"ב הֵגֶם שֶׁהוּא לְאַחֵר
הַחֲתִימָה שֶׁהוּא בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כִּנֵּז'

This supplication is also beneficial for a completely wicked person, even as regards the life in the World to Come, albeit after the seal on Rosh Hashana,

מְשׁוּם שֶׁיִּפָּה צַעֲקָה לְאָדָם בֵּין קֶדֶם גָּזַר דִּין בֵּין לְאַחֵר גָּזַר דִּין כִּמ"ש
שֶׁ ט"ז א.

and the reason for this is that a person's crying out to God is beneficial whether before or after the decreed verdict, as it states there Tractate Rosh Hashana 16a.

ומ"ש שם הגר"א שאין לומר לשנה טובה תכתב ותחתם אלא
תכתב

The GRA writes there that one should not say "May you be signed and sealed for a good year," but only, "may you be signed."

משום דלשון לשנה טובה שהוא הוראת שנה אחת שנה זו

****The reason is that the expression "May you have a good year..." applies only to a single year – *this* year.**

הרי הוא רק על חיי העוה"ז כי באם שהיה הכוונה על חיי עוה"ב
ג"כ היה צ"ל סתם לחיים טובים תכתב ותחתם

Thus it applies only to life in this world, since if the intention was also the life in the World to Come, it should have simply said, "May you be signed and sealed for a good life,"

בלי להזכיר לשון שנה שהוא משמע שנה זו

without mentioning the word 'year,' which implies *this* year.

והעקר הוא משום שהרי לחיי העוה"ב נגמר הדין מקדם הן
הכתיבה והן החתימה

The main point is that the judgment regarding life in the World to Come is completed earlier on, both the writing and the sealing,

ואחר החתימה אשר לחיי העוה"ב נעשה הכתיבה בראש השנה
לחיי עוה"ז

Only after the verdict regarding life in the World to Come has been sealed, is the writing begun on Rosh Hashana regarding life in this world.

וא"כ אם נאמר שהלשון לשנה טובה הוא כולל שניהם

This being so, if we say that the expression we wish others, 'may you have a good year' includes both of them, life in the World to Come and in this world,

הרי הוה הלשון תכתב ותחתם אינו מישב ומישר כלל

****then the expression "may you be written and sealed" does not sit well and is not straightforward at all,**

כי הכתיבה אשר לחיי העוה"ז הוא רק אחר החתימה דחיי
העוה"ב וכנ"ל

since the writing regarding life in this world is only *after* the sealing of the verdict regarding that person's life in the World to Come!

וְהָיָה צִרְיִךְ לְהֶאָרִיךְ וְלוֹמַר לְחַיִּים טוֹבִים תִּכְתֵּב וְתַחֲתֶם בְּחַיֵּי
הָעוֹלָם"ב

If that was the intention it would have been necessary to express this at length
and say, "May you be written and sealed for the life of the World to Come..."

וּלְשָׁנָה טוֹבָה תִּכְתֵּב לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם"ז וְאִין הַמִּנְהָג לְהֶאָרִיךְ כ"כ

and written for a good year of life in this world!" But it isn't the custom to
express this at such great length,

לְכוּ אָמַר הַגֵּר"א שֶׁאֵין לוֹמַר תַּחֲתֶם רַק תִּכְתֵּב וְקָאֵי עַל חַיֵּי עוֹלָם"ז

and therefore the GRA said not to say 'sealed' but only 'written,' referring to
life in this world,

וְנִכְלַל בּוֹ ג' כ"כ בְּרַכַּת חַיֵּי עוֹלָם"ב דַּל"כ הָרִי אֵינוֹ טוֹבָה כָּלֵל

and it included a blessing for the life of the World to Come as well, for if not,
that would not be a good year at all.

אָמַנְם עֲנִין הַכְּתִיבָה וְהַחֲתִימָה מָה שֶׁהֵם וְגַם עֲנִין מָה שֶׁנִּגְמְרוּ זֶה
בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה זֶה בִּיּוֹה"כ

However, the concept of 'writing' and 'sealing,' and the fact that one is
completed on Rosh Hashana, and the other on Yom Kippur,

וְכוּ עֲנִין הַג' סְפָרִים מָה שֶׁהֵם אֵין כָּאן הַמָּקוֹם לָזֶה

and also the idea of the three books that are opened on Rosh Hashana – here is not
the place to analyze this.

וְכִשְׁיִזְכְּנִי הַשִּׁית לַמָּקוֹם הַיָּאוֹת לָהֶם נִדְבָר בָּזֶה

When the Almighty will grant me the merit and the proper occasion for these,
we will discuss them.

וְנִחְזֹר לְהַעֲנִין וְנִשְׁלִים דְּבָרֵינוּ כִּי הִנֵּה נִתְבָּאֵר שְׁכָל תַּקּוֹת חֲמֻדַּת
יִשְׂרָאֵל

But let us return now to the subject and complete our words. We explained that
the hoped for thing that all of Israel yearns for

הִנֵּה הֵם יְעוּדִים הָעֵתִידִים לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלֵם בְּלִי חֲסוֹר אֶחָד מֵהֶם

are the promises that will be fulfilled for all of Israel, without exception,

כִּי הוּא תְּלוּי בְּבְרִית וְלֹא בְּזִכּוֹת וְהַבְּרִית הוּא בְּאוֹר הַמִּקְיָר

because it depends on the Covenant, and not on a person's merits, and the
Covenant originates in the *ohr makif* – the transcendent light –

שֶׁהוּא מְאִיר בְּלִתִּי גָבּוֹל וּלְמַעַלָּה מִן הַמַּדָּה

that illuminates without limitation, and beyond all measure.

אָבֵל הַזְכוּת הֵנָּה הוּא בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי וְבוֹ הוּא כָּל מִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה
וְשָׂרָה וְעֲנִשָּׁה

But merit is a feature of the *ohr pnimi* the light that is invested in vessels in which reside all the statutes of Torah and its rewards and punishments.

שֶׁהֵם בְּמִדָּה וּבְמִשְׁקָל וְגוֹמֵל לְכָל אִישׁ כְּמַפְעָלוֹ

These are measured and weighed and are paid back to every person according to their deeds,

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הוּא מְצֻמָּצָם בְּכָלִי וְלָכֵן הוּא בַּחֲקֹ וּגְבוּל

because the *ohr pnimi* is constricted into a vessel and therefore it is elicited according to laws and limitations,

וְאֵינוֹ מַעְבִּיר עַל מִדּוֹתָיו וְכַמֵּ"שׁ עֲבוֹ"ז דָּף ד' ע"ב

and He does not overlook His attributes, as it states in Tractate *Avodah Zara* 4b:

תּוֹרָה דְּכִתְיִב בָּהּ אֱמֶת אֵין הַקֵּב"ה עוֹשֶׂה לְפָנִים מִשּׁוֹרֵת הַדִּין

Regarding the Torah, described as Truth, the blessed Holy One does not do less than the letter of the Law.

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ ב"ק נ' סע"א כָּל הָאוֹמֵר הַקֵּב"ה וְתָרַן הוּא יִתְּרוֹ חֲיִיו

Similarly in Tractate *Bava Batra* 50a: Anyone who says that the blessed Holy One makes concessions concedes his life.

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַצּוֹר תָּמִים פָּעָלוֹ כִּי כָּל דִּרְכָּיו מִשְׁפָּט

For it states in the Torah (Deuteronomy 32:4) "*Hatzur* – 'the One Who forms' – Perfect is His work, for all His paths are justice."

וְאָמַר כָּאֵן הַצּוֹר שֶׁהוּא תָּאָרוֹ ית"ש ע"ש יִצִּירַת הָעוֹלָם

The verse here states *haTzur* – a descriptive term used for Him as Creator**, may His Name be blessed, because of the formation of the world** *yetzirat ha-olam***.

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁחֲקֵי הַיִּצִּירָה וּמִשְׁפָּטֵי הַתּוֹרָה אֶחָד הֵם כֵּן"ל רפ"ד

This is because the laws governing the formation of the world and the statutes of the Torah are one, as explained above in chapter 4,

כִּי הֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הַמְצֻמָּצָם שֶׁהוּא מִצַּד עֲצָמוֹ אֵינוֹ עוֹבֵר
עַל חֲקוֹ כָּלֵל

since both of them are in the *ohr pnimi* that is constricted in such a way that in themselves they do not step outside the bounds of their laws.

אֲמַנָם כָּבֵד אֲמַרְנוּ כִּי כָל עֲקָרוֹ דָּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ מֵאוֹר
הַמַּקִּיף

However, we have already noted that the primary aspect of the *ohr pnimi* is drawn entirely from the *ohr makif*,

וְהוּא רַק חֵלֶק מִמֶּנּוּ וְהָרִי הֵם אֶחָד בְּתַחֲלָתָם וְכֵן יִתְיַחֲדוּ בְּסוֹפָם

and it is merely an aspect thereof. Accordingly, they are one at the outset, and will reunite at the end.

כִּי ע"י כָּל הַדִּין וְהַמִּשְׁפָּט הַנֶּעֱשֶׂה בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי ע"י שֶׁהוּא מֵיֶסֶד עַל
זְכוּת וְעַל חוֹבָה

This is because the judgments and rulings made by the *ohr pnimi*, due to the fact that it is founded on merit and culpability,

הֵנָּה עי"ז גּוֹפֶה יִתְקַנּוּ כָּל־ם לְקַבֵּל אֶת הַגְּלוּי דָּאוֹר הַמַּקִּיף שֶׁשֵּׁם הוּא
סוֹד הַבְּרִית

itself brings about the rectification of all of them so that they will be able to receive the light of the *ohr makif* in which the secret of the Covenant resides,

וְכֵן ל"פ"ו שֶׁע"י מִדַּת וְאַמֶּת זֹכִים לְמִדַּת וְרַב חֶסֶד

as explained above in chapter 6 – that through the attribute of Truth they are worthy of the attribute of Abundant Kindness,

כִּי מִדַּת וְאַמֶּת הָרִי הוּא ג"כ רַק מֵאוֹר הַמַּקִּיף וְלָכֵן אֵינוּ מִתְּנַהֵג בְּכָל
מִשְׁפָּטָיו שָׁבוּ

because the attribute of Truth is also from the *ohr makif*, and therefore its judgments do not act in such a way as to

לְהַשְׁמִיד וּלְהַשְׁחִית ח"ו אֶלָּא שֶׁהֵם נִמְשָׁכִים בְּתַהֲלוּכוֹת שׁוֹנוֹת

destroy or annihilate, Heaven forbid; instead they are drawn into various channels

בְּאִפֻּן שֶׁמִּשְׁפָּטָיו נֶעֱשִׂים וּמִתְקִימִים כָּל־ם וְעכ"ז נִשְׁאָר הָעוֹשֶׂה עֲבֵרָה
עַל קִיּוּמוֹ

in a manner that justice is carried out, nevertheless the person who committed the transgression remains

לְקַבֵּל אֶת כָּל טוֹב הָעֵתִיד דָּאוֹר הַמַּקִּיף

to receive in the future all the good of the *ohr makif*.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאִמַּר הַצּוֹר תָּמִים פָּעֵלוּ כִּי כָּל דֶּרֶכּוֹ מִשְׁפָּט כּו' צָדִיק וְיֹשֵׁר
הוּא

And this is why it states, "*Hatzur* – 'the One Who forms' – Perfect is His work, for all His paths are justice; righteous and upright is He."

כי הגם שכל דרכיו משפט עכ"ז צדיק וישר הוא שעושה כל משפטיו
בצדקה תמיד

For although all His paths are justice, nevertheless, righteous and upright is He, for He always carries out His judgments in a charitable way.

שכל משפטיו הם רק כדי להיטיב בסופן וייתחדו בסופן האור
הפנימי ג"כ באור המקיף

For all of His judgments are only in order to benefit in the end, and in the end the *ohr pnimi* will become one with the *ohr makif*,

כי ע"י הצרור והלבון יתקנו כלם להגלוי דאור המקיף וכנ"ל בכל
דבריו

since by means of scouring and cleansing all of them will be prepared to receive the revelation of the *ohr makif*, as we explained above.

והרי יתקים יסוד הזכות ג"כ ויקבלו את כל טוב העתיד ע"י יסוד
הזכות ויסוד הברית ביחד

Thus the principle of merit will also be upheld, and they will receive all the good of the future by way of the principle of merit and the principle of Covenant together.

כי יתחדו הם שניהם ג"כ וכ"ז הוא ע"י שמדת ואמת הוא ג"כ עקרו
מאור המקיף

For the two will become one, and all this is by virtue of the fact that the main aspect of the attribute of Truth is also from the *ohr makif*,

והוא נובע ויוצא מהתקון ישוב ירחמנו ונמשך ממדת ורב חסד
וכנ"ל פ"ו

and flows forth and emerges from the Tikun of "He will again show us mercy" and is drawn from the attribute of Abundant Kindness, as we explained in chapter 6.

ולכן הוא מנהיג תמיד רק לתכלית זה והבן כל הדברים מאד.

And therefore He leads things always only towards this purpose. Understand all of these matters very well.

Footnotes

1. See *Bereishit Rabba* 78:8 (on the verse in Genesis 33:2) [↩](#)

2. *Shnei Luchot Habrit* by Rabbi Isaiah Horowitz, d. Prague 1630. ↩
3. See Genesis chaps. 15; 28:10-15. ↩
4. 26:44 ↩
5. This is an early Kabbalistic work, assumed to be from the time of King David. ↩
6. Literally, "atmosphere," or empty space. Referring to a very lofty and indescribable aspect of *keter*. ↩
7. This could also be rendered as "the root of the entire emanation." ↩
8. *Dorshei reshumot* is a term that seems to imply a non-literal interpretation of verses. See Rashi. ↩
9. It will become evident below why we have translated it this way. ↩
10. Tractate Sanhedrin 90a ff*.* ↩
11. Tractate Sanhedrin 104b. ↩
12. Explained according to Maharsha ad loc. ↩
13. Exodus 33:19. ↩
14. Or, *Torat Kohanim*. ↩
15. *Mishna Eduyot* 2:10. ↩
16. See Zohar III, 93b; Zohar III, 73a. Ramchal, commentary to *Idra Rabba* 467-507; *Nefesh Hachaim* 4:11. ↩
17. *Mishnah, Sanhedrin* 10:1. ↩
18. Rabbi Menachem Recanati, a distinguished Italian Kabbalist 1250-1290. ↩
19. Rabbi Ezra of Gerona (d. 1227), a student of Rabbi Isaac Sagi Nahor. According to some historians, he taught Kabbalah to Ramban (Rabbi Moshe ben Nachman). ↩
20. cf. *Menorat haMaor*, ner 4, chap. 2:2b; *Shnei Luchot haBrit, Torah Ohr*, p. 222. ↩
21. See Rashi ad loc. ↩
22. Non-legalistic exegetical texts of rabbinic origin. These texts include folklore, historical anecdotes, short biographies, ethical teachings and practical advice. In many cases they also mask deeper mystical secrets. ↩
23. *Mishnah Sanhedrin* 10:1 ↩
24. Words from the *Netanah Tokef* prayer of Yom Kippur ↩
25. See Rashi ad loc. ↩
26. *Mayim nukvin*, abbreviated as *ma"n*, refers to the arousal or awakening from below to seek out the Divine and bond thereto. ↩
27. *Avodah Zara* 10b, 17a. ↩
28. Literally, "sweetened to the maximum...." ↩

Chapter 10 — The revelation of the hidden light in the creation of the world as well as in the world to come

ומעתה הנה נאמר עוד כי הנה כל הענין הזה אשר אמרנו באור
המקיר

And now we can say further: the entire concept that we discussed regarding the *ohr hamakif*,

שבו יהיה כל תקוה העתידה דכל חמדת ישראל

in which resides the future hope and desire of all Israel,

ואורו הוא בבלתי גבול ותכלית וממנו הנה כל הנסים הנגלים

is that its light is without limitation or cessation, and from it come all revealed miracles.

כי הוא בלי צמצום וגוף כלל

For it is not constricted in any way and is not manifested in any particular body.

משא"כ האור הפנימי הנה הוא מלבש בגוף וכלי ומתצמצם על ידו

This is not so with the *ohr hapenimi* which is clothed in a 'body' and a vessel that constrict it.

וממנו נעשה כל הטבע כלו וכן בו הוא כל משפטי התורה בשכרה
וענשה וכנ"ל בדברינו מפרק ד' עד כה.

And from it from the *ohr hapenimi* all of Nature is made and in it are all the laws of the Torah with its rewards and punishments, as mentioned above from chapter 4 on.

עכ"ז הנה צריכים אנו לדעת מאד כי האמת הוא

Nevertheless, we have to know very clearly that the truth is –

שהו ראשית הבראה כלו והו ראשית גלוי ית"ש בנתינת התורה

whether we are talking about the beginning of the entire Creation, or whether we are talking about the beginning of His revelation of Himself with the giving of the Torah –

הנה הנה כל ההתחלה והראשית בשניהם רק בהגילוי אור דבלתי
גבול

the inception and beginning of both of them was exclusively from the revelation of the Infinite Light.

וְהוּא הָאוֹר הָרָאשִׁין שֶׁנִּגְנַז אֲשֶׁר עָלָיו נֶאֱמַר וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהי אוֹר
כ"ו

This was the initial light that was concealed, regarding which the verse (Genesis 1:3) states, "And God said, 'There shall be light' and there was light."

The Zohar explains in a number of places (e.g. Zohar I, 16b; 31b) that there are two types of light mentioned in this verse – the light that shall be ("There *shall be* light"), for this light will only be revealed in the future; and the light that in fact was ("and there *was* light"). The former light was the ultimate intention, but it was hidden away – and is therefore referred to as the *ohr haganuz*, 'the concealed light' – emerging only for the sake of creating the worlds, and through man's righteous actions. This is referred to below as the "light [that] was good."

וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב וּבּוֹ הָיָה רִאשִׁית הַבְּרִיאָה כָּלָה

And the next verse continues, "And God saw that the light was good," and with it He initiated the beginning of the entire Creation.

וְהָגַם כִּי מֵאַחַר שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הַבְּרִיאָה בְּהָאוֹר הַגֵּנוּז אֵיךְ הָיָה אִפְשָׁר
שִׁשְׁתָּנָה ע"י הַחֲטָא

Now since the Creation was brought about with the concealed light, how was it possible that sin could affect it?

כִּי אֵיךְ נַעֲשִׂית הַחֲטָא כָּלֵל כִּי אֵיךְ הָיָה שׁוּם אִפְשָׁרִית וּמָקוֹם
לְמַצִּיאת הָרַע בְּהַעוֹם כָּלֵל

Indeed, how could one sin at all? How was there even a possibility for any evil to exist in the world?

אך הָעֲנִין בְּזֶה הוּא כִּי כָּל הַגְּלוּי דֵּהָאוֹר שֶׁנִּגְנַז אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה לְצַרֵּךְ
הַבְּרִיאָה

However, the idea is this: the entire revelation of the light that was concealed, which became revealed for the purpose of creating,

הִנֵּה הָיָה סֵדֵר גְּלוּיָו ע"פ מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל פ"א

the order in which it was revealed is according to what we mentioned in chapter 1 –

כִּי קִדָּם הַבְּרִיאָה הִנֵּה הָיָה נַעֲמָה בְּחִי' צִמְצוּם בְּכָל הַמָּקוֹם שֶׁהָיָה
עֲתִיד לְהַעוֹלְמוֹת בִּי"ע

****that before the creation there was the aspect of the *tzimtzum*-withdrawal from the entire area that would in the future become the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.**

וְכַאֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה אַח"כ הָאוֹר שֶׁנִּגְנַז לְצַרֵּךְ הַמַּצִּיאוֹת דֵּהַעוֹלְמוֹת בִּי"ע

And when the hidden light (*ohr haganuz*) necessary to bring about the existence of the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* was revealed,

הָנָה לֹא נִתְפָּשֵׁט הָאוֹר הַזֶּה בְּכָל הַמָּקוֹם דִּהְצַמְצוּם כָּלוּ

this light did not spread throughout the area of the *tzimtzum*,

שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל הַמָּקוֹם דִּהְעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁל עֵתָּה

which is throughout the space that the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* currently occupy.

אֲלֹא נִשְׁאַר עֲדִין חֵלֶק גָּדוֹל בְּהַצְמָצוּם בְּלִתִּי הָאוֹר הַזֶּה

Instead there still remains a significant aspect of the *tzimtzum* that withdrew the light,

וְהָיָה רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש שֶׁאָדָם הָרָאשׁוֹן ע"י מַעֲשָׂיו יִמְשַׁךְ וְיִתְפָּשֵׁט הָאוֹר
הַזֶּה לְמַטָּה ג"כ:

and it was His blessed will that Adam, by his righteous deeds, would draw down and spread this light below as well.

וְהָעֲנִין בְּפִרְטוֹת הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה אֵז הָיוּ הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע בְּמַדְרָגָה גְּבוּהָ
נִעְלָה מְאֹד

Specifically, at that time the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* were on a very lofty level,

עַד שֶׁכָּל עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הָיָה מְסֻתָּיִם אֵז בְּסִיּוּם הו' סְפִירוֹת
הָרָאשׁוֹנוֹת דְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה שֶׁל עֵתָּה

to the extent that the entire World of *Asiyah* ended at that time with the conclusion of the first six *sefirot* of the World of *Yetzirah* as it is currently.

וְאַח"כּ בְּעֶרֶב שַׁבַּת בְּרָאשִׁית בְּסוֹף שָׁעָה ו' כְּשֶׁנִּכְנַס אָדָם בְּגֶן-עֵדֶן

But subsequently, on the eve of the first Sabbath of Creation, at the end of the sixth hour, when Adam entered the Garden of Eden (*Gan Eden*),

הֵנָּה נִתְעַלּוּ הָעוֹלָמוֹת עוֹד וְנִסְתָּיִם כָּל הָעֲשִׂיָּה בְּסִיּוּם הו' רָאשׁוֹנוֹת
דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה שֶׁל עֵתָּה

then the worlds ascended further, and the entire World of *Asiyah* now ended at the conclusion of the first six *sefirot* of what is currently the World of *Beriah*,

וְהָיוּ הַד' רָאשׁוֹנוֹת דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה ג"כ בְּמָקוֹם הָאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁל עֵתָּה

and the four first *sefirot* of the world of *Asiyah* were also in the place which is now the World of *Atzilut*,

וְהוּא תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דִּהְעֵשִׂיָּה הָיוּ בְּמָקוֹם הוּא רִאשׁוֹנוֹת דִּהֶבְרִיאָה שֶׁל
עֵתָהּ וּמִשָּׁם וְלִמַּטָּה הָיָה מָקוֹם פָּנוּי

and the six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah were in the place of the first six *sefirot* of what is now Beriah. And from there on down was empty space.

וְהִנֵּה לֹא הָיָה נִמְשָׁךְ הָאוֹר שֶׁנִּגְנַז אֶלָּא רַק עַד סוֹף הָעֵשִׂיָּה שֶׁל אָז

Thus the hidden light (*ohr haganuz*) was not drawn down further than the end of the World of Asiyah the way it was then:

שֶׁהָיָה מִתְחִילָה בְּסוֹף הוּא רִאשׁוֹנוֹת דִּהִיצִירָה שֶׁל עֵתָהּ

it began at the conclusion of the top six *sefirot* of what is now Yetzirah,

כִּי שָׁם הָיוּ מִסְתַּיִמִּים אָז כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

for it was there that all the worlds ended,

וְכָל מִשְׁךְ הַמָּקוֹם דָּהֵד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דִּהִיצִירָה שֶׁל עֵתָהּ

and the entire span of space of the four lower *sefirot* of what is now Yetzirah.

וְהַמָּקוֹם דָּהֵי' סְפִירוֹת דִּהְעֵשִׂיָּה שֶׁל עֵתָהּ שָׁם הָיָה כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת
דִּהֶקְלִיפוֹת

And the place where the ten *sefirot* of Asiyah are now was the place where all the *kelipot* were initially. The *kelipot*, literally "shells" or "husks" are symbolic, portraying the powers of obstruction and evil.

וְהוּא סוֹד מָה שֶׁאֱמָרוּ בַּחֲגִיגָה (יב, א) מֵאִי דְכָתִיב אֲנִי א-ל שַׁדַּי

This is the mystical explanation in Tractate Chagiga (12a) on the verse (Genesis 35:11) "I am E-I Shad-ai..."

אֲנִי הוּא שֶׁאֱמַרְתִּי לְעוֹלָמִי דִּי. וְהַכֹּנֶנָה כִּי בְּמָקוֹם הִיא"ד סְפִירוֹת הִנֵּנִי

The Talmud explains: "I am He who said to My World, 'Enough!' Do not extend down any further"

שֶׁהֵם הֵד' תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת דִּהִיצִירָה וְהִיא דִּהְעֵשִׂיָּה לֹא הִמְשִׁיךְ שָׁם
מִהָעוֹלָמוֹת מְאוּמָּה

– referring to the four lower *sefirot* of Yetzirah, and the ten *sefirot* of Asiyah –
nothing was drawn down further than those Worlds,

כִּי שָׁם הֵנִיחַ מָקוֹם לְהַמְּצִיאוֹת דִּהֶקְלִיפוֹת

for He left a space there for the existence of *kelipot*.

וְלָכֵן אָמַר לְהָעוֹלָמוֹת דִּי שֶׁלֹּא יִתְפָּשְׁטוּ בְּאֵלוֹ הֵד"י סְפִירוֹת
דִּהֶקְלִיפוֹת

And therefore He said to the Worlds "Enough!" so that those 14 *sefirot* would not spread forth into the *kelipot*.

אך ע"י החטא ירדו כל העולמות כולם ונכנסו מהד' תחתונות
בהיצירה ולמטה בתוך הקלפות ממש.

But because of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, all of the worlds fell, and the four lower *sefirot* of Yetzirah and down actually descended into the *kelipot*.

והרי היה אז מציאת הקלפות בעולם ג"כ

Thus the existence of *kelipot* was manifested in the world as well,

כי לא התפשט האור הגנוז אלא רק עד סיום הז' ראשונות דהיצירה
של עתה

for the hidden light (*ohr haganuz*) extends down only until the end of the first six *sefirot* of Yetzirah as it is now.

והיו נשארו עדין מהקלפות אשר נבראו בעולם התהו באותו
המקום דהי"ד ספי' הנז'

But there still remained aspects of the *kelipot* that were created in the World of Tohu, in the place of the 14 *sefirot* mentioned,

וזוהו מה שנתן לאדם הראשון לתקן במעשיו

and it was assigned to Adam to rectify this with his deeds,

ש'משוך את האור שנגנז למטה ג"כ ולבטל אח הקליפות מכל וכל

by drawing down the *ohr haganuz* there as well, thereby nullifying the *kelipot* completely.

This is what was meant to be, but due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, the *kelipot* were not nullified. To the contrary, the worlds sank down into the *kelipot*, as the Baal haLeshem will soon explain.

והנה עקר האור שנגנז הוא רק באצילות אמןם התפשט בהארתו
עד סוף העשייה של אז

Now the primary light that was concealed originally illuminated only Atzilut; nevertheless its radiance extended down until the end of Asiyah the way it was then,

אשר היה מתחילה עד סוף הו"ר דהיצירה של עתה.

which was from the top to the bottom of the first six *sefirot* of Yetzirah as it is now.

ואח"כ בערב שבת בראשית

Then, on the eve of Shabbat Bereishit the first Sabbath of Creation,

אחר חצות כאשר נכנס אדה"ר בגן עדן ונתעלו העולמות עוד

after midday, when Adam entered the Garden of Eden and the Worlds
ascended further,

והיה מגיע העשיה עד סיום הי' ראשונות דהבריאה של עתה

so that the World of Asiyah reached the bottom of the first ten *sefirot* of what is
currently Beriah,

והד' ראשונות דהעשיה עלו ג"כ באצילות ונכללו הם בהאור הנגנז
ממש

and the first four *sefirot* of Asiyah also rose into Atzilut and merged into the
hidden light there.

אך הו' תחתונות דהעשיה נשארו עדין למטה מאצילות

However, the six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah still remained below Atzilut,

ובמקום הו' ראשונות דהבריאה של עתה ששם הוא אינו האור
הגנוז ממש אלא רק הארתו

in the place of the first six *sefirot* of Beriah as it is currently, where the actual
ohr haganuz itself does not illuminate, only its radiance.

ועי"ז היו אלו הו' תחתונות דהעשיה בסוד עץ הדעת

By means of all this, these six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah constituted the mystery of
Etz haDa'at the Tree of Knowledge.

ונתן כ"ז לאדה"ר לתקנם ולהעלותם ג"כ להאצילות

All this was handed to Adam to rectify and elevate into Atzilut,

ולהמשיך את האור הגנוז העקרי למטה ג"כ וכנז'

and draw down the main *ohr haganuz* below as well, not just its radiance, as
mentioned above and thus rectify the *kelipot* there.

אך לא די שלא תקן אלא שקלקל והוריד את כל העולמות כלם

But not only did he not rectify in the manner outlined – he ruined the situation
and caused all of the worlds to fall lower.

והיה אפשרית וסבת החטא ע"י שהיה אז מציאת הקלפות ג"כ
עכ"פ כנ"ל

The possibility for and cause of that sin was that the *kelipot* were also present in
any event, as explained above,

וע"י הו' תחתונות דהעשיה שהיו עדין בסוד עץ הדעת כנז'

and also because the six lower *sefirot* of Asiyah still constituted the mystery of *Etz haDa'at* (the Tree of Knowledge), as mentioned.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוֹ כ"ז בְּבֵאוֹר הַיֵּטֶב בְּעֵמֶק וְאַרְכָּה בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב

All of this is explained clearly and in depth in our work *Drushei Olam haTohu* part 2,

וּבְחֵלֶק הַבְּאוֹרִים בְּשַׁעַר עֲקוּדִים פ"ב בְּדְרוּשׁ עַץ הַדַּעַת שֵׁם ע"ש
וְתִמְצָא בַּעֲה"י הַכֹּל מִבְּאֵר הַיֵּטִיב:

and in the explanatory section of *Sh'aar haAkudim* chapter 2, in the exposition of *Etz haDa'at*. Check there, and with G-d's help you will find everything explained clearly.

וְנִחְזֹר לְהַעֲנִין כִּי הִנֵּה בְּרִיאַת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ וְכָל צְבָאֵיהֶם הִנֵּה הָיָה
בְּהָאוֹר הַגָּנוּז

Let's now return to the idea that the creation of heavens and earth and all of their hosts was all with the *ohr haganuz*,

וְכִמּוֹ"שׁ בְּבִרְאֵשִׁית רַבָּא (פ' י"ב ס' ו') אוֹתָהּ הָאוֹרָה שֶׁנִּבְרָא בָּהּ
הָעוֹלָם

as *Bereishit Rabba* (12:6) states: that light with which the world was created

אָדָם הָרֵאשׁוֹן עָמַד וְהִבִּיט בָּהּ מִסּוּף הָעוֹלָם וְעַד סוּפוֹ כו' ע"ש

Adam stood and gazed with it from one end of the universe to the other.

וְהָיוּ עוֹמְדִים עִי"ז כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרִאֵשִׁית כֻּלָּם בְּמִדְרָגָה גְּבוּהָ נִעְלָה
וְנוֹרָא מְאֹד

And due to this, all of the work of Creation constituted a very lofty and tremendous level.

וּבִפְרָט אָדָם הָרֵאשׁוֹן גּוּפָהּ הִנֵּה הוּא הָיָה לְמַעַלָּה מִכָּלָם

And Adam himself in particular was superior to all of them,

וְכִמּוֹ"שׁ בְּפִרְקֵי דר"א פ' י"ח וּבִתְקוּנֵי זֵהָר תְּקוּן נ"ו וּבכ"מ

as *Pirkei d' R. Eliezer* chap. 18 and *Tikunei Zohar*, *Tikun* 56 state.

אֲךָ אַחֵר שֶׁחָטָא בְּעַץ הַדַּעַת הִנֵּה יָרַד הוּא וְכָל הַבְּרִיאָה כָּלָהּ

But after he transgressed with the Tree of Knowledge, he and the entire creation fell,

וְנִתְהַפְּכוּ כֻלָּם מִכְּתִנַּת אוֹר בָּא' לְכְתָנוּת עוֹר בַּע' שֶׁהוּא מְשַׁכָּא
דְּחִוּיָא

and everything was switched from garments of light *ohr* with an *aleph* (אור) to garments of skin *ohr* with an *ayin* (עור),

כמ"ש בַּתְּרָגוּם יוֹנָתָן שֶׁם וְכֵן בַּתְּקוּנֵי זֶהָר בַּכ"מ

as *Targum Yonatan* and *Tikunei Zohar* state in a number of places.

וְהָיָה אִזְ נִסְתַּלַּק וְנִתְעַלַּם כָּל הָאוֹר דְּשֵׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרָאשִׁית

At that point all the light of the six days of Creation was withdrawn and concealed,

וְנִתְעַבְּהָ וְנִתְגַּשְׁם כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה וְנִתְמַעַט וְנִתְצַמְצַם הָאוֹר מֵאִז
וְלִהְיוֹתָה

and the entire Creation became material and corporeal, and the light became reduced and diminished from then on,

וְאִין אָנוּ מְשַׁתְּמָשִׁים עִתָּה אֶלָּא בְּאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הַמְצַמְצָם בְּמַצִּיאת
הָעוֹלָמוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁהֵם עִתָּה אַחֵר הַחֹטָא

so that currently we can utilize only the immanent light that is downgraded to the level of the worlds as they exist now, after the sin.

אֲבָל הַבְּרִיאָה דְּשֵׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרָאשִׁית עֲצָמָן הָיָה בְּאֵמֶת רַק בְּהָאוֹר
הַגָּנוּז

But by contrast, creation during those six days of Creation was only by means of the *ohr haganuz*,

אֶלָּא שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט הָאוֹר הַזֶּה בְּכָל מְקוֹם דִּהְצַמְצוּם כָּל

albeit that this light the *ohr haganuz* did not spread into the entire area affected by the *tzimtzum*,

כִּי שֶׁם נִשְׁאַר מְקוֹם לְמִדּוֹר הַקְּלִפּוֹת כַּנ"ל

because there remained a space for the *kelipot* to lodge, as we explained above.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיִּבְדֵּל אֱלֹהִים בֵּין הָאוֹר וּבֵין הַחֹשֶׁךְ

And this is the meaning of the verse (Genesis 1:4), "And *Elokim* divided between the light and the darkness"

כִּי מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהָאוֹר הַזֶּה הוּא בְּלִתִּי גָבוּל הָיָה צָרִיךְ לַעֲשׂוֹת הַבְּדִלָּה
בֵּינֵיהֶם

– because since this light the *ohr haganuz* was infinite, it was necessary to make a division between them between the *ohr haganuz* and the constricted light,

שֶׁלֹּא יִתְפַּשֵּׁט לַמָּטָה ג"כ ע"י שֶׁהוּא בְּלִתִּי גָבוּל

so that it the *ohr haganuz* would not spread down below as well because it was without limitation and would naturally spread into the place of the *kelipot* as well.

וְהָיָה נִשְׁאָר זֶה שִׁיתְקוּ ע"י אָדָם וְכֵנִי

And this constricted light remained, to be rectified by Adam, as mentioned.

וְהָיָה לָנוּ עַכְפ"פ כִּי כָל הַבְּרִיאָה כָּלוּ הֵנָּה הָיָה רַק בְּהַאֲוֹר דְּבִלְתִּי גָבוּל
אֶלָּא שֶׁ"י הַחֲטָא נִסְתַּלַּק וְנִגְנַז

In any event, we have it that the entire Creation was exclusively with the infinite light, which was withdrawn due to the sin.

וְכֵן עַד"ז גְּלוּיָו ית"ש בְּנִתְיִנַת הַתּוֹרָה הֵנָּה הָיָה ג"כ בְּהַאֲוֹר הַגָּנוּז

Similarly, at the giving of the Torah, His revelation was also that of the *ohr haganuz*,

וְלָכוּ נֹאמַר אֲנִי אֲמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם וְכַמ"ש בְּעִבּוּדָה זָרָה ה' ע"א וְע'
בְּזוּה"ק ס"פ יִתְרוֹ

and therefore the verse (Psalms 82:6) states, "You are angelic, children of the Most High" as the Talmud *Avodah Zara 5a* opines: Said Reish Lakish, "Israel did not receive the Torah other than to prevent the Angel of Death from ruling over us."

אֶלָּא שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה נֶתָּן לָהֶם עַדִּיו בְּהַחֲלִט וְהָיָה נִתְעַכֵּב עַד הַלּוּחוֹת
הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת

But it was not given to them completely as yet, and matters waited until the first Tablets would be given to them, which was only after they heard the Ten Commandments.

וְאֵלוּ שֶׁזָּכִינוּ לַהֲלּוּחוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת הָיָה חֲזוֹר לָהֶם הָאֹר הַגָּנוּז
דְּשִׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרִאשִׁית

Had we been worthy of the first Tablets, the *ohr haganuz* from the six days of Creation would have been returned to us,

וְהָיָה מִתְתְּקוֹ מֵאֵז כָּל הָעוֹלָם כָּלוּ ג"כ כְּמוֹ קֶדֶם הַחֲטָא

and the entire world would have been rectified as well – to the way it was before the sin.

וְהֵנָּה הָיָה לִפִּי"ז הַגְּלוּיָו דְּכָל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה רַק כְּאוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת

Accordingly, the revelation of the entire Torah would have been like the light of Atzilut,

אֲשֶׁר עָלֶיהָ אָמְרוּ עֲבו"ז ג' ע"ב שֶׁהַקַּב"ה יוֹשֵׁב וְעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה

regarding which the Sages state in Tractate *Avodah Zara 3b* that the blessed Holy One 'sits and occupies Himself with Torah.'

וְהוּא הָיָה ג' כ עֲבֹדַת אֲדָמָה"ר קִדְּם הַחֲטָא כִּי אֱלֹלָא הַחֲטָא

And this was also Adam's Divine service prior to the sin, for if not for the sin,

הָיָה נָתַן הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה לֵאדָמָה"ר וְזֶהוּ שְׁנֵאמַר וַיִּנְחָהוּ בְּגֶן עֵדֶן לְעֲבֹדָה
וּלְשִׁמְרָה

the Torah would have been given to Adam, which is why it states (Genesis 2:15)

"And He placed him in the Garden of Eden to work it and to guard it", which the *Tikunei Zohar* 62b explains as referring to the positive commandments and the prohibitions of the Torah.

וְהַתּוֹרָה דְּאֶצִּילוֹת הִיא כְּלָה עַל סוּד הַיְחֻד לְיַחַד הַנְּאֻצִּים זב"ז
וְכֻלָּם בְּאִין סוּף בְּיַחְוָא שְׁלִים

The Torah of Atzilut is entirely about the secret of *yichud*¹ – to unify various emanated aspects one with the other, and all of them with the *Ein Sof*, the blessed Infinite One

(ע' זוה"ק מקץ קצ"ט ב' ותרומה קס"ה ב' ואתחנן רס"ג א' ברע"מ שם)

(see *Zohar: Miketz* 199b; *Terumah* 165b; *V'etchanan* 263a, *Raya Mehemna*).

וְזֶהוּ ג' כ סוּד עֲבֹדַת הַסְּפִירוֹת שְׁאָמַר הָרָאב"ד בְּסִפְרֵי יְצִירָה פ"ב
מִשְׁנָה א'

This is also the Divine service associated with the *sefirot* as explained by the Ra'avad in *Sefer Yetzirah* 2:1.

וְע' דְּבָרֵינוּ בְּשַׁעַר הָעֵקֻדִּים פ"ג אוֹת ה' וּבְסִפְרֵי הַדַּע"ה ח"ב דְּרוֹשׁ ד'
עֶנְף כ"ו

See our exposition in *Sha'ar haAkudim* 3:5, and in *Sefer Drushei Olam HaTohu* section 2, 2:26.

אֲךְ ע"י חֲטָא הָעֶגְלָל שְׁלֹא זָכוּ לְהַלּוּחוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת הִנֵּה חִזָּר וְנִסְתָּם
מֵהֶם כָּל הָאוֹר הַזֶּה

But due to the sin of the golden calf they were not worthy of the first Tablets, and all of that light was once again sealed off to them,

וַיִּתְּלַבֵּשׂ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה בְּנוֹשָׁאִים וּלְבוּשִׁים דִּהְעוּה"ז

and the Torah became clothed in matters and garments of this world,

וְנִקְרָא מֵעַתָּה תּוֹרַת הַבְּרִיאָה כִּי הָרִי הִיא מִתְּלַבֶּשֶׁת בְּלְבוּשִׁין
דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

and was called from then on 'the Torah of Beriah' since it became clothed in garments of the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהָיָא מִיָּסַד מַעֲתָה עַל הַטּוֹב וְהָרַע שֶׁבָּהֶם

The 'Torah of Beriah' is now focused² on the good and evil within them within the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah –

לְשׁוֹר מִהָרַע שֶׁבָּהֶם וְלַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת הַטּוֹב שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת מַעֲשִׂיּוֹת

guarding against the evil in them, and promoting the good in them, via all the positive commandments

שֶׁהֵם נַעֲשִׂים כָּלָם רַק בְּגוּיף וּנְפֶשׁ דֵּהֶעוּה"ז עֲצָמוֹ

which can all be performed only with a body and soul in this world itself, but not in the World to Come**.**

וְהֵם הָעֹשֶׂה וְלֹא תַעֲשֶׂה כִּי כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת ל"ת הֵם כָּלָם לְשׁוֹר
וּלְהִרְחִיק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ

These are the injunctions and prohibitions, because the purpose of all the prohibitive commandments are all in order to guard against and distance a person

מִכָּל מָה שֵׁישׁ לְהָרַע אַחֲזִיזָה וּנְגִיעָה בּוֹ

from anything to which evil is attached or touches.

וַע"ד שֶׁכָּתוּב וַיִּגַּע בְּכַף יָרְכוֹ עַל כֵּן לֹא יֹאכְלוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כּו'

For example, the verse (Genesis 32:26, 33) that states "And he the angel touched the socket of his hip... Therefore the Children of Israel do not eat the sinew of the hip-socket to this day..."

זֶהוּ הַטַּעַם לְכָל הַטְּמְאוֹת וְהָאֲסוּרִין שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה כַּמ"ש הַגֵּר"א
בְּתַקּוּנִים מ"א סע"א וְע' בְּזוּה"ק וַיִּשְׁלַח ק"ע ע"ב וְקע"א ע"ב

And this is the reason behind prohibiting contact with all the impure and things forbidden by the Torah, as the GRA writes in Tikunim 41a. See also Zohar, Vayishlach 170b, 171b.

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתַקּוּנִים תְּקוּן כ"ב שֶׁכָּל הַל"ת הֵם נִכְלָלִים בְּהַדְיָבוּר
לֹא יִהְיֶה לָךְ אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים עַל פְּנֵי

And this is also what they said in the Tikunim, Tikun 22 – that all the prohibitions are included in the second utterance of the Ten Commandments "You shall not recognize the gods of others in My Presence" (Exodus 20:2).

כִּי כָּלָם הֵם לְשׁוֹר וּלְהִרְחִיק אֶת עֲצָמוֹ מִמָּה שֵׁישׁ לְהָרַע אַחֲזִיזָה
וּנְגִיעָה בָּהֶם

This is because the purpose of all of them is in order to guard against and for a person to distance himself from anything to which evil is attached or touches.

וְנִשְׁמְרוּ אוֹתָם כְּלָם אֶז מְקִיָּם הֵלֹא דִלָּא יִהְיֶה לָךְ

And by guarding against all of them, then he fulfills the prohibition of "You shall not recognize the gods of others..."

וְכֹו לְהִפְךָ בְּמִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה כִּי כְלָם הֵם לְהַמְשִׁיךְ עַל עֲצָמוֹ אוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ
שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה וְאֱלֹהוֹתוֹ עָלָיו

And the opposite is true of the positive commandments – for all of them draw down upon a person the holy light of the blessed Holy One and His Godliness,

וְנִמְצָא כִּי בִקְיוֹם הַמ"ע מְקִיָּם מ"ש אֲנֹכִי ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ

so that by discharging the positive commandments, one fulfills the verse (Exodus 20:2) "I am the Lord your God..."

זֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר בְּתִקּוּנִים שֵׁם ע"א ע"ב כִּי כָל הַמ"ע הֵם כְּלוּלִים בְּאֲנֹכִי

And this is why it states in Tikunim there p. 71b that all the positive commandments are all included in "I am the Lord your God..."

כִּי הֵם כְּלָם פְּרָטִים בְּמֶה לְהַמְשִׁיךְ עַל עֲצָמוֹ אֱלֹהוֹתוֹ וּמַלְכוּתוֹ
וְקִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש

– because all of the positive commandments are specific means by which to draw down His blessed Godliness and Sovereignty and Holiness upon himself.

וּמִשּׁוּם כָּל זֶה הֵנָּה נִתְלַבֵּשׁ הַתּוֹרָה בְּנוֹשָׂאִים וּלְבוּשִׁים דְּהַעוּה"ז לְפִי
מְצִיאֻתָהּ אֲשֶׁר יָרְדָה אַחֵר הַחֲטָא

And because of all this the Torah is clothed in matters and in garments pertaining to this world as it exists after its descent due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge.

וּמִיִּסַּד הַתּוֹרָה מֵעֵתָה עַל הַטּוֹב וְרַע טָהוֹר וְטָמֵא אָסוּר וּמִתָּר כָּשֵׁר
פָּסוּל חַיֵּב זָכָאי

So now the Torah is focused on good and evil, spiritually pure and impure, prohibited and permitted, valid and invalid, guilty and innocent,

לְהַתְרַחֵק מֵהַטְּמָאָה וְהָרַע וּלְהִתְקַרֵּב וּלְהִדְבֵּק לְכָל הַטּוֹב טָהוֹר
וְקָדוֹשׁ

in order to distance a person from spiritual impurity and evil, and draw him closer to cleave to the good, the spiritually pure and the holy.

וְעוֹמֵד הַתּוֹרָה מֵעֵתָה לְפָנֵינוּ רַק בְּצוּרֵת תּוֹרַת הָאָדָם הַתַּחְתּוֹן
דְּהַעוּה"ז

The Torah stands before us now only in the form of the Torah of man below in this world,

וְכֹל כָּל שְׂכָרָהּ וְעִנְשָׁהּ הַגְּלוּיִם בָּהּ הֵם כָּלֵם ג' כֹּךְ מֵהָעוֹה"ז

and similarly the rewards and punishments revealed in it are also only those that pertain to this world.

וְהוּא עִנְיֵן הַכָּרֶת וְאֲבִדוֹן הַנֶּאֱמָר בָּהּ וְכַךְ"ל בְּכָל עֵמֶק הַדְּבָרִים
שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל

This is the matter of excision and destruction mentioned earlier and examined in depth as expounded above.

אָמַנְם כָּל הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוֹת הַזֶּה הֵן דְּהִתּוּרָה וְהֵן דְּהִבְרִיָּאָה

However, all of this 'cloaking' – whether in the Torah or in Creation –

הָרִי הוּא הַכָּל רַק ע"י הַחֲטָא וְהוּא רַק מֵעַתָּה הַחֲטָא עַד שְׁיִגְיַע עַת
הַתְּקוּן דְּקֶץ הַיָּמִין

is only a result of sin the sins of Adam and Eve and the Tree of Knowledge, and the sin of the golden calf and only from the time of the sin and on, until the time of the Tikun at the End of Days.

כִּי ע"י הַחֲטָא דְּעֶץ הַדַּעַת נִתְּגַשְׁמָה וְנִתְּעַכְרָה הַבְּרִיָּאָה כְּלָה

Due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge the entire creation became more corporeal and sullied,

וְע"י חֲטָא הָעֵגֶל נִתְּלַבֵּשׁ וְנִתְּגַשֵּׁם הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה

and due to the sin of the golden calf the entire Torah became cloaked in mundane and worldly matters³

וְאִין אָנוּ מְשַׁתְּמָשִׁים מֵעַתָּה אֲלָא רַק בְּהָאֹר הַפְּנִימִי הַמִּמְעָט
שֶׁבְּשִׁנְיָהֶם אֲשֶׁר נִתְּצַמְצַם לְפִי הַגּוּף וְהַלְבוּשׁ שֶׁבָּהֶם

so that now we make use only of the *ohr hapenimi*, the lesser of the two levels of light, as the *ohr* which is constricted according to the body and garment in which it is clothed.

אָבֵל עֲקָרוֹ וּיְסוּדוֹ שֶׁבִּתְחִלָּה הָרִי הָיָה בְּשִׁנְיָהֶם

But initially the primary and fundamental aspect of both of them

רַק בְּהָאֹר הַגָּנוּז וּבְהָאֹר הַזֶּה שֶׁם הוּא סוּד בְּרִית אָבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

was only the *ohr haganuz*, and in this *ohr* was the secret of the covenant of the Patriarchs and Israel,

אֲשֶׁר סִבְתּוֹ הִיא נוֹרָא וְנֶעְלָם מְאֹד וְכַמ"ש בְּמִלְאֲכֵי א'

the reason for which is awe-inspiring and very shrouded in mystery, as the verse states in Malachi 1:2-3

אָהַבְתִּי אֶתְכֶם אָמַר ה' וְאַמְרָתֶם בְּמָה אֶהְבְּתֵנוּ הֲלֹא אָח עָשׂוּ לַיעֲקֹב
נָאֻם ה' וְאַהֲבֵ אֶת יַעֲקֹב. וְאֵת עָשׂוּ שְׁנֵאתִי...

'I loved you, says God.' But if you say, 'How have you loved us?' How do we know that your love is for *us*, and not merely by virtue of the righteousness of the Patriarchs?⁴ God declares, **'Wasn't Esau the brother of Jacob, yet I loved Jacob, and Esau I despised...'** even though he too was the son of Isaac and the grandson of Abraham.

וְאָמַר הָאֲרִיזָל "ל בְּסוֹף סֵפֶר אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שֶׁקֶל כֶּסֶף

The Arizal said about this at the end of the work *Arba Me'ot Shekel Kesef*

שֶׁהַכֹּנֶה הוּא עַל שְׂרָשָׁם אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה שְׂשָׁם הוּא שְׂרָשׁ שְׁנֵיהֶם קִדָּשׁ
קִדָּשִׁים

that the intention of the verse cited above is regarding their root above – there the root of both of them is the holy of holies.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר הֲלֹא אָח עָשׂוּ לַיעֲקֹב נָאֻם ה' וּבְשְׂרָשָׁם לְמַעַלָּה הֵרִי הֵם
שְׁנֵיהֶם שְׂוִים וְעַכְ"ז וְאוֹהֵב אֶת יַעֲקֹב

And this is what the verse states – God declares, 'Wasn't Esau the brother of Jacob...?' for in their root above both of them are equal, yet despite this, 'I loved Jacob.'

וְכֵן בִּנְחֻמֶּיהָ ט' אֶתָּה הוּא ה' הָאֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר בָּחַרְתָּ בְּאַבְרָם כו'

And similarly a verse in Nehemiah 9:7 states: 'You are God, the Lord who chose Abram...'

וְהִרִי אָמַר אֲשֶׁר בָּחַרְתָּ שֶׁהוּא רַק בִּבְחִירָה וְרָצוֹן גַּם זֹלַת וְקִדָּם
מַעֲשֵׂי הַטּוֹבִים

Note that it states 'You... chose' – for it is only by way of choice and will that He chose Abram, aside from and prior to his good deeds.

וְכֵן בִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ כ"ד כֹּה אָמַר ה' אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעֶבֶר הַנָּהָר יָשְׁבוּ
אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם מֵעוֹלָם תֵּרַח אָבִי אַבְרָהָם וְאַבִּי נָחוֹר כו'

And similarly in Joshua 24:2-3: Thus said God, the Lord of Israel: 'Your forefathers – Terach, the father of Abraham and the father of Nachor, always dwelt on the other side of the river, and they served the gods of others.

וְאָקַח אֶת אֲבִיכֶם אֶת אַבְרָהָם כו' הִרִי אָמַר וְאָקַח שֶׁהוּא מוֹרָה ג"כ
שֶׁהִיָּה הַלְקִיחָהּ רַק בְּרָצוֹן גַּם זֹלַת מַעֲשֵׂי הַטּוֹבִים

'But I took your forefather Abraham...' Note that it states 'I took' indicating that this was only because He so willed, aside from his Abraham's good deeds.

וְאָמַר עוֹד וְאָרַב אֶת זַרְעוֹ וְאָתַן לוֹ אֶת יִצְחָק כו'

The verse continues 'And I multiplied his seed and I gave him Isaac...'

וְאָמְרוּ עַל זֶה בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם פְּסָחִים פ' הַלָּכָה ה' וְאָרַב כְּתִיב (חֶסֶר ה')

Regarding this it states in the Talmud Yerushalmi, *Pesachim* 10:5 it is written as אָרַב without the ה'. It should be written as וְאָרְבָּה with the letter *hai* at the end of the word.

נַעֲשִׂיתִי לוֹ אוֹרֵב אִין חֲטָא מִתָּן לִיה אִין זָכָה מִתָּן לִיה

The reason it is written without the *hai* is to suggest that I became his guarantor – if he did not sin a son would be given to him, and even if he was not worthy a son would still be given to him.

וּר"ל שֶׁהֵייתִי מַסְתַּכֵּל וְאוֹרֵב עָלָיו לָתֵן לוֹ אֶת יִצְחָק וְלִהְיוֹת אֶת זַרְעוֹ

Meaning to say, I gazed upon him and was his guarantor to give him Isaac, and to multiply his descendants,

בֵּין אִם חֲטָא הֵייתִי נֹתֵן לוֹ בֵּין אִם זָכָה הֵייתִי נֹתֵן לוֹ

whether he sinned or not, I would grant this to him, or whether he was worthy thereof or not, I would grant this to him.

וְכָל זֶה הוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כִּי עָקַר לְקִיחַת הָאֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

All of this is as we said: the primary aspect of taking i.e. choosing the Patriarchs and Israel

מָה שֶׁלָּקַח אוֹתָם הַקֵּב"ה אֵלָיו וּבָחַר בָּהֶם לְקַדְּשָׁהּ בְּקִדְּשָׁתוֹ
בְּעִבּוּדוֹתוֹ וּבְתוֹרָתוֹ

– that the blessed Holy One took them to Himself and chose them to sanctify them with His holiness, His service, and His Torah –

הוּא הַכֹּל רַק בְּסוֹד שֶׁרֶשׁ הַבְּרִית וְלֹא בְּזָכוֹת

is all exclusively due to the secret of the Covenant, not due to merit.

וְגַם כָּל הַזָּכוֹת גּוֹפָה הוּא ג"כ רַק מְסוֹד הַבְּרִית וּמִי שֶׁאִינוּ בְּבְרִית
הֵנָּה כָּל זְכוּתָם אֵינָם זְכוּתִים כָּלֵל

And even merit itself also emerges only from the secret of the Covenant, so that the 'merits' of one who is not part of the Covenant are not merits at all,

כִּי אֵינָם פּוֹעֲלִים לְמַעַלָּה מֵאוֹמָה וּמִמִּילָא הוּא שֶׁאֵין שׁוּם זְכוּת
לְמַטָּה ג"כ

because they have no effect above at all, and thus inevitably they bear no merit below either.

וְכָל בְּרִית הַנֶּה הוּא מְכָרָח שְׂיִתְקִים וְלָכֵן כָּל מִי שֶׁהוּא בְּבְרִית הַנֶּה
יִתְקִים בּוֹ כָּל פְּעֻלַּת הַזְכוּת ע"פ

Now every Covenant must of necessity be fulfilled, and therefore, for one who is
part of the Covenant, the effect of merit will perforce endure,

ע"פ סיבובים מסבובים שונים אשר יסד גדל העצה ורב העלייה
ית"ש

by one means or another, as established by the One who is 'great in counsel and
mighty in deed' (Jeremiah 32:19), may His Name be blessed.

ועי"ז הנה יזכו כל ישראל כלם לאור ולהאיר באור פני מלך חיים
לעולמי עד

In this way all of Israel without exception will be worthy of illumination and to
illuminate others forever with light of the living King's countenance.

והוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו לעיל שגם כל אור הפנימי המצמצם

This is according to what we stated above, that all the immanent constricted *ohr*
hapanimi

הנה הוא יוצא ונמשך רק מהאור המקיף והרי הוא עצמו רק
תמצית הארה מהאור הגנוז אשר הוא יסוד כל הבריאה כלה

emerges from and is drawn down exclusively from the transcendent light of the
ohr hamakif, which is itself only the distillation of a radiance from the *ohr*
haganuz, which is the foundation of the entire Creation.

ולכן כל מה שנעשה בו הנה הוא ג"כ רק לתכלית היסוד הראשון

And therefore everything that is done with it is also only for the purpose of this
first fundamental, the *ohr haganuz*.

אלא משום שהוא רק תמצית ממנו הנה נעלם כל הנהגתו מעיני
כל חי איך שמגיע גם הוא רק לתכלית אור הגנוז העקרי.

But because the immanent constricted *ohr* is merely a distillation thereof, how He
conducts matters exclusively for the sake of the *ohr haganuz*, which is the
primary goal, is concealed from the view of all living creatures.

אבל עכ"פ הוא כי כל הנהגתו של עתה היא ג"כ לעולם רק
לתכלית זה

In any event, all of His conduct at present is also always exclusively for this
purpose.

ומתנהג הקב"ה עם ישראל בדרכים מדרכים שונים הן בעוה"ז

And the blessed Holy One acts towards Israel in many different ways, both in this world

וְהוּן בְּעוֹלָם הַנִּפְשוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְאַחַר מִיתָה כְּדִי לְקַיֵּם בָּהֶם סוּד הַבְּרִית
and in the World of Souls after death, in order to fulfill with them the mystery of the Covenant

אֲשֶׁר הוּא אֵי אֶפְשָׁר שִׁישְׁתַּנֶּה וְעִי"ז יִזְכּוּ כָּלֶם עַכ"פּ לְהַאֲוֹר הַגָּנוּז בְּלִי
חֲסוֹר אֶחָד מֵהֶם

which is impossible to change, and through this, no matter what, all of them without exception will merit the *ohr haganuz*.

אֲךָ הַסֵּפֶה בְּזֶה הֵנָּה הוּא נֶעְלָם עֲתָה מֵעֵינֵי כָּל חַי וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁאִמְרוּ
לְעֵיל

But the reason for this is hidden for now from the eyes of any living creature, as we noted above,

שֶׁגַּם עֲנִין הַזְּכוּת הוּא תָּלוּי ג"כ רַק בְּסוּד הַבְּרִית כִּי מִי שֶׁאִינוּ בְּבְרִית
הוּא אִינוּ בְּזְכוּת כָּלֶל

so that even when it comes to merit, that too is dependent only upon the secret of the Covenant, for one who is not part of the Covenant has no merit at all.

וְהָרִי הֵנָּה סוּד הַבְּרִית נֶעְלָם מֵאֵד וְהֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּסוּד מָה שֶׁאִמְרוּ

Thus the mystery of the Covenant is very concealed, and it is exclusively the secret of what the Sages declared:

קב"ה וְאוֹרֵיטָא וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מִתְקַשְּׁרִין דָּא בְּדָא כַּמ"ש בַּפ' אַחֲרֵי ע"ג א'
וְע"ש ע"ב וְדִי בְּזֶה:

the blessed Holy One, the Torah and Israel are bound to one another, as it states in Zohar *parshat Acharei* p. 73a. Let this suffice regarding the matter.

Footnotes

1. *Yichud* is the unification of supernal elements in (and by) one's mystical devotions in prayer and/or mitzvah performance. [↩](#)
2. The literal translation is 'based,' but that may give the impression that the foundation of Torah is good and evil, which the *Baal HaLeshem* clearly points out is not the case. [↩](#)
3. 'Worldly' in the sense of physicalized, corporeal, material. [↩](#)
4. Malbim [↩](#)

Chapter 11 — The essence of the hidden light is supernatural and above that of the revelation of the hidden light

וְכַאֲשֶׁר נִתְּבוֹנֵן בְּזֶה אָנוּ רוֹאִין כִּי ע"ד שְׁאֻמְרָנוּ שְׂרָאשִׁית הַבְּרִיאָה
וְהַתְּחִלָּתָה הִנֵּה הָיָה בְּהָאֹר הַגָּנוּז

When we contemplate this matter, we see a similarity to what we noted regarding the inception and the beginning of Creation – which was by means of the *Ohr Haganuz* the Hidden Light,

וְהוּא יְסוּדָה הָעֶקְרִי אֲשֶׁר אֵלָיו תִּחְזֹר לְבִסּוּף

which is the primary foundation to which it will return in the end.

וְכֵן נִתְּיֵנָה הַחֹרָה בַּתְּחִלָּתָה שֶׁהֵם הַדְּבָרוֹת הָרִאשׁוֹנִית הָיָה ג"כ
מֵאֹר הַגָּנוּז

And likewise, when the Torah was given initially, in the form of the Ten Commandments, the first two were also from the *Ohr Haganuz*.

וְכֵן תִּתְּגַלֶּה לַעֲתִיד בְּכָל עֶקְרָה כַּמ"ש בַּפ' בְּהַעֲלֹתְךָ קִנ"ב א'

So too, in the future, the entire root of *Ohr Haganuz* will be revealed, as the *Zohar* states in *parshat Behalotecha* p. 152a.

עַד"ז הוּא ג"כ כִּי רִאשִׁית מְצִיאת הָאֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה ג"כ רַק
בְּהֶאֱרַת אֹר הַגָּנוּז

This is also similar to what transpired at the very beginning of the existence of the Patriarchs and the Israelites – which was also from the radiance of the *Ohr Haganuz*.

כִּי הָיָה מְצִיאוֹתָם שְׁלֹא מִן הַטֶּבַע וּלְמַעַלָּה מִן הַטֶּבַע לְגִמְרִי

For their existence was not natural, but completely transcended the natural world.

כִּי מְצִיאת אֲבִרָהּם אָבִינוּ ע"ה וְלִדְתוֹ הָיָה שְׁלֹא מִן הַטֶּבַע כִּי נוֹלַד
מִבִּיאָה כְּזוֹ אֲשֶׁר ע"פ טֵבַע אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְאִשָּׁה לְהַתְּעַבֵּר כָּלֵל מִבִּיאָה
כְּזֶה

Our Patriarch Abraham's existence and his birth were not natural, since he was born from a union that according to nature could not possibly have enabled a woman to become pregnant,

וְכַמ"ש הָאֲרִיז"ל בַּלְקוּטִי תוֹרָה אִיּוֹב וְכֵן בְּסִפְר הַגְּלִילוֹתִים פָּרָק נ' דָּף
ס"ז דְּפוּס פְּרַעַמִּישְׁלָא. וְע"ש הַסּוּד וְהַטֵּעַם בְּזֶה. וְע' רַמְב"ן וִיקְרָא

י"ח פסוק י"ט.

as the Arizal writes in *Likutei Torah, Iyov* and in *Sefer Hagilgulim* chap. 50 p. 67 in the Premishlan edition. See there the esoteric explanation and reason for it. See also Ramban, *Vayikra* 18:19.

וְכֹן אֲבָרָהֶם וְשָׂרָה וַיִּצְחָק וְרִבְקָה כָּלֹן עֲקוּרִים הָיוּ כַּמ"ש בִּיבְמוֹת
ס"ד א'

In addition, Avraham and Sarah, and Isaac and Rebecca were all barren, as the Talmud *Yevamot* 64a states.

וְכֹן רָחֵל וְלֵאָה שְׁנֵיהֶן עֲקֻרוֹת הָיוּ כִּי גַם לֵאָה הָיְתָה עֲקָרָה כַּמ"ש
בְּאַגְדַּת בְּרֵאשִׁית פ' נ"ב

Similarly, Rachel and Leah were also barren – even Leah was barren initially, as it states in the *Aggadata, Bereishit* ch. 52.

וַזֶּהוּ שְׁנֵאֹמַר וַיֵּרָא ה' כִּי שְׁנוּאָה לֵאָה וַיִּפְתַּח אֶת רִחְמָהּ וַכַּמ"ש בַּב"ר
ר"פ ע"א

This is why the verse (*Bereishit* 29:31) states, "And Hashem saw that Leah was shunned, so He opened her womb" – as *Bereishit Rabba* 71 states.

וְהָרִי הָיָה מְצִיאת הָאֵבוֹת וְהַשְּׁבָטִים שֶׁלֹּא מִן הַטֶּבַע כָּלֹל

Thus the existence of the Patriarchs and the Tribes was not natural at all.

וְכֹן בְּרִדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמִצְרַיִם וְנַעֲשׂוּ שֵׁם לְשָׁשִׁים רְבּוּא שֶׁהוּא מִסְפָּר
מְסֻגָּל וּמִיחָד לְקַבְּלַת הַתּוֹרָה

Similarly, the Israelites descended into Egypt as a family group numbering only 70 souls and became a large nation of 600,000 – a special and unique number¹ – who received the Torah,

וַכֹּמוּ שְׁאֹמְרוּ בְּמַכִּילֶתָּא יִתְרוּ בַּפְּסוּק וְהָיוּ נִכְנִים לַיּוֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שְׁאֵם
הָיָה חֹסֵר אֶחָד מֵהֶם לֹא הָיוּ כִּדְאֵי לְקַבֵּל

as it states in *Mechilta, Yitro*, on the verse (*Shemot* 19:11) "Let them be ready on the third day..." upon which the *Mechilta* comments: If even one of them was missing, they would not have been worthy of receiving the Torah.

וְכֹן הוּא בַּב"ר פ' ע' סִימָן מ' וּדְבָרִים רַבָּא פ' ז' סִימָן ח'.

A similar statement is found in *Bereishit Rabba* chap. 70 para. 40, and in *Devarim Rabba* chap. 7 para. 8.

הָרִי מָה שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ לְמִסְפָּר רַב כִּזֶּה בְּמִשְׁךְ רַד"ו שְׁנָה מֵע' נֶפֶשׁ לִס' רְבּוּא
הַגְּבָרִים לְבַר מִטָּר

That they became a nation of such a large number in a span of 210 years – 600,000 men alone, excluding children from only 70 souls,

ובמכילתא שם אמר ר' עקיבא שהוא לבד נשים וזקנים

and the *Mechilta* states in the name of Rabbi Akiva that this excluded women and the elderly –

והוא כמו שאמרו בבא בתרא קכ"א ע"ב שהמספר דס' רבוא הוא
מכ' עד ס'

and as our Sages state in *Bava Batra* 121b that the 600,000 included only men between the ages of 20–60.

ובשמות רבא ריש פ' מ"ב אמרו כי היו ס' רבוא של זקנים וכן ס'
רבוא של בחורים וכן של נערים וכן של נשים

In *Shemot Rabba* beginning of chap. 42 the Sages state that there were 600,000 elders, 600,000 young men, and 600,000 male youths and a similar number of women!

ובתרגום יונתן שמות י"ב ל"ז אמר כי הסף היה ה' לכ"א והיו הסף
לבד ש' רבוא

***Targum Yonatan (Shemot 12:37)* states that each family had five babies, and there were 600,000 babies alone!**

והרי מה שנעשו מע' נפש למספר רב ועצום כזה במשך רד"ו שנה
הרי הוא למעלה מהטבע לגמרי

Whatever the calculation – that 70 souls became such a huge number in the space of 210 years – it's way beyond the natural order,

וכמו שהאריך בזה בספר נפלאות ה'

as the work "*Niflao't Hashem*" discusses at length.

והרי לנו כי מציאת האבות והשבעים וישראל היה שלא מן הטבע
ולמעלה מן הטבע לגמרי

Thus it is that the existence of the Patriarchs and the 70 souls of Israel was way beyond the natural order.

וכן עד"ז כל ההנהגה שבהם שהם הנסים נגלים דגאלת מצרים
ושבמדבר

And similarly, the entire manner in which they the Israelites were guided – by means of open miracles at the time of the Exodus from Egypt and in the Sinai desert –

שהיה הכל אלהות גמור והיה כ"ז ג"כ שלא בזכות רק בבירית

for everything was totally Divine intervention, and none of it was due to their merits but rather because of the Covenant,

וכמ"ש יחזקאל מ"ז רבבה כצמח השדה נתתיך ותרבי ותגדלי כו'
ואת ערם ועריה כו'

As the verses in *Yechezkel 16:7–8* attest: "I made you as numerous as the plants of the field; you increased and grew... but you were naked and bare... i.e. without *mitzvoth****2**

ואשבע לך ואבוא בבְּרִית אִתְּךָ כו' וְתִהְיֶי לִי
and I took an oath to you and entered into a covenant with you... and you became Mine."

וְהָרִי לָנוּ מִכ"ז כִּי כָל מֵה שְׁאַמְרָנוּ לַעֲלֹל מִתְקַוְּתָנוּ הֶעֱתִידָה שֶׁהוּא
כָּל תְּקוּנוֹת חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל

What we conclude from all this is what we stated above regarding our future hopes, the hopes and longings of all Israel,

שֶׁהִיא יִתְקִים בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּלָם עכ"פ כִּי הוּא מְסוּד אֹר הַמְּקִיף
which will be fulfilled for every Jew, since it is the secret of the *ohr makif* the Divine revelation that is too lofty to be clothed in the vessels of the *sefirot* and therefore remains in a state of 'resting upon them' or enveloping **them** rather than being vested within them. See above *Sha'ar* 6:3.

אֲשֶׁר כָּל גְּלוֹי אֹרֻוּ וּפְעֻלָּתוֹ הוּא לְמַעֲלָה מִן הַטֶּבַע וּלְמַעֲלָה מִן
הַמַּדָּה

This *ohr makif* is revealed and acts in a manner that transcends nature, and transcends limitations.

כָּבֵר הָיָה זֶה לְעוֹלָמִים וְאַדְרָבָּה הוּא כִּי הוּא הָיָה יְסוּד כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה
כֻּלּוֹ וְיְסוּד כָּל מְצִיאת הָאָבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל

This revelation of the *ohr makif* already happened throughout the ages; to the contrary, it was the very foundation of the entire Creation, and was the fundamental factor in the existence of the Patriarchs and Israel.

וְכִבֵּר הַתְּחִיל הָאֹר הַזֶּה לְהִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בְּמַתָּן תּוֹרָה
And this *ohr* began to be revealed to us when we were given the Torah,

וּבְזֹהָר אֹרֻוּ גְּאֻלָּנוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם וְכֵן הִלְכָנוּ לְאֹרֻוֹ כָּל הַמ' שָׁנָה בְּמִדְבָּר
עַד כְּבוֹשׁ הָאָרֶץ

and with the radiance of this *ohr* He redeemed us from Egypt, and we traveled with its light all 40 years in the desert, until the Land was conquered.

כי כל זהר אורו שהאיר אז בישראל היה רק ע"י משה רבנו ע"ה

For the entire radiance of this light that illuminated the Israelites at that time was only through Moshe Rabeinu, peace be upon him,

שנאמר עליו ותרא אותו כי טוב הוא והוא מאור הגנוז הנאמר עליו
וירא אלהים את האור כי טוב

regarding whom the verse (*Shemot* 2:2) states, "and she saw that he was good," for the house became filled with light (*Sotah* 12a; Rashi). This was from the concealed light about which the verse (*Bereishit* 1:4) states, "And G-d saw that the light was good" and He concealed it for the righteous in the future,³

וכמ"ש בזוה"ק שמות י"א ב' ופ' בראשית ל"א ע"ב ע"ש

as it states in the *Zohar II Shemot* p. 11b; and *Zohar I Bereishit* p. 31b. See there.

ובשנסתלק משה חזר האור ונתעלם ולכן ולא ידע איש את קברתו
משום שהוא מהאור שנגנז. ע' זוה"ק יתרו פ"ט רע"א.

When Moshe passed on that *ohr* once again became hidden, and thus "no one knows his burial place to this day" (*Devarim* 34:6), because it is from the light that was concealed. See *Zohar II, Yitro* 89a.

אך לעתיד לבוא הנה נאמר מה שהיה הוא שיהיה שר"ת משה

But regarding the future, the verse (*Kohelet* 1:9) states, "That which was, will be" – where the initial letters of these words form the name Moshe,⁴

כי הוא היה גואל ראשון והוא יהיה גואל אחרון וכמ"ש בתקונים
תקון ס"ט קל"א ע"א ובהג"ר א"ש קל"ז ע"ב דה"מ ולבתר ע"ש

since Moshe was the first redeemer and will be the final redeemer, as the *Tikunim Tikunei Zohar Tikun* 69 p. 131a states. See GR" A there, p. 137b, beginning ולבתר. See there.

ולכן נאמר מיכה ז' כימי צאתך מארץ מצרים אראנו נפלאות

Therefore the Prophet Michah states (7:15), "As in the days when you left the land of Egypt, I will show you miracles,"

כי הגלוי דהאור הזה הוא כלו למעלה מהטבע וכל פעולותיו הוא
נסים נגלים

for the revelation of this *Ohr* completely transcends the natural realm, and all of its activities are revealed miracles.

וזהו מה שייסדו אפס בלתך גואלנו לימות המשיח

This is also what the Sages established in the Shabbat morning liturgy "there is nothing without You, our Redeemer, in the days of *Mashiach*...

כִּי יִהְיֶה כָּל גְּאֻלָּה הָעֲתִידָה הַכֹּל לְמַעַלָּה מִהַטָּבַע וְע"י הַקֵּב"ה לְבַד
וּבְהִגְלוֹי דְּהָאֹר הַגָּנוּז.

for the entire future redemption completely transcends the natural realm, and will be enacted by the Blessed Holy One alone, with the revelation of the hidden *ohr*.

וְכֹן אָמְרוּ בְּפִסְיקְתָא רַבְתִּי פְסָקָא ל"ו כִּי עִמָּךְ מְקוֹר חַיִּים בְּאוֹרְךָ
נִרְאָה אֹר.

And so is stated in *Pesikta Rabbati* 36 on the verse (*Tehillim* 36:10) "with You is the source of life; by Your light we will see light" –

אֵיזָה אֹר שֶׁכִּנְסַת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִצְפָּה זֶה אֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיֵּרָא
אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאֹר כִּי טוֹב שֶׁהוּא הָאֹר שֶׁנִּגְנָז.

regarding this the *Pesikta* asks: Which is the *ohr* that the Congregation of Israel yearns for? This is the light of *Mashiach*, regarding which it states (*Bereishit* 1:4), "And G-d saw that the light was good" – this is the concealed light.

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה גְאֻלַּת מִצְרַיִם ע"י הַקֵּב"ה לְבַד וְכִמ"ש בַּעַל הַגָּדָה
יִוְצִיאֵנוּ ה' מִמִּצְרַיִם לֹא ע"י מַלְאָךְ וְלֹא ע"י שְׂרָלִים

Just as it was in the days of the redemption from Egypt, where the Blessed Holy One acted alone, as the *Haggadah* declares, "G-d took us out of Egypt – not by means of an angel and not by means of an emissary.

כִּי גַם מָה שֶׁהָיָה נַעֲשֶׂה ע"י מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן הָיָה ג"כ רַק אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר
וְלֹא בְכַח אֲנוֹשֵׁי כָּלֹל

For what was achieved by Moshe and Aaron was also completely an act of the Divine; not by the power of man at all.

כִּי הָרִי מָה שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה כָּל מִימֵי מִצְרַיִם לָדָם ע"י שְׁהָרִים אַהֲרֹן אֶת
הַמָּטָה וַיַּךְ אֶת הַמַּיִם אֲשֶׁר בַּיָּאֵר

That all the water in Egypt turned to blood when Aaron raised his staff and struck the waters of the Nile River –

הָרִי לֹא הָיָה זֶה מִכֹּחַ אֲנוֹשֵׁי כָּלֹל וְעַד"ז כָּל הַמַּכּוֹת כָּלֵם.

is something not at all within the capacity of a human being to achieve. The same applies to all the plagues.

וְכֹן קְרִיעַת יַם סוּף שֶׁהָיָה ע"י שְׁהָרִים מֹשֶׁה אֶת הַמָּטָה וְנָטָה יָדוֹ עַל
הַיָּם

Similarly, the splitting of the sea took place after Moshe raised his staff and stretched his arm out over the sea –

הָרִי לֹא הָיָה כִּזְמִיכָה אֲנוֹשִׁי כָּלֵל וְהָיָה הַכֹּל אֱלֹהוֹת לְבַד

none of this was in the power of a human being to achieve; it was all a Divine feat exclusively.

וְמָה גַּם כִּי עָקַר הַגְּאֻלָּה שֶׁהָיָה ע"י מַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת הָרִי לֹא הָיָה בָּזָה שׁוּם מַגֵּעַ יָד מִמֶּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ ע"ה אֶלָּא מֵהַקֵּב"ה בְּכַבּוּדוֹ וּבְעֶצְמוֹ

And particularly in view of the fact that the redemption was primarily the result of the plague of the firstborn, in which Moshe Rabeinu had no hand at all; rather, it came exclusively from the holy Blessed One Himself.

וְהָרִי אָמַר בְּעַל הַגָּדָה הַיָּטִיב וַיּוֹצִיאֵנוּ ה' מִמִּצְרַיִם לֹא ע"י מַלְאָךְ וְלֹא ע"י שְׁלִיחַ

The author of the Passover *Hagaddah* expressed this well in the statement that "G-d Himself took us out of Egypt – not by means of an angel and not by means of an emissary.

וְכֹן יִהְיֶה גְאֻלָּה הָעִתִּידָה וְכַמ"ש כִּימֵי צֵאתְךָ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם אֲרָאֵנוּ נִפְלְאוֹת

And so too regarding the future redemption, as the verse (*Micha* 7:15) states: "As in the days when you left the land of Egypt, I will show you miracles."

וְכַמּוֹ שֶׁיִּסְדּוּ אֶפֶס בְּלִתְךָ גּוֹאֲלֵנוּ לַיָּמֹת הַמְּשִׁיחַ.

This is also what the Sages established in the Shabbat morning liturgy "there is nothing without You, our Redeemer, in the days of *Mashiach*,

וְאָמְרוּ בְּבִרְכוֹת סַפ"א כִּי כָּל הַנְּסִים דְּגְאֻלַּת מִצְרַיִם יִהְיוּ טָפֵל לַהַנְּסִים דְּגְאֻלָּה הָעִתִּידָה.

Furthermore, the Sages declared in Talmud *Berachot* end of ch. 1 that all of the miracles of the Redemption from Egypt will be inferior to the miracles that will take place in the future redemption.

וְע' בְּקִהְלֵת רַבָּא פ"א בַּפְּסוּק אֵין זְכוֹרוֹן לְרֵאשׁוֹנִים כו' ע"ש.

– see *Kohelet Rabba* ch. 1:11 on the verse "There is no recollection of former times..." See there.

וְכֹן כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה גְאֻלַּת מִצְרַיִם גַּם בְּעֵת שֶׁהָיוּ הִלְלוּ עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹ"ז וְהִלְלוּ כו'

And just as with the Redemption from Egypt, where there were idol-worshippers among the Israelites,⁵ just as there were among the Egyptians,

כֹּן גְאֻלָּה הָעִתִּידָה גַּם בְּדוֹר שֶׁכָּלוּ חֵיב.

so too, with the future Redemption, and even if the entire generation will be unworthy.

ועד"ז בענין התגלות התורה אמרו בקהלת רבא פ' י"א בפסוק כי אם שנים הרבה יחיה.

A similar statement is made by the Sages in *Kohelet Rabba* ch. 11 on the verse (11:8) "Even as a man lives many years..."

תורה שאדם למד בעוה"ז הכל היא לפני תורתו של משיח.

upon which the Sages comment: **The Torah a person learns in this world is insignificant⁶ compared with the Torah of Mashiach.**

וע' תנחומא פ' תבוא ובאותיות דר' עקיבא אות ז' ע"ש עוד בזה.

See also *Midrash Tanchuma, Tavo and Otiyot d'Rabbi Akiva* 7 regarding this matter.

וכ"ז הוא כי עקר אור הגנוז יתגלה רק לעתיד ולכן יהיה אז עקר כל הנסים ועקר הגלוי דאור התורה:

Now all of this is primarily because the *ohr haganuz* the concealed light will be revealed only in the future; therefore the greatest miracles and the primary revelation of the light of Torah will take place then.

והנה אור הגנוז הוא אורא עלאה אורא דלא אתפס נהורא דרדל"א

Now this *ohr haganuz* is referred to in *Zohar Chadash* (70a, 73a, 74a**^{7**}) as 'the upper exosphere' in the Kabbalistic sense, i.e. spiritual light (or illumination) that is not yet manifested as spiritual light, and the 'exosphere' that cannot be comprehended, the light of RADL" A⁸ the beginning that is not and cannot be known, the innermost dimension of *Keter*,

דאִתְגַּנֵּז בְּרִישָׁא דא"א וּמִמֶּנּוּ הוּא כָּל הַחֲוָרְתָּא שֶׁהֵם הֵתֵר"כ עֲמוּדֵי אור

that is concealed within the uppermost aspect of *Arich Anpin*. The lower aspects of *keter* we can relate to, and from there emerge all aspects of clear light⁹ which are the 620 pillars of light that emerge from *keter*.¹⁰

אֲשֶׁר שֵׁם הוּא סוּד בְּרִית אֲבוֹת וְיִשְׂרָאֵל וְהוּא שֶׁשׁ דָּכָל הַמְּקִיפִין שֶׁהֵם מְאִירִים בְּלִתִּי גָבּוּל וּלְמַעְלָה מִן הַמִּדָּה.

Therein is the mystery of the Covenant Hashem made with the Patriarchs and with Israel, and that is the root of all the aspects of *makifim* illuminations that are not clothed within the *sefirot* or the Worlds that illuminate without limitations and transcend any calibration.

וְלַעֲתִיד יִתְיַחַד כָּל אֹר מְקִיף בְּאֹר פְּנִימִי וּבְסוֹד הַכְּתוּב תְּהִלִּים ע"ד
אֶתְה רִצְצֶתָ רָאשֵׁי לִוְיָתָן... אֶתְה בְּקֻעַת מַעְוֹן וְנַחַל

In the future all the aspects of the non-manifested *ohr makif* will merge with the internalized *ohr penimi*, as in the mystical explanation of the verses in *Tehillim* 74:14–15 "You crushed the heads of the Leviathan¹¹... You split open fountain and stream..."

וְכֵן בִּישְׁעֶיהָ מ"א אֶפְתַּח עַל שְׂפֵיִים נְהָרוֹת וּבְתוֹךְ בְּקֻעוֹת מַעְיָנוֹת

Similarly in Isaiah 41:18 "I will open up rivers on the hilltops and springs in the midst of valleys..."

כִּי יִזְדַּכְּכוּ הַכֵּלִים וְיִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל צִמְצוּם

since the vessels will be refined or purified and the entire *tzimtzum* the constriction that led to the creation of finite worlds will be nullified,

וְיִתְיַחַד כָּל אֹר פְּנִימִי בְּהִמְקִיף שְׁלוֹ וַיֵּאָר הַכָּל בְּלִי חֶק וּגְבוּל.

and the *ohr pnimi* will unite with its *ohr makif* and everything will be illuminated without restrictions and limitations.

וְהוּא ע"פ מַה שְּׁאַמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל כִּי מִשְׁרָשָׁם הָיָה אֹר הַפְּנִימִי עִם אֹר
הַמְקִיף אֹר אֶחָד מִמֶּשׁ

This is as we stated above, that in their root the *ohr hapenimi* and the *ohr hamakif* are actually one light,

אֲלָא שְׂאוֹתוֹ הַחֶלֶק אֹר אֲשֶׁר נִכְנָס מִבְּפָנִים הוּא נִתְצַמְצַם ע"י הַגּוֹף
וְכָלִי

only that the aspect of the light that enters into i.e. is vested in the created worlds is restricted by the body and vessel of those created beings,

וְנִעֲשֶׂה עי"ז הָאֹר"פ עִם הָאֹר הַמְקִיף לְשָׁנִי מִיָּגִי אֹרוֹת וּלְתַכּוֹנוֹת
שׁוֹנוֹת

so that the *ohr hapenimi* and the *ohr hamakif* become two types of light, with differing characteristics.

אֲבָל כְּאֲשֶׁר יִתְגַּלֶּה אֹר הַמְקִיף בְּתוֹקֶף אֹרוֹ וְיִזְדַּכַּךְ עי"ז כָּל הָעֶבְיִת
דְּהַגּוֹף וְכָלִי

But when the *ohr hamakif* becomes revealed in all its potency and all the coarseness of the body and vessels becomes refined,

אֲזַי לֹא יִהְיֶה עוֹד שׁוּם הַפֶּסֶק בֵּין אֹר הַפְּנִימִי לְאֹר הַמְקִיף וְיִחְזְרוּ
לִהְיוֹת לְאֹר אֶחָד מִמֶּשׁ

then there will be no disruption between the *ohr hapenimi* and the *ohr hamakif*, and they will return to become a single light in actuality.

וַיֵּאִירוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם בְּלִי חֶק וּגְבוּל כָּלֵל שֶׁהוּא לְמַעַלָּה מִהֵטָבֵעַ לְגַמְרִי
וּלְמַעַלָּה מִן הַמַּדָּה לְגַמְרִי.

Both of them will shine forth without restriction and limitation – something transcending nature completely and way beyond calibration.

וְהִנֵּה נִתְבָּאֵר מִדְּבָרֵינוּ ג"כ כִּי אִזְרַח הַנִּסְיִי הוּא בְּאַמֶּת יְסוֹד כָּל
הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה

Thus we have explained that this miraculous *ohr* the *ohr haganuz* is in fact the foundation of the entire Creation,

אָלָא שְׁנַגְנִז וְנִתְעַלַּם ע"י הַחֲטָא דַּעֲהָד"ע [דְּעַץ הַדַּעַת] וְכַמ"ש בַּב"ר
פ' י"א וּפ' י"ב

but was hidden away and concealed due to the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, as *Bereishit Rabba* chaps. 11, 12 explains.

וְאִזְרַח נִתְצַמְצַם לְכָל חֶקִי וּגְבוּלֵי הֵטָבֵעַ

Only then was the light constricted by all of the restrictions and limitations of nature.

אֲךָ הִיא תְּלוּיָהּ בְּרָצוֹנוֹ ית"ש וּבְרָצוֹתוֹ חוּגָג וּבְרָצוֹתוֹ מְמוּגָג

Nevertheless, all of this depends upon His blessed Will as the Yom Kippur liturgy**¹²** states, "Like molten glass in the hand of the glassblower – he shapes it at will and dissolves it at will" –

וְהֵם כָּל הַנִּסִּים הַנִּגְלִים אֲשֶׁר הֵם מִהָאִזְרַח דְּבִלְתִּי גְבוּל שֶׁהוּא הָאִזְרַח
הַגְּנוּז

this alludes to all the revealed miracles that derive from the infinite light, which is the *ohr haganuz* the concealed light

אֲשֶׁר הוּא הִיָּה יְסוֹד הָעוֹלָם בְּעֶצֶם וּבְרֵאשׁוֹנָה

which was in essence the foundation of the world from the outset,

וְכַמּוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמָר וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי אֹר וַיְהִי אֹר וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת הָאֹר
כִּי טוֹב

as the verses (*Bereishit* 1:3–4) state, "And G-d said there shall be light, and there was light," and "G-d saw that the light was good..."

וְהוּא נִבְרָא קִדְם בְּרִיאַת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עוֹטָה אֹר בְּשִׁלְמָה
וְאַח"כּ נּוֹטָה שָׁמַיִם כִּירִיעָה, וְכַמ"ש בְּשִׁמוֹת רַבָּא פ' ט"ו סִימָן כ"ב

This light was created before He created the heavens and earth, as the verse (*Tehillim* 104:2) states, "He donned the light like a cloak" and only afterwards, "He spread out the heavens like a curtain" (*ibid.*), as *Shemot Rabba* 15:22 states. See there.

וּבְזָה מִבְּאֵר כָּל מָה שֶׁהִפְלִיגוּ הַחֻקִּים בְּעֵינֵי הַנָּסִים

This provides the answer to the investigations of the philosophers regarding miracles (how they came to be) –

כִּי אֲדַרְבָּה הוּא שְׁאוֹר הַנָּסִי הוּא יְסוֹד הָעוֹלָם שֶׁבְּתַחֲלָה

since, to the contrary, this miraculous *ohr* is the foundation of the universe from the outset,

וְהַאֲרִכְנוּ בְּזָה בְּסִפּוֹר הַכָּלָלִים כָּלֵל ב' וְשֵׁם כָּלֵל י"ט וּבכ"מ מִמְדְּבָרֵינוּ

as we discuss at length in *Sefer Haklalim*, *klal* 2, *klal* 19 and in a number of other places in our works.

וְכֵן יִחְזֹר הוּא לְהָאִיר וּלְהַתְגַּלֵּה לַעֲת קֵץ הַיָּמִין וְבו יִזְכּוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל
כָּלֵם לְכָל תְּקוּת חֲמֻדַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל בּב"א:

This light will return to illuminate and become revealed at the end of days, and all of Israel will be worthy of that which the Jewish People have always hoped and yearned for, speedily in our days!

Footnotes

1. See *Megaleh Amukot*, *Ofen* 186 that this refers to the 600,000 soul-roots of the Jewish people that corresponds precisely to the 600,000 letters in the Torah. Now although there are only 304,805 letters, the 600,000 includes vowel letters that are not included in the text, but are implied in the pronunciation of the word (e.g. a *yud* for a *chirik*, a *vav* for a *kubutz*, etc). Furthermore, the letters of the name ישראל spell out אותיות רבוא אִתּוֹת – there are 600,000 letters in the Torah. ↩
2. *Mechilta d'Rabbi Yishmael* 12:6. And therefore they were given two *mitzvot* – *brit milah* and the *Pesach* offering (*ibid.*) ↩
3. Talmud *Chagigah* 12a. ↩
4. *Sha'ar Hagilgulim*, *Intro* 38 – משה = שיהיה הוא שיהיה = משה ↩
5. See *Zohar II*, 170b. ↩
6. Literally "hot air", nothing ↩
7. In the Margolios print. ↩

8. רדל"א = רישא דלא ידע, ודלא איתידע [↪](#)
9. See *Zohar I*, 42b; *Zohar III* 128b. The Arizal explains that the חיוורתא (literally 'white light') is the whiteness of the 'skull' of *Arich Anpin* (see *Eitz Chaim* 13:5, *Mahadura Tinyana*). [↪](#)
10. The gematria of *keter* is 620, corresponding to the 620 letters of the Ten Commandments (*Baal HaTurim Shemot* 20:13; see Rashi *Shemot* 24:12). These 620 pillars of light represent the elicitation of those aspects of *keter* from which the 613 *mitzvot* of the Torah and the 7 *mitzvot* of the rabbis (= 620) emerge (see Rabbi David Vital's *Keter Torah*, cited in the Rama's *Torat haOlah* 3:38; *Shela, Yitro (Torah Ohr* 12). [↪](#)
11. Referring to Pharaoh and his ministers (Metzudat David). [↪](#)
12. In the lyric [↪](#) כִּי הִנֵּה כַחֲמֹר